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DIVINE EMBRACE

A Celebration Of The Romance Of The Ages!

A Unique Collection of Scriptures with Commentary

Answering Many Relevant Questions

The Ideal Study Aid

to go hand in hand with the Mirror Study Bible

DIVINE EMBRACE: An inspirational bouquet of mirror thoughts

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Stella's Secret by Lydia du Toit is beautifully illustrated by Wendy Francisco.

Their email address is info@mirrorword.net and website, www.mirrorword.net

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DIVINE EMBRACE

THE 2020 REVISION

A Bouquet of Inspirational Mirror Thoughts

Chapters 3-13 are 4 messages I preached in 1990

These were transcribed from audiotapes

Which were later printed in little pocket-size booklets

In 2007 we added 2 more chapters

Then another 4 chapters were added in 2010

Now, the completely revised 2020 edition, has 30 chapters

I have also updated all relevant scripture references from

The Mirror Study Bible

(Unless otherwise indicated)

Introduction

Religion thrives on two lies: distance and delay.

Divine Embrace celebrates the initiative that God undertook to cancel every possible definition of separation. Immanuel is introduced to an indifferent, often hostile humanity, as their lover. Their sins did not distract from this extravagant love.

Our calendar acknowledges the fact that more than 2000 years ago, human history was divided into a before and after Christ. While the vast expanse cannot even begin to measure or define God, their invisible image and likeness is made known in the only possible space wherein their being can be fully and accurately be unveiled, human life.

The mission of Jesus was not to begin the Christian religion but to reveal and redeem the image and likeness of God in human form. He did not come as an example for us but of us. Much of popular Christian doctrine reduces the life and teaching of Jesus to yet another

'display-window' message, while the very intent of God was to uncover the blueprint life of our design in Christ as in a mirror, where he is introduced to us not as Christ in history, or Christ in outer space, nor even as Christ in a future event, but as Christ in you! This alone completes your every expectation! Col 1:27. In John 14:20 Jesus announces the conclusion of his amazing mission: his brilliant act of salvation was not to reserve a place for a few in a distant heaven, but to redeem our oneness! He boldly declares, "I and the Father are one! If you have seen me you have seen the Father." Anything we thought that we knew about God that is unlike Jesus is not God. "In that day (the day that you hear the good news) you will know that I am in my Father and you in me and I in you!"

God is closer to you than your next breath! Any definition of distance is replaced with oneness. Oneness is not the end result of our diligent striving to get closer to God; oneness is the discovery of a union made in heaven - and a reconciliation that realizes this union here and now as the supreme reality of or being!

The good news announces our moment by moment point of reference in this life. Intimate romance is ours for all eternity! "He is not far from each one of us!" Says Paul to a group of idol worshiping philosophers in Athens. Acts 17:23-31.

Every sacrifice ever brought in any religious context is an appeal to innocence; be it as fragile or momentarily as it may.

In Jesus Christ, God speaks the most radical scapegoat language of the law of judgment and brings final closure to a dead and redundant system! In Psalm 40:6,7, it is clearly stated that God does not require sacrifices or offerings! Jesus is the Lamb of God! He collides victoriously with the futile sacrificial system whereby offerings are constantly made to the pseudo, moody, monster gods of our imagination! This is the scandal of the cross! God does not demand a sacrifice that would change the way he thinks about mankind; he provides the sacrifice of himself in Christ in order to forever eradicate sin-consciousness from our minds and radically change the way we think about our Maker, one another and ourselves! [Sin-consciousness is in essence a works-based consciousness.] God did not clothe Adam with the skin of an animal because of a divine need to be appeased, but because of their unconditional love for Adam; they spoke the language of Adam's own judgment: Adam, not God, was embarrassed about his nakedness. The clothing was not to make God look at Adam differently, but to make Adam feel better about himself! And ultimately it was to prophetically prepare Adam for the unveiling of the mystery of mankind's redemption in the incarnation. Here Deity would clothe themselves in human skin, in a Son; and the Lion of Judah would become the Lamb of God in order to free our minds to re-discover his image and likeness in our skin! See 1 Peter 1:2.)

Our sins resulted in his death; his resurrection is proof of our innocence. Rom. 4:25.

In the economy of God every single human life is equally represented and included in Christ. God is not more Immanuel to some than what he is to others!

In the light of the good news there can no longer remain an 'us and them'! Nothing that you can ever do can make you more God's, and nothing that God can ever do can make him more yours!

The thought of you intrigues your Maker with delight!

Faith has nothing to do with your ability to concentrate on God for at least five uninterrupted minutes; faith is a glorious awakening to the fact that your Maker is mindful of you. Yes indeed! God's mind is full of you!

Jesus is what God believes about you! Jesus is God's mind made up about the human race! Awake to your innocence, awake to oneness!

His words are kisses; his kisses words. Everything about him delights me, thrills me through and through! Song of Songs 5:14,15 (The Message)

The Mirror Message - Chapter 1

People often ask me how we got started in this wonderful mirror message. There are many moments of reflection and impression that triggered our awareness and appreciation of God's love initiative. My parents and others have laid such a sure foundation in demonstrating the simplicity of the love of God and his desire to bring about closeness and friendship. I will briefly mention four outstanding encounter-moments, which were my early awakenings to this message:

The first was in October 1978 during a devotional time. I remember how it dawned on me that we cannot even begin to understand the cross until we realize Genesis 1:26. We were made in the image and likeness of God. It was not our pitiful state that moved God to pay such a ridiculous price for humanity's redemption; it was his love knowledge of our likeness that persuaded this act. My mother used to say, "The lost coin never lost its original value!"

Imagine how your mind changes about the value of something when you hear what price it was sold for at an auction!

At first you cannot understand why someone would pay such absurd price, until you learn that it was an original painting by Vincent van Gogh!

You are worth exactly what God has always known to be true about you!

A priceless authentic Masterpiece!

The man who redeemed the hidden treasure sold all that he had to buy the entire field! Math 13:44. I began to see that while we reduce the cross of Christ to a mere historic and sentimental reference, the amazing mystery of what actually happened there, remains veiled from us.

I was reading systematically through the Bible at that time, doing two chapters daily from both the Old and the New Testaments. Part of my reading one morning, was from 1 Kings chapter 6. Verse 1 was certainly God's way of powerfully arresting my full attention! Lydia and I were dating exactly 4 years and 2 months that day which I realized with a shock when I read, "In the fourth year, in the month of Ziv, which is the second month, he began to build the house of the LORD!" (And I was thinking that maybe I should be like Paul and don't marry!)

My mind was still spinning with thoughts about Lydia, when suddenly verse 7 jumped

off the page! "When the house was built, it was with stone, cut to perfection in the quarry; so that neither hammer nor axe nor any tool of iron was heard in the temple, while it was being built." What struck me was the thought, that something happened to the stone in the quarry, to cut it to such precision, that no further chiseling was needed! How do we define the quarry in our theology? So much of our sincere Christian doctrine encourages us to believe that God has to employ the 'hammer and chisel' method to continually chip away little by little of our characters and traits, to hopefully, eventually prepare us for heaven one day! We believed that God would use anything, such as your spouse, your boss, a neighbor or even the neighbor's dog!

If our perfection and sanctification depend on how many years we spend in some wilderness, domestic, financial or perhaps some human crisis we are facing, then sanctification would be reduced to the law of works and human experience again, and we would have to pray and play for time! We would need to grow as old as possible, because this will take at least a lifetime!

The finished work of the cross is the quarry! Not your marriage or job or any size crisis for that matter!

In the light of the finished work of Christ, I became convinced that any doctrine that distracts from the success of the cross is a waste of time to pursue. The only possible way we can delay the glory that follows the cross is to underestimate what happened there, when Jesus died and cried: "It is finished!" If it did not happen in the death and resurrection of Jesus it is not going to happen anywhere else! In God's economy Jesus died humanity's death, once and for all! None of the rulers of the religious system of the day understood this mystery; if they had, they would never have crucified the Lord of glory! 1 Cor. 2:8, 1 Cor. 1:30.

While the cross cannot be reversed, our understanding of how included we were in his death and resurrection can be veiled; yet this 'veiling' can only happen with our permission! Paul says that the minds of the 'unbelievers' are blinded from seeing the light of the gospel, which is the glory of God, unveiled in the face of a man, as in a mirror! 2 Cor. 4:4 and 2 Cor. 3:18. Unbelief simply means to believe a lie about oneself, just as Israel did. (Num. 13:33)

I was in a mission at that time where inner-healing, with an emphasis on back-tracking emotional hurts, spiritual warfare and deliverance were very popular teachings; I began to see how many of our pet doctrines and interpretations clashed with the simple, but most powerful and liberating message of the success of the cross.

In the genius of God, the body of Jesus on the cross was the document of humanity's guilt; by taking guilt out of the equation, God disarmed every definition of accusation and forever cancelled the devil's claim to blackmail human life! Col. 2:14,15.

Sadly, from many pulpits, it has become fashionable to preach a defeated devil back into business, almost as though Pharaoh had not been thoroughly defeated in the prophetic picture of Israel's deliverance! Israel did not die in the desert because of an inferior deliverance out of Pharaoh's hand! Ex. 14:13 "And Moses said to the people, "Fear not, stand firm, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will work for you today; for the Egyptians whom you see today, you shall never see again." Israel wasted forty years living a neutralized life in the wilderness and that entire generation except two died because they believed a lie about themselves and underestimated their salvation! Num. 13:33; Josh. 2:11; Heb. 2:3. The supernatural is proof of God's mercy and not proof of faith; Israel witnessed miracles on a 24/7 basis for forty years, yet, they died because of unbelief.

The next passage in my reading that day was from 1 Pet. 2, and I quote v 2-5 "Like newborn babies, [born anew in his resurrection! 1:3] crave the pure spiritual milk, that by it you may grow up to salvation; for you have tasted the kindness of the Lord. Come to him, to that Living Stone, rejected by men but in God's sight chosen and precious; and like living stones be yourself built into a spiritual house." (Haha! Two months later this verse was on our wedding card!)

Jesus is the Living Stone and we are like him! Even as newborn babies we share his perfection; no chiseling required, only nurturing! We grow up by our addiction to the undiluted milk of the pure gospel that proclaims how Jesus fulfilled and perfected the prophetic word of our salvation. Peter says in the previous chapter that we were born anew when Jesus was raised from the dead!

What God spoke prophetically about the sufferings of Christ and the subsequent glory is the living and incorruptible seed of the Word. This truth realized, awakens in us newness of life! Col. 1:6. In the calculation of God we died with him and were raised together with him! Hosea 6:2, Eph. 2:5. Notice that Peter writes, "You are built into a spiritual house." Peter doesn't tell us to first get chiseled and shaped in order to eventually become something useful to God! The language of the Old Testament was, "Do, in order to become", while the language of the New Testament is, "Be, because of what was done!" We do not grow in completeness; we only grow in the awareness of our completeness!

It is interesting to note that it is Mr. Rock himself (Petros) who writes about us being living stones! When asked who he thought Jesus the Son of Man was, it was revealed to Simon, that Jesus was the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Immediately Jesus introduced Simon to the fact that even he, the son of Jonah, was hewn from the same Rock! Deut. 32:18 "You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who gave you birth." Isa. 51:1 "Hearken to me, you who pursue deliverance, you who seek the LORD; look to the Rock from which you were hewn, and to the quarry from which you were dug." It is upon this same Rock that God builds his ekklesia and the gates of hades (ignorance) shall not prevail against his ekklesia's claim! Jesus has come to introduce humanity to themselves again, because they have forgotten what manner of person they are! "By the waters of reflection my soul remembers who I am!" Ps. 23:2,3.

The second memorable encounter was during our honeymoon in January 1979. In the Bourke's Luck area in Mpumalanga, Lydia and I met a nature conservation officer who told us the remarkable story of how they had released a Black eagle that had been caged in the Pretoria zoo for ten years. This incident happened about a week prior to our visit.

She told us how excited they were when the bird finally arrived from Pretoria in its wooden crate. They knew that this was the day for the eagle to return to the life and environment of its design. It would never need to waste another day in a cage.

Their excitement soon turned to frustration when, after opening the cage, the bird just sat there with blank eyes, not at all realizing that it was free to fly! This continued for several hours; ten years of caged life had trapped this poor creature's mind in an invisible enclosure! What could they do to get the eagle to realize that it was indeed free? Then, after several hours, the eagle suddenly looked up, and in the distance the call of another eagle was heard; immediately the zoo-eagle took off in flight!

No flying lessons are required when truth is realized! This story gives such clarity and content to the fact that Jesus came to the planet not to upgrade the cage of Jewish or any other religion by starting a new brand called, 'the Christian religion,' but to be the incarnate voice of the likeness and image of God in human form! He came to reveal and redeem the image of God in us! His mission was to mirror the blueprint of our design, not as an example for us but of us! Col.1:15, 2:9-10.

James, the younger brother of Jesus says, we have forgotten what manner of people we are. In God's belief, mankind was always associated in Christ even before the

foundation of the world. Jesus died humanity's death and when the stone was rolled away, we were raised together with him! Every human life is fully represented in him! "After two days he will revive us; on the third day, he will raise us up!" Hosea 6:2. See also Eph. 1:4, and 2: 5-6 "While we were still dead in our sins he made us alive together with him and raised us together with him!" If the gospel is not the voice of the free eagle it is not the gospel.

The third vivid memory that molded this message in me, happened a few years later. In 1983 I was asked to pastor a church in White River, Mpumalanga. Until that time I was preaching in the schools of Kangwane along the border of the Kruger National Park. I would speak only once or perhaps twice a week to the same audience. But now, as a pastor I was concerned at the prospect of having to address the same group of people almost daily. One morning I was specifically praying about this when God reminded me of the miracle of the five loaves and two fish. I realized that Jesus just continued to multiply the same five loaves and two fish! He did not at some point run out and then had to ask for a few more fish or another loaf of bread! The numbers two and five somehow prompted me to read 2 Cor. 5. My eyes were drawn to verse 16; I have read through the Bible many times by then but never saw this scripture before! "From now on therefore, I no longer know anyone from a human point of view!"

I remember reading it over and over and just weeping with a revelation that flooded my whole being!

How could we have missed this for so long, I cried!

I then read Paul's previous statement in verse 14, For the love of Christ constrains us, because we are convinced that one has died for all; therefore all have died! Also verse 15, Now if all were included in his death, they were equally included in his resurrection. This unveiling of his love redefines human life! Whatever reference we could have of ourselves outside of our association with Christ is no longer relevant!

Suddenly verse 17 made new sense! It already was a favorite scripture of mine for a long time, and the only one that I had underlined in the chapter. Paul never wrote "If" anyone is in Christ he is a new creature! Instead he began the sentence with "Therefore!" If we discover what the therefore is therefore it changes the "If" from being a condition to being a glorious conclusion! From a question mark to an exclamation mark! Good news cannot get any better than that!

Our ministry immediately transformed, people began to respond to the gospel like

we've never witnessed before!

So to now have people warn me about including too many in the good news, is too late!

If the gospel we preach does not begin with the fact that every person on the planet is equally valued and included in Christ, well then our good news is just not good enough!

The danger was never to exaggerate the gospel, but always to underestimate it! Something happened to mankind in Christ, which is by far superior to what happened to mankind in Adam!

And it happened without our permission!

While we were still dead in our sins and trespasses, God made us alive together with Christ and raised us up together with Christ and seated us (fallen humanity) again together with Christ! Nothing could elevate us more than that. Eph. 2:5,6; Col. 3:1-3.

Truth is already true long before anyone but God believes it! We wouldn't have anything worthwhile believing if it wasn't true to begin with! Belief doesn't make a mathematical equation true! Discovering the truth certainly makes it true for you!

This is why we urgently and passionately proclaim the gospel!

Many are living in blindfold mode and suffering the judgment of the DIY tree, while Jesus already brought that judgment to an end! "When I am lifted up on the cross, I will draw all judgment unto me!" Behold the Lamb of God who took away the sin of the world!

I always say that the best test to true teaching is to see how the fruit of it fulfills the whole law! We knew how impossible it was to love the Lord our God with all our hearts and all our minds and all our strength, never mind loving our neighbor as we loved ourselves! The guilt and duty-driven law of willpower could never do it!

This gospel ignites romance with our Maker like nothing else does! And equal to that, not inferior to that, we find ourselves passionate about people!

There is no more beautiful gospel!

In the most dramatic fashion God persuades Peter to no longer call any one unholy or unclean! In Acts 10:10-16, 28 Peter is hungry and ready for another home-cooked meal; then, he is shocked out of his appetite! What he sees could be a horror movie to his delicate Kosher mind! Haha! Every unclean bird, reptile and animal is announced

clean by God! This is not after they've been killed, cleaned and chopped up into little blocks; then, camouflaged in herbs and spices, and slow-cooked into a stew. No! They are still parading around in their skins, scales, warts and feathers! On the outside nothing seems to have changed, but they're about to become part of Peter's menu!

The Lamb of God has taken away the sin of the world! It is about time that the good news of great joy is proclaimed with bold clarity!

Mankind is the property of God, both by design and redemption! "The earth is fully the Lord's, the world and those who dwell in it!" Psalm 24:1.

It is so important to ponder the Genesis of it all; where did we begin? "Let us make man in our image and likeness!" What an amazing thought to consider that Elohim knew us before they even formed us in our mother's womb. Our brief history on this planet did not introduce us to the Father, Son and Holy Spirit! We are their love dream; how easy it becomes then, to understand the gospel and why our Father paid a non-negotiable price to redeem his own. He bought the whole field because only he knew the treasure it holds. Jer. 1:5, 2 Cor. 4:7 and Matt. 13:44.

Fourthly, the mirror message became a very prominent ingredient of our ministry focus in the next few years. It dawned on me that James, the younger brother of Jesus, also once knew his brother merely from a human point of view; John 7:5 "For even his brothers did not believe in him!" But after the resurrection, Jesus specifically also appears to James. 1 Cor. 15:7.

The enormous impact of this encounter prompted James to discover and write that God birthed us by the Word of truth, and to hear this word is to see the face of your birth as in a mirror! James understood that what was veiled from us in the Law of Moses was now redeemed in us in the law of perfect liberty! We are no longer window-shopping. While the Old Testament represented a display window of promises, the New Testament unveils mankind's redeemed likeness and innocence as in a mirror. The one who gazes deeply into this law of our perfect liberty discovers the freedom of their redeemed identity!

James shows how contradiction attempts to veil a person's mind in unbelief and give one a 'valid' excuse to walk away from the influence of the mirror word and thus immediately forget what manner of person they are.

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them

hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing themselves]*, **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.**

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life [of their original design.] They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kupto**, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]**parameno**, to remain captivated under the influence of; **meno**, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]**eleutheria**, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

One day I had the pleasure of taking a famous photographer on a scenic boat trip in the bay of our hometown, Hermanus South Africa. I could tell by the size of his camera lenses and equipment that he was not your average tourist.

He explained to me that he needed to sell only two photographs a year to cover his budget! I was impressed to say the least and felt privileged and delighted to watch the artist at work. With fluent skill he would exchange lenses and film and go about his work.

After about two hours with the wonderful Southern Right whales we were on our way back to the harbor when we witnessed a flock of a few hundred Cape Cormorants.

The next moment they all took off in flight; the rhythm and unison of their wings were like a ballet reflecting on the water.

Our photographer friend was happily clicking away when suddenly he shouted, "I've got it! I've got it!"

It was amazing to witness the joy in the man's face. He knew that he had captured a moment that would be worth more than all the equipment in the boat. He immediately proceeded to pack away his expensive gear and carefully zipped up the waterproof bags. I then watched him relax and sit back, glowing with delight.

I couldn't help but reflect on what must have been the greatest moment when, for the first time in the history of the universe, the invisible Creator witnessed their image and likeness on display in fragile, tangible human form. And God saw everything that he had made and said, "Behold, it is very good." And God entered into his rest.

The Sabbath was a celebration of perfection, rather than a break from a busy and exhausting schedule, to observe a religious ritual. God did not rest because he was exhausted, but because he was satisfied. (Gen 1:31; Zeph 3:17).

I became absorbed with the thought of photography; magic moments of light, shape, color and movement arrested and stored on film or in memory to be reproduced in a million glossy magazines or framed in art galleries. These exhibitions would be appreciated in any culture or language for countless years to come. I imagined how the artist would document these gems in a way that no virus would flaw the original detail, regardless of what would happen to the prints, whether they be framed, forgotten or destroyed—like words storing images of rare beauty to be repeated at any time in any language or thought.

Man began in God - Chapter 2

You do not need to congratulate the shopkeeper for the great design of your mobile phone - it did not begin there or in the factory where it was assembled!

It began in someone's mind. It was someone's idea!

You did not begin in your mother's womb,

You began in God.

You are the most magnificent idea that the Engineer of the Universe has ever had!

We are not the invention of our parents.

It is not our brief history on planet earth that introduces us to God; he knew us before he formed us in our mother's womb! Jer. 1:5.

To consider that God imagined and knew me before time began is the most intriguing and liberating thought! It immediately gives substance to faith and relevance to the gospel. I matter to my Maker! He is mindful of me!

The gospel beautifully frames the picture that God painted and exhibits it in the grand gallery of our own reflections.

When Elohim imagined you, they thought of you on equal terms as they would of themselves; a being whose intimate friendship would intrigue Father Son and Holy Spirit, for eternity. Humanity would be partner in God's triune oneness! Elohim's image and likeness would be unmasked in human life. Every invention begins with an original thought; you are God's original thought; you are the greatest idea that God has ever had!

Human life was fashioned in the same mold; we are the expression of the same thought. Our Author's signature and invisible image is nowhere better preserved or

displayed than in our inner consciousness. Our origin traces the very imagination of God.

God is head over heels in love with you! They cannot get you out of their mind! Their thoughts are consumed with you from before time began!

They fashioned you in your mother's womb when they wrote the three billion-character script of your DNA, mirrored in each of your seventy five trillion cells!

The first Hebrew word in the Bible, translated, "In the beginning...", is the word, בְּרֵאשִׁית ***bereshet***, from ***be***, in and ***rosh***, head, literally means "in the head." You are his work of art; you are the most amazing idea of God. We do not invent God; Elohim invented us! Gen. 1:26,27.

Eph. 2:10 We are engineered by his design; he molded and manufactured us in Christ. We are his workmanship, his [1]poetry. We are [2]fully fit to do good, equipped to give attractive evidence of his likeness in us in everything we do. *(God finds inspired expression of Christ in us. The Greek word for workmanship is [1]**poeima**. God has done everything possible to find spontaneous and effortless expression of his character in us in our everyday lifestyle. The word, [2]**proetoimatso**, translates a notion that God has prepared a highway for us to lead us out like kings, just like the Oriental custom, where people would go before a king to level the roads to make it possible for the king to journey with ease and comfort. Isa 40:3-5.)*

Every single person is equally valued, included and represented in Christ. He gives context and reference to our being as in a mirror, not as an example for us, but of us.

We are not merely Christ-cloned; we are individually crafted to give display to the image and likeness of our Maker within our own person, our fingerprint, our touch, our smile, and the cadence of our voice.

The mandate of Jesus was not to begin the Christian religion but to reveal and redeem the image of the invisible God in human form.

Col. 1:15 In him the image and likeness of God is made visible in human form in order that everyone may recognize their true origin in him. He is the firstborn of every creature. *(What darkness veiled from us he unveiled. In him we clearly see the mirror reflection of our original life. The Son of his love gives accurate evidence of his image in human form. The incarnation means that God can never again be invisible!)*

The Christian calendar celebrates the moment when human history was forever divided into a before and after Christ. The Creator stepped into our planet in a human

body; his mother's womb was his passport. Had he arrived in a "superman suit" his life, death and resurrection would be irrelevant. He came to prove that God did not make a mistake when he made you.

Heb. 4:15 As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human lives. Having subjected it to close scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses which are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. *(He is not an example for us but of us.)*

As head of the human race he represents every human life; he represents the original blueprint of the life of our design.

The most labeled sinners in society were irresistibly attracted to him; what the prostitutes and publicans witnessed in his life mirrored the redeemed integrity of their own; they knew that what they thought to be their life was a lie.

In all three parables that Jesus told in Luke 15, the word "lost" immediately implies ownership. You cannot be lost unless you belong! The lost coin never lost its original inscription and value! "Show me a coin; whose image and inscription does it bear? "Return to Caesar what belongs to Caesar and to God what belongs to God." Luke 22:24, 25.

In Matthew 13:44, Jesus tells one of my most favorite parables! "The kingdom of heaven is like a treasure hidden in a field, which a man found and covered up; then in his joy he went and sold all that he had and bought the entire field. *(Greek, **agros**; an agricultural field.)*

The fact that it is an agricultural field means that it already has a calculated, historical value. It has been cultivated for many years and valued accordingly.

But now, the presence of a hidden treasure immediately brings a new dynamic to the table - there is much more to the field than what meets the eye!

Imagine how intrigued his Jewish audience were! They themselves were farmers and business men - and here's a man, who has discovered something that no one else knew about!

This puts him in a most unique position to buy a farm for a ridiculous bargain! And if, in this narrative, the field represents the world, then it is in a bad shape! Overgrown with thorns and thistles, and certainly one could point to many flaws that should influence the seller to settle for a much reduced price; they must have reasoned! But,

Jesus shocks them out of their wits when he reveals, that the man who found the treasure hid it again, and goes away and sells all he has and buys the entire field!

This doesn't make any sense! Why would this man be prepared to pay such a ridiculous and most extreme price, knowing that no one else had a clue about the treasure!?

Who did he it buy from? I mean, a thief surely never gets ownership; so, God did not buy us back from no "devil".

The man who discovered the treasure is also the original owner of the field! Psalm 24:1 The earth is the LORD's and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell therein. There is only one legitimate Father!

Herein lies the crux of the story! Jesus very intentionally tells this in a language that will awaken us to the most amazing discovery about ourselves! The mystery, that was hidden for ages and generations, is unveiled! He was about to ransom us from our own ignorance; our fallen mindsets *[diabolos, thru the fall],* and the lies we believed about ourselves! See Heb 6:17; he desired to show more convincingly to the heirs of the promise the unchangeable, non-negotiable character of his resolve - so he swore by himself!

How was it possible to interpret Math 13:44 any other way!? Who bought who from whom? Law-language cannot comprehend gift language!

He sold all he had and bought the entire field to persuade mankind that they belonged to him all along! The "field" is all he has! God has no other interest in the universe but you!

The whole of the gospel is to persuade us of our original, and now redeemed value; the scapegoat concept was only a pointer to the Lamb of God, commissioned to the planet to be slaughtered by man for man! God spoke the language of our scapegoat-mentality. **1 Pet. 1:18 It is clear to see that you were ransomed from the futile, fallen mindset that you inherited from your fathers. This was not concluded by the currency of your own labor, represented by the fluctuating values of gold and silver, and the economy of your religious efforts;**

1 Pet. 1:19 but you were redeemed with the priceless blood of Christ. He is the ultimate sacrifice; spotless and without blemish. Jesus completes the prophetic picture! *(In him God speaks the most radical scapegoat language of the law of judgment and brings final closure to a dead and redundant system! In Psalm 40:6,7,*

it is clearly stated that God does not require sacrifices or offerings! Jesus is the Lamb of God! He collides victoriously with the futile sacrificial system whereby offerings are constantly made to the pseudo, moody, monster gods of our imagination! This is the scandal of the cross! God does not demand a sacrifice that would change the way he thinks about mankind; he provides the sacrifice of himself in Christ in order to forever eradicate sin-consciousness from our minds and radically change the way we think about our Maker, one another and ourselves! [Sin-consciousness is in essence a works-based consciousness.] God did not clothe Adam with the skin of an animal because of a divine need to be appeased, but because of their unconditional love for Adam; they spoke the language of Adam's own judgment: Adam, not God, was embarrassed about his nakedness. The clothing was not to make God look at Adam differently, but to make Adam feel better about himself! And ultimately it was to prophetically prepare Adam for the unveiling of the mystery of mankind's redemption in the incarnation. Here Deity would clothe themselves in human skin, in a Son; and the Lion of Judah would become the Lamb of God in order to free our minds to re-discover his image and likeness in our skin! See 1 Peter 1:2.)

I tell the following true story more than any, since it so beautifully illustrates the essence of our message.

A dear friend, Mr Dolf Naude told me this amazing story many years ago, about his grandmother, who was engaged to marry one of the wealthiest farmers in South Africa. This was during time of the Ostrich Feather Boom, in the Oudtshoorn district, in the late 1800's and early 1900's. They had a gold plated horse-cart and mixed only with the high society of the day. During their engagement, she had an encounter with God and apparently her fiancé felt that it couldn't be good for business, to now have her talk so freely and openly about God. So, he promptly broke the engagement and sent her back to the Free Sate. There, she fell in love with a *Bywoner*. This was the Dutch name for someone who would give their labor in exchange for the right to occupy and work a portion of someone's farm land on their own account. After seven years [1904] they were able to buy the farm. Several years later, the first gold in the Free Sate was discovered on their farm!

Her great granddaughter told us that she wrote a document at the time, celebrating the incredible find! And how the same land was historically only cultivated for its maize while the gold was there all along! And, said she, one day, ordinary people will discover the gold they carry! Oh, how my heart danced with joy when I heard this! We

could not have asked for a more appropriate illustration to reinforce the message that burned in our hearts!

The mystery that was hidden for ages and generations is now revealed! It is Christ in you! See Col 1:26 and 27 **Within us, God is delighted to exhibit the priceless treasure of this glorious unveiling of Christ's indwelling in order that every person on the planet, whoever they are, may now come to the greatest discovery of all time and recognize Christ in them as in a mirror! He is the desire of the nations and completes their every expectation!** *(He is not hiding in history, or in outer space nor in the future, neither in the pages of Scripture, he is merely mirrored there to be unveiled within you!)*

There is so much more to you, than what meets the eye!

God's love is based on real value, not pity. In the incarnation, he "found" the treasure where it was hidden all along, in the earthen vessel.

"We have this treasure in earthen vessels," says Paul in 2 Cor. 4:7; but in verse 4 he says that the religious systems of this world have blindfolded us with unbelief to keep us from seeing the light of the gospel! The gospel reveals the glory of God, mirrored in the face of the man Jesus Christ.

Every human life is an individual masterpiece; a self-portrait of God, hidden in their innermost being! This is what Jesus came to reveal and redeem; the image of God in human form; not as in a display window, but as in a mirror!

The theme of prophetic scripture pointed to the sufferings of Christ and the subsequent glory. The glory of God is his image and likeness, redeemed in human form.

The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar testimony that is mathematically precise, revealing that God knew before time, the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross!

Seven hundred years BC the prophet Isaiah saw Jesus' slaughtered body on the cross as the redemptive love of God; Jesus is the Scapegoat of the human race:

1 Pet. 1:10-11 "The prophets who prophesied of the grace that was to be yours searched and inquired about this salvation; they inquired what person or time was indicated by the Spirit of Christ within them when predicting the sufferings of Christ and the subsequent glory." RSV

Isa. 53:3 "He was despised and rejected by men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief; and as one from whom men hide their faces he was despised, and we esteemed him not. Isa. 53:4 Surely he has borne our agony and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten by God, and afflicted. Isa. 53:5 But he was wounded by our transgressions, he was bruised by our iniquities; upon him was the chastisement that made us whole, and with his stripes, we were healed. Isa. 53:6 The Shepherd never forsook the sheep! All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned everyone to his own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all. The horror of humanity's sin was laid upon him. Isa. 53:7 He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth; like a lamb that is led to the slaughter, and like a sheep that before its shearers is dumb, so he opened not his mouth.

In Psalm 22 David dramatically prophesies the detail of Jesus' death on the cross, and concludes in verse 27, "The ends of the earth shall remember and turn to the Lord".

2 Cor. 3:16 The moment anyone [1]returns to the Lord the veil is gone! *(The word, [1]**epistrepho** means to return to where we've wandered from; "we all like sheep have gone astray." Jesus is God unveiled in human form. [Col 1:15] Also 1 Pet 2:25 You were completely vulnerable, just like sheep roaming astray without direction or protection, but now you have returned and are restored to the shepherd and Guardian of your souls! And 1 Pet 1:17. Then, Hebrews 8:1, "The conclusion of all that has been said points us to an exceptional Person, who towers far above the rest in the highest office of heavenly greatness. He is the executive authority of the majesty of God. 8:2 The office he now occupies is the one which the Moses-model resembled prophetically. He ministers in the holiest place in God's true tabernacle of worship. Nothing of the old man-made structure can match its perfection. Heb 8:10 Now, instead of documenting my laws on stone, I will chisel them into your mind and engrave them in your inner consciousness; it will no longer be a one-sided affair. I will be your God and you will be my people, not by compulsion but by mutual desire." See James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there; James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs [back to the old way of seeing himself] and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror. James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a*

*law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty [the law of faith] that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life [of their original design.] They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living. (The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kupto**, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]**parameno**, to remain captivated under the influence of; **meno**, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]**eleutheria**, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

2 Cor. 3:17 The Lord and the Spirit are one; his Lordship sanctions our freedom. A freedom from rules chiselled in stone to the voice of our redeemed design echoing in our hearts!

2 Cor 3:18 Now, we all, with new understanding, see ourselves in him as in a mirror. The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is [1]unveiled. In [2]gazing with wonder at the [5]blueprint of God displayed in human form, we suddenly realize that we are looking into a mirror, where every feature of his [3]image articulated in Christ is [2]reflected within us! The Spirit of the Lord engineers this radical [4]transformation; we are led [6]from an inferior [5]mind-set to the revealed [5]endorsement of our authentic identity. *(The word, [1]**anakalupto**; from **ana**, a Preposition denoting upward, to return again, and **kalupto**, to uncover, unveil. The word, [2]**katoptrizomai**, means to gaze into a reflection, to mirror oneself. Paul uses [4]**metamorphumetha** as a present Passive indicative from **metamorpho**; **meta**, together with, and **morphe**, form. [The word commonly translated sin, [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, allotted portion or form; thus, a distorted form, which is the opposite of metamorphe; with form. The word **meros** is the stem of **morphe**.] Now, with unveiled faces we are gazing at the glory of the Lord as in a mirror and metaporhe happens - image and likeness awakens within us!*

*The word, [3]**eikon**, translates as exact resemblance, image and likeness; **eikon** always assumes a prototype, that which it not merely resembles, but from that which it is*

*drawn; [5]**doxa**, glory, translates as mindset, or opinion from **dokeo**, authentic, blueprint-thought. Changed '**from** glory to glory', **apo doxes eis doxan**; **eis**, a point reached in conclusion; [6]**apo**, away from, meaning away from the glory that previously defined us, i.e. our own achievements or disappointments, to the glory of our original design that now defines us. Two glories are mentioned in this chapter; the glory of the flesh, which is the veiled, fading kind represented by Moses and the unfading, unveiled glory of God's image and likeness, mirrored in the face of Christ and now redeemed in us. See also 2 Cor 4:4 -7.*

*[Note, the Greek word translated "from" in this verse is not the same as the word translated "from" in Rom 1:17 Paul says the unveiling of God's righteousness is **from** faith to faith. Here he does not use the word **apo**, away from, but the Preposition, **ek**, which always denotes source or origin.]*

Some translations of this Scripture read, "we are being changed from glory to glory." This would suggest that change is gradual and will more than likely take a lifetime, which was the typical thinking that trapped Israel for forty years in the wilderness of unbelief! We cannot become more than what we already are in Christ. We do not grow more complete; we simply grow in the knowledge and awareness of our completeness! [See Colossians 3:10] How long does it take the beautiful swan to awaken to the truth of its design? The ugly duckling was an illusion! Whatever it was that endorsed the 'ugly duckling' mindset, co-died together with Christ! In the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, God did not redeem a compromised replica of you; he rescued the original, blueprint you, created in his radiant mirror likeness! Any other 'self' you're trying to find or esteem will disappoint! See Romans 6:11, Reckon your 'DIY-law of works-self' dead, and your redeemed self co-raised and co-seated together with Christ! This is freedom indeed! Galatians 2:19,20; Gal 2:20 So here I am dead and alive at the same time! I'm dead to the old me I was trying to be and alive to the real me which is Christ in me! Co-crucified, now co-alive! What a glorious entanglement! I was in him in his death; now he is in me in my life! For the first time I'm free to be me in my skin, immersed in his faith in our joint-sonship! He loves me and believes in me! He is God's gift to me! [The verb συνεσταυρωμαι from sustauroō, is in the Perfect Tense, indicating that not only was I crucified with Christ in the past, but I am existing now in that present condition. How can any human effort improve on this! See Hosea 6:2 and Eph 2:5 also Romans 7:6 But now we are fully released from any further association with a life directed by the rule of the law, we are dead to that which once held us captive, free to be slaves to the newness

of spirit-spontaneity rather than age old religious rituals, imitating the mere face value of the written code. The moment one exchanges spontaneity with rules, the edge of romance is compromised!])

The "ugly duckling" saw reflected in the water, the truth that freed the swan!

Ps 23 says, "He leads me beside still waters, and restores my soul"; or this can be translated as, "by the waters of reflection my soul remembers who I am".

James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above *(where we originate from);* **proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda.** *(The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word, [1]**anouthen**, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

James 1:18 It was according to the Father's delightful [1]resolve that he [2]birthed us; giving [3]authentic, incarnate expression to the Word. *[The face to face-ness of the Logos that was before time was. Jn 1:1]* **Just like the first-fruits mirror the harvest, so we mirror the [4]conclusion of his [4]workmanship in the core of our [5]being.** *(The word, [1]**boulomai**, means the affectionate desire and deliberate resolve of God. Only James uses the word, [2]**apokueō** from **apo** + **kuma**; from **kuo**, to swell with young; bend or curve. [same word in v 15, where sin's passion parented death, vs God's passion parented authentic life in us!] Truth, [3]**alethea**, from **a**, negative + **lanthano**, meaning hidden; that which is unveiled; the Word **[logos]** of truth is the [3]unveiled **logic** of God. The Preposition [4]**eis**, points to conclusion. The word, κτίσμα*

*[5]**ktisma** meaning, creation with reference to the the proprietorship of the manufacturer - God owns the idea of our invention - he holds the copyright! The words, εἰς τὸ εἶναι ημας ἀπαρχήν - **einai hemas** - [5]our beingness from **eimi**, I am. See Rom. 8:29, He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. Also, John 1:1-18; 1 Pet. 2:9,10.)*

John 1:1 To go back to the very [1]beginning, is to find the [2]Word already [3]present

there; [4]face to face with God. The Word is [3]I am; God's [2]eloquence echoes and [4]concludes in him. The Word equals God. *(In the beginning, [1]**arche,** to be first in order, time, place or rank. The Word, [2]**logos**, was "with" God; here and again in verse 2 John uses the Greek Preposition [4]**pros**, towards; face-to-face.*

*Three times in this sentence John uses the Active Indicative Imperfect form of the verb [3]**eimi,** namely **aen [ἦν]** to continue to be, [in the beginning 'was' the Word etc...] which conveys no idea of origin for God or for the Logos, but simply continuous existence, "I am." Quite a different verb **egeneto,** "became," appears in John 1:14 for the beginning of the Incarnation of the Logos. The Word 'became' flesh. The incarnation is not the origin of Jesus. See the distinction sharply drawn in John 8:58, "before Abraham was [born, **genesthai** from **ginomai**] I am." The word **eimi**, I am; the essence of being, suggesting timeless existence. See my commentary note on 1 Pet 1:16)*

John 1:2 The beginning mirrors the Word face to face with God. *(Nothing that is witnessed in the Word distracts from who God is. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father." [John 14:9] The Word that was from the beginning was not yet written nor spoken; it was simply face to face with God! The beginning declares the destiny of the Word, it would always only be who God is and conclude in God.)*

John 1:3 The Logos is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive Parent reference to their existence. There is nothing original, except the Word! The Logic of God defines the only possible place where mankind can trace their origin. *(All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made. KJV See Colossians 1:16.)*

John 1:4 His life is the light that defines our lives. *(In his life we discover the light of life.)*

John 1:5 The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. *(Darkness represents mankind's ignorance of their redeemed identity and innocence [Isa 9:2-4, Isa 60:1-3, Eph 4:18, Col 1:13-15].)*

John 1:6 Then there was this man John *(Jesus' cousin)* **commissioned by God;**

John 1:7 his mission was to draw attention to the light of their lives so that what they witnessed in him would cause them to believe *(in their original life redeemed again).*

John 1:8 His ministry was not to distract from the light, as if he himself was the light but rather to point out the light Source.

John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! *(This day would begin our calendar and record the fact that human history would forever be divided into before and after Christ. The incarnation would make the image of God visible in human form. In him who is the blueprint of our lives there is more than enough light to displace the darkness in every human life. He is the true light that enlightens everyone! [Col 1:15; 2:9, 10; 2 Cor 4:6])*

John 1:10 Although no one took any notice of him, he was no stranger to the world; he always was there and is himself the author of all things.

John 1:11 It was not as though he arrived on a foreign planet; he came to his own, yet his own did not [1]recognize him. *(The Jews should have been the first to recognize him! Revelation 19:12. Also Ps 24:1, "The earth is the Lord's and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell in it [RSV]." The word, [1]**paralambano**, comes from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **lambano**, to comprehend, grasp, to identify with.)*

John 1:12 Everyone who [1]realizes their association in him, [6]convinced that he is their [2]original life and that [7]his name defines them, God [5]gives the assurance that they are indeed his [4]offspring, [2]begotten of him; he [3]sanctions the legitimacy of their sonship. *(The word often translated, to receive, [1]**lambano**, means to take in hand, to comprehend, to grasp, to identify with. This word suggests that even though he came to his own, there are those who do not [1]identify with their true [2]origin revealed in him, and like the many Pharisees they behave like children of a foreign father, the father of lies [John 8: 44]. Neither God's legitimate fatherhood, nor his ownership is in question; mankind's indifference to their true [2]origin is the problem. This is what the Gospel addresses with utmost clarity in the person of Jesus Christ. Jesus has come to introduce the individual to themselves again; mankind has forgotten what manner of person they are by design! [James 1:24, Deuteronomy 32:18, Psalm 22:27].*

*The word, [2]**genesthai**, from **ginomai**, means to generate; to become; John employs this verb in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. Greek Infinitives could have either a present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms has more to do with aspect than with time. The Present Infinitive is used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures*

the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. This is an important point since many translations of this verse suggests that God's ability to make us his sons can only be in response to something we must first do in order to trigger God into action! Our grasping ***[lambano]*** *is simply the awakening to the fact that our genesis is already completed in the* ***Logos****. [See John 1:3] The* ***Logos*** *is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive Parent reference to their genesis. There is nothing original, except the Word. We are his offspring. [see also Acts 17:28]. "He has come to give us understanding to know him who is true and to realize that we are in him who is true." [1 John 5:20].)*

The word, [3]***exousia****, often translated "power;" as in, he gave "power" to* [2]*become children of God, is a compound word; from* ***ek****, always denoting origin or source and* ***eimi****, I am; thus, out of I am! This gives* [3]*legitimacy and authority to our sonship;* [4]***teknon****, translated as offspring, child.*

"He has given," [5]***didomi****, in this case to give something to someone that already belongs to them; thus, to return. The fact that they already are his own, born from above and that they have their* [2]*beginning and their being in him is now confirmed in their realizing it! Convinced,* [6]***pisteo****;* [7]*his name* ***onoma****, is mankind's family name. [see Eph 3:15]. "He made to be their true selves, their child-of-God selves." — The Msg.)*

John 1:13 These are the ones who discover their genesis in God, beyond their natural conception! This is not about our blood lineage or whether we were a wanted- or unwanted-child; this is about our God-begotteness. We are his dream come true and not the invention of our parents. You are indeed the greatest idea that God has ever had! *(See Jer. 1:5; 29:11; John 3:2-7)*

John 1:14 Suddenly the invisible, eternal Word takes on [1]**visible form - the Incarnation, on display in a flesh and blood Person, as in a mirror! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible exhibit of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He** [2]**captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the** [3]**authentic begotten Son. The** [4]**glory** *(that we lost in Adam)* **returns in fullness! Only** [5]**grace can communicate truth in such complete context!** *(In him we discover that we are not here by chance or accident or by the desire of an earthly parent, neither are we the product of a mere physical conception; we exist by the*

*expression of God's desire to reveal himself in the flesh. His eternal invisible Word, his Spirit-thought, [1]became flesh, [1]**ginomai**, as in be born and [2]**theaomai**, meaning to gaze upon, to perceive. We saw his glory, [4]**doxa**, the display of his opinion, the glory as of the original, authentic begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth. He is the "only begotten," [3]**monogenes**; begotten only by the Father and not of the flesh; in him we recognize our true beginning, as in the authentic original mold. He is also the "first born from the dead", declaring our new birth. [Colossians 1:18, 1 Peter 1:3]. He is the revelation of our completeness.*

*And out of [**ek**] his fullness have we all received! The Preposition, **ek** always points to source/origin. Grace mirrored in grace, [5]**garin anti garitos**. For the law was given through Moses, grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. He who is in the bosom of the Father, the only original, authentic begotten of the Father; he is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. Interesting that the revelation of the Incarnation in verse 14 doesn't follow verse 2 or 3, but verse 12 and 13! Genesis 1:26 is redeemed! See 2 Corinthians 3:17,18.)*

John 1:16 He is the [1]source of our completeness. Everyone may now realize their own completeness as evidenced in him. This is [2]grace mirrored in grace! *(It reminds of Col 2:9,10 The fullness of the Godhead embodied in Christ, reflects our own completeness! Out of [1**ek**] his fullness have we all received! The Preposition, **ek** always points to source/origin. His fullness is the source of all that grace communicates as our portion. Grace mirrored in grace - [2]**garin anti garitos**. The word **anti** means over against - thus, mirrored in.)*

John 1:17 The law was given through Moses; grace and truth have their genesis in Jesus Christ. Against the stark backdrop of the law, with Moses representing the condemned state of mankind, Jesus Christ unveils grace and truth! *(Moses represents the system of performance as basis to one's standing before God; Jesus Christ is incarnate grace and truth! He is the life of our design on display in human form, as in a mirror.)*

John 1:18 Until this moment God remained invisible; now the [1]authentic, incarnate begotten Son, the blueprint of our design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the [2]official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. *(Begotten only of God, [1]**monogenes**. Official guide, [2]**eksegesato**, from **ek**, Preposition denoting source,*

*and **hegeomai**, the strengthened form of **ago**, to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep; thus **hegeomai** means to be officially appointed in a position of authority.)*

Eph. 4:6 There is only one God. He remains the ultimate Father of the universe. We are because he is. He is present in all; he is above all, through all, and in all. *(He is not far from each one of us; in him we live and move and have our being. We are indeed his offspring. Acts. 17:24-28.)*

The father of lies is not the father of the human race!

God is not the product of our best guess; he is bigger than religion's biggest blunder or eloquence in our attempts to define him. He is beyond extinction or threat and can never be reduced to either our clever or clumsy expression of philosophy or art.

Jesus reveals God as Father and Redeemer of the human race.

The New Testament is the revelation of God's initiative and grace gift to humanity. While the law-system addresses mankind in Adam, grace reveals and addresses the same mankind in Christ.

1 Pet. 1:14 Your [1]accurate hearing is what distinguishes you as the resurrection generation; the days of being driven by every [2]desperate, distorted passion of your former ignorance are over! The [3]fashions and patterns of a redundant system are no longer relevant! *(The word, [1]**upoakoo** is often translated, obedience, from **upo**, meaning under, as in under the influence of, and akoo, to hear. In the context of this chapter, Peter urges us to hear accurately what was communicated in the prophetic word concerning the life of our design, now rebooted into newness by our joint resurrection with Jesus Christ! The word, [2]**epithumia**, translates, desire, craving, longing, desire for what is forbidden, lust. The word, [3]**suschēmatizō**, from **sun**, union, and **schema**, pattern; a typical template.)*

1 Pet. 1:15 The one whose [1]idea you are to begin with, designed you to radiate their image and likeness; as the true pattern of your being! So, [2]be who you are in realizing the exact detail of your genesis! You are [3]whole and in perfect harmony; seamlessly one with God! *(The word [1]kaleo, to define by name; to surname. The word [2]**genethete**, referring to genesis, or birth, is in the Aorist, Passive, imperative case; the distinction between the Aorist Imperative and the Present Imperative is one of aspect, not tense. Thus, to get something over and done with! The word, [3]**hagios**, holy, separate from common condition and use. See Hebrews 10:14-16 Mirror Bible)*

1 Pet. 1:16 On the very account that what is [1]written in prophetic Scripture, *[and*

echoed in your innermost being], **already mirrors the life of your design, you are free to [2]be who you are. As it is written, "I am, therefore you are! I am wholly separated unto you, and invite you to explore the same completeness of your being in me!"** *(The word, [1]**grapho**, to engrave, often refers to the prophetic writings, Old Testament Scripture. The appeal of truth is confirmed in the resonance within us due to the echo of that which is already written in our innermost being by design! "Did not our hearts ignite within us while he opened to us the Scriptures! Luke 24:27,32,44,45. The Textus Receptus uses the word **genesthe**, instead of [2]**esesthe**, from eimi, as in the Westtcott & Hort text. This makes a massive difference! So, instead of **ginomai**, to become, it is the word, **esesthe** "be!" from **eimi**, I am! See note in John 1:1 Three times in this sentence John uses the Active Indicative Imperfect form of the verb **eimi,** namely **aen [ἦν]** to continue to be, [in the beginning 'was' the Word etc...] which conveys no idea of origin for God or for the Logos, but simply continuous existence, "I am." Quite a different verb **egeneto,** "became," appears in John 1:14 for the beginning of the Incarnation of the Logos. The Word 'became' flesh. The incarnation is not the origin of Jesus. See the distinction sharply drawn in John 8:58, "before Abraham was [born, **genesthai** from **ginomai**] I am." The word **eimi**, I am; the essence of being, suggesting timeless existence. You did not begin in your mother's womb. You began in God's I-am-ness! You are the most magnificent idea that the Engineer of the Universe has ever had! "I knew you before I formed you in your mother's womb!" Jer 1:5. In him we live and move and have our being! Acts 17:28.)*

1 Pet. 1:17 Now since you are defined in your Father, who does not judge anyone on face value, but always only according his work; *(his finished work in Christ)* **wherever you find yourself located geographically or emotionally, [1]return to your 'at home-ness' in him, with a deep sense of God-consciousness; you are not defined by your circumstances.** *(The word [1]**anastrepho**, suggests a radical returning; literally a turning upside down! Actually **ana**, means upward- so, it's actually a turning downside up! See 2 Cor 3:16.)*

BEGOTTEN

Does the rain have a Father?

Who begot the drops of dew?

Who birthed the morning?

Caused the dawn to know its place?

Have you comprehended the expanses of the earth?

Have you comprehended their origin?

He knows you by name

His design is his claim

He boldly declares, “Measure me”

Have you measured your heart?

Have you measured the volume of your being?

He has chosen you to accommodate the fullness of his dream

Have you comprehended? He is at home within your heart,

A dwelling built within you without walls.

Take my love to its conclusion.

Take my love to every man,

Count the stars, count the sand

Measure the nations in my Hand,

Come on now, measure me

I fulfill your eternity.

(This song was written by Anthea, she was part of our ministry called, the Acts Team in the eighties; she was only 19 years old then.)

Romance Redeemed - Chapter 3

What is the ***summum bonum***—the supreme good?

You have life before you. You can only live it once. What is the noblest object of desire, the supreme gift to covet? *[The Greatest Thing - by Prof Henry Drummond]*

Imagine a love that exists with no other agenda but your good!

2 Cor 3:18 Now we all, with new understanding, see ourselves in him as in a mirror. The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is unveiled. In gazing with wonder at the blueprint of God displayed in human form, we suddenly realize that we are looking into a mirror, where every feature of God's invisible likeness, articulated in Christ, is reflected within us!

If Paul is right in saying what he does, here in 2 Cor 3:18, then, reading his love poem in 1 Cor 13, takes on a brand new dynamic! Love is not wishful thinking; love is who you are!

1 Cor 13:4 Love is large in being passionate about life and relentlessly patient in bearing the offenses and injuries of others, with kindness. Love is completely content and strives for nothing. Love has no desire to make others feel inferior and has no need to sing its own praises.

1 Cor 13:5 Love is predictable and does not behave out of character. Love is not ambitious. Love is not [1]spiteful and gets no mileage out of another's mistakes; it bears no record of wrongs! *(The word, [1]**paroxuno**, translates as spiteful, it has no sharp edges.)*

1 Cor 13:6 Love sees no joy in injustice. Love's delight is in everything that truth celebrates.

1 Cor 13:7 Love is a fortress where everyone feels protected rather than exposed! Love's persuasion is persistent! Love believes. Love never loses hope and always remains constant in contradiction.

We have said in our previous chapter that, when Elohim imagined you, they thought of you on equal terms as they would of themselves; a being whose intimate friendship would intrigue Father Son and Holy Spirit, for eternity. Humanity would be partner in God's triune oneness!

The plurality in Elohim immediately brings a relational emphasis in the entire creation narrative. God's oneness is not compromised in their relationship - mankind is fully

included in this oneness! See John 14:20.

Gen. 1:26-27 Then Elohim *[God plural]* said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness; so God created man in their own image; male and female they created them.

Gen. 1:31 And Elohim saw everything that they had made, and behold, it was very good."

God's image and likeness would be unmasked in human life. Every invention begins with an original thought; you are God's original thought; you are the greatest idea that God has ever had!

The central theme and revelation of the Bible celebrates a relationship between God and man of the highest order; an inseparable union of absolute integrity, with no hint of distance, inferiority, guilt, condemnation or suspicion. The sacred moment, when for the first time in the history of the universe, the invisible Creator reflected their image and likeness in a fragile vessel of flesh. This moment would be the reference of a presence and purpose in the earth that would dominate human history and destiny. It would continue to reflect the deepest quest and longing within the human heart, to be realized in their every relationship.

The origin of humanity is forever imprinted in the mind of God. Mankind is the God-kind by design.

An inseparable association exists from before the foundation of the earth that locates and defines us in Christ. Nowhere in the universe is mankind more comprehensively included and fully represented than in their in-Christ-ness! The idea of association has been a thought that I have often pondered and mentioned in my teachings over the years. It so happens that this morning, while I'm continuing with the revision of this book, it is indeed the 25th of August 2020. I met Lydia exactly 45 years ago, today. People who know us immediately associates us. The one brings the other to mind, naturally!

It is impossible for God not to immediately and naturally have you in mind at the very thought of Jesus! The words, "in Christ", are indeed the key words that unlock the mystery of the ages!

We have so underestimated the enormity of the implications of an association that goes back to before time was!

2 Tim. 1:9 He rescued the integrity of our original design and revealed that we have always been his own from the beginning, even before time was. This has

nothing to do with anything we did to qualify or disqualify ourselves. We are not talking religious good works or karma here. Jesus unveils grace to be the eternal intent of God! Grace celebrates our pre-creation innocence and now declares our redeemed union with God in Christ Jesus.

In Christ we see the original mold and intended shape of our lives, not as in a display window but as in a mirror.

Rom. 8:29 He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the [1]same womb that reveals our genesis. We are God's idea. *(We come from above [See John 1:13; also John 3:3-13] We were also born anew when he was raised from the dead! [1 Peter 1:3] His resurrection co-reveals our common genesis as well as our redeemed innocence. [Rom 4:25 and Acts 17:31] No wonder then that he is not ashamed to call us his siblings! The word, often translated, sibling is [1]**adelphos**, with* **a** *as a connective particle and* ***delphus****, the womb. We share the same origin [Heb 2:11* ***ek*** *[origin; source]* ***henos*** *[one]* ***pantes*** *[everyone], and, "In him we live and move and have our being, we are indeed his offspring!" [Acts 17:28].)*

Eph. 2:10 We are engineered by his design; he molded and manufactured us in Christ. We are his workmanship, his [1]poetry. We are [2]fully fit to do good, equipped to give attractive evidence of his likeness in us in everything we do. *(God finds inspired expression of Christ in us. The Greek word for workmanship is [1]**poeima**. God has done everything possible to find spontaneous and effortless expression of his character in us in our everyday lifestyle. The word, [2]**proetoimatso**, translates a notion that God has prepared a highway for us to lead us out like kings, just like the Oriental custom, where people would go before a king to level the roads to make it possible for the king to journey with ease and comfort. Isa 40:3-5.)*

Col. 1:15 In him the image and likeness of God is made visible in human form in order that everyone may recognize their true origin in him. He is the firstborn of every creature. *(What darkness veiled from us he unveiled. In him we clearly see the mirror reflection of our original life. The Son of his love gives accurate evidence of his image in human form. The incarnation means that God can never again be invisible!)*

Col. 1:19 The full measure of everything God has in mind for mankind indwells him.

("So spacious is he; so roomy, that everything of God finds its proper place in him

without crowding." (The Message)

Col. 2:9 In him, all the fullness of [1]Deity [2]resides in a human body! He proves that human life is tailor-made for God! *(The word, [1]**theotes**, godhead/deity, is feminine. Jesus exhibits what the Father, Son and Spirit is like, in human form. The word [2]**katoikeō** means to dwell in, to inhabit. While the expanse cannot measure or define God, their detailed likeness is displayed in human skin. See Col 1:19, God is fully at home in him. Jesus is God's happy delight to be human.)*

Col. 2:10 And since we are in him, there is no shortfall in us! Jesus mirrors our completeness and [1]endorses our true identity. He is "I am" in us! *(God packaged completeness in "I am," mirrored in you! The word, [1]**exousia**, is often translated authority; from, **ek + eimi**, originating out of "I am." The days are over where our lives were dictated to under the rule of the law of performance and an inferior identity. It's not about who I used to be or who I'm striving to become; we are celebrating I am! Any teaching that leaves one with a sense of lack and imperfection rather than completeness is a distraction from the truth.)*

"Your own completeness is only realized in him." (Phillip's Translation)

The revelation of the Gospel shows how God preserved the blueprint of our design in Christ in spite of humanity's fall into sin. Our eternal association in Christ from before the foundation of the earth was redeemed.

Eph. 1:3 Let's celebrate God! He lavished every blessing heaven has upon us in Christ!

Eph. 1:4 He associated us in Christ before [1]the fall of the world! Jesus is God's mind made up about us! He always knew in his love that he would present us again [2]face-to-face before him in blameless innocence. *(The implications of the fall are completely cancelled. Paul uses the word, [1]**kataballo**, meaning "to fall away, to put in a lower place," instead of **themelios**, meaning "foundation" [see Eph 2:20]; thus, translated "the fall of the world," instead of "the foundation of the world." The entire "Fall" was a falling away in our minds from our true identity as image and likeness bearers of Elohim. Just like Eve, were we all deceived to believe a lie about ourselves, which is the fruit of the "I-am-not-tree". We all, like sheep have gone astray. [Isa 53:6]) God found us in Christ before he lost us in Adam! We are presented in blameless innocence before him! The word, [2]**katenopion**, suggests the closest possible proximity, face-to-face!*

Your in-Christness is not the result of a lucky draw! Calvinism lied to you! Neither is it

the result of your "choice" to follow Jesus! Something doesn't become true by popular vote! Or by our beliefs! If it wasn't true to begin with, we're wasting our time trying to "believe" it true! Faith happens to you when you encounter the good announcement! Of God's doing are we IN CHRIST... (1 Cor 1:30) For "evangelical theology" to miss the meaning of mankind's inclusion IN CHRIST before they knew it or believed it, is to completely miss the point of the death, descent into hell, resurrection and ascension of Jesus! This would make Jesus irrelevant and reduce the salvation of the human race to their own fate managed by institutionalized religion, attaching mere sentimental value to an historic Jesus who died and rose again. By dying our death as fully God and fully man, once and for all (not for a "select few!"), death became the doorway, whereby Jesus would enter into our hell and deepest darkness and sense of lostness and loneliness as a result of the lies we believed about ourselves - to triumphantly lead us out as his trophies and relocate us face to face with the Father of the universe! Eph 4:7,8 and 9 See Mirror Bible! All this happened while we were still dead in our trespasses and sins! Eph 2:5,6 Co-quickened, co-raised, co-seated in his Executive authority [his right hand] Now ponder Colossians 3:1-3 and engage your thoughts with throne room realities!)

Eph. 1:5 He is the architect of our design; his heart dream realized our [1]coming of age in Christ. *(Adoption here is not what it means in our Western society. It is a coming of age, like the typical Jewish Barmitsva. See Galatians 4:1-6, " ... and to seal our sonship the spirit of his Son echoes Abba Father in our hearts." This is [1]**huiothesia.**)*

Eph. 1:6 His grace-plan is to be celebrated: he [1]greatly endeared us and highly favored us in Christ. His love for his Son is his love for us. *(The Gospel is not about telling people how lost they are, but reminding them of how loved they are! See Luke 1:28 only other use of the word, χαριτόω [1]**charitoō**.)*

God found us in Christ before he lost us in Adam! Much has been made of Adam's fall, while something of far greater implication deserves our undivided attention.

The message of reconciliation emphasizes the initiative that God undertook and reveals how God succeeded to restore fallen humanity to him in absolute innocence.

1 Cor. 1:30 [1]Of God's doing are we in Christ. He is both the genesis and genius of our wisdom; a wisdom that reveals how righteous, sanctified and redeemed we already are in him. *(The Preposition, [1]**ek**, always denotes origin, source. Mankind's association in Jesus is God's doing. In God's economy, Jesus Christ represents us; what mankind could never achieve through personal discipline and willpower as taught in every religion, God's faith accomplished in Christ. Of his design we are in Christ; we*

are associated in oneness with him. Our wisdom is sourced in this union! Also, our righteousness and holiness originate from him. Holiness equals wholeness and harmony of a person's spirit, soul, and body. Our redemption is sanctioned in him. He redeemed our identity, our sanity, our health, our joy, our peace, our innocence, and our complete well-being! [See Eph 1:4]. The Knox Translation reads, "It is from him that we take our [1]origin.")

2 Cor. 5:14 The love of Christ constrains us and [1]resonates within us; leaving us with only one [2]conclusion: when Jesus died; every individual simultaneously died. In God's logic, one has died for all, [2]thus all died. *(The word, [1]**sunecho**, to press together; to squeeze; from **sun**, meaning together with and **echo**, meaning to echo; to embrace; to hold; also, to resonate. The word αρα [2]**ara**, means conclusion. Jesus didn't die 99% or for 99%. He one hundred percent died humanity's death! If Paul had to compromise the last part of verse 14 to read: "one died for all therefore only those who follow the prescriptions to qualify, have also died," then he would have had to change the first half of the verse as well! Only the **agape** of Christ can make a calculation of such enormous proportion! The religious mind would question the extremity of God's love and perhaps prefer to add a condition or two to a statement like that!)*

2 Cor. 5:15 Now if all were included in his death they were equally included in his resurrection. This unveiling of his love redefines human life! Whatever reference we could have of ourselves outside of our association with Christ is no longer relevant.

2 Cor. 5:16 Therefore, from now on, I no longer know anyone according to the flesh! I no longer see people from a human point of view! This is a radical and most defining moment! No label that could possibly previously identify someone carries any further significance! Even our pet doctrines of Christ are redefined. Whatever we knew about him historically or sentimentally is challenged by this conclusion. *(By discovering Christ from God's point of view we discover ourselves and every other human life from God's point of view! Paul sees by revelation that, what Jesus redeemed in every person, brings final closure and death to any other reasoning and judgment we may have had of ourselves or anyone else for that matter! This is Paul's **'metanoia' moment!** Note, the Greek word, **metanoia**, from **meta**, together with and νοιέω **noieō**, to perceive with the mind. It describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing. Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery. It has nothing in common with the Latin word*

paenitentia *- where the idea of penance and repentance stems from!)*

2 Cor. 5:17 Now, in the light of your co-inclusion in his death and resurrection, whoever you thought you were before, in Christ you are a brand new person! The old ways of seeing yourself and everyone else are over. Acquaint yourself with the new! *(Just imagine this! Whoever a person was as a Jew, Greek, slave or freeman, Boer, Zulu, Xhosa, British, Indian, Muslim or American, Chinese, Japanese or Congolese; is now dead and gone! They all died when Jesus died! Remember we are not talking law language here! The 'If' in, "If anyone is in Christ" is not a condition, it is the conclusion of the revelation of the gospel! Mankind is in Christ by God's doing [1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4]. The verses of 2 Corinthians 5:14-16 give context to verse 17! For so long we studied verse 17 on its own and interpreted the 'if' as a condition! Paul did not say, "If anyone is in Christ," he said "THEREFORE if anyone is in Christ ..." The "therefore" immediately includes verses 14 to 16! If God's faith sees everyone in Christ in his death, then they were certainly also in Christ in his resurrection. Jesus did not reveal a "potential" you, he revealed the truth about you so that you may know the truth about yourself and be free indeed! In the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, God did not redeem a compromised replica of you; he rescued the original, blueprint you, created in his radiant mirror likeness! Any other 'self' you're trying to find or esteem will disappoint! Reckon your 'DIY-law of works-self' dead, and your redeemed self co-raised and co-seated together with Christ! This is freedom indeed! Galatians 2:19,20; Rom 6:11. See 1 Pet 1::3 We are reconnected with our original genesis through the resurrection of Jesus from the dead! This new birth endorses and celebrates the hope of the ages; God's eternal love dream concludes in life!)*

2 Cor. 5:18 The idea of mankind's co-inclusion in the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ is entirely God's doing! To now realize that God has indeed brought final closure to the old and for us to see everything and everyone in this new light is to simply see what God has always known to be true about us in Christ; we are not debating human experience, opinion, or their contribution; this is exactly what God believes. In Jesus Christ, God [1]exchanged equivalent value to redeem us to himself. He went to the highest extreme in this act of reconciliation to persuade us of our original worth! This God has given us as the mandate of our ministry. *(The word, [1]***katalasso***, translates as reconciliation; it is a mutual exchange of equal value. This transaction was not to buy us back from "the Devil"; a thief never becomes an owner; it was God redeeming our minds from the lies that we believed about ourselves -*

reconciliation is the bold unveiling of the value of the hidden treasure in everyone! See 2 Cor 4:7 and Math 13:44.)

2 Cor. 5:19 Our ministry declares that Jesus did not act independently of his Father. God was present in Christ when he reconciled the total [1]cosmos to himself. Deity and mankind embraced in him; the fallen state of mankind was deleted; their trespasses would no longer count against them! He now announces his friendship with every individual from within us! *(The incarnation did not separate the Father from the Son and the Spirit. In him dwells the fullness of God in a human body. Col 2:9. As a human person, Jesus felt the agony of fallen mankind on the cross when he echoed Psalm 22, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me! Why are you so far from helping me, from the words of my groaning?" But then in verse 24, David declares triumphantly: "He has not despised or abhorred the affliction of the afflicted; and he has not hid his face from him, but has heard, when he cried to him." The word, [1]kosmos in the NT refers to the entire human family.)*

2 Cor. 5:20 The voice God has in Christ he now has in us; we are God's ambassadors. Our lives exhibit the urgency of God to [1]persuade everyone to realize the reconciliation of their redeemed identity. *(The word, [1]**parakaleo**, comes from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname. In Luke 15:28, 31, His father pleaded with him, "My child, you are always with me, and all that I have is yours." "Be reconciled" could not be translated, "Become reconciled!" "Do in order to become" is the language of the Old Testament; the language of the New Testament is, "Be, because of what was done!")*

2 Cor. 5:21 This is the divine exchange: he who knew no [1]sin embraced our distortion; he appeared to be without form; this was the mystery of God's prophetic [2]poetry. He was disguised in our distorted image and marred with our iniquities; he took our sorrows, our pain and our shame to his grave and [3]birthed his righteousness in us. He took our sins and we [3]became his innocence. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without*

*form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. The word, [2]**poema**, often translated "made" like in, "he was made to be sin." However, because of its context here I have translated **poema** to read prophetic poetry. As the scapegoat of the human race, he took on the distorted image of fallen mankind, he did not become a sinner, but the official representative of mankind's sin. Then Paul uses the word [3]**ginomai**, he birthed his righteousness in us since we were born anew in his resurrection from the dead. Hosea 6:2, Eph 2:5, 1 Pet 1:3.*

Isaiah 52:10 "The Lord has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations, and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God." Isaiah 52:14-15 "Just as many were astonished at you—so was he marred in his appearance, more than any human and his form beyond that of human semblance—so will he startle many nations. Kings will shut their mouths because of him; for what had not been told them, they will see and what they had not heard, they will understand." Isaiah 53:4-5 "Surely he has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted. But surely he was wounded by our transgressions; he was bruised by our iniquities; the chastisement of our peace was on him and by his stripes we ourselves are healed."

*Note: He was not bruised by God but by the very mankind he was about to redeem! You may ask, "But what about Isaiah 53:10!?" [It pleased the Lord to "crush" him!] Translators of the New Revised Standard Version say in their footnotes to this verse: "Meaning of Hebrew uncertain." The Septuagint - Greek version of this verse - written between 300BC and 250BC, by 72 Hebrew scholars, with access to older manuscripts than what we have today, have rendered the Hebrew text as follows: "and the Lord desires to purify him of the plague!" Also translated, "The Lord desires to cleanse his wounds!" The word, **plege** means a wound.*

Deut. 32:5, 6 "They have corrupted themselves; they did not behave as his children, they have become a distorted generation of people, twisted out of their true pattern; they are a crooked and perverse generation."[Paul quotes this verse in Phil. 2:15.]

*Deut. 32:18 "You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you and have forgotten the God who danced with you." [Hebrew, חוּל **khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21.])*

Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that mankind pre-existed in God; he defined us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory we lost in Adam. *(Romans 3:23, 24: the word, **prohoritso**, means pre defined, like*

when an architect draws up a detailed plan; and the word, ***kaleo****, to surname, identify by name.)*

Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.

Rom. 1:16 I have no shame about sharing the Good News of Christ with anyone; the powerful rescuing act of God persuades both Jew and Gentile alike.

Rom. 1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it, until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of [1]God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness reveals the life of our design. "Righteousness by his *(God's)* **faith defines life."** *(In David's dramatic, prophetic account of the crucifixion in Psalm 22, he concludes with verse 27, "All the ends of the earth shall remember and return to the Lord; and all the families of the nations shall worship before him." And in verse 31, "...they shall declare his righteousness to a people that shall yet be born; that he has done it." The gospel is the revelation of the righteousness of God; it unveils how the Father, Son and Spirit succeeded to put mankind right with themselves. It is about what God did right, not what Adam did wrong. The good news reveals how God's righteousness rescued the life of our design and redeemed our innocence. Mankind's futile efforts to justify themselves, have failed them miserably. [Rom 7] The Good News shifts the emphasis away from our failure and condemnation to highlight what it was that God accomplished in Jesus Christ on humanity's behalf! "Look away [from the law of works] unto Jesus; he is the [1]Author and finisher of faith." [Hebrews 12:1]. It is God's faith to begin with; it is* [1]***from faith to faith****, and not our good or bad behavior; we are not defined by our performance or circumstances. The Greek word translated "from" is the Preposition,* [1]***ek****, which always denotes source or origin. The language of the old written code was, "Do in order to become! The language of the new is, "Be, because of what was done!" Instead of do, do, do, it's done, done, done! Paul refers here to Habakkuk 2:4, "The just shall live by his [God's] faith." Habakkuk sees a complete new basis to mankind's standing before God! Instead of reading the curse when disaster strikes, he realizes that the Promise out-dates performance as the basis to mankind's acquittal. The curse is taken out of the equation! Galatians 3:13. Deuteronomy 28 would no longer be the motivation or measure of right or wrong behavior! Instead of righteousness as a reward to mankind's efforts to obey the law, Habakkuk celebrates God's righteousness based on*

God's belief, in the face of apparent disaster, represented in the evidence of all the curses mentioned in Deuteronomy 28! He sings, "Though the fig trees do not blossom, nor fruit be on the vines, the produce of the olive fails and the fields yield no food, the flock be cut off from the fold and there be no herd in the stalls, yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will joy in the God of my salvation. God, the Lord, is my strength; he makes my feet like hinds' feet, he makes me tread upon my high places." [Habakkuk 3:17-19 RSV]. It is interesting to note that Habakkuk - חבקוק ***chăbaqqûq****, was possibly the son of the Shunammite woman and her husband who hosted the Prophet Elisha. They could not have children, until Elisha declared that in a year's time she would embrace -* חבק ***chabaq*** *- a child! When the child grew up to be a young man he died of sunstroke and Elisha stretched himself over the boy and mirror-embraced the dead child, face to face and the boy came back to life.* חבקוק ***Chabaqquq*** *is a double embrace - it is the prophetic picture of our mirror-resurrection together with Christ! If anyone knew that righteousness was not by works but by God's faith, it was Habakkuk!*

The word righteousness comes from the Anglo Saxon word, "rightwiseness;" wise in that which is right. In Greek the word for righteousness is ***dikaiosune****, from* ***dikay****, that which is right; it is a relationship word and refers to two parties finding likeness in each other. Righteousness points to harmony in a relationship. See 2 Corinthians 6:14. Faith-righteousness has nothing in common with the pagan philosophies of karma and performance-based approval; they could never balance the scales or be evenly yoked together in any context. [The word* ***heterozugeō****, an unequal or different yoke; from the Hebrew word,* ***zugot****,* זוגות *indicates pairs of two identical objects; a yoke or a teaching; the yoke of a rabbi or philosopher represented their doctrine; reminds of the Hebrew word for righteousness,* ***tzedek,*** צדק *which also includes the idea of the wooden beam in a scale of balances. "He that judges his neighbor according to the balance of righteousness, or innocence, they judge him according to righteousness." [T. Bab. Sabbat, fol. 127. 2.]*

It is interesting to note that the Greek goddess of Justice is Dike, [pronounced, ***dikay*** *- the stem of the word* ***dikaiosune****, righteousness] and she is always pictured holding a scale of balances in her hand. See also 2 Corinthians 6:15. In Colossians 2:9-10, "It is in Christ that God finds an accurate and complete expression of himself, in a human body! He mirrors our completeness and is the ultimate authority of our true identity.")*

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"I say you are gods, all of you are sons of the Most High, why would you die like mere men?" Ps. 82:6, 7 RSV

"You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who gave you birth." Deut. 32:18 RSV

In Psalm 22, David prophesies the death of the Messiah-Christ and sees the triumphant outcome in verse 27: "All the ends of the earth shall remember and return to the Lord; and all the families of the nations shall worship before Him!"

In the Incarnation, every possible excuse we could have, to feel separated and distanced from God, was erased! Jesus is the highway in the wilderness that Isaiah saw: every high place was brought down, every valley filled up, every crooked place made straight; even the rough places were made smooth!

"And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together: for the mouth of the LORD has spoken it." Isa. 40:3-5.

In his death on the cross he prepares a place for us so that we may forever be where he is, embraced in the bosom of the Father. And all mankind will see salvation from God's point of view!

Luke 3:4 John here, most significantly mirrors the words of Isaiah; this is the moment! He lifted up his voice with great strength and cried out, [1]"Turn the wilderness into a highway! Make the ancient, [2]trodden out paths, [3]beautiful!" *(This is the unfolding of the prophetic moment which Isaiah saw 700 years ago! Isa 40:3-5. The word, ἑτοιμάζω [1]**hetoimazō**, meaning to prepare the way - from the oriental custom of sending persons before kings on their journeys, to level the roads and make them passable. Here in the Aorist Imperative case - ετοιμασατε **etoimasate**. According to the Greek scholar, Wallace, most Aorist Imperatives can be placed in one of two broad categories: the Ingressive, and Constative. The Constative stresses the urgency and the solemnity... "make this your top priority". The word, τρίβος [2]**tribos**, a track or rut that has been worn-out over time through much use. Thus, the maize of mankind's futile, criss-cross and cul-de-sac attempts to escape the clutches of the wilderness of their lostness in their trodden out paths of traditional beliefs and philosophies, are finally over! The word εὐθύς [3]**euthus**, from **eu**, good; well done; beautiful and **tithemi**, to set in*

place. A voice cries: "In the wilderness prepare the way of the Lord, make straight in the desert a highway for our God. Every valley shall be lifted up, and every mountain and hill be made low; every crooked place shall be made straight, and the rough places smooth. And the glory of the Lord shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together, for the mouth of the Lord has spoken.)

Luke 3:5 The Engineer of the universe will do this, with meticulous attention to detail! What seemed an impassible [2]chasm, will be seamlessly bridged! Every valley shall be filled up! Also, every mountain and hill be levelled out and every [1]crooked curve shall be straightened out! Even the rough places shall be made smooth! *(A seamless union is announced! The [1]question marks shall become exclamation marks! The word φάραγξ [2]**pharagx** is an abyss; a chasm; a rift or ravine hedged in by precipices. Every possible excuse mankind could ever have to feel separated from God is addressed! Every definition of distance is cancelled and every single obstacle and obstruction is about to be removed! The Judaean desert has many ravines, most of them deep, from 1,200 feet in the west to 600 feet in the east. It is an area with a special morphological structure along the east of the Judaean Mountains.)*

Luke 3:6 And this saving act of God shall be fully [1]realized by every individual. All flesh shall see and celebrate it together! *(The word, οψεται from [1]**horao**, to gaze upon; to see for oneself; to discern and perceive with the mind.*

"This phrase aptly describes Luke's Gospel which has in mind the message of Christ for all mankind. It is the universal Gospel." Says A.T. Robertson, [1863 – 1934] New Testament and Greek professor of the Southern Baptist Theological Seminary.)

John 14:2 What makes my Father's house home, is your place in it! If this was not the ultimate conclusion of my mission why would I even bother to do what I am about to do if it was not to prepare a place for you? I have come to persuade you of a place of seamless oneness where you belong. *(See John 8:35 The difference between the slave and the son is that the slave only works there; for the son the father's house is home! 8:36 With the freedom found in sonship there is [1]no pretense! [Free indeed! The word, [1]**ontoos**, indeed is the opposite to what is pretended.] What Jesus is about to accomplish in his death and resurrection will forever shift the idea of religious works and pretense and performance from the typical slave-mentality to the freedom and reality of sonship!)*

John 14:3 The proportions of what I will accomplish are astonishing! I will [1]prepare a highway for you, just as in the Oriental custom, where people

would go before a king to level the roads to make it possible for royalty to journey with ease and comfort. Then I will personally come to escort you on this royal highway, guiding you to be where I am, in seamless, face to face oneness in the Father's embrace. *[v 20]* **By [2]fully identifying myself with you I have mirrored you in me so that you may be completely at home where I am!** *(Jesus sees the full scope of his work: by submitting himself to our judgment and hellish fury, he would enter our death and gloom and thereby strip every principality and dominion of its judgment and power-play over the human race. Colossians 2:14,15. The word [1]**hetoimazō** suggests a levelling of the road to make it passable for kings! [Isaiah 40:3-5] The word [2]**paralambano**, carries two components, **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **lambano**, to comprehend, grasp, to identify with. He would lead us in his triumphant procession on high out of our darkness into his marvellous light, where we may now participate in the union of the ages - "and take you to myself so that you may be where I am, face to face with the Father!" Hosea 6:2; Ephesians 4:8; Colossians 1:13. John 1:1,2. See John 1:18 Until this moment God remained invisible; now the authentic, incarnate begotten Son, the blueprint of our design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the father, brings him into full view! He is the official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us.)*

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and the Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

Col. 1:20 He initiated the reconciliation of all things to himself. Through the blood of the cross God restored the original harmony. His reign of peace now extends to every visible thing upon the earth as well as those invisible things which are

in the [1]heavenly realm. *(The heavens, [1]**ouranos**, a place of elevation, from **oros**, a mountain, from **airo**, to lift, to raise, to elevate, "Not only that, but all the broken and dislocated pieces of the universe, people and things, animals and atoms, get properly fixed and fit together in vibrant harmonies, all because of his death." — The Message.)*

Col. 1:21 Your indifferent mindset alienated you from God into a lifestyle of annoyances, hardships, and labors. Yet he has now fully [2]reconciled and restored you to your original design. *(The word, [1]**poneros**, is described in Thayer's Lexicon to mean, annoyances, hardships, and labors, often translated as evil. [See Septuagint: tree of knowledge of good and hard labor!] To reconcile: [2]**apokatallasso**, fully restored to the original value. [In Thayer Definition: to change, exchange, as coins for others of equivalent value.] "You yourselves are a case study of what he does." Msg.)*

Col. 1:22 He accomplished this in dying our death in a human body; he fully represented us in order to fully present us again in blameless innocence, face-to-face with God; with no sense of guilt, suspicion, regret, or accusation; all charges against us are officially cancelled.

Col. 1:23 Remain under the influence of what your faith knows to be true about you, firmly consolidated in the foundation of your belief so that nothing can distract you from the expectation of the Gospel; a hope that is consistent with what you have heard. Just as I, Paul, am in the ministry to proclaim the one and only message that rings true with resonance in all of creation under heaven. *(The dimension of the invisible spiritual realm. "You stay grounded and steady in that bond of trust, constantly tuned in to the Message, careful not to be distracted or diverted. There is no other Message—just this one. Every creature under heaven gets this same Message. I, Paul, am a messenger of this Message." —The Message.)*

Col. 1:24 This is why no form of suffering can interfere with my joy. Every suffering on your behalf is just another opportunity to reinforce that which might still be lacking *(in your understanding)* **of the affliction of Christ on behalf of his body which is the church.** *(The inconvenience that Paul might be suffering on behalf of the believers is not to add to the sufferings of Christ—as though the sufferings of Christ on our behalf were insufficient but it is to further emphasize and confirm the principle of unselfish love that constrains New Testament ministry.)*

Col. 1:25 I am an administrator in God's economy; my mission is to make his word known to you with utmost clarity.

Col. 1:26 Mankind's most sought after quest, the mystery which has remained elusive and concealed for ages and generations, is now fully realized in our redeemed innocence.

Col. 1:27 Within us, God is delighted to exhibit the priceless treasure of this glorious unveiling of Christ's indwelling in order that every person on the planet, whoever they are, may now come to the greatest discovery of all time and recognize Christ in them as in a mirror! He is the [1]desire of the nations and completes their every expectation! *(He is not hiding in history, or in outer space nor in the future, neither in the pages of Scripture, he is merely mirrored there to be unveiled within you. Mt. 13:44, Gal 1:15, 16, 2 Cor 3:18, 2 Cor 4:4,7. This is huge! What God was now able to disclose in the saints is immediately equally relevant in the nations! Christ in the nations is the hope of glory! This is the mystery of the ages! This is what we were waiting for. [1]Haggai 2:6,7.)*

Col. 1:28 This is the essence and focus of our message; we [1]awaken everyone's mind, instructing every individual by bringing them into [2]full understanding *[flawless clarity]* **in order that we may [3]prove** *(present)* **everyone [4]perfect in Christ.** *(Translating [1]**vous + tithemi** as to re-align every mind with God's mind. The word, [2]**sophos**, comes from **sophes** meaning clear, clarity. The word, [3]**paristano**, comes from **para**, sphere of influence, closest possible association, and **histemi**, meaning to stand, to exhibit with evidence. The word, [4]**teleios**, means perfect, without shortcoming and fully efficient.)*

Col. 1:29 [1]Your completeness in Christ is not a remote goal, but your immediate reference! My labor now exceeds any zeal that I previously knew under the duty-driven law of willpower. I am laboring beyond the point of exhaustion, striving with intense resolve with all the energy that he mightily inspires within me. *([1]**eis**, a point reached in conclusion.)*

Col. 3:3 Your union with his death broke the association with that world; see yourselves located in a fortress where your life is hidden with Christ in God! *("In that day you will know that I am in my father, and you in me and I in you." [John 14:20] Occupy your mind with this new order of life; you died when Jesus died; whatever defined you before defines you no more. Christ, in whom the fullness of deity dwells, defines you now! The word, "hidden" can also be translated, secret; the secret of your life is your union with Christ in God! [See Col 2:9, 10]*

"Risen, then, with Christ you must lift your thoughts above where Christ now sits at the right hand of God, you must be heavenly minded; not earthly minded, you have undergone death, and your life is hidden away now with Christ in God. Christ is your life, when he is made manifest you are made manifest in his glory." — Knox Translation.)

2 Cor. 5:18-19 "All this is from God, who through Christ reconciled us to himself and gave us the ministry of reconciliation; that is, in Christ God was reconciling the world to himself, not counting their trespasses against them, and entrusting to us the message of reconciliation." RSV

Paul expresses his boundless gratitude towards God for the believers at Corinth whenever he considers the full implication of their faith-union in Christ. He sees them established in favour and grace, and able to communicate spontaneously in order to equally impact others.

1 Cor. 1:4 I am always so happy for you when I consider how greatly advantaged you are because of God's grace unveiled in Jesus Christ.

1 Cor. 1:5 Your knowledge of Christ is based on so much more than hearsay; every aspect of your life gives eloquent expression to the rich reservoir of your union in him.

1 Cor. 1:6 You certainly have the testimony of Christ evidenced in you. *(You possess full knowledge and give full expression because in you the evidence for the truth of Christ has found confirmation. — NEB. "Even as the testimony of Christ was confirmed in you." KJV)*

Paul encourages us to embrace with confident expectation the full revelation of Christ in us. We may now know beyond doubt that everything we would ever need is already part and parcel of this grace-gift. The testimony of Christ confirmed in you will not leave you stranded half way, but is able to sustain you guiltless in his presence to the end of days. Jesus is the guarantee of your acquittal; his life and testimony is the receipt and documented proof against all accusation and suspicion. "He is the guarantee of your vindication; he is your warrant against all accusation or indictment." (Amplified Bible)

In this light Paul pleads with every believer to be mutually persuaded in the same opinion; he exhorts each and every one of us to speak the same language, because we share the exact same reference.

Ps. 36:9 "For with you is the fountain of life; in your light do we see light." RSV. God's

point of view is the only light that dispels the illusion of distance and division.

1 Cor. 1:7 In [1]receiving the [2]revelation of Jesus Christ as the principal influence in your life *(his Lordship)*, **you prove that you lack nothing and that his grace gifts fully compliment you.** *(This is in such contrast to those days when under-achievement was the rule; when you felt that you were never good enough and always lagging behind. Note: [1]**apekdechomai** is not "eagerly waiting for," but "eagerly accepting" or to welcome with hospitality; [2]**apokalupsis** is the unveiling, disclosure. I don't know why most translations always want to postpone what God has already unveiled!)*

1 Cor. 1:8 He establishes you from start to finish; to stand [1]vindicated in your identity in the light of day as evidenced in the Lord Jesus Christ. *(The word, [1]**anegkletos**,from **ana**, upward, **en**, in and **kaleo**, to identify by name. Jesus gives evidence to our original identity. Compare **anoche** from **ana + echo** in Rom 3:26.)*

1 Cor. 1:9 We are [1]surnamed by God; this is our true lineage; he is faithful and fully persuaded about our joint participation in the fellowship of sonship; we are included in everything that our Lord Jesus Christ and the Father enjoys. God's faithfulness is the basis of this union. *(The word [1]**kaleo**, means to call or identify by name, to surname.)*

1 Cor. 1:10 Friends, because we are surnamed and identified in the name of our master Jesus Christ, I [1]urge you to speak with one voice; we share the same source as our reference; the idea of division is an illusion. We are a perfect match; accurately joined in the same thought and communicating the same resolve. *(The word, [1]**parakaleo**, is from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, and **kaleo**, to surname.)*

1 Cor. 1:11 Some of the believers in Chleo's fellowship told me about the controversy in your ranks; this is most disturbing!

1 Cor. 1:12 What I was told is that you are divided into groups, where some side with Paul, others with Apollos, still others with Cephas, and even some who say, "we are the Messianic group"!

1 Cor. 1:13 This is really ridiculous: can Christ be cut up into little relics? Was Paul crucified for you? Were you baptized into Paul's name?

1 Cor. 1:14 Baptism is not my business or emphasis; I am glad that I only baptized Crispus and Gaius amongst you. *(Crispus was his neighbor and leader of the synagogue [see Acts 18:8]. Gaius resided at Corinth. Paul stayed with him when he*

wrote the Epistle to the Romans [Rom 16:23]; he was also a travel companion of Paul's [Acts 19:29].)

1 Cor. 1:15 I distance myself from the idea of employing baptism as a means of branding my ministry with my name! Somehow baptism has become a snare to some who wish to win members to their denomination! Rom. 12:18 You have within you what it takes to be everyone's friend, regardless of how they treat you. *(See Rom. 1:16, 17. Also Matt. 5:44, 45.)*

If possible, so far as it depends upon you, live peaceably with all. Rom. 12:18. RSV.

Eph. 4:21 Truth is defined in Christ! It is not possible to study Christ in any other context; he is the incarnation; hear him resonate within you! The truth about you has its ultimate reference in Jesus. *(He did not come to introduce a new compromised set of rules; he is not an example for us but of us!)*

Eph. 4:22 Now you are free to strip off that old identity like a filthy worn-out garment. Lust corrupted you and cheated you into wearing it. *(Just like an actor who wore a cloak for a specific role he had to interpret; the fake identity is no longer appropriate!)*

Eph. 4:23 Be renewed in your innermost mind. *[Ponder the truth about you, as it is displayed in Christ; begin with the fact of your co-seatedness.]* **This will cause you to be completely re-programmed in the way you think about yourself!** *Notice that Paul does not say, "Renew your minds!" This transformation happens in the spirit of your mind, awakened by truth on a much deeper level than a mere intellectual or academic consent. We often thought that we had to get information to drop from the head to the heart; but it is the other way around! Jesus says in John 7:37, "When you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, then you will discover that you are what I am all about, and rivers of living waters will gush out of your innermost being! The spirit of mankind was never contaminated; just like the watermark in a paper note. The lost coin never lost its original inscription and image [see also James 3:9]; it was the mind that was veiled by darkness; we were darkened in our understanding! Our thoughts were reduced to the soul realm reference, knowing ourselves, and one another merely after the flesh. Isa. 55:8-11 There is nothing wrong with our design or our redemption; we were thinking wrong! In order for our thoughts to be rescued from the dominion of darkness, Jesus as the incarnate image and likeness of God, has gone into our darkest hellish nightmare, and faced our cruellest judgment and fears, and died our death! This is the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations, for our glorification! We were*

co-crucified, to bring absolute closure to every reference we have had of ourselves as a result of Adam's fall! And while we were dead in our sins and trespasses, God co-quickened us and co-raised us, and co-seated us in Christ! Now, we all with unveiled faces may behold the glory of the Lord as in a mirror! And be radically transformed in our thinking in order to rediscover his image and likeness fully redeemed in us!)

The love dream of God provides the platform for unhindered friendship.

The eye of the fountain preserves and secures the original undiluted thought of God; he is the Word that proceeds from the mouth of God. He is our origin; all our springs of joy are in him!

The Gospel holds the ingredient of the most powerful influence that we could ever encounter. Nothing known to us presents a greater wealth of wisdom than the love of God realized. This great revelation is not only his love for us but also his love in us for others!

We are designed for friendship. Any measure or definition of hostility, distance or loneliness is foreign to our makeup.

"A human being is like a work of art; the more it is admired the more beautiful it grows reflecting the gift of love like light back to the giver" Elizabeth Goudge.

The most tragic consequence of the fall of man was the loss of man's conviction of his true identity. A new dominance was introduced, and man became subject to the judgement of the sense realm. An environment ruled by chance, change and temporal values became man's reference.

The greatest distraction and contradiction to man's true identity and destiny is to live a life subject to an inferior opinion. We have inherited and adopted a set of values and prejudices that crippled relationships on every level of our society.

Somehow in our efforts to reconcile or rehabilitate, all the energy is spent on targeting the cobwebs instead of killing the spider. Crime, juvenile delinquency, drug addiction, and alcohol-abuse, the abuse of women and children, the divorce-rate, the break up of the family, corruption and war make a mockery of our social, religious and political structures.

Paul declares, that we wrestle not against flesh and blood, which takes man out of the equation. No human can qualify to be an enemy again. The focus of our ministry is, "to make all men see what is the plan of the mystery hidden for ages in God who created all things, that through the church (ekklesia, from ek, a preposition denoting

origin, and kaleo, to identify by name, thus the revelation of man's original identity) the manifold wisdom of God might now be made known to the principalities and powers in the heavenly realm. This was according to the eternal purpose, which He realised in Christ Jesus our Lord." Eph. 3:9-11. What God was able to communicate in Christ, is now made visible in man to be communicated in spirit realm. The mystery is "Christ in you." Col.1:25-27.

Law-inspired behavior reduces the impact of your life to the natural realm, while faith realities realized, has an immediate impact in the spirit realm.

Nowhere has life become more worthless than in the context of war. Violence as a voice, whether it is a minority such as al-Qaeda or the Boeremag or a majority such as the Bush and Blair-administration, says the same thing: we have a sick society with a sick self-image. To ignore the value of the human spirit is to insult the integrity of our design. *[At the time of writing these thoughts.]*

This becomes such a complex thing; we are prepared to spend millions to save life and at the same time we spend millions to destroy life. We have failed in our basic education when we fail to appreciate or respect life. Should our mutual respect for one another be challenged, our highest moral value is at risk.

No man can live happily who regards himself alone,

Who turns everything to his own advantage.

One must live for another if one wishes to live for oneself.

True fiends are the whole world to one another,

And he that is a friend to himself is also a friend to mankind.

Seneca 4 BC – AD 65 Roman Philosopher

We are designed for friendship. Any measure or definition of hostility, distance or loneliness is foreign to our makeup.

A man was carrying a very ill person over a long distance when someone asked him if the load he carried was not too heavy for him. 'He ain't heavy, he's my brother' came the prompt reply. This man's attitude is the theme of the law of liberty. The law of love liberates one into a different level of life. Its language is not 'have to' but 'want to'. There is a distinct difference between willpower and willingness. This law governs the will of man, not through a sense of obligation but inspiration and passion, with a

love that desires to please. Faith-inspiration is the purest energy of the soul. This level of inspiration is fuelled not by reasoning, but by revelation. God's faith in you declares your value; realized value ignites passion. Routine living takes the edge off passion; routine dulls passion; taking yourself or others for granted does the same.

In your every relationship begin to discover and declare the value of the other. God desires closeness, not distance. You are designed to live a totally fulfilled life. Sustained, intimate and total pleasure is not an illusion but meant to be the focus of your faith.

One of our most basic human rights is to feel appreciated. We long for recognition. Nothing harms a relationship or self-image more than to feel neglected and taken for granted. Love and friendship blossom in an environment of appreciation. It is in the nature of love to admire without prejudice.

Yet, love can afford to be misunderstood, ignored, face conflict, injustice and war, and still conquer. Love is designed to conquer.

Every contradiction becomes an opportunity for the reinforcement and confirmation of the truth, rather than a distraction from it. Truth realized makes of faith a fortress!

To appreciate means to express and communicate value. But value must have a realized, realistic reference; a reference that goes beyond our best, or poorest performance. Christ in his Person and work of redemption is that blueprint reference. Oh that we may know, even as we have always been known! 1 Cor. 13:12.

Let us consider these 5 vital ingredients to meaningful friendship:

1/ The Agape agenda: Unconditional love sets the pace,

2/ Uncluttered belief

3/ Innocence: forgiveness, no suspicion, blame or guilt,

4/ Oneness of mind ~ sharing the same reference,

5/ Living happily ever after Long-term, sustained friendship.

Unconditional Love - Agape is the only agenda! Chapter 4

He loved us first!

The revelation of God's love initiative to reconcile himself with humanity distinguishes true Christianity from every other religion. Grace takes Karma out of the equation! Religion needs paying and returning customers. In Africa, no witch doctor would make any money were the ancestors not always portrayed as unhappy or angry. The moodier the ancestor seems, the more expensive the scapegoat.

The mission of Jesus was not to change God's mind about us but to change our mind about God! He shocked the Jews with statements like, "No man knows God! The Son reveals him! If you have seen me you have seen the Father!"

Jesus didn't come to persuade an angry God to be nice towards mankind; he came to persuade an indifferent and hostile humanity about the goodness of God!

True Christian faith is not about humanity attempting to win the favour of deity, or trying to influence the mood of a bad tempered god; it is the revelation of the love of God reconciling a hostile world to himself.

Rom. 5:10 Our hostility and indifference towards God did not reduce his love for us; he saw equal value in us when he exchanged the life of his Son for ours. Now that the act of [1]reconciliation is complete, his life in us saves us from the gutter-most to the uttermost. *(Reconciliation, from [1]***katalasso***, meaning a mutual exchange of equal value. Thayer Definition: to exchange, as coins for others of equivalent value.")*

"For if while we were enemies we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son, much more, now that we are reconciled, shall we be saved by his life."RSV

It is not about a sacrifice that we bring; the gospel reveals God's love initiative: John 1:29 "Behold the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world." RSV

Gen. 22:7-8 And Isaac said to his father Abraham, "My father!" And he said, "Here am I, my son." He said, "Behold, the fire and the wood; but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?" Abraham said, "God will provide himself the lamb for a burnt offering, my son."

Gen. 22:13 "And Abraham lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold, behind him was a ram, caught in a thicket by its horns; and Abraham went and took the ram, and offered it up as a burnt offering instead of his son." RSV

God will himself provide the lamb....and behold, behind him was a lamb!" Jesus is the same YESTERDAY, today and forever! Heb. 13:8.

"I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and I heard behind me a loud voice like a trumpet. Rev. 1:10

John 8:56-58 "Your father Abraham rejoiced that he was to see my day; he saw it and was glad." The Jews then said to him, "You are not yet fifty years old, and have you seen Abraham?" Jesus said to them, "Truly, truly, I say to you, before Abraham was, I am." RSV

Isa. 53:7 "He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth; like a lamb that is led to the slaughter, and like a sheep that before its shearers is dumb, so he opened not his mouth." RSV

Acts. 8:30-35 So Philip ran to him, and heard him reading Isaiah the prophet, and asked, "Do you understand what you are reading?" And he said, "How can I, unless someone guides me?" And he invited Philip to come up and sit with him. Now the passage of the scripture which he was reading was this: "As a sheep led to the slaughter or a lamb before its shearer is dumb, so he opened not his mouth. In his humiliation justice was denied him. Who can describe his generation? For his life is taken up from the earth." And the eunuch said to Philip, "About whom, pray, does the prophet say this, about himself or about someone else?" Then Philip opened his mouth, and beginning with this scripture he told him the good news of Jesus. RSV .See Luke 24:27, 44, 45, John 5:39, 40.

I wrote in the margin of my Bible next to Acts 8:35, when you study or teach scripture, get to the point."

Rom. 5:8-9 Herein is the extremity of God's love gift: mankind was rotten to the core when Christ died their death. If God could love us that much when we were ungodly and guilty, how much more are we free to realize his love now that we know that we are declared innocent by his blood? *(God does not love us more now that we are reconciled to him; we are now free to realize how much he loved us all along! Col. 2:14, Rom. 4:25.)*

"We love because he first loved us." 1 John 4:19 RSV

If sin could separate us from the love of God then redemption would be impossible. Paul declares to the Greek philosophers in Acts 17, that the Creator is "not far from each one of us!" God is not closer to some than what he is to others; in the incarnation

he is equally Immanuel to every person.

God takes pleasure in mankind. His reference exceeds anything that could possibly disqualify us. In Christ he has broken down every wall of hostility and every excuse we have to feel distant from him.

Eph. 4:7 The gift of Christ measures the extravagant dimensions of grace; where everyone is equally advantaged. *(Grace was given to each one of us according to the measure of the gift of Christ. One measure, one worth! Our worth is defined by his gift not by a reward for our behavior.)*

1 Pet. 1:18 It is clear to see that you were ransomed from the futile, fallen mindset that you inherited from your fathers, not by the currency of your own labor, represented by the fluctuating values of gold and silver, and the economy of your religious efforts;

1 Pet. 1:19 but you were redeemed with the priceless blood of Christ; he is the ultimate sacrifice; spotless and without blemish. He completes the prophetic picture! *(In him God speaks the most radical scapegoat language of the law of judgment and brings final closure to a dead and redundant system! In Psalm 40:6,7, it is clearly stated that God does not require sacrifices or offerings! Jesus is the Lamb of God! He collides victoriously with the futile sacrificial system whereby offerings are constantly made to the pseudo, moody, monster gods of our imagination! This is the scandal of the cross! God does not demand a sacrifice that would change the way he thinks about mankind; he provides the sacrifice of himself in Christ in order to forever eradicate sin-consciousness from our minds and radically change the way we think about our Maker, one another and ourselves! [Sin-consciousness is in essence a works-based consciousness.] God did not clothe Adam with the skin of an animal because of a divine need to be appeased, but because of their unconditional love for Adam; they spoke the language of Adam's own judgment: Adam, not God, was embarrassed about his nakedness. The clothing was not to make God look at Adam differently, but to make Adam feel better about himself! And ultimately it was to prophetically prepare Adam for the unveiling of the mystery of mankind's redemption in the incarnation. Here Deity would clothe themselves in human skin, in a Son; and the Lion of Judah would become the Lamb of God in order to free our minds to re-discover his image and likeness in our skin! See 1 Peter 1:2.)*

Job. 7:17 "What is man that you should magnify him, and that you should set your

heart on him?" Literal Translation of the Holy Bible LTHB.

"What is man that you are mindful of him, and the son of man that you care so much for him?" Ps. 8:4.

"How precious to me are your thoughts, O God! How impossible to calculate their sum total; were I to count them my years would have to equal yours!" Ps. 139:17, 18. REB. It will take eternity to calculate the full extent of your thoughts towards us!

God's faith sees the fruit of the labor of his love, and feasts upon the thought of our redemption and reconciliation to him. God's faith feasts on the knowledge of mankind's restored union and oneness with him!

Isa. 53:3-6 " He was despised and rejected by men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief; and as one from whom men hide their faces he was despised, and we esteemed him not. Surely he has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten by God, and afflicted. But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities; upon him was the chastisement that made us whole, and with his stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned everyone to his own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all."

Isa. 53:11 "He shall see the fruit of the travail of his soul and be satisfied; by his knowledge shall the righteous one, my servant, make the multitudes to be accounted righteous; because he shall bear their iniquities."

Zeph. 3:17 God rejoices over you with gladness, he renews you in his love; he exults over you with loud singing and spins around in joyful dancing!

Titus 3:2 Gossip is out! Never have anything bad to say about anyone! Don't try and be the [1]macho man, having to win every argument; instead, avoid quarrelling, be appropriate, always show perfect courtesy to one and all. *(The word, [1]**amachos** from a as a negative particle and **mache**, a brawler, to be controversial, striving. You don't have to wait for people to change before you are nice to them. There is a big difference between "fake politeness" and perfect courtesy!)*

Titus 3:3 Do not be harsh on others. Remember that we, too, were typically foolish; we were stubborn and indifferent to spiritual things, our addiction to the sensual and sexual kept us running around in circles, we were engaged in malice and spiteful jealousies, we were bored and lonely, often utterly disliking ourselves and hating one another! *(The only difference in who we are now and who we were then is*

in what we now know to be true about ourselves.)

Titus 3:4 But then, oh happy day! It was the generosity of God and his fondness for mankind that dawned on us like a shaft of light. Our days of darkness were over! Light shone everywhere and we became aware: God rescued the human race! *(See Titus 2:11.)*

"I was ready to be found by those who did not seek me; I said, "Here I am, here I am! I spread out my hands all day long to a rebellious people." Isa. 65:1, 2. RSV

Be God's 'pop-ups' in society. Live God's initiative! Make known his patient fondness for mankind.

Love sets faith in motion. Gal. 5:6. *(It is easy for love to believe!)*

Love fuels belief.

The same God who engineered the sunrise engineered our salvation.

The redemption of humanity is beyond dispute. God himself guarantees the integrity of this union: **2 Tim. 2:13 Our unbelief does not change what God believes; he cannot contradict himself. (***What we believe about God does not define him; God's faith defines us. God cannot be untrue to himself.)*

Rom. 3:3 The question is, how does someone's failure to believe God affect what God believes? Can their unbelief cancel God's faith? *(What we believe about God does not define him; God's faith defines us. See the RSV translation, "What if some were unfaithful? Does their faithlessness nullify the faithfulness of God? By no means!")*

Rom. 3:4 God's word is not under threat! In fact if all of mankind fails, truth remains intact. Truth is defined in God; it is neither challenged nor vindicated by human experience. Contradiction does not intimidate or diminish God's belief. Scripture records that God stands justified in his own word; it confirms that God's promise and purpose are not compromised through mankind's failure; neither is God's reputation threatened by our behavior. *(Truth does not become true by popular vote. It is already as true as it gets because God believes it; it is from faith to faith, says Paul [Rom 1:17]; there is no gospel in it until the righteousness of God is revealed; "we can do nothing against the truth!" [See 2 Cor 13:5 and 8]. David's sin did not cancel God's promise. "But my mercy I will not take from him" and "his house shall be made sure, and his kingdom for ever before me, and his throne shall be set up forever." [2 Sam 7:15-16].)*

God desires to persuade us beyond all dispute about the transparent integrity of his eternal purpose; (in our human affairs we would swear an oath by the highest authority in order to add conclusive weight to our intentions.) God employs a similar method in order to drive home his unwavering conviction concerning us; so he swears by himself, there being no higher authority than his own Throne; by implication God's being becomes the immediate guarantee to his word.

Heb. 6:13 Since God had no one greater by whom to swear, he swore by himself. He could give Abraham no greater guarantee but the integrity of his own Being; this

makes the promise as sure as God is.

Heb. 6:16 It is common practice in human affairs to evoke a higher authority under oath in order to add weight to any agreement between parties, thereby [1]silencing any possibility of quibbling. *(The word [1]**peras**, means the end of all dispute; the point beyond which one cannot go.)*

Heb. 6:17 In the same context we are confronted with God's eagerness to go to the last extreme in his dealing with us as heirs of his promise, and to cancel out all possible grounds for doubt or dispute. In order to persuade us of the unalterable character and finality of his resolve, he [1]confined himself to an oath. The promise which already belongs to us by heritage is now also [1]confirmed under oath. *(The word [1]**mesiteo** is used, interposed or mediated. Compare **mesites**, mediator, from **mesos**, midst. In the incarnation, God has positioned himself in the midst, of his creation.*

See Galatians 3:20 With Abraham there was no middleman; it was just God! [The Mosaic law sopke the language of "the fallen mind" and required mediators - the Levitical priesthood - because it was an arrangement whereby mankind had a part and God had a part. God's covenant with Abraham was a grace covenant pointing to the man Jesus Christ, in whom God himself would fulfil mankind's part and therefore needed no mediator apart from himself.]

The Word is the promise; the Incarnate, crucified and risen Christ is the proof. He desires to show more convincingly to the heirs of the promise the unchangeable character of his purpose. RSV .

God did not buy us back from the Devil; a thief never becomes an owner; neither did Jesus do what he did to change his Father's mind about us! It was our minds that needed persuasion! God was not to be reconciled to his creation; God was in Christ when he reconciled the world to himself! 2 Corinthians 5:18-20.)

Heb. 6:18 So that we are now dealing with two irreversible facts which make it impossible for anyone to prove God wrong; thus our persuasion as to our redeemed identity is powerfully reinforced. We have already escaped into that destiny; our expectation has come within our immediate grasp! *(The promise of redemption sustained throughout Scripture and the fulfillment of that promise in Jesus. See John 8:13-18 That should settle it for you since it is written in your law that the testimony of two, is true! [This combined witness of two is not true just because they*

agree, unless true in fact separately. But if they disagree, the testimony falls to the ground. Deuteronomy 17:6; and Deut 19:15. - Robertson. Also Rev 10:6 See notes on the Oath at the end of Rev 10 also the Notes on the Testimony of Jesus at the end of Rev 20 in the .])

Heb. 6:19 Our hearts and minds are certain; anchored securely within the innermost courts of God's immediate Presence; beyond the *(prophetic)* **veil.**

Heb. 6:20 By going there on our behalf, Jesus pioneered a place for us and removed every type of obstruction that could possibly distance us from the promise. In him we are represented for all time; he became our High Priest after the order of Melchizedek. We now enjoy the same privileged access he has. *(He said, "I go to prepare a place for you so that you may be where I am. On that day you will no longer doubt that I and the Father are one; you will know that I am in the Father and you in me and I in you!" John 10:30, 14:3, 20.)*

Mankind's redemption is not in the balance neither is it at risk!

The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar testimony that is mathematically precise, revealing that God knew before time the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross!

Jesus is God's eternal and final yes mankind; in his own person he became the guarantee and fulfillment of every promise God had in mind for humanity! 2 Cor. 1:18-22. God cannot lie. Jesus is God's mind made up about you!

Heb.13:8 Take your lead from Jesus. He is your reference to the most complete life. In him yesterday is confirmed today and today mirrors tomorrow. What God spoke to us in Christ is as relevant now as it was in the prophetic past and will always be in the eternal future! *(Jesus is the same yesterday, today, and forever; there is a history to our salvation that carries more authority and relevance than anything that ever happened in our past, or anything present in time or still to happen in the future. Imagine the enormity of eternity in his sameness before time was; and we were there in him all along! See Rom 8:34 What further ground can there possibly be to condemn mankind? In his death he faced our judgment; in his resurrection he declares our innocence; the implications cannot be undone! He now occupies the highest seat of authority as the executive of our redemption in the throne room of God. See Rom 8: 1, also Rom 4:25. The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar*

testimony that is mathematically precise, revealing that God knew before time was the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross and be raised again from the dead!)

Titus 1:3 "In the hope of eternal life, which God, who cannot lie, promised long ages ago but at the proper time manifested." RSV

Titus 1:2 This is the life of the [1]ages which was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before [2]time or space existed. *(Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. The word, [1]**aionios**, speaks of ages. Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer. The word, [2]**xronos**, means a measured duration or length of time; **kairos** is a due, or specific moment of time. This was before the ages or any measure of calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity!*

This life was made certain before eternal time. [BBE 1949, Bible in Basic English]

Hebrews 13:8 Take your lead from Jesus. He is your reference to the most complete life. In him yesterday is confirmed today and today mirrors tomorrow. What God spoke to us in Christ is as relevant now as it was in the prophetic past and will always be in the eternal future! [Jesus is the same yesterday, today, and forever; there is a history to our salvation that carries more authority and relevance than anything that ever happened in our past, or anything present in time or still to happen in the future. Imagine the enormity of eternity in his sameness before time was; and we were there in him all along! See Rom 8:34 What further ground can there possibly be to condemn mankind? In his death he faced our judgment; in his resurrection he declares our innocence; the implications cannot be undone! He now occupies the highest seat of authority as the executive of our redemption in the throne room of God. See Rom 8: 1, also Rom 4:25. The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar testimony that is mathematically precise, revealing that God knew before time was the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross and be raised again from the dead!])

Titus 1:3 My message announces the completeness of time; God's eternal moment realized the logic of our salvation. *(But then the day dawned; the most complete*

culmination of time! [Gal 4:4] Everything predicted was concluded in Christ!

John 1:14 Suddenly the invisible eternal Word takes on visible form! The Incarnation! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible display of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He captivates our gaze!

*Hebrews 1:1 Throughout [1]ancient times God spoke in many fragments and glimpses of prophetic thought to our fathers. Now, this entire conversation has [2]finally dawned in sonship. Suddenly what seemed to be an ancient language, falls fresh and new like the dew on the tender grass! He is the sum total of every utterance of God in conversation with us. He is whom the Prophets pointed to and we are his immediate audience! [The word [1]**palai**, meaning, of old, ancient; from **palin** through the idea of oscillatory repetition or retrocession; anew, afresh. See Deut 32:1 "Give ear, Oh heavens, and I will speak; and let the earth hear the words of my mouth. Deut 32:2 May my teaching drop as the rain, my speech distil as the dew, as the gentle rain upon the tender grass, and as the showers upon the herb.... Deut 32:18 You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who gave you birth. Like in James 1: 24, we have forgotten what manner of people we are - we have forgotten the face of our birth!*

*The word [2]**eschatos** means extreme; last in time or in space; the uttermost part, the final conclusion. Sonship revealed and redeemed defines eschatology!]*

Heb 1:2 In sonship, God declares the Incarnate Word to be the heir of all things. He is, after all, the author of the ages. We have our beginning and our being in him. [Sonship endorses heirship! See Heb 6:16-18.]

Heb 1:3 Jesus is the crescendo of God's conversation with mankind; he gives context and content to the authentic thought. Everything that God had in mind for mankind is voiced in him. Jesus is God's language. He is the radiant and flawless expression of the person and [1]intent of God. He mirrors God's [2]character and exhibits his every attribute in human form. He is the incarnate voice of God in revealing and redeeming our sonship and innocence. This voice is the dynamic that sustains the entire cosmos. He is the force of the universe upholding everything that exists as the executive authority of God, enthroned in the boundless measure of his majesty. ["Having accomplished purification of sins, he sat down ..." His throne is proof of mankind's redeemed innocence!

More than two thousand years ago the conversation that had begun before time was recorded—sustained in fragments of thought throughout the ages, whispered in prophetic language, chiseled in stone and inscribed in human conscience and memory—

became a man. Beyond the tablet of stone, the papyrus scroll or parchment roll, human life has become the articulate voice of God. The name of Jesus defines his mission. As Savior of the world he truly redeemed the image and likeness of the invisible God and made him apparent again in human form, as in a mirror.])

2 Tim. 2:9 I might be in bonds, but the word of God is not. *(It might seem to some that my suffering contradicts what I preach, but it cannot! My ministry is measured by the word not by my circumstances. See Colossians 1:24.)*

2 Tim. 2:10 This gives me more than enough reason not to quit. I desire for everyone to discover the fact that the life of their [1]design is redeemed in Christ Jesus; this is the timeless intent of God. *(The word [1]**eklegomai**, **ek**, source, origin, and **legomai** from **logos**, word, thus the life of our design.)*

2 Tim. 2:11 The logic of God endorses our faith: we were included in his death and are therefore equally included in his resurrection.

2 Tim. 2:12 Sufferings do not distract us; neither do they contradict our joint position with him in the throne room , the Christ-life rules. If we [1]contradict ourselves *(behave unlike ourselves)*, **he will contradict us and prove us wrong!** *(The word [1]**arneomai** means to contradict.)*

Heb. 10:23 Our conversation echoes his persuasion; his faithfulness backs his promises. *(His integrity inspires our confession. "Let us hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering, for he who promised is faithful.)*

Abraham showed no hesitation or doubt at God's promise, but drew strength from his faith, confessing God's power *(Greek, **doxa**, opinion)* fully convinced that God was able to perform what he had promised. His faith was thus reckoned virtue. Rom. 4:20, 21 (Knox)

Rom. 4:20 While he had every reason to doubt the promise, he did not hesitate for a moment but instead empowered by faith confidence, he continued to communicate God's opinion. *(His name was his confession: in the Hebrew language, "Abraham" אברהם was not a mere familiar sounding name, but a meaningful sentence, a confession of faith authority, against the odds. He did not become embarrassed about his name; he did not change his name to "Abe" for short when there seemed to be no change in his circumstances. Every time he introduced himself or someone called him by his name, it was a bold declaration and repetition of God's promise, calling things that were not as though they were. I would imagine that Sarah spoke his name the most! In*

fact, every time they addressed one another they spoke the promise, "Mother of nations, kings of peoples shall come from you!" [Gen 17:5, 16]. Abraham, "the father of the multitudes.")

Rom. 4:21 Abraham's confidence was his [1]dress-code; he knew beyond doubt that the power of God to perform was equal to his promise. *([1]**plerophoreo**, from **plero** to be completely covered in every part, **+ phoreo**, to wear garments or armor; traditionally translated to be completely persuaded. His faith was his visible identity and armor; he wore his persuasion like he would his daily garments.)*

Rom. 4:22 The persuasion of God rubbed off on Abraham and became his personal conviction. This was the [1]basis of his righteousness. *("Righteousness was [1]reckoned to him," this means that God's faith pointed Abraham to an invisible future where mankind's innocence and identity would be redeemed again. Greek, [1]**logitsomai**, logical conclusion.)*

Rom. 4:23 Here is the Good News: the recorded words, "It was reckoned to him" were not written for his sake alone.

Rom. 4:24 Scripture was written with us in mind! The same [1]conclusion is now equally relevant in our realizing the significance of Jesus' resurrection from the dead. *(By raising Jesus from the dead God proclaims his belief in our redeemed innocence. Isaac's birth from Sarah's barren womb prophetically declared the resurrection of Jesus from the tomb! Abraham's best efforts could not produce Isaac. Sarah's dead womb is a picture of the impossibility of the flesh to produce a child. This underlines mankind's inability to redeem themselves under the law of willpower. Jesus said, "Abraham saw my day!" Mankind's most extreme self-sacrifice offered in an attempt to win the favorable attention of their deity could never match the sacrifice of God's Lamb to win the attention of mankind! When Isaac questioned his father about the sacrifice, then Abraham announced, "Jaweh jireh!" יהוה יראה Jaweh sees! And he lifted up his eyes and behold **behind him** was a ram caught in the thorn bush by its horns! Note, "Behind him!" Faith sees the future in past tense-mode! The resurrection is the ultimate proof and trophy of righteousness by God's faith. [See Rom 6:11] [1]**logitsomai** - logical conclusion. "Consider **[logitsomai]** yourself dead indeed," compared with 4:19, "Abraham considered his own body dead." We can only study Scripture in the context of Christ as representing the human race; God had us in mind all along [John 5:39].)*

Rom. 4:25 Here is the equation: He was handed over [1]because of our [2]short fallings *[our fallen mindset]*; **he was raised [1]because we were declared righteous! His resurrection is the official receipt to our acquittal.** *(His cross = our sins, his resurrection = our innocence! His death brought closure to our short fallings; his resurrection is proof of our redeemed righteousness. Why was Jesus handed over to die? Because of, [1]**dia**, our transgressions. Why was he raised from the dead? Because of, [1]**dia**, our righteousness! His resurrection reveals our righteousness! If mankind was still guilty after Jesus died, his resurrection would be irrelevant! This explains Acts 10:28 and 2 Corinthians 5:14 and 16.*

1Tim. 4:9 The word is certainly true and worthy of our undivided attention.

1Thes. 2:13 When you first heard us preach the word, you did not pass it off as just one more human opinion, but you took it to heart as God's true word to you, which it is, God himself at work in you believers! The Message.

Heb. 12:2 Look away from the shadow dispensation of the law and the Prophets and fix your eyes upon Jesus. He is the fountainhead and conclusion of faith. He saw the joy *[of mankind's salvation]* **when he braved the cross and despised the shame of it. As the executive authority of God** *[the right hand of the throne of God]* **he now occupies the highest seat of dominion to endorse mankind's innocence!** *(Having accomplished purification of sins, he sat down. Heb 1:3, Isa 53:11.)*

2 Cor. 1:18 God's certainty is our persuasion; there is no maybe in him!

2 Cor. 1:19 The Son of God, Jesus Christ, whom I, Paul, Sylvanus, and Timothy boldly announced in you, is God's ultimate yes to "you-manity". Jesus is God's Yes to you! Human life is associated in all that he is. In God's mind there exists not even a hint of hesitation about this! *(Note, Paul and his team proclaimed Christ **in** them, not, "to"them! See Gal 1:16; and Col. 1:27. Also 2 Cor 3:4.)*

2 Cor. 1:20 In him the detail of every single promise of God is fulfilled; Jesus is God's yes to your entire well being! In our union with him the Amen that echoes in us gives evidence to his glorious intent through us.

2 Cor. 1:21 God himself authorizes our oneness with you in Christ. He is our anointing! *(The word, χρίω **chriō** means to smear or rub with oil, to anoint.)*

2 Cor. 1:22 His personal signet signature is the official stamp that sanctions the integrity of our ministry to you; this is the seal of the Spirit in our hearts.

God's faith is the fountainhead of our faith. We do not need to conjure up our own

faith when we can have God's; we only need to know what God believes.

Paul says "The joy of the Lord is our strength" We do not need to manufacture our own joy if we can have his. If the joy of the Lord is to our advantage then his joy must be based on something he knows to be true about us! We are God's joy!

What we believe about God does not define him; our doctrines do not even define us, even though they may label us. What God knows to be true about us as demonstrated in Christ alone defines us. Agree with God about you!

Jesus is what God believes about you!

Anything you believe about God that is unlike Jesus is not true about God; Jesus is the image of the invisible God, if you have seen him you have seen the Father.

Any attempt to understand God apart from Jesus Christ isn't theology but mythology. Jesus is the benchmark from which every truth about the Father must be measured and evaluated. If it doesn't line up with Jesus, "it ain't God." (Steve McVey)

The Bible is all about Jesus; Jesus is all about us!

The Gospel announces that Jesus is what God believes about us! The truth, as it is on exhibit in Christ. The truth about you has its ultimate reference in Jesus. Eph 4:21. Whatever is true of Jesus, is equally true of you! 1 John 2:7,8; As he is, so are we in THIS world! 1 John 4:17.

Truth persuades naturally!

Something doesn't become truer because a person believes it; it's already as true as it gets because God believes it; otherwise there is nothing for a person to believe, if it wasn't true in the first place; it is from faith to faith says Paul.

Rom. 1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness reveals the life of our design. "Righteousness by his *(God's)* **faith defines life."** *(Habakkuk 2:4] "Look away [from the law of works], unto Jesus; he is the Author and finisher of faith." [Hebrews 12:1]. It is God's faith to begin with; it is* ***from faith to faith****, and not our good or bad behavior; we are not defined by our performance or circumstances. The Greek word translated "from" is the Preposition,* ***ek****, which always denotes source or origin.)*

Because mankind is the god-kind we are designed to be persuaded; we are faith-

compatible; **2 Cor. 4:13 We [1]echo the exact same spirit of faith David had when he wrote: "I [2]believe and so I speak!" We too believe and so we speak! Our persuasion is our conversation.** *(The word, [1]**echo**, means to hold or to embrace. Paul quotes David here in Psalm 116; sometimes one's soul wants to gallop away into distraction like a wild horse; then, David reminds himself, "Return to your rest, oh my soul, for the Lord has dealt bountifully with you! I believe, and so I speak!" God's bountiful dealings with us in Christ is our only valid rest; Sabbath celebrates perfection! "Behold, it is very good!" Gen 1:31,2:2 And remember God does not employ circumstances to teach us something! The finished work of Christ teaches us; his work on the cross rescued us! Ps 116:7,10 I [2]believe; I am sure, אמן **aw-man**, with the root meaning, to build up, or support; to foster as a parent or nurse; figuratively to render [or be] firm or faithful, to trust or believe, to be permanent or quiet; to be true or certain; to go to the right hand: - hence assurance, [relocate yourself mentally where you are co-seated together with Christ in God's right hand!] Also, the word, amen, so be it.*

*Hebrew word to speak, דבר **dabar**, to arrange words in such a way that their effect is to subdue. [Like a lawyer's letter; using legal language.]*

*Then David uses the word, ענה **anah**, which was translated, 'afflicted', but the same word is also used to respond; by extension to begin to speak; specifically to sing, shout, testify, announce: - give account, which is a much more appropriate rendering of this word in context! The Hebrew actually says: I will sing loudly! Remember Paul sang in prison!*

Let faith speak. Let faith break out in song!)

The context of this statement is the mirror principle:

2 Cor. 4:1 Having this ministry by the mercy of God, we do not lose heart. RSV

2 Cor. 4:8-9 We are afflicted in every way, but not crushed; perplexed, but not driven to despair; persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down, but not destroyed; RSV

The Mirror reads: **2 Cor. 4:8 We often feel completely hemmed in on every side but our inner space remains unrestricted; when there seems to be no way out we escape within! 2 Cor. 4:9 says At times we are persecuted to the extreme but we are never abandoned. We are knocked down but not knocked out.**

Every contradiction becomes an opportunity for the reinforcement and confirmation of the truth, rather than a distraction from it. Truth realized makes of faith a fortress!

No contradiction has what it takes to persuade otherwise.

Paul says emphatically in 1 Cor. 9:17 If this was a mere career choice, then surely you could hire or fire me! But I am not for sale; I am employed by the economy of persuasion!

The inscription and image of Caesar distinguishes the piece of metal as legal tender; in the same way, the gospel reveals the inscription and the image of God in the face of Christ as legal tender to redeem mankind. He mirrors every person!

The lost coin never lost its original value.

The younger brother of Jesus, James, discovered in the resurrection of Christ his own as well as the face of every person's birth. The Father of lights brought us forth *(Greek, **egeneto**)* by the Word of truth! To hear the word of truth is to see the face of one's birth as in a mirror, he says.

Then, in James 3:9 We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a fellow human made in his mirror likeness. *(The point is not what the person did to deserve the insult. The point is that people are image and likeness bearers of God by design! True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate.)*

Innocence Redeemed - Chapter 6

Sinners were attracted to Jesus not because he introduced a compromised set of rules; something like, "It's all right to sin just don't get caught; or, try and do it less!" Instead he revealed in his person the mirror-reflection of their true origin, their original identity and the integrity of their innocence! Sinners knew that the lie they lived as their identity had no power against the resonance of their own conscience. Jesus didn't say to the prostitute, "Go and sin less," he said to her "Go and sin no more!" Jesus knew something about the life of our design that we have lost sight of! What he revealed, he also redeemed!

Sin-consciousness is what empowers religion. Gift language disarms reward language. It always amazes me how Simon felt more comfortable with the fact that he had caught nothing the previous night because, "I am a sinful man"! He accepted his fate as his due because his mind was educated under the law of blessings and curses. *(Deuteronomy 28)* When he witnessed the word and the miracle of the catch, he slotted back into his familiar 'karma' mode! "I am not worthy!"

Luke 5:8 Witnessing this, Simon fell on his knees and began to beg Jesus to leave! "Depart from me Lord, for I am a sinful man!" *(Religion over the years has majored on the subject of sin-consciousness. The moment something goes wrong, guilt trips are empowered. Simon's response surprises after he witnesses the teaching and ministry of Jesus, and a catch that he could not claim any credit for! "Depart from me Lord, for I am a sinful man!" He apparently felt a lot more familiar and comfortable to account the previous night's toil and no success to his own sinfulness! Karma makes so much sense to a religion that makes its money out of paying and returning customers!)*

Thank God! Jesus didn't pick disciples on their performance! It wasn't Simon's skill or reputation as a good fisherman that qualified him to become a fisher of men!

Sin-consciousness empowers the law of performance and contradicts what grace reveals; it inhibits any ground for meaningful friendship. A relationship based upon accusation, inferiority, guilt, suspicion or condemnation, has no future. For friendship to be worth anything, innocence is a non negotiable. The innocence Adam walked in before the fall is the same innocence that Jesus enjoys in union with his Father, and is now the restored privilege of every human. Every accusation against mankind has been cancelled; humanity stands fully vindicated and acquitted. The prodigal son was

not out on probation; he stood justified in his father's love, just as if he had never sinned!

Rom. 4:25 Our sins [1]resulted in his death; his resurrection is [1]proof of our righteousness. Here is the equation: He was handed over [1]because of our [2]short fallings *[our fallen mindset]*; **he was raised [1]because we were declared righteous! His resurrection is the official receipt to our acquittal.** *(This is one of the most important statements in the entire Bible. His cross = our sins, his resurrection = our innocence! His death brought closure to our short fallings; his resurrection is proof of our redeemed righteousness. Why was Jesus handed over to die? Because of, [1]**dia**, our transgressions. Why was he raised from the dead? Because of, [1]**dia**, our righteousness! His resurrection reveals our righteousness! If mankind was still guilty after Jesus died, his resurrection would be irrelevant! This explains Acts 10:28 and 2 Corinthians 5:14 and 16.*

See Young's Literal Translation, Rom 4:25 "who was delivered up because of our offences, and was raised up because of our being declared righteous."

*The word [2]**parapiptō** has two components, **para**, closest possible proximity of union, and **piptō**, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to fall; to be thrust down; from **petomai**, to fly. Thus to stop flying! Losing altitude! This speaks of mankind's short fallings, or their fallen mindset. See Col 3:1-3.*

In Acts 17:31, Paul explains to the Greek philosophers that according to the Jewish prophetic word, "God had fixed a day on which he would judge the world in righteousness by a man whom he has appointed, and of this he has given proof to all mankind by raising him from the dead." God's declaration of your redeemed innocence is his most urgent invitation to you(manity) to encounter intimate oneness!

See also 1 Peter 1:10-12 "This salvation which you now know as your own, is the theme of the prophetic thought; this is what captured the Prophets' attention for generations and became the object of their most diligent inquiry and scrutiny. They knew all along that mankind's salvation was a grace revelation, sustained in their prophetic utterance! (Salvation would never be by personal achievement or a reward to willpower-driven initiative! The law of works would never replace grace!)

1 Pet 1:11 In all of their conversation there was a constant quest to determine who the Messiah would be, and exactly when this will happen. They knew with certainty that it was the spirit of Christ within them pointing prophetically and giving testimony to the

sufferings of the Christ and the subsequent glory. (Whatever glory was lost in Adam, would be redeemed again in Jesus Christ!)

1 Pet 1:12 It was revealed to them that this glorious grace message that they were communicating pointed to a specific day and person beyond their own horizon and generation; they saw you in their prophetic view! This heavenly announcement had you in mind all along! They proclaimed glad tidings to you in advance, in the Holy Spirit, commissioned from heaven; the celestial shepherd-messengers themselves longed to gaze deeply into its complete fulfillment.")

Rom. 5:1 The [1]conclusion is clear: our blameless innocence has absolutely nothing to do with something we did to qualify ourselves; it is what happened to us, solely because of our Lord Jesus Christ's doing. Faith, and not reward, is the only valid [2]basis for righteousness! Let us now fully [2]engage this seamless union in our [3]face to face [4]friendship with God! *(In one sentence Paul sums up the previous four chapters. "Standing then acquitted as the result of faith, let us enjoy peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ." Weymouth NT. The word [1]**dikaiothentes** is an Aorist Participle, which translates, "having been justified by faith." See previous verse, Rom 4:25 "...who was delivered up because of our offences, and was raised up because of our being declared righteous." Young's Literal Translation. The Preposition [2]**ek** confirms that faith is the source or basis of our righteousness. Let us have [[2]**echo,** engage/resonate] peace with God - **eirēnēn echōmen pros ton theon**. This is the correct text beyond a doubt, the Present Active Subjunctive, not **echomen** (Present Indicative) of the Textus Receptus. One has only to observe the force of the tense to see Paul's meaning clearly. The mode is the Volitive Subjunctive and the Present Tense expresses linear action. [Vincent] The Preposition [3]**pros** means face to face; see John 1:1. The word, [4]**eirene**, means peace, from **eiro**, to join, to be set at one again, in carpentry it is referred to as the dove-tail joint, which is the strongest joint. Peace is a place of unhindered enjoyment of friendship beyond guilt, suspicion, blame or inferiority.)*

Rom. 5:2 Jesus is God's face to face grace [1]embrace of the entire human race. So here we are, [2]standing tall in the joyful bliss of our redeemed innocence! We are God's [3]dream come true! This was God's [4]idea all along!

God bore witness to our redeemed innocence when he raised Jesus from the dead. (Acts 17:31) "God appointed a day and a person, and on that day in that person he would judge the world in righteousness! He gave proof of this, by raising Jesus from the dead!

Tenses in the Bible can be most confusing unless we understand the logic of Gods faith! "Before Abraham was I am! The Lamb was since the fall of the world! Our redeemed innocence is the central theme of scripture and the very foundation of God's throne. "Having made purification for sins he sat down!" Jesus is the executive authority of God; seated in the boundless measure of his majesty where he occupies the highest seat of dominion to endorse humanity's innocence! Heb.1:3.

Consider the Greek word *μετάνοια* ***metanoia***, from meta, together with, and, noieō, to perceive with the mind; which describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing. It has nothing in common with the Latin word ***paenitentia***, where the word ***pennance*** stems from; meaning, payback and punishment inflicted on oneself. Then they added the "re" to get even more mileage out of sin consciousness. ***Re-penance***. This gross deception led to the perverted doctrines of indulgences, where naive, ignorant people were led to believe that they needed to purchase favor from an angry god. Most cathedrals as well as many ministries were funded with this guilt money.

English translations do little to help us understand what repentance truly is. Until Jerome's Latin Vulgate translation, the word metanoia was commonly used. For instance, Tertullian wrote in ١٩٨ A.D. "In Greek, metanoia is not a confession of sins but a change of mind." But despite this the Latin fathers begin to translate the word as "do penance" following the Roman Catholic teaching on doing penance in order to win God's favor.

In 1430, Lorenzo Valla, a Catholic theologian, began a critical study of Jerome's Latin Vulgate and Valla pointed out many mistakes that Jerome had made. Sadly, the "Vulgate-Only" crowd of Valla's day forced him to renounce many of the changes that he noted needed changing in the Vulgate including the poor translation of metanoia.

Everyone who drinks from the wells of religion will thirst again! The business of religion desperately needs paying and returning customers! Religionists crucified Jesus for this reason because their entire system of keeping people dependent on their hierarchy was challenged and condemned! It was mankind's sin consciousness and their sense of failure and inferiority that empowered religion for centuries.

Isa. 55:8-11 gives meaning to metanoia: your thoughts were distanced from God's thoughts as the heavens are higher than the earth; but just like the rain and the snow cancel that distance and saturate the soil to awaken its seed, so shall my word be that proceeds from my mouth. (The authentic word from the "eye of the fountain.")

Genesis 1:26 redeemed! Col. 1:15, 2:9-10. In the incarnation the earth was saturated with the ultimate evidence of the image and likeness of God unveiled and redeemed in human form.

The authentic thought, the mind of God, is realized again; the distance caused by Adam's fall, (heaven higher than earth), is cancelled in the incarnation. "Come now, let us reason together, says the LORD: though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they are red like crimson, they shall become like wool." Isa. 1:18. RSV

Paul says categorically that he refuses to tamper with God's word: "With the open statement of the truth, *(the unveiled mirror likeness, 2 Cor. 3:18)* we commend ourselves to every man's conscience!" Greek, ***suneido***, to see together, to co-know, which is the opposite of ***Hades***, *from* ***ha + eido***, *not to see.*

2 Cor. 4:2 We have renounced hidden agendas *[employing a little bit of the law in an attempt to "balance" out grace]*; **we have distanced ourselves from any obscure [1]craftiness to manipulate God's word to make it mean what it does not say! With truth on open display in us, we highly recommend our lives to everyone's [2]conscience! Truth finds its most authentic and articulate expression in human life, [3]mirrored in the face of God.** *(It is our passion for all to see what is so completely obvious in the mirror of our redeemed likeness and innocence; this beats any doctrinal debate! The word translated craftiness, is the word [1]**panourgia** from **pas** and **ergon,** all manner of wearisome labor! [2]Conscience in Latin means to know together; in the Greek, [2]**suneido**, translates as joint seeing; which is the opposite of **Hades**, from ha + eido, not to see. πρὸς πᾶσαν [every individual] συνείδησιν [seamless-seeing] ἀνθρώπων ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ pros [face to face] The word for the human species, male or female is **anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner.)*

Your belief in God does not define him; his faith in what he knows to be true about you, defines you.

In Mark 11:22 Jesus says, "***have the faith of God***." Unfortunately many translations say, "***have faith in God***"; there is a vast difference. God's belief in you gives substance to your faith. Jesus is what God believes about you! Faith is to the spirit what the senses are to the body; while the one engages with fleeting and fading moments, the other celebrates perfection.

If our point of reference is not God's faith in the finished work of Christ we have

no valid gospel to preach! If our faith is not sourced and sustained in him as the mirror image of God revealed and redeemed in us we are deceiving ourselves with yet another religious disguise, called Christianity.

Acts 17:30-31 "He overlooked the times of ignorance and now urges all people everywhere to awaken in their understanding to that which is revealed in Christ; mankind was judged righteous in one man's death, and co-raised in his resurrection as the trophy of innocence redeemed! Having made purification for sins he sat down! His throne authority is established upon our redeemed innocence.

God's work in Christ on humanity's behalf has done so much more than the mere forgiveness of sins; He has broken the dominion of sin in our lives! See Eph 4:8-10 and Col 2:14,15.

Isa. 1:18 "Come now, let us reason together, says the LORD: though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they are red like crimson, they shall become like wool.

Rom. 8:1 Now the decisive conclusion is this: in Christ, every bit of condemning evidence against us is cancelled. *("Who walk not after the flesh but after the spirit." This sentence was not in the original text, but later copied from verse 4. The person who added this most probably felt that the fact of Paul's declaration of mankind's innocence had to be made subject again to a person's conduct. Religion under the law felt more comfortable with the condition of personal contribution rather than the conclusion of what faith reveals. The "in Christ" revelation is key to God's dealing with mankind. It is the PIN-code of the Bible. [See 1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4].)*

Rom. 8:2. The law of the Spirit is the liberating force of life in Christ. This leaves me with no further obligation to the law of sin and death. Spirit has superseded the sin enslaved senses as the principle law of our lives. *(The law of the spirit is righteousness by faith vs the law of personal effort and self righteousness which produces condemnation and spiritual death which is the fruit of the DIY tree.)*

Rom. 8:3 The law failed to be anything more than an instruction manual; it had no power to deliver us from the strong influence of sin holding us hostage in our own bodies. God disguised himself in his Son in this very domain where sin ruled us, in flesh. The body he lived and conquered in was no different to ours. Thus sin's authority in the human body was condemned. *(Hebrews 4:15, As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human life. Having subjected it to close*

scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses that are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. He is not an example for us but of us.)

Rom. 8:4 The righteousness promoted by the law is now realized in us. Our practical day-to-day life bears witness to spirit inspiration and not flesh domination.

Rom. 8:5 Sin's symptoms are sponsored by the senses, a mind dominated by the sensual. Thoughts betray source; spirit life attracts spirit thoughts.

Rom. 8:6 Thinking patterns are formed by reference, either the sensual appetites of the flesh and spiritual death, or zoe-life and total tranquillity flowing from a mind addicted to spirit *[faith]* **realities.**

Rom. 8:7 A mind focused on flesh *(the sensual domain where sin held me captive)* **is distracted from God with no inclination to his life-laws. Flesh** *[self-righteousness]* **and spirit** *[faith righteousness]* **are opposing forces.** *(Flesh no longer defines you; faith does!)*

Col. 2:11 You were in Christ when he died; which means that his death represents your true circumcision. Sin's authority in the human body was deleted you in him dying your death.

Col. 2:12 In the same parallel *[your co-circumcision in his death]*, **your co-burial and joint-resurrection is now demonstrated in baptism; your co-inclusion in Christ is what God's faith knew when he powerfully raised him from the dead.** *(Hosea 6:2.)*

Col. 2:13 You were once spiritually dead, as confirmed in your constant failure, being bound to a lifestyle ruled by the [1]distorted desires of the flesh; but now God made you alive together with him and thus [2]graciously restored our innocence and dignity, having forgiven us all our [3]short fallings. *([1]The uncircumcision of the flesh, i.e., in the Greek, a life controlled by the sexual organs. God [2]graced us in Christ. The word translated, forgiven, [2]**charisamenos** from **charizomai** means he graciously restored our innocence and dignity! The word, [3]**paraptoma**, comes from, **para**, close proximity, sphere of influence and **pipto**, to stop flying, from **petomai**, to fly; thus, to fall from flight or to lose altitude.)*

Col. 2:14 His body nailed to the cross hung there as the [3]document of mankind's guilt; in dying our death he [1]cancelled the detailed [2]hand-written [3]record which testified against us. Every [1]stain on our conscience, reminding of the sense of

failure and guilt, was thus fully blotted out. *(The word, [1]**exaleipho**, comes from **ek**, out of, and **aleipho**, with **a,** as a particle of union, and **liparos**, to grease, to leave a stain; guilt, as well as all hurtful memories were like grease stains upon the conscience. In N.T. only here and Rev 3:5; 7:17; 21:4 and in Acts 3:19 "Be awakened in your minds and fully converted to face the fact of your redeemed innocence - your sins have been thoroughly blotted out!" Plato used it of blotting out a writing. The word, [2]**cheirographon**, translates as hand-written. The word, [3]**dogma**, comes from **dokeo**, a thought pattern; thus thought patterns engraved by human experience of constant failure to do what the law required. In his personal handwriting mankind endorsed their own death sentence. The hands of fallen mankind struck the body of Jesus with the blows of their religious hatred and fury when they nailed his bloodied body to the tree; they did not realize that in the mystery of God's economy, Jesus became the scapegoat of the entire human race! [Isaiah 53:4, 5] See notes on Heb 8:12.*

"The slate wiped clean, that old arrest warrant cancelled and nailed to Christ's Cross." —The Message.)

Col. 2:15 In him dying mankind's death, he [1]defused every possible claim of accusation against the human race and thus made a public [2]spectacle of every [3]rule and authority in God's brilliant triumph, demonstrated in him. The [4]voice of the cross will never be silenced! *(The horror of the Cross is now the eternal trophy of God's triumph over sin! The cross stripped religion of its authority to manipulate mankind with guilt. Every accusation lost its leverage to blackmail the human race with condemnation and shame! The word, [1]**apekduomai**, is translated from **apo**, away from, and **ekduo**, to be stripped of clothing; to disarm; the religious facade that disguised the law of works as a means of defining a person's life, was openly defeated. Same word used in Col 3:9. The dominance of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil [**poneros**, hard work and labor] was ended. The word, [2]**deikmatizo**, means to exhibit in public. See [3]commentary below of the words **arche**, rule and **exousia**, authority. The word, [4]**parresia**, comes from **pas**, all and **rheo**, outspokenness, pouring forth speech.*

"He stripped all the spiritual tyrants in the universe of their sham authority at the Cross and marched them naked through the streets." — The Message

See commentary for 1 Corinthians 15:24, The complete conclusion in his work of redemption is celebrated in his yielding the full harvest of his reign to God the Father, having brought to nought the law of works which supported every definition of

*dominion under the fall, including all **principalities**, all authority and every dynamic influence in society. [He brought to nought the law of works, **katargeo**, from **kata**, meaning intensity, and **argos**, meaning labor; thus free from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ. All principalities, [3]**arche**, or chief ranks, i.e., kings, governors; this includes any governing system whereby one is ranked above the other on the basis of their performance or preference. All authority, [3]**exousia**, comes from **ek**, denoting origin and **eimi**, I am; in this case, because of what I can do I am defined by what I can do better than you; therefore, I have authority over you. Every dynamic influence in society, **dunamis**, means power, in this case, willpower. Every government structure in society will be brought under the dominion of grace where the Christ-life rules.]*

In 1 Corinthians 2:7-8, We voice words of wisdom that was hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in mankind. Neither the politicians nor the theologians of the day had a clue about this mystery [of mankind's association in Christ]; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory!)

God used Christ's body to condemn sin. *(Contemporary English Version)*

Rom. 8:3. He has signed the death warrant of sin. *(Knox)*

1 Cor. 1:22 The Jews crave signs *[to confirm their doubts]* **while the Greeks revel in philosophical debate!** *(Both groups are addicted to the same soul realm.)*

1 Cor. 1:23 The crucified Christ is the message we publicly proclaim, to the disgust of the Jews while the Greeks think we are wacky.

1 Cor. 1:24 The dynamic of God's wisdom is the fact that both Jew and Greek are equally included and defined in Christ.

1 Cor. 1:25 It seems so foolish that God should die mankind's death on the cross; it seems so weak of God to suffer such insult; yet their wisest schemes and most powerful display of genius cannot even begin to comprehend or compete with God in his weakest moment on the cross.

1 Cor. 2:2 My [1]mind is fully made up about you! The only possible way in which I can truly [2]know you, is in the light of God's mystery, which is [3]Christ in you! Jesus died mankind's death on the cross and thus brought final closure to any other basis of [1]judgment! *(The word, [1]**krino**, to judge, to determine, to deem in a forensic sense, here, in the Aorist Tense, **ekrina**, which suggests a once and for all completed*

*act. The Aorist tense presents an occurrence in summary, viewed as a whole from the outside, almost like a snapshot of the action. Paul makes a very bold and radical statement, confining his ministry focus to "know" the full scope and consequence of the revelation of mankind's redeemed innocence as communicated in the cross of Jesus Christ! This is the essence of the mystery of God! "For I determined to [2]know [- [2]**eido**, to see, to perceive] nothing in you except Jesus Christ and him crucified." Nothing else! Not the latest gossip or popular news events! He says in 2 Cor 5:14,16, The love of Christ leads to this conclusion, one has died for all - therefore all died! From now on therefore, I no longer know ANYONE from a human point of view!*

Paul continues to unfold the mystery of our redeemed oneness! In the previous chapter, he concludes that we are ***in Christ*** *by God's doing; here he clearly points to* [3]***Christ in us****! [As Jesus declared in John 14:20]*

See 2 Cor 3:4 Christ is proof of our persuasion about you before God. Also 2 Cor 1:18 God's certainty is our persuasion; there is no maybe in him! 2 Cor 1:19 The Son of God, Jesus Christ, whom I, Paul, Sylvanus and Timothy boldly announced in you is God's ultimate yes to mankind. Human life is associated in all that he is. In God's mind, there exists not even a hint of hesitation about this! Also Gal 1:16 and Col 1:27.)

Heb. 8:10 Now, instead of documenting my laws on stone, I will chisel them into your mind and engrave them in your inner consciousness; it will no longer be a one-sided affair. I will be your God and you will be my people, not by compulsion but by mutual desire.

Heb. 8:11 Knowing me will no longer be a Sunday-school lesson, or something taught by persuasive words of doctrine, neither will they know me on account of family tradition or door to door evangelism *[each one telling his neighbor].* **Everyone, from the most unlikely to the most prominent people in society, will know me inwardly.**

Heb. 8:12 This knowledge of me will never again be based on sin-consciousness. My act of mercy, extended in Christ as the new Covenant, has removed every possible definition of sin from memory! *(God's memory of our sins was not what needed to be addressed in the redemption of our innocence. God did not have a problem with sin-consciousness, we had! He wasn't hiding from Adam and Eve in the garden; they were hiding from him! What needed to be addressed were our perceptions of a judgmental God, which were the inevitable fruit of the I-am-not tree system and mentality.*

Revenge, judgment, guilt, condemnation, inferiority, shame, regret, suspicion etc. could not be treated lightly; they are the enemies of romance! If rules could do it, then the law would be our opportunity to save ourselves, simply by making the correct decisions! If willpower could save us then Moses would be our savior! But, alas! "The good that I want to do I cannot!" See Rom 7.

The scapegoat system would be introduced to somehow address and attempt to manage the consequences of sin. The typical "eye for and eye, tooth for a tooth" scenario would be substituted with the idea of a scapegoat. And so, every system of sacrifice carried some significance, but only as far as it pointed to its weaknesses in dealing with the root of the problem, and the need for a better solution! We needed more than forgiveness of our sins; we needed a savior who could rescue us from our sinfulness! This was not merely a means whereby we could get rid of the cobwebs; the spider needed to be killed! The "pay now, sin later-system" had a very real sell-by date!

See Heb 10:2 & 3 Had it been possible to present the perfect offering that had the power to successfully remove any trace of a sin-consciousness, then the sacrificial system would surely have ceased to be relevant. But in the very repetition of these ritual sacrifices the awareness of guilt is reinforced rather than removed.

God does not demand sacrifice; he provides the sacrifice! The ultimate sacrifice for sins would never be something we did, or brought to God, to appeal to him; but the shocking scandal of the cross, is the fact that mankind is confronted with the extravagant, embarrassing proportions of the love of their Maker; he would go to the most ridiculous extreme to finally convince us of his heart towards us! In order to persuade us of our worth to him, he speaks the most severe scapegoat language: "Behold the Lamb of God, who takes away the sins of the world!" This completely disarms religion! Suddenly there is nothing that we can do to persuade God about our sincere intentions; this is God persuading us of his eternal love dream!

God did not clothe Adam with the skin of an animal because of a divine need to be appeased, but because of their unconditional love for Adam; they spoke the language of Adam's own judgment: Adam, not God, was embarrassed about his nakedness. The clothing was not to make God look at Adam differently, but to make Adam feel better about himself! And ultimately it was to prepare Adam for the unveiling of the mystery of mankind's redemption in the incarnation. Here Deity would clothe themselves in human skin in a Son, and the Lion of Judah would become the Lamb of God in order to free our minds to re discover his image and likeness in our skin! Mankind is tailor-made for God!

See also **1 Peter 1:19 but you were redeemed with the priceless blood of Christ; he is the ultimate sacrifice; spotless and without blemish. He completes the prophetic picture!** *(In him God speaks the most radical scapegoat language of the law of judgment, and brings final closure to a dead and redundant system! In Psalm 40:6,7, it is clearly stated that God does not require sacrifices or offerings! Jesus is the Lamb of God! He collides victoriously with the futile sacrificial system whereby offerings are constantly made to the pseudo, moody, monster gods of our imagination! This is the scandal of the cross! God does not demand a sacrifice that would change the way he thinks about mankind; he provides the sacrifice of himself in Christ in order to forever eradicate sin-consciousness from our minds and radically change the way we think about our Maker, one another and ourselves! [Sin-consciousness is a works-based consciousness which is the currency of religion.]*

*Also John 5:28 Do not be alarmed by this, but the hour is coming when those in the [1]graves will hear his voice! (No-one who ever lived will escape the extent of his righteous judgment! Those who have [1]forgotten who they are will hear his incarnate voice! The word for grave, [1]**mnēmeion**, memory, suggests a remembrance! Like David prophesies in Psalm 22 when he sees the cross-crisis [**krisis** - judgment] a thousand years before it happens! His conclusion in verse 27 sums up the triumph of God's resolve! "All the ends of the earth shall [1]remember and turn to the LORD; and all the families of the nations shall worship before him!" See 1 Corinthians 15:21,22 The same mankind who died in a man was raised again in a man. In Adam all died; in Christ all are made alive.))*

Heb. 9:9 The tabernacle pattern of that time was an analogy of the hitherto imperfect system in which the gifts and sacrifices presented failed completely to cleanse the conscience of the worshipper.

Heb. 9:10 All these external rituals pertaining to food and drink and the various ceremonial baptisms and rules for bodily conduct were imposed upon them until the anticipated time of restoration; the foretold moment when [1]all that was crooked would be made straight and restored to its natural and original condition. *(This word, [1]**diothosis**, is only used in this one place in the New Testament; what was crooked will be made thoroughly straight, restoring to its natural and normal condition something which in some way protrudes or has gotten out of line, as broken or misshapen limbs.)*

Heb. 9:11 But now Christ has made his public appearance as High Priest of a

perfect tabernacle. The good things that were predicted have arrived. This new tabernacle is not a compromised replica of its shadow type, man-made one. This is the real deal! *(The restoration of God's original dwelling place in human life is again revealed!)*

Heb. 9:12 As High Priest, his permission to enter the Holy Place was not secured by the blood of beasts. By his own blood he obtained access on behalf of the human race. Only one act was needed for him to enter the most sacred place of grace and there to institute a ransom of perpetual consequence. *(The perfection of the redemption he secured needs no further sacrifice. There are no outstanding debts; there is nothing we need do to add weight to what he has accomplished once and for all. The only possible priesthood activity we can now engage in is to continually bring a sacrifice of the fruit of our lips, giving thanks to his Name; no blood, just fruit, even our acts of self-sacrifice, giving of time and money, etc. are all just the fruit of our constant gratitude!)*

Heb. 9:13 The blood of beasts and the ashes of the burnt sacrifice of a heifer could only achieve a very temporal and surface cleansing by being sprinkled on the guilty. *(The word for heifer, is **damalis**, from **damatzo**, to tame; this was the most dear and expensive sacrifice. She was a strong, pristine, spotless female calf, she was raised as a family pet; "A Little Princess!" This was the best that the law-system could present; yet, no inner purging of conscience was possible; only the sense of temporal relief; whilst knowing that the entire process would have to be repeated again and again! In this arrangement, God addressed the dilemma of our sin consciousness; the deep-seated stain that it had left needed to be thoroughly exposed, and then brought to closure. The shadow system with its imperfections, as a possible means of obtaining a lasting and meaningful sense of innocence, had to be exhausted; ultimately proving that no sacrifice that anyone can bring at any expense of their own, could possibly match the sacrifice of God giving himself as scapegoat to the human race in order to persuade us that his love for us would go to the scandalous extreme, where we are finally confronted with the fact that it is not in a sacrifice that we bring where God's mind is favorably influenced towards us; but in the shocking sacrifice of himself, where he forever, in the most radical language, impact our ideas and thoughts about the Father, Son and Spirit's estimate of us. There is nothing dearer in the universe to them, but our redeemed innocence and our individual value realized! See Colossians 2:14,15 in the Mirror Bible.)*

Heb. 9:14 How much more effective was the blood of Christ, when he presented

his own flawless life through the eternal Spirit before God, in order to purge your conscience from its frustration under the [1]cul-de-sac rituals of the law. There is no comparison between a guilt and duty-driven, dead religious system, and the vibrancy of living your life free from a sin-consciousness! This is what the new testament priesthood is all about! *(Dead works, [1]**nekros ergon**. A dead, religious-routine system can never compete with the resurrected Christ now realized in you.)*

1 Pet. 4:1-2 Death brings a final end to sin, since Christ suffered for us in the flesh. *(He died your death; you were on his mind throughout)* **Consider the implication of your co-inclusion in him; thus reinforce your mind to stand fully armed against any onslaught. You may confidently live the rest of your time in the flesh inspired by the determined purpose of God with no further obligation to perverted human lusts.**

Col. 3:1 See yourselves co-raised with Christ! Now ponder with persuasion the consequence of your co-inclusion in him. Relocate yourselves mentally! Engage your thoughts with throne room realities where you are co-seated with Christ in the executive authority of God's right hand.

Col. 3:2 Becoming affectionately acquainted with throne room thoughts will keep you from being distracted again by the earthly *[soul-ruled]* **realm.** *("Set your minds upon the things that are above and not upon the things below!" RSV. Whatever you face in your daily lives, acquaint yourselves with the greater reality! The things that are above! Do not engage the energy of the things that are below! Also note Romans 1:18, where the word **katecho** is used - to echo downwards is the opposite to **anoche**, to echo upward- Romans 2:4 and Romans 3:26. Also 2 Corinthians 4:18 "We are not keeping any score of what seems so obvious to the senses on the surface; it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us which has our full attention and captivates our gaze!" A renewed mind conquers the space previously occupied by worthless pursuits and habits. See my notes on Earthbound vs. Heavenly Dimension Realities at the end of Revelation Chapter 16.)*

Col. 3:3 Your union with his death broke the association with that world; see yourselves located in a fortress where your life is hidden with Christ in God! *("In that day you will know that I am in my father, and you in me and I in you." [Jn 14:20] Occupy your mind with this new order of life; you died when Jesus died; whatever defined you before defines you no more. Christ, in whom the fullness of deity dwells, defines you now! The word, "hidden" can also be translated, secret; the secret of your*

life is your union with Christ in God! [See Col 2:9, 10] "Risen, then, with Christ you must lift your thoughts above where Christ now sits at the right hand of God, you must be heavenly minded; not earthly minded, you have undergone death, and your life is hidden away now with Christ in God. Christ is your life, when he is made manifest you are made manifest in his glory." [Knox.])

Col. 3:4 The unveiling of Christ, as defining our lives, [1]immediately implies that, what is evident in him, is equally mirrored in you! The exact life on exhibit in Christ is now repeated in us. We are included in the same bliss and joined-oneness with him; just as his life reveals you, your life reveals him. *(This verse was often translated to again delay the revelation of Christ to a future event! The word, [1]**otan**, often translated as "when" is better translated as "every time." Thus, "Every time Christ is revealed we are being co-revealed in his glory." According to Walter Bauer Lexicon, **otan** is often used of an action that is repeated. Paul declares our joint-glorification in Christ! We are co-revealed in the same bliss. [See 1 Cor 2:7-8, Rom 3:23-24, Rom 8:30, 2 Pet 1:3.] In him we live and move and have our being; in us he lives and moves and has his being! Acts 17:28.)*

Col. 3:5 Consider the members of your body as dead and buried towards everything related to the porn industry, sensual uncleanness, longing for forbidden things, lust and greed, which are just another form of idol worship. *(Idol worship is worshipping a distorted image of yourself!)*

Col. 3:6 These distorted expressions are in total contradiction to God's design and [1]desire for your life. *(The word [1]**orge**, associated with wrath or punishment is from **oregomai**, to stretch oneself out, to reach out, to long for, to desire. The sentence, "upon the sons of unbelief" [Greek word, ἀπείθεια Lit. without faith]; or as the KJV translates it, "sons of disobedience", was added later in some manuscripts.)*

Col. 3:7 We were all once swept along into a lifestyle of lust and greed.

Col. 3:8 But now, because you realize that you co-died and were co-raised together with Christ, you can flush your thoughts with truth! Permanently put these things behind you: things such as violent outbursts of rage, depression, all manner of wickedness, [1]slander and every form of irregular conversation. *(The lifelong association with sin is broken; the dominion of the character of God is revealed again in ordinary life. The word [1]**blasphemos** means any attempt to belittle someone else and to cause someone to receive a bad reputation.)*

Col. 3:9 That old life was a lie, foreign to our design! Those garments of disguise

are now thoroughly stripped off us in our understanding of our union with Christ in his death and resurrection. We are no longer obliged to live under the identity and rule of the robes we wore before, neither are we cheating anyone through false pretensions. *(The garments an actor would wear define his part in the play but cannot define him.)*

Col. 3:10 We stand fully identified in the new creation renewed in knowledge according to the pattern of the exact image of our Creator.

Col. 3:11 The revelation of Christ in us gives identity to the individual beyond anything anyone could ever be as a Greek or a Jew, American or African, foreigner or famous, male or female, king or pawn. From now on everyone is defined by Christ; everyone is represented in Christ. *(In seeing him not just recorded in history but revealed in us, we discover the face of our birth as in a mirror! Jas 1:18.)*

Heb. 10:1 For the law presented to us a faint shadow, outlining the promise of the blessings anticipated in the coming of Christ, even detailing its future significance. The mere sketch however, could never be confused with the actual object that it represented. The annual sacrificial rites as shadow of the eventual object would always leave the worshipper feeling inadequate and be a reminder year after year of the sinfulness of mankind. *(Barnes Notes on Heb 10:1, "For the law having a shadow: That is, the whole of the Mosaic economy was a shadow; for so the word "Law" is often used. The word "shadow" here refers to a rough outline of anything, a mere sketch, such as a carpenter draws with a piece of chalk, or such as an artist delineates when he is about to make a picture.*

He sketches an outline of the object which he desires to draw, which has "some" resemblance to it, but is not the "very image;" for it is not yet complete. The words rendered "the very image" refer to a painting or statue that is finished, where every part is an exact representation of the original. The "good things to come" here refer to the future blessings which would be conferred on mankind by the Gospel. The idea is, that under the ancient sacrifices there was an imperfect representation; a dim outline of the blessings which the Gospel would impart to people. They were a typical representation; they were not such that it could be pretended that they would answer the purpose of the things themselves which they were to represent, and would make those who offered them perfect.

Such a rude outline; such a mere sketch, or imperfect delineation, could no more answer the purpose of saving the soul than the rough sketch which an architect makes would

answer the purpose of a house, or than the first outline which a painter draws would answer the purpose of a perfect and finished portrait. All that could be done by either would be to convey some distant and obscure idea of what the house or the picture might be, and this was all that was done by the Law of Moses."

The Gospel is no longer a future prediction; it is a now and relevant revelation. We are talking good news, and not just good predictions! News already happened! Every definition of distance or delay is cancelled in Christ.)

Heb. 10:2 Had it been possible to present the perfect offering that had the power to successfully remove any trace of a sin-consciousness, then the sacrificial system would surely have ceased to be relevant.

Heb. 10:3 But in the very repetition of these ritual sacrifices the awareness of guilt is reinforced rather than removed.

Heb. 10:4 The conclusion is clear: animal sacrifices failed to remove anyone's sinfulness or their sin-consciousness.

Heb. 10:5 So when Jesus, the Messiah, arrives as the fulfillment of all the types and shadows, he quotes Psalm 40:6-8, and says, "In sacrifices and offerings God takes no pleasure; but you have ordained my incarnation!" *(Adam Clark writes the following commentary: A body hast thou prepared me - The quotation of this and the two following verses by the apostle, is taken from the Septuagint, with scarcely any variety of reading: they are widely different in verbal expression in the Hebrew. In the Hebrew text David's words are,* ***oznayim caritha li,*** *אזנים כרית לי which we translate, "My ears hast thou opened"; but the writer of this Epistle quotes,* ***soma*** *[body]* ***de katertiso moi****; which I translated as, "You have ordained my incarnation!" How is it possible that the Septuagint and the Apostle should take a meaning so completely different from the sense of the Hebrew? Dr. Kennicott has a very ingenious conjecture here: he supposes that the Septuagint and Apostle express the meaning of the words as they stood in the copy from which the Greek translation [LXX - Septuagint] was made; and that the present Hebrew text is corrupted in the word* ***aznayim****, ears, which has been written through carelessness for* ***az gevah****, then, a body... The first syllable אז,* ***az****, Then, is the same in both; and the latter, נים* ***nyim****, which, joined to* ***az*** *makes* ***oznayim****, might have been easily mistaken for* ***geviah****, גויה body; the letter נ* ***nun*** *being very like the letter ג* ***gimel****; and י* ***yod*** *like ו* ***vau****; and ה* ***he*** *like final ם* ***mem****; especially if the line on which the letters were written in the MS. happened to be blacker than ordinary, which*

has often been a cause of mistake, it might then have been easily taken for the under-stroke of the ***mem***, ם *and thus give rise to a corrupt reading; add to this, the root of* כרית ***carah*** כרה *signifies as well to prepare, as to open, dig, etc. On this supposition the ancient copy translated by the Septuagint, and followed by the apostle, must have read the Hebrew text thus:* ***az geviah charitha li****; and therefore wrote the Greek text thus,* ***soma de katertitsoo moi - Σωμα δε κατηρτισω μοι****. Then a body thou hast prepared me: thus the older Hebrew text, the version of the Septuagint, and the Apostle, will agree in what is known to be an indisputable fact in the Christian faith; namely, that Jesus Christ is the incarnate prophetic word; he is the Lamb of God who took away the sin of the world!*

It is remarkable, that all the offerings and sacrifices which were considered to be of an atoning or cleansing nature, offered under the law, are here enumerated, to show that none of them, nor all of them, could take away sin; and that the grand sacrifice of Christ was that alone which could do it. Adam Clarke)

Heb. 10:6 None of the prescribed offerings and sacrifices, including burnt offerings and sin offerings were your request.

Heb. 10:7 "Then I said, I read in your book what you wrote about me; so here I am, I have come to fulfill my destiny." *(Ps 40:7, Lk 4:17, Lk 24:27, 44.)*

Heb. 10:8 Having said what he did in the above quote, that the prescribed offerings and sacrifices were neither his desire nor delight, he condemned the entire sacrificial system upheld by the law.*(These only served to sustain a sin-consciousness and was of no redemptive benefit to anyone.)*

Heb. 10:9 Also by saying, "I am commissioned to fulfil your will," he announces the final closure of the first in order to introduce the second. *(Grace replaces the law; innocence supersedes sin-consciousness.)*

Heb. 10:10 So, by this fulfilled will, in the mind of God and by his resolution he declares mankind immediately sanctified through one sacrifice; the presentation of the body of Jesus Christ.

Heb. 10:11 Every priest continually repeats the same daily rituals and sacrifices, knowing that they have always proved incapable of removing sins.

Heb. 10:12 But now we have an exception. In complete contrast to the previous priesthood, this priest offered a single sacrifice of perpetual efficacy for sins.

To celebrate the perfection of what was attained through his single sacrifice, he

sat down as the executive authority of God. *(God's right hand [Heb 1:3]. He occupies the highest seat of dominion to endorse mankind's innocence! "Having accomplished purification of sins, he sat down.")*

Heb. 10:13 His seat of authority is established upon [1]the fully realized, prophetic expectation that all his enemies [2]would be subdued. He would most certainly stand in triumph with his feet on their necks. *(See Heb. 1:13 "You are the extension of my right hand, my executive authority; take your position and witness how I make your enemies a place upon which you may rest your feet." [Mt 22:42-45.] The neck supporting and turning the head suggests that the mindset of every hostile influence is thus conquered. This act was done symbolically, as a token, not only of the present complete victory, but of continued and sustained triumph over all adversaries. The word, εκδεχομενος [1]**ekdechomenos**, [to accept from the source] is the Present Participle Passive.*

*Participles are verbal adjectives. [Nearly a third of Greek verbal forms are Participles.] For the Present Participle this implies that the action of the Participle is going on at the same time as the action of the main verb in the sentence, which is the verb in the previous verse where the sentence begins, ἑκάθισεν **ekathisen**, the Aorist Indicative Active, he sat down having offered a single sacrifice of perpetual efficacy for sins...*

*Then the word, τεθωσιν [2]**tethoosin**, to be subdued; the Aorist Subjunctive Passive - a definite outcome that will happen as a result of another stated action. See 1 Cor 15:25 His dominion is destined to subdue all hostility and contradiction under his feet. ("The Lord said to my Lord, Sit at my right hand until I make your enemies your footstool." [Ps 110:1] Jesus is Lord of Lords; in his victory mankind is restored to lordship; "I say you are gods, all of you are sons of the Most High" [Ps 82:6 RSV]. See Rev 3:11.)*

Heb. 10:14 By that one perfect sacrifice he has [1]perfectly [2]sanctified sinful mankind forever. *(The word, [2]**hagiazomenous**, means sanctify, the present Participle describes an action thought of as simultaneous with the action of the main verb, "perfectly;" [1]**teteleioken**, in the Perfect Tense denotes an action which is completed in the past, but the effects of which are regarded as continuing into the present. [See Heb. 2:11] For he who sanctifies and those who are sanctified have all one origin.)*

Heb. 10:15 This is exactly what the Holy Spirit now endorses in us having already foretold it in Scripture. *(Jer 31:33, 34.)*

Heb. 10:16 This is my covenant that I will make with you during those days, says

the Lord; I will greatly advantage you by [1]giving my laws in your hearts and engrave them in your inmost thoughts. *(The word, [1]**didomi**, means to give someone something to their advantage.)*

Heb. 10:17 This is final: I have no record of your sins and misdeeds. I cannot recall them. *(Nothing in God's reference of mankind, reminds him of sin. See Heb. 8:12.)*

Heb. 10:18 Sins were dealt with in such a thorough manner that the idea of future offerings would never again be considered. Nothing that we can personally sacrifice could add any virtue to our innocence.

Heb. 10:19 So, fellow family, what the blood of Jesus communicates, seals our immediate access into this ultimate place of sacred encounter, with unashamed confidence.

Heb. 10:20 This is the official inauguration of a brand new way of life. The torn flesh of Jesus opened the veil for us. Our own flesh can no longer be a valid excuse to interrupt the expression of the life of our design from within our innermost shrine.

Heb. 10:21 We have a High Priest in the house!

Heb. 10:22 We are free to approach God with absolute confidence, fully persuaded in our hearts that nothing can any longer separate us. We are invited to draw near now! We are thoroughly cleansed, inside and out, with no trace of sin's stains on our conscience or conduct. The sprinkled blood purges our inner thought-patterns; our bodies also are bathed in clean water. *(1 Cor 6:19 Do you not realize that your body is the sacred shrine of the Spirit of God, echoing within you. You do not own your life! 1 Cor 6:20 You are bought and paid for. All of you are his. Live your life conscious of how irreplaceably priceless you are. You host God in your skin.)*

Heb. 10:23 Our conversation echoes his persuasion; his faithfulness backs his promises. *(His integrity inspires our confession. "Let us hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering, for he who promised is faithful.)*

Heb. 10:24 Let us also think of creative ways by which we can influence one another to find inspired expression in doing things that benefit others. Good actions give voice and volume to the love of God. *(Let us consider how to stir up one another to love and good works." RSV.)*

Heb. 10:25 In the light of our free access to the Father, let us extend that embrace to one another. Our gatherings are no longer a repetition of tradition but an

essential fellowship where we remind one another of our true identity. Let us do so with greater urgency now the day has dawned in our understanding. *(The prophetic shadow has been replaced by the light of day.)*

1 Pet. 3:18 For Christ also died for sins once for all, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in flesh but made alive in spirit.

Rom. 6:6 We perceive that our old lifestyle was co-crucified together with him; this concludes that the vehicle that accommodated sin in us, was scrapped and rendered entirely useless. Our slavery to sin has come to an end.

Rom. 6:7 If nothing else stops you from doing something wrong, death certainly does.

Rom. 6:8 Faith sees us joined in his death and alive with him in his resurrection.

Rom. 6:9 It is plain for all to see that death lost its dominion over Christ in his resurrection; he need not ever die again to prove a further point.

Rom. 6:10 His appointment with death was [1]once-off. As far as sin is concerned, he is dead. The reason for his death was to take away the sin of the world; his life now exhibits our union with the life of God. *(The Lamb of God took away the sin of the world; [1]**efapax**, once and for all, a final testimony, used of what is so done to be of perpetual validity and never needs repetition. This is the final testimony of the fact that sin's power over us is destroyed. See Hebrews 9:26, "But Jesus did not have to suffer again and again since the fall (or since the foundation) of the world; the single sacrifice of himself in the fulfillment of history now reveals how he has brought sin to nought." Thus, in this context [of everyone's appointment with death], Jesus is the ultimate sacrifice. What the first, shadow-dispensation merely prophetically pointed to, he fulfilled once and for all, when he was presented as an offering, to take upon himself the sins of the entire human race! Now, with sin no longer on the agenda, he appears a second time, out of this death, to be clearly seen in everyone's whole-hearted embrace of him as Savior! [Heb 9:28]."*)

Rom. 6:11 This reasoning is equally relevant to you. [1]Calculate the cross; there can only be one logical conclusion: he died your death; that means you died to sin, and are now alive to God. Sin-consciousness can never again feature in your future! You are in Christ Jesus; his Lordship is the authority of this union. *(We are not being presumptuous to reason that we are in Christ! "[1]Reckon yourselves therefore dead to sin" The word, [1]**logitsomai**, means to make a calculation to which there can only be one*

logical conclusion. [See Eph 1:4 and 1 Cor 1:30].

"From now on, think of it this way: Sin speaks a dead language that means nothing to you; God speaks your mother tongue, and you hang on every word. You are dead to sin and alive to God. That's what Jesus did."— The Message.)

Rom. 6:12 You are under no obligation to sin; it has no further rights to dominate your dead declared body. Therefore let it not entice you to obey its lusts. *(Your union with his death broke the association with sin [Col 3:3].)*

Rom. 6:13 Do not let the members of your body lie around loose and unguarded in the vicinity of unrighteousness, where sin can seize it and use it as a destructive weapon against you; rather place yourself in [1]readiness to God, like someone resurrected from the dead and present your whole person as a weapon of righteousness. *(Thus you are reinforcing God's grace claim on mankind in Christ; [1]**paristemi**, to place in readiness, in the vicinity of.)*

Rom. 6:14 Sin was your master while the law was your measure; now grace rules. *(The law revealed your slavery to sin, now grace reveals your freedom from it.)*

Rom. 6:15 Being under grace and not under the law most certainly does not mean that you now have a license to sin.

Rom. 6:16 As much as you once gave permission to sin to trap you in its spiral of spiritual death and enslave you to its dictates, the obedience that faith ignites now, introduces a new rule, rightness with God; to this we willingly yield ourselves. *(Righteousness represents everything that God restored us to—in Christ.)*

Rom. 6:17 The content of teaching that your heart embraced has set a new [1]standard to become the [1]pattern of your life; the grace of God ended sin's dominance. *(The word, [1]**tupos**, means form, mold. The Doddrich translation translates it as, "the model of doctrine instructs you as in a mold.")*

Rom. 6:18 Sin once called the shots; now righteousness rules.

Rom. 5:18 The conclusion is clear: if one offence condemns the entire human race; then in principle, the righteousness of one vindicates the entire human race. *(Phillips translation: "We see then, that as one act of sin exposed the whole race of humanity to condemnation, so one act of perfect righteousness presents all humanity freely acquitted in the sight of God!")*

John 12:27 My soul is exceedingly perplexed right now! What shall I say, "Father! Rescue me [1]out of the clutches of this hour!" No! This hour is the very culmination

of my destiny! *[Greek Preposition, [1]**ek**, out of; source; origin.]*

John 12:28 "Father! Glorify your name!" And immediately there came a voice out of the heavenly realm saying, "I have glorified it, and I will glorify it again!"

John 12:29 The crowd heard the voice and said that it had thundered; others thought it was the voice of celestial messenger.

John 12:30 Jesus replied, "This voice was not for my sake but for yours! *(Signs are for unbelievers. 1 Corinthians 14:22.)*

John 12:31 Now is the judgment of this world; this is the moment where the ruler of the world-system is [1]conclusively cast out! *(The serpent's head is about to be crushed! Genesis 3:15; Colossians 2:14,15. This is what the Holy Spirit will convince the world of! John 16:11. John uses a double-barrel word here,* ***ekballo ekso*** *- completely thrown out! Thus, taken out of the equation! Luke 10:18.)*

John 12:32 When I am lifted up from the earth, I will draw all judgment unto me! *(He would be lifted up on a cross, descend into the depths of our hell, then, according to the prophetic word in Hosea 6:2, after two days, the entire human race he represents, will be co-quickened and on the third day, be co-raised, out of the lowest parts of the earth and elevated to the highest heavens! Ephesians 4:8,9; see also Ephesians 2:5,6 and Colossians 3:1-3. 'All' includes all of mankind and their judgment. The subject of the sentence, as from the previous verse, is the judgment of the world - thus the primary thought here is that in his death, Jesus would draw all judgment upon himself! John 3:14; John 8:28; Act 2:33. 1 John 3:5 We have witnessed with our own eyes how, in the unveiling of the prophetic word, when he was lifted up upon the cross as the Lamb of God, he lifted up our sin and broke its dominion and rule over us! John 1:29 "Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away* ***[airo]*** *the sin of the world! The word* ***airo*** *means to lift up.")*

John 12:33 This he said to point to the way in which he would die. *(See John 19:15 - Lift him up! Lift him up! Crucify him!")*

Rev. 12:9 So the great Dragon, the [1]ancient [2]ophis *[serpent],* **also known as the Devil or Satan - whose sole mission was to lead the entire inhabited world astray - was cast down to the earth-dimension, together with all his [3]herding-heralds.** *(The word [1]**archaios**, ancient, of old; from **arche**, from the beginning. As Jesus said that the Devil was a murderer "from the beginning" The Greek word, [2]**ophis** is translated serpent and comes from **optomai**, to gaze, in this case, to present a visual idea through illusion.*

*John 8:44. He was stripped of his pseudo rank of authority see Col 2:14,15 he was made a public spectacle! Luke 10:18 And Jesus said to them, I saw Satan falling out of heaven like lightning! Also John 12:31 Now is the judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world shall be cast down. [When I am lifted up on the cross. Jn 12:32] The word often translated angel, [3]**aggelos** has two components, **ago** to lead as a shepherd leads and **agele,** a herd of cattle or company.)*

Rev. 12:10 Then I heard a very loud voice in the heavens announcing, "This is the moment which the entire prophetic word pointed to and culminates in; it is the realization of mankind's salvation. The power of the kingdom of our God and its authority is endorsed in the I-am-ness of his Christ. The business of accusation is bankrupted. The 24/7 industry of condemning the brotherhood of mankind before the face of God has been annihilated." *(The word [1]**kategoros**, a name given to the Devil by the Rabbis, the one whose business is accusation, from **kata**, downward and **agora**, to trade; a word used for all kinds of business in the public arena. See John 12:27-30)*

Rev. 12:11 Mikael and his celestial shepherd-messengers conquered the Dragon because of the blood of the little Lamb and the word of their testimony! They did not believe that the agape of life discovered in Christ can be threatened or [1]terminated in death! *(The blood of the Lamb brought closure to every possible accusation against the human race. This is the testimony of the prophetic word announcing the Good News throughout the ages. The word [1]**achri** - the end; the idea of terminating. Mikael and his messengers represent the entire host of heaven - including all the multitudes previously mentioned. See **Extended Notes on the Word of God and the Testimony of Jesus Christ** at the end of chapter 20.)*

Ps. 103:1 A Psalm of David. Bless the LORD, O my soul; and all that is within me, bless his holy name!

Psa 103:2 Bless the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits,

Psa 103:3 who forgives all your iniquity, who heals all your diseases,

Psa 103:4 who redeems your life from the Pit, who crowns you with steadfast love and mercy,

Psa 103:5 who satisfies you with good as long as you live so that your youth is renewed like the eagle's.

Psa 103:6 The LORD works vindication and justice for all who are oppressed.

Psa 103:7 He made known his ways to Moses, his acts to the people of Israel.

Psa 103:8 The LORD is merciful and gracious, slow to anger and abounding in steadfast love.

Psa 103:9 He will not always chide, nor will he keep his anger for ever.

Psa 103:10 He does not deal with us according to our sins, nor requite us according to our iniquities.

Psa 103:11 For as the heavens are high above the earth, so great is his steadfast love toward those who fear him;

Psa 103:12 as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us. RSV

Zec. 3:1 Then he showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, and Satan standing at his right hand to accuse him.

Zec. 3:2 And the LORD said to Satan, "The LORD rebuke you, O Satan! The LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke you! Is not this a brand plucked from the fire?"

Zec. 3:3 Now Joshua was standing before the angel, clothed with filthy garments.

Zec. 3:4 And the angel said to those who were standing before him, "Remove the filthy garments from him." And to him he said, "Behold, I have taken your iniquity away from you, and I will clothe you with rich apparel."

Zec. 3:5 And I said, "Let them put a clean turban on his head." So they put a clean turban on his head and clothed him with garments; and the angel of the LORD was standing by.

Zec. 3:6 And the angel of the LORD enjoined Joshua,

Zec. 3:7 "Thus says the LORD of hosts: If you will walk in my ways and keep my charge, then you shall rule my house and have charge of my courts, and I will give you the right of access among those who are standing here.

Zec. 3:8 Hear now, O Joshua the high priest, you and your friends who sit before you, for they are men of good omen: behold, I will bring my servant the Branch.

Zec. 3:9 For behold, upon the stone which I have set before Joshua, upon a single stone with seven facets, I will engrave its inscription, says the LORD of hosts, and I will remove the guilt of this land in a single day. RSV.

1 Cor. 5:8 Our daily life is now the extension of the Passover celebration; feasting on sustained innocence! The old sin conscious-system, the leaven-mind set *(always anticipating and tolerating sin)***, is replaced with an understanding of our**

unleavened innocence, just like when a diamond is [1]scrutinized in the rays of the sun to confirm its flawless integrity. *(The word, [1]**elikrineia**, translates as scrutinized in the rays of the sun.)*

Having just healed a blind man at the entrance to Jericho,

Luke 19:1 Jesus then entered the city with the intention to just pass through.

Luke 19:2 There he a man who was known as Zacchaeus; he was the commissioner of taxes and wealthy. *(The city was close to the fords of the Jordan, on the frontier of Peraea, and on the richest plain of Palestine, abounding most in the choicest productions, especially balsam; and was, therefore, an appropriate seat for an officer of superior rank to preside over the collection of revenues. Zacchaeus זכּי transparent/ innocent, pure; a chief tax collector.)*

Luke 19:3 He was [1]very keen to see for himself who this Jesus was. This was almost impossible, since he was short of stature and Jesus was swamped with people. *(He obviously learned that Jesus was in town and was doing his best to see him; εζητει [1]**etzetey**, the Imperfect Active Indicative - searching continually.)*

Luke 19:4 So, he ran ahead and climbed into a sycamore tree to make sure he sees Jesus when he passes by.

Luke 19:5 As soon as Jesus was under the tree, he looked up and said, Zacheus, come down quickly and take me to your house, I would really like to spend time with you. *(peusas katabēthi. Simultaneous Aorist Active Participle, speusas, with the Aorist Active Imperative. "Come down in a hurry. "I must abide with you!")*

Luke 19:6 He was down in a flash and welcomed Jesus into his home with great joy.

Luke 19:7 The crowds were rumbling with disgust, like a hornet's nest disturbed; how dare he lodge with such a notorious sinner!

Luke 19:8 Zacheus stood his ground in an effort to defend himself and said, Lord, I give half of my income to the poor and even if anyone accuses me falsely for over-charging them, I restore to them four times more than what they accuse me of! *(Clearly Zach's keenness to encounter Jesus was due to the fact that he was plagued with accusation, as can be clearly seen in the people's reaction when he hosted Jesus! He's own efforts to justify himself failed him; the people still continued to accuse him vehemently!)*

Luke 19:9 Jesus responded, Today, salvation has come to your home! Mr. Innocent, you too are a son of Abraham! *(Jesus shifts the conversation from the crowd's*

accusations and Zachaes' futile efforts to justify himself according to the law of works, and engages him with the meaning of both of their names! Jesus - means salvation and Zachaes means, pure, blameless, innocent! Abraham's seed is the blessing of righteousness by faith - "Abraham saw my day!" See John 8:39, They immediately responded with, "But Abraham is our father!" To which Jesus replied, "If you were conceived by Abraham's faith, you would mirror his persuasion! Jesus commends Zaheus' faith by connecting him with the faith lineage of Abraham. See Gal 3:7 The conclusion is clear; faith and not flesh relates us to Abraham! [Grace rather than law is our true lineage. Ishmael represents so much more than the Muslim religion. Ishmael represents the clumsy effort of the flesh to compete with faith; the preaching of a mixed message of law and grace.])

1 John 2:28 So now, just like an [1]infant in a mother's embrace, [2]abide in this place of innocence where his [3]manifest appearance is meant to be fully realized and echoed in unashamed utterance! In his [4]immediate presence there exist no sense of shame or any form of [5]separation! *([1]**Teknion**, diminitive of **teknon**, an infant. The word, [2]**meno** suggests an uninterrupted abiding, a seamless oneness! The word, [3]**phanerothe** is an Aorist Passive in the Subjunctive mode, expressing the hypothetical, expected result of the completed action; from **phaneroo**, to appear; to fully realize, to manifest.*

*The word [4]**parousia** speaks of the immediate presence of the Lord! From **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **eimi,** I am! There is not even a hint of judgment or punishment in this word! Sadly this word has often been translated to yet again point to a future event suggesting the coming of Christ! While there are great and accurate definitions in Strongs, please do not believe everything you read there! "G3952 parousia from the Present Participle of G3918 **[pareimi]**; a being near, that is, advent; often, return; specifically of Christ to punish Jerusalem, or finally the wicked."!? [This is blatant nonsense!] The Greek word **parousia**, occurs 24 times in the NT, and 22 times it wrongly implies a 2nd coming or coming judgment! Only twice it is translated as presence! 2 Cor 10:10, Phil 2:12. Of all the English translations that I have checked, only the Young's Literal has it correct! What a shame that this word has been so dramatically twisted over the years!)*

Oneness Realized - Chapter 7

Separation is an illusion!

In his essay on The Mediation Of Jesus Christ, Dr. C Baxter Kruger writes,

"The assumption of separation between Jesus and us is, in my opinion, one of the fundamental failures of Western Christianity. The blind spot of separation begets and perpetuates a multitude of 'us-them' divisions, including and especially religious divisions, that are destroying our lives and the planet.

Moreover, this assumption necessarily makes our faith a work we do that relates us to an absent Jesus, rather than a mind-boggling, liberating, hope-begetting discovery of the reality of his union with us and with all creation.

The apostolic Jesus is the Father's eternal Son, and the One anointed in the Spirit, and he is the One in and through and by whom all things were created and are constantly sustained. These three fundamental truths about Jesus Christ have rarely been held together with the incarnation. And failure here has fueled the oppressive racial, relational, sexual, ecological, environmental, religious, and political and social hell we find ourselves in today.

We stand before the beautiful mystery of the very being of God. Three divine persons completely dwelling in one another in indivisible oneness without loss of distinct personhood— perichoresis [the divine dance]. Every act of God is therefore a trinitarian act, arising out of and involving the relationship, the indivisible oneness, of the Father, Son, and Spirit."

In the Incarnation, every possible excuse we could have, to feel separated and distanced from God, was erased! Jesus is the highway in the wilderness that Isaiah saw: every high place was brought down, every valley filled up, every crooked place made straight; even the rough places were made smooth! "And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together: for the mouth of the LORD has spoken it." Isa. 40:3-5. See Luke 3:4,5 Mirror Bible.

In his death on the cross he prepares a place for us so that we may forever be where he is, embraced in the bosom of the Father. And all mankind will see salvation from God's point of view!

2 Cor. 3:18 The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is unveiled. In gazing with wonder at the blueprint likeness of God displayed in human form

we suddenly realize that we are looking at ourselves! Every feature of his image is mirrored in us! This is the most radical transformation engineered by the Spirit of the Lord; we are led from an inferior mind-set to the revealed endorsement of our authentic identity. Mankind is his glory!

Isa. 55:10-11 "For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven, and return not thither but saturate the earth, making it bring forth and sprout, giving seed to the sower and bread to the eater, so shall my word be that goes forth from my mouth; it shall not return to me empty, but it shall accomplish that which I purpose, and prosper in the thing for which I sent it."

Jesus Christ is the Word made flesh! In him God lavished every blessing heaven has upon us! Eph. 1:3. God owes us nothing! Imagine how this revelation would change someone's prayer life!

In the incarnation God cancelled every definition of distance. He cannot saturate the soil of human life more than what he already has. All the mineral wealth is already deposited in the earth! The word was made flesh in every human life! We have this treasure in earthen vessels! 2 Cor. 4:7.

God is not closer to some than what he is to others! He is equally Immanuel to every individual on planet earth! Paul speaks to a pagan, idol worshipping audience in Acts 17 and makes this remarkable statement: The God who created the universe is not far from each one of us! Paul understands that in Christ God already reconciled the world to himself! The world cannot be more reconciled to their Maker than what they already are! In Christ there can never again be an "us" and "them".

Jesus is what God believes about you; Jesus is God's mind made up about every human life!

John 14:16 In my prayerful engagement with the Father, he will give you [1]another [2]close companion to be with you - in such an intimate way that [3]my immediate presence will continue to be [4]inseparably one with you in [5]timeless ages to come! *(The word **allos** is used here. The words [1]**allos** and **heteros** are both usually translated as "another" in English. Yet **allos** means "another of the same kind" and **heteros** means "another of a different type". The word, [2]**parakaleo,** alongside, closest possible proximity of nearness; and **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname. Also, kinsman; intimate companion. See Rom 12:8. "...just be there alongside someone to remind them of their true identity." 1 Thessalonians 5:11 Continue, as you so eloquently do, to edify one another by cultivating the environment of your close association in*

*your joint-genesis. [The word **parakaleo** is here translated as our joint-genesis] The words, **ina he meth** [meta] **umoon eis ton aiona he** - ινα η μεθ υμων εις τον αιωνα - the verb [3]**he** from **eimi**, I am, is in the Present Active Subjunctive form, to continue to be; [4]**meta**, with, inseparably one with you in [5]**aiona**, the timeless ages!)*

14:17 Your eternal companion is the Spirit of truth, whom those trapped in the sense-ruled world, just cannot [1]get to grips with! Their visual horizon is veiled, and they are unable to understand what they cannot see. But, *[in your acquaintance with me],* **you are familiar with this [2]seamless, intimate union, and the Spirit's continued presence within you.** *(The word, [1]**lambanoo**, to grasp; to get to grips with. The following 3 verbs are all in the Present Active Indicative tense, which is the timeless present tense, and indicates continued action, something that happens continuously or repeatedly, or something that is in the process of happening: to know, **ginosko**; to abide **meno**; and to be **eimi**. Thus, [2]**ginooskete**, a knowing that is extended beyond the moment. The "absence" of Jesus will not interrupt this knowing. [See verse 20!] Then, ὅτι παρ᾽ ὑμῖν μένει **hoti** because, **para**, closest possible nearness and intimate acquaintance, and [2]**meno** - to abide in seamless oneness; and is present in you! καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἐστίν **kai en humin estin**- the Spirit already resides in you. In the Incarnate Word, spirit dimension is not a foreign place, neither is the Spirit a foreign person to you!)*

John 14:18 At no time will you be orphaned or abandoned by me; I come to abide [1]face to face with you. *(I come to be no less face to face with you, than what I've always been face to face with the Father, from the beginning and for all eternity. The Holy Spirit does not replace, but reinforces the presence of Jesus and the closeness of the Father. Again, John uses the word [1]**pros**, face to face. See John 1:1)*

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and the Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

James 1:26 Meaningless conversation is often disguised in religious eloquence. Just because it sounds sincere, doesn't make it true. If your tongue is not bridled

by what your heart knows to be true about you, you cheat yourself.

Paul sees that oneness in Christ inspires the fine-tuning of our every conversation:

1 Cor. 1:9 We are [1]surnamed by God; this is our true lineage; he is faithful and fully persuaded about our joint participation in the fellowship of sonship; we are included in everything that our Lord Jesus Christ and the Father enjoys. God's faithfulness is the basis of this union. *(The word [1]**kaleo**, means to call or identify by name, to surname.)*

1 Cor. 1:10 Friends, because we are surnamed and identified in the name of our master Jesus Christ, I [1]urge you to speak with one voice; we share the same source as our reference; the idea of division is an illusion. We are a perfect match; accurately joined in the same thought and communicating the same resolve. *(The word, [1]**parakaleo**, is from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, and **kaleo**, to surname.)*

1 Cor. 1:11 Some of the believers in Chleo's fellowship told me about the controversy in your ranks; this is most disturbing!

1 Cor. 1:12 What I was told is that you are divided into groups, where some side with Paul, others with Apollos, still others with Cephas, and even some who say, "we are the Messianic group"!

1 Cor. 1:13 This is really ridiculous: can Christ be cut up into little relics? Was Paul crucified for you? Were you baptized into Paul's name?

2 Cor. 4:13 We [1]echo the exact same spirit of faith David had when he wrote: "I [2]believe and so I speak!" We too believe and so we speak! Our persuasion is our conversation. *(The word, [1]**echo**, means to hold or to embrace. Paul quotes David here in Psalm 116; sometimes one's soul wants to gallop away into distraction like a wild horse; then, David reminds himself, "Return to your rest, oh my soul, for the Lord has dealt bountifully with you! I believe, and so I speak!" God's bountiful dealings with us in Christ is our only valid rest; Sabbath celebrates perfection! "Behold, it is very good!" Gen 1:31,2:2 And remember God does not employ circumstances to teach us something! The finished work of Christ teaches us; his work on the cross rescued us! Ps 116:7,10 I [2]believe; I am sure, אמן **aw-man**, with the root meaning, to build up, or support; to foster as a parent or nurse; figuratively to render [or be] firm or faithful, to trust or believe, to be permanent or quiet; to be true or certain; to go to the right hand: - hence assurance, [relocate yourself mentally where you are co-seated together with Christ in God's right hand!] Also, the word, amen, so be it.*

Hebrew word to speak, דבר ***dabar****, to arrange words in such a way that their effect is to subdue. [Like a lawyer's letter; using legal language.]*

Then David uses the word, ענה ***anah****, which was translated, 'afflicted', but the same word is also used to respond; by extension to begin to speak; specifically to sing, shout, testify, announce: - give account, which is a much more appropriate rendering of this word in context! The Hebrew actually says: I will sing loudly! Remember Paul sang in prison!*

Let faith speak. Let faith break out in song!)

Phil. 1:6 The acknowledging of every good thing that is in us in Christ, ignites the energy of faith in our fellowship with one another!

Gal. 5:10 In spite of the interference of those "law-church" people, I remain convinced about our like-mindedness in the Lord. It does not matter what high profile position anyone may occupy, do not let their title disturb you! The very law they promote, is their judgment! *(The fermentation process is unavoidable when you host a legalistic mind-set.)*

The entire gospel reveals our co-inclusion in Christ. No wonder Paul says that for us to compete with one another or even to measure or compare ourselves with one another is to be without understanding.

2 Cor. 10:12 Not that we venture to class or compare ourselves with some of those who commend themselves. But when they measure themselves by one another, and compare themselves with one another, they are without understanding. RSV

And in the Mirror, **2 Cor. 10:12 We are not contesting with those who desire to commend themselves! While they compete and compare with one another they completely miss the point; they fail to [1]comprehend our joint I-am-ness!** *(The word, [1]**suniemi**, means a joining together like that of two streams; a fusion of thought.)*

This concludes that no personal differences, preferences, or prejudices can be tolerated above the wonderful truth of God's work of grace and reconciliation. We are entrusted with world peace! Our ministry is the ministry of reconciliation. God already reconciled a hostile world to him and now urgently pleads through us and appeals to every person's conscience, in order to make us all see and realize its consequence.

Paul reminds Titus, "To avoid gossip, to speak evil of no one, to quit quarreling, to be gentle, and to show perfect courtesy toward all people. Remember how foolish and hard of hearing we ourselves were; not knowing the truth about ourselves we were led

astray, slaves to various passions and pleasures, passing our days in malice and envy. We existed only for our own selfish interests, hated by others and hating one another. But when God overwhelmed us with goodness and his fondness for mankind dawned on us in the gospel, he rescued us, not because of some righteous deeds done by us, but by his own mercy demonstrated in Christ." Tit. 3:2-5. RSV

Titus 3:2 Gossip is out! Never have anything bad to say about anyone! Don't try and be the [1]macho man, having to win every argument; instead, avoid quarrelling, be appropriate, always show perfect courtesy to one and all. *(The word, [1]**amachos** from **a** as a negative particle and **mache**, a brawler, to be controversial, striving. You don't have to wait for people to change before you are nice to them. There is a big difference between "fake politeness" and perfect courtesy!)*

Titus 3:3 Do not be harsh on others. Remember that we, too, were typically foolish; we were stubborn and indifferent to spiritual things, our addiction to the sensual and sexual kept us running around in circles, we were engaged in malice and spiteful jealousies, we were bored and lonely, often utterly disliking ourselves and hating one another! *(The only difference in who we are now and who we were then is in what we now know to be true about ourselves.)*

Titus 3:4 But then, oh happy day! It was the generosity of God and his fondness for mankind that dawned on us like a shaft of light. Our days of darkness were over! Light shone everywhere and we became aware: God rescued the human race! *(See Titus 2:11.)*

Titus 3:5 Salvation is not a reward for good behavior. It has absolutely nothing to do with anything that we have done. God's mercy saved us. The Holy Spirit endorses in us what happened to us when Jesus Christ died and was raised! When we heard the glad announcement of salvation it was like taking a deep warm bath! Our minds were [1]thoroughly cleansed and re-booted into [2]newness of life! *(The word [1]**paliggenesia** suggests a complete restoration to the original, in modern terms, rebooted. The word [2]**anakainosis**, from **ana**, upward, and **kainosis**, newness, speaks of a fresh upward focus; a re-engaging with heavenly thoughts. See Col 3:1-3; also 1 Thess 1:5. We realized that we were indeed co-included, co-crucified, and co-raised and are now co-seated together with Christ in heavenly places! [See 2 Cor 5:14-21; Hosea 6:2; Eph 2:5, 6; and 1 Pet 1:3.])*

Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.

Rom. 12:17 Two wrongs do not make a right. Never retaliate; instead, cultivate the attitude to [1]anticipate only beauty and value in every person you encounter. *([1]**pronoew**, to know in advance.)*

Rom. 12:18 You have within you what it takes to be everyone's friend, regardless of how they treat you. *(See Romans 1:16, 17. Also Matthew 5:44, 45.)*

Rom. 12:19 Do not bother yourselves to get even, dear ones. Do not let anger or irritation distract you; [1]that which we have in common with one another *(righteousness)* **must set the pace. Scripture confirms that the Lord himself is the [1]revealer of righteousness.** *([1]**ekdikeo**, from **ek**, a Preposition denoting origin, and **dikeo**, two parties finding likeness in one another. That which originates in righteousness sets the pace in every relationship.)*

Rom. 12:20 "If your enemy is hungry, feed him; if he is thirsty, give him something to drink." These acts of kindness will be like heaping coals of fire on his head and certainly rid him of the dross in his mind and win him as a friend. *(A refiner would melt metal in a crucible and intensify the process by heaping coals of fire on it [Prov 25:21,22]. This is good strategy; be sensitive to the needs of your enemies. God sees gold in every person. Hostility cannot hide our true value. He won us while we were hostile towards him [see also Rom 5:8, 10]. His kindness led us to the radical awakening of our minds! [Rom 2:4].)*

Rom. 5:8 Herein is the extremity of God's love gift: mankind was rotten to the core when Christ died their death.

Rom. 5:9 If God could love us that much when we were ungodly and guilty, how much more are we free to realize his love now that we are declared innocent by his blood? *(God does not love us more now that we are reconciled to him; we are now free to realize how much he loved us all along! [Col 2:14, Rom 4:25].)*

Rom. 5:10 Our hostility and indifference towards God did not reduce his love for us; he saw equal value in us when he exchanged the life of his Son for ours. Now that the act of [1]reconciliation is complete, his life in us saves us from the gutter-most to the uttermost. *(Reconciliation, from [1]**katalasso**, meaning a mutual exchange of equal value. Thayer Definition: to exchange, as coins for others of equivalent value. "For if while we were enemies we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son, much more, now that we are reconciled, shall we be saved by his life." RSV.)*

Rom. 2:4 Do not [1]underestimate God's [2]kindness. The wealth of his [2]benevolence and his [3]resolute refusal to let go of us is because he continues to hear the echo

of his likeness in us! Thus his [4]patient passion is to [5]Shepherd everyone into a [6]radical mind shift. *(The word translated, underestimate is the word, [1]**kataphroneō,** from **kata**, down, and **phroneo**, to think, to form an opinion; thus a downcast mind, to despise or take for granted. It is the revelation of the goodness of God that leads us to [6]repentance; it is not our "repentance" that leads God to goodness! The word "repentance" is a fabricated word from the Latin word, **paenitentia**, which became penance, and to give religion more mileage the English word became re-penance! That is not what the Greek word means at all! The word, [6]**metanoia**, comes from **meta**, together with and **noieō**, to perceive with the mind. It describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing. Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery. [See Isa 55:8-10] The word, [2]**chrestos**, kind, benevolent, from **xeir**, hand which is also connected to the word **xristos**, to draw the hand over, to anoint, to measure; see also the Hebrew for Messiah, משיח to anoint; to measure, from **mashach**, משח to draw the hand over, to measure! [Analytical Hebrew and Chaldee Lexicon, B Davidson.] In Jesus Christ, God has measured mankind innocent, he is the blueprint of our design! The word [3]**anoches** comes from **ana**, meaning upward; **ana** also shows intensity and the word **echo**, to hold, or embrace, as in echo. He continues to hear the echo of his likeness in us! [See Rom 3:26.] The word, [4]**makrothumias**, means to be patient in bearing the offenses and injuries of others. Literally, passion that goes a long way; from the stem **thuo**, to slay a sacrifice. The word, [5]**ago**, means to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep.)*

2 Cor. 5:14 The love of Christ constrains us and resonates within us; leaving us with only one conclusion: when Jesus died; every individual simultaneously died. In God's logic, one has died for all, thus all died.

1 Cor. 2:7 We voice words of wisdom that were hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's [1]Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in man. Our glorification has always been God's agenda, even [2]before time was. *(Paul employs the words, [1]**prohoritso**, predesigned and [2]**pro aion** before the ages, in order to emphasize the certainty of God's persuasion concerning their determined intent to rescue and restore their image and likeness in us. Our redemption existed upon the inner-horizons of God before the ages. The word, **prohoritso**, from **pro**, before and **horitso**, horizon; means pre-defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan. See Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that we pre-existed in God; he defines us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory that we lost in*

Adam.)

1 Cor. 2:8 Neither the politicians nor the religious leaders of the day had a clue about this mystery; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory! *(Time witnessed and recorded the death and resurrection of an individual; eternity witnessed the death and resurrection of the human race!)*

Acts 10:15 The voice spoke to him again, "Do not consider anything unclean that God has declared clean." Good News Bible

1 John 1:7 We are invited to explore the dimensions of the same light that engulfs God; when we see the light in his light, fellowship ignites! In this light, we understand how the blood of Jesus Christ is the removal of every distortion and stain of sin! *(Sin **[hamartia]** is a distorted identity. From the words, **ha**, without and **meros**, form. To walk in the light as he is in the light means to see your life and everything that concerns you, exclusively from your Father's point of view. Ps. 36:9 For with you is the fountain of life; in your light do we see light. 1 Pet 1:18,19.)*

2 Cor. 1:18 God's certainty is our persuasion; there is no maybe in him!

2 Cor. 1:19 The Son of God, Jesus Christ, whom I, Paul, Sylvanus and Timothy boldly announced in you, is God's ultimate yes to "you-manity". Jesus is God's Yes to you! Human life is associated in all that he is. In God's mind there exists not even a hint of hesitation about this! *(Note, Paul and his team proclaimed Christ* **in** *them, not, "to"them! See Gal 1:16; and Col. 1:27. Also 2 Cor 3:4.)*

2 Cor. 1:20 In him the detail of every single promise of God is fulfilled; Jesus is God's yes to your entire well being! In our union with him the Amen that echoes in us gives evidence to his glorious intent through us.

Job 22:21 "Agree with God, and be at peace." RSV

Eph. 4:2 Meekness and tenderness are the fabric of your make-up; this enables you to show compassion even in seemingly impossible situations, eagerly bearing with one another in an environment where love rules.

Eph. 4:3 Being alert to treasure our oneness in spirit; encapsulated in peace. *(The word **sundesmos** from **sun**, a primary Preposition denoting union and **deo** to bind in agreement like in a marriage. The word [1]**eirene**, means peace, from **eiro**, to join, to be set at one again; in carpentry it is referred to as the dove-tail joint, which is the strongest of joints. Peace is a place of unhindered enjoyment of friendship.)*

Eph. 4:4 There is only one body and one Spirit. We are inseparably one, in the same

hope; there is no plan B. We bear the same [1]surname. *(Called, [1]**kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname.)*

Eph. 4:5 There is only one legitimate Lordship; one faith and one [1]baptism; we are all immersed in the same oneness! *(There is only one faith! Not what we believe about God but what God believes about us! Our faith does not invent God; God's faith defines us! Jesus is what God believes! See my commentary on John 1:33; John's baptism announces the incarnation; yet it communicates a mere prophetic picture of what Jesus' spirit baptism will fully interpret of mankind's co-inclusion and joint immersion into his death, resurrection and ascension. In the incarnation we have the prophetic word on exhibit, intercepting human history by assuming human form; thus we see divinity immersed into our humanity and declaring that there would be no stopping him from entering into our hell and deepest darkness. In dying our death, God would bring closure to every destructive mindset and futile fruit we inherited from Adam's fall. Just as he was raised out of the water in his baptism, we would be co-elevated together with him in his resurrection into newness of life! Hosea 6:2; Ephesians 2:5,6. The word [1]**baptizo** from **bapto**, to immerse, to overwhelm.)*

Eph. 4:6 There is only one God. He remains the ultimate Father of the universe. We are because he is. He is present in all; he is above all, through all, and in all. *("He is not far from each one of us; in him we live and move and have our being. We are indeed his offspring." Acts. 17:24-28. The father of lies is not the father of the human race!)*

Eph. 4:7 The gift of Christ measures the extravagant dimensions of grace; where everyone is equally advantaged. *(Grace was given to each one of us according to the measure of the gift of Christ. RSV. One measure, one worth! Our worth is defined by his gift not by a reward for our behavior.)*

Eph. 4:8 [1]Scripture confirms that he [3]arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! *["he took captivity captive"]* **And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he [2]repossessed what belonged to us by design, [4]in human form; this is his grace-gift to us!** *(In this verse Paul explains what he just declared in verse 7 - he wants us to know the extravagant extent and dimensions of the measure of the gift of Christ! Remember that he is writing from prison [Eph 4:1] He's not asking for prayers to get him out of jail! He is imprisoned in Christ - [4:1] my complete existence is defined and confined in him! He was once a prisoner of the law of performance, held hostage in his own body, crying in desperation, "Is there anyone who can deliver them from this*

*death trap?" [Rom 7] He now speaks as a prisoner of Christ! He is reminded of and obviously intrigued by the entire context of Psalm 67 which celebrates God rescuing the prisoners from their captivity and even the wayward and stubborn, who already died and are stuck in their graves! [mindsets] See Ps 67:6,7 He is the father of the orphans, and protector of the widows. God settles the lonely in a home; leading forth prisoners mightily, also the stubborn, even them that dwell in tombs! Paul sees by revelation the relevance of Jesus dying our death and entering into our darkness and hell on a rescue mission! Now he [1]quotes Ps 67:19 [from the LXX Septuagint - the Greek OT which is Ps 68 in the Masoretic Hebrew text], and sees captive mankind arrested in the death, descent into hell and the triumphant resurrection of the incarnate Word, in the man Jesus Christ. Ps 67:19 ἀνέβης εἰς ὕψος, ᾐχμαλώτευσας αἰχμαλωσίαν, ἔλαβες δόματα ἐν ἀνθρώπῳ - **anebes eis hupsos, [3]echmaloteusas aichmaloosian, [2]elabes domata en** [in] [4]**anthropo** "You ascended on high, having taken captivity captive [[3]**arresting at spearpoint**! See 2 Cor 10:5] and [2]**repossessed mankind's gifts** in human form. The word [2]**elabes** from **lambano** means to take what is one's own. The word for the [4]human species, male or female is [4]**anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner. [The Masoretic Hebrew text, Ps 68:18,19,* לקחת מתנות באדם ***lakachat mattanoth ba adam*** *- "You have taken gifts in Adam." **The gifts which Jesus Christ distributes to us he has received in us, in and by virtue of his incarnation!** Adam Clarke.] Ps 67:19 LXX continues: καὶ γὰρ ἀπειθοῦντες τοῦ κατασκηνῶσαι - **kai gar apeithountes tou kataskenoosai,** "in order that even the unbelievers, **apeithountes** - the ones resisting persuasion, the backsliding, the headstrong, the wayward, the rebellious may rest; or may now inhabit - **kataskenosai** - to encamp within - again this word emphasizes the significance of the incarnation - **kata**, down and **skenosai**, from **skenos** - skin! The eternal thoughts of God, the conversation that was before time was, is clothed in skin! John 1:1-3,14. See Rev 13:10, Being taken captive by the spear and killed by the sword [John 18:3] made death a doorway into the very domain in which mankind was held prisoner, [to be led out triumphantly in the resurrection as the Lamb's trophies!] After two days he will revive us! On the third day he will raise us up! Hosea 6:2 We were born anew in his resurrection. 1 Pet 1:3. Also Ephesians 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our deviations, we were co-quickened together with Christ!)*

Eph. 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. *(See John 3:13, "No one has ascended into heaven but he*

*who [1]descended from heaven, even the son of man." All mankind originate from above; we are [1]**anouthen**, from above [see Jas 1:17, 18].)*

Eph. 4:10 He now occupies the ultimate rank of authority, from the lowest regions of our darkness into which he reached in order to rescue us, to the highest authority in the heavens, having executed his mission to the full. *(Fallen mankind is restored to the authority of the authentic life of their design. [Psa 139:7,8 Whither shall I go from your Spirit? Or whither shall I flee from your presence? If I ascend to heaven, You! If I make my bed in Sheol, You!] Eph 1:20,21.)*

Eph. 4:11 What God has in us, is gift wrapped to the world: some are commissioned to pioneer, others are gifted prophetically, some as announcers of good news, some as Shepherds with a real gift to care and nurture, and others have a gift to ignite instruction through revelation knowledge. *(Couriers, communicators, counsellors and coaches. — Rob Lacey.)*

Eph. 4:12 Each expression of his gift is to fully equip and enable you for the work of the ministry so that you may mutually contribute in your specific function to give definition to the visible body of Christ.

Eph. 4:13 The purpose of these ministry gifts is to present everyone on par and in oneness of faith; believing exactly what the Son of God believes and knowing accurately what he knows concerning us. Standing face-to-face in equal stature to the measure of the [1]completeness of Christ. *(The word, [1]**pleroma**, means a life filled to the brim with Christ, like a freight ship carrying its cargo.)*

James 3:9 We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a fellow human made in his mirror likeness. *(The point is not what the person did to deserve the insult. The point is that people are image and likeness bearers of God by design! True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate.)*

1 Jn 5:9 If we receive the testimony of people, the testimony of God is greater; for this is the testimony of God, that he has borne witness to his Son. RSV.

1 John 5:9 Now if it is reasonable for us to be readily persuaded by the evidence that people may lay out before us, how much more certainty is there in the evidence that God has so compellingly borne witness to concerning his Son! *(To go back to the very beginning is to find the Word already present there; face to face*

with God; this Word, translated into the prophetic promise in Scripture and pointing to the Messiah Redeemer for centuries, the Logos, finally became flesh and forever divided human history into a BC and AD. The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar testimony that is mathematically precise, revealing that God knew before time was the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross and be raised again from the dead! No one has ever known God as Father; Jesus, the humble brother of the human race, [as my dear friend Baxter Kruger would say,] he has revealed him in the most articulate language as our Father. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father!" John 14:9. "In that day, you will know that as I am in my Father, so you are in me, and I am in you!" John 14:20. The Holy Spirit now endorses in us what happened to us when Jesus died and was raised, and now echoes from within our spirits, "Abba Father!")

1 John 5:20 This is what has become distinctly clear to us: the [1]coming of the Son of God is God's mission accomplished! He is the incarnate Christ. The moment all of Scripture pointed to has arrived! The Son is [1]present! In him God has given us the greatest gift, [2]a mind whereby we may know him who is true; and in the same knowing, to find ourselves there in him who is true! Mankind is fully included and located in him, in his Son Jesus Christ; this means that whatever Jesus is as Son, we are. This is the true God; this is the life of the ages! *(The word [1]***heko** *means to have come, to have arrived, to be present. John uses the word [2]***dianoian***; deep thought; with* **dia** *relating to the means by which we may know; a mind to know; compare metanoia, to know together with; an entwining of thought; the mind of Christ.*

Jesus said, you will know the truth as it is unveiled in me, and that will set you free!

The culmination of the gospel according to John is summed up in these verses: John 14:20 "In that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you are in me and I am in you!" Also 1 John 2:7 & 8, "what is true of him, is equally true of us. 1 John 4:17 "As he is, so are we in this world! Our lives are mirrored in him" as well as here in 1 John 5:20.)

1 John 5:21 This defeats every image of our imagination that could possibly compete with the authentic likeness of our design! Darling children, distance yourselves from every substitute image, which is what idolatry is all about! *(The word [1]***eidolon,** *often translated idol, refers to image or likeness. Isa 40:18-21 To whom then will you liken God, or what likeness compare with him? The idol? A workman casts it, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold, and casts for it silver chains. He who is impoverished chooses for an offering wood that will not rot; he seeks out a skilful*

craftsman to set up an image that will not move. Have you not known? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you ***from the beginning?*** *Have you not understood from the foundations of the earth? Remember your beginning! You are God's idea - the Engineer of the Universe imagined you! Gen 1:26; Col 1:15; Col 2:9,10.*

Act 17:28-31 For 'In him we live and move and have our being'; as even some of your poets have said, 'For we are indeed his offspring.' Being then God's offspring, we ought not to think that the Deity is like gold, or silver, or stone, a representation by the art and imagination of human origin. The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he compels all of mankind everywhere to awaken to their redeemed identity and innocence!

Idolatry is a projection of an image of one's own making. Idolatry is the crux of religion - it is expensive business since your idol is like a slot machine at the casino! It remains hungry and it is wired to bite and bankrupt you!)

1 John 2:6 It is in this place of consciously [1]abiding in the awareness of your oneness that your conversation unveils the same fellowship with the Father that Jesus enjoys, and results in a daily walk that mirrors his; one of living your life in the full [2]benefit of it! *(The word, [1]**meno** suggests an uninterrupted abiding, a seamless oneness! The word [2]**opheilō**, often translated, ought to, is from the stem **ophelos**, which means to advantage, to profit, to gain, to heap up, to accumulate, to benefit!)*

1 John 2:7 My beloved family, I know that the words I write to you here may not immediately remind you of the [1]precepts of Moses; this does not mean that it is a new [1]doctrine, it is the ancient [1]conversation that [2]echoes God's voice prophetically! It is indeed the very [1]conclusion of the word, which you have heard from the beginning! *(The word [1]**entole** is often translated commandment or precept; this word has two components:* **en**, *in and* **telos**, *from* **tello**, *to set out for a definite point or goal; properly the point aimed at as a limit, that is, by implication, the conclusion of an act or state, the result; the ultimate or prophetic purpose. Strong's 5056. The word, [2]**echo**, to hold, like sound is held in an echo; to resonate.)*

1 John 2:8 And yet it is a glorious [1]new [2]message that I am writing to you! You may ask, "How can that which is old, also be new?" Herein is the secret of its newness: whatever is true of Jesus is equally true of you! The days of the [3]dominance of darkness as a reference to human life, are over! The true light surely shines with [4]bold certainty and illuminates your life, as it is unveiled in Christ. *(The word [1]**kainos** means, fresh, recent, unused, unworn, of a new kind,*

*unprecedented, novel, uncommon. The freshness of this encounter is celebrated in a fellowship of exactly the same oneness enjoyed between the Father and the Son! Again the word [2]**entole** is used, precept or teaching. The word [3]**parago** from para, close proximity and **agoo**, to lead; thus darkness will no longer lead you into its sway. The word [4]**ede**, even now: - already, by this time; from **ē** [pronounced ay] an adverb of confirmation; assuredly: - surely; and **dē** [pronounced day] which is a particle of emphasis or explicitness; now, then, etc.: - also, and, doubtless, now, therefore.)*

1 John 2:9 To feel justified in your judgment to [1]dislike a fellow human, is to continue in darkness, even if you might claim to be in the light! This place of illumination is not cheap talk! It immediately translates into seeing your brother differently! *(See 1 John 1:6, also 2 Corinthians 5:16. [1]It was common among the Hebrews to use the terms "love" and "hatred" in this comparative sense, where the former implied strong positive attachment, and the latter, not positive hatred, but merely a less love, or the withholding of the expressions of affection [compare Genesis 29:30-31; Luke 14:26].)*

1 John 2:10 From this conscious union with that which light reveals, there follows a deep love for the very brother who might previously have irritated you!

Rom. 13:9 Love makes it impossible for you to commit adultery, or to kill someone, or to steal from someone, speak evil of anyone, or to covet anything that belongs to someone else. Your only option is to esteem a fellow human with equal value to yourself.

Rom.13:10 Everything love does is to the advantage of another; therefore, love is the most complete expression of what the law requires.

I see God in every human being; in his many disturbing disguises! When I wash the leper's wounds, I feel I am nursing the Lord himself. Is it not a beautiful experience?
Mother Teresa

If we still see some people as great and some as insignificant we are seeing wrong.

This gospel mobilizes us to be the mirror voice of every person's true redeemed identity and the integrity of their individual value and innocence.

"He vanished from their sight" because Jesus could no longer be any more present in his person on earth than what he is present in the Word incarnate in us!

Mankind's co-Ascension in Christ is the crux of the gospel!

Life is a mind flooded with wholesome thoughts;

pondering and celebrating the redeemed life of our design

and communing with the Father, Son and Spirit,

and one another in sweet fellowship!

Multitudes don't have a clue!

Be their clue!

Living happily ever after! Chapter 8

There is no 'sell by date' to this union!

This is not a flash in the pan, hit and run thing! This gospel measures a friendship to be enjoyed with an unhindered, unlimited, uninterrupted future!

When we step out of this earth suit one day, we do not step into redefined time, we're stepping into eternity himself; the Author of the ages, who already dwells within us!

Heb. 13:8 Take your lead from Jesus. He is your reference to the most complete life. In him yesterday is confirmed today and today mirrors tomorrow. What God spoke to us in Christ is as relevant now as it was in the prophetic past and will always be in the eternal future! *(Jesus is the same yesterday, today, and forever; there is a history to our salvation that carries more authority and relevance than anything that ever happened in our past, or anything present in time or still to happen in the future. Imagine the enormity of eternity in his sameness before time was; and we were there in him all along! See Rom 8:34 What further ground can there possibly be to condemn mankind? In his death he faced our judgment; in his resurrection he declares our innocence; the implications cannot be undone! He now occupies the highest seat of authority as the executive of our redemption in the throne room of God. See Rom 8: 1, also Rom 4:25. The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar testimony that is mathematically precise, revealing that God knew before time was the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross and be raised again from the dead!)*

Sixty years after he last saw Jesus in the flesh, John, now in his nineties, reflects on the mystery that was revealed which transformed his life from an illiterate fisherman to a saint. He speaks of an uninterrupted fellowship that he desires for everyone to fully participate in.

John spent most of the latter part of his life (about 30 years) living in Asia Minor and more specifically at Ephesus; much of Paul's emphasis in teaching therefore reflects in John's writing. This he did either from Ephesus or from the Isle of Patmos where he spent a few years in exile. (Compare Col.1:15-17, John 1:1-3, 16-17, 1 John 5:20, "He has given us understanding to know him who is true and we are in him who is true!") None of the other disciples better captured the conclusion of the mission of Jesus than what John did in John 14:20, "In that day you will know that I am in the Father and you in me and I in you!"

He has no desire to outwit the others in giving an even more accurate historic account of Christ! The life that was manifest within his sacred gaze and now tangible embrace is a fellowship of the highest order! He must write and extend this reality to the next generations!

I am writing this to complete your joy and include you in my delight! 1 John 1:4.

Unlike Matthew and Luke who wrote 30 years prior to John, he did not bother to locate Jesus in the setting of his natural lineage.

Instead he declares, "In the beginning was the Word!" Before history was ever recorded the Word was!

Mankind pre-existed in the Logic of God! John understands that the Word was both the eternal source and destiny of all things and that nothing could ever reduce or confine the Word to an isolated island experience, neither could the Word be trapped in human doctrine or tradition. No inferior translation or interpretation could compromise God's original intent.

The authentic integrity of God's thought would forever be preserved and celebrated in the incarnation; human life would be the uninterrupted future of the Word. "We are not preaching a new doctrine, but the word that was from the beginning; yet it is new in that what is true in him is equally true in us!" 1 John 2:7-8. In him we discover that we are not here by chance or accident, or by the desire of an earthly parent, neither are we the product of a mere physical conception; we exist by the expression of God's desire to reveal him in the flesh.

1 John 1:1 The [1]Logos is the source; everything commences in him. The initial reports concerning him that have reached our ears, and which we indeed bore witness to with our own eyes - to the point that we became irresistibly attracted - now captivates our gaze. In him we witnessed [2]tangible life in its most articulate form. *(The Logos - the [1]Word. To touch, [2]**psallo**, to touch the string of a musical instrument, thus resonance.)*

1 John 1:2 The same life that [1]was [2]face to face with the Father from the beginning, has now dawned on us! The infinite life of the Father became visible before our eyes in a human person! *(In the beginning "was" the Word; [1]**eimi**, timeless existence, "I am". The Preposition [2]**pros** says so much more than 'with,' it suggests towards; face to face. See John 1:1&2. Also John 1:14 "Suddenly the invisible eternal Word takes on visible form! The Incarnation! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate*

tangible display of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the authentic begotten Son. The glory (that Adam lost) returns in fullness! Only grace can communicate truth in such complete context!" Also John 1:18 "Until this moment God remained invisible; now the authentic begotten Son, the blueprint of mankind's design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us.")

1 John 1:3 We include you in this conversation; you are the immediate audience of the logic of God! This is the Word that always was; we saw him incarnate and witnessed his language as defining our lives. In the incarnation Jesus includes mankind in the eternal friendship of the Father and the Son! This life now finds expression in an unreserved union. *(We do not invent fellowship; we are invited into the fellowship of the Father and the Son!)*

1 John 1:4 I am writing this to complete your joy and include you in my delight! *(In all these years since the ascension of Jesus, John, now ninety years old, continues to enjoy unhindered friendship with God and desires to extend this same fellowship to everyone through this writing. You are never too old to learn to write or become computer literate!)*

To Job this thought of uninterrupted favor was just too good to be true. Fear and sin-consciousness dominated his relationship with God. When he reflects on his life, he speaks about the "the autumn days of God's friendship." Job 29:2-4. RSV

This suggests that he lived under the constant fear that winter would soon interrupt the bliss of this friendship! God has so much more than a seasonal blessing in mind.

Job 1:4-5 His sons used to go and hold a feast in the house of each on his day; and they would send and invite their three sisters to eat and drink with them. And when the days of the feast had run their course, Job would send and sanctify them, and he would rise early in the morning and offer burnt offerings according to the number of them all; for Job said, "It may be that my sons have sinned, and cursed God in their hearts." This Job did continually.

Job 3:25 " For the thing that I fear comes upon me, and what I dread befalls me."

Job 29:2-4 "Oh, that I were as in the months of old, as in the days when God watched

over me; when his lamp shone upon my head, and by his light I walked through darkness; as I was in my autumn days, when the friendship of God was upon my tent. RSV

1 Cor. 1:8 He establishes you from start to finish; to stand [1]vindicated in your identity in the light of day as evidenced in the Lord Jesus Christ. *(The word, [1]**anegkletos**,from **ana**, upward, **en**, in and **kaleo**, to identify by name. Jesus gives evidence to our original identity. Compare **anoche** from **ana + echo** in Rom. 3:26.)*

Eph. 1:3 Let's celebrate God! He lavished every blessing heaven has upon us in Christ!

Eph. 1:4 He associated us in Christ before [1]the fall of the world! Jesus is God's mind made up about us! He always knew in his love that he would present us again [2]face-to-face before him in blameless innocence. *(The implications of the fall are completely cancelled. Paul uses the word, [1]**kataballo**, meaning "to fall away, to put in a lower place," instead of **themelios**, meaning "foundation" [see Eph 2:20]; thus, translated "the fall of the world," instead of "the foundation of the world." The entire "Fall" was a falling away in our minds from our true identity as image and likeness bearers of Elohim. Just like Eve, were we all deceived to believe a lie about ourselves, which is the fruit of the "I-am-not-tree". We all, like sheep have gone astray. [Isa 53:6]) God found us in Christ before he lost us in Adam! We are presented in blameless innocence before him! The word, [2]**katenopion**, suggests the closest possible proximity, face-to-face!*

Your in-Christness is not the result of a lucky draw! Calvinism lied to you! Neither is it the result of your "choice" to follow Jesus! Something doesn't become true by popular vote! Or by our beliefs! If it wasn't true to begin with, we're wasting our time trying to "believe" it true! Faith happens to you when you encounter the good announcement! Of God's doing are we IN CHRIST... (1 Cor 1:30) For "evangelical theology" to miss the meaning of mankind's inclusion IN CHRIST before they knew it or believed it, is to completely miss the point of the death, descent into hell, resurrection and ascension of Jesus! This would make Jesus irrelevant and reduce the salvation of the human race to their own fate managed by institutionalized religion, attaching mere sentimental value to an historic Jesus who died and rose again. By dying our death as fully God and fully man, once and for all (not for a "select few!"), death became the doorway, whereby Jesus would enter into our hell and deepest darkness and sense of lostness and loneliness as a result of the lies we believed about ourselves - to triumphantly lead us out as his

trophies and relocate us face to face with the Father of the universe! Eph 4:7,8 and 9 See Mirror Bible! All this happened while we were still dead in our trespasses and sins! Eph 2:5,6 Co-quickened, co-raised, co-seated in his Executive authority [his right hand] Now ponder Colossians 3:1-3 and engage your thoughts with throne room realities!)

Eph. 1:5 He is the architect of our design; his heart dream realized our [1]coming of age in Christ. *(Adoption here is not what it means in our Western society. It is a coming of age, like the typical Jewish Barmitsva. See Galatians 4:1-6, " ... and to seal our sonship the spirit of his Son echoes Abba Father in our hearts." This is [1]**huiothesia.**)*

Eph. 1:6 His grace-plan is to be celebrated: he [1]greatly endeared us and highly favored us in Christ. His love for his Son is his love for us. *(The Gospel is not about telling people how lost they are, but reminding them of how loved they are! See Luke 1:28 only other use of the word, χαριτόω [1]**charitoō**.)*

Jer. 1:5 Before I formed you in the womb I knew you.

Ps. 139:13 For you formed my inward parts and knitted me together in my mother's womb.

1 Cor 13:12 Then we will know even as we have always been known! RSV

And in the , **1 Cor. 13:12 There was a time of [1]suspense, when everything we saw was merely mirrored in the prophetic word, like in an enigma; but then** *[when I became an adult in the revelation of Christ]* **I gaze face-to-face that I may know me, even as I have always been known!** *(The word, [1]**arti**, comes from* **airo**, *meaning to keep in suspense. "I knew you before I formed you in your mother's womb!" Jeremiah 1:5.)*

Jesus came to introduce us to ourselves again, "Simon son of Jonah, I say you are Rock!" Matt. 16:17-18. "Look to the Rock from which you were hewn and the quarry from which you were dug!" Isa. 51:1. You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who gave you birth. Deut. 32:18.

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing himself]* **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving**

another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life** *[of their original design.]* **They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kupto**, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]**parameno**, to remain captivated under the influence of; **meno**, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]**eleutheria**, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

In Christ the Sabbath is no longer a shadow, a token holy day in the week, but the celebration of a perfect redemption in which the exact image and likeness of God is revealed and redeemed in human form. Mankind's original identity and innocence is redeemed. "Having made purification for sins, he sat down..." His throne is established upon the fact of our innocence! God's unhindered enjoyment of every Individual and their unhindered enjoyment of God is realized again.

He overlooked the times of ignorance and now urges all people everywhere to discover his eternal thoughts about mankind, revealed in Christ, when we were judged in righteousness in one man's death, and raised in his resurrection as the trophy of justice redeemed! Acts 17:30-31. God's rest is not at risk! He invites us to "enter into his rest", that is to see what his faith sees and knows to be true about the finished work of the cross.

Heb. 4:10 God's rest celebrates his finished work; whoever enters into God's rest immediately abandons his own efforts to compliment what God has already perfected. *(The language of the law is "do;" the language of grace is "done.")*

Ps. 36:9 For with you is the fountain of life; in your light do we see light.

1 John 1:5 My conversation with you flows from the same source which illuminates this fellowship of union with the Father and the Son. This then, is the essence of the message: God is radiant light, and in him there exists not even a trace of obscurity or darkness at all. *(See James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above (where we originate from); proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda. (The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word, [1]**anouthen**, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

1 John 1:6 This is the real deal! To live a life of pretense is such a waste of time! The truth has no competition. Truth inspires the poetry of friendship in total contrast to a fake, performance-based relationship! Light is not threatened by darkness! Why say something with darkness as your reference?

1 John 1:7 We are invited to explore the dimensions of the same light that engulfs God; when we see the light in his light, fellowship ignites! In this light, we understand how the blood of Jesus Christ is the removal of every distortion and stain of sin! *(Sin [hamartia] is a distorted identity. From the words, ha, without and meros, form. To walk in the light as he is in the light means to see your life and everything that concerns you, exclusively from your Father's point of view. Ps 36:9. 1 Pet 1:18,19.)*

1 John 1:8 To claim innocence by our own efforts under the law of personal performance, is to deceive ourselves and to deliberately ignore the truth. The truth about us, does not mean that we now have to go into denial as if we haven't done anything wrong! *(If you've hurt or wronged someone, go to them and be reconciled! To apologize restores harmony; but the essence of confession is a conversation inspired by the revelation of the love of God demonstrated in Christ. The focus of this conversation shifts from what you did wrong, to what Jesus did right! One cannot afford to cheat oneself by living a double life, acting out "the fellowship thing", while still hosting stuff in one's life that is inconsistent with the life of our design. You do not need to first get rid of darkness and then bring the light! Light deals most effectively and effortlessly with darkness. The light of the gospel does not reveal sin, it reveals our freedom from it!)*

1 John 1:9 Our [1]conversation takes on a brand new dynamic when we take sides with what God believes about us! So, instead of telling God about the detail of your sin, you remind yourself about the detail of your redemption. God doesn't need the information, you do! God's faithfulness and righteousness is the basis of our [2]forgiveness and [3]cleansing from every distortion. Jesus removed every bit of condemning evidence against us! *(The word traditionally translated "confession" is the word [1]**homologeo** from **homo**, the same, and **logeo** to speak. The context of verse 7 suggests that we say what God says about us. The word translated forgiveness, or remission is the word [2]**aphiemi**, from **apo**, away from, and **hieimi** an intensive form of **eimi**, I am; thus forgiveness is in essence a restoring to your true 'I-am-ness.' The injury, insult, shame, hostility or guilt would no longer define the individual. The words, αφη aphe, from aphiemi [to forgive] and καθαριση [3]katharitse, from katharitzo, [to cleanse from every stain] are in the Aorist Subjunctive, which indicates a definite outcome that happens as a result of another stated action.)*

1 John 5: 9 If we receive the testimony of people, the testimony of God is greater; for this is the testimony of God that he has borne witness to his Son. 1 John 5:10 He who believes in the Son of God has the testimony in himself. RSV.

1 John 2:1 My darling little children, the reason I write these things to you is so that you will not [1]believe a lie about yourselves! If anyone does believe a [1]distorted image to be their reality, we have Jesus Christ who [2]defines our likeness [3]face to face with the Father! He is our [4]parakletos, the one who endorses our true identity, being both the source and the reflection of the Father's image in us! *(The root of sin is to believe a lie about yourself. The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. Jesus the righteous, **iesoun xriston dikaion**; the word [2]**dikaiosune**, righteousness is from the stem **dike**, two parties finding likeness in each other. The Preposition [3]**pros** suggests a face to face presentation. [See John 1:1] The word [4]**parakletos** comes from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from*

*which an action originates, intimate connection; and **kaleo**, meaning to identify by name, to surname. Jesus introduces the Holy Spirit in the same capacity: **parakletos**, meaning close companion, kinsman [John 14:16]. Sadly this word has been translated as 'advocate' as if Jesus needs to persuade the Father to like us and possibly forgive us!)*

1 John 2:12 The reason of my writing is to remind you to live your lives in the innocence of an infant! The name Jesus means that you can rest assured in your salvation from sin's harassment! *(Teknion, diminutive of teknon, an infant. John writes to believers at different levels of their maturity; little children, young men and fathers. To the little children he says, "I am writing this so that you may not sin; but if any one does sin...[sin is the exception, even if you are a young believer.] see 1 John 2:1.)*

1 John 2:13 May my writing also remind you that your fatherhood has its authentic genesis in him who is from the beginning. *(1 John 2:7,8; 1 John 5:20)* **And to you young men, I write to congratulate you for your victory over the [1]exhausting system of hardships, annoyances and labors. You have discovered your strength in Christ's achievement and not your own efforts! I wrote to all of you as children because you know God as your Father.** *(The word often translated evil, is [1]**poneros**, which according to Thayer's definition means to be full of labors, annoyances, hardships; to be pressed and harassed by labors. This is so typical of the religious system of a works-based self-righteousness, as opposed to faith righteousness. This is the fruit of the I am not-tree-system. The young men who become weary and exhausted under the system of hardships and labor; the law of works, have discovered their eagle wings in Kawa-mode; where God's thoughts entwine with their thoughts, and his strength ignites within. Isa 40:31 The Hebrew word,* קוה ***kawa**, often translated, to wait, means to entwine; to plat together.)*

1 John 2:14 What I have written previously will resonate with the fathers whose acquaintance with him is established in the prophetic voice [1]from the beginning. Also the young men will find their strength endorsed in my writing, since they have the word firmly rooted within them as their permanent source and reference. They have defeated the duty-and guilt-driven system that snared them before in the futility of their own efforts. *(The word [1]**arche**, means to be first in order, time, place or rank; the beginning.)*

Heb. 4:14 In the message of the incarnation, we have Jesus the Son of God representing mankind in the highest place of spiritual authority. That which God has spoken to us in him is his final word. It is echoed now in our conversation.

Heb. 4:15 As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human lives. Having subjected it to close scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses which are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. *(He is not an example for us but of us.)*

Heb. 4:16 For this reason we can approach the authoritative throne of grace with bold utterance. We are welcome there in his embrace, and are [1]reinforced with immediate effect in times of trouble. *(The word, [1]**boetheia**, means to be reinforced, specifically a rope or chain for frapping a vessel in a storm.In his incarnate human body Jesus represents us on the deepest possible level of every detail of our lives, spirit, soul and body. He victoriously faced every onslaught and scrutiny that we would ever possibly encounter!)*

Heb. 9:12 As High Priest, his permission to enter the Holy Place was not secured by the blood of beasts. By his own blood he obtained access on behalf of the human race. Only one act was needed for him to enter the most sacred place of grace and there to institute a ransom of perpetual consequence. *(The perfection of the redemption he secured needs no further sacrifice. There are no outstanding debts; there is nothing we need do to add weight to what he has accomplished once and for all. The only possible priesthood activity we can now engage in is to continually bring a sacrifice of the fruit of our lips, giving thanks to his Name; no blood, just fruit, even our acts of self-sacrifice, giving of time and money, etc. are all just the fruit of our constant gratitude!)*

Heb. 9:13 The blood of beasts and the ashes of the burnt sacrifice of a heifer could only achieve a very temporal and surface cleansing by being sprinkled on the guilty. *(The word for heifer, is **damalis**, from **damatzo**, to tame; this was the most dear and expensive sacrifice. She was a strong, pristine, spotless female calf, she was raised as a family pet; "A Little Princess!" This was the best that the law-system could present; yet, no inner purging of conscience was possible; only the sense of temporal relief; whilst knowing that the entire process would have to be repeated again and again! In this arrangement, God addressed the dilemma of our sin consciousness; the deep-seated stain that it had left needed to be thoroughly exposed, and then brought to closure. The shadow system with its imperfections, as a possible means of obtaining a lasting and meaningful sense of innocence, had to be exhausted; ultimately proving that no sacrifice that anyone can bring at any expense of their own, could possibly match the*

sacrifice of God giving himself as scapegoat to the human race in order to persuade us that his love for us would go to the scandalous extreme, where we are finally confronted with the fact that it is not in a sacrifice that we bring where God's mind is favorably influenced towards us; but in the shocking sacrifice of himself, where he forever, in the most radical language, impact our ideas and thoughts about the Father, Son and Spirit's estimate of us. There is nothing dearer in the universe to them, but our redeemed innocence and our individual value realized! See Colossians 2:14,15 in the Mirror Bible.)

Heb. 9:14 How much more effective was the blood of Christ, when he presented his own flawless life through the eternal Spirit before God, in order to purge your conscience from its frustration under the [1]cul-de-sac rituals of the law. There is no comparison between a guilt and duty-driven, dead religious system, and the vibrancy of living your life free from a sin-consciousness! This is what the new testament priesthood is all about! *(Dead works, [1]**nekros ergon**. A dead, religious-routine system can never compete with the resurrected Christ, now realized in you.)*

Rom. 6:1 It is not possible to interpret grace as a cheap excuse to continue in sin. It sounds to some that we are saying, "Let's carry on sinning then so that grace may abound." *(In the previous chapter Paul expounds the heart of the gospel by giving us a glimpse of the far-reaching faith of God; even at the risk of being misunderstood by the legalistic mind he does not compromise the message.)*

Rom. 6:2 How ridiculous is that! How can we be dead and alive to sin at the same time?

Rom. 6:10 His appointment with death was [1]once-off. As far as sin is concerned, he is dead. The reason for his death was to take away the sin of the world; his life now exhibits our union with the life of God. *(The Lamb of God took away the sin of the world; [1]**efapax**, once and for all, a final testimony, used of what is so done to be of perpetual validity and never needs repetition. This is the final testimony of the fact that sin's power over us is destroyed. See Hebrews 9:26, "But Jesus did not have to suffer again and again since the fall (or since the foundation) of the world; the single sacrifice of himself in the fulfillment of history now reveals how he has brought sin to nought." Thus, in this context [of everyone's appointment with death], Jesus is the ultimate sacrifice. What the first, shadow-dispensation merely prophetically pointed to, he fulfilled once and for all, when he was presented as an offering, to take upon himself the sins of the entire human race! Now, with sin no longer on the agenda, he appears a second time, out of this death, to be clearly seen in everyone's whole-hearted embrace*

of him as Savior! [Heb 9:28].")

Rom. 6:11 This reasoning is equally relevant to you. [1]Calculate the cross; there can only be one logical conclusion: he died your death; that means you died to sin, and are now alive to God. Sin-consciousness can never again feature in your future! You are in Christ Jesus; his Lordship is the authority of this union. *(We are not being presumptuous to reason that we are in Christ! "[1]Reckon yourselves therefore dead to sin" The word,* **[1]logitsomai**, *means to make a calculation to which there can only be one logical conclusion. [See Eph 1:4 and 1 Cor 1:30].*

"From now on, think of it this way: Sin speaks a dead language that means nothing to you; God speaks your mother tongue, and you hang on every word. You are dead to sin and alive to God. That's what Jesus did."— The Message.)

Rom. 8:1 Now the decisive conclusion is this: in Christ, every bit of condemning evidence against us is cancelled. *("Who walk not after the flesh but after the spirit." This sentence was not in the original text, but later copied from verse 4. The person who added this most probably felt that the fact of Paul's declaration of mankind's innocence had to be made subject again to a person's conduct. Religion under the law felt more comfortable with the condition of personal contribution rather than the conclusion of what faith reveals. The "in Christ" revelation is key to God's dealing with mankind. It is the PIN-code of the Bible. [See 1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4].)*

Rom. 8:2 The law of the Spirit is the liberating force of life in Christ. This leaves me with no further obligation to the law of sin and death. Spirit has superseded the sin enslaved senses as the principle law of our lives. *(The law of the spirit is righteousness by faith vs the law of personal effort and self righteousness which produces condemnation and spiritual death which is the fruit of the DIY tree.)*

Rom. 8:3 The law failed to be anything more than an instruction manual; it had no power to deliver us from the strong influence of sin holding us hostage in our own bodies. God disguised himself in his Son in this very domain where sin ruled us, in flesh. The body he lived and conquered in was no different to ours. Thus sin's authority in the human body was condemned. *(Hebrews 4:15, As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human life. Having subjected it to close scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses that are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. He is not an example for us but of us.)*

Rom. 8:4 The righteousness promoted by the law is now realized in us. Our practical day-to-day life bears witness to spirit inspiration and not flesh domination.

Rom. 8:5 Sin's symptoms are sponsored by the senses, a mind dominated by the sensual. Thoughts betray source; spirit life attracts spirit thoughts.

Rom. 8:6 Thinking patterns are formed by reference, either the sensual appetites of the flesh and spiritual death, or zoe-life and total tranquillity flowing from a mind addicted to spirit *[faith]* **realities.**

Rom. 8:7 A mind focused on flesh *(the sensual domain where sin held me captive)* **is distracted from God with no inclination to his life-laws. Flesh** *[self-righteousness]* **and spirit** *[faith righteousness]* **are opposing forces.** *(Flesh no longer defines you; faith does!)*

2 Cor. 4:18 We are not keeping any score of what seems so obvious to the senses on the surface; it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us which has our full attention and captivates our gaze! *(See John 1:18 Until this moment God remained invisible to mankind; now the [1]authentic begotten Son, ([1]**monogenes,** begotten only of God) the blueprint of mankind's design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the [2]official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. (Official guide, [2]**eksegesato**, from **ek,** Preposition denoting source, and **hegeomai,** the strengthened form of **ago**, to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep; thus **hegeomai** means to be officially appointed in a position of authority.*

2 Cor 3:18 The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is unveiled. In gazing with wonder at the blueprint likeness of God displayed in human form, we suddenly realize that we are looking at ourselves! Every feature of his image

is mirrored in us! This is the most radical transformation engineered by the Spirit of the Lord; we are led from an inferior mindset to the revealed endorsement of our authentic identity.)

Titus 1:2 This is the life of the [1]ages which was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before [2]time or space existed. *(Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. The word, [1]**aionios**, speaks of ages. Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before*

*the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer. The word, [2]**xronos**, means a measured duration or length of time; **kairos** is a due, or specific moment of time. This was before the ages or any measure of calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity!)*

2 Tim. 1:9 He rescued the [1]integrity of our original [2]design and revealed that we have always been his own from the beginning, even [3]before time was. This has nothing to do with anything we did to qualify or disqualify ourselves. We are not talking religious good works or karma here. Jesus unveils grace to be the [4]eternal intent of God! Grace celebrates our pre-creation innocence and now declares our redeemed union with God in Christ Jesus. *(The word [1]**hagios**, means holiness, purity, integrity; **hagios + kaleo** is often translated, holy calling; [2]**kaleo** means to identify by name, to surname; [3]**pro xronos aionios**; **pro**, before; **xronos**, means a measured duration or length of time; **aionios**, speaks of ages. Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer; this was before calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. [**kairos** is a due, or specific moment of time.] So **aionios** spans time in dimensions that includes specific seasons or eras, but expands it all from the immediate now as the focus and zooms it out beyond boundaries without losing the "now" relevance! Jesus defines it as, "Before Abraham was, I am!" What happened to us in Christ is according to God's eternal purpose [Bread of the Presence, or Show-bread, in Greek, πρόθεσις [4]**prothesis**, pre-designed/prophetic purpose], which he has shown in every prophetic pointer and shadow; in the Hebrew tradition the showbread [**prothesis**] pointed to the true bread from heaven, the authentic word that proceeded from the mouth of God - Jesus, the incarnate word - sustaining the life of our design. See Heb 9:2 The first tented area was called the Holy Place; the only light here came from the lampstand illuminating the table upon which the showbread - **prothesis** - was presented. The Hebrew word is* לחם הפנים ***lechem paniym,*** *face bread, or bread of the presence. The lampstand was a beautifully crafted golden chandelier portraying budding and blossoming almond branches. Remember that this is also what Jeremiah saw in Jer 1:12, when God said, "I am awake over my word to perform it." The same Hebrew word is used here,* שקד

***shaqad**, the almond was called the 'awake tree', because it blossomed first, while the other trees were still in their winter sleep. The showbread pointed towards the daily sustenance of life in the flesh as the ultimate tabernacle of God, realized in the account of Jesus with the two from Emmaus. Their hearts were burning with resonance and faith while he opened the Scriptures to them, and then around the table their eyes were opened to recognize him as the fulfillment of Scripture, their true meal incarnated: Luke 24:27-31; Mankind shall not live by bread alone, but by the authentic thought of God, the Word proceeding from his mouth, the original intent, his image and likeness incarnated, revealed and redeemed in human life.*

Titus 1:2 This is the life of the ages that was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before time or space existed. [Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity!] Mirror Study Bible.

This life was made certain before eternal time. [BBE 1949, Bible in Basic English])

What an amazing view you have created for yourself in my mind, oh God!

Through the avenue of my thoughts you extend eternity

and embrace it in me in the here and now!

What bliss to encounter life

and people through your eyes!

I love my thoughts!

I AM is your past present and future.

Now live the adventure daily,

in total abandonment!

Rom. 1:1 Paul, [5]passionately engaged by Jesus Christ, [1]identified in him to [2]represent him. My [3]mandate and [4]message is to announce the goodness of God to mankind. *(Mandate, the scope or horizon of my message, from [3]**horitso**, meaning marked out. The word, [2]**apostelo**, means an extension from him, a representative; [5]**doulos**, means slave from **deo**, to be bound or knitted together like a husband and wife; [1]**kletos** comes from **kaleo**, meaning called, to identify by name, to surname; and [4]**eu + angellion**, means well done announcement, good news, the official announcement of God's goodness.)*

Rom. 1:2 This message is what the Scriptures are all about. It remains the central prophetic theme and content of inspired writing.

Scripture could never again be interpreted in any other way! The gospel of the successful redemption of the image and likeness of our Creator in human form gives content and context to the Bible.

Rom. 1:16 I have no shame about sharing the Good News of Christ with anyone; the powerful rescuing act of God persuades both Jew and Gentile alike.

Rom.1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of [1]God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness reveals the life of our design. "Righteousness by his *(God's)* **faith defines life."** *(See my commentary note on Rom. 1:17 in chapter 3 The Romance of the Ages, page 33.)*

From Romans chapters 1:18 to 3:20 Paul proceeds to give a graphic display of distorted human behavior.

Being a Jew, and therefore to be acquainted with the requirements of the law, offers no real advantage, since it offers no disguise or defence from sin. It bears the same symptoms and consequences.

His triumphant statement in Romans 1:16 & 17, and again reinforced in chapter 3:21-24, is set against this backdrop. The good news declares how the same condemned mankind in Adam is now freely acquitted by God's grace through the redemption that is unveiled in Christ Jesus.

Sadly the evangelical Christianity emphasized the wrong verse! Rom. 3:23 is not the

good news! It's all in the next verse! Why can many quote Rom 3:23 off by heart, but hardly anyone knows verse 24!? Rom. 3:23 "...since all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, Rom 3:24 they [the same, all!] are justified by his grace as a gift, through the redemption which is in Christ Jesus.

Rom. 3:22 Jesus is what God believes about you! In him the righteousness of God is on display in such a way [1]that everyone may be equally persuaded about what God believes about them, regardless of who they are; there is [2]no distinction. *(The Preposition, [1]**eis**, indicates a point reached in conclusion. The Greek, **ou gar estin diastoley** means [2]there is no exception - this includes every single person, Jew and Gentile alike!)*

Rom. 3:23 Mankind is in the same boat; their [1]distorted behavior is proof of a [2]lost [3]blueprint. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. See Deuteronomy 32:18, "You have forgotten the Rock that begot you and have gotten out of step with the God who danced with you!" Hebrew,* חול ***khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21. See Romans 9:33 in the Mirror! The word [2]**hustereo**, to fall short, to be inferior, [3]**doxa**, glory, blueprint, from **dokeo**, opinion or intent.)*

Rom. 3:24 While the law proved mankind's dilemma, the grace of God announces the same mankind's redemption in Jesus Christ! Their blameless innocence is a free gift! The gift-principle puts the idea of reward out of business! There is no exception - this belongs to every single person, Jew and Gentile alike! *(v 22)* **Mankind's righteousness is now redeemed. Jesus Christ is proof of God's grace gift; he redeemed the glory of God in human life; mankind condemned in the language of religion, is now mankind justified in the language of the gospel!** *(The man Jesus Christ proved that God did not make a mistake when they made humankind in their image and likeness! Sadly the evangelical world proclaimed verse 23 completely out of context! There is no good news in verse 23, the gospel is in verse 24! All fell short because of Adam; the same 'all' are equally declared innocent because of Christ! The law reveals what happened to mankind in Adam; grace reveals what happened to the same mankind in Christ. Their is no distinction - all have sinned and fallen short of the glory*

of God - now they are all justified freely as a gift through the redemption [the liberating action] of Jesus Christ!)

Rom. 3:25 Jesus exhibits God's mercy. In his blood conciliation God's faith persuades mankind of his righteousness and the fact that he has brought closure to the historic record of their sins. *(Not by demanding a sacrifice but providing the sacrifice of himself.)* **Jesus is the unveiling of the Father's heart towards us.** *(See note to Hebrews 8:12; also 1 John 2:2.)*

Rom. 3:26 All along God [1]refused to let go of mankind. At this very moment God's act of [2]righteousness is [3]pointing them to the evidence of their innocence, with Jesus as the [4]fountainhead of faith. *(God's tolerance, [1]**anoche**, to echo upward; God continues to hear the echo of his likeness in us. See Rom 2:4. In both these verses [25+26] Paul uses the word, [3]**endeixis**, where we get the word indicate from. It is also part of the stem of the word translated, righteousness, [2]**dikaiosune**. To point out, to show, to convince with proof. Then follows, [4]**ek pisteos iesou; ek,** source or origin and **iesou** is in the Genitive case, the owner of faith is Jesus! He is both the source and substance of faith! Hebrews 11:1, 12:2 "The Incarnation means that God Himself condescended to enter into our alienated human existence, to lay hold of it, to bind it in union with Himself; and the consummation of the Incarnation in the death and resurrection means the Son of God died for all men, and so once and for all constituted men as men upon whom God had poured out His life and love, so that men are for ever laid hold of by God and affirmed in their being as His creatures. They can no more escape from His love and sink into non-being than they can constitute themselves men for whom Christ has not died. How can God go back upon the death of His dear Son? How can God undo the Incarnation and go back upon Himself? How can God who is Love go back upon the pouring out of His love once and for all and so cease to be Himself? That is the decisive, final thing about the whole Incarnation including the death of Christ, that it affects all men, indeed the whole of creation, for the whole of creation is now put on a new basis with God, the basis of a Love that does not withhold itself but only overflows in our unending Love. That is why creation still continues in being, and that is why man still exists, for God has not given him up, but on the contrary poured out His love upon him unreservedly once and for ever, decidedly and finally affirming man as His child, eternally confirming the creation as His own handiwork. God does not say Yes, and No, for all He has done is Yes and Amen in Christ. That applies to every man, whether he will or no. He owes his very being to Christ and belongs to Christ, and in that he belongs*

to Christ he has his being only from Him and in relation to Him." Thomas F. Torrance courtesy Baxter Kruger's study notes.)

Rom. 3:27 The law of faith cancels the law of works; which means there is suddenly nothing left for anyone to boast in. No one is superior to another. *(Bragging only makes sense if there is someone to compete with or impress. "While we compete with one another and compare ourselves with one another we are without understanding. [2 Corinthians 10:12]. "Through the righteousness of God we have received a faith of equal standing." [See 2 Peter 1:1 RSV] The OS (operating system) of the law of works is willpower; the OS of the law of faith is love. Galatians 5:6 Love sets faith in motion. The law presented one with choices; grace awakens belief! Willpower exhausts, love ignites! If choices could save us we would be our own Saviors! Willpower is the language of the law, love is the language of grace and it ignites faith that leads to romance; falling in love beats "making a decision to believe in love" by far! See Rom 7:19 Willpower has failed me; this is how embarrassing it is, the most diligent decision that I make to do good, disappoints.)*

Rom. 3:28 This leaves us with only one logical conclusion, mankind is justified by God's faith and not by their ability to keep the law.

Rom. 3:29 Which means that God is not the private property of the Jews but belongs equally to all the nations. *(While the law excludes the non-Jewish nations, faith includes us all on level terms.)*

Rom. 3:30 There is only one God, he deals with everyone, circumcised or uncircumcised exclusively on the basis of faith.

Rom. 3:31 No, faith does not re-write the rules; instead it confirms that the original life-quality meant for mankind as documented in the law, is again realized.

Paul brings the argument of the ineffectiveness of the law to get a person to change their behavior to a final crescendo in Chapter 7. He states in 7 verse 1 that he is writing to those who are familiar with the law. They have firsthand experience therefore of the weakness of the rule to consistently govern the conduct of people.

The best that the law could offer was to educate and confirm good intentions; but a more powerful law, the law of sin introduced to mankind through one man's transgression, has to be challenged by a greater force than human willpower.

Because sin robbed mankind of their true identity and awakened in them all kinds of worse-than-animal-like conduct, a set of rules couldn't do it. The revelation of God's

righteousness has to be far more effective and powerful mankind's slavery to sin.

It is evident that because of our corrupt behavior, we deserve nothing less than condemnation. Yet within this context the grace and mercy of God is revealed; not as mere tolerance from God's side to turn a blind eye and to put up with sin, but as God's triumphant act in Christ to cancel our guilt and to break sin's spell and dominion over us.

For salvation to be relevant it has to offer mankind a basis and reference for their faith to be launched from. It has to offer a conclusion of greater implication than the stalemate condition they find themselves in under the dispensation of the law.

Rom. 7:12 I stress again that the law as principle is holy and so is every individual commandment it contains; it consistently promotes that which is just and good.

Rom. 7:13 How then could I accuse something that is that good to have killed me? I say again, it was not the law, but sin that caused my spiritual death. The purpose of the law was to expose sin as the culprit. The individual commandment ultimately serves to show the exceeding extent of sin's effect on mankind.

Rom. 7:14 We agree that the law is spiritual, but because I am [1]sold like a slave to sin, I am reduced to a mere carnal life. *(Spiritual death. The word, [1]**piprasko** comes from **perao**, meaning to transport into a distant land in order to sell as a slave. Sin is a foreign land.)*

Rom. 7:15 This is how the sell-out to sin affects my life: I find myself doing things my conscience does not allow. My dilemma is that even though I sincerely desire to do that which is good, I don't, and the things I despise, I do.

Rom. 7:16 It is obvious that my conscience sides with the law;

Rom. 7:17 which confirms then that it is not really I who do these things but sin manifesting its symptoms in me. It has taken my body hostage. *(Sin is similar to a dormant virus that suddenly breaks out in very visible symptoms.)*

Rom. 7:18 The total extent and ugliness of sin that inhabits me, reduced my life to good intentions that could not be followed through.

Rom. 7:19 Willpower has failed me; this is how embarrassing it is, the most diligent decision that I make to do good, disappoints; the very evil I try to avoid, is what I do. *(If mere quality decisions could rescue mankind, the law would have been enough. Good intentions cannot save someone. The revelation of what happened to us in Christ's death is what brings faith into motion to liberate from within. Faith is not a*

decision we make to give God a chance, faith is realizing our inclusion in what happened on the Cross and in the resurrection of Christ! See Rom 3:27.)

Rom. 7:20 If I do the things I do not want to do, then it is clear that I am not evil, but that I host sin in my body against my will.

Rom. 7:21 It has become a predictable principle; I desire to do well, but my mere desire cannot escape the evil presence that dictates my actions.

Rom. 7:22 The real person that I am on the inside delights in the law of God. *(The law proves to be consistent with my inner make-up.)*

Rom. 7:23 There is another law though, *(foreign to my design)* **the law of sin, activating and enrolling the members of my body as weapons of war against the law of my mind. I am held captive like a prisoner of war in my own body.**

Rom. 7:24 It doesn't matter how I [1]weigh myself I just do not measure up to expectations! The situation is absolutely desperate for mankind; is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap? *(The word [1]**talaipōros** occurs only twice in the New Testament - Rom 7:24, Rev 3:17 - and both times it is translated wretched!? It has two components, **talanton**, which is the word for a scale of balance; that which is weighed, a talent; and **poros** from **peira**, to test as in testing the weight of something.)*

Rom. 7:25 Thank God, this is exactly what he has done through Jesus Christ our Leader; he has come to our rescue! I am finally freed from this conflict between the law of my mind and the law of sin in my body. *(In the Incarnation, in a human body exactly like ours, Jesus balanced the scales! He is the true measure of the life of our design - he revealed and redeemed the image and likeness of God in us as in a mirror! See Rom 1:16,17 and 3:24 and 27.)*

Rom. 8:1 Now the decisive conclusion is this: in Christ, every bit of condemning evidence against us is cancelled. *("Who walk not after the flesh but after the spirit." This sentence was not in the original text, but later copied from verse 4. The person who added this most probably felt that the fact of Paul's declaration of mankind's innocence had to be made subject again to a person's conduct. Religion under the law felt more comfortable with the condition of personal contribution rather than the conclusion of what faith reveals. The "in Christ" revelation is key to God's dealing with mankind. It is the PIN-code of the Bible. [See 1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4].)*

Rom. 8:2 The law of the Spirit is the liberating force of life in Christ. This leaves me with no further obligation to the law of sin and death. Spirit has superseded

the sin enslaved senses as the principle law of our lives. *(The law of the spirit is righteousness by faith vs the law of personal effort and self righteousness which produces condemnation and spiritual death which is the fruit of the DIY tree.)*

Rom. 8:3 The law failed to be anything more than an instruction manual; it had no power to deliver us from the strong influence of sin holding us hostage in our own bodies. God disguised himself in his Son in this very domain where sin ruled us, in flesh. The body he lived and conquered in was no different to ours. Thus sin's authority in the human body was condemned. *(Hebrews 4:15, As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human life. Having subjected it to close scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses that are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. He is not an example for us but of us.)*

Rom. 8:4 The righteousness promoted by the law is now realized in us. Our practical day-to-day life bears witness to spirit inspiration and not flesh domination.

Paul is convinced that whatever happened to the human race because of Adam's fall is far superseded in every possible proportion by the revelation of mankind's inclusion in the life, death and resurrection of Jesus Christ. He places the fall of Adam and every act of unrighteousness that followed against the one act of righteousness that God performed in Christ as proof of our acquittal.

The revelation of righteousness by faith unveils how God in Christ represented and redeemed mankind. The etymological essence of the word, 'righteousness' in its root form, ***diké***, implies the idea of two parties finding likeness in each other; with no interference of any sense of blame, guilt or inferiority.

The Hebrew word for righteousness, ***tzedek***, צדק which also includes the idea of the wooden beam in a scale of balances. "He that judges his neighbor according to the balance of righteousness, or innocence, they judge him according to righteousness." *[T. Bab. Sabbat, fol. 127. 2.]* The Greek stem for righteousness is ***dike*** - it is interesting to note that the Greek goddess of Justice is Dike [pronounced, dikay] and she is always pictured holding a scale of balances in her hand.

When Adam lost the glory of God *(In Hebrew the word* דבכ ***Kabod****, means weight; the consciousness of God's likeness and image),* the law proved that no amount of good works could balance the scale again. Grace reveals how God redeemed his image and

likeness again in human form; now the scale is perfectly balanced! No wonder Jesus cried out on the cross, "It is finished!"

The law reveals what happened to humanity in Adam; Grace reveals what happened to the same humanity in Christ.

The law presented mankind with choices, grace awakens belief. Willpower exhausts, love ignites. Willpower is the drive of the law of works; love sets faith in motion. Gal. 5:6.

This is the message that Paul says he owes to the whole world!

Rom. 1:5 The grace and commission we received from him, is to bring about a [1]faith-inspired lifestyle in all the nations. [2]His name is his claim on the human race. *(Paul immediately sets out to give new definition to the term, "obedience," no longer by law, but of faith. [1]Obedience, from* ***upo + akoo****, means to be under the influence of what is heard, accurate hearing; hearing from above. [2]Every family in heaven and on earth is identified in him. Eph 3:15.)*

Rom. 16:25 I am not talking "hear-say-theory"; I own the gospel I proclaim! This is my message! I salute God who empowers you dynamically and establishes you to be strong and immovable in the face of contradiction. Jesus Christ is the disclosure of the very mystery that was concealed in silence before [1]time or human [2]history were recorded. *(Titus 1:2 This is the life of the ages which was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before [2]time or space existed. [Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. The word, [2]****aionios****, speaks of ages.] Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer. The word, [1]****xronos****, means a measured duration or length of time; [****kairos*** *is a due, or specific moment of time.] This was before the ages or any measure of calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity! "This life was made certain before eternal time." [BBE 1949, Bible in Basic English] Paul's gospel does not merely proclaim Christ in history; he announces Christ unveiled in human life; Christ in you! Colossians 1:27.)*

Rom. 16:26 The mystery mirrored in [1]prophetic Scripture is now unveiled. The

God of the ages determined to make this mystery known in such a way that all the nations of the earth will hear and realize the [2]lifestyle that faith ignites. *(This gospel breaks the silence of the ages and reveals how God succeeded to redeem his image and likeness in mankind. [1]Isa 53:4, 5. See note on 16:19, Faith inspires an [2]obedience of spontaneity beyond guilt and obligation.)*

Rom. 16:27 Jesus Christ [1]uniquely [2]articulates the [3]wisdom of God; he is the [4]conclusion of the ages. *(Uniquely, [1]**monos,** alone, Jesus has no competition; this one man represents the entire human race; this is the mystery of the ages. 1 Cor 2:7 We voice words of wisdom that were hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in man. Our glorification has always been God's agenda, even before time was. 1 Cor 2:8 Neither the politicians nor the theologians of the day had a clue about this mystery [of mankind's association in Christ]; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory! The word, [3]**sophos**, means clarity, wisdom. He forever broke the silence of the ages! The words, [4]**eis aion, eis** indicates a point reached in conclusion, thus the conclusion of the ages. He is the [2]**doxa**, opinion; the logos that was before time was; the Word that became flesh and dwells within us [Jn 1:1, 14]. The incarnation [Latin, **in carne**, in the body] is the final trophy of the eternal logos and doxa of God.*

Col 1:15 In him the image and likeness of God is made visible in human form in order that everyone may recognize their true origin in him. He is the firstborn of every creature. *(What darkness veiled from us he unveiled. In him we clearly see the mirror reflection of our original life. The Son of his love gives accurate evidence of his image in human form. The incarnation means that God can never again be invisible!)*

Col. 1:19 God is fully at home in him. Jesus exhibits God's [1]happy delight to be human. *(Delightful intent, [1]**eudokeo**. "So spacious is he, so roomy, that everything of God finds its proper place in him without crowding." — The Message.)*

Col 2:3 Everything that could possibly define our wealth is [1]hidden in Christ. In this place of our union in him the complete [2]treasure of all wisdom and knowledge is sourced. *(The word, [1]**apokriphos**, translates from **apo,** away from and **krupto**, to conceal, to keep secret. The word, [2]**thesaurus**, means treasure; the place in which precious things are collected and laid up; from **tithemi**, to place and **theo**, God, the ultimate capacity of all things. Christ is the context of all wisdom and knowledge.)*

Col 2:9 In him, all the fullness of [1]Deity [2]resides in a human body! He proves that human life is tailor-made for God! *(The word, [1]**theotes**, godhead/deity, is*

*feminine. Jesus exhibits what the Father, Son and Spirit is like, in human form. The word [2]**katoikeō** means to dwell in, to inhabit. While the expanse cannot measure or define God, their detailed likeness is displayed in human skin. See Col 1:19, God is fully at home in him. Jesus is God's happy delight to be human.)*

Col 2:10 We are complete in him! Jesus mirrors our wholeness and [1]endorses our true identity. He is "I am" in us! *(God packaged completeness in "I am," mirrored in you! The word, [1]**exousia**, is often translated authority; from, **ek + eimi**, originating out of "I am." The days are over where our lives were dictated to under the rule of the law of performance and an inferior identity. It's not about who I used to be or who I'm striving to become; we are celebrating I am! Any teaching that leaves one with a sense of lack and imperfection rather than completeness is a distraction from the truth.)*

Jesus is the author and finisher of faith's capacity within us to mirror and celebrate completeness!

The principle of faith is to see what God sees. God called humanity's salvation when there seemed to be no evidence of it. Sarah's barren womb did not intimidate God's faith. Romans 4:17 "While we look not at the things that the senses observe, but we look at the revelation of the unseen as it is unveiled in our understanding through the mirror revelation of the Gospel of Christ. 2 Cor. 3:18; 2 Cor. 4:18

Rom. 4:17 finds its context in Rom. 1:17 and 10:17, "It is clear then that faith's source is found in the content of the message heard; the message is Christ. *(We are God's audience; Jesus is God's language!)*"

Paul wrote Rom. 5:12-21 before any of us preached it; and at the risk of being misunderstood by the legalistic mind as he states in the next verse 6:1, "Shall we continue in sin so that grace may abound?" What happened to mankind in Adam is by far surpassed by what happened to them in Christ!

Rom. 5:12 One person opened the door to [1]sin. Sin introduced *(spiritual)* **death. Both sin and death had a global impact. No one escaped its tyranny.** *(The word translated sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony.)*

Rom. 5:13 The law did not introduce sin; it was just not pointed out yet.

Rom. 5:14 In the mean time death dominated everyone's lifestyle, from Adam till Moses, *[2500 years before the law was given]* **no one was excluded; even those whose sins were different from Adam's. The fact is that Adam's [1]deviation set sin into motion - what happened to mankind because of one man, Adam, is in principle typical of what was about to happen to the same mankind because of the one man, Jesus!** *(Paul now employs a word that only he uses in his epistles [7 times]* ***parabasis*** *instead of the usual word for sin,* ***hamartia*** *-* ***parabasis*** *has two components,* ***para****, which points to a close proximity/union and* ***bainos****, step, footprint - in this sense, a deviation; out of step - out of sync. In Adam mankind became out of sync with their true identity but didn't know it until the law revealed it - in Christ the same mankind became exceedingly righteous, but do not realize it until the gospel reveals it.)*

Rom. 5:15 The only similarity in the comparison between the [1]crash-landing and the gift, is that both Adam and Christ represent the masses. However, the grace gift lavished upon mankind in the one man Jesus Christ supersedes the effect of Adam's failure by far and is beyond comparison in significance to the idea of [2]death and separation. *(Now Paul introduces the word [1]****paraptoma****, from* ***para*** *closest possible proximity and* ***pipto****, to descend from a higher place to a lower – to stop flying. No wonder he urges us in Col 3:1-3 to engage our thoughts with the things that are above, where we are co-elevated and jointly enthroned in the heavenlies together with Christ! The word [2]****apothnesko****, death, suggests a separation; from* ***apo****, meaning any kind of separation of one thing from another by which the union or fellowship of the two is destroyed; also of a state of separation and distance. The word,* ***thnesko*** *means death.*

But God's free gift immeasurably outweighs the transgression. For if through the transgression of the one individual the mass of mankind have died, infinitely greater is the generosity wherewith God's grace, and the gift given in his grace which found expression in the one man Jesus Christ, have been bestowed on the mass of mankind.—Weymouth, 1912.)

Rom. 5:16 The principle of the gift speaks a different language and brings a radically different equation to the table. Whereas a single sin resulted in a judgment that concluded in condemnation; grace translates countless deviations into acquittal and innocence.

Rom. 5:17 Death no longer has the final say. Life rules! If the effect of one man's crash-landing engaged mankind in a death-dominated lifestyle how much more

advantaged is the very same mankind now that they are the recipients of the boundless reservoirs of grace, empowering them to enjoy the dominion of life through the gift of righteousness because of that one man, Jesus Christ. Grace is out of all proportion in superiority to the transgression. *(No, grace is not something you qualify for by receiving it! Grace already belongs to mankind without their permission! The words* ***οἱ λαμβάνοντες - [1]oi lambanontes*** *do not mean, to believingly accept, but simply the recipients! [the Present Active Participle Nominative] The word [2]**perisseia περισσεία** means super abundantly; that which exceeds all boundaries. Of course it doesn't take faith out of the equation! It gives context to faith! See verse 1&2. Faith isn't what you do in order to; it's what happens to you because of!)*

Rom. 5:18 The conclusion is clear: if one offence condemns the entire human race; then in principle, the righteousness of one vindicates the entire human race.

Rom. 5:19 The disobedience of the one [1]exhibits mankind as sinners; the obedience of another exhibits mankind as righteous. *(The word, [1]**kathistemi**, means to cause to be, to set up, to exhibit. We were not made sinners by our own disobedience; neither were we made righteous by our own obedience.)*

Rom. 5:20 The presence of the law made no difference, instead it merely high lighted the offence; but where sin increased, grace superseded it.

Rom. 5:21 Death provided sin its platform and power to reign from; now grace has taken over sovereignty through righteousness to introduce unthreatened life under the Lordship of Jesus Christ over us.

A simple equation: We were not made sinners by our own disobedience; neither were we made righteous by our own obedience.

The same humanity represented in the one man Adam, is triumphantly represented in the one man Jesus Christ!

Adam's transgression no longer holds the human race hostage.

The same humanity that fell under the spell of Adam's sin, are now addressed in the Gospel of Jesus Christ!

What God accomplished in Christ is beyond comparison and out of all proportion in effect to Adam's sin. Rom.5:18. Johnson

J.B. Phillips (1955) writes in the preface of his translation of the book of Acts, the following: "Now in much modern evangelism the main plank of the platform is the emphasis, again and again, upon the utter sinfulness of man."

The modern evangelist will shout that the Bible says, "All have sinned", and that, "There is none righteous, no not one." They will shout that the Bible says, "All our righteousness is as filthy rags." However, Luke in writing the Book of Acts seemingly knows nothing about this emphasis. He instead highlights the experience of Peter with Cornelius, when God persuades him to call no man common or unclean! Indeed the modern technique of arousing guilt by quoting isolated texts of Scripture is not found in the Book of Acts at all.

The effect of the "word of his grace" is evident in the Book of the Acts.

Acts 6:7 And the word of God increased; and the number of the disciples multiplied greatly in Jerusalem, and a great many of the priests were obedient to the faith.

Acts 14:3 So they remained for a long time, speaking boldly for the Lord, who bore witness to the word of his grace, granting signs and wonders to be done by their hands. RSV

The gospel declares humanity's innocence; it is the receipt that confirms their acquittal. In any transaction a receipt represents the documented detail and legal reference to effective payment; it is the written acknowledgement of such payment. The legal grounds for such a verdict are detailed in the preaching and teaching of the gospel of grace.

See Math 13:44 The man who redeemed the hidden treasure sold all he had, and bought the entire field!

The lost coin never lost its original value.

The fact that the treasure was hidden didn't diminish its authentic worth.

Jesus' shed blood was not to buy as back from the devil, a thief never gets ownership - Psalm 24:1. Neither was it to persuade his Father to forgive us - it was to persuade our minds of God's esteem of us and free us from the lies that we believed about ourselves. Hebrews 6:16,17

Many Christians can quote Romans 3:23 but sadly fail to memorize the good news is in the next verse! The glory that Adam lost on our behalf is now redeemed in Jesus.

There is no good news in telling people how condemned they are! The good news reveals how redeemed they are!

How God interprets the death and resurrection of Jesus gives ultimate definition and impact to the gospel. He now desires to capture our gaze to see what he saw in the fruit of the travail of his soul, so that we may know even as we have always been

known!

Isa. 53:11 He shall see the fruit of the travail of his soul and be satisfied; by his knowledge shall the righteous one, my servant, make many to be accounted righteous; and he shall bear their iniquities. RSV

Isa. 52:13 in the Septuagint reads, Behold my boy! The word, "servant" is only in the Masoretic Hebrew text which dates a thousand years later than the LXX.

Also Isa 53:4 Surely he has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows; *yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten by God, and afflicted.* Then, Isa 53:10 in the Septuagint! No! It did not "please the Lord to bruise him!!" *The Lord desires to cleanse his wounds - and in the offering of his life as sacrifice he shall see his seed afar off!* See verse 11 - the joy that is set before him! The offspring is the fruit of the travail of his soul! Heb 12:2, for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame!

The highlight of John 10:10 is not the fact that the thief came to steal, kill and destroy, but that Jesus came so that we might have life more abundantly!

Behold the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!

See Acts 10:14 But Peter said, "No, Lord; for I have never eaten anything that is common or unclean." Act 10:15 And the voice came to him again a second time, "What God has cleansed, you must not call common." Also Acts 10:28, and he said to them, "You yourselves know how unlawful it is for a Jew to associate with or to visit any one of another nation; but God has shown me that I should not call anyone common or unclean!"

2 Cor. 5:14 The love of Christ constrains us and [1]resonates within us; leaving us with only one [2]conclusion: when Jesus died; every individual simultaneously died. In God's logic, one has died for all, [2]thus all died. *(The word, [1]**sunecho**, to press together; to squeeze; from **sun**, meaning together with and **echo**, meaning to echo; to embrace; to hold; also, to resonate. The word αρα [2]**ara**, means conclusion. Jesus didn't die 99% or for 99%. He one hundred percent died humanity's death! If Paul had to compromise the last part of verse 14 to read: "one died for all therefore only those who follow the prescriptions to qualify, have also died," then he would have had to change the first half of the verse as well! Only the **agape** of Christ can make a calculation of such enormous proportion! The religious mind would question the extremity of God's love and perhaps prefer to add a condition or two to a statement like that!)*

No personal ambition, qualification, noble-birth, or achievement gives more

distinction or definition to the individual, than the fact of our identification and co-inclusion in Christ!

Phil. 3:4 I have more reason than anyone else to rely on my years of diligent and most sincere devotion to Jewish sentiment and rituals. If gaining God's approval had anything to do with striving and personal effort I would beat the best in the business! My pedigree is obvious:

Phil. 3:5 I received the famous cut when I was 8 days old, exactly as the law prescribed. I am Israeli by birth; the head of my tribe is Benjamin. I am a Hebrew of the Hebrews! In my observance of the law I belonged to the strictest party; I was proud to be a Pharisee. *(Rachel was the darling wife of Jacob; she died while giving birth to Benjamin; also the two tribes that did not revolt were Benjamin and Judah. By saying that he is a Hebrew of the Hebrews Paul emphasizes that his lineage from both parents side was not mixed with any Gentile blood.)*

Phil. 3:6 The extremities of my fervor were demonstrated in the way I fiercely opposed and persecuted anyone who identified themselves in Christ. *[The so-called Ekklesia.]* **If keeping the law and these credentials could possibly have given me a blameless standing before God, I had it made!**

Phil. 3:7 The sum total of my religious pedigree and sincere devotion amounts to zero! What we have been gifted with in Christ has reduced what once seemed so important, to meaningless information. To esteem the law is to your loss! Faith is your profit.

Phil. 3:8 In fact, I have come to the conclusion that every association I have had with that which defined me before as a devout Jew, is by far eclipsed by what I have gained in knowing the Messiah. Jesus Christ and his masterful redemption define me now. Religion is like dog pooh; and it stinks, avoid stepping in it!

Phil. 3:9 So here I am; found in Christ! I was looking in the wrong place all along! My own duty-and-guilt-driven religious endeavor snared me in the cul-de-sac maize of self-righteousness, sponsored by the law of works! The faith of Christ reveals my identity; righteousness defines who God believes that I really am. This righteousness is sourced in God and endorses the authority of faith. *(Faith is a fairy tale if Jesus is not the substance of it!)*

Phil. 3:10 Oh to comprehend the dynamic of his resurrection! His resurrection is evidence of our righteousness! In the revelation of God's economy of inclusion, I actually co-suffered with him and co-died together with Christ! *(Because I was*

already fully represented in his sufferings, his death and resurrection, I am greatly inspired when faced with contradictions now! Rom. 4:25.)

Paul guards with jealous zeal over this gospel:

Gal. 1:6 I am amazed that you can so easily be fooled into swapping the Gospel for a gimmick! The Gospel reveals the integrity of your original identity rescued in Christ; the gimmick is a conglomeration of grace and legalism. This mixture boils down to a do-it-yourself plan of salvation. *(Which is a recipe for disaster.)*

Gal. 1:7 There is no other gospel in spite of the many so-called Christian products branded "gospel." If any hint of the law remains, it is not good news but merely religious people's ideas, detracting from the gospel of Christ. *(Some seek to unsettle your minds by perverting the Gospel to accommodate their own opinion.)*

Gal. 1:8 I and any of my team would stand equally disqualified, even if we claim to have had a celestial angelic visitation, if what we preach were to stray ever so slightly from the Gospel of the finished work of Christ.

Gal. 1:9 Let me be blatant and clear about this: any gospel that does not emphasize the success of the cross is counterfeit and produces nothing but the curse!

Gal. 1:10 *(In sharp contrast to the time when I needed letters of authority from the religious institutions of the day, endorsing my mission)* **God is my complete persuasion. I answer to him alone, not anyone else. Christ employs me; I am addicted to his grace. Popular religious opinion will not influence me to compromise my message.** *(What is the point of an impressive CV, when your Maker is not even asking for it?)*

Gal. 1:11 I want to make it very clear to you my friends that the message I proclaim is not mere speculation or the product of philosophical or religious debate.

Gal. 1:12 This is not my own invention, neither was I spoon-fed by human tuition; my source of reference is the unveiled mystery of Christ in me. *(Even though we once knew Christ from a human point of view, we know him thus no longer. 2 Corinthians 5:16.)*

Gal. 3:6 Abraham had no other claim to righteousness but simply believing what God declared concerning him! Isaac confirmed God's faith, not Abraham's efforts. This is all we have in common with Abraham. *(Righteousness reveals God's faith as responsible for mankind's salvation in direct contrast to their doing it themselves by keeping moral laws!)*

Gal. 3:7 The conclusion is clear; faith and not flesh relates us to Abraham! *(Grace rather than law is our true lineage. Ishmael represents so much more than the Muslim religion. Ishmael represents the clumsy effort of the flesh to compete with faith; the preaching of a mixed message of law and grace.)*

Gal. 3:8 Scripture records prophetically that the mass of non-Jewish nations would be justified by faith and not by keeping moral laws. This announcement by God over Abraham is the gospel in advance. God saw every nation included in the same principle of the faith that Abraham pioneered. "In you all the nations of the earth are equally represented in the blessing of faith." *([Gen 22:17] I will indeed bless you, and I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven and as the sand which is on the seashore. And your seed shall possess the gate of their enemies, Gen 22:18 and by your seed shall all the nations of the earth bless themselves. Righteousness by faith is the revelation of the gospel; [Rom 1:17 and Hab 2:4] "the just shall live by his (God's) faith" Righteousness by faith defines your life!)*

Gal. 3:9 As did Abraham so do we now find our source in the blessing of faith.

Gal. 4:21 Since you are so intrigued by the law, please understand its prophetic message:

Gal. 4:22 The law records the fact that Abraham had two sons: one by a slave girl, the other by a free woman.

Gal. 4:23 The one is produced by the flesh *[the DIY-tree]*, **the other by faith** *[the promise]*.

Gal. 4:24 There is a parallel meaning in the story of the two sons: they represent two systems, works and grace.

Gal. 4:25 Sinai is an Arabian rocky mountain named after Hagar, *[outside the land of promise]*. **Its association with the law of Moses mirrors Jerusalem as the capital of Jewish legalism. Hagar is the mother of the law of works.**

Gal. 4:26 But the mother from above, the true mother of mankind is grace, the free Jerusalem; she is the mother of the promise.

1 Cor. 1:17 My mandate was not about winning members for some 'Christian club' through baptism! I am commissioned to declare the Good News without any strings attached; nothing to distract from the powerful effect of the revelation of the cross of Christ. *(The mystery of the cross is the revelation of mankind's inclusion in his death and resurrection [see 1 Cor 2:2,7].)*

1 Cor. 1:18 To their own loss the message of the cross seems foolish to some; but to us who discover our salvation there, it is the dynamic of God.

1 Cor. 1:19 Isaiah wrote: I will confuse the wisdom of the "so-called" wise and prove their experts wrong. *(Isa 29:14.)*

1 Cor. 1:20 God's wisdom puts the rest out of business! They have all closed shop; the philosophers, the academics, the smooth-talkers, the lot. *(When it comes to real answers to the dilemma of mankind, God's wisdom, revealed in the foolishness of the cross, is the currency of the Gospel.)*

1 Cor. 1:21 By suspicious scrutiny the sense-ruled world surveys the works of God in creation and still do not recognize or acknowledge him; in sharp contrast to this, the foolishness of the message we proclaim brings God's work of redeeming his image in us into faith's focus. *(What we preach cancels every basis for boasting in personal contribution, which seems folly to the DIY systems of this world.)*

1 Cor. 1:22 The Jews crave signs *[to confirm their doubts]* **while the Greeks revel in philosophical debate!** *(Both groups are addicted to the same soul realm.)*

1 Cor. 1:23 The crucified Christ is the message we publicly proclaim, to the disgust of the Jews while the Greeks think we are wacky.

1 Cor. 1:24 The dynamic of God's wisdom is the fact that both Jew and Greek are equally included and defined in Christ.

1 Cor. 1:25 It seems so foolish that God should die mankind's death on the cross; it seems so weak of God to suffer such insult; yet their wisest schemes and most powerful display of genius cannot even begin to comprehend or compete with God in his weakest moment on the cross.

1 Cor. 1:26 You might as well admit it, my friends; it was not your academic qualifications or your good looks or social connections that influenced God to represent you in Christ.

1 Cor. 1:27 It is almost as if God deliberately handpicked the wacky of this world to embarrass the wise, the rejects to put to shame the noble.

1 Cor. 1:28 The ones with no pedigree of any prominence, the "nobodies" in society, attracted God's initiative to unveil his blueprint opinion in order to redefine mankind. Thus he rendered any other social standard entirely irrelevant, redundant and inappropriate. *(Blueprint opinion, **eklegomai**, from **ek**, meaning origin, source, and **legomai** from **logos**, the logic of God; traditionally translated as*

"elect".)

1 Cor. 1:29 Every reason for someone's boasting in themselves dwindles into insignificance before God.

1 Cor. 1:30 [1]Of God's doing are we in Christ. He is both the genesis and genius of our wisdom; a wisdom that reveals how righteous, sanctified and redeemed we already are in him. *(The Preposition, [1]**ek**, always denotes origin, source. Mankind's association in Jesus is God's doing. In God's economy, Jesus Christ represents us; what mankind could never achieve through personal discipline and willpower as taught in every religion, God's faith accomplished in Christ. Of his design we are in Christ; we are associated in oneness with him. Our wisdom is sourced in this union! Also, our righteousness and holiness originate from him. Holiness equals wholeness and harmony of a person's spirit, soul, and body. Our redemption is sanctioned in him. He redeemed our identity, our sanity, our health, our joy, our peace, our innocence, and our complete well-being! [See Eph 1:4]. The Knox Translation reads, "It is from him that we take our [1]origin.")*

1 Cor. 1:31 He is our claim to fame. *(This is what Jeremiah meant when he wrote: "Let not the wise glory in their wisdom, let not the mighty glory in their might, let not the rich glory in their riches; but let the one who glories glory in this, that they understand and know me, that I am the Lord who practice steadfast love, justice, and righteousness in the earth; for in these things do I delight, says the Lord." Jer. 9:23, 24.)*

1 Cor. 2:2 My [1]mind is fully made up about you! The only possible way in which I can truly [2]know you, is in the light of God's mystery, which is [3]Christ in you! Jesus died mankind's death on the cross and thus brought final closure to any other basis of [1]judgment! *(The word, [1]**krino**, to judge, to determine, to deem in a forensic sense, here, in the Aorist Tense, **ekrina,** which suggests a once and for all completed act. The Aorist tense presents an occurrence in summary, viewed as a whole from the outside, almost like a snapshot of the action. Paul makes a very bold and radical statement, confining his ministry focus to "know" the full scope and consequence of the revelation of mankind's redeemed innocence as communicated in the cross of Jesus Christ! This is the essence of the mystery of God! "For I determined to [2]know [- [2]**eido**, to see, to perceive] nothing in you except Jesus Christ and him crucified." Nothing else! Not the latest gossip or popular news events! He says in 2 Cor 5:14,16, The love of Christ leads to this conclusion, one has died for all - therefore all died! From now on therefore, I no longer know ANYONE from a human point of view!*

*Paul continues to unfold the mystery of our redeemed oneness! In the previous chapter, he concludes that we are **in Christ** by God's doing; here he clearly points to [3]**Christ in us**! [As Jesus declared in John 14:20]*

See 2 Cor 3:4 Christ is proof of our persuasion about you before God. Also 2 Cor 1:18 God's certainty is our persuasion; there is no maybe in him! 2 Cor 1:19 The Son of God, Jesus Christ, whom I, Paul, Sylvanus and Timothy boldly announced in you is God's ultimate yes to mankind. Human life is associated in all that he is. In God's mind, there exists not even a hint of hesitation about this! Also Gal 1:16 and Col 1:27.)

1 Cor. 2:3 I felt completely inadequate; you know that it was not my eloquent speech that persuaded you. I was so nervous that my whole body was trembling with stage fright!

1 Cor. 2:4 My message was not with persuasive arguments based on secular wisdom, since my aim was [1]not to point people to me but rather to the powerful working of the Spirit in them. *(Thayer's Greek definition of [1]**apodeiknumi** is to point away from one's self. Previous translations of this word have often given the impression that the great, miracle-working man of God would steal the show and entertain the crowds! This was so unlike Jesus and Paul! Paul never writes about how many people he had healed and brought to faith, etc. His all-consuming concern was that the eyes of our understanding would be illuminated with the revelation of Christ in us.*

Note 2 Corinthians 10:10 [RSV], "For they say, 'His letters are weighty and strong, but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech of no account.'" Also, 2 Corinthians 11:6, "Even if I am unskilled in speaking, I am not in knowledge." — RSV.)

1 Cor. 2:5 Mankind's wise schemes of influence could never match the power of God as reference to your faith.

1 Cor. 2:6 The words we speak resonate revelation wisdom in those who understand how perfectly redeemed they are in Christ, this wisdom supersedes every secular kind; suddenly what once seemed wise and good advice has become useless information. *(All popular programs towards improved moral behavior are now outdated. "Of God's doing are we in Christ. He is both the genesis and genius of our wisdom; a wisdom that reveals how righteous, sanctified, and redeemed we already are in him." In God's economy, Christ represents us; what mankind could never achieve through personal discipline and willpower as taught in every religion, God's faith accomplished in Christ [1 Cor 1:30].)*

1 Cor. 2:7 We voice words of wisdom that were hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's [1]Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in man. Our glorification has always been God's agenda, even [2]before time was. *(Paul employs the words, [1]**prohoritso**, predesigned and [2]**pro aion** before the ages, in order to emphasize the certainty of God's persuasion concerning their determined intent to rescue and restore their image and likeness in us. Our redemption existed upon the inner-horizons of God before the ages. The word, **prohoritso**, from **pro**, before and **horitso**, horizon; means pre-defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan. See Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that we pre-existed in God; he defines us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory that we lost in Adam.)*

1 Cor. 2:8 Neither the politicians nor the religious leaders of the day had a clue about this mystery; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory! *(Time witnessed and recorded the death and resurrection of an individual; eternity witnessed the death and resurrection of the human race!)*

Mankind's inclusion in Christ is the conclusion of grace - Chapter 10

The Prophets saw it

Isa 9:2 The people who walk in darkness have seen a great light. The ones who dwell in the land of the shadow of death, on them, light shone.

See Isa 40:3-5 A voice cries: In the wilderness prepare the way of the Lord, make straight in the desert a highway for our God. Every valley shall be lifted up, and every mountain and hill be made low; the crooked places shall be made straight, even the rough places shall be made smooth. And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together, for the mouth of the LORD has spoken."

In the incarnate Christ, God removed every definition of distance; every possible excuse humanity could have to feel separated from God was removed once and for all.

Isa. 66:8 "Who has heard of such a thing? Who has seen such things? Shall the earth be born in one day? Shall all people be brought forth in one moment?"

The only scripture in the entire Old Testament that prophesies the third day resurrection includes us!

Hos. 6:2. After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will raise us up, that we may live before him. RSV

Our co-inclusion in Jesus' death and resurrection was prophesied 800 years B.C. through Hosea and 700 B.C. by Isaiah.

Is 52:10 The LORD has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God.

Is 52:14-15 As many were astonished at him, his appearance was so marred, beyond human semblance, and his form beyond that of the sons of men, so shall he startle many nations; kings shall shut their mouths because of him; for that which has not been told them they shall see, and that which they have not heard they shall understand.

Isa. 53:1-3 Who has believed what we have heard? And to whom has the arm of the LORD been revealed? For he grew up before him like a young plant, and like a root out of dry ground; he had no form or comeliness that we should look at him, and no

beauty that we should desire him. He was despised and rejected by men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief; and as one from whom men hide their faces he was despised, and we esteemed him not.

Isa. 53:4-7 Surely he has borne our grief's and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten by God, and afflicted. But he was wounded by our transgressions, he was bruised by our iniquities; upon him was the chastisement that made us whole, and with his stripes we were healed. All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned everyone to his own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all. He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth; like a lamb that is led to the slaughter, and like a sheep that before its shearers is dumb, so he opened not his mouth.

Psalm 22 graphically portrays the crucifixion then concludes in verse 27 with, "All the ends of the earth shall remember and turn to the LORD; and all the families of the nations shall worship before him."

Isa. 45: 22 Face me and be saved all the ends of the earth! *[Note, 'Be saved!' Not 'become saved!']* I am God; your idols are figments of your invention and imagination!"

Isa. 45:23 I have sworn by myself; the word of my mouth has begotten righteousness; this cannot be reversed! (The Hebrew word, יצא ***Yatsa*** *can be translated, begotten like in Judges 8:30 "Every knee shall bow to me and every tongue shall echo my oath!" [Thus, speak with the same certainty sourced in me!] The Hebrew word,* שבע ***Shaba*** *means to seven oneself, that is, swear - thus in the Hebrew mind, by repeating a declaration seven times one brings an end to all dispute! See Heb. 6:13.16,17.)*

Peter saw it

In dramatic fashion God re-writes Peters doctrine and changes his appetite! Acts 10:28 "God has shown me that I should not call any person common or unclean."

It's when we see what Peter saw when God challenged his paradigms in Acts 10. I mean the man's hungry, and when a Jew gets hungry he's supposed to see favorite food pop-ups! But instead God shows him every unclean animal alive in their skins, feathers, warts and scales! Not neatly chopped up into a "Gumbo" or stew, and flavored with favorite spices! Alive, dirty and ugly! This happened three times; even with Peter trying his best take on a favorite scripture (Don't eat anything unclean, remember!) God shows him in v 28 that he may no longer call anyone unclean or

unholy!!

We have so underestimated what God did when Jesus died humanity's death! Behold the Lamb OF GOD who takes away the sin of the world! He did it once and for all long before anyone but God believed it! And without our permission!

1 Pet. 1:3 Let us [1]celebrate God with articulate acclaim! He is the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. According to his matchless mercy and tender compassions, he [2]birthed us again when Jesus was raised from the dead. Now we are alive to witness the [3]expectation of the ages unfold! *(The word, [1]**eulogetos**, means to brag, to bless, to speak well of. Jesus reminds Nicodemus that we are born **anouthen**, from above. [John 3:3, and John 3:13] No one can fully engage in heaven's perspective, unless one's heavenly origin is realized! The Son of man declares mankind's co-genesis from above and now through our joint resurrection, we are reconnected again to our original identity as sons. The word [2]**anagennao**, from **ana**, upward, [reconnecting with **anouthen** - Jn 3:3 - from above, where we came from in the first place]; and **gennao**, to regenerate, to give birth. As much as his death brought dramatic closure to our futile and failed attempts to justify and define ourselves, our co-resurrection rebooted the original blueprint of our Maker's image and likeness in us. [3]"A living hope" - the expectation of the ages concluding in life. See Colossians 1:27 - The mystery of the ages is unveiled! Christ in us!)*

Peter realized that something happened to mankind in the death and resurrection of Jesus. Flesh and blood did not reveal this to him; he saw that we were hewn out of that same rock tomb!

Luke saw it

Acts 13:32-33 And we bring you the good news that what God promised to the fathers, this he has fulfilled to us their children by raising Jesus; as also it is written in the second psalm, "You are my Son, today I have begotten you."

The resurrection of Jesus declares humanity's new birth.

Luke 13:23 Someone observed, Lord, so it seems that only a few are being saved? Jesus answered this person by speaking specifically to the religious Jews, who are part of his audience, but who witness him through their legalistic lenses and miss the entire plot!

Luke 13:28 To your shock and surprise you will eventually realize, that even your national heroes, Abraham, Isaac and Jacob as well as the prophets *(who you*

murdered), **are in the house! And they didn't get there by their own personal, agonizing efforts!** *(The phrase, weeping and gnashing of teeth is thought to derive from the hypothetical Q source, which "quoted" Matthew 8:12 and Luke 13:28. The other five occurrences [Matthew 13:42, Matthew 13:50, Matthew 22:13, Matthew 24:51, and Matthew 25:30] are all within the context of parables and are widely held to be redactional additions by Matthew.)*

Luke 13:29 And they will arrive from the rising of the sun in the east to its setting in the west and from the north and the south and recline at the banquet in the kingdom of God.

Luke 13:30 And you will observe that there are those who seemed to be least important in your estimate *[the Gentiles]*, **to arrive first and eventually, those who thought they were leading the procession** *[the Jews]*, **will also arrive!** *(Thus, Jesus concludes his answer to the question, "So, are only a few being saved?" Luke 13:23*

Luke 15:1 Now all the people of reputation, the infamous tax-collectors as well as your regular sinners, were in the habit of crowding Jesus. They were magnetically drawn to him, addicted to his conversation.

Luke 15:2 But the Pharisees and Law Professors were furiously complaining about the warm hospitality with which Jesus embraced these people in their frequent banquets. *(In the following three stories, Jesus justifies their frequent festivity!)*

Luke 15:3 The constant murmuring of the professional religious leaders inspired this story.

Luke 15:4 Imagine you have a hundred sheep and one is lost; who of you would not leave the ninety-nine in the wilderness and go in search of the lost one, until he finds it?

Luke 15:5 And when he finds it, he rejoices and lifts it on his shoulders.

Luke 15:6 Then, as soon as he arrives home, he invites all his friends and neighbors to join him in celebration of his lost and found sheep.

Luke 15:7 I tell you, this mirrors heaven's joy over the one [1]out of sync person who [2]awakens to their authentic identity, rather than over the ninety nine, who [3]supposedly understand who they are and therefore need no persuasion. *(The ninety-nine [3]other sheep, is a reflection of the religious Pharisees and also reminds of the other brother in the third story, who didn't join the party, neither did he enjoy the benefits of true sonship, since he thought he was ok! The condition of the "lost"*

*sheep **[apollumi]** is compared to the word, αμαρτωλός **hamartōlos**, "sinner" from **ha**, negative and **meros**, portion or form; thus, to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**; as in 2 Cor 3:18, the word **metamorphe**, with form; which is the opposite of **hamartolos**. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. It suggests anything that could possibly distract from the awareness of our likeness. The word, **metanoia** suggests an awakening of one's mind.)*

Luke 15:8 Or, what woman who has ten silver coins and loses one, will not immediately light a lamp, sweep the entire house, and with the utmost scrutiny search every nook and cranny, until she finds it!

Luke 15:9 And when she finds it, she calls her friends and neighbors to come and celebrate with her that she has found her precious coin. *(The lost coin never lost it's original value! Neither its authentic image and inscription, as pointed out by Jesus in another conversation, where he mentions the image and inscription on the coin in answering the question about taxes; then he says, "return to Caesar what belongs to Caesar and [whose image and inscription do you bear?!] return to God what belongs to God!)*

Luke 15:10 I tell you, the faces of the celestial messengers light up with joy over a single person who [1]re-discovers their authentic value and identity. *(Note, the Greek word, **metanoia**, from **meta**, together with and νοιέω **noieō**, to perceive with the mind. It describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing. Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery. It has nothing in common with the Latin word **paenitentia** - where the idea of penance and repentance stems from!)*

Luke 15:11 Then he continued, A certain man had two sons,

Luke 15:12 The youngest approached his father and said, Father, give me my share of our inheritance. So, the father gave them his life. *(See Luke 15:31 "All that I have is yours!" Jesus shows the Father in a different light to the ideas they've had of the god of their law! Deut 21:18-21. See John 14:9.)*

Luke 15:13 Within a few days the young man had gathered all his belongings and left to a foreign country far away from home. There was nothing holding him back now, and he soon squandered his inheritance, living it up without any restraint.

Luke 15:14 By now he exhausted his resources and to make matters worse, a severe famine gripped that land. He began to be in dire need.

Luke 15:15 So he journeyed further into the country and attached himself to a local citizen who sent him into his fields to shepherd his pigs.

Luke 15:16 He was so desperately hungry that he was even craving to fill his stomach with the pods that the pigs were feeding on, but no one would allow him to.

Luke 15:17 At this point he [1]came to his senses! Thinking out loud he said, My father has many hirelings working for him, and everyone has more than enough to eat, and here I am, dying of hunger. *(The word, [1]**erchomai**, to come - **eis heauton** to one's self - to one's senses; to return to self - [Greek English Lexicon by C.Grimm Wilke.]*

This reminds of the Genesis story; the Sword would always point back to mankind's original identity. The Hebrew word in Gen 3:24, [where the cherub with the flaming sword was positioned at the Eastern Gate of Eden], the word, הפך ***hâpak*** *is a primitive root; meaning to turn about; by implication to change, to return, to be converted, turn back. Here, in Luke 15 the prodigal son returns to himself - Plato is quoted by Ackerman [Christian Element in Plato] as thinking of redemption as coming to oneself!*

Though he turned to himself, he did not find himself in his shame - he found himself in his father's embrace!)

Luke 15:18 He was up and ready to go and began to rehearse what he would do, I will travel home to face my father and tell him that I have sinned against heaven and before him;

Luke 15:19 I will convince him that I am no longer worthy to be called his son and beg him to employ me as one of his hired servants!

Luke 15:20 And with that, he got up and began the return journey to his father. He was yet a long way from home when his father saw him and, filled with compassion, ran to his son, flung his arms around his neck and kissed him fondly.

Luke 15:21 When the son caught his breath, he began his rehearsed sinner's prayer, Father, I have sinned before heaven and in your face, I am not worthy to be known as your son...

Luke 15:22 The father wasn't paying any attention to this and didn't give him a chance to finish his rehearsed plea; he merely instructed his slaves to immediately bring out the best robe and clothe him in it and give him a ring to put on his finger

and shoes for his feet!

Luke 15:23 In full anticipation for his son's return, he now also had the grain-fattened calf brought and slaughtered. It was party-time! So, "with our minds flooded with joy, let the merry celebrations begin!" *(The word, εὐφραίνεσθαι **euphrainesthai** from **eu**, good, celebrating goodness and well being; well done! And **phren**, mind; thus to be celebrating in a merry frame of mind.)*

Luke 15:24 This is the reason for our joy: my son here, was dead, and he was revived! He seemed to be lost forever, but here he is, found! And so they began their merry celebrations.

Luke 15:25 The older brother was returning from the field and approaching the house, he heard what sounded like a concert of instruments and a choir of voices singing and dancing.

Luke 15:26 Alarmed, he called one of the boy-servants and asked him what this was all about.

Luke 15:27 The boy answered, Your brother is here. So, your father sacrificed the grain-fattened calf to celebrate your brother returning home in good health.

Luke 15:28 The news enraged the older brother who had no desire to join them. Then his father went out and [1]pleaded with him. *(The word [1]**parakaleo**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **kaleo**, meaning to identify by name.)*

Luke 15:29 He answered his father, Consider the many years that I have toiled for you like a slave! And at no time did I ever dodge any of your commandments; yet, you never considered rewarding me, even with a little lamb, so I could party with my friends!

Luke 15:30 However, when this son of yours comes here, having devoured your savings by wasting it on prostitutes, you slay the grain-fattened calf!

Luke 15:31 He said to him, My dear child, you are always with me and all that I have is yours!

Luke 15:32 To now have our minds flooded with merriness and exceeding joy is fitting, because your own brother was dead and he is alive again. He was lost and is found! *(In all three stories, the term lost implies ownership - you cannot be lost unless*

you belong.

Jesus again, points the Pharisees and the law professors to the fact that the Gentiles and the Jews have the same Father and share the same value and heirship! Sonship squandered, reduces life to slavery - this was true for both brothers in the story.

Oh, the beauty of a Father who is not offended by the 'other' brother's initial attitude, but pleads with the same urgency—"My boy, Come join the party!"

I can even see the stubborn brother beginning to tap his feet because of the irresistible appeal of the festive sound and the constant echo of the Father's invitation.

Sin is singular - its symptoms are plural - its been a sonship thing from the beginning - no wonder Jesus says freedom indeed is found in the truth of our authentic and redeemed sonship - Sin is not about things you do or don't do - sin is missing out on sonship!

Would you say that the church in all its many groupings have "successfully converted" about 10 percent (or even 1% perhaps!) of the entire human population? While Jesus reveals in this amazing story that 99 sheep in the fold is not enough! He goes after the last one, not out of a sense of duty until he finally gives up on it, but, he seeks UNTIL he finds the one!

The GOOD NEWS is that the lost sheep, the lost coin, the lost son, are now all found safe and sound in Jesus!

His death was the doorway into the very domain in which mankind was held prisoner; he descended into the darkest and deepest dungeons of our lostness and in the resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Eph 4:8,9.

His return to the Father is humanity's return!

The problem is, most people [including most Bible believers] don't know it! This is why we live our lives with persuasion, intent and passion to tell them! Isa 40:9.

Multitudes are in hell on this side of the grave; we have the keys to unlock a door that was already opened when Jesus went there as a man to free the human race from Adam till Noah to now! Wow, what joy to introduce people to the freedom of sonship! Let's not make the other brother our reference when we can know the Father's heart!)

You cannot be lost unless you belong, to begin with!

Psalm 24:1 The earth is the Lord's and the fullness of it!

Col. 2:14 His body nailed to the cross hung there as the [3]document of mankind's guilt; in dying our death he [1]cancelled the detailed [2]hand-written [3]record which testified against us. Every [1]stain on our conscience, reminding of the sense of failure and guilt, was thus fully blotted out. *(The word, [1]**exaleipho**, comes from **ek**, out of, and **aleipho**, with **a,** as a particle of union, and **liparos**, to grease, to leave a stain; guilt, as well as all hurtful memories were like grease stains upon the conscience. In N.T. only here and Rev 3:5; 7:17; 21:4 and in Acts 3:19 "Be awakened in your minds and fully converted to face the fact of your redeemed innocence - your sins have been thoroughly blotted out!" Plato used it of blotting out a writing. The word, [2]**cheirographon**, translates as hand-written. The word, [3]**dogma**, comes from **dokeo**, a thought pattern; thus thought patterns engraved by human experience of constant failure to do what the law required. In his personal handwriting mankind endorsed their own death sentence. The hands of fallen mankind struck the body of Jesus with the blows of their religious hatred and fury when they nailed his bloodied body to the tree; they did not realize that in the mystery of God's economy, Jesus became the scapegoat of the entire human race! [Isaiah 53:4, 5] See notes on Heb 8:12. "The slate wiped clean, that old arrest warrant cancelled and nailed to Christ's Cross." —The Message.)*

Col. 2:15 In him dying mankind's death, he [1]defused every possible claim of accusation against the human race and thus made a public [2]spectacle of every [3]rule and authority in God's brilliant triumph, demonstrated in him. The [4]voice of the cross will never be silenced! *(The horror of the Cross is now the eternal trophy of God's triumph over sin! The cross stripped religion of its authority to manipulate mankind with guilt. Every accusation lost its leverage to blackmail the human race with condemnation and shame! The word, [1]**apekduomai**, is translated from **apo**, away from, and **ekduo**, to be stripped of clothing; to disarm; the religious facade that disguised the law of works as a means of defining a person's life, was openly defeated. Same word used in Col 3:9. The dominance of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil [**poneros**, hard work and labor] was ended. The word, [2]**deikmatizo**, means to exhibit in public. See [3]commentary below of the words **arche**, rule and **exousia**, authority. The word, [4]**parresia**, comes from **pas**, all and **rheo**, outspokenness, pouring forth speech.*

"He stripped all the spiritual tyrants in the universe of their sham authority at the Cross

and marched them naked through the streets." — The Message

See commentary for 1 Corinthians 15:24, The complete conclusion in his work of redemption is celebrated in his yielding the full harvest of his reign to God the Father, having brought to nought the law of works which supported every definition of dominion under the fall, including all ***principalities****, all authority and every dynamic influence in society. [He brought to nought the law of works,* ***katargeo****, from* ***kata****, meaning intensity, and* ***argos****, meaning labor; thus free from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ. All principalities, [3]****arche****, or chief ranks, i.e., kings, governors; this includes any governing system whereby one is ranked above the other on the basis of their performance or preference. All authority, [3]****exousia****, comes from* ***ek****, denoting origin and* ***eimi****, I am; in this case, because of what I can do I am defined by what I can do better than you; therefore, I have authority over you. Every dynamic influence in society,* ***dunamis****, means power, in this case, willpower. Every government structure in society will be brought under the dominion of grace where the Christ-life rules.]*

In 1 Corinthians 2:7-8, We voice words of wisdom that was hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in mankind. Neither the politicians nor the theologians of the day had a clue about this mystery [of mankind's association in Christ]; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory!)

Eph. 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our [1]deviations, we were [2]co-quickened together with Christ! We had nothing to do with it. Grace [3]freed us, once and for all from the lies that we believed about ourselves under the performance-driven system, and now [4]defines our authentic identity! *(The word often translated, trespasses, παράπτωμα [1]****paraptoma****, deviation; from* ***para*** *close proximity and* ***pipto****, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to stop flying,* ***petomai****, to fly. Losing altitude speaks of mankind's fallen mindset. Col 3:1-3. The verb συνεζωοποιησεν [2]****sunetzoopoiesen*** *[co-quickened] is the Aorist Active Indicative, describing an action that was completed in the past. The sentence,* ***χάριτί [2]ἐστε [3]σεσῳσμένοι*** *- literally translates, "By grace you are - having been saved!" The verb, [4]****este*** *is the Present Active Indicative of* ***eimi****, I am - indicating the continues state of your being which celebrates an [3]unstoppable freedom that happened in your favor! The verb [3]****sesoosmenoi****, having been rescued; is the Perfect Passive Participle, describing a state that exists, as a result of something that happened*

previously. The basic thought of the Perfect Tense is that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. In other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now in existence. We had no contribution to our salvation! God's Master-Plan unfolded in the mystery of the gospel declaring our joint inclusion in Christ's death and resurrection. This is the mystery of grace, God reveals us in Christ! Now we may know, even as we have always been known! 1 Cor 13:12. Of God's doing are we in Christ! 1 Cor 1:30. God saw us in Christ, in his death and resurrection before we saw ourselves there! He declared mankind's co-resurrection with Christ 800 BC. This is the only scripture in the entire Old Testament that specifically mentions the third day resurrection and it includes us! "After two days he will revive us, on the third day, he will raise us up!" Hosea 6:2.)

Eph. 2:6 We are co-included in his resurrection. We are also co-elevated in his ascension to be equally present in the throne room of the heavenly realm where we are co-seated with him in his executive authority. We are fully represented in Christ Jesus. *(We have wasted so much time trying to get there, when "there" is where we are to begin with! Our joint position in Christ defines us; this can never again be a distant goal to reach through religious devotion or striving, but our immediate location. Col 3:1-3.)*

Eph. 2:7 *(In a single triumphant act of righteousness God saved us from the "guttermost" to the uttermost. Here we are now, revealed in Christ in the highest possible position of bliss! If mankind's sad history could not distract from the extravagant love of God,)* **imagine how God is now able for timeless perpetuity to exhibit the trophy of the wealth of his grace demonstrated in his kindness towards us in Christ Jesus. Grace exhibits excessive evidence of the success of the cross.**

Eph. 2:8 Your salvation is not a reward for good behavior! It was a grace thing from start to finish; you had no hand in it. Even the gift to believe simply reflects his faith! *(Again, as in Eph 2:5 Paul says, χάριτί ἐστε σεσῳσμένοι* ***chariti este sesoosmenoi****, "By grace you are, having been saved from the "I am not-lie" by the gift of faith; grace reveals who we are and the faith of God persuades us of it. We did not invent faith; it was God's faith to begin with! It is from faith to faith says Paul in Romans 1:17. Jesus is both the source and conclusion of faith. Heb 12:2.)*

Eph. 2:9 If this could be accomplished through any action of yours then there would be ground for boasting.

Eph. 4:8 [1]Scripture confirms that he [3]arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! *["he took captivity captive"]* **And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he [2]repossessed what belonged to us by design, [4]in human form; this is his grace-gift to us!** *(In this verse Paul explains what he just declared in verse 7 - he wants us to know the extravagant extent and dimensions of the measure of the gift of Christ! Remember that he is writing from prison [Eph 4:1] He's not asking for prayers to get him out of jail! He is imprisoned in Christ - [4:1] my complete existence is defined and confined in him! He was once a prisoner of the law of performance, held hostage in his own body, crying in desperation, "Is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap?" [Rom 7] He now speaks as a prisoner of Christ! He is reminded of and obviously intrigued by the entire context of Psalm 67 which celebrates God rescuing the prisoners from their captivity and even the wayward and stubborn, who already died and are stuck in their graves! [mindsets] See Ps 67:6,7 He is the father of the orphans, and protector of the widows. God settles the lonely in a home; leading forth prisoners mightily, also the stubborn, even them that dwell in tombs! Paul sees by revelation the relevance of Jesus dying our death and entering into our darkness and hell on a rescue mission! Now he [1]quotes Ps 67:19 [from the LXX Septuagint - the Greek OT which is Ps 68 in the Masoretic Hebrew text], and sees captive mankind arrested in the death, descent into hell and the triumphant resurrection of the incarnate Word, in the man Jesus Christ. Ps 67:19 ἀνέβης εἰς ὕψος, ᾐχμαλώτευσας αἰχμαλωσίαν, ἔλαβες δόματα ἐν ἀνθρώπῳ - **anebes eis hupsos, [3]echmaloteusas aichmaloosian, [2]elabes domata en** [in] **[4]anthropo** "You ascended on high, having taken captivity captive [**[3]arresting at spearpoint**! See 2 Cor 10:5] and [2]**repossessed mankind's gifts** in human form. The word [2]**elabes** from **lambano** means to take what is one's own. The word for the [4]human species, male or female is [4]**anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner. [The Masoretic Hebrew text, Ps 68:18,19, לקחת מתנות באדם **lakachat mattanoth ba adam** - "You have taken gifts in Adam." **The gifts which Jesus Christ distributes to us he has received in us, in and by virtue of his incarnation!** Adam Clarke.]*

*Ps 67:19 LXX continues: καὶ γὰρ ἀπειθοῦντες τοῦ κατασκηνῶσαι - **kai gar apeithountes tou kataskenoosai,** "in order that even the unbelievers, **apeithountes** - the ones resisting persuasion, the backsliding, the headstrong, the wayward, the rebellious may rest; or may now inhabit - **kataskenosai** - to encamp within - again this word*

*emphasizes the significance of the incarnation - **kata**, down and **skenosai**, from **skenos** - skin! The eternal thoughts of God, the conversation that was before time was, is clothed in skin! John 1:1-3,14.*

See Rev 13:10, Being taken captive by the spear and killed by the sword [John 18:3] made death a doorway into the very domain in which mankind was held prisoner, [to be led out triumphantly in the resurrection as the Lamb's trophies!] After two days he will revive us! On the third day he will raise us up! Hosea 6:2 We were born anew in his resurrection. 1 Pet 1:3. Also Ephesians 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our deviations, we were co-quickened together with Christ!)

Eph. 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. *(See John 3:13, "No one has ascended into heaven but he who [1]descended from heaven, even the son of man." All mankind originate from above; we are [1]**anouthen**, from above [see Jas 1:17, 18].)*

Eph. 4:10 He now occupies the ultimate rank of authority, from the lowest regions of our darkness into which he reached in order to rescue us, to the highest authority in the heavens, having executed his mission to the full. *(Fallen mankind is restored to the authority of the authentic life of their design. [Psa 139:7,8 Whither shall I go from your Spirit? Or whither shall I flee from your presence? If I ascend to heaven, You! If I make my bed in Sheol, You!] Eph 1:20,21.)*

Gal. 2:18 Only a con artist will try to be a law-man and a grace-man at the same time!

Gal. 2:19 The law [1]demanded my death; grace reveals that in God's mind Jesus died that death. So as far as the law is concerned, I'm a dead man but as far as God is concerned I'm alive! *(The word [1]**dia** means because of; suggesting here that the law was what demanded my death! But in the mystery of God's genius, Jesus died mankind's death; which means, in God's belief, I died to the old system of trying to please him with my own good behavior! We might as well admit it! Our most sincere beliefs as well as our best attempts to attain to a righteousness based on us getting ten out of ten all the time, failed! There is no ways to get around this! See Romans chapter 7 in the Mirror Bible!)*

Gal. 2:20 So here I am dead and alive at the same time! I'm dead to the old me I was trying to be and alive to the real me which is Christ in me! Co-crucified, now co-alive! What a glorious entanglement! I was in him in his death; now I discover

that he is infused in me, in my life! For the first time, I'm free to be me in my skin, immersed in his faith in our joint-sonship! He loves me and believes in me! He is God's gift to me! *(The verb* [1]***συνεσταυρωμαι*** *from* ***sustauroō****, is in the Perfect Tense, indicating that not only was I crucified with Christ in the past, but I am existing now in that present condition. How can any human effort improve on this! See Hosea 6:2 and Eph 2:5 also Romans 7:6 But now we are fully released from any further association with a life directed by the rule of the law, we are dead to that which once held us captive, free to be slaves to the newness of spirit-spontaneity rather than age old religious rituals, imitating the mere face value of the written code. The moment one exchanges spontaneity with rules, the edge of romance is compromised!*

See 1 Thess 5:10 The fact that he died our death is equally valid to those who are awake to its effect or still fast asleep in their indifference to it; we are together destined to live entwined in the [1]*closest possible association with him! [The word* [1]***hama*** *is a particle of union denoting close association.])*

Gal. 2:21 It is an insult to the grace of God to prefer Moses to Jesus! If the law could justify you then Jesus wasted his time dying your death! *(That would reduce salvation to a ludicrous contest between your obedience and the obedience of Christ! Rom 5:19.)*

Rom. 6:5 If we were included in his death we are equally included in his resurrection.

Col. 2:10 We are complete in him! Jesus mirrors our wholeness and [1]**endorses our true identity. He is "I am" in us!** *(God packaged completeness in "I am," mirrored in you! The word,* [1]***exousia****, is often translated authority; from,* ***ek*** *+* ***eimi****, originating out of "I am." The days are over where our lives were dictated to under the rule of the law of performance and an inferior identity. It's not about who I used to be or who I'm striving to become; we are celebrating I am! Any teaching that leaves one with a sense of lack and imperfection rather than completeness is a distraction from the truth. Jesus is the author and finisher of faith's capacity within us to mirror and celebrate completeness!)*

Col. 2:11 You were in Christ when he died which means that his death represents your true circumcision. Sin's authority in the human body was deleted you in him dying your death.

Col. 2:12 In the same parallel *[your co-circumcision in his death]* **your co-burial and joint-resurrection is now demonstrated in baptism; your co-inclusion in Christ is**

what God's faith knew when he powerfully raised him from the dead. *(Hosea 6:2.)*

Col. 2:13 You were once spiritually dead, as confirmed in your constant failure, being bound to a lifestyle ruled by the [1]distorted desires of the flesh; but now God made you alive together with him and thus [2]graciously restored our innocence and dignity, having forgiven us all our [3]short fallings. *([1]The uncircumcision of the flesh, i.e., in the Greek, a life controlled by the sexual organs. God [2]graced us in Christ. The word translated, forgiven, [2]**charisamenos** from **charizomai** means he graciously restored our innocence and dignity! The word, [3]**paraptoma**, comes from, **para**, close proximity, sphere of influence and **pipto**, to stop flying, from **petomai**, to fly; thus, to fall from flight or to lose altitude.)*

Adam's transgression no longer holds the human race hostage. Rom. 5:7, 8,12-21.

Col. 3:1 See yourselves co-raised with Christ! Now ponder with persuasion the consequence of your co-inclusion in him. Relocate yourselves mentally! Engage your thoughts with throne room realities where you are co-seated with Christ in the executive authority of God's right hand.

Col. 3:2 Becoming affectionately acquainted with throne room thoughts will keep you from being distracted again by the earthly *[soul-ruled]* **realm.** *("Set your minds upon the things that are above and not upon the things below!" RSV. Whatever you face in your daily lives, acquaint yourselves with the greater reality! The things that are above! Do not engage the energy of the things that are below! Also note Romans 1:18, where the word **katecho** is used - to echo downwards is the opposite to **anoche**, to echo upward- Romans 2:4 and Romans 3:26. Also 2 Corinthians 4:18 "We are not keeping any score of what seems so obvious to the senses on the surface; it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us which has our full attention and captivates our gaze!" A renewed mind conquers the space previously occupied by worthless pursuits and habits. See my notes on Earthbound vs. Heavenly Dimension Realities at the end of Revelation Chapter 16.)*

Col. 3:3 Your union with his death broke the association with that world; see yourselves located in a fortress where your life is hidden with Christ in God! *("In that day you will know that I am in my father, and you in me and I in you." [Jn 14:20] Occupy your mind with this new order of life; you died when Jesus died; whatever defined you before defines you no more. Christ, in whom the fullness of deity dwells, defines you now! The word, "hidden" can also be translated, secret; the secret of your life*

is your union with Christ in God!

"Risen, then, with Christ you must lift your thoughts above where Christ now sits at the right hand of God; be heavenly minded, not earthly minded; you have undergone death, and your life is hidden away now with Christ in God. Christ is your life, when he is made manifest you are made manifest in his glory." — Knox Translation.)

Col. 3:4 The unveiling of Christ, as defining our lives, [1]immediately implies that, what is evident in him, is equally mirrored in you! The exact life on exhibit in Christ is now repeated in us. We are included in the same bliss and joined-oneness with him; just as his life reveals you, your life reveals him. *(This verse was often translated to again delay the revelation of Christ to a future event! The word, [1]**otan**, often translated as "when" is better translated as "every time." Thus, "Every time Christ is revealed we are being co-revealed in his glory." According to Walter Bauer Lexicon,* ***otan*** *is often used of an action that is repeated. Paul declares our joint-glorification in Christ! We are co-revealed in the same bliss. [See 1 Cor 2:7-8, Rom 3:23-24, Rom 8:30, 2 Pet 1:3.] In him we live and move and have our being; in us he lives and moves and has his being! Acts 17:28.)*

Phil. 2:8 And so we have the drama of the cross in context: the man Jesus Christ who is fully God, becomes fully man to the extent of willingly dying humanity's death at the hands of his own creation. He embraced the curse and shame of the lowest kind in dying a criminal's death. *(Thus, through the doorway of death, he descended into our hellish darkness. Rev 9:1 When the fifth celestial shepherd-messenger blew his trumpet, I saw a star that had fallen to earth from the sky. The star was given the key to the shaft into the fathomless depths of the Abyss. [In his death, Jesus conquered the underworld and he has the keys; no-one else does!] Rev 1:18 I am also the Living One; I became dead and now, see, here I am alive unto the ages of the ages and I have the keys wherewith I have disengaged the gates of Hades and death! Also, Eph 4:8-10.)*

Phil. 2:9 From this place of utter humiliation, God exalted him to the highest rank. God graced Jesus with a Name that is far above every other name. *(Eph 1:20 Do you want to measure the mind and muscle of God? Consider the force which he unleashed in Jesus Christ when he raised him from the dead and forever seated him enthroned as his executive authority in the realm of the heavens. Jesus is God's right hand of power! He was raised up from the deepest dungeons of human despair to the highest region of heavenly bliss! [See Eph 2:5,6 & 4:8,9] Eph 1:21 Infinitely above all the combined*

forces of rule, authority, dominion or governments; he is ranked superior to any name that could ever be given to anyone of this age or any age still to come in the eternal future. The name of Jesus endorses his mission as fully accomplished! He is the Savior of the world! Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible. See also Eph 3:15, Every family in heaven and on earth originates in him; his is mankind's family name and he remains the authentic identity of every nation.)

Phil. 2:10 What his name unveils will persuade every creature of their redemption! Every knee in heaven and upon the earth and under the earth shall bow in spontaneous worship! *(See Isa 45:23 "My own life is the guarantee of my conviction, says the Lord, every knee shall freely bow to me in worship, and every tongue shall spontaneously speak from the same God-inspired source.")*

Phil. 2:11 Also every tongue will voice and resonate the same devotion to his unquestionable Lordship as the Redeemer of life! Jesus Christ has glorified God as the Father of creation! This is the ultimate conclusion of the Father's [1]intent! *(The word [1]**doxa,** intent, opinion, often translated, glory. Rev 5:13 And I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth and in the sea, and all therein, saying, "To him who sits upon the throne and to the Lamb be blessing and honor and glory and might for ever and ever!" Also my commentary note on Rom 14:11. Paul, here quotes Isaiah 45:23 See verse 22,& 23 "Face me and **be** saved all the ends of the earth! [Note, '**Be saved**!' Not 'become saved!'] I am God; your idols are figments of your invention and imagination!" Isa 45:23 "I have sworn by myself; the word of my mouth has begotten righteousness; this cannot be reversed!" The Hebrew word, [1]צא **Yatsa** can be translated, begotten like in Judges 8:30 "Every knee shall bow to me and every tongue shall echo my oath!" [Thus, speak with the same certainty sourced in me!] The Hebrew word, שבע **Shaba** means to seven oneself, that is, swear - thus in the Hebrew mind, by repeating a declaration seven times one brings an end to all dispute! See Heb 6:13.16,17.)*

Phil. 2:12 Considering this amazing outcome of what our faith sees and celebrates, I strongly urge you my darling friends to continue to have your [1]ears tuned to that which inspires your conduct to give full expression to the detail of your own salvation in a most personal and practical way. See salvation in its earth-shattering awesome and ultimate conclusion. I know that my personal presence encourages you greatly but now I want you to realize an inspiration in my absence that supersedes anything you've known before. This would mean that even if you

were never to see my face again or receive another Epistle from me, it will make no difference at all to your faith! *(The success of Paul's ministry was not to enslave people to him but to his gospel! He knew that he would be more present in his message than in his person! Ministry success is not measured by how many partners you can congregate, but by how absent you can preach yourself! The word often translated, obedience, is the word* [1]***upoakoo,*** *to be under the inspired influence of what you hear.)*

Phil. 2:13 Discover God himself as your inexhaustible inner source; he ignites you with both the desire and energy that matches his own delight!

Phil. 2:14 Your entire life is a poem; any undercurrent murmuring or argumentative debating would be completely out of place! Do not let such issues disrupt the rhythm of your conversation.

Phil. 2:15 Your flawless innocence radiates attraction as beacons of light in the midst of a people who have forgotten their true sonship and whose lives have become distorted and perverse. *(In this verse Paul quotes Deut 32:5 from the Greek Septuagint translation of the Hebrew text, with reference to Deut 32:4,5 &18. In context God's perfect workmanship as Father of mankind is forgotten; people have become "crooked and perverse" twisted and distorted out of their true pattern of sonship. Deut 32:18 says, "you have forgotten the Rock that begot you and have gotten out of step with the God who* [1]*danced with you!" Hebrew,* [1]***khul*** חול *also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21.)*

2 Cor. 5:16 Therefore, from now on, I no longer know anyone according to the flesh! I no longer see people from a human point of view! This is a radical and most defining moment! No label that could possibly previously identify someone carries any further significance! Even our pet doctrines of Christ are redefined. Whatever we knew about him historically or sentimentally is challenged by this conclusion.

John saw it:

John 1:1 To go back to the very [1]**beginning, is to find the** [2]**Word already** [3]**present there;** [4]**face to face with God. The Word is** [3]**I am; God's** [2]**eloquence echoes and** [4]**concludes in him. The Word equals God.** *(In the beginning,* [1]***arche,*** *to be first in order, time, place or rank. The Word,* [2]***logos****, was "with" God; here and again in verse 2 John uses the Greek Preposition* [4]***pros****, towards; face-to-face.*

Three times in this sentence John uses the Active Indicative Imperfect form of the

*verb [3]**eimi,** namely **aen [ἦν]** to continue to be, [in the beginning 'was' the Word etc...] which conveys no idea of origin for God or for the Logos, but simply continuous existence, "I am." Quite a different verb **egeneto,** "became," appears in John 1:14 for the beginning of the Incarnation of the Logos. The Word 'became' flesh. The incarnation is not the origin of Jesus.*

*See the distinction sharply drawn in John 8:58, "before Abraham was [born, **genesthai** from **ginomai**] I am." The word **eimi**, I am; the essence of being, suggesting timeless existence. See my commentary note on 1 Pet 1:16)*

John 1:2 The beginning mirrors the Word face to face with God. *(Nothing that is witnessed in the Word distracts from who God is. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father." [John 14:9] The Word that was from the beginning was not yet written nor spoken; it was simply face to face with God! The beginning declares the destiny of the Word, it would always only be who God is and conclude in God.)*

John 1:3 The Logos is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive Parent reference to their existence. There is nothing original, except the Word! The Logic of God defines the only possible place where mankind can trace their origin. *(All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made. KJV See Colossians 1:16.)*

John 1:4 His life is the light that defines our lives. *(In his life we discover the light of life.)*

John 1:5 The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. *(Darkness represents mankind's ignorance of their redeemed identity and innocence [Isa 9:2-4, Isa 60:1-3, Eph 4:18, Col 1:13-15].)*

John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! *(This day would begin our calendar and record the fact that human history would forever be divided into before and after Christ. The incarnation would make the image of God visible in human form. In him who is the blueprint of our lives there is more than enough light to displace the darkness in every human life. He is the true light that enlightens everyone! [Col 1:15; 2:9, 10; 2 Cor 4:6])***1:11 It was not as though he arrived on a foreign planet; he came to his own, yet his own did not [1]recognize him.** *(The Jews should have been the first to recognize him! Revelation 19:12. Also Ps 24:1, "The earth is the Lord's and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell in it [RSV]." The word, [1]**paralambano**,*

*comes from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **lambano**, to comprehend, grasp, to identify with.)*

John 1:12 Everyone who [1]realizes their association in him, [6]convinced that he is their [2]original life and that [7]his name defines them, God [5]gives the assurance that they are indeed his [4]offspring, [2]begotten of him; he [3]sanctions the legitimacy of their sonship. *(The word often translated, to receive, [1]**lambano**, means to take in hand, to comprehend, to grasp, to identify with. This word suggests that even though he came to his own, there are those who do not [1]identify with their true [2]origin revealed in him, and like the many Pharisees they behave like children of a foreign father, the father of lies [John 8: 44]. Neither God's legitimate fatherhood, nor his ownership is in question; mankind's indifference to their true [2]origin is the problem. This is what the Gospel addresses with utmost clarity in the person of Jesus Christ. Jesus has come to introduce the individual to themselves again; mankind has forgotten what manner of person they are by design! [James 1:24, Deuteronomy 32:18, Psalm 22:27].*

*The word, [2]**genesthai**, from **ginomai**, means to generate; to become; John employs this verb in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. Greek Infinitives could have either a present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms has more to do with aspect than with time. The Present Infinitive is used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. This is an important point since many translations of this verse suggests that God's ability to make us his sons can only be in response to something we must first do in order to trigger God into action! Our grasping **[lambano]** is simply the awakening to the fact that our genesis is already completed in the **Logos**. [See John 1:3] The **Logos** is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive Parent reference to their genesis. There is nothing original, except the Word. We are his offspring. [see also Acts 17:28]. "He has come to give us understanding to know him who is true and to realize that we are in him who is true." [1 John 5:20].)*

*The word, [3]**exousia**, often translated "power;" as in, he gave "power" to [2]become children of God, is a compound word; from **ek**, always denoting origin or source*

*and **eimi**, I am; thus, out of I am! This gives [3]legitimacy and authority to our sonship; [4]**teknon**, translated as offspring, child.*

*"He has given," [5]**didomi**, in this case to give something to someone that already belongs to them; thus, to return. The fact that they already are his own, born from above and that they have their [2]beginning and their being in him is now confirmed in their realizing it! Convinced, [6]**pisteo**; [7]his name **onoma**, is mankind's family name. [see Eph 3:15].*

"He made to be their true selves, their child-of-God selves." — The Message)

John 1:13 These are the ones who discover their genesis in God, beyond their natural conception! This is not about our blood lineage or whether we were a wanted- or unwanted-child; this is about our God-begotteness. We are his dream come true and not the invention of our parents. You are indeed the greatest idea that God has ever had! *(See Jeremiah 1:5; 29:11 & John 3:2-7)*

John 1:14 Suddenly the invisible, eternal Word takes on [1]visible form - the Incarnation, on display in a flesh and blood Person, as in a mirror! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible exhibit of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He [2]captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the [3]authentic begotten Son. The [4]glory *(that we lost in Adam)* **returns in fullness! Only [5]grace can communicate truth in such complete context!** *(In him we discover that we are not here by chance or accident or by the desire of an earthly parent, neither are we the product of a mere physical conception; we exist by the expression of God's desire to reveal himself in the flesh. His eternal invisible Word, his Spirit-thought, [1]became flesh, [1]**ginomai**, as in be born and [2]**theaomai**, meaning to gaze upon, to perceive. We saw his glory, [4]**doxa**, the display of his opinion, the glory as of the original, authentic begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth. He is the "only begotten," [3]**monogenes**; begotten only by the Father and not of the flesh; in him we recognize our true beginning, as in the authentic original mold. He is also the "first born from the dead", declaring our new birth. [Colossians 1:18, 1 Peter 1:3]. He is the revelation of our completeness.*

*And out of [**ek**] his fullness have we all received! The Preposition, **ek** always points to source/origin. Grace mirrored in grace, [5]**garin anti garitos**. For the law was given through Moses, grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. He who is in the bosom of the Father, the only original, authentic begotten of the Father; he is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. Interesting that the*

revelation of the Incarnation in verse 14 doesn't follow verse 2 or 3, but verse 12 and 13! Genesis 1:26 is redeemed! See 2 Corinthians 3:17,18.)

John 6:5 There was no getting away from the crowds though; when Jesus saw the multitude arrive he said to Phillip, "How do you think we are going to feed all these people?"

John 6:6 This wasn't a trick question, but simply to engage their faith; he already knew exactly what he was going to do! *(Jesus was not about to be distracted by the enormity of his mission where his body would be broken at the highest price in order to feed the multitudes of mankind with the true bread from heaven! Just like in Chapter 24 of Luke - the picture of a meal always translates into incarnation language - bread becomes flesh!)*

John 6:7 Phillip immediately concluded that this was impossible to do and far beyond a budget of any reasonable calculation; two hundred days wages could never buy enough for each person in the crowd to even get a little morsel of bread! *(Mankind cannot redeem themselves! Again, Jesus leads the conversation into a different dimension - like with Nicodemus and the Samaritan woman - he points to a different source; not related to external reasoning or challenges to be met with personal contributions of our own toil or labor to define or defend ourselves but simply accessing the Father's limitless resources within. He has come to free our minds from the restrictions of a dimension that could never truly define us! He dramatically and very intentionally disengages us with every effort of our own to save ourselves! Our salvation is beyond our budget! BUT WAIT!! What about the little lad!? For unto us a child is born, remember!)*

1 John 1:1 The [1]Logos is the source; everything commences in him. The initial reports concerning him that have reached our ears, and which we indeed bore witness to with our own eyes - to the point that we became irresistibly attracted - now captivates our gaze. In him we witnessed [2]tangible life in its most articulate form. *(The Logos - the [1]Word. To touch, [2]**psallo**, to touch the string of a musical instrument, thus resonance.)*

1 John 1:2 The same life that [1]was [2]face to face with the Father from the beginning, has now dawned on us! The infinite life of the Father became visible before our eyes in a human person! *(In the beginning "was" the Word; [1]**eimi**, timeless existence, "I am". The Preposition [2]**pros** says so much more than 'with,' it suggests towards; face to face. See John 1:1&2. Also John 1:14 "Suddenly the invisible eternal Word takes*

on visible form! The Incarnation! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible display of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the authentic begotten Son. The glory (that Adam lost) returns in fullness! Only grace can communicate truth in such complete context!" Also John 1:18 "Until this moment God remained invisible; now the authentic begotten Son, the blueprint of mankind's design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us.")

1 John 1:3 We include you in this conversation; you are the immediate audience of the logic of God! This is the Word that always was; we saw him incarnate and witnessed his language as defining our lives. In the incarnation Jesus includes mankind in the eternal friendship of the Father and the Son! This life now finds expression in an unreserved union. *(We do not invent fellowship; we are invited into the fellowship of the Father and the Son!)*

1 John 1:4 What we enjoy equally belongs to you! I am writing this for your reference, so that joy may be yours in its most complete measure. *(In all these years since the ascension of Jesus, John, now ninety years old, continues to enjoy unhindered friendship with God and desires to extend this same fellowship to everyone through this writing.)*

1 John 1:5 My conversation with you flows from the same source which illuminates this fellowship of union with the Father and the Son. This, then, is the essence of the message: God is radiant light and in him there exists not even a trace of obscurity or darkness at all. *(See James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above (where we originate from); proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda. (The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word, [1]anouthen, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

1 John 1:6 This is the real deal! To live a life of pretense is a such a waste of time! The truth has no competition. Truth inspires the poetry of friendship in

total contrast to a fake, performance-based fellowship! Light is not threatened by darkness! Why say something with darkness as your reference?

1 John 1:7 We are invited to explore the dimensions of the same light that engulfs God; when we see the light in his light, fellowship ignites! In his light we understand how the blood of Jesus Christ is the removal of every stain of sin! The success of the cross celebrates our redeemed innocence!

1 John 1:8 To claim innocence by our own efforts under the law of personal performance is to deceive ourselves and to deliberately ignore the truth. The truth about you does not mean that you now have to go into denial if you have done something wrong!

1 John 1:9 When we [1]communicate what God says about our sins, we discover what he believes concerning our redeemed oneness and innocence! We are cleansed from every distortion we believed about ourselves! Likeness is redeemed! *(The word traditionally translated "confession" is the word [1]**homologeo** from homo, the same, and logeo to speak. In the context of verse 7, this suggests that we say what God says about us!)*

1 John 2:1 My darling little children, the reason I write these things to you is so that you will not [1]believe a lie about yourselves! If anyone does believe a [1]distorted image to be their reality, we have Jesus Christ who [2]defines our likeness [3]face to face with the Father! He is our [4]parakletos, the one who endorses our true identity, being both the source and the reflection of the Father's image in us! *(The root of sin is to believe a lie about yourself. The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. Jesus the righteous, **iesoun xriston dikaion**; the word [2]**dikaiosune**, righteousness is from the stem **dike**, two parties finding likeness in each other. The Preposition [3]**pros** suggests a face to face presentation. [See John 1:1] The word [4]**parakletos** comes from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **kaleo**, meaning to identify by*

name, to surname. Jesus introduces the Holy Spirit in the same capacity: ***parakletos****, meaning close companion, kinsman [John 14:16]. Sadly this word has been translated as 'advocate' as if Jesus needs to persuade the Father to like us and possibly forgive us!)*

1 John 2:2 Jesus is our [1]at-one-ment, he has conciliated us to himself and has taken our sins and distortions out of the equation. What he has accomplished is not to be seen as something that belongs to us exclusively; the same at-one-ment includes the entire [2]cosmos! *(The word [1]****hilasmos****, means to conciliate, to bring about atonement, from* ***hileos****, gracious, merciful. Also reminds of the word* ***hilaros****, cheerful, joyous, hilarious! The word, [2]****kosmos*** *in the NT refers to the entire human family.)*

1 John 2:7 My beloved family, I know that the words I write to you here may not immediately remind you of the [1]precepts of Moses; this does not mean that it is a new [1]doctrine, it is the ancient [1]conversation that [2]echoes God's voice prophetically! It is indeed the very [1]conclusion of the word, which you have heard from the beginning! *(The word [1]****entole*** *is often translated commandment or precept; this word has two components:* ***en****, in and* ***telos****, from* ***tello****, to set out for a definite point or goal; properly the point aimed at as a limit, that is, by implication, the conclusion of an act or state, the result; the ultimate or prophetic purpose. Strong's 5056. The word, [2]****echo****, to hold, like sound is held in an echo; to resonate.)*

1 John 2:8 And yet it is a glorious [1]new [2]message that I am writing to you! You may ask, "How can that which is old, also be new?" Herein is the secret of its newness: whatever is true of Jesus is equally true of you! The days of the [3]dominance of darkness as a reference to human life, are over! The true light surely shines with [4]bold certainty and illuminates your life, as it is unveiled in Christ. *(The word [1]****kainos*** *means, fresh, recent, unused, unworn, of a new kind, unprecedented, novel, uncommon. The freshness of this encounter is celebrated in a fellowship of exactly the same oneness enjoyed between the Father and the Son! Again the word [2]****entole*** *is used, precept or teaching. The word [3]****parago*** *from para, close proximity and* ***agoo****, to lead; thus darkness will no longer lead you into its sway. The word [4]****ede****, even now: - already, by this time; from* ***ē*** *[pronounced ay] an adverb of confirmation; assuredly: - surely; and* ***dē*** *[pronounced day] which is a particle of emphasis or explicitness; now, then, etc. - also, and, doubtless, now, therefore.)*

1 John 3:1 Consider the amazing love the Father lavished upon us; this is our [1]defining moment: we began in the agape of God – the engineer of the universe is our Father! So it's no wonder that the performance-based systems of this world

just cannot see this! Because they do not recognize their origin in God, they feel indifferent towards anyone who does! *(The word, [1]**kaleo**, to identify by name; to surname.)*

1 John 3:2 Beloved, we know that we are children of God to begin with, which means that there can be no future surprises; his manifest likeness is already mirrored in us! Our sameness cannot be compromised or contradicted; our gaze will confirm exactly who he is - and who we are. *(See Phil. 2:15 Your flawless innocence radiates life's contrast as beacons of light in the midst of a people who have forgotten their true sonship and whose lives have become distorted and perverse. [In this verse Paul quotes Deut. 32:5 from the Greek Septuagint translation of the Hebrew text, with reference to Deut. 32:4,5 &18. In context, God's perfect workmanship as Father of mankind is forgotten; people have become "crooked and perverse" twisted and distorted out of their true pattern of sonship. Deut.32:18 says, you have forgotten the Rock that begat you and have gotten out of step with the God who danced with you! Hebrew, חוּל khul, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21.])*

1 John 3:4 [1]Distorted behavior is the result of a warped self-image! A [2]lost sense of identity is the basis of all sin! *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, derives from **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. It is to be out of step with our true sonship! See Deuteronomy 32:18. Sin is not something we do or don't do, it is missing out on sonship. Hear the father pleading with the other "lost" brother in Luke 15, "My son, you've always been with me and all that I have is yours!" See 1 John 3:9. The root of sin is to believe a lie about yourself, which is the fruit of the 'I am-not Tree'. This was also the essence of Israel's unbelief that kept them trapped in a grasshopper-mindset for 40 years. The word often translated, lawlessness, [2]**anomia**, from **a**, without, and **onoma**, name - thus without a name, anonymous. In my opinion there exists an etymological link between the words **onoma** and **anomos**.)*

1 John 3:5 We have witnessed with our own eyes how, in the unveiling of the prophetic word, when he was lifted up upon the cross as the Lamb of God, he [1]lifted up our sins and disengaged its dominion and rule over us! *(John 1:29 "Behold, the Lamb of God, who [1]takes away **[airo]** the sin of the world! The word [1]**airo***

means to lift up.)

1 John 3:6 To [1]abide in him in uniterrupted, seamless oneness, is to live free from sin. Whoever continues in sin has obviously not perceived how free they are in him; they clearly do not really know him. (*The word, [1]**meno** suggests an uninterrupted abiding; a seamless oneness!)*

1 John 4:17 So now, with us awakening to [1]our full inclusion in this love union, everything is perfect! Its completeness is not compromised in contradiction. Our [2]confident conversation [3]echoes this fellowship even in the face of [4]crisis; because, as he is, so are we in this world - our lives are mirrored in him. We are as blameless in this life as Jesus is! This perfect love union is the source of our confidence whenever we [5]face the scrutiny of contradiction. *(This place of seamless union is the perfection of Agape - **en toutoo teteleotai he agape meth'hemoon**; notice, the word [1]**meth'hemoon**, together with us; from meta, together with and hemoon, us; to be included in the same togetherness. The word [2]**parresia**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, and **rheo**, to pour forth; to flow freely, suggesting unreservedness in speech; bold utterance, confidence. The word, [3]**echo**, to hold, like sound is held in an echo; to resonate. The word [4]**krisis** is often translated, judgment. So, the [5]day of judgment, "in the face of crisis", can be translated, "facing the scrutiny of contradiction in our daily lives.")*

1 John 4:18 Fear cannot co-exist in this love realm. The perfect love union that we are talking about expels fear. Fear holds on to an expectation of crisis and judgment *[which brings separation]* **and interprets it as due punishment** *[a form of karma!]* **It echoes torment and only registers in someone who does not yet realize the completeness of their love union.** *[With the Father, Son and Spirit and with one another.] (See Heb 2:15.)*

1 John 4:19 We love because he loved us first! *(We did not invent this fellowship; we are invited into the fellowship of the Father and the Son!)*

1 John 4:20 If anyone claims to love God but he cannot stand a fellow human, his love for God is fake; how is it possible to not love someone you can see with your eyes yet claim to love an invisible God? *(Love is not defined by our ability to like or dislike someone; love is a God-thing from start to finish. God cannot make his love for mankind more tangibly certain than what he did in his Son, Jesus Christ.)*

1 John 4:21 God's [1]conclusion on this is clear, loving him includes loving your

fellow human - there is no distinction. *(Conclusion, **entole.**)*

1 John 5:19 We know that we have our origin in God; yet the whole world [1]lies trapped in the blindfold-mode of a lost identity; intoxicated by the poneros system of a futile mentality of hardships labors and annoyances! *(The word **keimai** means to lie prostrate, outstretched; buried.)*

1 John 5:20 This is what has become distinctly clear to us: the [1]coming of the Son of God is God's mission accomplished! He is the incarnate Christ. The moment all of Scripture pointed to has arrived! The Son is [1]present! In him God has given us the greatest gift, [2]a mind whereby we may know him who is true; and in the same knowing, to find ourselves there in him who is true! Mankind is fully included and located in him, in his Son Jesus Christ; this means that whatever Jesus is as Son, we are. This is the true God; this is the life of the ages! *(The word [1]**heko** means to have come, to have arrived, to be present. John uses the word [2]**dianoian**; deep thought; with **dia** relating to the means by which we may know; a mind to know; compare metanoia, to know together with; an entwining of thought; the mind of Christ.*

Jesus said, you will know the truth as it is unveiled in me, and that will set you free!

The culmination of the gospel according to John is summed up in these verses: John 14:20 "In that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you are in me and I am in you!" Also 1 John 2:7 & 8, "what is true of him, is equally true of us. 1 John 4:17 "As he is, so are we in this world! Our lives are mirrored in him" as well as here in 1 John 5:20.)

1 John 5:21 This defeats every image of our imagination that could possibly compete with the authentic likeness of our design! Darling children, distance yourselves from every substitute image, which is what idolatry is all about! *(The word [1]**eidolon,** often translated idol, refers to image or likeness.*

*Isa. 40:18-21 To whom then will you liken God, or what likeness compare with him? The idol? A workman casts it, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold, and casts for it silver chains. He who is impoverished chooses for an offering wood that will not rot; he seeks out a skilful craftsman to set up an image that will not move. Have you not known? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you **from the beginning**? Have you not understood from the foundations of the earth? Remember your beginning! You are God's idea - the Engineer of the Universe imagined you! Gen 1:26; Col 1:15; Col 2:9,10.*

Acts 17:28-31 For 'In him we live and move and have our being'; as even some of your poets have said, 'For we are indeed his offspring.' Being then God's offspring, we ought

not to think that the Deity is like gold, or silver, or stone, a representation by the art and imagination of human origin. The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he compels all of mankind everywhere to awaken to their redeemed identity and innocence! Idolatry is a projection of an image of one's own making. Idolatry is the crux of religion - it is expensive business since your idol is like a slot machine at the casino! It remains hungry and it is wired to bite and bankrupt you!)

Rev. 5:13 At that point the entire universe burst out in praise! I heard every created being in the heavenly realm and upon the earth and under the earth and upon the ocean and everything within all these spheres, declaring to the One seated upon the throne and to the Lamb: "The most [1]articulate language, the admiration, the supreme magnificence, the might until the ages of the ages!" *(The word [1]**eulogia**, from **eu**, good, well done, and **logos**; thus, polished language; such language which is artfully adapted to captivate the hearer: fair speaking, fine speeches.)*

Rev. 7:9 At this moment I saw a massive throng of people, impossible to count, standing tall and innocent - every one of them [1]dressed in white with palm branches in their hands; they have [1]escaped everything that could possibly define them as a non-Jewish, Gentile world! In fact, every sphere of society was there - including the entire spectrum of people-groupings; all tribal identities with their unique language-specific dialect preferences, they were all present facing the throne and the Lamb as the people of the planet! *(Amazing how, in the previous verses of this chapter, the tribes of Israel are associated with a very specific "number", emphasizing the prophetic detail of the entire Jewish nation. But here, John sees a massive throng of people, impossible to count! In Israel there is a prophetic voice of God's intention to release the blessing of the single SEED of God's faith through Abraham and bless all the nations of the earth! "Count the stars, count the sand!"*

*The word [1]**stolay**, is the white outer garment worn by kings, priests, and persons of rank. The palm branches and the white robes are signs of the celebration of victory and joy. The Preposition [1]**ek**, points to source or origin; mankind was delivered out of their national, geographical and historical identities! Seven times in the book of Revelation human society is addressed in the most all-inclusive fashion, with a similar grouping of words. Rev 5:9, here in Rev 7:9, Rev 10:11, Rev 11:9, Rev 13:7, Rev 14:6 and Rev 17:15. Also note Rev 5:13 and Rev 11:15. See Extended Notes on Israel at the end of Rev 20.*

I looked again and saw a huge crowd, too huge to count. Everyone was there—all nations and tribes, all races and languages. And they were standing, dressed in

white robes and waving palm branches, standing before the throne and the Lamb. The Message)

Rev. 7:10 Then I heard the masses shouting as if with one thundering voice saying, "Our salvation is secure in our God who is seated upon the throne and endorsed in the Lamb's doing!"

Rev. 19:9 And he instructed me to record this in writing: Oh the [1]blessedness of this bliss which is the supreme celebration of the union of the ages! You have individually been [2]identified by name and invited to the Lamb's supper, concluding in the ultimate wedding feast! This is the Grand Finale in the [3]unveiling of God's word. *(This is not a wedding where you are invited simply because you're a friend of a friend of the Groom or the Bride - or a distant second cousin to a relative of a relative on someone's mother's side! No! You're the Bride!*

*The word, [1]**makarios**, usually translated, blessed, suggests a special intensity of delight. It is another beatitude **[makarioi]** like that in Rev 14:13 [fourth of the seven in the book]*

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and the Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

James, the brother of Jesus saw it

While none of Jesus' brothers believed in him during the three years of his ministry, [John 7:5] his brother James discovers his own true identity when Jesus appears to him after the resurrection. [1 Corinthians 15:4-7]

James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above *(where we originate from);* **proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda.** *(The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The*

*word, [1]**anouthen**, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

James 1:18 It was according to the Father's delightful [1]resolve that he [2]birthed us; giving [3]authentic, incarnate expression to the Word. *[The face to face-ness of the Logos that was before time was. Jn 1:1]* **Just like the first-fruits mirror the harvest, so we mirror the [4]conclusion of his [4]workmanship in the core of our [5]being.** *(The word, [1]**boulomai**, means the affectionate desire and deliberate resolve of God. Only James uses the word, [2]**apokueō** from **apo** + **kuma**; from **kuo**, to swell with young; bend or curve. [same word in v 15, where sin's passion parented death, vs God's passion parented authentic life in us!] Truth, [3]**alethea**, from **a**, negative + **lanthano**, meaning hidden; that which is unveiled; the Word [**logos**] of truth is the [3]unveiled **logic** of God. The Preposition [4]**eis**, points to conclusion. The word, κτίσμα*

*[5]**ktisma** meaning, creation with reference to the the proprietorship of the manufacturer - God owns the idea of our invention - he holds the copyright! The words, εἰς τὸ εἶναι ημας ἀπαρχήν - **einai hemas** - [5]our beingness from **eimi**, I am. See Rom. 8:29, He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. Also, John 1:1-18; 1 Pet. 2:9,10.)*

James 1:19 Consequently my beloved friends, *[when you are faced with temptation,]* **give your immediate attention to the Word that reveals your true origin; do not ponder the contradiction. Rather remain silent, than to quickly give your vote and voice to the [1]emotions that arise in the heat of the moment!** *(Quick to hear, slow to speak, slow to [1]anger. The word ὀργή [1]**orgay** from oregomia, means the excitement of the mind; to stretch one's self out in order to grasp something, to reach after or desire.)*

James 1:20 These outbursts of emotion would typically distort the picture, and bring no credit to compliment God's [1]righteousness. *([1]What God achieved in redeeming our identity and innocence.)*

James 1:21 Therefore, by embracing the [1]infused word, you discover how thoroughly freed you already are from any kind of perverted passion that spirals out of control, polluting your lives like a filthy garment; your [1]gentle

abandonment to this logic, powerfully [2]realizes the full extent of your salvation from the dictates of the soul ruled realm. *(Again, a word only James uses, ἔμφυτος [1]**emphutos** impregnated. The words, [1]**en prauteti** - in gentleness are used in contrast to **orgay**. Rescuing you from negative thought patterns and depressing emotional traits!)*

James 1:22 Give the mirror-word your [1]undivided attention; do not underestimate yourself. [3]Make the calculation. There can only be one logical conclusion: your authentic origin is mirrored in the word. You are God's poem; [2]let his voice make poetry of your life! *(The word, [1]**akroate**, means intent listening. James is not promoting the doing of the law of works; he is defining the law of perfect liberty. Doing the word begins with your undivided attention to the face of your birth. [2]A doer of the Word, **poetes**, means poet. Make the calculation, [3]**paralogizomai**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, union, and **logizomai**, to reckon the logic in any calculation.)*

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing himself]* **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.**

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life** *[of their original design.]* **They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from*

which an action originates, intimate connection, and ***kupto****, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny;* [2]***parameno****, to remain captivated under the influence of;* ***meno****, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom,* [3]***eleutheria****, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

James sees the mirror mystery of our birth from above. We existed in God before we were formed in our mother's womb. He brought us forth by the word of truth! James 1:17, 18. If anyone hears this word, *(of our joint resurrection in Christ)* **he sees the face of his birth as in a mirror. See 1 Pet. 1:3, Eph. 2:5.**

James 3:9 We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a fellow human made in his mirror likeness. *(The point is not what the person did to deserve the insult. The point is that people are image and likeness bearers of God by design! True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate.)*

Now we see it

Paul spoke in such a manner that many believed.

Acts 14:1 And so spoke that a great company believed, both of Jews and of Greeks RSV

Eph. 3:9 The mandate of my message is to make all men see. The unveiling of this eternal secret is to bring into public view an association that has always been hidden in God; Jesus Christ is the blueprint of creation. *(Eph 1:4.)*

Eph. 3:4 In [1]**pondering these words you will perceive my** [2]**insight into the mystery of Christ.** *(The word,* [1]***anaginosko****, suggests an upward knowledge; to know again, to recognize, to read with recognition. Insight,* [2]***sunesis,*** *from συνίημι* ***suniēmi*** *-* ***sun*** *+* ***eimi,*** *together with my "I am-ness", to resonate; which means a flowing together as of two streams - a seamless merging, a fusion of thought. It suggests the grasp and comprehension that happens from comparing and combining things. A word only Paul uses; also his colleague Dr Luke , in Lk 2:47, as well as another disciple of Paul, Mark who uses it in Mark 12:33, "To love him with all your heart, with all your* ***understanding****, with all your strength, and to love your neighbor as you love yourself; this is more important than all the burnt offerings and sacrifices.")*

Eph. 1:9 The secret is out! His cherished love dream now unfolds in front of our very eyes.

Eph. 1:10 In the [1]economy of the fullness of time, everything culminates in Christ. All that is in heaven and all that is on earth is reconciled in him. Jesus is the [2]consummation of the ages! *(The word,[1]**oikonomia,** translates as administration. The word, ανακεφαλαιωσασθαι is the Aorist Infinitive of **anakephalaiomai**, which has two components, **ana**, upward and **kephale**, head, pointing to a condition where no separation exists - the return to our Source. The Aorist Infinitive presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end.)*

"All human history shall be consummated in Christ, everything that exists in heaven or earth shall find its perfection and fulfillment in him." (Phillips)

"All that is in heaven, all that is on earth, summed up in him!" (Knox)

Eph. 1:17 I desire that you will draw directly from the source; that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory kindles within you the spirit of wisdom and of revelation in the unveiling of his [1]Master Plan. I long for you to know by revelation what he has known about you all along! *([1]His intent, **doxa**, glory. In the words, **en epignosei auto**, Paul suggests that we might find our source in God's knowledge - in what it is that he knows! See 1 Cor 13:12 - to know even as we have always been known.)*

Eph. 1:18 I pray that your thoughts will be flooded with light and inspired insight; that you will clearly picture his intent in identifying you in him so that you may know how precious you are to him. What God possesses in your redeemed innocence is his treasure and the glorious trophy of his inheritance! You are God's portion. You are the sum total of his assets and the measure of his wealth!

Eph. 1:19 I pray that you will be overwhelmed with an understanding of the magnitude of his power in the finished work of Christ. This is what [1]results in the dynamic of [2]your faith. *(The Preposition [1]**eis**, speaks of a point reached in conclusion. The word [2]**pisteuontas** is the Present Participle in the Accusative case of **pisteuo** [to be certain; to be persuaded] which describes an action thought of as simultaneous with the action of the main verb, which, in this case is **energeken**, "which he has wrought"... [see v 20] which is the Perfect Tense of **energeo**, to energize; to work dynamically. The Perfect Tense denotes an action which is completed in the past, but the effects of which are regarded as continuing into the present. Paul is desiring to establish a basis for our faith that exceeds our attempts to believe!)*

Eph. 1:20 Do you want to measure the mind and muscle of God? Consider the force

which he unleashed in Jesus Christ when he raised him from the dead and forever seated him enthroned as his executive authority in the realm of the heavens. Jesus is God's right hand of power! He was raised up from the deepest dungeons of human despair to the highest region of heavenly bliss! *(See Eph 2:5,6 & 4:8,9.)*

Eph. 1:21 Infinitely above all the combined forces of rule, authority, dominion or governments; he is ranked superior to any name that could ever be given to anyone of this age or any age still to come in the eternal future.

Eph. 1:22 I want you to see this: he subjected all these powers under his feet. He towers head and shoulders above everything. He is the head;

Eph. 1:23 the [1]Ekklesia is his body. The completeness of his being that fills all in all resides in us! God cannot make himself more visible or exhibit himself more accurately. *(The word, [1]**Ekklesia**, comes from **ek**, a Preposition always denoting origin, and **klesia** from **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname; thus the "church" is his redeemed image and likeness in human form.)*

Rom. 6:11 Think of yourself as dead to sin. (Knox Translation)

Rom. 6:11 This reasoning is equally relevant to you. [1]Calculate the cross; there can only be one logical conclusion: he died your death; that means you died to sin, and are now alive to God. Sin-consciousness can never again feature in your future! You are in Christ Jesus; his Lordship is the authority of this union. *(We are not being presumptuous to reason that we are in Christ! "[1]Reckon yourselves therefore dead to sin" The word, [1]**logitsomai**, means to make a calculation to which there can only be one logical conclusion. [See Eph 1:4 and 1 Cor 1:30].*

"From now on, think of it this way: Sin speaks a dead language that means nothing to you; God speaks your mother tongue, and you hang on every word. You are dead to sin and alive to God. That's what Jesus did." *(The Message)*

The ends of the earth will see it!

In Psalm 22 David dramatically prophesies the detail of Jesus' death on the cross, and concludes in verse 27, "The ends of the earth shall remember and turn to the Lord".

Isa. 52:10 The LORD has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God.

Habakkuk, (whose name means to embrace) is the prophet who saw righteousness by faith, 2:4; in chapter 2:2 he says,

"Write the vision, and make it plain upon tablets that he may run who reads it."

"I will give you my message in the form of a vision. Write it clearly enough to be read at a glance." (The Contemporary English Version)

And, then in Habakkuk 2 :14 makes this remarkable statement,

"For the earth will be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the Lord as the waters cover the sea."

Psalm 98:1-3 records the following song:

Sing unto the Lord a new song, for he has done marvelous things! His right hand and his holy arm have gotten him the victory. The Lord has made known his salvation, his righteousness has he openly shown in the sight of the nations. All the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God."

Isa 40:3-5 A voice cries: In the wilderness prepare the way of the Lord, make straight in the desert a highway for our God. Every valley shall be lifted up, and every mountain and hill be made low; the crooked places shall be made straight, even the rough places shall be made smooth. And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, **and all flesh shall see it together,** for the mouth of the LORD has spoken."

Luke 8:17 There is nothing hidden that will not become fully known; even things that have long been unnoticed will come to light! *(The full counsel of God is destined to flood the earth with the knowledge of his glory unveiled in human life! And all flesh shall see it together! Isa 40:5)*

Rom. 8:19 Our lives now represent the one event every creature anticipates with held breath, standing on tip-toe as it were to witness the unveiling of the sons of God. Can you hear the drum-roll?

Rom. 8:20 Every creature suffered abuse through Adam's fall; they were discarded like a squeezed-out orange. Creation did not volunteer to fall prey to the effect of the fall. Yet within this stark setting, hope prevails.

Rom. 8:21 All creation knows that the glorious liberty of the sons of God sets the stage for their own release from [1]decay. *(2 Cor 11:3 I am concerned for you that you might [1]pine away through the illusion of separation from Christ and that, just like Eve, you might become blurry-eyed and deceived into believing a lie about yourselves. The temptation was to exchange the truth about our completeness [I am] with the idea of incompleteness [I am not] and shame; thinking that perfection required your toil and all manner of wearisome labor! [The word, [1]**phteiro**, means to pine or waste away, to*

whither. Any idea of separation causes one to whither away in loneliness!])

Principalities and powers saw it

Eph. 1:22 I want you to see this: he subjected all these powers under his feet. He towers head and shoulders above everything. He is the head;

Eph. 1:23 the [1]Ekklesia is his body. The completeness of his being that fills all in all resides in us! God cannot make himself more visible or exhibit himself more accurately. *(The word, [1]**Ekklesia**, comes from **ek**, a Preposition always denoting origin, and **klesia** from **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname; thus the "church" is his redeemed image and likeness in human form.)*

Eph. 2:7 *(In a single triumphant act of righteousness God saved us from the "guttermost" to the uttermost. Here we are now, revealed in Christ in the highest possible position of bliss! If mankind's sad history could not distract from the extravagant love of God,)* **imagine how God is now able, for timeless perpetuity to exhibit the trophy of the wealth of his grace demonstrated in his kindness towards us in Christ Jesus. Grace exhibits excessive evidence of the success of the cross.**

Eph. 3:10 Every invisible authority and government in the arena of the heavenlies were confronted with the display of God's genius. The ekklesia disperses the varied magnitude of God like a prism, in human form. *(See Math 16:18, "Upon this rock, I will build my ekklesia [authentic identity] and the gates of Hades [from **ha**, negative and **eido**, to see; the blindfold] will not prevail!" Also, Rev 12:8 The Dragon's influence was totally demolished and rendered powerless - not a trace of its presence was found in the heavens! (Principalities and powers were completely disarmed on the cross! Col 2:14,15 "And their place was not found" see Dan 2:35 - the little stone against whom the Gates of Hades shall not prevail - the Chip of the old Block demolished the pseudo man-made identity. There are numeral references to the same "once and for all war" in the heavens! It is however the same hour; the same event! Rev 16:13,14; Rev 17:13,14; 19:19; Rev 20:8.)*

And Rev 17:14, These join forces in that hour to wage war against the Lamb, but the Lamb defeats them since he is the Lord of lords and the King of kings. And sharing with him in his victory are his kindred. They recognize their origin in this conversation and are now of the same persuasion. The Lamb led them into freedom from their lost identity, and their doubts.)

Col. 2:15 In him dying mankind's death, he [1]defused every possible claim of accusation against the human race and thus made a public [2]spectacle of every [3]rule and authority in God's brilliant triumph, demonstrated in him. The [4]voice of the cross will never be silenced! *(The horror of the Cross is now the eternal trophy of God's triumph over sin! The cross stripped religion of its authority to manipulate mankind with guilt. Every accusation lost its leverage to blackmail the human race with condemnation and shame! The word, [1]**apekduomai**, is translated from **apo**, away from, and **ekduo**, to be stripped of clothing; to disarm; the religious facade that disguised the law of works as a means of defining a person's life, was openly defeated. Same word used in Col 3:9. The dominance of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil [**poneros**, hard work and labor] was ended. The word, [2]**deikmatizo**, means to exhibit in public. See [3]commentary below of the words **arche**, rule and **exousia**, authority. The word, [4]**parresia**, comes from **pas**, all and **rheo**, outspokenness, pouring forth speech. .*

"He stripped all the spiritual tyrants in the universe of their sham authority at the Cross and marched them naked through the streets." — The Message

*See commentary for 1 Corinthians 15:24, The complete conclusion in his work of redemption is celebrated in his yielding the full harvest of his reign to God the Father, having brought to nought the law of works which supported every definition of dominion under the fall, including all **principalities**, all authority and every dynamic influence in society. [He brought to nought the law of works, **katargeo**, from **kata**, meaning intensity, and **argos**, meaning labor; thus free from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ. All principalities, [3]**arche**, or chief ranks, i.e., kings, governors; this includes any governing system whereby one is ranked above the other on the basis of their performance or preference. All authority, [3]**exousia**, comes from **ek**, denoting origin and **eimi**, I am; in this case, because of what I can do I am defined by what I can do better than you; therefore, I have authority over you. Every dynamic influence in society, **dunamis**, means power, in this case, willpower. Every government structure in society will be brought under the dominion of grace where the Christ-life rules.]*

In 1 Corinthians 2:7-8, We voice words of wisdom that was hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in mankind. Neither the politicians nor the theologians of the day had a clue about this mystery [of mankind's association in Christ]; if they did, they would never have crucified

the Lord whose death redeemed our glory!)

Jesus saw his own life mirrored in the Scriptures

Heb. 10:7 "Then I said, I read in your book what you wrote about me; so here I am, I have come to fulfill my destiny." *(Ps. 40:7, Luke. 4:17, Luke. 24:27, 44, John 5:39, 40, 7:39)*

"You have your heads in your Bibles constantly because you think you'll find eternal life there. But you miss the forest for the trees. These Scriptures are all about me!" John 5:39. *(The Message)*

John 5:39 You scrutinize the Scriptures tirelessly, assuming that in them you [1]embrace the life of the ages - yet I am what the Scriptures are all about! *([1]Echo, to hold, embrace, resonate)*

John 5:40 Still you refuse to resort to me as the very source of the life you seek. (*I echo the life of the ages within you!)*

Heb. 5:7 When he faced the horror of his imminent death, he presented his plea to God in an outburst of agonizing emotion and with tears. He prayed with urgent intent to be delivered from death, knowing God's power was saving him and that he enjoyed God's full attention - he had a [1]firm grip on the prophetic word. *(Not because he feared, as some translations have put it, but because he fully grasped that he was the fulfillment of Scripture; he knew that he would be raised on the third day; [Hosea 6:2]* ***eu + lambano*** *- he had a firm grip; he grasped/embraced the goodness of God.)*

Heb. 5:8 Acquainted with sonship he was in the habit of [1]hearing from above; what he heard [2]distanced him from the effect of what he had suffered. *(The word often translated as obedience is the word, [1]***upoakuo***, under the influence of hearing, or hearing from above. "By" the things he suffered, [2]***apo****, away from, distanced. "Then I said, I read in your book what you wrote about me; so here I am, I have come to fulfill your will." [Heb 10:7])*

Heb. 5:9 By his perfect hearing he forever freed mankind to hear what he had heard. *(He now makes it possible for us to hear in such a way that we may participate again in the full release of our original identity; the logos finding voice in the incarnation in us.*

Luke 4:17 The scroll of Isaiah the prophet, was handed to him and he stood up

to read. *(The Syriac Sinaitic manuscript has it that Jesus stood up after the attendant handed him the scroll.)*

Luke 4:18 He opened the scroll and rolled it out in order to find the specific place where the following was written, "The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he has [1]anointed me to announce [2]glad tidings to a [3]starving people; he has [4]commissioned me to announce the freedom of [5]forgiveness *[their true I-am-ness]* **to those [6]held captive at spear-point by their guilt and shame; also, the blind may now look up and be restored in their sight! I am anointed [7]to send out those who are bruised and traumatized, into the freedom of their redeemed [8]innocence.**
*(The verb, εχρισεν [1]**echrisen** from χρίω **chrio**, to smear with the hand; from **xeir**, hand; to anoint; see the Hebrew for Messiah, משיח to anoint; from **mashach**, משח to draw the hand over, to measure. [Analytical Hebrew and Chaldee Lexicon, B Davidson.] The anointing is the true measure of our lives, not our mental- or muscle-effort to produce results.*

Our use of the word, "christening" is really a word that means the endorsing of our in-Christness.

*To announce good tidings, ευαγγελισασθαι [2]**euangelisasthai**, in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. The Anointed Christ is the Good News in its most complete context.*

*The word, πτωχός [3]**ptōchos**; to be in a starving and beggarly state.*

*The Perfect Active Indicative απεσταλκεν [4]**apestalken** denotes an action that has been completed in the past and the results of the action are continuing on in this moment, in full effect; of the word, **apostellō**, to commission. Then, the same word, **apostello**, but this time in the Aorist Infinitive, αποστειλαι [8]**apostelai**, which presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end; thus, a sending out of the enclosure of their trauma and hurts, since the door that shut them in, no longer exists.*

*The word, αἰχμαλωτός, [6]**aichmalotos**, from **aichme**, spear and **halosis**, to capture, thus, to arrest at spear point.*

*Then the opening of the blind eyes suggests, a complete change of perspective - a looking upward! The word, ἀναβλέπω **anablepō**, from **ana**, upward and **blepo**, to see.*

*The word translated forgiveness, or remission is the word ἄφεσις aphesis from [8]**aphieimi**; from **apo**, away from, and **hieimi** an intensive form of **eimi**, I am; thus,*

forgiveness is in essence a restoring to your true 'I-am-ness.' The injury, insult, shame, hostility or guilt would no longer define the individual.)

Luke 4:19 I announce that the Jubilee year of the Lord has come! This is the liberation celebration of the Lord, embracing humanity home! *(Lev. 25,10 "You will declare this fiftieth year sacred and proclaim the liberation [Greek **aphesis**] of all the inhabitants of the land. This is to be a jubilee for you". In the Greek translation of the Old Testament the relation between jubilee and liberation is even closer because the Hebrew term יובל **jubel** is not translated into Greek as it was in the Latin of the Vulgate (jubilaeus) and in other languages, it has been translated as "liberation [**aphesis**; see my commentary of this word in the previous verse]" (Lev 25,13), or "year of liberation" (Lev 25,10) or again "sign of liberation" (Lev 25,11-12) In Hebrew, יובל or in Ancient Hebrew* lbfi *to shepherd someone safely and securely home. See Lev 25:10 in the LXX "...and each of you shall return to his home!" Luke 15! The prodigal son came to himself when he returned home! Back to his true I-am-ness!)*

Luke 4:20 Jesus then rolled up the scroll and gave it back to the attendant and sat down, while everyone's eyes were fixed on him. *(They knew that the entire Messianic expectation hinges on this Scripture; the big question is, when?!)*

Luke 4:21 He then proceeded to say to them, "Everything contained in this scripture, its complete prophetic, Messianic and Jubilee significance is now fulfilled - in your ears! You don't have to wait for another day or another time! Within your grasping and accurate hearing, today becomes your day! This is the fulness of time!"

John 12:23 Jesus, immediately understanding the prophetic significance of the moment, knew that he, the Messiah, was who all the nations were longing for and answered, "The hour is here for the Son of man to be glorified! *(Jesus studied Scripture as in a mirror - he knew that "in the book, it is written about me!" Haggai 2:7 and the desire of the nations shall come...See Col 1:27.)*

John 12:24 Most certainly shall the single grain of wheat fall into the earth and die - if it doesn't die it remains alone - but in its death it produces much fruit.

John 7:37 On the final day, the crescendo of the eight-day Feast of Tabernacles, Jesus, knowing that he is the completeness of every prophetic picture and promise, cried out with a loud voice, "If anyone is thirsty, let him come and stand [1]face-to-face with me and drink! *(John again employs the word [1]**pros** in order*

to emphasize the face-to-face fellowship we are invited into.)

John 7:38 In your realizing that I am what the Scriptures are all about, [1]you will discover uniquely for yourself, face to face with me, that I am what you are all about and rivers of living waters will gush out of your innermost being!" *(Jesus addresses the individual; [1]you singular. Here John records how Jesus witnessed the eighth day, the great and final day of the Feast of Tabernacles, when, according to custom, the High Priest would draw water from the Pool of Siloam with a golden jar, mix the water with wine, and then pour it over the altar while the people would sing with great joy from Psalm 118:25-26, See also the entire Psalm 118 which was obviously what Jesus reminded himself of and also Isaiah 12:3; "Therefore with joy shall we draw water from the wells of salvation!" Then, Jesus, knowing that he is the completeness of every prophetic picture and promise, cried out with a loud voice: "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink! If you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, you will discover that you are what I am all about, and rivers of living waters will gush from your innermost being!" The Siloam tunnel is a winding tunnel carved into the rock, leading from the spring of Gihon to the Pool of Siloam. The pool of Siloam also suggests an outflow of waters* שילוח *Shiloach. Dating from the time of Hezekiah [800 BC] or earlier, it was an aqueduct that effectively replaced the Middle Bronze Age channel. Gihon* גחון *derives from,* ***Giha*** גיח *which means* ***gushing forth****; like in an eruption! Also of a child coming forth from the womb. Job 38:8, Psalm 22:9.*

The pool of Siloam as the source in the city of Jerusalem, mirrors your innermost being. When Jesus speaks of waters gushing forth out of your innermost being, he says that you are the city! You are the bride! God's redeemed society! Rev 21:2 And I saw her, in spotless magnificence, the holy city, the new Jerusalem, descending out of the heavens; having been fully prepared as a bride and beautifully adorned for her husband. [In total contrast to the symbolic religious Prostitute city of Babylon.])

John 7:39 Jesus spoke about the Spirit whom those who would believe that he is the conclusion of Scripture were about to [1]grasp since who Jesus was in all of his majestic splendor was not yet fully acknowledged and thus the Spirit was not yet evident. *(The word often translated, to receive, [1]**lambano**, means to comprehend, grasp, to identify with. Note, Holy Spirit is an outpouring not an in-pouring!)*

John 8:14 Jesus answered, "Whatever I declare concerning myself is absolutely true because I know where I am from and where I am going.

It is amazing how we seem to struggle to receive something we did not work for, or maybe argue that we do not deserve, yet we would have no problem claiming the money should we win the LOTTO.

We also do not hesitate to celebrate the victory of our team or sport hero as our own! 'We won!' We would proudly announce; even though we only watched the game as a spectator.

Jesus is so much more than a lucky draw for a better life, or a Christian club we support on a Sunday.

Or a promise of a possible future reward for good behavior, or the judge of the bad guys!

He is God's priceless gift to you-manity!

Nothing you could ever dream to have or wish to enjoy can enrich you more!

The logic of God's economy of inclusion - Chapter 11

The entire theme of Scripture hinges on the image and likeness of God revealed and redeemed in Jesus the Christ.

In the mind of God, Jesus represents the human race.

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

The pin-code of the Bible is in the two words Paul often uses, "in Christ".

Eph. 1:3 Let's celebrate God! He lavished every blessing heaven has upon us in Christ!

Eph. 1:4 He associated us in Christ before [1]the fall of the world! Jesus is God's mind made up about us! He always knew in his love that he would present us again [2]face-to-face before him in blameless innocence. *(The implications of the fall are completely cancelled. Paul uses the word, [1]**kataballo**, meaning "to fall away, to put in a lower place," instead of **themelios**, meaning "foundation" [see Eph 2:20]; thus, translated "the fall of the world," instead of "the foundation of the world." The entire "Fall" was a falling away in our minds from our true identity as image and likeness bearers of Elohim. Just like Eve, were we all deceived to believe a lie about ourselves, which is the fruit of the "I-am-not-tree". We all, like sheep have gone astray. [Isa 53:6]) God found us in Christ before he lost us in Adam! We are presented in blameless innocence before him! The word, [2]**katenopion**, suggests the closest possible proximity, face-to-face!*

Your in-Christness is not the result of a lucky draw! Calvinism lied to you! Neither is it the result of your "choice" to follow Jesus! Something doesn't become true by popular vote! Or by our beliefs! If it wasn't true to begin with, we're wasting our time trying to "believe" it true! Faith happens to you when you encounter the good announcement!

Of God's doing are we IN CHRIST... (1 Cor 1:30) For "evangelical theology" to miss the meaning of mankind's inclusion IN CHRIST before they knew it or believed it, is to completely miss the point of the death, descent into hell, resurrection and ascension of Jesus! This would make Jesus irrelevant and reduce the salvation of the human race to their own fate managed by institutionalized religion, attaching mere sentimental value to an historic Jesus who died and rose again. By dying our death as fully God and fully man, once and for all (not for a "select few!"), death became the doorway, whereby Jesus would enter into our hell and deepest darkness and sense of lostness and loneliness as a result of the lies we believed about ourselves - to triumphantly lead us out as his trophies and relocate us face to face with the Father of the universe! Eph 4:7,8 and 9 See Mirror Bible! All this happened while we were still dead in our trespasses and sins! Eph 2:5,6 Co-quickened, co-raised, co-seated in his Executive authority [his right hand] Now ponder Colossians 3:1-3 and engage your thoughts with throne room realities!)

Eph. 1:5 He is the architect of our design; his heart dream realized our [1]coming of age in Christ. *(Adoption here is not what it means in our Western society. It is a coming of age, like the typical Jewish Barmitsva. See Galatians 4:1-6, " ... and to seal our sonship the spirit of his Son echoes Abba Father in our hearts." This is [1]**huiothesia.**)*

Eph. 1:6 His grace-plan is to be celebrated: he [1]greatly endeared us and highly favored us in Christ. His love for his Son is his love for us. *(The Gospel is not about telling people how lost they are, but reminding them of how loved they are! See Luke 1:28 only other use of the word, χαριτόω [1]**charitoō**.)*

Eph. 1:7 Since we are *[fully represented]* **in him, his blood is the ransom that secures our redemption. His forgiving our sins measures the wealth of his grace.**

Eph. 1:10 In the [1]economy of the fullness of time, everything culminates in Christ. All that is in heaven and all that is on earth is reconciled in him. Jesus is the [2]consummation of the ages! *(The word,[1]**oikonomia,** translates as administration. The word, ανακεφαλαιωσασθαι is the Aorist Infinitive of **anakephalaiomai**, which has two components, **ana**, upward and **kephale**, head, pointing to a condition where no separation exists - the return to our Source. The Aorist Infinitive presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end.*

"All human history consummates in Christ; everything that exists in heaven or earth shall find its perfection and fulfillment in him." — Phillips. "All that is in heaven, all that is on earth, summed up in him!" — Knox.)

Eph. 1:11 This is how we fit into God's picture: Christ is the measure of our portion,

we are in him, invented and defined in him. God's blueprint intention is on exhibition in us. Everything he accomplishes is inspired by the energy and intent of his affection. *(See Romans 8:29, "He engineered us from the start to fit the mold of sonship and likeness according to the exact blueprint of his design. We see the original and intended shape of our lives preserved in his Son; he is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God.")*

Eph. 4:7 The gift of Christ measures the extravagant dimensions of grace; where everyone is equally advantaged.

Rom. 5:18 The conclusion is clear: if one offence condemns the entire human race; then in principle, the righteousness of one vindicates the entire human race.

Rom. 5:19 The disobedience of the one [1]exhibits mankind as sinners; the obedience of another exhibits mankind as righteous. *(The word, [1]**kathistemi**, means to cause to be, to set up, to exhibit. We were not made sinners by our own disobedience; neither were we made righteous by our own obedience.)*

The immediate implication of the revelation of Christ's obedience releases an authority in us whereby we are empowered to destroy every stronghold *(mindset)* and arrest every thought that would snare us to an inferior opinion or identity.

2 Cor. 5:14 The love of Christ constrains us and [1]resonates within us; leaving us with only one [2]conclusion: when Jesus died; every individual simultaneously died. In God's logic, one has died for all, [2]thus all died. *(The word, [1]**sunecho**, to press together; to squeeze; from **sun**, meaning together with and **echo**, meaning to echo; to embrace; to hold; also, to resonate. The word αρα [2]**ara**, means conclusion. Jesus didn't die 99% or for 99%. He one hundred percent died humanity's death! If Paul had to compromise the last part of verse 14 to read: "one died for all therefore only those who follow the prescriptions to qualify, have also died," then he would have had to change the first half of the verse as well! Only the **agape** of Christ can make a calculation of such enormous proportion! The religious mind would question the extremity of God's love and perhaps prefer to add a condition or two to a statement like that!)*

2 Cor. 5:15 Now if all were included in his death they were equally included in his resurrection. This unveiling of his love redefines human life! Whatever reference we could have of ourselves outside of our association with Christ is no longer relevant.

2 Cor. 5:16 Therefore, from now on, I no longer know anyone according to the

flesh! I no longer see people from a human point of view! This is a radical and most defining moment! No label that could possibly previously identify someone carries any further significance! Even our pet doctrines of Christ are redefined. Whatever we knew about him historically or sentimentally is challenged by this conclusion.

2 Cor. 10:4 The dynamic of our strategy is revealed in God's ability to disengage mindsets and perceptions that have held people captive in pseudo fortresses for centuries!

2 Cor. 10:5 Every lofty idea and argument positioned against God's knowledge of us, is cast down and exposed to be a mere invention of our own imagination. We [1]arrest every thought at spear point - anything that could possibly trigger an opposing threat to our redeemed identity and innocence is taken captive. The caliber of our weapon is empowered by the revelation of the ultimate consequence of the obedience of Christ. *(The obedience of Christ dwarfs the effect of the disobedience of Adam into insignificance! See Romans 5:12-21. The word* ***aichmalōtizō*** *from* ***aichme****, spear and* ***halosis****, to capture, thus, to arrest at spear point.)*

Many translations read, "to obey Christ!" This makes an enormous difference: to obey Christ keeps one restricted to the same limitations and frustrations experienced under the law of performance; one's own inconsistency and inability bring about the inevitable sense of shame, guilt and failure; whereas the obedience of Christ already achieved every blessing that God has always had in mind for us. The life of our design is redeemed! This is the sharpness of the spear whereby we arrest every thought! The understanding of the obedience of Christ is the best anti-virus protection to harness one's mind with. The Greek word, ***aichmalotizo*** means to arrest at spear point! No contradiction to the implication of his obedience is tolerated. The moment of faith is like the effect of light dispelling darkness, effortlessly! Darkness does not erase truth, it only hides from view that which already is true. The true light that enlightens everyone has come!

John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! *(This day would begin our calendar and record the fact that human history would forever be divided into before and after Christ. The incarnation would make the image of God visible in human form. In him who is the blueprint of our lives there is more than enough light to displace the darkness in every human life. He is the true light that enlightens everyone! [Col 1:15; 2:9, 10; 2 Cor 4:6])*

(See 2 Cor. 4:1-18 in Chapter 6 Asia in One Man.)

Col. 1:13 He rescued us from the [1]dominion of darkness *(the sense-ruled world, dominated by the law of performance)* **and relocated us into the kingdom where the love of his Son rules.** *(Darkness is not a force, it is the absence of light. [See Eph 4:18] A darkened understanding veiled the truth of our redeemed design from us. 2 Cor 4:4. What "empowered" darkness was the lie that we believed about ourselves! The word, [1]**exousia**, sometimes translated authority, is from **ek**, origin or source, and **eimi**, I am. Thus, I was confused about who I am until the day that I heard and understood the grace of God in truth, as in a mirror. See 2 Corinthians 3:18, John 1:12.)*

Col. 1:14 In God's mind mankind is associated in Christ; in his blood sacrifice we were ransomed; our redemption was secured; our [1]sins were completely done away with. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. See Deuteronomy 32:18, "You have forgotten the Rock that begot you and have gotten out of step with the God who danced with you!" Hebrew, חול **khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21. Sin distorts the life of our design. Jesus reveals and redeemed our true form.)*

Col. 1:15 In him the image and likeness of God is made visible in human form in order that everyone may recognize their true origin in him. He is the firstborn of every creature. *(What darkness veiled from us he unveiled. In him we clearly see the mirror reflection of our original life. The Son of his love gives accurate evidence of his image in human form. The incarnation means that God can never again be invisible!)*

Col. 2:14 His body nailed to the cross hung there as the [3]document of mankind's guilt; in dying our death he [1]cancelled the detailed [2]hand-written [3]record which testified against us. Every [1]stain on our conscience, reminding of the sense of failure and guilt, was thus fully blotted out. *(The word, [1]**exaleipho**, comes from **ek**, out of, and **aleipho**, with **a,** as a particle of union, and **liparos**, to grease, to leave a stain; guilt, as well as all hurtful memories were like grease stains upon the conscience. In N.T. only here and Rev 3:5; 7:17; 21:4 and in Acts 3:19 "Be awakened in your minds and fully converted to face the fact of your redeemed innocence - your sins have been thoroughly blotted out!" Plato used it of blotting out a writing.*

*The word, [2]**cheirographon**, translates as hand-written. The word, [3]**dogma**, comes from **dokeo**, a thought pattern; thus thought patterns engraved by human experience of constant failure to do what the law required. In his personal handwriting mankind endorsed their own death sentence. The hands of fallen mankind struck the body of Jesus with the blows of their religious hatred and fury when they nailed his bloodied body to the tree; they did not realize that in the mystery of God's economy, Jesus became the scapegoat of the entire human race! [Isaiah 53:4, 5] See notes on Heb 8:12. "The slate wiped clean, that old arrest warrant cancelled and nailed to Christ's Cross." —The Message.)*

Col. 2:15 In him dying mankind's death, he [1]defused every possible claim of accusation against the human race and thus made a public [2]spectacle of every [3]rule and authority in God's brilliant triumph, demonstrated in him. The [4]voice of the cross will never be silenced! *(The horror of the Cross is now the eternal trophy of God's triumph over sin! The cross stripped religion of its authority to manipulate mankind with guilt. Every accusation lost its leverage to blackmail the human race with condemnation and shame! The word, [1]**apekduomai**, is translated from **apo**, away from, and **ekduo**, to be stripped of clothing; to disarm; the religious facade that disguised the law of works as a means of defining a person's life, was openly defeated. Same word used in Col 3:9. The dominance of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil [**poneros**, hard work and labor] was ended. The word, [2]**deikmatizo**, means to exhibit in public. See [3]commentary below of the words **arche**, rule and **exousia**, authority. The word, [4]**parresia**, comes from **pas**, all and **rheo**, outspokenness, pouring forth speech.*

"He stripped all the spiritual tyrants in the universe of their sham authority at the Cross and marched them naked through the streets." — The Message

*See commentary for 1 Corinthians 15:24, The complete conclusion in his work of redemption is celebrated in his yielding the full harvest of his reign to God the Father, having brought to nought the law of works which supported every definition of dominion under the fall, including all **principalities**, all authority and every dynamic influence in society. [He brought to nought the law of works, **katargeo**, from **kata**, meaning intensity, and **argos**, meaning labor; thus free from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ. All principalities, [3]**arche**, or chief ranks, i.e., kings, governors; this includes any governing system whereby one is ranked above the other on the basis of their performance or preference. All authority, [3]**exousia**,*

*comes from **ek**, denoting origin and **eimi**, I am; in this case, because of what I can do I am defined by what I can do better than you; therefore, I have authority over you. Every dynamic influence in society, **dunamis**, means power, in this case, willpower. Every government structure in society will be brought under the dominion of grace where the Christ-life rules.]*

In 1 Corinthians 2:7-8, We voice words of wisdom that was hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in mankind. Neither the politicians nor the theologians of the day had a clue about this mystery [of mankind's association in Christ]; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory!)

Phil. 2:8 And so we have the drama of the cross in context: the man Jesus Christ who is fully God, becomes fully man to the extent of willingly dying humanity's death at the hands of his own creation. He embraced the curse and shame of the lowest kind in dying a criminal's death. *(Thus, through the doorway of death, he descended into our hellish darkness. Rev 9:1 When the fifth celestial shepherd-messenger blew his trumpet, I saw a star that had fallen to earth from the sky. The star was given the key to the shaft into the fathomless depths of the Abyss. [In his death, Jesus conquered the underworld and he has the keys; no-one else does!] Rev 1:18 I am also the Living One; I became dead and now, see, here I am alive unto the ages of the ages and I have the keys wherewith I have disengaged the gates of Hades and death! Also, Eph 4:8-10.)*

Phil. 2:9 From this place of utter humiliation, God exalted him to the highest rank. God graced Jesus with a Name that is far above every other name. *(Eph 1:20 Do you want to measure the mind and muscle of God? Consider the force which he unleashed in Jesus Christ when he raised him from the dead and forever seated him enthroned as his executive authority in the realm of the heavens. Jesus is God's right hand of power! He was raised up from the deepest dungeons of human despair to the highest region of heavenly bliss! [See Eph 2:5,6 & 4:8,9] Eph 1:21 Infinitely above all the combined forces of rule, authority, dominion or governments; he is ranked superior to any name that could ever be given to anyone of this age or any age still to come in the eternal future. The name of Jesus endorses his mission as fully accomplished! He is the Savior of the world! Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible. See also Eph 3:15, Every family in heaven and on earth originates in him; his is mankind's family name and he remains the authentic identity*

of every nation.)

Phil. 2:10 What his name unveils will persuade every creature of their redemption! Every knee in heaven and upon the earth and under the earth shall bow in spontaneous worship! *(See Isa 45:23 "My own life is the guarantee of my conviction, says the Lord, every knee shall freely bow to me in worship, and every tongue shall spontaneously speak from the same God-inspired source.")*

Phil. 2:11 Also every tongue will voice and resonate the same devotion to his unquestionable Lordship as the Redeemer of life! Jesus Christ has glorified God as the Father of creation! This is the ultimate conclusion of the Father's [1]intent! *(The word [1]**doxa,** intent, opinion, often translated, glory. Rev 5:13 And I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth and in the sea, and all therein, saying, "To him who sits upon the throne and to the Lamb be blessing and honor and glory and might for ever and ever!" Also my commentary note on Rom 14:11. Paul, here quotes Isaiah 45:23 See verse 20,22,& 23 "Face me and **be** saved all the ends of the earth! [Note, '**Be saved**!' Not 'become saved!'] I am God; your idols are figments of your invention and imagination!" Isa 45:23 "I have sworn by myself; the word of my mouth has begotten righteousness; this cannot be reversed!" The Hebrew word, יצא **Yatsa** can be translated, begotten like in Judges 8:30 "Every knee shall bow to me and every tongue shall echo my oath!" [Thus, speak with the same certainty sourced in me!] The Hebrew word, שבע **Shaba** means to seven oneself, that is, swear - thus in the Hebrew mind, by repeating a declaration seven times one brings an end to all dispute! See Heb 6:13.16,17.)*

Phil. 2:12 Considering this amazing outcome of what our faith sees and celebrates, I strongly urge you my darling friends to continue to have your [1]ears tuned to that which inspires your conduct to give full expression to the detail of your own salvation in a most personal and practical way. See salvation in its earth-shattering awesome and ultimate conclusion. I know that my personal presence encourages you greatly but now I want you to realize an inspiration in my absence that supersedes anything you've known before. This would mean that even if you were never to see my face again or receive another Epistle from me, it will make no difference at all to your faith! *(The success of Paul's ministry was not to enslave people to him but to his gospel! He knew that he would be more present in his message than in his person! Ministry success is not measured by how many partners you can congregate, but by how absent you can preach yourself! The word often translated,*

obedience, is the word [1]***upoakoo,*** *to be under the inspired influence of what you hear.)*

Phil. 2:13 Discover God himself as your inexhaustible inner source; he ignites you with both the desire and energy that matches his own delight!

The success of the cross is the most dynamic and tangible reference to ordinary people living in victory over sin and temptation; not through their strong willpower, but by discovering what God believes about them.

There is only one faith that matters, not what we believe about God, but what God believes about us! Ephesians 4:

The Christ life realized in us is a well of living water, freeing us from within to live the life of our design, uncluttered by the effect of Adams fall.

Identity redeemed - Chapter 12

The most tragic consequence of the fall of humanity was the loss of their conviction of their true identity. A new dominance was introduced, and mankind became subject to the treadmill of performance as the measure of their worth and the cruel judgment of deception. An environment ruled by chance, change and temporal values became their reference.

The greatest distraction and contradiction to our true identity and destiny is to live a life subject to an inferior opinion. We have inherited and adopted a set of values and prejudices that crippled relationships on every level of society.

We have forgotten what manner of people we are. In Adam mankind fell into the maize of a confused identity; they fell from I am into, I am not!

When Adam 'died' his awareness and consciousness of the divine likeness in him became reduced to merely knowing himself, his wife and God from a guilt-based and performance-driven, human point of view. He lost the sense of the doxa-smile of God's joy and approval and began to live the life of the flesh, with its fading glories, typical of fragile, seasonal flowers.

When Jesus tells the stories of the lost sheep, the lost coin and the lost son he emphasis in all 3 parables that neither original ownership, nor original value was lost! You cannot be lost unless you belong! The turning point in the prodigal son's life was when he came to himself! Luke.15:17.

We all like sheep have gone astray. Jesus is the good Shepherd; he came to seek and to rescue the lost!

In Psalm 22 David paints a most dramatic prophetic picture of the crucifixion of the Messiah and in verse 27 boldly proclaims the outcome, "All the ends of the earth shall remember and turn to the Lord!" Then in the next Psalm he sings about the Shepherd "that leads me to the waters of reflection, where my soul remembers who I am!"

Eph. 2:10 We are engineered by his design; he molded and manufactured us in Christ. We are his workmanship, his poetry.

We have forgotten the Rock from which we were hewn, the God who gave us birth! Deut. 32:18

You who seek God, (here is your clue!) Look to the rock from which you were hewn...Isa. 51:1

Col. 1:15 In him the invisible God is made visible again; in order that every one may recognize their true origin in him; he is the firstborn of every creature. *(What darkness veiled from us he unveiled. In him we clearly see the mirror reflection of our original image and likeness redeemed. The Son of his love gives evidence of his image in human form.)*

Col. 1:19 The full measure of everything God has in mind for mankind indwells him.

Col. 2:9 In him, all the fullness of [1]Deity [2]resides in a human body! He proves that human life is tailor-made for God! *(The word, [1]**theotes**, godhead/deity, is feminine. Jesus exhibits what the Father, Son and Spirit is like, in human form. The word [2]katoikeō means to dwell in, to inhabit. While the expanse cannot measure or define God, their detailed likeness is displayed in human skin. See Col 1:19, God is fully at home in him. Jesus is God's happy delight to be human.)*

Col. 2:10 We are complete in him! Jesus mirrors our wholeness and [1]endorses our true identity. He is "I am" in us! *(God packaged completeness in "I am," mirrored in you! The word, [1]**exousia**, is often translated authority; from, **ek + eimi,** originating out of "I am." The days are over where our lives were dictated to under the rule of the law of performance and an inferior identity. It's not about who I used to be or who I'm striving to become; we are celebrating I am! Any teaching that leaves one with a sense of lack and imperfection rather than completeness is a distraction from the truth. Jesus is the author and finisher of faith's capacity within us to mirror and celebrate completeness!)*

Heb. 1:1 Throughout [1]ancient times God spoke in many fragments and glimpses of prophetic thought to our fathers. Now, this entire conversation has [2]finally dawned in sonship. Suddenly what seemed to be an ancient language falls fresh and new like the dew on the tender grass! He is the sum total of every utterance of God. He is whom the Prophets pointed to and we are his immediate audience! *(The word [1]**palai**, meaning, of old, ancient; from **palin** through the idea of oscillatory repetition or retrocession; anew, afresh. See Deut 32:1 "Give ear, Oh heavens, and I will speak; and let the earth hear the words of my mouth. Deut 32:2 May my teaching drop as the rain, my speech distil as the dew, as the gentle rain upon the tender grass, and as the showers upon the herb.... Deut 32:18 You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who gave you birth. Like in James 1:24, we have forgotten what manner of people we are - we have forgotten the face of our birth! Jesus successfully rescued the real you, not the pseudo, make-belief you! God has never*

believed less of you than what he was able to communicate in the sonship that Jesus mirrored and redeemed!

*The word [2]**eschatos** means extreme; last in time or in space; the uttermost part, the final conclusion. What God said about 'you-manity' in Jesus defines eschatology! Jesus is what has been on the tip of the Father's tongue all along!)*

Heb. 1:2 In sonship, God declares the Incarnate Word to be the heir of all things. He is, after all, the author of the ages. We have our beginning and our being in him. *(Sonship endorses heirship! See Heb 6:16-18.)*

Heb. 1:3 Jesus is the crescendo of God's conversation; he gives context and content to the authentic thought. Everything that God had in mind for mankind is voiced in him. Jesus is God's language. He is the radiant and flawless expression of the person and [1]intent of God. He mirrors God's [2]character and exhibits his every attribute in human form. He is the voice of God announcing our redeemed innocence. By his own doing he accomplished purification for sins and sat down, enthroned in the boundless measure of his majesty in the right and of God as the executive authority; the force of the universe, upholding everything that exists. His voice is the dynamic that sustains the entire cosmos. *("Having accomplished purification of sins, he sat down ..." His throne is the very authority and proof of mankind's redeemed innocence!*

More than two thousand years ago the conversation that had begun before time was recorded—sustained in fragments of thought throughout the ages, whispered in prophetic language, chiseled in stone and inscribed in human conscience and memory—became a man. Beyond the tablet of stone, the papyrus scroll or parchment roll, human life has become the articulate voice of God. Jesus is the crescendo of God's conversation with humankind; he gives context and content to the authentic thought. His name declares his mission. As Savior of the world he truly redeemed the image and likeness of the invisible God and made him apparent again in human form as in a mirror.

*The word [1]**doxa** from **dokeo**, opinion or intent defines the glory of God. The word [2]**charakter** from **charax** - to engrave - translated 'mark of the beast' in the book of Revelation. Either the character of the Father or the character of the fallen mind will influence our actions (hand) because it is what engages our thoughts [forehead].*

Like in Isa 55:8-11 "Your thoughts are not my thoughts; therefore your ways are not my ways....but my word will incarnate, and saturate earth (flesh) just like the rain and the

snow cancel the distance between heaven and earth, so shall my word be that goes forth from my mouth! It shall not return void but prosper in my purpose!")

In the culmination of God's eternal thought Jesus exhibits his exact likeness, the radiance of his glory in human form, and successfully redeems mankind's innocence.

The truth about mankind is revealed in Christ; this is the mystery of grace: God revealed us in Christ!

The perfect law of liberty frees you to discover your true self beyond all contradiction! James 1:25.

Every human life is equally valued and represented in Christ. He gives context and reference to our being as in a mirror; not as an example for us, but of us.

The "ugly duckling" saw reflected in the water the truth that freed the swan!

Gal. 1:15 God's eternal [1]love dream separated me from my mother's womb; his grace became my [2]identity. *(The word, [1]**eudokeo**, means his beautiful intention; the well done opinion. [My mother's womb, my natural lineage and identity as son of Benjamin.] The word, [2]**kaleo**, means to surname, to summon by name.)*

Gal. 1:16 This is the heart of the gospel that I proclaim; it began with an unveiling of his Son [1]in me, freeing me to announce the same sonship [2]in the masses of non-Jewish people. I felt no immediate urgency to compare notes with those who were familiar with Christ from a mere historic point of view. *(The Greek text is quite clear: "It pleased the Father to reveal his Son in me in order that I may proclaim him in the nations!" The words, **en emoi**, translate as "in me," and **en ethnos** translate as in the Gentile nations, or the masses of non Jewish people! Not "among" the Gentiles as most translations have it. Later, when Barnabas is sent to investigate the conversion of the Greeks in Acts 11, instead of reporting his findings to HQ in Jerusalem, he immediately finds Paul, knowing that Paul's gospel is the revelation of the mystery of Christ in the nations [see Col 1:27]. No wonder then that those believers were the first to be called Christians, or Christ-like Anointed ones!)*

Jesus Christ confirms that the son of man is the son of God. "Call no man your father on earth, for you have one Father who is in heaven." [Mt 23:9] Paul reminds the Greek philosophers in Acts 17 that we live and move and have our being in God; mankind is indeed the offspring of God. He is quoting from their own writings, Epimenedes 600 BC and Aratus, 300 BC. The incorruptible seed of sonship is as much present in every person as the seed is already in all soil, even in the desert, waiting for the rain to awaken and

ignite its life!

"For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven and water the earth, making it bring forth and sprout, so shall my word be that proceeds from my mouth, it shall not disappoint my purpose, it shall saturate the soil and cause it to bring forth and sprout. Instead of the thorn the cyprus and instead of the brier the myrtle!" [Isa 55:8-11, 13]

In Matthew 13:44, Jesus says that the kingdom of heaven is like a treasure hidden in an agricultural field! There is more to the field than what meets the eye!

In 2 Corinthians 4:4, 7 Paul says that we have this treasure in earthen vessels! But the god of this world has blindfolded our minds through unbelief [believing a lie about ourselves, Num 13:33] to keep us from seeing the light of the gospel revealing the glory of God in the face of Christ who is the image of God, as in a mirror!

When Jesus speaks of the sinner he speaks of him as the lost sheep, coin, or son. [Lk 15] You cannot be lost unless you belong! The inscription and image did not disappear from the coin when it was lost. How can we praise God and with the same mouth curse a person made in his image? [James 3:9 and Luke 20:20-26] Mankind has forgotten what manner of people they are by design; we are the image and likeness bearer of our Maker; this is exactly what Jesus came to reveal and redeem.

We may now behold him with unveiled faces as in a mirror and be immediately transformed [in our understanding] into his likeness. From the glory [opinion] of the flesh to the glory [opinion] of God. Legalistic religion kept the veil in place; the proclaiming of the liberating truth of the Good News, removes the veil! The "ugly duckling" didn't need a face-lift or lessons on how to fake the swan life! It only needed to know the truth about itself to be free indeed.)

Gal. 1:17 This is radical! I deliberately distanced myself from Jerusalem and the disciples of Jesus. I landed up in Arabia before I returned again to Damascus. *(The weight of this revelation left me no choice; instead of finding out more about Christ in history, I desire to discover him more in me! Also 2 Cor 5:16.)*

Gal. 1:18 Then three years later I ventured into Jerusalem, specifically to meet with [1]Kefas. I ended up staying with him for two weeks. *(In [1]Aramaic the word "rock" is **kefas**, and in Greek it is **petros**. Here Paul calls Peter Kefas in order to emphasize the meaning of his name rather than the familiar sound of Peter. Jesus said that the revelation of mankind's true identity and origin is the rock foundation of the **Ekklesia**, lit. original identity from **ek,** the Preposition denoting origin and **kaleo**, to surname. [Mt 16:13-18; see also Isa 51:1; Deut 32:18; 1 Peter 2:5 and 1 Kings 6:7.])*

Gal. 1:19 During this time I did not see any of the other Apostles except James, the younger brother of Jesus. *(Saul [Paul], Peter [Kefas] and James shared a vital revelation; all three of them discovered their original identity beyond their natural birth: "From now on, we no longer know anyone according to the flesh", says Paul in 2 Cor 5:16. "Simon son of Jonah, flesh and blood did not reveal to you that as the son of man, I am the Christ, the Son of God; now that you know who I am, allow me to introduce you to you! I say that you are Mr Rock; a Chip of the old Block. [Mt 16:17, 18] James speaks about the effect of the Word as discovering the reflection of the face of our birth as in a mirror there! Rescuing us from our forgetfulness! "We have forgotten what manner of people we are!"*

During the three years of Jesus's ministry none of his brothers believed in him. [John 7:5] But in 1 Corinthians 15:7, Paul specifically mentions the fact that Jesus also appeared to James after his resurrection. Suddenly it dawns on James that the Father of light birthed mankind by the eternal Word of truth; the word that became flesh and died mankind's death and who co-raised mankind into newness of life in his resurrection. If anyone hears this word they see the face of their birth as in a mirror! As Peter later admitted "We were born anew when Jesus was raised from the dead!" [1 Pet 1:3] The word that was before time was is our genesis. Jas 1:17, 18, 23, 24.)

The days of window-shopping are over! The mirror revelation makes the Bible a new book! A mirror can only reflect the object; likewise the purpose of the page was only to reflect the message, which is "Christ in you"; he completes the deepest longing of every human heart. There is no more accurate translation of Scripture than the Incarnation.

Jesus has come to reveal that the son of man is the son of God. "If you have seen me you have seen the Father! Mat 23:9 "Call no man your father on earth, for you have one Father, who is in heaven." He says to Peter, "Flesh-and-blood cannot reveal to you who the son of man is, but my Father who is in heaven; blessed are you, Simon son of Jonah, I give you a new name that reveals your original identity: you are Mr Rock, a chip of the old Block! (Petros, hewn out of the rock, petra. Isa 51:1, Deut 32:3, 4, 18.) This revelation is the rock foundation that I will build my identity upon, [my image and likeness] and the gates of Hades, (from ha + eido, not to see) that trapped mankind into the walled city of the senses, will not prevail against the voice that surnames and summons mankind again. (Mt 16:13, 17) Church, Ekklesia, from ek, denoting source or origin and klesia from kaleo, to surname or identify by name.)

In him we discover that we are not here by chance or accident, nor by the desire of an earthly parent; neither are we the product of a mere physical conception; we exist by the expression of God's desire to reveal himself in the flesh. His eternal, invisible Word, his Spirit-thought, became flesh! [egeneto, from ginomai.]James says: "Of his own will he brought us forth by the word of truth ... if any man hears this word, he sees the face of his birth as in a mirror." (Jas. 1:17, 18, 23) Now we may know even as we have always been known. (1 Cor. 13:12)

God never compromised his original thought. "The word became flesh and took up residence (tabernacled) in us, and we gazed with wonder and amazement upon the mystery of our inclusion in him. (theaomai, to gaze upon, to perceive). We saw his glory (doxa, the display of his opinion); the glory as of the original, authentic begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth." (The original mind, or opinion of God, preserved and now revealed in Christ. He is both the "only begotten," monogenes, as in the authentic original mold, as well as the first born from the dead. [Col. 1:18, 1Pet. 1:3].)

Israel died in the desert not because of an inferior redemption from slavery, but because they believed a lie about themselves! "We are grasshoppers compared to the giants. Num. 13:33

They did not realize that those giants were already defeated and paralysed with fear! Josh. 2:11.

The church has preached a defeated devil back into business for many years!

The devil is not the parent of a single person; he is the father of lies!

Mal. 2:10 Have we not all one Father? Has not one God created us?

Sin is singular - its symptoms are plural - its been a sonship thing from the beginning - no wonder Jesus says freedom indeed is found in the truth of our authentic and redeemed sonship - even the "other brother" has the Father pleading with him, "My son you have always been with me and all that I have is yours!!" Sin is not about things you do or don't do - sin is missing out on sonship!

1 John 1:1 The [1]Logos is the source; everything commences in him. The initial reports concerning him that have reached our ears, and which we indeed bore witness to with our own eyes - to the point that we became irresistibly attracted - now captivates our gaze. In him we witnessed [2]tangible life in its most articulate form. *(The Logos - the [1]Word. To touch, [2]**psallo**, to touch the string of a musical instrument, thus resonance.)*

1 John 1:2 The same life that [1]was [2]face to face with the Father from the beginning, has now dawned on us! The infinite life of the Father became visible before our eyes in a human person! *(In the beginning "was" the Word; [1]**eimi**, timeless existence, "I am". The Preposition [2]**pros** says so much more than 'with,' it suggests towards; face to face. See John 1:1&2. Also John 1:14 "Suddenly the invisible eternal Word takes on visible form! The Incarnation! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible display of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the authentic begotten Son. The glory (that Adam lost) returns in fullness! Only grace can communicate truth in such complete context!" Also John 1:18 "Until this moment God remained invisible; now the authentic begotten Son, the blueprint of mankind's design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us.")*

1 John 1:3 We include you in this conversation; you are the immediate audience of the logic of God! This is the Word that always was; we saw him incarnate and witnessed his language as defining our lives. In the incarnation Jesus includes mankind in the eternal friendship of the Father and the Son! This life now finds expression in an unreserved union. *(We do not invent fellowship; we are invited into the fellowship of the Father and the Son!)*

1 John 1:4 I am writing this to complete your joy and include you in my delight! *(In all these years since the ascension of Jesus, John, now ninety years old, continues to enjoy unhindered friendship with God and desires to extend this same fellowship to everyone through this writing. You are never too old to learn to write or become computer literate!)*

In our make-up we are the god-kind with an appetite for more than what bread and the senses can satisfy. Jesus proves that we come from above. It would not be possible for a person to access the heavenly sphere if they did not originate from there; the Son of Man is in heavenly places in the bosom of his Father whilst on this planet in an earthly body *(John 3:13)*.

In his death, descent into the darkness of our hell and in his glorious resurrection, he prepared a place for us so that we may be where he is! The fullness of Deity bodily indwells him *(Col. 2:9)*! Jesus said to Nicodemus, "Unless you are born from above,

anouthen (meaning unless you originate from above), you cannot access heavenly realities; you would have no appetite for heavenly things!" *(John 3:3)*.

John records how Jesus defended his message when he declared, to the disgust of the religious leaders, "I and the Father are one!" John 10:30 - He quoted Psalm 82:6, "I say you are gods, sons of the Most High, all of you!"

Mankind began in God; we are not the invention of our parents!

Jesus declares the climax of his mission where in his death and resurrection every possible definition of separation would be cancelled.

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and the Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

John 1:12 Everyone who [1]realizes their association in him, [6]convinced that he is their [2]original life and that [7]his name defines them, God [5]gives the assurance that they are indeed his [4]offspring, [2]begotten of him; he [3]sanctions the legitimacy of their sonship. *(The word often translated, to receive, [1]**lambano**, means to take in hand, to comprehend, to grasp, to identify with. This word suggests that even though he came to his own, there are those who do not [1]identify with their true [2]origin revealed in him, and like the many Pharisees they behave like children of a foreign father, the father of lies [John 8: 44]. Neither God's legitimate fatherhood, nor his ownership is in question; mankind's indifference to their true [2]origin is the problem. This is what the Gospel addresses with utmost clarity in the person of Jesus Christ. Jesus has come to introduce the individual to themselves again; mankind has forgotten what manner of person they are by design! [James 1:24, Deut. 32:18, Psalm 22:27].*

*The word, [2]**genesthai**, from **ginomai**, means to generate; to become; John employs this verb in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. Greek Infinitives could have either a present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms has more to do with aspect than with time.*

The Present Infinitive is used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. This is an important point since many translations of this verse suggests that God's ability to make us his sons can only be in response to something we must first do in order to trigger God into action! Our grasping ***[lambano]*** *is simply the awakening to the fact that our genesis is already completed in the* ***Logos****. [See John 1:3] The* ***Logos*** *is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive Parent reference to their genesis. There is nothing original, except the Word. We are his offspring. [see also Acts 17:28]. "He has come to give us understanding to know him who is true and to realize that we are in him who is true." [1 John 5:20].)*

The word, [3]***exousia****, often translated "power;" as in, he gave "power" to* [2]*become children of God, is a compound word; from* ***ek****, always denoting origin or source and* ***eimi****, I am; thus, out of I am! This gives* [3]*legitimacy and authority to our sonship;* [4]***teknon****, translated as offspring, child.*

"He has given," [5]***didomi****, in this case to give something to someone that already belongs to them; thus, to return. The fact that they already are his own, born from above and that they have their* [2]*beginning and their being in him is now confirmed in their realizing it! Convinced,* [6]***pisteo****;* [7]*his name* ***onoma****, is mankind's family name. [see Eph 3:15].*

["He made to be their true selves, their child-of-God selves." — The Message)

John 1:13 These are the ones who discover their genesis in God, beyond their natural conception! This is not about our blood lineage or whether we were a wanted- or unwanted-child; this is about our God-begotteness. We are his dream come true and not the invention of our parents. You are indeed the greatest idea that God has ever had! *(See Jeremiah 1:5; 29:11 & John 3:2-7)*

See my commentary notes at the end of Revelation 3 on our ***God-Identity*** - Also, Revelation 17 on ***The Lamb's Book of Life - Mankind's Redeemed Identity.***

1 Peter 2:10 You were once a people without identity, but have now discovered the integrity of your original identity in God; where there was no mercy *[under the cruel judgment of the law of works, sponsored by the "I am not-tree-system,]* **you have now received much mercy!**

1 Peter 2:11 It does not matter how appealing the system of the flesh-glory seems,

it can never define or fulfill you; do not allow yourself to be lured into its strategies and sway! You are dearly loved! I urge you from within this place of our joint oneness to remain like pilgrims and strangers to the subtleties of a world-system that is foreign to your design. Avoid any influence that does not [2]resonate with your innocence. *(The word, [1]**parakaleo** has two components; **para**, suggesting close proximity and **kaleo**, to surname or to identify by name; suggesting close and intimate companionship; the word [2]**apechomai, apo**, away from and **echo**, to abstain from that which does not resonate.)*

The authentic ID of human life is defined in the Book of Life - also called, the Tree of Life, representing the redeemed life of our design, versus the alternative Tree of the knowledge of good and evil, representing mankind's identity under scrutiny and questioned. The "I am not-Tree" heads up the system of a works and performance-based philosophy. To have your name written in the Book of Life simply suggests that you discover your identity there in the Zoe-life, redeemed by the Lamb. You may have only known yourself according to the flesh, as Simon, the son of Jonah, while you really are Petros! Mr. Rock, you are a chip of the old Block! Every evidence of an inferior identity will be cast into the lake of sulphur burning away the dross to reveal the gold! Any idea of an identity outside of the Book of Life, is dissolved! The Lamb's Book of Life and not the law of personal performance, defines us...

God's Strategy ~ Asia in one man - Chapter 13

Paul writes in Rom. 16:5 "Salute my dear friend Epaenetus. He represents the whole of Asia to me, since he was my first convert there."

God always sees the many in the one. In God's economy "one died for all; therefore all died!" 2 Cor. 5:14

Every human life is equally valued, included and represented in JesusChrist.

The law reveals what happened to mankind in Adam; Grace reveals what happened to this same mankind in Christ.

We were found in Christ, before we were lost in Adam!

1 Cor. 2:7 We voice words of wisdom that were hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's [1]Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in man. Our glorification has always been God's agenda, even [2]before time was. (*Paul employs the words, [1]**prohoritso**, predesigned and [2]**pro aion** before the ages, in order to emphasize the certainty of God's persuasion concerning their determined intent to rescue and restore their image and likeness in us. Our redemption existed upon the inner-horizons of God before the ages. The word, **prohoritso**, from **pro**, before and **horitso**, horizon; means pre-defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan. See Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that we pre-existed in God; he defines us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory that we lost in Adam.)*

1 Cor. 2:8 Neither the politicians nor the religious leaders of the day had a clue about this mystery; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory! *(Time witnessed and recorded the death and resurrection of an individual; eternity witnessed the death and resurrection of the human race!)*

John 1:29 The next day John saw Jesus approaching him, and declared: "Behold the Lamb of God; this is the one who would [1]lift the [2]sin of the [3]cosmos like an anchor from the sea floor, for mankind to sail free!" *(This is unheard of! It is not about a vengeful god demanding a sacrifice; this is your Father and Creator providing himself as sacrifice. The ultimate sacrifice for sin would never be something we did, or brought to God to appeal to him; the shocking scandal of the cross, is the fact that mankind is confronted with the extravagant, embarrassing proportions of the love of their Maker; Father Son and Spirit would go to the most ridiculous extreme to finally*

*convince us of their heart towards us! In order to persuade us of our worth, God speaks the most severe scapegoat language: "Behold the Lamb of God, who takes away [**airo** - lifts up] the sin [singular] of the world!" This completely disarms religion! Suddenly there is nothing that we can do to persuade God about our sincere intentions; this is God persuading us of their eternal love dream! The word **αἴρω** - [1]**airo**, a primary verb; to lift up; by implication to take up or away; specifically to raise the anchor to sail away. See John 12:32 When I am lifted up from the earth, I will draw all judgment to me! Also John 19:15 - Lift him up! Lift him up! Crucify him!" Note, the word [2]sin is singular **hamartian** - sin is not stuff you do, sin is being out of sync with your true identity and thus, missing out on sonship. The word, [3]**kosmos** in the NT refers to the entire human family and their social structures.)*

Heb. 1:3 When he had by himself purged our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high. (KJV) The throne of God is established upon our innocence!

History recorded the death and resurrection of one man; eternity recorded the death and resurrection of the human race.

Rom. 4:25 Our sins [1]resulted in his death; his resurrection is [1]proof of our righteousness. Here is the equation: He was handed over [1]because of our [2]short fallings *[our fallen mindset]*; **he was raised [1]because we were declared righteous! His resurrection is the official receipt to our acquittal.** *(This is one of the most important statements in the entire Bible. His cross = our sins, his resurrection = our innocence! His death brought closure to our short fallings; his resurrection is proof of our redeemed righteousness. Why was Jesus handed over to die? Because of, [1]**dia**, our transgressions. Why was he raised from the dead? Because of, [1]**dia**, our righteousness! His resurrection reveals our righteousness! If mankind was still guilty after Jesus died, his resurrection would be irrelevant! This explains Acts 10:28 and 2 Corinthians 5:14 and 16.*

See Young's Literal Translation, Rom 4:25 "who was delivered up because of our offences, and was raised up because of our being declared righteous."

*The word [2]**parapiptō** has two components, **para**, closest possible proximity of union, and **piptō**, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to fall; to be thrust down; from **petomai**, to fly. Thus to stop flying! Losing altitude! This speaks of mankind's short fallings, or their fallen mindset. See Col 3:1-3.*

In Acts 17:31, Paul explains to the Greek philosophers that according to the Jewish prophetic word, "God had fixed a day on which he would judge the world in

righteousness by a man whom he has appointed, and of this he has given proof to all mankind by raising him from the dead." God's declaration of your redeemed innocence is his most urgent invitation to you(manity) to encounter intimate oneness!

See also 1 Peter 1:10-12 "This salvation which you now know as your own, is the theme of the prophetic thought; this is what captured the Prophets' attention for generations and became the object of their most diligent inquiry and scrutiny. They knew all along that mankind's salvation was a grace revelation, sustained in their prophetic utterance! (Salvation would never be by personal achievement or a reward to willpower-driven initiative! The law of works would never replace grace!)

1 Pet 1:11 In all of their conversation there was a constant quest to determine who the Messiah would be, and exactly when this will happen. They knew with certainty that it was the spirit of Christ within them pointing prophetically and giving testimony to the sufferings of the Christ and the subsequent glory. (Whatever glory was lost in Adam, would be redeemed again in Jesus Christ!)

1 Pet 1:12 It was revealed to them that this glorious grace message that they were communicating pointed to a specific day and person beyond their own horizon and generation; they saw you in their prophetic view! This heavenly announcement had you in mind all along! They proclaimed glad tidings to you in advance, in the Holy Spirit, commissioned from heaven; the celestial shepherd-messengers themselves longed to gaze deeply into its complete fulfillment.")

Paul boldly announces to the idol worshipping Greek philosophers in Acts 17 that the Creator "is not far from each one of us! In him we live and move and have our being! We are indeed his offspring!" He understands that in Christ God cancelled every definition of distance! In the incarnation God embraced the human race! He is equally Immanuel to everyone! In the light of the incarnation there can no longer be an "us" and "them!" This message claims the most radical mind-shift! The word translated repent is a very unfortunate and deliberate mistake! It comes from the Latin word, ***paenitentia***, and in order to squeeze even more mileage and guilt money out of people a "re" was added to make it repennance! The Greek word ***metanoia*** suggests a radical mindshift! It is a compound word, ***meta*** means together with and ***noeo***, means to perceive with the mind. It describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing. Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery. It has nothing in common with the Latin word paenitentia - where the idea of penance and repentance stems from! The

good news confronts mankind with Jesus as the mind of God made up about us! Paul makes this powerful statement to these philosophers in Acts 17:30, 31, "The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he implores all people everywhere to discover God's thoughts towards them, because he has fixed a day and appointed a person, and on that day in that person he would judge the world in righteousness, and of this he has given proof to all men by raising him from the dead."

The resurrection of Jesus Christ announces mankind's innocence! This is the heart of the gospel!

In dramatic fashion God re-writes Peters doctrine and changes his appetite! Acts 10:28 "God has shown me that I should not call any person common or unclean."

1 Pet. 1:3 Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! By his great mercy we have been born anew to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead.

2 Cor. 5:16 From now on, therefore, we regard no one from a human point of view; even though we once regarded Christ from a human point of view, we regard him thus no longer. RSV

Eph. 1:3-4 Let's celebrate God! He lavished every blessing heaven has upon us in Christ! He associated us in Christ before the fall of the world! Jesus is God's mind made up about mankind! He always knew in his love that he would present us again face to face before him in blameless innocence. The word, katenopion, suggests the closest possible proximity, face-to-face! The concept of association is a very powerful one; it suggests that it is impossible to bring the one party to mind without immediately and on equal terms include the other. The one immediately reminds of the other!

Col. 1:25 I am an administrator in God's economy; my mission is to make his word known to you with utmost clarity.

Col. 1:26 Mankind's most sought after quest, the mystery which has remained elusive and concealed for ages and generations, is now fully realized in our redeemed innocence.

Col. 1:27 Within us, God is delighted to exhibit the priceless treasure of this glorious unveiling of Christ's indwelling in order that every person on the planet, whoever they are, may now come to the greatest discovery of all time and recognize Christ in them as in a mirror! He is the [1]desire of the nations and

completes their every expectation! *(He is not hiding in history, or in outer space nor in the future, neither in the pages of Scripture, he is merely mirrored there to be unveiled within you. Mt 13:44, Gal 1:15, 16, 2 Cor 3:18, 2 Cor 4:4,7. This is huge! What God was now able to disclose in the saints is immediately equally relevant in the nations! Christ in the nations is the hope of glory! This is the mystery of the ages! This is what we were waiting for. [1]Haggai 2:6,7.)*

Col. 1:28 This is the essence and focus of our message; we [1]awaken everyone's mind, instructing every individual by bringing them into [2]full understanding *[flawless clarity]* **in order that we may [3]prove** *(present)* **everyone [4]perfect in Christ.** *(Translating [1]**vous + tithemi** as to re-align every mind with God's mind. The word, [2]**sophos**, comes from **sophes** meaning clear, clarity. The word, [3]**paristano**, comes from **para**, sphere of influence, closest possible association, and **histemi**, meaning to stand, to exhibit with evidence. The word, [4]**teleios**, means perfect, without shortcoming and fully efficient.)*

Col. 1:29 [1]Your completeness in Christ is not a remote goal, but your immediate reference! My labor now exceeds any zeal that I previously knew under the duty-driven law of willpower. I am laboring beyond the point of exhaustion, striving with intense resolve with all the energy that he mightily inspires within me. *([1]**eis**, a point reached in conclusion.)*

Gal. 3:8 Scripture records prophetically that the mass of non-Jewish nations would be justified by faith and not by keeping moral laws. This announcement by God over Abraham is the gospel in advance. God saw every nation included in the same principle of the faith that Abraham pioneered. "In you all the nations of the earth are equally represented in the blessing of faith." *([Gen 22:17] I will indeed bless you, and I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven and as the sand which is on the seashore. And your seed shall possess the gate of their enemies, Gen 22:18 and by your seed shall all the nations of the earth bless themselves. Righteousness by faith is the revelation of the gospel; [Rom 1:17 and Hab 2:4] "the just shall live by his (God's) faith" Righteousness by faith defines your life!)*

Heb. 12:2 Look away from the shadow dispensation of the law and the Prophets and fix your eyes upon Jesus. He is the fountainhead and conclusion of faith. He saw the joy *[of mankind's salvation]* **when he braved the cross and despised the shame of it. As the executive authority of God** *[the right hand of the throne of God]* **he now occupies the highest seat of dominion to endorse mankind's innocence!**

(Having accomplished purification of sins, he sat down. Heb 1:3, Isa 53:11.)

Rom. 4:16 Therefore since faith sponsors the gift of grace, the promise is equally secured for all the children. The law has no exclusive claim on anyone *[the reward system cannot match the gift principle].* **Faith is our source, and that makes Abraham our father.**

Rom. 4:17 When God changed Abram's name to Abraham, he made a public statement that he would be the father of all nations. *[Genesis 17:]* **Here we see Abraham faced with God's faith; the kind of faith that resurrects the dead and calls things which are not** *[visible yet]* **as though they were.** *(Note that most of Abram's ancestors were allready fathers by the time that they had turned 30 or 35; yet Terah was 70 years old before he had Abram; his name suggests that Terah acknowledged that he could not claim parenthood of this son, he was 'fathered from above'! [Gen 11:12-26] Now imagine how nervous Abram was when eventually he was 75 and still without child! That was when God met with him and added to his name the 'ה he' of Jaweh's -* יהוה *- own name! Abraham!* אברהם*. The* ה *[he] is also the number 5, which is the number for grace! In Arabic the word* ***raham*** *means drizzling and lasting rain. The innumerable drops of water in a drizzling rain are like the stars mentioned in Gen 15:5 ("look toward heaven, and number the stars, if you are able to number them . . . so shall your seed be") now imagine those innumerable stars raining down upon the earth and each one becomes a grain of sand! So shall your seed be! Gen 22:17 ("I will indeed bless you, and I will multiply your descendants as the stars of heaven and as the sand which is on the seashore"). In Genesis 17:4-5 God announces him as the father of the masses of nations* אב המון גוים*,* ***ab hamon goyim****; The word* המון*, (****hamon****), does not express simply a large number, but the rain-like noise that emerges from a unified, seething throng of people! Abraham's identity, his name, was the echo of God's faith and his bold confession in the absence of Isaac. The name change, similar to that of Simon to Rock, reminds mankind to realize their original identity as sons of God, hewn out of the Rock [Deut 32:18, Isa 51:1, 2].)*

Rom. 4:18 Faith gave substance to hope when everything seemed hopeless; the words, "so shall your seed be" conceived in him the faith of fatherhood. *(Abraham's case here pictures the hopelessness of fallen mankind, having lost their identity, and faced with the impossibility to redeem themselves.)*

Gal. 3:16 It is on record that the promise *[of the blessing of righteousness by God's faith]* **was made to Abraham and to his seed, singular,** *[thus excluding his effort*

to produce Ishmael.] **Isaac, the child of promise and not of the flesh mirrors the Messiah.**

Rom. 1:16 I have no shame about sharing the Good News of Christ with anyone; the powerful rescuing act of God persuades both Jew and Gentile alike.

Rom. 1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of [1]God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness reveals the life of our design. "Righteousness by his *(God's)* **faith defines life."** *(The gospel is the revelation of the righteousness of God; it unveils how the Father, Son and Spirit succeeded to put mankind right with themselves. It is about what God did right, not what Adam did wrong. The good news reveals how God's righteousness rescued the life of our design and redeemed our innocence. Mankind's futile efforts to consistently obey moral laws, have failed them miserably - the Good News shifts the emphasis away from mankind's failure and condemnation to highlight what it was that God accomplished in Jesus Christ on mankind's behalf! "Look away [from the law of works] unto Jesus; he is the [1]Author and finisher of faith." [Hebrews 12:1]. It is God's faith to begin with; it is [1]**from faith to faith**, and not our good or bad behavior; we are not defined by our performance or circumstances. The Greek word translated "from" is the Preposition, [1]**ek**, which always denotes source or origin.*

It is interesting to note that the Greek goddess of Justice is Dike, [pronounced, ***dikay*** *- the stem of the word* ***dikaiosune****, righteousness] and she is always pictured holding a scale of balances in her hand. See also 2 Corinthians 6:15. In Colossians 2:9-10, "It is in Christ that God finds an accurate and complete expression of himself, in a human body! He mirrors our completeness and is the ultimate authority of our true identity.")*

Isa. 9:2-7 The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light; those who dwelt in a land of deep darkness, have been illuminated with light. Thou hast multiplied the nation, thou hast increased its joy; they rejoice before thee as with joy at the harvest, as men rejoice when they divide the spoil. For the yoke of his burden, and the staff for his shoulder, the rod of his oppressor, thou hast broken as on the day of Midian. *(Gideon's victory Judges 7:8)* For to us a child is born, to us a son is given; and the government will be upon his shoulder, and his name will be called "Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." Of the increase of his government and of peace there will be no end, upon the throne of David, and over his

kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from this time forth and for evermore. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will do this." RSV

The zeal of the Lord is in total contrast to a religious zeal for God. The zeal of God is fueled by the revelation of righteousness by faith. While the one exhausts the other ignites!

Rom. 10:2 I have been there myself. I know their zeal and devotion; their problem is not their passion, but their ignorance.

Rom. 10:3 They are tirelessly busy with their own efforts to justify themselves while blatantly ignoring the fact that God already justified them in Christ.

Rom. 10:4 Christ is the conclusion of the law, everything the law required of mankind was fulfilled in him; he thus represents the righteousness of the human race, based upon faith *[and not personal performance]*.

Rom. 10:5 Moses is the voice of the law; he says that a person's life is only justified in their doing what the law requires.

Rom. 10:6 Faith finds its voice in something much closer to a person than their most disciplined efforts to obey the law. Faith announces that the Messiah is no longer a distant promise; neither is he reduced to a mere historic hero. He is mankind's righteousness now! The revelation of what God accomplished in Christ, births a new conversation! The old type of guess-talk has become totally irrelevant; Christ is not hiding somewhere in the realm of heaven as a future hope; so, to continue to say, "Who will ascend into heaven, to bring Christ down", makes no sense at all! *(The nearness of the Word in incarnation-language is the new conversation! The word made flesh so that all flesh may witness the glory of God reflected in the radiance of their own illuminated understanding!)*

Rom. 10:7 Faith-conversation understands the resurrection-revelation *(and mankind's co-inclusion in it! Hosea 6:2).* **The Messiah is not roaming around somewhere in the region of the dead. Someone asks, "Oh, but what about the pit? Where does the abyss fit into this? Who will descend into the abyss to bring Christ back from the dead?" This revelation takes the abyss out of the equation!** *(Those who deny the resurrection of Jesus would wish they could send someone down there and confirm their doubts, and bring back final proof that Jesus was not the Messiah. Faith announces a righteousness that reveals that mankind has indeed been co-raised together with Christ! See Eph 4:8 Scripture confirms that he arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! ["he took captivity captive"] And in his resurrection,*

he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he repossessed what belonged to us by design, in human form; this is his grace-gift to us! Eph 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. See Luke 9:27 You don't have to wait till you're dead to see the kingdom of God; some of you standing here with me right now, are about to dramatically witnesses the kingdom of God with your own eyes! [The word, ὁράω ***horaoo****, to stare; to gaze with wonder; to encounter; to see for yourselves. Then, in the next verse, [Lk 9:28], Peter James and John join Jesus in prayer on the mountain, where his appearance is spectacularly changed by the radiance of God's glory bursting through his skin; even his clothes became dazzling white like light. Then, the voice of his Father confirms that his beloved son is the conclusion of the conversation represented in both Moses, [the law] and Elijah, [the prophets] - "Hear him!" - Jesus is the conversation of God - he is the Logos - See John 1:1,2,5,9 To go back to the very beginning, is to find the Word already present there; face to face with God. The Word is I am; God's eloquence echoes and concludes in him. The Word equals God. The beginning mirrors the Word face to face with God. [Nothing that is witnessed in the Word distracts from who God is. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father."] The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! At the end of his life Peter reminds us that, 2 Pet 1:16 We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic appearance; with our own eyes we witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate presence of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life. 2 Pet 1:17 He was spectacularly endorsed by God the Father in the highest honor and glory. God's majestic voice announced, "This is the Son of my delight; he completely pleases me." 2 Pet 1:18 For John, James, and I the prophetic word is fulfilled beyond doubt; we heard this voice loud and clear from the heavenly realm while we were with Jesus in that sacred moment on the mountain. 2 Pet 1:19 For us the appearing of the Messiah is no longer a future promise but a fulfilled reality. Now it is your turn to have more than a second-hand, hearsay testimony. Take my word as one would take a lamp at night; the day is about to dawn within you, in your own understanding. When the Morning Star appears, you no longer need the lamp; this will happen shortly on the horizon of your own hearts. 2 Pet 1:20 It is most important to understand that the prophetic word recorded in Scripture does not need our interpretation or opinion to make it valid. 2 Pet 1:21 The holy men who first spoke these*

words of old did not invent these thoughts, they simply voiced God's oracles as they were individually inspired by the Holy Spirit.)

Rom. 10:8 Righteousness announced by God's faith, is the authentic conversation! Here, every definition of distance in time, space, or even indifference and hostility, is cancelled. The word is no longer a distant prophetic pointer in the mouths of Moses and Elijah! They announced its destiny to be mirrored in the incarnation! "The Word is extremely close to you. It spills over from your heart and becomes dynamic conversation in your mouth!" *(Deut 30:11-14.)* **We publicly announce this message, since we are convinced that it belongs to everyone.** *(LXX Greek OT - ἔστιν σου ἐγγὺς τὸ ῥῆμα σφόδρα **[extremely near]** ἐν τῷ στόματί **[in your mouth]** σου καὶ ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ σου **[in your heart]** καὶ ἐν ταῖς χερσίν σου **[in your hands!]**)*

Rom. 10:9 Now your salvation is realized! Your own [1]words echo God's voice. The unveiling of the masterful act of Jesus forms the words in your mouth, inspired by the conviction in your heart that God indeed raised him from the dead. *(In his resurrection, God co-raised us [Hosea 6:2]. His resurrection declares our innocence [Rom 4:25]. Salvation is not reduced to a recipe or a "sinners prayer" formula; it is the spontaneous inevitable conversation of a persuaded heart! To confess, [1]**homologeo,** **homo,** the same thing + **logeo**, to say.)*

Rom. 10:10 This is where believing happens spontaneously, in the heart! The revelation of mankind's redeemed righteousness ignites a new conversation, announcing salvation. *(The word **pisteuetai** is the Impersonal construction, "it is believed"; believing takes place! [Present Passive Indicative of **pisteuō**] Faith is not something we "do" - faith is what happens to us when we realize what God has done for us! He restored us to blameless innocence! It is impossible not to boldly announce news of such global consequence [Isa 40:9])*

1 Cor 15:10 While my own doing completely disqualified me; his doing now defines me. I am what I am by the grace of God. I am because he is! His grace was not wasted on me; instead I am inspired to labor beyond the point of exhaustion, more than anything I ever did under the law of performance; whatever it is that I accomplish now has grace written all over it. I take no credit for it.

Ps. 2:7-8 You are my Son, today I have begotten you. Ask of me, and I will make the nations your heritage, and the ends of the earth your possession. RSV

1 Pet. 1:3 Let us [1]celebrate God with articulate acclaim! He is the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. According to his matchless mercy and tender compassions,

he [2]birthed us again when Jesus was raised from the dead. Now we are alive to witness the [3]expectation of the ages unfold! *(The word, [1]**eulogetos**, means to brag, to bless, to speak well of. Jesus reminds Nicodemus that we are born **anouthen**, from above. [John 3:3, and John 3:13] No one can fully engage in heaven's perspective, unless one's heavenly origin is realized! The Son of man declares mankind's co-genesis from above and now through our joint resurrection, we are reconnected again to our original identity as sons. The word [2]**anagennao**, from **ana**, upward, [reconnecting with **anouthen** - Jn 3:3 - from above, where we came from in the first place]; and **gennao**, to regenerate, to give birth. As much as his death brought dramatic closure to our futile and failed attempts to justify and define ourselves, our co-resurrection rebooted the original blueprint of our Maker's image and likeness in us. [3]"A living hope" - the expectation of the ages concluding in life. See Colossians 1:27 - The mystery of the ages is unveiled! Christ in us!)*

Hos. 6:1-3 "Come, let us return to the LORD; for he has torn, that he may heal us; he has stricken, and he will bind us up. [See Isa. 53:4, 5] After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will raise us up, that we may live before him. Let us know, let us press on to know the LORD; his going forth is sure as the dawn; he will come to us as the showers, as the spring rains that water the earth." RSV

Eph. 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our [1]deviations, we were [2]co-quickened together with Christ! We had nothing to do with it. Grace [3]freed us, once and for all from the lies that we believed about ourselves under the performance-driven system, and now [4]defines our authentic identity! *(The word often translated, trespasses, παράπτωμα [1]**paraptoma**, deviation; from **para** close proximity and **pipto**, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to stop flying, **petomai**, to fly. Losing altitude speaks of mankind's fallen mindset. Col 3:1-3. The verb συνεζωοποιησεν [2]**sunetzoopoiesen** [co-quickened] is the Aorist Active Indicative, describing an action that was completed in the past. The sentence, **χάριτί [2]ἐστε [3]σεσῳσμένοι** - literally translates, "By grace you are - having been saved!" The verb, [4]**este** is the Present Active Indicative of **eimi**, I am - indicating the continues state of your being which celebrates an [3]unstoppable freedom that happened in your favor! The verb [3]**sesoosmenoi**, having been rescued; is the Perfect Passive Participle, describing a state that exists, as a result of something that happened previously. The basic thought of the Perfect Tense is that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. In*

other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now in existence. We had no contribution to our salvation! God's Master-Plan unfolded in the mystery of the gospel declaring our joint inclusion in Christ's death and resurrection. This is the mystery of grace, God reveals us in Christ! Now we may know, even as we have always been known! 1 Cor 13:12. Of God's doing are we in Christ! 1 Cor 1:30. God saw us in Christ, in his death and resurrection before we saw ourselves there! He declared mankind's co-resurrection with Christ 800 BC. This is the only scripture in the entire Old Testament that specifically mentions the third day resurrection and it includes us! "After two days he will revive us, on the third day, he will raise us up!" Hosea 6:2.)

Eph. 2:6 We are co-included in his resurrection. We are also co-elevated in his ascension to be equally present in the throne room of the heavenly realm where we are co-seated with him in his executive authority. We are fully represented in Christ Jesus. *(We have wasted so much time trying to get there, when "there" is where we are to begin with! Our joint position in Christ defines us; this can never again be a distant goal to reach through religious devotion or striving, but our immediate location. Col 3:1-3.)*

2 Cor. 5:15 Now if all were included in his death they were equally included in his resurrection. This unveiling of his love redefines human life! Whatever reference we could have of ourselves outside of our association with Christ is no longer relevant.

In Psalm 22 David paints a most dramatic prophetic picture of the crucifixion of the Messiah and in verse 27 boldly proclaims the outcome, "All the ends of the earth shall remember and turn to the Lord!" And in verse 31 he declares, "his deliverance will be proclaimed to a people yet unborn; they will hear that he has done it."

Then in the next Psalm David sings about the Shepherd that leads us to "the waters of reflection, where my soul remembers who I am!"

The remotest parts of the earth will witness the salvation that God has brought about.

Isa. 42:6-7 "I am the LORD, I have called you in righteousness, I have taken you by the hand and kept you; I have given you as a covenant to the people, a light to the nations, to open the eyes that are blind, to bring out the prisoners from the dungeon, from the prison those who sit in darkness.

Picture the body language of the messengers returning from the battlefield with the

glad tidings of victory!

Isa. 52:7-10 How beautiful upon the mountains are the feet of him who brings good tidings, who publishes peace, who brings good tidings of good, who publishes salvation, who says to Zion, "Your God reigns." Hark, your watchmen lift up their voice, together they sing for joy; for eye to eye they see the return of the LORD to Zion. Break forth together into singing, you waste places of Jerusalem; for the LORD has comforted his people, he has redeemed Jerusalem. The LORD has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God." RSV

Isa. 60:1-3 Arise, shine; for your light has come, and the glory of the LORD has risen upon you. For behold, darkness shall cover the earth, and thick darkness the peoples; but the LORD will arise upon you and his glory will be seen upon you. And nations shall come to your light, and kings to the brightness of your rising.

Isa. 60:21-22 Your people shall all be righteous; they shall possess the land for ever, the shoot of my planting, the work of my hands, that I might be glorified. The least one shall become a clan, and the smallest one a mighty nation; I am the LORD; in its time I will hasten it!

Is.61:1-2 The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me, because the LORD has anointed me to bring good tidings to the afflicted; he has sent me to bind up the broken hearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to those who are bound; to proclaim the year of the LORD's favor, and the day of vengeance of our God; to comfort all who mourn.

Luke 4:18 He opened the scroll and rolled it out in order to find the specific place where the following was written, "The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he has [1]anointed me to announce [2]glad tidings to a [3]starving people; he has [4]commissioned me to announce the freedom of [5]forgiveness *[their true I-am-ness]* **to those [6]held captive at spear-point by their guilt and shame; also, the blind may now look up and be restored in their sight! I am anointed [7]to send out those who are bruised and traumatized, into the freedom of their redeemed [8]innocence.** *(The verb, εχρισεν [1]**echrisen** from χρίω **chrio**, to smear with the hand; from **xeir**, hand; to anoint; see the Hebrew for Messiah, משיח to anoint; from **mashach**, משח to draw the hand over, to measure. [Analytical Hebrew and Chaldee Lexicon, B Davidson.] The anointing is the true measure of our lives, not our mental- or muscle-effort to produce results.*

Our use of the word, "christening" is really a word that means the endorsing of our in-Christness.

*To announce good tidings, ευαγγελισασθαι [2]**euangelisasthai**, in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. The Anointed Christ is the Good News in its most complete context.*

*The word, πτωχός [3]**ptōchos**; to be in a starving and beggarly state.*

*The Perfect Active Indicative απεσταλκεν [4]**apestalken** denotes an action that has been completed in the past and the results of the action are continuing on in this moment, in full effect; of the word, **apostellō**, to commission. Then, the same word, **apostello**, but this time in the Aorist Infinitive, αποστειλαι [8]**apostelai**, which presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end; thus, a sending out of the enclosure of their trauma and hurts, since the door that shut them in, no longer exists.*

*The word, αἰχμαλωτός, [6]**aichmalotos**, from **aichme**, spear and **halosis**, to capture, thus, to arrest at spear point.*

*Then the opening of the blind eyes suggests, a complete change of perspective - a looking upward! The word, ἀναβλέπω **anablepō**, from **ana**, upward and **blepo**, to see.*

*The word translated forgiveness, or remission is the word ἄφεσις aphesis from [8]**aphieimi**; from **apo**, away from, and **hieimi** an intensive form of **eimi**, I am; thus, forgiveness is in essence a restoring to your true 'I-am-ness.' The injury, insult, shame, hostility or guilt would no longer define the individual.)*

Luke 4:19 I announce that the Jubilee year of the Lord has come! This is the liberation celebration of the Lord, embracing humanity home! *(Lev. 25,10 "You will declare this fiftieth year sacred and proclaim the liberation [Greek **aphesis**] of all the inhabitants of the land. This is to be a jubilee for you". In the Greek translation of the Old Testament the relation between jubilee and liberation is even closer because the Hebrew term יובל **jubel** is not translated into Greek as it was in the Latin of the Vulgate (jubilaeus) and in other languages, it has been translated as "liberation [**aphesis**; see my commentary of this word in the previous verse]" (Lev 25,13), or "year of liberation" (Lev 25,10) or again "sign of liberation" (Lev 25,11-12) In Hebrew, יובל or in Ancient Hebrew* lbfi *to shepherd someone safely and securely home. See Lev 25:10 in the LXX "...and each of you shall return to his home!" Luke 15! The prodigal son came to himself when he returned home! Back to his true I-am-ness!)*

Luke 4:20 Jesus then rolled up the scroll and gave it back to the attendant and sat down, while everyone's eyes were fixed on him. *(They knew that the Messianic expectation hinges on this Scripture; the big question was, when?!)*

Luke 4:21 He announced emphatically, Today this scripture is fulfilled in your hearing! *(This, "one-liner message", contains the weight of the entire prophetic, messianic and jubilee significance! Now, it's no longer a waiting game; it's all about your hearing! See Rom 10:8, "The Word is extremely close to you. It spills over from your heart and becomes dynamic conversation in your mouth!" [Deut 30:11-14.])*

If the gospel was to be measured geographically then the ends of the earth can be the only conclusion. The dimensions of the love of Christ surpasses knowledge, and addresses every human as fully included in God's audience. This gospel is every person's portion. In the breadth and length we see the horizontal extent of the love of Christ: the complete inclusion of the human race. 2 Cor 5:14,16. The depth of his love reveals how his love rescued us from the deepest pits of hellish despair and led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Eph 3:18.

Luke 2:10-11 And the angel said unto them, Be not afraid; for behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy which shall be to all the people. *(ASV)*

Luke 2:10 The celestial messenger immediately calmed them and said, "You have no reason to fear! Listen! I have the most wonderful announcement to make - this will lead to the great encounter of the most joyful bliss for every single person on the planet!

Luke 2:11 For your [1]Savior was born this day in the city of David, the Messiah, the Master. *([1]Σωτηρ, to make safe, to deliver, preserve, to make alive, thus used by the Septuagint for* החיה *hecheiah, to cause to escape; also for* פלט *thalaph to confide in, to hope. Adam Clarke.*

He is the Christ, ὁ Χριστος, ***ho Christos****, the anointed. The word,* ***chrestos****, kind, benevolent, from* ***xeir****, hand which is also connected to the word* ***xristos****, from χριω to anoint. To draw the hand over, to anoint, to measure; see also the Hebrew for Messiah,* משיח *to anoint, from* ***mashach****,* משח *to draw the hand over, to measure! [Analytical Hebrew and Chaldee Lexicon, B Davidson.]*

LXX Isa 9:5 [:6 in our Bibles] ὅτι παιδίον ἐγεννήθη ἡμῖν, υἱὸς καὶ ἐδόθη ἡμῖν.

Isa 9:5 כי־ילד ילד לנו בן נתן ***ki yeled yâlad*** *a child is born, to us* ***lanu*** *a son is given* ***ben nathan.***

For unto us a child is born,.... This is a reason of all that is said in the context; of the great light that shone upon and was seen by those that sat in darkness, and in the land of the shadow of death; of the great joy among the people; of the breaking off of the yoke, rod, and staff of the oppressor; and of the burning of garments rolled in blood, so putting an end to war, and establishing peace; all which is owing to the child here said to be born... John Gill.

Isa 9:2 The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light; those who dwelt in a land of deep darkness, have been illuminated with light.

Isa 9:3 Thou hast multiplied the nation, thou hast increased its joy; they rejoice before you as with joy at the harvest, as men rejoice when they divide the spoil.

Isa 9:4 For the yoke of his burden, and the staff for his shoulder, the rod of his oppressor, thou hast broken as on the day of Midian.

Isa 9:7 Of the increase of his government and of peace there will be no end, upon the throne of David, and over his kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from this time forth and for evermore. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will do this.)

Luke 2:13 The next moment, a heavenly host of multitudes of celestial messengers joined and erupted in accolades of praise telling the God-story! *(The word, αἰνέω **aineō** a story of tribute and honor.)*

Luke 2:14 God's highest and grandest [1]intention in the heavens is [2]dove-tailed upon earth in unbroken, incarnate oneness; in being human, he exibits [3]his delight with mankind! *(The word, **doxa**, often translated, glory, means opinion or, intention. Peace, εἰρήνη [2]**eirēnē** from εἴρω **eirō** - to join, as in carpentry, a dove-tail joint. Then follows, **en anthrōpois eudokias**. It is not, "Peace to all men and women on earth who please him"; as if God's delight is only a reward for those who qualify. He loved us when we were at our worst. And he loved us first! The Genitive, [3]**eudokias** is undoubtedly correct, supported by the oldest and best uncials. [Aleph, A B D W] Thus, mankind is God's delight! See, Colossians 1:19 God is fully at home in him. Jesus exhibits God's happy delight to be human. [Delightful intent, **eudokeo**.])*

The destiny of the good news is to win the world.

Phil. 2:9-11 Therefore God has highly exalted him and bestowed on him the name which is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth, and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ

is Lord, to the glory of God the Father. RSV

Acts 4:20 "We cannot but speak of what we have seen and heard."

Job 32:8 "But it is the spirit in a man, the breath of the Almighty, that makes him understand."

Job. 32:18-20 "For I am full of words, the spirit within me constrains me. Behold, my heart is like wine that has no vent; like new wineskins, it is ready to burst. I must speak, that I may find relief." RSV

PS. 39:3 "My heart became hot within me. As I mused, the fire burned; then I spoke with my tongue." RSV

Luke 24:32 "They said to each other, "Did not our hearts burn within us while he talked to us on the road, while he opened to us the scriptures?" RSV

Our beholding him as in a mirror, gives volume to our voice! The revelation of grace fuels the fire within!

Isa. 40:9 "Get you up to a high mountain, O Zion, herald of good tidings; lift up your voice with strength, O Jerusalem, herald of good tidings, lift it up, fear not; say to the cities of Judah, "Behold your God!" RSV

Col. 3:1-3 You are in fact raised together with Christ! Now ponder with persuasion the consequence of your co-inclusion in him. Relocate yourselves mentally! Engage your thoughts with throne room realities. His resurrection co-raised you to the same position of authority where you are now co-seated in the executive authority of God's right hand. Becoming affectionately acquainted with these thoughts will keep you from being distracted again by the earthly (soul-ruled) realm. (A renewed mind conquers the space that was previously occupied by worthless pursuits and habits) Your union with his death broke the association with that world; see yourselves located in a fortress where your life is hidden with Christ in God!

The secret and success of Paul's ministry was not in his articulate or persuasive speech or the size of his budget or audience, but in the revelation of the redeemed image and likeness of God in mankind, and the love of Christ constraining him.

2 Cor. 10:10 For they say, "His letters are weighty and strong, but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech of no account."

2 Cor. 11:6 Even if I am unskilled in speaking, I am not in knowledge; in every way we have made this plain to you in all things. RSV

1 Cor. 2:1 My intention in visiting you was not to engage with you in

theological debate or to impress you with clever philosophical words guessing about the [1]mystery of God. *(The words **μαρτύριον [marturion]**, testimony and **μυστήριον [musterion]**, mystery, look similar. The Alexandrian copy, and others, read, "the mystery" of God: also the Syriac version אזר אהלאד, "the mystery of God". The Alexandrian text-type is the form of the Greek New Testament that predominates in the earliest surviving documents. The Syriac version of the New Testament, dates back to the second century A.D. Syria was the country in which the Greek language intersected with the Syriac, which was closely related to the Aramaic dialect used by Jesus and the Apostles. That is why Syriac versions are highly esteemed by textual critics. The context of this chapter beautifully unfolds the mystery of the Gospel.)*

1 Cor. 2:2 My [1]mind is fully made up about you! The only possible way in which I can truly [2]know you, is in the light of God's mystery, which is [3]Christ in you! Jesus died mankind's death on the cross and thus brought final closure to any other basis of [1]judgment! *(The word, [1]**krino**, to judge, to determine, to deem in a forensic sense, here, in the Aorist Tense, **ekrina,** which suggests a once and for all completed act. The Aorist tense presents an occurrence in summary, viewed as a whole from the outside, almost like a snapshot of the action. Paul makes a very bold and radical statement, confining his ministry focus to "know" the full scope and consequence of the revelation of mankind's redeemed innocence as communicated in the cross of Jesus Christ! This is the essence of the mystery of God! "For I determined to [2]know [- [2]**eido**, to see, to perceive] nothing in you except Jesus Christ and him crucified." Nothing else! Not the latest gossip or popular news events! He says in 2 Cor 5:14,16, The love of Christ leads to this conclusion, one has died for all - therefore all died! From now on therefore, I no longer know ANYONE from a human point of view!*

*Paul continues to unfold the mystery of our redeemed oneness! In the previous chapter, he concludes that we are **in Christ** by God's doing; here he clearly points to [3]**Christ in us**! [As Jesus declared in John 14:20]*

See 2 Cor 3:4 Christ is proof of our persuasion about you before God. Also 2 Cor 1:18 God's certainty is our persuasion; there is no maybe in him! 2 Cor 1:19 The Son of God, Jesus Christ, whom I, Paul, Sylvanus and Timothy boldly announced in you is God's ultimate yes to mankind. Human life is associated in all that he is. In God's mind, there exists not even a hint of hesitation about this! Also Gal 1:16 and Col 1:27.)

1 Cor. 2:3 I felt completely inadequate; you know that it was not my eloquent speech that persuaded you. I was so nervous that my whole body was trembling

with stage fright!

1 Cor. 2:4 My message was not with persuasive arguments based on secular wisdom, since my aim was [1]not to point people to me but rather to the powerful working of the Spirit in them. *(Thayer's Greek definition of [1]**apodeiknumi** is to point away from one's self. Previous translations of this word have often given the impression that the great, miracle-working man of God would steal the show and entertain the crowds! This was so unlike Jesus and Paul! Paul never writes about how many people he had healed and brought to faith, etc. His all-consuming concern was that the eyes of our understanding would be illuminated with the revelation of Christ in us.*

Note 2 Corinthians 10:10 [RSV], "For they say, 'His letters are weighty and strong, but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech of no account.'" Also, 2 Corinthians 11:6, "Even if I am unskilled in speaking, I am not in knowledge." — RSV.)

1 Cor. 2:5 Mankind's wise schemes of influence could never match the power of God as reference to your faith.

1 Cor. 2:6 The words we speak resonate revelation wisdom in those who understand how perfectly redeemed they are in Christ, this wisdom supersedes every secular kind; suddenly what once seemed wise and good advice has become useless information. *(All popular programs towards improved moral behavior are now outdated. "Of God's doing are we in Christ. He is both the genesis and genius of our wisdom; a wisdom that reveals how righteous, sanctified, and redeemed we already are in him." In God's economy, Christ represents us; what mankind could never achieve through personal discipline and willpower as taught in every religion, God's faith accomplished in Christ [1 Cor 1:30].)*

1 Cor. 2:7 We voice words of wisdom that were hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's [1]Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in man. Our glorification has always been God's agenda, even [2]before time was. *(Paul employs the words, [1]**prohoritso**, predesigned and [2]**pro aion** before the ages, in order to emphasize the certainty of God's persuasion concerning their determined intent to rescue and restore their image and likeness in us. Our redemption existed upon the inner-horizons of God before the ages. The word, **prohoritso**, from **pro**, before and **horitso**, horizon; means pre-defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan. See Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that we pre-existed in God; he defines us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory that we lost in Adam.)*

Paul's ministry was so much more than a mere career choice; he was compelled by love and joy because of what he knew to be true, in spite of severe contradiction.

1 Cor. 15:10 While my own doing completely disqualified me, his doing now defines me. I am what I am by the grace of God. I am because he is! His grace was not wasted on me; instead, I am inspired to labour beyond the point of exhaustion, more than anything I ever did under the law of performance; whatever it is that I accomplish now has grace written all over it. I take no credit for it.

2 Cor. 4:1 Since we are employed by the mercy of God, and not by our own qualifications, quitting is not an option. *(Having this ministry by the mercy of God, we do not lose heart. RSV.)*

2 Cor. 4:2 We have renounced hidden agendas *[employing a little bit of the law in an attempt to "balance" out grace]*; **we have distanced ourselves from any obscure [1]craftiness to manipulate God's word to make it mean what it does not say! With truth on open display in us, we highly recommend our lives to everyone's [2]conscience! Truth finds its most authentic and articulate expression in human life, [3]mirrored in the face of God.** *(It is our passion for all to see what is so completely obvious in the mirror of our redeemed likeness and innocence; this beats any doctrinal debate! The word translated craftiness, is the word [1]**panourgia** from **pas** and **ergon,** all manner of wearisome labor! [2]Conscience in Latin means to know together; in the Greek, [2]**suneido**, translates as joint seeing; which is the opposite of **Hades**, from ha + eido, not to see. πρὸς πᾶσαν [every individual] συνείδησιν [seamless-seeing] ἀνθρώπων ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ pros [face to face] The word for the human species, male or female is **anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner.)*

2 Cor. 4:3 If our message seems vague to anyone, it is not because we are withholding something from certain people! It is just because some are so stubborn in their efforts to uphold an outdated system that they don't see it! They are all equally found in Christ but they prefer to remain lost in the cul-de-sac language of the law!

2 Cor. 4:4 The survival and self-improvement programs of the [1]religious systems of this world veil the minds of the unbelievers; exploiting their ignorance about their true origin and their redeemed innocence. The veil of unbelief obstructs a person's view and keeps them from seeing what the light of the gospel so clearly reveals: the [2]glory of God is the image and likeness of our Maker redeemed in human form; this is what the gospel of Christ is all about. *(The god of this [1]**aion**, age,*

refers to the religious systems and governing structures of this world. The unbelief that neutralized Israel in the wilderness was the lie that they believed about themselves; "We are grasshoppers, and the 'enemy' is a giant beyond any proportion!" [Num 13:33, Josh 2:11, Heb 4:6.] "They failed to possess the promise due to unbelief." The blueprint [2]***doxa****, glory of God, is what Adam lost on mankind's behalf. See Eph 4:18.)*

2 Cor. 4:5 Even though we recommend ourselves with great confidence, it is not with arrogance; we do not preach ourselves! We preach Christ Jesus the Lord; we are addicted to this gospel; employed by Jesus for your sakes.

2 Cor. 4:6 The light source is founded in the same God who said, "Light, be!" And light shone out of darkness! He lit the lamp in our understanding so that we may clearly recognize the features of his likeness in the face of Jesus Christ reflected within us. *(The same God who bade light shine out of darkness has kindled a light in our hearts, whose shining is to make known his glory as he has revealed it in the features of Jesus Christ. — Knox Translation.)*

2 Cor. 4:7 And now, in the glow of this glorious light and with unveiled faces we discover this treasure where it was hidden all along, in these frail skin-suits made of [1]**clay. We did not invent ourselves; we are God's idea to begin with and the dynamic of his doing and amazing engineering!** *(The word translated earthen vessel or clay jar is the word* [1]***ostrakinos*** *from* ***ostrakon*** *"oyster"! It is a great visual picture of how we carry a very valuable pearl within us. The cosmetic value of the clay pot can never compete with the treasure it holds. There is so much more to you than what meets the eye! "The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in an agricultural field, which a man found and covered up; then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and buys the entire field." [Matthew 13:44] In order to redeem our minds from the lies that we believed about us, God invested all that he has in the redeeming of our original value! See 1 Peter 1:18,19. He rescued the life of our design. Our inner life hosts this treasure. Jesus said in John 7:37,38, "If you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, you will know that you are what I am all about and rivers of living water will gush out of* ***your innermost being!****")*

2 Cor. 4:8 We often feel completely hemmed in on every side but our inner space remains unrestricted; when there seems to be no way out, we escape within!

2 Cor. 4:9 At times we are persecuted to the extreme but we are never abandoned. We are knocked down but not knocked out.

2 Cor. 4:10 Wherever we go, whatever we encounter in our bodies, we bear witness within us of the fact that Jesus died our death; in this same body, we now exhibit his life. The fact that we co-died in his death confirms that we now co-live in his resurrection!

2 Cor. 4:11 Our day-to-day experience continues to exhibit that even in the face of death, our association with the death Jesus already died remains the inspiration of his life made so clearly visible within us. This is in such contrast to the circumstances that we are often faced with.

2 Cor. 4:12 Our persuasion of our co-crucifiction with Christ in the face of death threatening circumstances [1]inspires life in you! *(The word, [1]**energeo**, translates as energy trigger.)*

2 Cor. 4:13 We [1]echo the exact same spirit of faith David had when he wrote: "I [2]believe and so I speak!" We too believe and so we speak! Our persuasion is our conversation. *(The word, [1]**echo**, means to hold or to embrace. Paul quotes David here in Psalm 116; sometimes one's soul wants to gallop away into distraction like a wild horse; then, David reminds himself, "Return to your rest, oh my soul, for the Lord has dealt bountifully with you! I believe, and so I speak!" God's bountiful dealings with us in Christ is our only valid rest; Sabbath celebrates perfection! "Behold, it is very good!" Gen 1:31,2:2 And remember God does not employ circumstances to teach us something! The finished work of Christ teaches us; his work on the cross rescued us! Ps 116:7,10 I [2]believe; I am sure, אמן **aw-man**, with the root meaning, to build up, or support; to foster as a parent or nurse; figuratively to render [or be] firm or faithful, to trust or believe, to be permanent or quiet; to be true or certain; to go to the right hand: - hence assurance, [relocate yourself mentally where you are co-seated together with Christ in God's right hand!] Also, the word, amen, so be it.*

*Hebrew word to speak, דבר **dabar**, to arrange words in such a way that their effect is to subdue. [Like a lawyer's letter; using legal language.]*

*Then David uses the word, ענה **anah**, which was translated, 'afflicted', but the same word is also used to respond; by extension to begin to speak; specifically to sing, shout, testify, announce: - give account, which is a much more appropriate rendering of this word in context! The Hebrew actually says: I will sing loudly! Remember Paul sang in prison!*

Let faith speak. Let faith break out in song!)

2 Cor. 4:14 This resurrection life we enjoy in Jesus fully includes you.

2 Cor. 4:15 Whatever we go through in the gospel is to advantage you! We live for you! As grace abounds in more and more people so does the volume of gratitude in the accomplished mission of Jesus break through the sound barrier to exhibit the [1]heart dream of God. *(The word, [1]**doxa**, means glory, from **dokeo**, meaning intent opinion, the heart dream of God is his image and likeness redeemed in mankind.)*

2 Cor. 4:16 We have much reason to be brave! There might be a lot of wear and tear on the outside; but don't be distracted by that! On the inside we are celebrating daily revival!

2 Cor. 4:17 We are fully engaged in an exceedingly superior reality; the extent and [1]weight of this glory make any degree of suffering vanish into insignificance! The suffering is fleeting and ever so slight by comparison to the weight and enduring effect of this glory we participate in for all eternity. *(In Hebrew the word* דבכ *Kabod, means weight - this is also the word for glory - Paul reflects on this weight as the standard measure of everything that defines the glory of God! According to 2 Cor 3:18 mankind is his glory. This glory is the true currency of life. Paul reasons that by comparison, any size contradiction is dwarfed into insignificance and appears ever so slight when positioned against the enormity of the weight of glory that dwells within us.)*

2 Cor. 4:18 We are not keeping any score of what seems so obvious to the senses on the surface; it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us which has our full attention and captivates our gaze! *(See John 1:18 Until this moment God remained invisible to mankind; now the [1]authentic begotten Son, ([1]**monogenes,** begotten only of God) the blueprint of mankind's design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the [2]official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. (Official guide, [2]**eksegesato**, from **ek,** Preposition denoting source, and **hegeomai,** the strengthened form of **ago**, to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep; thus **hegeomai** means to be officially appointed in a position of authority.*

2 Cor 3:18 The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is unveiled. In gazing with wonder at the blueprint likeness of God displayed in human form, we suddenly realize that we are looking at ourselves! Every feature of his image

is mirrored in us! This is the most radical transformation engineered by the Spirit of the

Lord; we are led from an inferior mindset to the revealed endorsement of our authentic identity.)

2 Cor. 11:23 If you want to compare notes, I eclipse their claims as ministers of Christ. I speak from personal experience; none of them could compete with me when it comes to the extremities of wearisome labors endured: I was beaten up many times, frequently jailed, often face to face with death.

2 Cor. 11:24 To be more specific, I received the infamous forty lashes less one, five times from the Jews!

2 Cor. 11:25 Three times the Romans beat me up with sticks; once I was stoned and left for dead! Three times on my journeys I have been shipwrecked. I have been adrift at sea for a night and a day.

2 Cor. 11:26 My frequent travels have kept me on the road more than most people I know; I faced flooded rivers, I was attacked by robbers and encountered life threatening dangers from both Jew and Gentile. Everywhere I turned I was confronted with great danger, whether in the city, countryside or at sea. It seemed that there was no safe place left for me on the planet! Even amongst fellow Christians I was snared into controversy and betrayal!

2 Cor. 11:27 I was often extremely exhausted with a burdensome workload. The list goes on and on: I had many a sleepless night; I was frequently forced to fast since I had nothing to eat or drink; I suffered extreme exposure in bitterly cold conditions with nothing warm to wear.

2 Cor. 11:28 Beside the many external challenges I face daily, I continuously care for the churches in every place with all my heart.

2 Cor. 11:29 Don't talk to me about weaknesses and scandalous insults! I have been there and bought the T-shirt! The scandal of the cross ignites me with fervor!

2 Cor. 11:30 My frailties are my claim to fame!

Phil. 4:5 This kind of joy empowers you to show perfect [1]courtesy towards all people! The Lord is not nearer to some than what he is to others! *(Courtesy, [1]**epieikes**, from **epi**, indicating continuous influence upon, and **eikos**, reasonable, courteous. This is exactly Paul's attitude towards the idol worshipping Greek philosophers in Acts 17:27,28. See also Titus 3:3. Your joy makes the gospel visible! Every definition of distance is cancelled!)*

Phil. 4:11 I have discovered my "I-am-ness" and found that I am fully [1]self

sufficient, whatever the circumstance. *(Self sufficient, [1]**autarkes**, self complacent, the feeling you have when you are completely satisfied with yourself.)*

Phil. 4:12 I am not defined by abuse or abundance! It might be a different day and a different place, but the secret remains the same; whether I am facing a feast or a fast, a fountain or famine. *(Abundance is not a sign of God's goodness; neither is lack a sign of his absence! "Righteousness by his (God's) faith defines life." The good news is the fact that the Cross of Christ was a success. God rescued the life of our design; he redeemed our innocence. Mankind would never again be judged righteous or unrighteous by their own ability to obey moral laws! It is not about what someone must or must not do but about what Jesus has done! It is from faith to faith, and not a person's good or bad behavior or circumstances interpreted as a blessing or a curse [Hab 2:4]. Instead of reading the curse when disaster strikes, Habakkuk realizes that the Promise out-dates performance as the basis to mankind's acquittal. Deuteronomy 28 would no longer be the motivation or the measure of right or wrong behavior! "Though the fig trees do not blossom, nor fruit be on the vines, the produce of the olive fail and the fields yield no food, the flock be cut off from the fold and there be no herd in the stalls, yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will joy in the God of my salvation. God, the Lord, is my strength; he makes my feet like hinds' feet, he makes me tread upon my high places [Hab 3:17-19 RSV]. "Look away [from the law of works] to Jesus; he is the Author and finisher of faith." [Heb 12:1]. See Rom 1:17.)*

Phil. 4:13 In every situation I am strong in the one who empowers me from within to be who I am! *(Paul lived his life in touch with this place within himself. He discovered that the same I-am-ness that Jesus walked in, was mirrored in him! I am what I am by the grace of God! Christ in me, mirrors Christ in you! Phil 2:12, "Not only in my presence but much more in my absence! Col 1:27 In us God desires to exhibit the priceless treasure of Christ's indwelling; every nation will recognize him as in a mirror! The unveiling of Christ in human life completes mankind's every expectation. He is not hiding in history, or in outer space nor in the future, neither in the pages of Scripture, he is merely mirrored there to be unveiled within you. Mt 13:44, Gal 1:15, 16.)*

Temporal setbacks and lack are no threat to the overwhelming conviction of God's love.

Rom. 8:37 On the contrary, in the thick of these things our triumph remains beyond dispute. His love has placed us above the reach of any onslaught.

Rom. 8:38 This is my conviction; no threat whether it be in death or life; be it

celestial messengers, demon powers or political principalities, nothing known to us at this time, or even in the unknown future;

Rom. 8:39 no dimension of any calculation in time or space, nor any device yet to be invented, has what it takes to separate us from the love of God demonstrated in Christ. The Lordship of Jesus Christ is our ultimate authority.

Paul felt urged and indebted to persuade both the learned Greeks and the illiterate masses of their inclusion in Christ.

Rom. 1:5 The grace and commission we received from him, is to bring about a [1]faith-inspired lifestyle in all the nations. [2]His name is his claim on the human race. *(Paul immediately sets out to give new definition to the term, "obedience," no longer by law, but of faith. [1]Obedience, from* ***upo + akoo****, means to be under the influence of what is heard, accurate hearing; hearing from above. [2]Every family in heaven and on earth is identified in him. Eph 3:15.)*

Rom. 1:6 In Jesus Christ you individually discover [1]who you are. *(The word, [1]****kaleo****, means to call by name, to surname.)*

Rom. 1:14 I am so convinced of everyone's inclusion; I am [2]indebted both to the Greeks as well as those many [1]foreigners whose languages we do not even understand. I owe this message to everyone, it is not a matter of how literate and educated people are; the illiterate are equally included in the benefit of the Good News. *(The word, [1]****barbaros****, means one who speaks a strange and foreign language; [2]****opheiletes****, means to be indebted, obliges one to return something to someone that belongs to him or her in the first place.)*

Rom. 1:15 Because of this compelling urgency I am so keen to preach to you Romans also.

He continued to labor with his own hands not to put any burden on the people he ministered to; yet he was never known as Paul the tentmaker; even his apostleship was not a formal title but rather a description of his passion; he was driven by the word to make all men see.

1 Cor. 4:1 This is how one should regard us *(so called, Apostles)*: **we are the [1]under-rowers of Captain Christ; responsible for the engine room as it were! We are entrusted with the administration of the mysteries of God.** *(The unveiling of the mystery of the gospel of mankind's association in Christ is the driving force of the Church. The word, [1]****huperetes****, means an under-rower, who was one who was in*

the trireme, quadrireme, or quinquereme galleys and rowed in one of the undermost benches; those who were the lowest ranked slaves and often the most invisible part of the whole operation. We are not hiding behind fancy titles or impressive CV's to try and win your applause or financial support. We are not here to impress you with us; our mandate is to impress you with how complete you are in Christ because of God's doing. [See 1 Cor 1:30, 2:6-9].)

1 Cor. 4:2 *(Our title might be unimpressive, but our job is most significant.)* **For this reason our ministry is of unquestionable integrity.**

1 Cor. 4:3 The authority of my ministry is not based upon your scrutiny of my life or even any cross examination by a human court. Neither is it by my own assumption;

1 Cor. 4:4 even though I know of nothing against my conscience, I am not thereby acquitted. The point is not how self righteous I appear in my own eyes; the Lord's judgment is the only valid reference to our innocence.

Rom. 16:25 I am not talking "hear-say-theory"; I own the gospel I proclaim! This is my message! I salute God who empowers you dynamically and establishes you to be strong and immovable in the face of contradiction. Jesus Christ is the disclosure of the very mystery that was concealed in silence before [1]time or human [2]history were recorded. *(Titus 1:2 This is the life of the ages which was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before [2]time or space existed. [Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. The word, [2]**aionios**, speaks of ages.] Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer. The word, [1]**xronos**, means a measured duration or length of time; [**kairos** is a due, or specific moment of time.] This was before the ages or any measure of calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity! "This life was made certain before eternal time." [BBE 1949, Bible in Basic English] Paul's gospel does not merely proclaim Christ in history; he announces Christ unveiled in human life; Christ in you! Colossians 1:27.)*

Rom. 16:26 The mystery mirrored in [1]prophetic Scripture is now unveiled. The God of the ages determined to make this mystery known in such a way that all the nations of the earth will hear and realize the [2]lifestyle that faith ignites.

(This gospel breaks the silence of the ages and reveals how God succeeded to redeem his image and likeness in mankind. [1]Isa 53:4, 5. See note on 16:19, Faith inspires an [2]obedience of spontaneity beyond guilt and obligation.)

Rom. 16:27 Jesus Christ [1]uniquely [2]articulates the [3]wisdom of God; he is the [4]conclusion of the ages. *(Uniquely, [1]**monos,** alone, Jesus has no competition; this one man represents the entire human race; this is the mystery of the ages. 1 Cor 2:7 We voice words of wisdom that were hidden in silence for timeless ages; a mystery unfolding God's Masterful plan whereby he would redeem his glory in man. Our glorification has always been God's agenda, even before time was. 1 Cor 2:8 Neither the politicians nor the theologians of the day had a clue about this mystery [of mankind's association in Christ]; if they did, they would never have crucified the Lord whose death redeemed our glory! The word, [3]**sophos**, means clarity, wisdom. He forever broke the silence of the ages! The words, [4]**eis aion**, **eis** indicates a point reached in conclusion, thus the conclusion of the ages. He is the [2]**doxa**, opinion; the logos that was before time was; the Word that became flesh and dwells within us [Jn 1:1, 14]. The incarnation [Latin, **in carne**, in the body] is the final trophy of the eternal logos and doxa of God.*

Col 1:15 In him the image and likeness of God is made visible in human life in order that everyone may recognize their true origin in him. He is the firstborn of every creature. [What darkness veiled from us he unveiled. In him we clearly see the mirror reflection of our original life. The Son of his love gives accurate evidence of his image in human form. God can never again be invisible!]

Col 2:3 In Christ the complete treasure of all wisdom and knowledge is sourced.

Col 2:9 It is in Christ that God finds an accurate and complete expression of himself, in a human body! [While the expanse cannot measure or define God, his exact likeness is displayed in human form. Jesus proves that human life is tailor-made for God!]

Col 2:10 Jesus mirrors our completeness and endorses our true identity. He is "I am" in us. The days are over where our lives were dictated to under the rule of the law of performance and an inferior identity. [See Col 1:19] The full measure of everything God has in mind for a person, indwells him.)

In Chapter 16 of the book of Romans the names of 37 individual believers are personally honoured in this chapter of salutation. Seven home churches are also specifically mentioned, five in Rome and two in Corinth. Since Paul had never visited Rome, these people were all acquaintances, converts, fellow prisoners, or travel companions of his before they moved to Rome.

Since Priscilla and Aquilla originally came from Rome (Acts 18:2, 26 and 1 Cor. 16:19), they possibly purposefully returned there to establish or strengthen the ekklesia together with a strong team of believers. Their strategy was to scatter several home-fellowships throughout the city. This is reflected in Paul's letter to the Corinthians where he says, "Our expectation is that as your faith increases, our field amongst you will be greatly enlarged so that we may preach the gospel also in lands beyond you."(2 Cor. 10:15, 16)

Acts 18:2-5 And he found a Jew named Aquila, a native of Pontus, lately come from Italy with his wife Priscilla, because Claudius had commanded all the Jews to leave Rome. And he went to see them; and because he was of the same trade he stayed with them, and they worked, for by trade they were tentmakers. And he argued in the synagogue every Sabbath, and persuaded Jews and Greeks. When Silas and Timothy arrived from Macedonia, Paul was occupied with preaching, testifying to the Jews that the Christ was Jesus.

1 Thes. 2:7 Instead we were fostering you with the tender care of a mother nursing her children.

1 Thes. 2:8 It is with this same motherly affection that we yearn for you and were delighted to present you God's gospel gift wrapped in us, since you are so very dear to us! *(The word, [1]**metadidomi**, translates as the kind of giving where the giver is not distanced from the gift but wrapped up in it! The Apostles, Prophets, preachers, pastors, and teachers are gifts to the Ekklesia to establish them in their faith and to present everyone in the full and mature stature of Christ [Eph 4:11-16]. There is such a vast difference between a gift and a reward! We are God's gifts to one another. What God now has in us is gift wrapped to the world. What we are in our individual expression is a gift and not a reward for personal diligence or achievement. These gifts were never meant to establish one above the other, or to become mere formal titles, but rather to identify specific and dynamic functions with one defined purpose, to bring everyone into the realization of the fullness of the measure of Christ in them!)*

1 Thes. 2:9 I don't have to remind you to what extreme extents we were prepared to go in our efforts to bring you God's gospel at no expense to you at all! We kept going night and day, both teaching you as well as actively trading in the marketplace!

Acts 20:33 I coveted no one's silver or gold or apparel.

1 Thes. 4:11 Cultivate the [1]highest esteem for that which is of value and

honor; [2]cease from striving; mind your own business and give whatever you do your personal touch! These practical instructions are all part and parcel of the same [3]source as our constant sphere of influence. *(The beautiful word [1]**philotemeomai,** means to have a fondness for value and honor. The word [2]**hesuchatzo** means to rest and to cease from striving. See commentary note on the word [3]**paraggelia** in verse 2.)*

1 Thes. 4:12 Always maintain a good attitude towards those who still see themselves as outside of your company; do not hint for favors, echo completeness.

To Paul life in the flesh meant fruitful labour; everything that happened to him only served to advance the gospel.

Phil. 1:12 I wish to encourage you dear friends that the opposition I face, which was meant to defeat the gospel, has only served to advance it!

Phil. 1:13 The prison has become my pulpit! All the soldiers in the Governor's guard and everyone involved in the palace have learnt about my message. They know that I am not their prisoner but that I am enclosed in Christ.

Phil. 1:14 My imprisonment has also persuaded many believers in the Lord to speak the word with fearless courage.

2 Tim. 1:9 He rescued the integrity of our original design and revealed that we have always been his own from the beginning, even before time was. This has nothing to do with anything we did to qualify or disqualify ourselves. We are not talking religious good works or karma here. Jesus unveils grace to be the eternal intent of God! Grace celebrates our pre-creation innocence and now declares our redeemed union with God in Christ Jesus.

2 Tim. 1:10 Everything that grace pointed to is now realized in Jesus Christ and brought into clear view through the gospel: Jesus is what grace reveals. He took death out of the equation and re-defines life; this is good news indeed!

2 Tim. 1:11 Grace is my commission; it is my job and joy to proclaim this message and guide the nations into a full understanding of the love initiative of God.

2 Tim. 1:12 What I suffer because of this does not frighten me at all; faith has made him so [1]apparent. I am absolutely persuaded that I am safe in him. We are no longer looking for a future event, or another day, the day has come! Death is not Doomsday; nothing can interrupt what he has done! *(Greek, [1]**eido**, Latin, **video**, to see, to know.)*

2 Tim. 2:7 Ponder my words; the Lord will give you insight which will inspire you in every contradiction that you face.

2 Tim. 2:8 Make my gospel emphasis the focus of your thoughts: Jesus Christ is the seed of David, he is the promised Messiah; his resurrection from the dead is the proof. *(It is the evidence that he completed the salvation of mankind by defeating death. Hosea 6:2, Ephesians 2:5, Romans 4:25, Acts 17:31.)*

2 Tim. 2:9 I might be in bonds, but the word of God is not. *(It might seem to some that my suffering contradicts what I preach, but it cannot! My ministry is measured by the word not by my circumstances. See Colossians 1:24.)*

2 Tim. 2:10 This gives me more than enough reason not to quit. I desire for everyone to discover the fact that the life of their [1]design is redeemed in Christ Jesus; this is the timeless intent of God. *(The word [1]**eklegomai**, **ek**, source, origin, and **legomai** from **logos**, word, thus the life of our design.)*

2 Tim. 2:11 The logic of God endorses our faith: we were included in his death and are therefore equally included in his resurrection.

2 Tim. 2:12 Sufferings do not distract us; neither do they contradict our joint position with him in the throne room , the Christ-life rules. If we [1]contradict ourselves *(behave unlike ourselves)*, **he will contradict us and prove us wrong!** *(The word [1]**arneomai** means to contradict.)*

2 Tim. 2:13 Our unbelief does not change what God believes; he cannot contradict himself! *(See Rom 3:3,4 What we believe about God does not define him; God's faith defines us. God cannot be untrue to himself!)*

Col. 1:24 This is why no form of suffering can interfere with my joy. Every suffering on your behalf is just another opportunity to reinforce that which might still be lacking *(in your understanding)* **of the affliction of Christ on behalf of his body which is the church.** *(The inconvenience that Paul might be suffering on behalf of the believers is not to add to the sufferings of Christ—as though the sufferings of Christ on our behalf were insufficient but it is to further emphasize and confirm the principle of unselfish love that constrains New Testament ministry.)*

1 Cor. 9:13 It is common knowledge that the people engaged in temple ministry eat what is sacrificed there.

1 Cor. 9:14 The same principle goes for those who proclaim the Gospel; and this is not just someone's good idea it is endorsed by the Lord.

1 Cor. 9:15 The reason for my writing about these issues is not to bring you under any kind of obligation; on the contrary, I want to be very clear about this, the fact that I do things differently by not expecting anyone to pay me for my ministry is to emphasize my urgency to remove any possible excuse from anyone's mind that I might have ulterior motives! I am dead serious about this Gospel!

1 Cor. 9:16 I live to preach; it consumes my total being. Your money is not going to make any difference since this Gospel has my arm twisted and locked behind my back! ***[anagke]*** **In fact, my life would be reduced to utter misery if it were not possible for me to preach the Good News!**

1 Cor. 9:17 If this was a mere career choice, then surely you could hire or fire me! But I am not for sale; I am employed by the economy of persuasion!

1 Cor. 9:18 So what's in it for me, you may ask? The pleasure of declaring the Gospel of Christ at no expense is priceless! No, I am not cheating anyone or myself by foregoing the rights I might have as a preacher.

1 Cor. 9:19 So in a sense I am free from everyone's expectation or management; yet I have voluntarily enslaved myself to all people. This beats any other motivation to influence people.

1 Cor. 9:20 I am like a Jew to the Jew to win them; I am disguised as a legalist to win those stuck under the law!

1 Cor. 9:21 To the Gentiles who have no regard for Jewish sentiment, I became like one without any obligation to Jewish laws to win them! Don't get me wrong; I am not sinning to identify with the sinners! I am in the law of Christ! *(The agape law!)*

1 Cor. 9:22 I am so persuaded about every person's inclusion in Christ that I desire to be everything I need to be in order to win everyone's understanding of their union with Christ. I do not present myself as super strong to the weak, but rather expose myself to their weakness in order to win them. I do not distance myself from anyone. My mission is to be exactly what is required of me in every possible situation to awaken every kind of person, whoever they are, to own their salvation! I have no other agenda. *(Traditionally translated, "in order to save some;" I do not believe that this is what Paul is saying here! The word,* ***[1]tis****, can also suggest every single kind.)*

1 Cor. 9:23 The gospel explains my lifestyle; it is so much more than a pulpit ministry to me. My life is inseparably joined to you in the fellowship of the Good

News!

1 Cor. 9:24 Athletes run a race to win; their aim is to receive the prize not just to compete! This is why I preach, to persuade you and not just to entertain you! *(A soccer player can do magic with his footwork and ball skills, but it is no good if he cannot take the gap and score the goal!)*

1 Cor. 9:25 The athlete knows how to draw from focused inner strength in order to win the crown; for them all their effort translates into a mere moment celebrated by a fading wreath of honor. For us to win your faith is of imperishable value!

1 Cor. 9:26 I run with certain victory in my every step! I am not shadow boxing when I preach!

1 Cor. 9:27 I deliberately compare myself to the sacrifice and dedication of a champion athlete; in similar fashion I would pummel my body and subdue it! I would deny myself many things in my pursuit to win your faith so that you will not have any excuse to reject my message. I want you, not your money! *(Paul is not saying this because he is worried about God's approval. It is his audience's approval that he is after: "becoming all things to all types of people in order to win every single one of them!" 1 Corinthians 9:12, we would rather suffer lack than insisting on our rights and in the process cause you to be distracted from the gospel of Christ. [See also Paul's urgency in Col 1:25-28].)*

1 Cor. 15:58 Therefore, my beloved brethren, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that in the Lord your labour is not in vain. RSV

And in the Mirror Study Bible it reads, **1 Cor. 15:58 For this reason you can afford to be absolutely settled and rock-solid in faith's persuasion and always ready to go beyond where you would have gone before. Your doing now is inspired by your knowing that you are in him. If his resurrection is yours then his victory over sin and death is equally yours.**

2 Cor. 10:12 We are not contesting with those who desire to commend themselves! While they compete and compare with one another they completely miss the point; they fail to [1]comprehend our joint I-am-ness! *(The word, [1]**suniemi**, means a joining together like that of two streams; a fusion of thought.)*

2 Cor. 10:13 Why boast in something you can take absolutely no credit for! The only valid measure that defines our lives and explains why we have [1]arrived on

your doorstep with the gospel, is the one wherewith God has measured us in Christ. *(One cannot measure temperature with a ruler. The word [1]**ephikneomai**, from **epi**, continuous influence upon, and **hēkō**, to have come, to have arrived, to be present. See Romans 6:14, Sin was your master while the law was your measure; now grace rules. [The law revealed your slavery to sin; now grace reveals your freedom from it.] Also Romans 3:27 The law of faith cancels the law of works, which means there is suddenly nothing left for mankind to boast in. No one is superior to another. Bragging only makes sense if there is someone to compete with or impress. "Through the righteousness of God we have received a faith of equal standing." See 2 Pet 1:1 RSV The OS (operating system) of the law of works is willpower; the OS of the law of faith is love. Gal 5:6 Love sets faith in motion. The law presented mankind with choices; grace awakens belief! Willpower exhausts, love ignites! If choices could save us we would be our own Saviors! Willpower is the language of the law, love is the language of grace and it ignites faith that leads to romance; falling in love beats making a decision to believe in love! See Rom 7:19.)*

2 Cor. 10:14 Our ministry to you is proof that there are no geographic limitations that could possibly exclude you from the gospel of Jesus Christ!

2 Cor. 10:15 We are not competing with others for your membership; our vision for you is to see your faith mature into a full harvest; this is our standard rule, we have no other expectation! To the same degree that your faith matures, our field among you is greatly increased!

2 Cor. 10:16 You become the extension of our sphere of influence as we together reach neighboring regions beyond yourselves. The gospel is the key role-player here, not hidden agendas of man-made ministries!

2 Tim. 2:2 and what you have heard from me before many witnesses entrust to faithful men who will be able to teach others also. RSV

And in the Mirror, **2 Tim. 2:2 What you have learnt from me is not a theory; you have witnessed ample evidence that confirms the integrity of my message. See the future of this gospel in everyone you influence; their persuasion is also their competence to instruct others in the same revelation.** *(See Titus 1:9)*

Titus 1:7 An overseer must be above reproach; if he has a bad reputation in the community you do not want him to be part of your leadership team! A leader administrates God's economy and must therefore be a competent manager of

God's business. A person with his own selfish agenda, or one who loses his temper easily, or someone that is known to over indulge in food or wine, or a bully, or greedy for money is certainly not a candidate.

Titus 1:8 He must be [1]fond of strangers and able to make people feel immediately at home. Your leader must be a [2]caring person and one who shows [3]unselfish devotion to the welfare of others. Someone [3]sober-minded, whose thought-life is sorted out; one who walks in the [4]revelation of the finished work of Christ; a man of [5]mercy and who is strong in spirit. *(The word, [1]**philoxenos**, means fond of strangers. The word, [2]**philagathos**, translates as benevolent, good, kind, humane, generous, liberal, benign, philanthropic, altruistic. The word, [3]**sophrone**, means a saved mind. The word, [4]**dikaion**, translates as righteousness, the revelation of the finished work of Christ, and the word, [5]**hosios**, is translated as mercy as in Acts 13:44, which is a quote from Isaiah 55:3 from the Hebrew word, **ghesed**,* חסד *- mercy.)*

Titus 1:9 The overseer [1]mirrors the persuasion of the word he was taught and is competent to instruct with accuracy and to entreat and convince those who oppose the message. *(The word, [1]**antechomai,** comes from **anti** meaning against, standing opposite, and **echo**; thus one who mirrors the word.)*

Titus 1:10 There are many who engage in worthless debates about their Jewish sentiments and playing mind-games in order to snare new believers into legalism.

Titus 1:11 By entreating and persuading them with wisdom, their influence will be silenced. The rot must be stopped since they have already confused entire families with their teachings and robbed them financially in the process. Titus 3:2 Gossip is out! Never have anything bad to say about anyone! Don't try and be the [1]macho man, having to win every argument; instead, avoid quarrelling, be appropriate, always show perfect courtesy to one and all. *(The word, [1]**amachos** from **a** as a negative particle and **mache**, a brawler, to be controversial, striving. You don't have to wait for people to change before you are nice to them. There is a big difference between "fake politeness" and perfect courtesy!)*

Titus 3:3 Do not be harsh on others. Remember that we, too, were typically foolish; we were stubborn and indifferent to spiritual things, our addiction to the sensual and sexual kept us running around in circles, we were engaged in malice and spiteful jealousies, we were bored and lonely, often utterly disliking ourselves and hating one another!

Titus 3:4 But then, oh happy day! It was the generosity of God and his fondness for mankind that dawned on us like a shaft of light. Our days of darkness were over! Light shone everywhere and we became aware: God rescued the human race! *(See Titus 2:11.)*

Titus 3:5 Salvation is not a reward for good behavior. It has absolutely nothing to do with anything that we have done. God's mercy saved us. The Holy Spirit endorses in us what happened to us when Jesus Christ died and was raised! When we heard the glad announcement of salvation it was like taking a deep warm bath! Our minds were [1]thoroughly cleansed and re-booted into [2]newness of life! *(The word [1]**paliggenesia** suggests a complete restoration to the original, in modern terms, rebooted. The word [2]**anakainosis**, from **ana**, upward, and **kainosis**, newness, speaks of a fresh upward focus; a re-engaging with heavenly thoughts. See Col 3:1-3; also 1 Thess 1:5. We realized that we were indeed co-included, co-crucified, and co-raised and are now co-seated together with Christ in heavenly places! [See 2 Cor 5:14-21; Hosea 6:2; Eph 2:5, 6; and 1 Pet 1:3.])*

Titus 3:6 Holy Spirit is the extravagant Administrator of the salvation of Jesus Christ; gushing forth within us like an artesian well. *(An artesian well is a well, sunk through solid strata of sedimentary rock into strata from an area of a higher altitude than that of the well, so that there is sufficient pressure to force water to flow upward. From the French word, artesian, referring to the old French province Artois, where such wells were common.*

In John 7:37-39, John records how Jesus witnessed the eighth day, the great and final day of the Feast of Tabernacles, when, according to custom, the High Priest would draw water from the Pool of Siloam with a golden jar, mix the water with wine, and then pour it over the altar while the people would sing with great joy from Psalm 118:25-26, and also Isaiah 12:3; "Therefore with joy shall we draw water from the wells of salvation!" Then, Jesus, knowing that he is the completeness of every prophetic picture and promise, cried out with a loud voice: "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink! If you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, you will discover that you are what I am all about, and rivers of living waters will gush from your innermost being!" See Rom 5:5.)

Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.

Jesus never underestimated the individual, regardless of their reputation; he reached

the city of Sychar through one woman.

John 4:40 They then approached Jesus and entreated him to remain with them longer, so he stayed over for two days.

John 4:41 When they heard him speak, many more believed.

John 4:42 They said to the woman, now we believe not just because of your word but we have heard for ourselves and can clearly see that this man is indeed the Christ, the Savior of the world!

Mark 5:18-20 And as he was getting into the boat, the man who had been possessed with demons begged him that he might be with him. But he refused, and said to him, "Go home to your friends, and tell them how much the Lord has done for you, and how he has had mercy on you." And he went away and began to proclaim in the Decapolis how much Jesus had done for him; and all men marveled.

Here Jesus sees ten cities in one man's testimony! (Decapolis = 10 cities.)

God saw so much more in Gideon than what Gideon saw in himself. Before he encountered the word of the Lord, his life was reduced to mere survival.

Judges 6:11-16 Now the angel of the LORD came and sat under the oak at Ophrah, which belonged to Joash the Abiezrite, as his son Gideon was beating out wheat in the wine press, to hide it from the Midianites. And the angel of the LORD appeared to him and said to him, "The LORD is with you, you mighty man of valor." And the LORD turned to him and said, "Go in this might of yours and deliver Israel from the hand of Midian; do not I send you?" And he said to him, "Pray, Lord, how can I deliver Israel? Behold, my clan is the weakest in Manasseh, and I am the least in my family." And the LORD said to him, "But I will be with you, and you shall smite the Midianites as one man." RSV

God watches over His word to perform it! Jer.1:5-12. Jeremiah sees an almond tree; The same Hebrew word is used here, שָׁקַד shaqad, the almond was called the 'awake tree', because it blossomed first, while the other trees were still in their winter sleep. Phillip is led by the Spirit on a lonely road to introduce one Ethiopian to Christ; God sees the continent of Africa in one man! Acts 8:26-40.

Paul is not led by open doors, but by the knowledge that God always leads us in triumph and through us spreads the fragrance of the knowledge of him everywhere.

2 Cor. 2:12 So instead of coming to you I went to Troas where again a great ministry opportunity in the Good News of Christ was opened for me in the Lord.

(There is not a place on this planet that is not an open door for this gospel!)

2 Cor. 2:13 I expected to find Titus in Troas and was hoping to hear from him refreshing news concerning you. I felt so urgent to meet with Titus that I took leave from Troas and hastened on to look for him in Macedonia. *(See 2 Cor 7:4-8.)*

2 Cor. 2:14 I am overwhelmed with gratitude! Wherever my travels take me I am so aware that God leads us as trophies in his victory parade. What he knows to be true about us diffuses through us like a perfume of sweet aroma everywhere we go, celebrating the success of the cross. *(In ancient triumphs, abundance of perfumes and wreaths of sweet smelling flowers were used in victory celebrations.)*

2 Cor. 2:15 We are a sweet savor of Christ to God evident in everyone we meet. The fragrance of Christ is recognized in all to salvation. The same gospel that announces the fragrant victory of Christ declares the odor of death; the [1]defeat of destruction in everyone! *(This parade of victory is a public announcement of the defeat of the religious systems and structures based on the law of works. Just like it is in any public game where the victory celebration of the winning team is an embarrassment for the losing team. The death of evil is announced in resurrection life! The word, [1]**apollumi**, is derived from **apo**, away from, and **luo**, to loosen, to undo, to dissolve. See 1 John 3:8.)*

2 Cor. 2:16 The message we communicate is a fragrance with an immediate association; to darkness, it is the smell of doom *[the death of death];* **to life it is the familiar fragrance of life itself.**

2 Cor. 2:17 We are not competing with those who have added their [1]price tag to the gospel. Our conversation has its source in Christ; we communicate from the transparent innocence of a face to face encounter with God. *(The law of personal performance or [1]**kapeleuo**, meaning retail, which I translated here as a gospel with a price tag.)*

How we have wasted time playing for time! "You say there are yet four months then comes the harvest! I say you are looking at the wrong harvest! The bread you labour for cannot satisfy; lift up your eyes and see the harvest that is already ripe!" The seed in the fruit already matches the seed that was sown. We cannot even begin to preach the gospel without a revelation of the finished work of the cross! The only possible address of God is human life! No temple or any structure that an individual can build or organize can replace the living epistle.

John 2:19 To which Jesus responded, "The temple will be completely demolished

by you and in three days I will raise it up!" *(The word [1]**lusate**, to undo, demolish, is in the Aorist, Passive, imperative case; the distinction between the Aorist Imperative and the Present Imperative is one of aspect, not necessarily tense. Thus, to get something over and done with!*

See Matthew 12:39,40 But he answered them, "An evil and adulterous generation seeks for a sign; but no sign shall be given to it except the sign of the Prophet Jonah. For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of the whale, so will the son of man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth.

"Ask a sign of the LORD your God; let it be deep as Sheol or high as heaven. But you would not, therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign. Behold, a virgin shall conceive and bear a Son, and shall call his name Immanuel." Isaiah 7:11-14. "For unto us a child is born, to us a Son is given; and the government will be upon his shoulder, and his name will be called Wonderful Counsellor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. Of the increase of his government and of peace there will be no end." Isaiah 9:6,7.

In his resurrection on the third day, God would co-quicken the human race and co-raise us together with him! Hosea 6:2, Ephesians 2:5. Human life will again be the tabernacle of God! "On the third day Esther put on her royal robes and stood in the inner court of the king's palace, opposite the king's hall. The king was sitting on his royal throne inside the palace opposite the entrance to the palace; and when the king saw Queen Esther standing in the court, she found favor in his sight and he held out to Esther the golden scepter that was in his hand. Then Esther approached and touched the top of the scepter." Esther 5:1,2.

"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he interpreted to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself." Luke 24:27 "They said to each other, did not our hearts ignite within us while he talked to us on the road, while he opened to us the Scriptures?" Luke 24:32 "Then he said to them, these are my words which I spoke to you, while I was still with you, that everything written about me in the law of Moses and the Prophets and the Psalms must be fulfilled. Then he opened their minds to understand the Scriptures, and said to them, Thus it is written, that the Christ should suffer and on the third day rise from the dead" Luke 24:44-46; See also Ps 22 and Isa. 53.

Matthew 16:21 From that time Jesus began to show his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem and suffer many things from the elders and chief priests and law professors, and be killed, and on the third day be raised.)

Hos. 6:2 After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will raise us up, that we

may live before him.

The human body is redeemed as the very tabernacle and address of God.

John 4:35 The bread you labor for takes four months from the day you sow the seed until it ripens in the ear, doesn't it? This is not the food that I am talking about. The fruit of your own toil and performance will never satisfy permanently; from now on, lift up your eyes! Look at yourselves and everyone else differently; see them through your Father's eyes and you will know that they too are ripe and ready to discover how fully included they are in my finished work. They are perfectly mirrored in me! *(A harvest is ripe when the seed in the ear matches the seed that was sown! My mission is to reveal and redeem the image and likeness of God in human form!)*

John 4:36 This harvest reveals how both he who sows and he who reaps participate in the same joy of the life of the ages!

John 4:37 Just as the proverb says, "One sows and another reaps!"

John 4:38 I commissioned you to reap that which you did not labor for! Others labored and you tapped into the fruit of their toil!

Isaiah 52:10 The Lord has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations, and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God. vs. 14-15 Just as many were astonished at you—so was he marred in his appearance, more than any human, and his form beyond that of human semblance—so will he startle many nations. Kings will shut their mouths at him; for what had not been told them they will see, and what they had not heard they will understand. Isaiah 53:4-5 Surely he has borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted. But surely he was wounded for our transgressions; he was bruised for our iniquities; the chastisement of our peace was on him; and with his stripes we ourselves are healed. RSV

Deuteronomy 32:5, 6 They have corrupted themselves; they did not behave as his children, they have become a distorted generation of people, twisted out of their true pattern; they are a crooked and perverse generation. (Paul quotes this very verse in Phil. 2:15) Deuteronomy 32:18 You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you and have forgotten the God who danced with you. (Hebrew: חול ***kghul*** also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21,23.)

Rom. 8:29 He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly

fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. *(We come from above [See John 1:13; also John 3:3-13] We were also born anew when he was raised from the dead! [1 Peter 1:3] His resurrection co-reveals our common genesis as well as our redeemed innocence. [Rom 4:25 and Acts 17:31] No wonder then that he is not ashamed to call us his siblings! The word,* ***adelphous****, with* ***a*** *as a connective particle and* ***delphus****, the womb. We share the same origin [Heb 2:11* ***eks*** *[origin; source]* ***henos*** *[one]* ***pantes*** *[everyone], and, "In him we live and move and have our being, we are indeed his offspring!" [Acts 17:28].)*

Rom. 8:30 Jesus reveals that we [1]pre-existed in God; he [2]defined us. He [3]rendered us innocent and also [4]adorned us with splendor and esteem. *(The word [1]****prohorisen*** *from* ***prohoritso****, pre-defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan. Then [2]****ekalesen*** *from* ***kaleo****, to surname, identify by name. The verb, [3]****edikaiosen*** *is in the Aorist Active form from* ***dikaioo****, to declare righteous and innocent. All the verbs in this verse are in the Aorist tense. The Aorist presents an occurrence in summary, viewed as a whole from the outside, almost like a snapshot of the action. Also [4]****edoxasen*** *from* ***doxazō****; we have been adorned with splendor and glory. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory we lost in Adam. See Rom. 3:23, 24.)*

Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.

Rom. 10:10 This is where believing happens spontaneously, in the heart! The revelation of mankind's redeemed righteousness ignites a new conversation, announcing salvation. *(The word* ***pisteuetai*** *is the Impersonal construction, "it is believed"; believing takes place! [Present Passive Indicative of* ***pisteuō****] Faith is not something we "do" - faith is what happens to us when we realize what God has done for us! Isa. 26:12 O LORD, you have wrought for us all our works. RSV. "Of God's doing are we in Christ!" 1 Cor. 1:30. He restored us to blameless innocence! It is impossible not to boldly announce news of such global consequence [Isa 40:9])*

Rom. 10:11 Scripture declares that whosoever believes in Christ *[to be the fulfillment of the promise of God to redeem mankind]* **will [1]not be ashamed** *[hesitant].* *([See Isa 28:16] These two Hebrew words,* חוּשׁ ***chush****, to make haste, and [Isa 49:23]* בּוֹשׁ **bush, to be[1] ashamed, look and sound very similar and were obviously confused in**

some *translations—the Septuagint [LXX], was the text that Paul was familiar with and there the Greek word, καταισχύνω* ***kataischunō*** *to be ashamed, was translated from the word* בּוּשׁ ***bush.)***

Rom. 10:12 Nothing distinguishes the Jew from the Greek when it comes to the generosity of God. He responds with equal benevolence to everyone who sees themselves identified in him. *(They realize that God defines them and not their cultural identity.)*

Rom. 10:13 Salvation is to understand that every person's [1]true identity is revealed in Christ. *(Whosoever shall [1]call upon the Name of the Lord shall be saved;* [1]***epikaleomai,*** *to entitle; to identify by name, to surname.)*

Rom. 10:14 How is it possible to convince people of [1]their identity in him while they do not believe that he represents them? How will they believe if they remain ignorant about who they really are? How will they understand if the Good News of their inclusion is not announced? *(The word,* [1]***epikaleomai****, traditionally translates as "to call upon," from* ***kaleo****, which literary means to surname, or to identify by name. This is also the stem in* ***Ekklesia****, with* ***ek*** *being a Preposition that denotes origin, and* ***kaleo****. In the context of Matthew 16 where Jesus introduces this word, he reveals that the son of man is indeed the son of God, "I say to you Simon, son of Jonah, you are* ***Petros*** *[Rock] and upon this* ***petra*** *I will build my* ***Ekklesia****!" [See note on Rom 9:33].)*

Rom. 10:15 What gives someone the urgency to declare these things? It is recorded in prophetic Scripture, "How lovely on the mountains *(where the watchmen were stationed to witness the outcome of a war)* **are the feet of them leaping with the exciting news of victory. Because of their eyewitness encounter they are qualified to run with the Gospel of peace and announce the consequent glad tidings of good things that will benefit everyone."**

Rom. 10:16 It is hard to imagine that there can yet be a people who struggle to hear and understand the Good News. Isaiah says, "Lord, who has believed our report?"

Rom. 10:17 So, [1]this faith is [2]sourced in discerned hearing; the kind of hearing that recognizes the authentic unveiling of Christ as the [2]fountainhead of faith. *(Note,* [1]***this faith****; see 2 Cor. 13:5, also, Eph 4:5. There is only one faith that matters - not what we, or a million others believe, but what God believes! Jesus is what God believes about you-manity! We are God's audience; Jesus is God's language! The*

*Greek, [2]**ek**, is a Preposition that denotes origin; thus, faith emerges out of the word that reveals Christ. Hearing this dynamic message, both in the mouths of the prophets and now unveiled in the incarnate Christ, ignites persuasion!*

*The word [rhema] of "Christ", **not**, "of God" appears in the best manuscripts. It's not the mere quoting of the Scriptures that brings faith! It is the unveiling of Christ within, that does! See Luke 24:27 And beginning with Moses and all the prophets, he interpreted to them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself. They later testified, "Did not our hearts ignite within us while he explained the Scriptures to us?")*

Rom. 10:18 Has God not given mankind a fair chance to hear? Psalm 19 says, "His words touch the entire world like the rays of the sun; nothing is hid from its heat; yes, truly their resonance resounded in all the earth, and their voice unto the ends of the earth."

Our ability to obey and believe is superseded by his. It is what he did and believes that inspires our action and faith!

Uneducated, ordinary men turned their world upside down.

Acts 1:5 for John baptized with water, but before many days you shall be baptized with the Holy Spirit."

Acts 1:8 But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be my witnesses in Jerusalem and in all Judea and Samaria and to the end of the earth."

Acts 4:13 Now when they saw the boldness of Peter and John, and perceived that they were uneducated, common men, they wondered; and they recognized that they had been with Jesus.

Acts 17:6 And when they could not find them, they dragged Jason and some of the brethren before the city authorities, crying, "These men who have turned the world upside down have come here also -----"

1 Cor. 1:22 The Jews crave signs *[to confirm their doubts]* **while the Greeks revel in philosophical debate!** *(Both groups are addicted to the same soul realm.)*

1 Cor. 1:23 The crucified Christ is the message we publicly proclaim, to the disgust of the Jews while the Greeks think we are wacky.

1 Cor. 1:24 The dynamic of God's wisdom is the fact that both Jew and Greek are equally included and defined in Christ.

1 Cor. 1:25 It seems so foolish that God should die mankind's death on the cross;

it seems so weak of God to suffer such insult; yet their wisest schemes and most powerful display of genius cannot even begin to comprehend or compete with God in his weakest moment on the cross.

1 Cor. 1:26 You might as well admit it, my friends; it was not your academic qualifications or your good looks or social connections that influenced God to represent you in Christ.

1 Cor. 1:27 It is almost as if God deliberately handpicked the wacky of this world to embarrass the wise, the rejects to put to shame the noble.

1 Cor. 1:28 The ones with no pedigree of any prominence, the "nobodies" in society, attracted God's initiative to unveil his blueprint opinion in order to redefine mankind. Thus he rendered any other social standard entirely irrelevant, redundant and inappropriate. *(Blueprint opinion, **eklegomai**, from **ek**, meaning origin, source, and **legomai** from **logos**, the logic of God; traditionally translated as "elect".)*

1 Cor. 1:29 Every reason for someone's boasting in themselves dwindles into insignificance before God.

1 Cor. 1:30 [1]Of God's doing are we in Christ. He is both the genesis and genius of our wisdom; a wisdom that reveals how righteous, sanctified and redeemed we already are in him. *(The Preposition, [1]**ek**, always denotes origin, source. Mankind's association in Jesus is God's doing. In God's economy, Jesus Christ represents us; what mankind could never achieve through personal discipline and willpower as taught in every religion, God's faith accomplished in Christ. Of his design we are in Christ; we are associated in oneness with him. Our wisdom is sourced in this union! Also, our righteousness and holiness originate from him. Holiness equals wholeness and harmony of a person's spirit, soul, and body. Our redemption is sanctioned in him. He redeemed our identity, our sanity, our health, our joy, our peace, our innocence, and our complete well-being! [See Eph 1:4]. The Knox Translation reads, "It is from him that we take our [1]origin.")*

1 Cor. 1:31 He is our claim to fame. *(This is what Jeremiah meant when he wrote: "Let not the wise glory in their wisdom, let not the mighty glory in their might, let not the rich glory in their riches; but let the one who glories glory in this, that they understand and know me, that I am the Lord who practice steadfast love, justice, and righteousness in the earth; for in these things do I delight, says the Lord." Jer. 9:23, 24.)*

Heb. 12:1 So now the stage is set for us: all these faith-heroes cheer us on, as it

were, like a great multitude of spectators in the amphitheater. This is our moment. As with an athlete who is determined to win, it would be silly to carry any baggage of the old law-system that would weigh one down. Make sure you do not get your feet clogged up with sin-consciousness. Become absolutely streamlined in faith. Run the race of your spiritual life with total persuasion. *(Persuaded in the success of the cross.)*

Heb. 12:2 Look away from the shadow dispensation of the law and the Prophets and fix your eyes upon Jesus. He is the fountainhead and conclusion of faith. He saw the joy *[of mankind's salvation]* **when he braved the cross and despised the shame of it. As the executive authority of God** *[the right hand of the throne of God]* **he now occupies the highest seat of dominion to endorse mankind's innocence!** *(Having accomplished purification of sins, he sat down. Heb 1:3, Isa 53:11.)*

Heb. 12:3 [1]Ponder how he overcame all the odds stacked against him; this will boost your soul-energy when you feel exhausted. *([1]**analogitsomai**, upward calculation.)*

Acts 8: 5-8 Philip went down to a city of Samaria, and proclaimed to them the Christ. And the multitudes with one accord gave heed to what was said by Philip, when they heard him and saw the signs which he did. For unclean spirits came out of many who were possessed, crying with a loud voice; and many who were paralyzed or lame were healed.

All of Asia both Jews and Greeks heard the word within two years as a result of focused ministry coming from one school!

Acts 19: 8-11 And he entered the synagogue and for three months spoke boldly, arguing and pleading about the kingdom of God; but when some were stubborn and disbelieved, speaking evil of the Way before the congregation, he withdrew from them, taking the disciples with him, and argued daily in the hall of Tyrannus. This continued for two years, so that all the residents of Asia heard the word of the Lord, both Jews and Greeks. And God did extraordinary miracles by the hands of Paul,

Isa. 40:9 Get you up to a high mountain, O Zion, herald of good tidings; lift up your voice with strength, O Jerusalem, herald of good tidings.

Pondering the revelation of Christ in you gives volume to your voice. Engaging your thoughts with throne room realities where you are seated together with Christ is the highest mountain for strategic altitude! Col. 3:1-3, 16.

Isa. 52:7 How beautiful upon the mountains are the feet of him who brings good tidings, who publishes peace, who brings good tidings of good, who publishes salvation.

If you believe that I am what the scriptures are all about, you will know that you are what I am all about and rivers of living water will flow out of your innermost being. John 7:37, 38.

And the earth shall be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the Lord as the waters cover the sea.

One wonders why God showed Ezekiel a valley of bleached bones? Zero sign of life left! And then ask the question, "Can these bones live?" And why God waited till Sarah's womb was dead! And why God only created Adam on the 6th day when all his work was already done?

Jesus didn't die 99% or for 99% He died humanity's death! If Paul had compromised the last part of verse 14 of 2 Cor. 5, to read: "one died for all therefore only those who follow the prescriptions to qualify, have also died," then he would have had to change the first half of the verse as well!

Only the love of Christ can make a calculation of such enormous proportion!

How can we underestimate such a great salvation!

How can anyone possibly be lost if they are already found in Christ!

There is no good news in telling people how lost they are! Let's tell everyone how found they are! Let's not be the other brother in Luke 15

The revelation of the initiative of God to bring an end to hostility is the dominant theme of the Gospel of redemption. If we can fully grasp the implication of this it would revive every relationship and cause wars to cease to the ends of the earth!

We are entrusted with world peace! Our ministry is the ministry of reconciliation. God already reconciled a hostile world to himself and now urgently pleads through us and appeals to every individual's conscience, in order to make all people see and realize its consequence.

While every effort is spent in the research of possible solutions to the horror threat of diseases, the greatest quest to meaningful life, friendship with substance, of spontaneity and continuity, is either neglected or ignored. Often the very cancer of promiscuity and immorality that destroys relationship is not only tolerated but accepted or even promoted in a corrupt society.

The Gospel is the unveiling of a friendship of the highest expression of value and other-centered love and quality, within every person's reach!

We have underestimated the Gospel of Jesus Christ for centuries, because we have adopted an interpretation that robbed us of the true impact of salvation in its relation to life in the here and now on planet earth. We have felt more comfortable with a faith that refers us to a place in heaven one day rather than to see faith as the now and relevant substance of things we always longed for and the evidence of unseen realities within us and within our immediate grasp.

Light dispels darkness effortlessly

Just like water breaks the drought naturally

We're not gonna get it right by debating the degrees of the darkness or the drought - be the light - be the river of living waters because you are!

God couldn't give himself more beautifully to the world

than what he did in you!

Discover yourselves in Christ!

Then see Christ mirrored in you -

now, live the adventure!

There is nothing wrong with you! Chapter 14

So, you've been told to embrace your doubts, flaws, fears and imperfections - well,

that maybe popular philosophy and sincere psychology - but, it's not the Good News!

You are perfect and complete and lacking in nothing!

Your design defines you - not the size of your challenges and contradictions.

You cannot measure temperature with a ruler! Don't measure yourself by the law of willpower-driven striving and performance.

Measure yourself by the liberating law of love and faith - Gods love and belief in you, is mirrored in Christ!

While we compete and compare ourselves with one another, we are without understanding! 2 Cor. 10:12

Song of Songs 4:7 You are altogether beautiful, my darling; there is no blemish is in you.

Nothing to be improved! You're totally ten out of ten! S/Songs 4:7 *[Rob Lacey]*

We've got our masks off and God's brilliance is bouncing off our faces! We're glowing from knowing! *2 Cor. 3:18 [Rob Lacey]*

Look him in the face- you'll glisten with God.

You'll gleam, your face'll scream, "GOD!" Psalm 34:5 [Rob Lacey]

By the way, God doesn't use "Jesus" glasses when he looks at you!

He sees you! And loves you!

Jesus has come to introduce us to ourselves again. So that we may know, even as we have always been known! 1 Cor. 13:12

James 1:2 Temptations and contradictions come in different shapes, sizes, and intervals; their intention is always to suck you into their energy field. However, my friends, your joy in who you know you are [1]leads you out triumphantly every time. *(The word, [1]**hegeomai**, comes from a strengthened form of ago, to lead, thus, to officially appoint in a position of authority; to lead with distinguished authority. Joy is the official voice of faith! "Count it all joy," make a calculation to which joy can be the only logical conclusion.)*

James 1:3 Here is the secret: joy is not something you have to fake, it is the fruit

of what your faith knows to be true about you! You know that the proof of faith results in a persuasion that remains constant in contradiction.

James 1:4 *(Just like a mother hen patiently broods over her eggs,)* **steadfastness provides you with a consistent environment, and so patience prevails and proves your perfection; how entirely whole you are and without any shortfall.**

James 1:5 The only thing you could possibly lack is wisdom. *[One might sometimes feel challenged beyond the point of sanity.]* However, make your request in such a way that you draw directly from the [2]source. *[Not filtered through other opinions]* God is the origin and author of wisdom; he [1]intertwines your thoughts with good judgment. His gifts are available to all, without regret. *(The word, [1]**haplos**, from ha, particle of union; **hama**, together with + **pleko**, meaning to plait, braid, weave together. See Luke 11:34 "The eye is the lamp of the body; if the eye is "single" [entwined with light], the whole body is full of light!" Entwining our eyes with Papa's eyes is what enlightens our entire being! Which is exactly what the word קוה Kawa in Hebrew means in Isa 40:31, they that entwine with the Lord's thoughts mount up with wings like eagles! We are wired by design to entwine! Also, Matthew 6:22. See 2 Cor 1:12. Wisdom that comes from above remains unaffected by the contradictions of the senses. The word, [2]**didomi**, to give, to be the author or source of a thing — Wesley J. Perschbacher.)*

God's rest celebrates your perfection! Behold, you are very good! He rests in his love and dances over you with joyful singing and delight! Zeph. 3:17.

Quit trying your best and enter into his rest! Heb. 4:10,11.

Now, live the adventure of your life from that place of strength! Col. 3:1-4

Return to your rest oh my soul, for the Lord has dealt bountifully with you!

In October 2010 I was ministering in Budapest when I woke up one night at 2 am with this startling thought, "There is nothing wrong with the human race, because there is nothing wrong with their design and there is nothing wrong with their salvation. There is only something horribly wrong with their thinking!"

Jesus is proof that God has done enough to rescue his image and likeness in us and restore fallen humanity to a place of blameless innocence.

Why then is the world in such a mess when the cross was indeed a success?

I deal with this in the following chapters:

- We were thinking wrong!

- What about the sinful Nature?

- Question: Why did Jesus have to DIE for this?

If it's merely a "mind matter," if God never saw mankind different, why could Jesus not just come, reveal himself and introduce us to our original design again?

Just as Israel did, when, after their amazing deliverance from Pharaoh and slavery, they continued to believe a lie about themselves and died neutralized in a desert. The challenges that we are faced with both individually as well as a global humanity, seem to dwarf us into insignificance. Num. 13:33

God says it as it is in Isa. 55:8-11 "For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, says the LORD. For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts than your thoughts."

We often stop reading here and conclude that God's thoughts and ways are meant to be incomprehensible. This makes no sense at all! Thank God for the next two verses; the whole of the good news is wrapped up in this statement: "For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven, and return not thither but saturate the earth, making it bring forth and sprout, giving seed to the sower and bread to the eater. So shall my word be that goes forth from my mouth; it shall not return to me empty, but it shall accomplish that which I purpose, and prosper in the thing for which I sent it. RSV

Jesus Christ is the incarnate word; he is God's thoughts most perfectly packaged and unveiled in human form. In him the word became flesh. Every definition of distance is cancelled! The word cannot become more flesh than what it did in the man Jesus Christ. As head of the human race Jesus Christ is proof that the destiny of the word was fulfilled in him on behalf of the human race. He did not come as an example for us but of us!

2 Cor. 3:13 What we say is so unlike Moses who had to keep Israel in suspense with a veiled face; they did not realize that this arrangement would never suffice to secure their standing before God. In essence the letters on stone confirmed their death. All that they could see was the futility of the law of works; how entirely useless their best attempts would be to match the life of their design. *(In Adam all people alike stood condemned; they did not realize it until the law revealed it. In Christ all are declared innocent; yet they do not know it until the Gospel reveals it. Rom 10:17 and Rom 7:4-25.)*

2 Cor. 3:14 Since the time of Moses until this very day their minds remain calloused and veiled. They are kept in suspense without realizing that there is no glory left in the law: *(whatever glory there was, carried merely a fading, prophetic glimmer)* **reading**

the Old Covenant without understanding that Christ is the fulfillment of Scripture is a complete waste of time. Only in discovering our union with Christ is the veil removed and do we realize that the old system is [1]rendered entirely useless. *(The word [1]**katergeo** comes from **kata**, meaning intensity, and **argos**, meaning labor, the law of works is rendered entirely useless; thus the new arrangement frees us from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ.)*

2 Cor. 3:15 In the meantime nothing seems to have changed; the same veil continues to blindfold the hearts of people whenever Moses is read. *(Moses symbolizes the futility of self righteousness as the global blindfold of the religious world. [John 1:17] Against the stark backdrop of the law; with Moses representing the condemned state of mankind, Jesus Christ unveils grace and truth! He is the life of our design redeemed in human form.)*

2 Cor. 3:16 The moment anyone [1]returns to the Lord the veil is gone! *(The word, [1]**epistrepho** means to return to where we've wandered from; "we all like sheep have gone astray." Jesus is God unveiled in human form. [Col 1:15] Also 1 Pet 2:25 You were completely vulnerable, just like sheep roaming astray without direction or protection, but now you have returned and are restored to the shepherd and Guardian of your souls! And 1 Pet 1:17. Then, Hebrews 8:1, "The conclusion of all that has been said points us to an exceptional Person, who towers far above the rest in the highest office of heavenly greatness. He is the executive authority of the majesty of God. 8:2 The office he now occupies is the one which the Moses-model resembled prophetically. He ministers in the holiest place in God's true tabernacle of worship. Nothing of the old man-made structure can match its perfection. Heb 8:10 Now, instead of documenting my laws on stone, I will chisel them into your mind and engrave them in your inner consciousness; it will no longer be a one-sided affair. I will be your God and you will be my people, not by compulsion but by mutual desire." See James 1:25, "Those who gaze into the mirror reflection of the face of their birth are captivated by the effect of a law that frees them from the obligation to the old written code that restricted them to their our own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what they see in that mirror concerning the law of perfect liberty [the law of faith] that now frees them to get on with the act of living the life [of their original design]. They find a new spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living." [The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human life as in a mirror.])*

2 Cor. 3:17 The Lord and the Spirit are one; his Lordship sanctions our freedom. A freedom from rules chiselled in stone to the voice of our redeemed design echoing in our hearts!

2 Cor. 3:18 Now, we all, with new understanding, see ourselves in him as in a mirror. The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is [1]unveiled. In [2]gazing with wonder at the [5]blueprint of God displayed in human form, we suddenly realize that we are looking into a mirror, where every feature of his [3]image articulated in Christ is [2]reflected within us! The Spirit of the Lord engineers this radical [4]transformation; we are led [6]from an inferior [5]mind-set to the revealed [5]endorsement of our authentic identity. *(The word, [1]**anakalupto**; from **ana**, a Preposition denoting upward, to return again, and **kalupto**, to uncover, unveil. The word, [2]**katoptrizomai**, means to gaze into a reflection, to mirror oneself. Paul uses [4]**metamorphumetha** as a present Passive indicative from **metamorpho**; **meta**, together with, and **morphe**, form. [The word commonly translated sin, [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, allotted portion or form; thus, a distorted form, which is the opposite of metamorphe; with form. The word **meros** is the stem of **morphe**.] Now, with unveiled faces we are gazing at the glory of the Lord as in a mirror and metaporhe happens - image and likeness awakens within us!*

*The word, [3]**eikon**, translates as exact resemblance, image and likeness; **eikon** always assumes a prototype, that which it not merely resembles, but from that which it is drawn; [5]**doxa**, glory, translates as mindset, or opinion from **dokeo**, authentic, blueprint-thought. Changed '**from** glory to glory', **apo doxes eis doxan**; **eis**, a point reached in conclusion; [6]**apo**, away from, meaning away from the glory that previously defined us, i.e. our own achievements or disappointments, to the glory of our original design that now defines us. Two glories are mentioned in this chapter; the glory of the flesh, which is the veiled, fading kind represented by Moses and the unfading, unveiled glory of God's image and likeness, mirrored in the face of Christ and now redeemed in us. See also 2 Cor 4:4 -7.*

*[Note, the Greek word translated "from" in this verse is not the same as the word translated "from" in Rom 1:17 Paul says the unveiling of God's righteousness is **from** faith to faith. Here he does not use the word **apo**, away from, but the Preposition, **ek**, which always denotes source or origin.]*

Some translations of this Scripture read, "we are being changed from glory to glory." This would suggest that change is gradual and will more than likely take a lifetime,

which was the typical thinking that trapped Israel for forty years in the wilderness of unbelief! We cannot become more than what we already are in Christ. We do not grow more complete; we simply grow in the knowledge and awareness of our completeness! [See Colossians 3:10] How long does it take the beautiful swan to awaken to the truth of its design? The ugly duckling was an illusion! Whatever it was that endorsed the 'ugly duckling' mindset, co-died together with Christ! In the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, God did not redeem a compromised replica of you; he rescued the original, blueprint you, created in his radiant mirror likeness! Any other 'self' you're trying to find or esteem will disappoint! See Romans 6:11, Reckon your 'DIY-law of works-self' dead, and your redeemed self co-raised and co-seated together with Christ! This is freedom indeed! Galatians 2:19,20; Gal 2:20 So here I am dead and alive at the same time! I'm dead to the old me I was trying to be and alive to the real me which is Christ in me! Co-crucified, now co-alive! What a glorious entanglement! I was in him in his death; now he is in me in my life! For the first time I'm free to be me in my skin, immersed in his faith in our joint-sonship! He loves me and believes in me! He is God's gift to me! (The verb συνεσταυρωμαι from sustauroō, is in the Perfect Tense, indicating that not only was I crucified with Christ in the past, but I am existing now in that present condition. How can any human effort improve on this! See Hosea 6:2 and Eph 2:5 also Romans 7:6 But now we are fully released from any further association with a life directed by the rule of the law, we are dead to that which once held us captive, free to be slaves to the newness of spirit-spontaneity rather than age old religious rituals, imitating the mere face value of the written code. The moment one exchanges spontaneity with rules, the edge of romance is compromised!))

2 Cor. 4:4 The survival and self-improvement programs of the [1]religious systems of this world veil the minds of the unbelievers; exploiting their ignorance about their true origin and their redeemed innocence. The veil of unbelief obstructs a person's view and keeps them from seeing what the light of the gospel so clearly reveals: the [2]glory of God is the image and likeness of our Maker redeemed in human form; this is what the gospel of Christ is all about. *(The god of this [1]**aion**, age, refers to the religious systems and governing structures of this world. The unbelief that neutralized Israel in the wilderness was the lie that they believed about themselves; "We are grasshoppers, and the 'enemy' is a giant beyond any proportion!" [Num 13:33, Josh 2:11, Heb 4:6.] "They failed to possess the promise due to unbelief." The blueprint [2]**doxa**, glory of God, is what Adam lost on mankind's behalf. See Eph 4:18.)*

Luke 11:34 The eye is the lamp of the body. When the eye is [1]entwined with light, the entire person is illuminated! But when the [2]poneros-system of wearisome rules and regulations is its focus, it's all darkness. *(The word, [1]**haplos**, from **ha**, particle of union; **hama**, together with + **pleko**, meaning to plait, braid, weave together. If the eye is "single" [entwined with light], the whole body is full of light! Entwining our eyes with Papa's eyes is what enlightens our entire being! Which is exactly what the word* קוה *Kawa in Hebrew means in Isa 40:31, they that entwine with the Lord's thoughts mount up with wings like eagles! We are wired by design to entwine! The word, [2]**poneros** is often translated, evil; it suggests the intoxication of a futile mentality of hardships labors and annoyances - which is what the system of performance, is all about! See Rom 3:27)*

Luke 11:35 Make sure then, that your inner enlightenment is not veiled by some secret hidden compartments *[the typical agenda of seeking affirmation and identity in the old system of performance],* **or perhaps a devious business transaction** *[a business basket - a bushel]* **which gives darkness dominance in your life!** *(See in verse 33, the word, [1]**krupte** a secret place, hidden from view; a vault or cellar. Also, the market-related word often translated, **bushel**, **modios** from the Latin modius, which is a cylindrical basket for measuring a specific mass of dry grain; approximately 2 gallons/ 8.7liters. Jesus speaks about a good measure, pressed down, shaken together and running over! Luke 6:38. See Revelation 3:17 in the Mirror Study Bible. Allow the light of God's intimate knowledge of you to purge you entirely of any hidden habits or secret sins! See 1 John 1:7 We are invited to explore the dimensions of the same light that engulfs God; when we see the light in his light, fellowship ignites! In his light we understand how the blood of Jesus Christ is the removal of every stain of sin! The success of the cross celebrates our redeemed innocence!*

1 John 1:8 To claim innocence by our own efforts under the law of personal performance is to deceive ourselves and to deliberately ignore the truth. The truth about you does not mean that you now have to go into denial if you have done something wrong!

1 John 1:9 When we [1]communicate what God says about our sins, we discover what he believes concerning our redeemed oneness and innocence! We are cleansed from every distortion we believed about ourselves! Likeness is redeemed! [The word traditionally translated "confession" is the word [1]homologeo from homo, the same, and logeo to speak. In the context of verse 7, this suggests that we say what God says about us!]

1 John 1:10 If we judge ourselves innocent by the law of our own works, then we

make Jesus Christ, and what his word and blood communicate within us, irrelevant. [See John 1:3-5 The Logos is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive parent reference to their genesis. There is nothing original - except the Word! His life is the light that defines our lives. [In his life, man discovers the light of life.] The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. [Darkness represents mankind's ignorance of their redeemed identity and innocence. Isaiah 9:2-4, Isaiah 60:1-3, Ephesians 3:18, Colossians 1:13-1.]". See also Isaiah 9:2 "The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light; those who dwelt in a land of deep darkness, have been illuminated with light." Matthew 4:16 The people who sat in darkness have seen a great light, and for those who sat in the region and shadow of death, light has dawned." A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world!])

Luke 11:36 So, with light dispelling every trace of darkness within you, your entire life becomes a beaming, radiant light!

Eph. 4:14 The most dangerous life you can live is an ignorant one. You're left like an infant on a ship out of control in the waves and winds of the storms of life. The fall of the dice dictates while the deceptive teachings of men and their distracting tricks entertain.

Eph. 4:15 [1]Love gives truth its voice. The conversation that [2]truth inspires creates the atmosphere wherein growth is both spontaneous and inevitable. The whole person is addressed in Christ who is the head of the body; he is the conclusion of God's communication with mankind. *("Speaking the truth in love" is not only the preferred attitude in our every conversation, but the only option; where truth gives integrity to love, and love gives attraction to truth. Love, [1]**agape**, comes from **ago**, to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep, and **pao**, to rest. God's rest celebrates our perfection; **agape** is to see the same value that God sees in every person. [2]Truth as it is mirrored in Christ [v 21].)*

Eph. 4:16 [1]From him flows the original composition and detail of our design. Like words entwined in poetry, *[[1]like a conductor of music, [1]**epichoregeo**]* **they connect layer upon layer to complete the harmony, following the rhythm of his thoughts like footprints. Meanwhile the body thrives and pulsates with the energy of love. Each individual expression finds its complete measure there.** *(The church is not a dismembered, dysfunctional body, but a fully functional, coordinated lover of people." — Rob Lacey.)*

Eph. 4:17 My most urgent appeal to you in the Lord is this: you have nothing in common with the folly of the empty-minded [1]masses; the days of conducting your lives and affairs in a meaningless way are over! *(The Gentiles, [1]**ethnos**, the masses of people who are walking in the vanity of their minds.)*

Eph. 4:18 The life of their design seems foreign to them because their minds are darkened through a hardened heart ruled by ignorance. They are blinded by the illusion of the senses as their only reference, stubbornly wearing a blindfold in broad daylight. *(Hardness of heart is the result of a darkened understanding; a mind veiled through unbelief. See 2 Cor 4:4.)*

Eph. 4:19 Having become conditioned to a life distanced from God; they are calloused in spirit, and are lust and greed driven; they have completely abandoned themselves to outrageous shameless living. *(See Rom 1:19-23 in the Mirror Study Bible.)*

Eph. 4:20 Of what total contrast is Christ!

Eph. 4:21 [1]Truth is defined in Jesus! It is not possible to study him in any other context; he is the incarnation; hear him resonate within you! The truth about you has its ultimate reference in Jesus. *(Lit. [1]The truth, as it is in Jesus. See 1 John 2:7,8, Whatever is true of him, is equally true of you! He did not come to introduce a new compromised set of rules; he is not an example for us but of us!)*

Eph. 4:22 Now you are free to strip off that old identity like a filthy worn-out garment. Lust corrupted you and cheated you into wearing it. *(Just like an actor who wore a cloak for a specific role he had to interpret; the fake identity is no longer appropriate!)*

Eph. 4:23 Be renewed in your innermost mind. *[Ponder the truth about you, as it is displayed in Christ; begin with the fact of your co-seatedness.]* **This will cause you to be completely re-programmed in the way you think about yourself!** *(Notice that Paul does not say, "Renew your minds!" This transformation happens in the spirit of your mind, awakened by truth on a much deeper level than a mere intellectual or academic consent. We often thought that we had to get information to drop from the head to the heart; but it is the other way around! Jesus says in John 7:37, "When you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, then you will discover that you are what I am all about, and rivers of living waters will gush out of your innermost being! The spirit of mankind was never contaminated; just like the watermark in a paper note. The lost coin never lost its original inscription and image [see also James 3:9]; it was the*

mind that was veiled by darkness; we were darkened in our understanding! Our thoughts were reduced to the soul realm reference, knowing ourselves, and one another merely after the flesh. Isa 55:8-11 There is nothing wrong with our design or our redemption; we were thinking wrong! In order for our thoughts to be rescued from the dominion of darkness, Jesus as the incarnate image and likeness of God, has gone into our darkest hellish nightmare, and faced our cruellest judgment and fears, and died our death! This is the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations, for our glorification! We were co-crucified, to bring absolute closure to every reference we have had of ourselves as a result of Adam's fall! And while we were dead in our sins and trespasses, God co-quickened us and co-raised us, and co-seated us in Christ! Now, we all with unveiled faces may behold the glory of the Lord as in a mirror! And be radically transformed in our thinking in order to rediscover his image and likeness fully redeemed in us!)

1 John 5:19 We know that we have our origin in God; yet the whole world [1]lies trapped in the blindfold-mode of a lost identity; intoxicated by the poneros system of a futile mentality of hardships labors and annoyances! *(The word **keimai** means to lie prostrate, outstretched; buried.)*

1 John 5:20 This is what has become distinctly clear to us: the [1]coming of the Son of God is God's mission accomplished! He is the incarnate Christ. The moment all of Scripture pointed to has arrived! The Son is [1]present! In him God has given us the greatest gift, [2]a mind whereby we may know him who is true; and in the same knowing, to find ourselves there in him who is true! Mankind is fully included and located in him, in his Son Jesus Christ; this means that whatever Jesus is as Son, we are. This is the true God; this is the life of the ages! *(The word [1]**heko** means to have come, to have arrived, to be present. John uses the word [2]**dianoian**; deep thought; with **dia** relating to the means by which we may know; a mind to know; compare metanoia, to know together with; an entwining of thought; the mind of Christ.*

Jesus said, you will know the truth as it is unveiled in me, and that will set you free!

The culmination of the gospel according to John is summed up in these verses: John 14:20 "In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you!" Also 1 John 2:7 & 8, "what is true of him, is equally true of us. 1 John 4:17 "As he is, so are we in this world! Our lives are mirrored in him" as well as here in 1 John 5:20.)

1 John 5:21 This defeats every image of our imagination that could possibly compete with the authentic likeness of our design! Darling children, distance

yourselves from every substitute image, which is what idolatry is all about! *(The word [1]**eidolon,** often translated idol, refers to image or likeness.*

*Isa 40:18-21 To whom then will you liken God, or what likeness compare with him? The idol? A workman casts it, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold, and casts for it silver chains. He who is impoverished chooses for an offering wood that will not rot; he seeks out a skilful craftsman to set up an image that will not move. Have you not known? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you **from the beginning**? Have you not understood from the foundations of the earth? Remember your beginning! You are God's idea - the Engineer of the Universe imagined you! Gen 1:26; Col 1:15; Col 2:9,10.*

Act 17:28-31 For 'In him we live and move and have our being'; as even some of your poets have said, 'For we are indeed his offspring.' Being then God's offspring, we ought not to think that the Deity is like gold, or silver, or stone, a representation by the art and imagination of human origin. The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he compels all of mankind everywhere to awaken to their redeemed identity and innocence!

Idolatry is a projection of an image of one's own making. Idolatry is the crux of religion - it is expensive business since your idol is like a slot machine at the casino! It remains hungry and it is wired to bite and bankrupt you!)

James speaks about the effect of the Word as discovering the reflection of the face of our birth as in a mirror there! Rescuing us from our forgetfulness! "We have forgotten what manner of people we are!"

The appeal of the good news message is to straighten out mankind's thinking! This is what the Greek word, metanoia means! It means to discover God's thoughts about you! It does not mean to repent as all the English translations have it! Repent comes from a Latin word which means pennance! Religion deliberately squeezed this word into the Bible to make money out of people's misery!

Jer. 29:11 For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, says the LORD, thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and a hope.

Jesus is God's mind made up about mankind!

One of the greatest teachers in the Celtic world, John Scotus Eriugena in ninth-century Ireland, also taught that Christ is our memory. We suffer from the "soul's forgetfulness," he says. Christ comes to re-awaken us to our true nature. He is our epiphany. He comes to show us the face of God. He comes to show us also our face, the true face of the human soul. This leads the Celtic tradition to celebrate the relationship between

nature and grace. Instead of grace being viewed as opposed to our essential nature or as somehow saving us from ourselves, nature and grace are viewed as flowing together from God. They are both sacred gifts. The gift of nature, says Eriugena, is the gift of "being"; the gift of grace, on the other hand, is the gift of "well-being." Grace is given to reconnect us to our true nature. At the heart of our being is the image of God, and thus the wisdom of God, the creativity of God, the passions of God, the longings of God. Grace is opposed not to what is deepest in us but to what is false in us. It is given to restore us to the core of our being and to free us from the unnaturalness of what we are doing to one another and to the earth.

An ancient Moroccan legend records the story of Eve deceived by the thought that she had competition in another woman more beautiful than herself!

She was offered the magic fruit of a tree that would make her more beautiful than what she already was.

The deceiver led her to a mountain where this "other" woman was supposed to be "in hiding" and prompted her to look into the cave.

What she saw there, reflected in a pool of water was herself, but she believed it was someone more beautiful than her and immediately took the fruit and ate it!

The legend concludes by saying that, whoever is not deceived by the reflection in the water, remains in paradise!

In David's dramatic account of the cross in Psalm 22, a thousand years BC, he concludes with this most significant statement, "The ends of the earth shall remember, and turn to the Lord; and all the families of the nations shall worship before him! " And again in the next Psalm, 23, he says, "By the waters of reflection, my soul remembers who I am!" Now I can go through the valley of the shadow of death and fear no evil!

What about the sinful Nature? Chapter 16

We theologically created the idea of humanity being 'sinful by nature' as if humans are flawed by design. In fact it is a distorted mindset that we inherited from Adam from which Jesus had to free us. The tree of the knowledge of good and evil sponsored this mindset. We were alienated and hostile in mind, doing evil deeds sponsored by the law of sin and death that lodged in our bodies hosting a foreign influence, contrary to our design. Just like a virus would attach itself to a person and display its symptoms. Someone might host a virus but at no point does the patient become the virus!

Rom. 3:23 Mankind is in the same boat; their [1]distorted behavior is proof of a [2]lost [3]blueprint. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. See Deuteronomy 32:18, "You have forgotten the Rock that begot you and have gotten out of step with the God who danced with you!" Hebrew, חול **khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21. See Romans 9:33 in the Mirror! The word [2]**hustereo**, to fall short, to be inferior, [3]**doxa**, glory, blueprint, from **dokeo**, opinion or intent.)*

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing himself]* **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.**

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life** *[of*

their original design.] **They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in mankind as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kupto**, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]**parameno**, to remain captivated under the influence of; **meno**, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]**eleutheria**, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

God's thoughts are most accurately expressed in the incarnation; not as in a display window but as in a mirror, so that we now may behold his glory with unveiled faces; the eyes of our understanding enlightened with the true light that enlightens every person.

Eph. 4:17 My most urgent appeal to you in the Lord is this: you have nothing in common with the folly of the empty-minded [1]masses; the days of conducting your lives and affairs in a meaningless way are over! *(The Gentiles, [1]**ethnos**, the masses of people who are walking in the vanity of their minds.)*

Eph. 4:18 The life of their design seems foreign to them because their minds are darkened through a hardened heart ruled by ignorance. They are blinded by the illusion of the senses as their only reference, stubbornly wearing a blindfold in broad daylight. *(Hardness of heart is the result of a darkened understanding; a mind veiled through unbelief. See 2 Cor 4:4.)*

Eph. 4:19 Having become conditioned to a life distanced from God; they are calloused in spirit, and are lust and greed driven; they have completely abandoned themselves to outrageous shameless living. *(See Rom 1:19-23.)*

In the RSV it reads, Eph. 4:17-18 Now this I affirm and testify in the Lord, that you must no longer live as the Gentiles do, in the futility of their minds; they are darkened in their understanding, alienated from the life of God ***because of the ignorance that is in them***, due to their hardness of heart.

Rom. 1:18 God is not standing neutral to mankind's indifference. This revelation of God's belief in our redeemed righteousness is at the same time an unveiling of God's [1]passionate desire, from a heavenly perspective, [2]towards a [3]humanity who

seemed to have [5]lost touch with the romance of their devotion by [4]suppressing the truth about themselves; they have [5]forgotten the delicate art to adore and be adored; while they continue to hold on to an [6]inferior reference of themselves by being out of sync with their true likeness! *(God's belief in mankind's redeemed righteousness is endorsed in the heavens and in sharp contrast to the counterfeit, earthly reference that blindfolds people in their own unrighteousness. The word often translated wrath, [1]**orge**, means desire - as a reaching forth or excitement of the mind, passion. The Preposition [2]**epi** means towards, continuous influence upon; I interpreted it here as "contrast". The word for the [3]human species, male or female is **anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner. The word [4]**katecho**, to echo downwards is the opposite of **anoche**, to echo upward; see Romans 2:4 and 3:26. In Colossians 3:2 Paul encourages us to engage our thoughts with things above [God's belief], and not below [law of works]. The word, ασεβειαν [5]**asebeian**, from **a**, negative and **sebomai**, to adore, to worship. The word [6]**adikia**, unrighteousness, is the opposite of **dikay**, two parties finding likeness in each other; thus, to be out of sync with likeness. The law reveals how guilty and sinful mankind is, while the gospel reveals how forgiven and restored to their original blueprint we are. See 2 Corinthians 4:4.)*

Rom. 1:19 God is not a stranger to anyone; whatever can be known of God is [1]manifest in man. God has revealed it in the very core of their being which bears witness within their own conscience! *(Note Rom 2:14 & 15 For even a pagan's natural instinct will confirm the law to be present in their conscience and though they have never even heard about Jewish laws. Thus they prove to be a law unto themselves. The law is so much more than a mere written code; its presence in human conscience even in the absence of the written instruction is obvious. See also 2 Corinthians 4:4 & 7 and Colossians 1:27. Blindfold-mode does not remove the treasure from where it was hidden all along! Every time we love, encounter joy, or experience beauty, a hint of the nature of our Maker reflects within us; even in the experience of the unbeliever. In the incarnation Jesus unveils God's likeness, not his "otherness", in human form as in a mirror! The word [1]**phaneros** from **phaino**, means to shine like light. Colossians 2:9,10 "It is in Christ that God finds an accurate and complete expression of himself, in a human body! Jesus mirrors our completeness." While the expanse cannot measure or define God, his exact likeness is displayed in human form. Jesus proves that human life is tailor-made for God! See also Ephesians 4:8 And James 3:9 We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a fellow human made in his mirror likeness. The*

point is not what the person did to deserve the insult! The point is that people are image and likeness bearers of God by design!)

Rom. 1:20 God is on display in creation; the very fabric of visible cosmos appeals to reason. It clearly bears witness to the ever present sustaining power and intelligence of the invisible God, leaving mankind without any valid excuse to ignore him. *(Psalm 19:1-4, "God's glory is on tour in the skies, God-craft on exhibit across the horizon. Madame Day holds classes every morning, Professor Night lectures each evening. Their words aren't heard, their voices aren't recorded, But their silence fills the earth: unspoken truth is spoken everywhere." — The Message.)*

Rom. 1:21 Yet mankind only knew him in a philosophical religious way, from a distance, and failed to give him credit as God. Their taking him for granted and lack of gratitude veiled him from them; they became absorbed in useless debates and discussions, which further darkened their understanding about themselves.

Rom. 1:22 Their wise conclusions only confirmed their folly.

Rom. 1:23 Their losing sight of God, made them lose sight of who they really were. In their calculation the image and likeness of God became reduced to a corrupted and distorted pattern of themselves. Suddenly a person has more in common with "creepy crawlies" than with their original blueprint.

Rom. 1:24 It seemed like God abandoned mankind to be swept along by the lusts of their own hearts to abuse and defile themselves. Their most personal possession, their own bodies, became worthless public property.

Rom. 1:25 Truth suppressed *(v18)* **became twisted truth. Instead of embracing their Maker as their authentic identity, they preferred the deception of a distorted image of their own making, religiously giving it their affection and worship. The true God is the blessed God of the ages. Hey! He is not defined by our devotion or indifference!** *(And all this because they traded the true God for a fake god, and worshiped the god they made instead of the God who made them. Message.)*

Rom. 1:26 By being confused about their Maker they became confused about themselves; which led to all manner of obsessions.

The physical life we've 'inherited' as it were, comes with its 'tendencies and traits' which 'traits and tendencies' have been imprinted genetically into us through generations of behavioral patterns that were inconsistent with the life of our design. Also, we are raised within fixed cultural and social moulds that further established our

thinking patterns and behavioral inclinations.

People are not born Christians; yet every person ever born comes from God! God says in Jeremiah 1:5 "I knew you before I formed you in your mother's womb!" We are God's idea: we began in God! We are born into a world where we are bombarded with many diverse cultural and traditional mindsets, most of which directly stems from the Tree of the knowledge of good and evil system, which is the fallen mindset system which says you are not...you have to strive to become!

People who do gross things do it from believing a lie about themselves and not knowing the truth of their incredible design as image bearers of God! James says in Js 3:9, We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a man made in his mirror likeness. The point is not what the man did to deserve the curse! A doctor doesn't slap his patient and command him to stop coughing! You may have the flu but you never become the flu! At no point does the patient become the virus!

True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate. Multitudes of people are living in the darkness of ignorance, not knowing the truth of the integrity of their design and their redeemed value and innocence! The adventure of the Christian life is to declare what we have discovered to be true about every single person! Jesus says that when we discover that the son of man is indeed the son of God then the gates of hades (not to see) will crumble and the prisoners of darkness will be free to discover themselves in him!

Eph. 2:1 Picture where God found us. We were in a death trap of an inferior lifestyle, constantly living below the [1]blueprint measure of our lives. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. See Deuteronomy 32:18, "You have forgotten the Rock that begot you and have gotten out of step with the God who danced with you!" Hebrew, חול **khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21.)*

Eph. 2:2 We were all part of a common pattern, swept along under a powerful invisible influence, a spirit-energy that adopted us as sons to its dictates through

unbelief.

Eph. 2:3 Throughout that time everyone of us were warped and corrupted in our conduct; snared in a jumble of forbidden lusts, driven by the desires of the senses, completely engaged in an expression of a life ruled by mind games; it was as if a twisted passion parented a global breed of people.

Eph. 2:4 None of this could distract from the extravagant love of God; he continued to love us with the exact same intensity.

Eph. 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our [1]deviations, we were [2]co-quickened together with Christ! We had nothing to do with it. Grace [3]freed us, once and for all from the lies that we believed about ourselves under the performance-driven system, and now [4]defines our authentic identity! *(The word often translated, trespasses, παράπτωμα [1]**paraptoma**, deviation; from **para** close proximity and **pipto**, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to stop flying, **petomai**, to fly. Losing altitude speaks of mankind's fallen mindset. Col 3:1-3. The verb συνεζωοποιησεν [2]**sunetzoopoiesen** [co-quickened] is the Aorist Active Indicative, describing an action that was completed in the past. The sentence, **χάριτί [2]ἐστε [3]σεσῳσμένοι** - literally translates, "By grace you are - having been saved!" The verb, [4]**este** is the Present Active Indicative of **eimi**, I am - indicating the continues state of your being which celebrates an [3]unstoppable freedom that happened in your favor! The verb [3]**sesoosmenoi**, having been rescued; is the Perfect Passive Participle, describing a state that exists, as a result of something that happened previously. The basic thought of the Perfect Tense is that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. In other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now in existence. We had no contribution to our salvation! God's Master-Plan unfolded in the mystery of the gospel declaring our joint inclusion in Christ's death and resurrection. This is the mystery of grace, God reveals us in Christ! Now we may know, even as we have always been known! 1 Cor 13:12. Of God's doing are we in Christ! 1 Cor 1:30. God saw us in Christ, in his death and resurrection before we saw ourselves there! He declared mankind's co-resurrection with Christ 800 BC. This is the only scripture in the entire Old Testament that specifically mentions the third day resurrection and it includes us! "After two days he will revive us, on the third day, he will raise us up!" Hosea 6:2.)*

Eph. 2:6 We are co-included in his resurrection. We are also co-elevated in his

ascension to be equally present in the throne room of the heavenly realm where we are co-seated with him in his executive authority. We are fully represented in Christ Jesus. *(We have wasted so much time trying to get there, when "there" is where we are to begin with! Our joint position in Christ defines us; this can never again be a distant goal to reach through religious devotion or striving, but our immediate location. Col 3:1-3.)*

Eph. 2:7 *(In a single triumphant act of righteousness God saved us from the "guttermost" to the uttermost. Here we are now, revealed in Christ in the highest possible position of bliss! If mankind's sad history could not distract from the extravagant love of God,)* **imagine how God is now able for timeless perpetuity to exhibit the trophy of the wealth of his grace demonstrated in his kindness towards us in Christ Jesus. Grace exhibits excessive evidence of the success of the cross.**

Eph. 2:8 Your salvation is not a reward for good behavior! It was a grace thing from start to finish; you had no hand in it. Even the gift to believe simply reflects his faith! *(Again, as in Eph 2:5 Paul says, χάριτί ἐστε σεσῳσμένοι* ***chariti este sesoosmenoi****, "By grace you are, having been saved from the "I am not-lie" by the gift of faith; grace reveals who we are and the faith of God persuades us of it. We did not invent faith; it was God's faith to begin with! It is from faith to faith says Paul in Romans 1:17. Jesus is both the source and conclusion of faith. Heb 12:2.)*

Eph. 2:9 If this could be accomplished through any action of yours then there would be ground for boasting.

Eph. 2:10 We are engineered by his design; he molded and manufactured us in Christ. We are his workmanship, his [1]poetry. We are [2]fully fit to do good, equipped to give attractive evidence of his likeness in us in everything we do. *(God finds inspired expression of Christ in us. The Greek word for workmanship is [1]****poeima****. God has done everything possible to find spontaneous and effortless expression of his character in us in our everyday lifestyle. The word, [2]****proetoimatso****, translates a notion that God has prepared a highway for us to lead us out like kings, just like the Oriental custom, where people would go before a king to level the roads to make it possible for the king to journey with ease and comfort. Isa 40:3-5.)*

Adam's mind changed, not God's.

When Adam 'died' his awareness and consciousness of the divine likeness in him was reduced to him merely knowing himself, his wife and God from a guilt-based and performance-driven human point of view; he lost sight of the doxa (glory) of God and

began to live the life of the flesh, with its fading glories like seasonal flowers.

2 Cor. 3:7 Because of its prophetic purpose even the old administration of death, carved in stone evidenced a glimpse of glory; for a brief moment the face of Moses shone with such brilliance that the people of Israel could not even look at his face. The fact that the glory reflected in Moses was brief and fading confirmed that the ministry of the letter had a "sell by" date and that it was destined [1]to be brought to nought. *(It served merely to emphasize the failure of the flesh to access the glory that Adam had lost on mankind's behalf. The word, [1]**katargeo**, derives from **kata**, meaning intensity, and **argos**, meaning labor, denotes that the law of works would be rendered entirely useless; thus, the new arrangement would free us from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ. Consider the contrast in verse 18; from a mere glimpse of a veiled and fading glory to unveiled gazing into the face of glory as in a mirror and a transformed life radiating the same glory!)*

2 Cor. 3:8 How much more radiant would the ministry of the Spirit be.

2 Cor. 3:9 If the ministry of condemnation had a glimpse of glory, the glory that the ministry of righteousness now communicates is beyond comparison! *(There are two administrations: the one confirms mankind's guilt because of Adam; the other confirms mankind's innocence because of Christ! The one was upheld by the letter of the law; the other is sustained by the life of the Spirit. Mankind's standing before God is restored; righteousness by the merit of the cross far outweighs any attempt of the flesh to compete! Nothing that anyone can do can improve their standing before God!)*

2 Cor. 3:10 What seemed glorious and important at the time has been reduced to total obscurity and irrelevance.

2 Cor. 3:11 The fragile and fading glory of the flesh is dwarfed into insignificance by the unfading glory of the Spirit! *(The ministry of the New Testament reveals oneness and permanence. In Christ, every definition and idea of distance and delay is cancelled.)*

Titus 3:2 Gossip is out! Never have anything bad to say about anyone! Don't try and be the [1]macho man, having to win every argument; instead, avoid quarrelling, be appropriate, always show perfect courtesy to one and all. *(The word, [1]**amachos** from **a** as a negative particle and **mache**, a brawler, to be controversial, striving. You don't have to wait for people to change before you are nice to them. There is a big difference between "fake politeness" and perfect courtesy!)*

Titus 3:3 Do not be harsh on others. Remember that we, too, were typically foolish;

we were stubborn and indifferent to spiritual things, our addiction to the sensual and sexual kept us running around in circles, we were engaged in malice and spiteful jealousies, we were bored and lonely, often utterly disliking ourselves and hating one another!

Titus 3:4 But then, oh happy day! It was the generosity of God and his fondness for mankind that dawned on us like a shaft of light. Our days of darkness were over! Light shone everywhere and we became aware: God rescued the human race! *(See Titus 2:11.)*

No wonder then that Paul could encourage Titus to speak evil of no one, to avoid quarreling and to show perfect courtesy towards all people; "for we ourselves were once ignorant." Titus 3:2-5. The only difference in who we are now and who we were then is in what we now know to be true about ourselves. What is true in him is equally true in us, says John in 1 John 2:7-8. This message sets the stage for New Testament ministry!

Isa 40:3-5 A voice cries: In the wilderness prepare the way of the Lord, make straight in the desert a highway for our God. Every valley shall be lifted up, and every mountain and hill be made low; the crooked places shall be made straight, even the rough places shall be made smooth. And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together, for the mouth of the LORD has spoken."

Luke 8:17 There is nothing hidden that will not become fully known; even things that have long been unnoticed will come to light! *(The full counsel of God is destined to flood the earth with the knowledge of his glory unveiled in human life! And all flesh shall see it together! Isa 40:5)*

Sin is singular - its symptoms are plural - its been a sonship thing from the beginning - no wonder Jesus says freedom indeed is found in the truth of our authentic and redeemed sonship - even the "other brother" in Luke 15 has the Father pleading with him, "My son you have always been with me and all that I have is yours!!" Sin is not about things you do or don't do - sin is missing out on sonship!

Question: Why did Jesus have to DIE for this,

if it is merely a "mind matter"? Chapter 17

If God never saw mankind differently, why could Jesus not just come, reveal himself and introduce us to our original design again?

This is the whole point of the gospel: If one could merely make a quality decision to change one's life then Moses would be our savior.

Rom. 7:1 I write to you in the context of your acquaintance with the law.

Rom. 7:7 The law in itself is not sinful; I am not suggesting that at all. Yet in pointing out sin, the law was in a sense the catalyst for sinful actions to manifest. Had the law not said, "Thou shall not covet," I would not have had a problem with lust.

Rom. 7:8 But the commandment triggered sin into action, suddenly an array of sinful appetites were awakened in me. The law broke sin's dormancy.

Rom. 7:9 Without the law I was alive; the law was introduced, sin revived and I died.

Rom. 7:10 Instead of being my guide to life, the commandment proved to be a death sentence.

Rom. 7:11 Sin took advantage of the law and employed the commandment to seduce and murder me.

Rom. 7:12 I stress again that the law as principle is holy and so is every individual commandment it contains; it consistently promotes that which is just and good.

Rom. 7:13 How then could I accuse something that is that good to have killed me? I say again, it was not the law, but sin that caused my spiritual death. The purpose of the law was to expose sin as the culprit. The individual commandment ultimately serves to show the exceeding extent of sin's effect on mankind.

Rom. 7:14 We agree that the law is spiritual, but because I am [1]sold like a slave to sin, I am reduced to a mere carnal life. *(Spiritual death. The word, [1]**piprasko** comes from **perao**, meaning to transport into a distant land in order to sell as a slave. Sin is a foreign land.)*

Rom. 7:15 This is how the sell-out to sin affects my life: I find myself doing things my conscience does not allow. My dilemma is that even though I sincerely desire to

do that which is good, I don't, and the things I despise, I do.

Rom. 7:16 It is obvious that my conscience sides with the law;

Rom. 7:17 which confirms then that it is not really I who do these things but sin manifesting its symptoms in me. It has taken my body hostage. *(Sin is similar to a dormant virus that suddenly breaks out in very visible symptoms.)*

Rom. 7:18 The total extent and ugliness of sin that inhabits me, reduced my life to good intentions that could not be followed through.

Rom. 7:19 Willpower has failed me; this is how embarrassing it is, the most diligent decision that I make to do good, disappoints; the very evil I try to avoid, is what I do. *(If mere quality decisions could rescue mankind, the law would have been enough. Good intentions cannot save someone. The revelation of what happened to us in Christ's death is what brings faith into motion to liberate from within. Faith is not a decision we make to give God a chance, faith is realizing our inclusion in what happened on the Cross and in the resurrection of Christ! See Rom 3:27.)*

Rom. 7:20 If I do the things I do not want to do, then it is clear that I am not evil, but that I host sin in my body against my will.

Rom. 7:21 It has become a predictable principle; I desire to do well, but my mere desire cannot escape the evil presence that dictates my actions.

Rom. 7:22 The real person that I am on the inside delights in the law of God. *(The law proves to be consistent with my inner make-up.)*

Rom. 7:23 There is another law though, *(foreign to my design)* **the law of sin, activating and enrolling the members of my body as weapons of war against the law of my mind. I am held captive like a prisoner of war in my own body.**

Rom. 7:24 It doesn't matter how I [1]weigh myself I just do not measure up to expectations! The situation is absolutely desperate for mankind; is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap? *(The word [1]**talaipōros** occurs only twice in the New Testament - Rom 7:24, Rev 3:17 - and both times it is translated wretched!? It has two components, **talanton**, which is the word for a scale of balance; that which is weighed, a talent; and **poros** from **peira**, to test as in testing the weight of something.)*

Rom. 7:25 Thank God, this is exactly what he has done through Jesus Christ our Leader; he has come to our rescue! I am finally freed from this conflict between the law of my mind and the law of sin in my body. *(In the Incarnation, in a human body exactly like ours, Jesus balanced the scales! He is the true measure of the life of our*

design - he revealed and redeemed the image and likeness of God in us as in a mirror! See Rom 1:16,17 and 3:24 and 27.)

Rom. 3:27 The law of faith cancels the law of works; which means there is suddenly nothing left for anyone to boast in. No one is superior to another. *(Bragging only makes sense if there is someone to compete with or impress. "While we compete with one another and compare ourselves with one another we are without understanding. [2 Corinthians 10:12]. "Through the righteousness of God we have received a faith of equal standing." [See 2 Peter 1:1 RSV] The OS (operating system) of the law of works is willpower; the OS of the law of faith is love. Galatians 5:6 Love sets faith in motion. The law presented one with choices; grace awakens belief! Willpower exhausts, love ignites! If choices could save us we would be our own Saviors! Willpower is the language of the law, love is the language of grace and it ignites faith that leads to romance; falling in love beats "making a decision to believe in love" by far! See Rom 7:19 Willpower has failed me; this is how embarrassing it is, the most diligent decision that I make to do good, disappoints.)*

Rom. 8:1 Now the decisive conclusion is this: in Christ, every bit of condemning evidence against us is cancelled. *("Who walk not after the flesh but after the spirit." This sentence was not in the original text, but later copied from verse 4. The person who added this most probably felt that the fact of Paul's declaration of mankind's innocence had to be made subject again to a person's conduct. Religion under the law felt more comfortable with the condition of personal contribution rather than the conclusion of what faith reveals. The "in Christ" revelation is key to God's dealing with mankind. It is the PIN-code of the Bible. [See 1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4].)*

Rom. 8:2 The law of the Spirit is the liberating force of life in Christ. This leaves me with no further obligation to the law of sin and death. Spirit has superseded the sin enslaved senses as the principle law of our lives. *(The law of the spirit is righteousness by faith vs the law of personal effort and self righteousness which produces condemnation and spiritual death which is the fruit of the DIY tree.)*

Rom. 8:3 The law failed to be anything more than an instruction manual; it had no power to deliver us from the strong influence of sin holding us hostage in our own bodies. God disguised himself in his Son in this very domain where sin ruled us, in flesh. The body he lived and conquered in was no different to ours. Thus sin's authority in the human body was condemned. *(Hebrews 4:15, As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human life. Having subjected it to close*

scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses that are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. He is not an example for us but of us.)

Rom. 8:4 The very righteousness promoted by the law, is now realized in us. Our practical day-to-day life bears witness to spirit inspiration and not flesh domination.

Rom. 8:5 Sin's symptoms are sponsored by the senses, a mind dominated by the sensual. Thoughts betray source; spirit life attracts spirit thoughts.

Rom. 8:6 Thinking patterns are formed by reference, either the sensual appetites of the flesh and spiritual death, or zoe-life and total tranquillity flowing from a mind addicted to spirit *[faith]* **realities.**

Rom. 8:7 A mind focused on flesh *(the sensual domain where sin held me captive)* **is distracted from God with no inclination to his life-laws. Flesh** *[self-righteousness]* **and spirit** *[faith righteousness]* **are opposing forces.** *(Flesh no longer defines you; faith does!)*

Gal. 2:15 Sin is not a respecter of persons! Sin is sin whether you're Jew or Gentile.

Gal. 2:16 As Jews we should be the first to know that righteousness is not a reward for good behavior according to the requirements of the Law. We have pursued righteousness for generations under the system of personal performance but failed miserably! Jesus Christ embodies [1]God's belief concerning mankind's redeemed righteousness; this is the only valid basis of our belief. Our best intentions to do good cannot add any weight to our righteousness. We have no advantage over any other person. Jew and Gentile alike were equally disqualified by the law; now we are equally justified because of Jesus and for no other reason! *(Paul uses the [1]objective Genitive - "faith of." "He is the author and finisher of faith; he is both the origin and conclusion of faith" [Heb. 12:2]; "from faith to faith" [Rom 1:17]. It is God's persuasion in the merit of his Son's achievement that awakens faith in mankind." Rom 4:25.)*

Gal. 2:17 However, if in our quest to discover righteousness by faith in what Christ did for us, we find that it is still possible to stumble; do not now label yourself a sinner yet again! The fact that you sinned does not cancel the cross of Christ and gives you no reason to abandon justification by faith as if Christ is to be blamed for your distraction! That would be absurd! *(Now all of a sudden you want to keep the*

law again to further add to your righteousness as if Christ did not achieve enough. Do not let your experience deceive you to invent a new doctrine.)

Gal. 2:18 Only a con artist will try to be a law-man and a grace-man at the same time!

Gal. 2:19 The law [1]demanded my death; grace reveals that in God's mind Jesus died that death. So as far as the law is concerned, I'm a dead man but as far as God is concerned I'm alive! *(The word [1]**dia** means because of; suggesting here that the law was what demanded my death! But in the mystery of God's genius, Jesus died mankind's death; which means, in God's belief, I died to the old system of trying to please him with my own good behavior! We might as well admit it! Our most sincere beliefs as well as our best attempts to attain to a righteousness based on us getting ten out of ten all the time, failed! There is no ways to get around this! See Romans chapter 7 in the Mirror Bible!)*

Gal. 2:20 So here I am dead and alive at the same time! I'm dead to the old me I was trying to be and alive to the real me which is Christ in me! Co-crucified, now co-alive! What a glorious entanglement! I was in him in his death; now I discover that he is infused in me, in my life! For the first time, I'm free to be me in my skin, immersed in his faith in our joint-sonship! He loves me and believes in me! He is God's gift to me! *(The verb [1]**συνεσταυρωμαι** from **sustauroō**, is in the Perfect Tense, indicating that not only was I crucified with Christ in the past, but I am existing now in that present condition. How can any human effort improve on this! See Hosea 6:2 and Eph 2:5 also Romans 7:6 But now we are fully released from any further association with a life directed by the rule of the law, we are dead to that which once held us captive, free to be slaves to the newness of spirit-spontaneity rather than age old religious rituals, imitating the mere face value of the written code. The moment one exchanges spontaneity with rules, the edge of romance is compromised!*

*See 1 Thess 5:10 The fact that he died our death is equally valid to those who are awake to its effect or still fast asleep in their indifference to it; we are together destined to live entwined in the [1]closest possible association with him! [The word [1]**hama** is a particle of union denoting close association.])*

Gal. 2:21 It is an insult to the grace of God to prefer Moses to Jesus! If the law could justify you then Jesus wasted his time dying your death! *(That would reduce salvation to a ludicrous contest between your obedience and the obedience of Christ! Rom 5:19.)*

Gal. 3:7 The conclusion is clear; faith and not flesh relates us to Abraham! *(Grace rather than law is our true lineage. Ishmael represents so much more than the Muslim religion. Ishmael represents the clumsy effort of the flesh to compete with faith; the preaching of a mixed message of law and grace.)*

Gal. 3:8 Scripture records prophetically that the mass of non-Jewish nations would be justified by faith and not by keeping moral laws. This announcement by God over Abraham is the gospel in advance. God saw every nation included in the same principle of the faith that Abraham pioneered. "In you all the nations of the earth are equally represented in the blessing of faith." *([Gen 22:17] I will indeed bless you, and I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven and as the sand which is on the seashore. And your seed shall possess the gate of their enemies, Gen 22:18 and by your seed shall all the nations of the earth bless themselves. Righteousness by faith is the revelation of the gospel; [Rom 1:17 and Hab 2:4] "the just shall live by his (God's) faith" Righteousness by faith defines your life!)*

Gal. 3:9 As did Abraham so do we now find our source in the blessing of faith.

Gal. 3:10 In clear contrast to faith, the law is the authority of the curse. As it is written, "Everyone who fails to perform the detailed requirements of the law, even in the least, is condemned." *(Deut 27:26.)*

Gal. 3:11 Habakkuk confirms conclusively that righteousness by God's faith is the only basis to life; this terminates any possible justification before God based on moral behavior. *(Hab 2:4, 3:17-19.)*

Gal. 3:12 Law and faith have nothing in common! Law measures a person's doing and experience as defining their life. *(Faith measures God's doing in redeeming his design in us, as defining our lives.)*

Gal. 3:13 Christ redeemed us from the curse as consequence of our failure to keep the law. In his cross he concentrated the total curse of the human race upon himself. In his abandoning himself to death, he absorbed and dissolved the horror of the curse in his own person. Scripture declares that anyone hanging on a tree embodies the curse. *(Deut 21:23.)*

Gal. 3:14 This act of Christ released [1]the blessing of Abraham upon the [2]Gentiles! Now we are free to receive [1]the blessing of the Spirit. *([1]Righteousness by God's faith in the achievement of Christ, and not as a reward for our behavior. In the obedience of Christ Deuteronomy 28 is out-dated! [Rom 5:19, Eph 1:3] [2]The mass of non-Jewish nations.)*

Gal. 3:15 We are familiar with the fact that in civil affairs a testament, once endorsed, is authoritative and cannot be tampered with at a later stage.

Gal. 3:16 It is on record that the promise *[of the blessing of righteousness by God's faith]* **was made to Abraham and to his seed, singular,** *[thus excluding his effort to produce Ishmael.]* **Isaac, the child of promise and not of the flesh mirrors the Messiah.**

Gal. 3:17 This is my reasoning: God endorsed the covenant of promise in Christ 430 years before the law was given. The law did not later replace the promise! *(God's faith, as embodied in Christ, is the only basis to mankind's acquittal and could never be replaced by their own ability to keep moral laws. See Rom 4:25.)*

2 Cor. 5:21 This is the divine exchange: he who knew no [1]sin embraced our distortion; he appeared to be without form; this was the mystery of God's prophetic [2]poetry. He was disguised in our distorted image and marred with our iniquities; he took our sorrows, our pain and our shame to his grave and [3]birthed his righteousness in us. He took our sins and we [3]became his innocence. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. The word, [2]**poema**, often translated "made" like in, "he was made to be sin." However, because of its context here I have translated **poema** to read prophetic poetry. As the scapegoat of the human race, he took on the distorted image of fallen mankind, he did not become a sinner, but the official representative of mankind's sin. Then Paul uses the word [3]**ginomai**, he birthed his righteousness in us since we were born anew in his resurrection from the dead. Hosea 6:2, Eph 2:5, 1 Pet 1:3. Isaiah 52:10 "The Lord has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations, and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God." Isaiah 52:14-15 "Just as many were astonished at you—so was he marred in his appearance, more than any human and his form beyond that of human semblance—so will he startle many nations. Kings will shut their mouths because of him; for what had not been told them, they will see and what they had not heard, they will understand." Isaiah 53:4-5 "Surely he has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted. But surely he was wounded by our transgressions; he was bruised by our*

iniquities; the chastisement of our peace was on him and by his stripes we ourselves are healed."

Note: He was not bruised by God but by the very mankind he was about to redeem! You may ask, "But what about Isaiah 53:10!?" [It pleased the Lord to "crush" him!] Translators of the New Revised Standard Version say in their footnotes to this verse: "Meaning of Hebrew uncertain." The Septuagint - Greek version of this verse - written between 300BC and 250BC, by 72 Hebrew scholars, with access to older manuscripts than what we have today, have rendered the Hebrew text as follows: "and the Lord desires to purify him of the plague!" Also translated, "The Lord desires to cleanse his wounds!" The word, ***plege*** *means a wound.*

Deuteronomy 32:5, 6 "They have corrupted themselves; they did not behave as his children, they have become a distorted generation of people, twisted out of their true pattern; they are a crooked and perverse generation."[Paul quotes this verse in Philippians 2:15.]

Deuteronomy 32:18 "You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you and have forgotten the God who danced with you." [Hebrew, חוּל ***khul****, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21.]*

Romans 8:29 "He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the idea and invention of God." (We were born anew when he was raised from the dead! [1 Peter 1:3] His resurrection co-reveals our common genesis as well as our redeemed innocence. [Romans 4:25 and Acts 17:31, 2 Timothy 1:9] No wonder then that he is not ashamed to call us his family! We indeed share the same origin [Hebrew 2:11], and, "In him we live and move and have our being; we are indeed his offspring!" [Acts 17:28].)

Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that mankind pre-existed in God; he defined us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory we lost in Adam. [Romans 3:23, 24: the word, ***prohoritso****, means pre defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan; and the word,* **kaleo****, to surname, identify by name.]*

Titus 2:11 "The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.")

Eph. 4:7 The gift of Christ measures the extravagant dimensions of grace; where everyone is equally advantaged. *(Grace was given to each one of us according to the*

measure of the gift of Christ. RSV. One measure, one worth! Our worth is defined by his gift not by a reward for our behavior.)

Eph. 4:8 [1]Scripture confirms that he [3]arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! *["he took captivity captive"]* **And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he [2]repossessed what belonged to us by design, [4]in human form; this is his grace-gift to us!** *(In this verse Paul explains what he just declared in verse 7 - he wants us to know the extravagant extent and dimensions of the measure of the gift of Christ! Remember that he is writing from prison [Eph 4:1] He's not asking for prayers to get him out of jail! He is imprisoned in Christ - [4:1] my complete existence is defined and confined in him! He was once a prisoner of the law of performance, held hostage in his own body, crying in desperation, "Is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap?" [Rom 7] He now speaks as a prisoner of Christ! He is reminded of and obviously intrigued by the entire context of Psalm 67 which celebrates God rescuing the prisoners from their captivity and even the wayward and stubborn, who already died and are stuck in their graves! [mindsets] See Ps 67:6,7 He is the father of the orphans, and protector of the widows. God settles the lonely in a home; leading forth prisoners mightily, also the stubborn, even them that dwell in tombs! Paul sees by revelation the relevance of Jesus dying our death and entering into our darkness and hell on a rescue mission! Now he [1]quotes Ps 67:19 [from the LXX Septuagint - the Greek OT which is Ps 68 in the Masoretic Hebrew text], and sees captive mankind arrested in the death, descent into hell and the triumphant resurrection of the incarnate Word, in the man Jesus Christ. Ps 67:19 ἀνέβης εἰς ὕψος, ᾐχμαλώτευσας αἰχμαλωσίαν, ἔλαβες δόματα ἐν ἀνθρώπῳ -* ***anebes eis hupsos, [3]echmaloteusas aichmaloosian, [2]elabes domata en*** *[in]* ***[4]anthropo*** *"You ascended on high, having taken captivity captive [***[3]***arresting at spearpoint****! See 2 Cor 10:5] and* ***[2]repossessed mankind's gifts*** *in human form. The word* ***[2]elabes*** *from* ***lambano*** *means to take what is one's own. The word for the [4]human species, male or female is* ***[4]anthropos****, from* ***ana****, upward, and* ***tropos****, manner of life; character; in like manner. [The Masoretic Hebrew text, Ps 68:18,19,* לקחת מתנות באדם ***lakachat mattanoth ba adam*** *- "You have taken gifts in Adam."* ***The gifts which Jesus Christ distributes to us he has received in us, in and by virtue of his incarnation!*** *Adam Clarke.]*

Ps 67:19 LXX continues: καὶ γὰρ ἀπειθοῦντες τοῦ κατασκηνῶσαι - ***kai gar apeithountes tou kataskenoosai,*** *"in order that even the unbelievers,* ***apeithountes*** *- the ones*

*resisting persuasion, the backsliding, the headstrong, the wayward, the rebellious may rest; or may now inhabit - **kataskenosai** - to encamp within - again this word emphasizes the significance of the incarnation - **kata**, down and **skenosai**, from **skenos** - skin! The eternal thoughts of God, the conversation that was before time was, is clothed in skin! John 1:1-3,14.*

See Rev 13:10, Being taken captive by the spear and killed by the sword [John 18:3] made death a doorway into the very domain in which mankind was held prisoner, [to be led out triumphantly in the resurrection as the Lamb's trophies!] After two days he will revive us! On the third day he will raise us up! Hosea 6:2 We were born anew in his resurrection. 1 Pet 1:3. Also Ephesians 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our deviations, we were co-quickened together with Christ!)

Eph. 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. *(See John 3:13, "No one has ascended into heaven but he who [1]descended from heaven, even the son of man." All mankind originate from above; we are [1]**anouthen**, from above [see Jas 1:17, 18].)*

Eph. 4:10 He now occupies the ultimate rank of authority, from the lowest regions of our darkness into which he reached in order to rescue us, to the highest authority in the heavens, having executed his mission to the full. *(Fallen mankind is restored to the authority of the authentic life of their design. [Psa 139:7,8 Whither shall I go from your Spirit? Or whither shall I flee from your presence? If I ascend to heaven, You! If I make my bed in Sheol, You!] Eph 1:20,21.)*

Eph. 4:11 What God has in us, is gift wrapped to the world: some are commissioned to pioneer, others are gifted prophetically, some as announcers of good news, some as Shepherds with a real gift to care and nurture, and others have a gift to ignite instruction through revelation knowledge. *(Couriers, communicators, counsellors and coaches. — Rob Lacey.)*

1 Cor. 1:22 The Jews crave signs *[to confirm their doubts]* **while the Greeks revel in philosophical debate!** *(Both groups are addicted to the same soul realm.)*

1 Cor. 1:23 The crucified Christ is the message we publicly proclaim, to the disgust of the Jews while the Greeks think we are wacky.

1 Cor. 1:24 The dynamic of God's wisdom is the fact that both Jew and Greek are equally included and defined in Christ.

1 Cor. 1:25 It seems so foolish that God should die mankind's death on the cross; it seems so weak of God to suffer such insult; yet their wisest schemes and most powerful display of genius cannot even begin to comprehend or compete with God in his weakest moment on the cross.

Heb. 4:15 As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human lives. Having subjected it to close scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses which are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. *(He is not an example for us but of us.)*

Heb. 4:16 For this reason we can approach the authoritative throne of grace with bold utterance. We are welcome there in his embrace, and are [1]reinforced with immediate effect in times of trouble. *(The word, [1]**boetheia**, means to be reinforced, specifically a rope or chain for frapping a vessel in a storm.In his incarnate human body Jesus represents us on the deepest possible level of every detail of our lives, spirit, soul and body. He victoriously faced every onslaught and scrutiny that we would ever possibly encounter!)*

In conversation with Jesus (see John 4) the Samaritan lady began to realize that Jesus was more than a Jew, and that mirrored in him, she was more than a Samaritan. Suddenly she understood that all people indeed share the same origin. The fountain of living water was not distant from her or beyond reach, but waiting to awaken within her. None of her previous five marriages or even her religious tradition could quench her thirst. Not because she failed to meet 'Mr. Perfect' or the men in her life failed to meet her expectation, but simply because of the fact that a partner was never meant to define or complete her life.

Many doctrines of people are based on isolated scripture references outside of the context of God's work of redemption as it is revealed in Christ. Any concept that excludes the good news of what God achieved on humanity's behalf in Christ is irrelevant, no matter how many scriptures can be quoted.

Jesus as the Revealer and Redeemer of God's blueprint image and likeness in human form is the context of scripture. Not even the historic or traditional setting of Scripture can distract from the revelation of Christ in us. Luke 24:27, Luke 24:44, Col. 1:27.

"Jesus who incarnated God 2,000 years ago is mystically present and waiting to be

discovered in EVERY person you and I encounter" (Tony Campolo)

The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in mankind as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. *(Mirror note on Jam. 1:25)*

God takes pleasure in mankind. His reference exceeds anything that could possibly disqualify us. In Christ he has broken down every wall of hostility and every excuse we have to feel distant from him.

The mystery that was hidden for ages and generations is now revealed! It is Christ in you! He is not hiding in history or in future; he is "I am" in you!

1 Pet. 1:18 It is clear to see that you were ransomed from the futile, fallen mindset that you inherited from your fathers, not by the currency of your own labor, represented by the fluctuating values of gold and silver, and the economy of your religious efforts;

1 Pet. 1:19 but you were redeemed with the priceless blood of Christ; he is the ultimate sacrifice; spotless and without blemish. He completes the prophetic picture! *(In him God speaks the most radical scapegoat language of the law of judgment and brings final closure to a dead and redundant system! In Psalm 40:6,7, it is clearly stated that God does not require sacrifices or offerings! Jesus is the Lamb of God! He collides victoriously with the futile sacrificial system whereby offerings are constantly made to the pseudo, moody, monster gods of our imagination! This is the scandal of the cross! God does not demand a sacrifice that would change the way he thinks about mankind; he provides the sacrifice of himself in Christ in order to forever eradicate sin-consciousness from our minds and radically change the way we think about our Maker, one another and ourselves! [Sin-consciousness is in essence a works-based consciousness.] God did not clothe Adam with the skin of an animal because of a divine need to be appeased, but because of their unconditional love for Adam; they spoke the language of Adam's own judgment: Adam, not God, was embarrassed about his nakedness. The clothing was not to make God look at Adam differently, but to make Adam feel better about himself! And ultimately it was to prophetically prepare Adam for the unveiling of the mystery of mankind's redemption in the incarnation. Here Deity would clothe themselves in human skin, in a Son; and the Lion of Judah would become the Lamb of God in order to free our minds to re-discover his image and likeness in our*

skin! See 1 Peter 1:2.)

New Thoughts on the New Birth - Chapter 18

The moment of awakening to the truth of our redeemed identity and innocence can certainly be described as a 'new birth' experience! But that's not what Jesus said to Nicodemus. In John 3:3 he explained to Nico that we did not begin in our mother's womb; we "anouthen", we are from above!

Paul didn't use the 'New Birth' message to get people to make a commitment to follow Jesus. He spoke the mystery of mankind's association in Christ's death and resurrection in such a clear way that many believed! Acts 14:1

Even Peter understood that the reference to our new birth is the resurrection of Jesus from the dead. 1 Pet. 1:3

Paul says in Eph. 2:5, 6 that this happened "while we were still dead in our sins"! God made us alive together with Christ.

The days of window-shopping redemption realities are over! The mirror makes the Bible a new book! When I look into a mirror I can see the color of my eyes, but they only reflect in the mirror; they are in reality, located in my face! Jesus is not hiding in the pages of the book, but reflects in scripture, to be unveiled as Christ in us!

A wrong perception of the "New Birth" was cause for much confusion over the years. While the reference to the new birth experience leans on a mere decision one has to make, to follow Jesus, it carries with it every reason to disappoint, and causes enough doubt to make one wander away from God and then having to face the subsequent, dreadful routine of backsliding and 'repentance', again and again. Many sincere believers thought that they needed to be born again and again. And that they had to dedicate and re-dedicate their lives frequently in order to stand the best possible chance to go to heaven one day!

There must be more substance to faith than fragile, human willpower!

Some say that when a person comes to Christ, they become a brand new species that never existed before! Now, if that were the case then such a new species would certainly not be capable of committing the very same horrific sins that everybody else commits.

Another popular perception in some Christian groups is the idea of "once saved always saved", suggesting that as long as you have made a commitment somewhere along the line, you can live like a devil for the rest of your life and you'll be okay in the

final day! I mean, does Grace say, "It's all right for Christians to sin, they won't go to hell but if non Christians sin, they are going to burn!" Our doctrines really do not make any sense sometimes! Our ideas of heaven and hell are not the point of the gospel, to begin with!

The gospel reveals how God succeeded to rescue mankind from the distorted mind-set we inherited from Adam; we have a new reference to live the life of our redeemed design now! What a waste to live an ignorant and inferior life in the meantime, regardless of whether or not you'll be okay one day!

Israel wasted forty years in the wilderness after being powerfully saved from slavery to Pharaoh. There was nothing inferior about their deliverance; but there was something dreadfully inferior about their faith. They continued to believe a lie about themselves! Num. 13:33. Joshua 2:11.

Our problem has never been to exaggerate the gospel but always to underestimate it! Somehow, it seems not to be the case with the devil! While Paul sees principalities and powers disarmed at the cross, they continue to be largely exaggerated for centuries! Sadly, from many a sincere christian pulpit, a defeated devil is preached back into business!

Neither Jesus nor Paul told people to "get born again"! You couldn't even get yourself born the first time; how are you going to get it right a second time?

Jesus did say to Nicodemus, "unless you're born from above (meaning unless you realize that you originate from above) you would have no interest or appetite for heavenly things!" John 3:13

Religion and philosophy endeavour to engage humanity in a sincere pursuit in an effort to define the gods of their imagination, by means of cleverly devised myths. Jesus did not come to compete with these, neither did he attempt to win a few doctrinal debates; he came to win our hearts! We are wired by design to love and be loved. To encounter a love that awakens in us a sense of worth and significance is the most meaningful dynamic of life!

Titus 3:3 Do not be harsh on others. Remember that we, too, were typically foolish; we were stubborn and indifferent to spiritual things, our addiction to the sensual and sexual kept us running around in circles, we were engaged in malice and spiteful jealousies, we were bored and lonely, often utterly disliking ourselves and hating one another! *(The only difference in who we are now and who we were then is*

in what we now know to be true about ourselves.)

Titus 3:4 But then, oh happy day! It was the generosity of God and his fondness for mankind that dawned on us like a shaft of light. Our days of darkness were over! Light shone everywhere and we became aware: God rescued the human race! *(See Titus 2:11.)*

Rom. 8:14 The original life of the Father revealed in his Son is the life the Spirit now [1]conducts within us. *(The word, [1]**agoo**, means to conduct or to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep.)*

Rom. 8:15 Slavery is such a poor substitute for sonship! They are opposites; the one leads forcefully through fear while sonship responds fondly to Abba Father.

Rom. 8:16 His Spirit bears joint witness within our spirit to confirm the fact that we began in God. *(To realize our joint-genesis in God leads us to the conclusion of our inclusion in his suffering and resurrection. We are joint heirs in all that Jesus accomplished on humanity's behalf!)*

In Paul's understanding of our common genesis in God, to begin with, and then revealed again in the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ as representing the human race, he announces to the idol worshipping philosophers in Athens, that even in their own philosopher's thoughts, Aratus proclaimed 300 BC that mankind is indeed God's offspring! Acts 17:28 and in verse 29 Paul says, "Being then God's offspring, we ought not to think that the Deity is like gold, or silver, or stone, a representation by the art and imagination of man." It is therefore foolish to think that God is defined by our imagination! Paul also quotes another of their philosophers, Epimenedes who wrote a song 600BC. In him we live and move and have our being!

Paul then announces to them that the God whom they worship in ignorance is not far from each one of us! He is not more Immanuel to the Jew than what he is Immanuel to the Gentile! Then, in the context of his Jewish background and personal encounter of the revelation of Jesus Christ, Paul declares to them the Good News of mankind's redeemed innocence. "God has overlooked the times of ignorance and now implores all of mankind everywhere to awaken in their understanding, since he has prophetically fixed a day and appointed a person and on that day in that person, God would judge the world innocent! In righteousness and of this [righteous judgment] he has given proof to all mankind by raising Jesus from the dead."

Your new birth is not the result of your sincere decision to follow Jesus; it is the awakening of your spirit to the truth of your genesis in God and the fact that in the

death of Jesus, God brought closure to every distorted idea and lie that we believed about ourselves, and then co-quickened and co-raised us together with Jesus into newness of life. See Hos. 6:2, 1 Peter 1:3, Eph. 2:5,6.

The incorruptible seed of sonship is as much present in every person as the seed is already in all soil, even in the desert, waiting for the rain to awaken and ignite its life! "For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven and water the earth, making it bring forth and sprout, so shall my word be that proceeds from my mouth, it shall not disappoint my purpose, it shall saturate the soil and cause it to bring forth and sprout. Instead of the thorn the cyprus and instead of the brier the myrtle!" [Isa. 55:8-11, 13]

Mankind share three births in common:

1/ ***Man began in God***. Mal. 2:10, Have we not all one Father? Has not one God created us? See Matt. 22:41-45, Now while the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them a question, saying, "What do you think of the Christ? Whose son is he?" They said to him, "The son of David." He said to them, "How is it then that David, inspired by the Spirit, calls him Lord, saying, 'The Lord said to my Lord, Sit at my right hand, till I put your enemies under your feet'? If David thus calls him Lord, how is he his son?" Also Matt. 23:9 And call no man your father on earth, for you have one Father, who is in heaven. Gen.1:26,27, Then Elohim said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness. So Elohim created man in their own image, in the image of Elohim they created man; male and female they created them.

2/ ***Our mother's womb is our only passport to the planet.*** Jer. 1:5, Before I formed you in the womb I knew you. The womb of a mother is everyone's unique passport to planet earth.

3/ ***Our co-resurrection with Jesus from the dead.*** Eph. 2:5,6 While we were still dead in our sins, he made us alive together with Christ and co-raised us together with Christ." 1Pet. 1:3 "We have been born anew through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead." 2 Cor. 5:15 "Now if all were included in his death they are equally in his resurrection." 1 Cor. 15:21 The same mankind who died in a man was raised again in a man. 1 Cor. 15:22 In Adam all died; in Christ all are made alive.

Three Births in common - 1/ Man began in God

Mal. 2:10, Have we not all one Father? Has not one God created us?

Two births, first spirit, then flesh got us to where we are on planet earth; the new birth

in our joint-resurrection with Jesus from the dead restored us to where we belong, in heavenly places - spirit dimension is not some foreign, distant location somewhere in outer space! Eph. 2:5, 6; 1 Pet. 1:3.

To merely know ourselves according to the "flesh" is to not know ourselves at all!

Consider your creation before your physical birth. Jer. 1:5, I knew you, before I formed you in your mother's womb! It is not our brief time on planet earth that introduces us to God! We have always been known! Wow! See 1 Cor. 13:12, Then we will know, even as we have always been known!

Deut. 32:18, You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who birthed you.

Isa. 51:1 Hear me, you who pursue righteousness, you who seek the LORD; look to the rock from which you were hewn, and to the quarry from which you were dug.

Matt. 16:16-18 He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?"

Simon replied, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."

And Jesus answered him, "Blessed are you, Simon son of Jona! For flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven.

Matt. 16:18, Allow me to introduce you to you, Mr. Rock; you are Petros, a chip of the old Block! And upon this rock-revelation, I am the Master-builder of my house. And mirrored in who I am, you will reflect your authentic identity as my ekklesia. And the gates of Hades, that trapped mankind in blind-fold-mode, shall not be able to hold any prisoners against your powerful advance!

James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above *(where we originate from);* **proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda.** *(The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word, [1]**anouthen**, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

James 1:18 It was according to the Father's delightful [1]resolve that he [2]birthed us; giving [3]authentic, incarnate expression to the Word. *[The face to face-ness of the Logos that was before time was. Jn 1:1]* **Just like the first-fruits mirror the harvest, so we mirror the [4]conclusion of his [4]workmanship in the core of our [5]being.** *(The*

*word, [1]**boulomai**, means the affectionate desire and deliberate resolve of God. Only James uses the word, [2]**apokueō** from **apo** + **kuma**; from **kuo**, to swell with young; bend or curve. [same word in v 15, where sin's passion parented death, vs God's passion parented authentic life in us!] Truth, [3]**alethea**, from **a**, negative + **lanthano**, meaning hidden; that which is unveiled; the Word **[logos]** of truth is the [3]unveiled **logic** of God. The Preposition [4]**eis**, points to conclusion. The word, κτίσμα*

*[5]**ktisma** meaning, creation with reference to the the proprietorship of the manufacturer - God owns the idea of our invention - he holds the copyright! The words, εἰς τὸ εἶναι ημας ἀπαρχήν - **einai hemas** - [5]our beingness from **eimi**, I am. See Rom. 8:29, He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. Also, John 1:1-18; 1 Pet. 2:9,10.)*

James 1:22 Give the mirror-word your [1]undivided attention; do not underestimate yourself. [3]Make the calculation. There can only be one logical conclusion: your authentic origin is mirrored in the word. You are God's poem; [2]let his voice make poetry of your life! *(The word, [1]**akroate**, means intent listening. James is not promoting the doing of the law of works; he is defining the law of perfect liberty. Doing the word begins with your undivided attention to the face of your birth. [2]A doer of the Word, **poetes**, means poet. Make the calculation, [3]**paralogizomai**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, union, and **logizomai**, to reckon the logic in any calculation.)*

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing themselves],* **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.**

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted

one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life** *[of their original design.]* **They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kupto**, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]**parameno**, to remain captivated under the influence of; **meno**, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]**eleutheria**, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

Rom. 8:29 He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. *(We come from above [See John 1:13; also John 3:3-13] We were also born anew when he was raised from the dead! [1 Peter 1:3] His resurrection co-reveals our common genesis as well as our redeemed innocence. [Rom 4:25 and Acts 17:31] No wonder then that he is not ashamed to call us his siblings! The word, **adelphous**, with **a** as a connective particle and **delphus**, the womb. We share the same origin [Heb 2:11 **eks** [origin; source] **henos** [one] **pantes** [everyone], and, "In him we live and move and have our being, we are indeed his offspring!" [Acts 17:28].)*

Rom. 8:30 Jesus reveals that we [1]pre-existed in God; he [2]defined us. He [3]rendered us innocent and also [4]adorned us with splendor and esteem. *(The word [1]**prohorisen** from **prohoritso**, pre-defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan. Then [2]**ekalesen** from **kaleo**, to surname, identify by name. The verb, [3]**edikaiosen** is in the Aorist Active form from **dikaioo**, to declare righteous and innocent. All the verbs in this verse are in the Aorist tense. The Aorist presents an occurrence in summary, viewed as a whole from the outside, almost like a snapshot of the action. Also [4]**edoxasen** from **doxazō**; we have been adorned with splendor and glory. He redeemed our innocence and*

restored the glory we lost in Adam. See Romans 3:23, 24.)

Gen. 1:26,27, Then Elohim said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness. So Elohim created man in their own image, in the image of Elohim they created man; male and female they created them.

John 3:13 No one can fully engage in heaven's perspective, unless one's heavenly origin is realized! The Son of man declares mankind's co-genesis from above!

1 Cor. 13:12 There was a time of [1]suspense, when everything we saw was merely mirrored in the prophetic word, like in an enigma; but then *[when I became an adult in the revelation of Christ]* **I gaze face-to-face that I may know me, even as I have always been known!** *(The word, [1]**arti**, comes from **airo**, meaning to keep in suspense. "I knew you before I formed you in your mother's womb!" Jeremiah 1:5.)*

Paul reminds the Greek philosophers in Acts 17 that we live and move and have our being in God; mankind is indeed the offspring of God. He is quoting from their own writings, Epimenedes 600 BC and Aratus, 300 BC. The incorruptible seed of sonship is as much present in every person as the seed is already in all soil, even in the desert, waiting for the rain to awaken and ignite its life!

1 John 3:9 To discover one's authentic sonship in God, is to discover true freedom from sin. We are born of him and his seed remains in us; this is the only possible reference to sober up the mind from the intoxicating influence of deception. *(The incorruptible seed of our Father carries the exact pattern of the authentic life of our design! Jesus calls the Devil, the father of lies.*

John 8:31 Jesus then said to the Jews who had believed in him, "If you continue in my word, you are truly my disciples, John 8:32 and you will know the truth, and the truth will make you free." John 8:36 So if the Son makes you free, you will be free indeed. John 8:44 You are of your father the Devil, and your will is to do your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, and has nothing to do with the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks from his own distorted opinion; for he is a liar and the father of lies. His intention was to kill mankind's awareness of their god-identity.)

Isa 40:18 To whom then will you liken God, or what likeness compare with him?

Isa 40:19 The idol! a workman casts it, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold, and casts for it silver chains.

Isa 40:20 He who is impoverished chooses for an offering wood that will not rot; he

seeks out a skilful craftsman to set up an image that will not move.

Isa 40:21 Have you not known? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you from the beginning? Have you not understood from the foundations of the earth?

See Paul's discourse at the Areopagus:

Acts 17:24 The God who made the world and everything in it, being Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in shrines made by man,

Acts 17:25 nor is he served by human hands, as though he needed anything, since he himself gives to all men life and breath and everything.

Acts 17:26 And he made from one, every nation of mankind to live on all the face of the earth; within their specific time frame and geographic location;

Acts 17:27 Yet he is not far from each one of us;

Acts 17:28 for 'In him we live and move and have our being', as even some of your poets have said; 'For we are indeed his offspring.'

Acts 17:29 Being then God's offspring, we ought not to think that the Deity is like gold, or silver, or stone, a representation by the art and imagination of man.

Paul reminds them of their own ancient writings and he quotes two of their well known philosophers: in 600BC Epimenedes wrote a song saying, "We live and move and have our being in God" and Aratus wrote in 300BC that we are indeed the offspring of God!

Paul announces to them that the God whom they worship in ignorance is not far from each one of us!

He is not more Immanuel to the Jew than what he is Immanuel to the Gentile! Then, in the context of his Jewish background and personal encounter of the revelation of Jesus Christ Paul declares to them the Good News of mankind's redeemed innocence. "God has overlooked the times of ignorance and now appeals to all of mankind, everywhere, to a radical mind-shift since he has prophetically fixed a day on which he would judge the world in righteousness by a man whom he has appointed, and of this [righteous judgment] he has given proof to all mankind by raising him from the dead."

In Paul's understanding, the resurrection of Jesus from the dead includes mankind's co-resurrection and seals their acquittal and redeemed innocence.

Paul affirms the unity of the human race with a common origin and with God as the

Creator. This view runs counter to Greek exclusiveness which treated other races as barbarians and to Jewish pride which treated other nations as heathen or pagan.

1 John 5:21 This defeats every image of our imagination that could possibly compete with the authentic likeness of our design! Darling children, distance yourselves from every substitute image, which is what idolatry is all about! *(The word* [1]***eidolon,*** *often translated idol, refers to image or likeness. Idolatry is a projection of an image of one's own making. Idolatry is the crux of religion - it is expensive business since your idol is like a slot machine at the casino! It remains hungry and it is wired to bite and bankrupt you!)*

Three Births in common- 2/ The womb of a mother is our only passport to the planet

Jer. 1:5, Before I formed you in the womb I knew you. The womb of a mother is everyone's unique passport to planet earth.

Psalm 139:13-18 You molded my being and knitted me together in my mother's womb.

I praise you, for I am wonderfully made! Your workmanship is amazing! You know me inside out!

You were acquainted with my unformed frame and every feature of my being, when I was conceived in secret; intricately woven in hidden places.

Your eyes beheld my unformed substance; you anticipated the significance of my life; even down to the seemingly, mundane detail of my days; I am mirrored in your word!

How precious to me are your thoughts, O God! How vast is their sum total!

Were I to count them, my years would have to equal yours! When I awake, I am still with you.

Luke 1:48 I am so aware of God's favorable gaze upon my life - even though I am a handmaid of no prominent social standing - from now on, his favor will be endorsed in [1]every birth and his blessing will be evident for all [1]generations to realize! *(God's Favor is not a reward for good behavior or social status! Christ in the nations **[en ethnos]** is the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations but now unveiled in the incarnation revelation! His favor will be endorsed in [1]every birth - πασαι γενεαι **pasai geneai**. See also verse 50.)*

Luke 1:50 The [1]kindness of God in the gift of life, [2]from birth to birth, is forever celebrated in awe! *(The word, ἔλεος [1]**eleos**, kindness, mercy, generosity, good will; a desire to help. The words, εἰς γενεὰς και γενεας [2]**eis** [3]**geneas kai geneas**, literally, from birth to birth. [generation to generation] **eis** - indicates a point reached in conclusion. To be overwhelmed with his mercy is to be awestruck with his generosity, every-time we witness the miracle of birth! The birth-theme is obviously most prominent in Mary's mind! **The birth of the Savior will give context and significance to every birth on the planet! She symbolizes the dream of Elohim-incarnate, about to be redeemed and realized in every human life!)***

Three Births in common - 3/ The resurrection of Jesus

Eph. 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our [1]deviations, we were [2]co-quickened together with Christ! We had nothing to do with it. Grace [3]freed us, once and for all from the lies that we believed about ourselves under the performance-driven system, and now [4]defines our authentic identity! *(The word often translated, trespasses, παράπτωμα [1]**paraptoma**, deviation; from **para** close proximity and **pipto**, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to stop flying, **petomai**, to fly. Losing altitude speaks of mankind's fallen mindset. Col 3:1-3. The verb συνεζωοποιησεν [2]**sunetzoopoiesen** [co-quickened] is the Aorist Active Indicative, describing an action that was completed in the past. The sentence, **χάριτί [2]ἐστε [3]σεσῳσμένοι** - literally translates, "By grace you are - having been saved!" The verb, [4]**este** is the Present Active Indicative of **eimi**, I am - indicating the continues state of your being which celebrates an [3]unstoppable freedom that happened in your favor! The verb [3]**sesoosmenoi**, having been rescued; is the Perfect Passive Participle, describing a state that exists, as a result of something that happened previously. The basic thought of the Perfect Tense is that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. In other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now in existence. We had no contribution to our salvation! God's Master-Plan unfolded in the mystery of the gospel declaring our joint inclusion in Christ's death and resurrection. This is the mystery of grace, God reveals us in Christ! Now we may know, even as we have always been known! 1 Cor 13:12. Of God's doing are we in Christ! 1 Cor 1:30. God saw us in Christ, in his death and resurrection before we saw ourselves there! He declared mankind's co-resurrection with Christ 800 BC. This is the only scripture in the entire Old Testament that specifically mentions the third day resurrection and it includes us! "After two days he will revive us, on the third day, he will raise us up!" Hosea 6:2.)*

Eph. 2:6 We are co-included in his resurrection. We are also co-elevated in his ascension to be equally present in the throne room of the heavenly realm where we are co-seated with him in his executive authority. We are fully represented in Christ Jesus. *(We have wasted so much time trying to get there, when "there" is where we are to begin with! Our joint position in Christ defines us; this can never again be a distant goal to reach through religious devotion or striving, but our immediate location. See Eph 4:8-10; Col 3:1-3.)*

1Pet. 1:3 Let us [1]celebrate God with articulate acclaim! He is the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. According to his matchless mercy and tender compassions, he [2]birthed us again when Jesus was raised from the dead. Now we are alive to witness the [3]expectation of the ages unfold! *(The word, [1]**eulogetos**, means to brag, to bless, to speak well of. Jesus reminds Nicodemus that we are born **anouthen**, from above. [John 3:3, and John 3:13] No one can fully engage in heaven's perspective, unless one's heavenly origin is realized! The Son of man declares mankind's co-genesis from above and now through our joint resurrection, we are reconnected again to our original identity as sons. The word [2]**anagennao**, from **ana**, upward, [reconnecting with **anouthen** - Jn 3:3 - from above, where we came from in the first place]; and **gennao**, to regenerate, to give birth. As much as his death brought dramatic closure to our futile and failed attempts to justify and define ourselves, our co-resurrection rebooted the original blueprint of our Maker's image and likeness in us. [3]"A living hope" - the expectation of the ages concluding in life. See Colossians 1:27 - The mystery of the ages is unveiled! Christ in us!)*

Isa. 66:8 "Who has heard of such a thing? Who has seen such things? Shall the earth be born in one day? Shall all people be brought forth in one moment?"

The only scripture in the entire Old Testament that prophesies the third day resurrection, includes us! Hos. 6:2. After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will raise us up, that we may live before him. RSV

Our co-inclusion in Jesus' death and resurrection was prophesied 800 years B.C. through Hosea and 700 B.C. by Isaiah.

2 Cor. 5:15 "Now if all were included in his death they are equally in his resurrection."

1 Cor. 15:21 The same mankind who died in a man was raised again in a man.

1 Cor. 15:22 In Adam all died; in Christ all are made alive.

2 Cor. 5:18 The idea of mankind's co-inclusion in the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ is entirely God's doing! To now realize that God has indeed brought final closure to the old and for us to see everything and everyone in this new light is to simply see what God has always known to be true about us in Christ; we are not debating human experience, opinion, or their contribution; this is exactly what God believes. In Jesus Christ, God [1]exchanged equivalent value to redeem us to himself. He went to the highest extreme in this act of reconciliation to persuade us of our original worth! This God has given us as the mandate of our ministry. *(The*

*word, [1]**katalasso**, translates as reconciliation; it is a mutual exchange of equal value. This transaction was not to buy us back from "the Devil"; a thief never becomes an owner; it was God redeeming our minds from the lies that we believed about ourselves - reconciliation is the bold unveiling of the value of the hidden treasure in everyone! See 2 Cor 4:7 and Math 13:44.)*

2 Cor. 5:19 Our ministry declares that Jesus did not act independently of his Father. God was present in Christ when he reconciled the total [1]cosmos to himself. Deity and mankind embraced in him; the fallen state of mankind was deleted; their trespasses would no longer count against them! He now announces his friendship with every individual from within us! *(The incarnation did not separate the Father from the Son and the Spirit. In him dwells the fullness of God in a human body. Col 2:9. As a human person, Jesus felt the agony of fallen mankind on the cross when he echoed Psalm 22, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me! Why are you so far from helping me, from the words of my groaning?" But then in verse 24, David declares triumphantly: "He has not despised or abhorred the affliction of the afflicted; and he has not hid his face from him, but has heard, when he cried to him." The word, [1]kosmos in the NT refers to the entire human family.)*

Gal. 4:21 Since you are so intrigued by the law, would you please, also understand it's prophetic message:

Gal. 4:22 The law records the fact that Abraham had two sons: one by a slave girl, the other by a free woman. *(The law in Jewish thinking includes the entire Torah, or Pentateuch - the 1st 5 books of Moses, as well as the prophetic writings including Psalms.)*

Gal. 4:23 The one is produced by the flesh *[the DIY-tree]*, **the other by faith** *[the promise]*.

Gal. 4:24 There is a parallel meaning in the story of the two sons: they represent two systems, works and grace.

Gal. 4:25 Sinai is an Arabian rocky mountain named after Hagar, *[outside the land of promise]*. **Its association with the law of Moses mirrors Jerusalem as the capital of Jewish legalism. Hagar is the mother of the law of works.** *[DIY-religion]*

Gal. 4:26 But the mother from above, the true mother of mankind is grace, the free Jerusalem; she is the mother of the promise.

Gal. 4:27 For it is written, "Rejoice, Oh childless one! Erupt in jubilee! For though

you have never known travail before, your children will greatly outnumber her who was married!" *(Married to the law; Isa 54:1; see also Rom 7:1-6)*

Gal. 4:28 We resemble Isaac: we are begotten of faith; the promise is our parent.

Gal. 4:29 Just as when the flesh child persecuted the faith child, so now these Jerusalem Jews in their Christian disguise, seek to harass you;

Gal. 4:30 however, Scripture is clear: "Expel the slave mother and her son; the slave son cannot inherit with the free son." *(In exactly the same way, rid your minds radically from the slave mother and child mentality. Light dispels darkness effortlessly.)*

Gal. 4:31 Realize whose children we are my Brothers and Sisters: we are not children of the slave-mother, the law, but children of the free mother; we are begotten of grace!

To merely know ourselves according to the "flesh" is to not know ourselves at all!

Paul says in Gal. 1:15, 16 "God separated me from my mother's womb and revealed his Son in me." He discovered it was not his so-called "noble birth" as offspring of Jacob and Rachel's son Benjamin, that defined him, but Christ's resurrection giving mirror evidence of his original design.

When Paul preaches the resurrection in Acts 13, he quotes Psalm 2 as his text reference, "Today I have begotten you! Ask of me the nations and I will give you the ends of the earth as your inheritance!" He understands that the resurrection of Jesus represents the human race! Paul knows by revelation that what Hosea saw prophetically 800 BC was made a reality in the resurrection of Jesus from the dead. "After 2 days he will revive us, on the 3rd day he will raise us up!" In Eph. 2:5,6 Paul draws the powerful conclusion that "while we were dead in our sins, God made us alive TOGETHER WITH CHRIST and raised us up TOGETHER WITH CHRIST and seated us TOGETHER WITH CHRIST in heavenly places!

Paul further details the revelation of mankind's association and inclusion in Christ, in this powerful account, recorded in Ephesians 4:8-10 ..."Having descended into the deepest gloom of our hellish darkness, he led us as his trophies in his triumphant procession on high!" Jesus emptied whatever definition we have of hell and came back with the keys! Oh, what an insult it is to the entire gospel to preach a defeated devil and an empty hell, back into business!

Through the preaching of this gospel, humanity is implored to awaken in their understanding to this reality: Since, by God's belief, we are raised together with Christ,

Paul urges us to also relocate ourselves mentally; to engage our thoughts with throne room realities! He urges us to see ourselves joint-seated with Christ in the throne room of God, in heavenly places! We have returned to where we originate from! Col. 3:1-4.

The defeated Adam died in Jesus' death, and the re-newed (original) man, was raised together with Christ in the resurrection. God knew us before he formed us in our mother's womb. Jer. 1:5. See also John 7:5 where James, the younger brother of Jesus did not believe in Jesus until after the resurrection. "Then Jesus also appeared to James" (1 Cor. 15:7) and suddenly James discovers that he had more in common with Jesus than Mary's womb!

James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above *(where we originate from);* **proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda.** *(The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word,* **[1]anouthen**, *means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

James 1:18 It was according to the Father's delightful [1]resolve that he [2]birthed us; giving [3]authentic, incarnate expression to the Word. *[The face to face-ness of the Logos that was before time was. Jn 1:1]* **Just like the first-fruits mirror the harvest, so we mirror the [4]conclusion of his [4]workmanship in the core of our [5]being.** *(The word,* **[1]boulomai**, *means the affectionate desire and deliberate resolve of God. Only James uses the word,* **[2]apokueō** *from* **apo** *+* **kuma**; *from* **kuo**, *to swell with young; bend or curve. [same word in v 15, where sin's passion parented death, vs God's passion parented authentic life in us!] Truth,* **[3]alethea**, *from* **a**, *negative +* **lanthano**, *meaning hidden; that which is unveiled; the Word* **[logos]** *of truth is the [3]unveiled* **logic** *of God. The Preposition* **[4]eis**, *points to conclusion. The word, κτίσμα*

[5]ktisma *meaning, creation with reference to the the proprietorship of the manufacturer - God owns the idea of our invention - he holds the copyright! The words, εἰς τὸ εἶναι ἡμᾶς ἀπαρχήν -* **einai hemas** *- [5]our beingness from* **eimi**, *I am. See Rom. 8:29, He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original*

and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. Also, John 1:1-18; 1 Pet. 2:9,10.)

What a wonderful, clear reference the resurrection of Jesus is: the Trophy of our true identity and innocence redeemed! What a glorious new birth is revealed; just like Isaac from Sarah's dead womb, we arose together with Christ from that rock-hewn tomb!

The incorruptible seed has been in the soil all along, even as it is in the Sahara desert! It is just waiting for the rain! Isa. 55:8-10. If the treasure was not already in the field, why would God be prepared to sell all he has to buy a piece of worthless property? Matt. 13:44. And remember, he didn't buy us back from the Devil! A thief never becomes an owner! He paid the most ridiculous price in order to persuade our minds of our authentic value, so that we might know even as we have always been known! Heb 6:16,17. Paul says that we have this treasure in earthen vessels; but while the eyes of our understanding are veiled through our unbelief, we cannot see the truth about us, or the treasure inside us! 2 Cor. 4:7.

(See 2 Cor. 4:1-18 in Chapter 6 Asia in One Man.)

David declares the conclusion of the crucifixion revelation in Psalm 22:27 "All the ends of the earth shall remember and return to the LORD; and all the families of the nations shall worship before him."

In Eph. 3:14 and 15 Paul prays: "For this reason I bow my knees before the Father, from whom every family in heaven and on earth is named."

When Isaiah prophesies the birth of the Messiah he says in Isa. 9:6, 7 "For to us a child is born, to us a son is given; and the government will be upon his shoulder, and his name will be called "Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, the Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. Of the increase of his government and of peace there will be no end, upon the throne of David, and over his kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from this time forth and for evermore. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will do this."

Matt. 22:41-46 Now while the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them a question, saying, "What do you think of the Christ? Whose son is he?" They said to him, "The son of David." He said to them, "How is it then that David, inspired by the Spirit, calls him Lord, saying, 'The Lord said to my Lord, sit at my right hand, till I put your enemies under your feet'? If David then calls him Lord, how is he his Son?" And no one was able to answer him a word, nor from that day did any one dare to ask him

any more questions.

Matt. 23:9 "And call no man your father on earth, for you have one Father, who is in heaven."

To merely know ourselves according to the "flesh" is to not know ourselves at all!

There is another knowing that matters most! "To know, even as you have always been known! 1 Cor. 13:12

We have forgotten who we are. James 1:24

Deut. 32:18, You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you, and you forgot the God who gave you birth.

Isa. 51:1 Hear me, you who pursue righteousness, you who seek the LORD; look to the rock from which you were hewn, and to the quarry from which you were dug.

Matt. 16:16, He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?"

Matt. 16:16, Simon replied, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."

Matt. 16:17, And Jesus answered him, "Blessed are you, Simon son of Jona! For flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven.

Matt. 16:18, Allow me to introduce you to you, Mr. Rock; you are Petros, a chip of the old Block! And upon this rock-revelation, I am the Master-builder of my house. And mirrored in who I am, you will reflect your authentic identity as my ekklesia. And the gates of Hades, that trapped humanity in blindfold-mode, shall not be able to hold any prisoners against your powerful advance!

John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! *(This day would begin our calendar and record the fact that human history would forever be divided into before and after Christ. The incarnation would make the image of God visible in human form. In him who is the blueprint of our lives there is more than enough light to displace the darkness in every human life. He is the true light that enlightens everyone! [Col 1:15; 2:9, 10; 2 Cor 4:6])*

John 1:10 Although no one took any notice of him, he was no stranger to the world; he always was there and is himself the author of all things.

John 1:11 It was not as though he arrived on a foreign planet; he came to his own, yet his own did not [1]recognize him. *(The Jews should have been the first to recognize him! Revelation 19:12. Also Ps 24:1, "The earth is the Lord's and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell in it [RSV]." The word, [1]**paralambano**, comes from **para**,*

*a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection; and **lambano**, to comprehend, grasp, to identify with.)*

John 1:12 Everyone who [1]realizes their association in him, [6]convinced that he is their [2]original life and that [7]his name defines them, God [5]gives the assurance that they are indeed his [4]offspring, [2]begotten of him; he [3]sanctions the legitimacy of their sonship. *(The word often translated, to receive, [1]**lambano**, means to take in hand, to comprehend, to grasp, to identify with. This word suggests that even though he came to his own, there are those who do not [1]identify with their true [2]origin revealed in him, and like the many Pharisees they behave like children of a foreign father, the father of lies [John 8: 44]. Neither God's legitimate fatherhood, nor his ownership is in question; mankind's indifference to their true [2]origin is the problem. This is what the Gospel addresses with utmost clarity in the person of Jesus Christ. Jesus has come to introduce the individual to themselves again; mankind has forgotten what manner of person they are by design! [James 1:24, Deuteronomy 32:18, Psalm 22:27] The word, [2]**genesthai**, from **ginomai**, means to generate; to become; John employs this verb in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. Greek Infinitives could have either a present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms has more to do with aspect than with time. The Present Infinitive is used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. This is an important point since many translations of this verse suggests that God's ability to make us his sons can only be in response to something we must first do in order to trigger God into action! Our grasping **[lambano]** is simply the awakening to the fact that our genesis is already completed in the **Logos**. [See John 1:3] The **Logos** is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive Parent reference to their genesis. There is nothing original, except the Word. We are his offspring. [see also Acts 17:28]. "He has come to give us understanding to know him who is true and to realize that we are in him who is true." [1 John 5:20]*

*The word, [3]**exousia**, often translated "power;" as in, he gave "power" to [2]become children of God, is a compound word; from **ek**, always denoting origin or source and **eimi**, I am; thus, out of I am! This gives [3]legitimacy and authority to our*

*sonship; [4]**teknon**, translated as offspring, child.*

*"He has given," [5]**didomi**, in this case to give something to someone that already belongs to them; thus, to return. The fact that they already are his own, born from above and that they have their [2]beginning and their being in him is now confirmed in their realizing it! Convinced, [6]**pisteo**; [7]his name **onoma**, is mankind's family name. [see Eph 3:15])*

"He made to be their true selves, their child-of-God selves." — *The Message*

John 1:13 These are the ones who discover their genesis in God, beyond their natural conception! This is not about our blood lineage or whether we were a wanted- or unwanted-child; this is about our God-begotteness. We are his dream come true and not the invention of our parents. You are indeed the greatest idea that God has ever had! *(See Jeremiah 1:5; 29:11 & John 3:2-7)*

John 1:14 Suddenly the invisible, eternal Word takes on [1]visible form - the Incarnation, on display in a flesh and blood Person, as in a mirror! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible exhibit of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He [2]captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the [3]authentic begotten Son. The [4]glory *(that we lost in Adam)* **returns in fullness! Only [5]grace can communicate truth in such complete context!** *(In him we discover that we are not here by chance or accident or by the desire of an earthly parent, neither are we the product of a mere physical conception; we exist by the expression of God's desire to reveal himself in the flesh. His eternal invisible Word, his Spirit-thought, [1]became flesh, [1]**ginomai**, as in be born and [2]**theaomai**, meaning to gaze upon, to perceive. We saw his glory, [4]**doxa**, the display of his opinion, the glory as of the original, authentic begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth. He is the "only begotten," [3]**monogenes**; begotten only by the Father and not of the flesh; in him we recognize our true beginning, as in the authentic original mold. He is also the "first born from the dead", declaring our new birth. [Colossians 1:18, 1 Peter 1:3]. He is the revelation of our completeness.*

*And out of **[ek]** his fullness have we all received! The Preposition, **ek** always points to source/origin. Grace mirrored in grace, [5]**garin anti garitos**. For the law was given through Moses, grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. He who is in the bosom of the Father, the only original, authentic begotten of the Father; he is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. Interesting that the revelation of the Incarnation in verse 14 doesn't follow verse 2 or 3, but verse 12 and 13!*

Genesis 1:26 is redeemed! See 2 Corinthians 3:17,18.)

John 1:15 John the Baptist raised his voice to announce emphatically that Jesus was what his ministry and prophetic message were all about. He declared that Jesus, though younger than him, since he [1]witnessed his [2]birth, ranks above him in prominence and in his Messianic mission - because in his I-am-ness, he always [3]was pre-eminent. *(He was [2]born [2]in front of my eyes - I witnessed his birth, meaning he is younger than I; [1]**emprosthen mou [2]gegonen** [from **ginomai] oti protos mou [3]ean [eimi]** - but he [3]was before I was [2]born - Later Jesus reminds us that before Abraham was born, **[ginomai]** I am! **[eimi]**")*

John 1:16 He is the [1]source of our completeness. Everyone may now realize their own completeness as evidenced in him. This is [2]grace mirrored in grace! *(It reminds of Col 2:9,10 The fullness of the Godhead embodied in Christ, reflects our own completeness! Out of [1]ek] his fullness have we all received! The Preposition, **ek** always points to source/origin. His fullness is the source of all that grace communicates as our portion. Grace mirrored in grace - [2]**garin anti garitos**. The word **anti** means over against - thus, mirrored in.)*

John 1:17 The law was given through Moses; grace and truth have their genesis in Jesus Christ. Against the stark backdrop of the law, with Moses representing the condemned state of mankind, Jesus Christ unveils grace and truth! *(Moses represents the system of performance as basis to one's standing before God; Jesus Christ is incarnate grace and truth! He is the life of our design on display in human form, as in a mirror.)*

John 1:18 Until this moment God remained invisible; now the [1]authentic, incarnate begotten Son, the blueprint of our design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into full view! He is the [2]official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. *(Begotten only of God, [1]**monogenes**. Official guide, [2]**eksegesato**, from **ek,** Preposition denoting source, and **hegeomai,** the strengthened form of **ago**, to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep; thus **hegeomai** means to be officially appointed in a position of authority.)*

I'm often overwhelmed

at the magnitude of our eternal Genesis

and the thought of eternity that dwells within us!

If our finite minds could invent technology

that captures fleeting, fragile moments in a time-frame

with such precision and attention to detail -

how vast is the eternal sphere we come from?

And how excellent the logic of the Logos

that was face to face with God before time was -

and gave birth to us!

We began

and conclude in God!

The Metanoia-moment! Chapter 19

People are not born Christians, yet every person ever born comes from God!

We are born into a world where we are bombarded with many diverse cultural and traditional mindsets, most of which directly stems from the Tree of the knowledge of Good and Evil-System, which is the fallen mindset system, which says that you are not...you have to strive to become! People who do gross things do it from believing a lie about themselves and not knowing the truth of their incredible design as image bearers of God!

James says in Js 3:9, We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a man made in his mirror likeness. The point is not what the man did to deserve the curse!

A doctor doesn't slap his patient and command him to stop coughing! You may have the flu but you never become the flu! True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate.

Multitudes of people are living in the darkness of ignorance, not knowing the truth of the integrity of their design and their redeemed value and innocence!

The adventure of the Christian life is to declare what we have discovered to be true about every single person! Jesus says that when we discover that the son of man is indeed the son of God then the gates of hades *(not to see)* will crumble and the prisoners of darkness will be free to discover themselves in him!

The Gospel holds the ingredient of the most powerful influence that we could ever encounter. Nothing known to us presents a greater wealth of wisdom and enrichment than the love of God realized. This great revelation is not only his love for us but also his love in us for others!

The awakening of the spirit of our understanding through the preaching of the gospel is not something we do in order to "get saved;" it's something that happens to us when we realize what Jesus has done for us! The "must do's" and "must become's" have all been replaced by a masterfully done deal through one brilliant move of God.

Consider the Greek word μετάνοια ***metanoia***, from ***meta***, together with, and, ***noieo***, to perceive with the mind; which describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-

knowing. It has nothing in common with the Latin word ***paenitentia***, where the word ***pennance*** stems from; meaning, payback and punishment inflicted on oneself. Then they added the "re" to get even more mileage out of sin consciousness. Re-penance or, repentance! This gross deception led to the perverted doctrines of indulgences, where naive, ignorant people were led to believe that they needed to purchase favor from an angry god. Most cathedrals as well as many ministries were funded with this guilt- money.

Faith is not a decision; faith is the most amazing discovery! The love of God realized awakens belief! Faith is not blind, neither is it unconscious; faith knows.

Rom 1:17 explains Rom 10:17; the "from faith to faith" only happens in the revelation of what God did right to put us right. (This is completely superior to what Adam or we did wrong) Jesus is the source of faith; it is impossible for us to manufacture any valid faith outside of the revelation of grace.

While we are on the verse 17's, now Rom 4:17 suddenly makes sense! God called things (mankind's salvation) which were not as though they were!

If our point of reference is not God's faith in the finished work of Christ we have no valid gospel to preach! If our faith is not sourced and sustained in him as the mirror image of God revealed and redeemed in us we are deceiving ourselves with yet another religious disguise called Christianity.

The days of window-shopping are over; now with unveiled faces we are gazing into the mirror of our revealed likeness and innocence. 2 Cor. 3:18

Acts 14:1 "The same thing happened in Iconium: Paul and Barnabas went to the synagogue and spoke in such a way that a great number of Jews and Gentiles became believers." (GNB)

Col. 1:6 So, from the day that you heard and understood the grace of God in truth, you bore fruit!

For Paul the understanding of mankind's joint inclusion in Christ's death and resurrection was his defining moment. He announced, From now on therefore, I no longer know anyone after the flesh! (From a human point of view) 2 Cor. 5:16

The hearing of the mirror-gospel ignites this "from now on moment"!

"Behold, everything has become new!" 2 Cor. 5:17 RSV

James 1:18 It was according to the Father's delightful [1]resolve that he [2]birthed us; giving [3]authentic, incarnate expression to the Word. *[The face to face-ness of the*

Logos that was before time was. Jn 1:1] **Just like the first-fruits mirror the harvest, so we mirror the [4]conclusion of his [4]workmanship in the core of our [5]being.** *(The word, [1]**boulomai**, means the affectionate desire and deliberate resolve of God. Only James uses the word, [2]**apokueō** from **apo** + **kuma**; from **kuo**, to swell with young; bend or curve. [same word in v 15, where sin's passion parented death, vs God's passion parented authentic life in us!] Truth, [3]**alethea**, from **a**, negative + **lanthano**, meaning hidden; that which is unveiled; the Word [**logos**] of truth is the [3]unveiled **logic** of God. The Preposition [4]**eis**, points to conclusion. The word, κτίσμα*

*[5]**ktisma** meaning, creation with reference to the proprietorship of the manufacturer - God owns the idea of our invention - he holds the copyright! The words, εἰς τὸ εἶναι ημας ἀπαρχήν - **einai hemas** - [5]our beingness from **eimi**, I am. See Rom. 8:29, He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. Also, John 1:1-18; 1 Pet. 2:9,10.)*

2 Cor. 3:13 What we say is so unlike Moses who had to keep Israel in suspense with a veiled face; they did not realize that this arrangement would never suffice to secure their standing before God. In essence the letters on stone confirmed their death. All that they could see was the futility of the law of works; how entirely useless their best attempts would be to match the life of their design. *(In Adam all people alike stood condemned; they did not realize it until the law revealed it. In Christ all are declared innocent; yet they do not know it until the Gospel reveals it. Rom 10:17 and Rom 7:4-25.)*

2 Cor. 3:14 Since the time of Moses until this very day their minds remain calloused and veiled. They are kept in suspense without realizing that there is no glory left in the law: *(whatever glory there was, carried merely a fading, prophetic glimmer)* **reading the Old Covenant without understanding that Christ is the fulfillment of Scripture is a complete waste of time. Only in discovering our union with Christ is the veil removed and do we realize that the old system is [1]rendered entirely useless.** *(The word [1]**katergeo** comes from **kata**, meaning intensity, and **argos**, meaning labor, the law of works is rendered entirely useless; thus the new arrangement frees us from all self effort to attempt to improve what God has already perfected in Christ.)*

2 Cor. 3:15 In the meantime nothing seems to have changed; the same veil continues to blindfold the hearts of people whenever Moses is read. *(Moses symbolizes the futility of self righteousness as the global blindfold of the religious world. [John 1:17] Against the stark backdrop of the law; with Moses representing the condemned state of mankind, Jesus Christ unveils grace and truth! He is the life of our design redeemed in human form.)*

2 Cor. 3:16 The moment anyone [1]returns to the Lord the veil is gone! *(The word, [1]**epistrepho** means to return to where we've wandered from; "we all like sheep have gone astray." Jesus is God unveiled in human form. [Col 1:15] Also 1 Pet 2:25 You were completely vulnerable, just like sheep roaming astray without direction or protection, but now you have returned and are restored to the shepherd and Guardian of your souls! And 1 Pet 1:17. Then, Hebrews 8:1, "The conclusion of all that has been said points us to an exceptional Person, who towers far above the rest in the highest office of heavenly greatness. He is the executive authority of the majesty of God. 8:2 The office he now occupies is the one which the Moses-model resembled prophetically. He ministers in the holiest place in God's true tabernacle of worship. Nothing of the old man-made structure can match its perfection. Heb 8:10 Now, instead of documenting my laws on stone, I will chisel them into your mind and engrave them in your inner consciousness; it will no longer be a one-sided affair. I will be your God and you will be my people, not by compulsion but by mutual desire." See James 1:25, "Those who gaze into the mirror reflection of the face of their birth are captivated by the effect of a law that frees them from the obligation to the old written code that restricted them to their our own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what they see in that mirror concerning the law of perfect liberty [the law of faith] that now frees them to get on with the act of living the life [of their original design]. They find a new spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living." [The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human life as in a mirror.])*

2 Cor. 3:17 The Lord and the Spirit are one; his Lordship sanctions our freedom. A freedom from rules chiselled in stone to the voice of our redeemed design echoing in our hearts!

2 Cor. 3:18 Now, we all, with new understanding, see ourselves in him as in a mirror. The days of window-shopping are over! In him every face is [1]unveiled. In [2]gazing with wonder at the [5]blueprint of God displayed in human form,

we suddenly realize that we are looking into a mirror, where every feature of his [3]image articulated in Christ is [2]reflected within us! The Spirit of the Lord engineers this radical [4]transformation; we are led [6]from an inferior [5]mind-set to the revealed [5]endorsement of our authentic identity. *(The word, [1]**anakalupto**; from **ana**, a Preposition denoting upward, to return again, and **kalupto**, to uncover, unveil. The word, [2]**katoptrizomai**, means to gaze into a reflection, to mirror oneself. Paul uses [4]**metamorphumetha** as a present Passive indicative from **metamorpho**; **meta**, together with, and **morphe**, form. [The word commonly translated sin, [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, allotted portion or form; thus, a distorted form, which is the opposite of metamorphe; with form. The word **meros** is the stem of **morphe**.] Now, with unveiled faces we are gazing at the glory of the Lord as in a mirror and metaporhe happens - image and likeness awakens within us!*

*The word, [3]**eikon**, translates as exact resemblance, image and likeness; **eikon** always assumes a prototype, that which it not merely resembles, but from that which it is drawn; [5]**doxa**, glory, translates as mindset, or opinion from **dokeo**, authentic, blueprint-thought. Changed '**from** glory to glory', **apo doxes eis doxan**; **eis**, a point reached in conclusion; [6]**apo**, away from, meaning away from the glory that previously defined us, i.e. our own achievements or disappointments, to the glory of our original design that now defines us. Two glories are mentioned in this chapter; the glory of the flesh, which is the veiled, fading kind represented by Moses and the unfading, unveiled glory of God's image and likeness, mirrored in the face of Christ and now redeemed in us. See also 2 Cor 4:4 -7.*

*[Note, the Greek word translated "from" in this verse is not the same as the word translated "from" in Rom 1:17 Paul says the unveiling of God's righteousness is **from** faith to faith. Here he does not use the word **apo**, away from, but the Preposition, **ek**, which always denotes source or origin.]*

Some translations of this Scripture read, "we are being changed from glory to glory." This would suggest that change is gradual and will more than likely take a lifetime, which was the typical thinking that trapped Israel for forty years in the wilderness of unbelief! We cannot become more than what we already are in Christ. We do not grow more complete; we simply grow in the knowledge and awareness of our completeness! [See Colossians 3:10] How long does it take the beautiful swan to awaken to the truth of its design? The ugly duckling was an illusion! Whatever it was that endorsed the 'ugly duckling' mindset, co-died together with Christ! In the death and resurrection of

Jesus Christ, God did not redeem a compromised replica of you; he rescued the original, blueprint you, created in his radiant mirror likeness! Any other 'self' you're trying to find or esteem will disappoint! See Romans 6:11, Reckon your 'DIY-law of works-self' dead, and your redeemed self co-raised and co-seated together with Christ! This is freedom indeed! Galatians 2:19,20; Gal 2:20 So here I am dead and alive at the same time! I'm dead to the old me I was trying to be and alive to the real me which is Christ in me! Co-crucified, now co-alive! What a glorious entanglement! I was in him in his death; now he is in me in my life! For the first time I'm free to be me in my skin, immersed in his faith in our joint-sonship! He loves me and believes in me! He is God's gift to me! (The verb συνεσταυρωμαι from sustauroō, is in the Perfect Tense, indicating that not only was I crucified with Christ in the past, but I am existing now in that present condition. How can any human effort improve on this! See Hosea 6:2 and Eph 2:5 also Romans 7:6 But now we are fully released from any further association with a life directed by the rule of the law, we are dead to that which once held us captive, free to be slaves to the newness of spirit-spontaneity rather than age old religious rituals, imitating the mere face value of the written code. The moment one exchanges spontaneity with rules, the edge of romance is compromised!))

Titus 3:2 Gossip is out! Never have anything bad to say about anyone! Don't try and be the [1]macho man, having to win every argument; instead, avoid quarrelling, be appropriate, always show perfect courtesy to one and all. *(The word, [1]**amachos** from **a** as a negative particle and **mache**, a brawler, to be controversial, striving. You don't have to wait for people to change before you are nice to them. There is a big difference between "fake politeness" and perfect courtesy!)*

Titus 3:3 Do not be harsh on others. Remember that we, too, were typically foolish; we were stubborn and indifferent to spiritual things, our addiction to the sensual and sexual kept us running around in circles, we were engaged in malice and spiteful jealousies, we were bored and lonely, often utterly disliking ourselves and hating one another! *(The only difference in who we are now and who we were then is in what we now know to be true about ourselves.)*

Titus 3:4 But then, oh happy day! It was the generosity of God and his fondness for mankind that dawned on us like a shaft of light. Our days of darkness were over! Light shone everywhere and we became aware: God rescued the human race! *(See Titus 2:11.)*

Titus 3:5 Salvation is not a reward for good behavior. It has absolutely nothing

to do with anything that we have done. God's mercy saved us. The Holy Spirit endorses in us what happened to us when Jesus Christ died and was raised! When we heard the glad announcement of salvation it was like taking a deep warm bath! Our minds were [1]thoroughly cleansed and re-booted into [2]newness of life! *(The word [1]**paliggenesia** suggests a complete restoration to the original, in modern terms, rebooted. The word [2]**anakainosis**, from **ana**, upward, and **kainosis**, newness, speaks of a fresh upward focus; a re-engaging with heavenly thoughts. See Col 3:1-3; also 1 Thess 1:5. We realized that we were indeed co-included, co-crucified, and co-raised and are now co-seated together with Christ in heavenly places! [See 2 Cor 5:14-21; Hosea 6:2; Eph 2:5, 6; and 1 Pet 1:3.])*

Titus 3:6 Holy Spirit is the extravagant Administrator of the salvation of Jesus Christ; gushing forth within us like an artesian well. *(An artesian well is a well, sunk through solid strata of sedimentary rock into strata from an area of a higher altitude than that of the well, so that there is sufficient pressure to force water to flow upward. From the French word, artesian, referring to the old French province Artois, where such wells were common.*

In John 7:37-39, John records how Jesus witnessed the eighth day, the great and final day of the Feast of Tabernacles, when, according to custom, the High Priest would draw water from the Pool of Siloam with a golden jar, mix the water with wine, and then pour it over the altar while the people would sing with great joy from Psalm 118:25-26, and also Isaiah 12:3; "Therefore with joy shall we draw water from the wells of salvation!" Then, Jesus, knowing that he is the completeness of every prophetic picture and promise, cried out with a loud voice: "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink! If you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, you will discover that you are what I am all about, and rivers of living waters will gush from your innermost being!" See Rom 5:5.)

Titus 2:11 The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.

Titus 2:12 [1]The day and age we live in sets the stage for displaying the attraction of an [2]awe-inspired life; our [6]minds are rescued in the revelation of righteousness. We are in the [4]school of grace, instructed how to thoroughly [5]reverse the apathy and [3]indifference that erupts in a [5]wave of lust that would seek to dictate the day! *(The word, [1]**aion**, as in the day and age we live in; [2]**eusebos**, meaning godly, the attraction of devotion, awe; [3]**asebeia**, as in ungodliness, indifference; [4]**paideou**, training*

*students; [5]**arneomai**, from **a**, negative, and **rheo**, pouring forth of utterance; [5]**kosmikos epithumia**, worldly lusts; [6]**sophronos**, saved minds; the revelation of righteousness shows how completely God redeemed mankind in Christ and empowers us to cultivate an innocence consciousness instead of a sin consciousness).*

Titus 2:13 Everyone must [1]welcome with open arms the outrageously blessed expectation; Jesus is what the world was waiting for! He radiates the brilliant intent of God, engineered by his greatness to rescue the world in him. *(The word, [1]**prosdechomenoi**, means to receive to oneself, to welcome with open arms.)*

Titus 2:14 He gave himself as sacrifice in [1]exchange for our freedom. We are [1]redeemed from every obligation and accusation under the law and declared absolutely innocent. He defines who we are! [2]Our brand name is "I am." We are exclusively his. We are a [3]passionate people; we excel in doing everything we do beautifully. *(The word, [1]**lutroo**, means ransom, redemption price, to purchase from slavery; [2]**periousios**, comes from **peri**, for sphere, circuit, locality, pertaining to, and **eimi**, "I am;" [3]**zelotes**, translates as zealous, passionate; and [4]**kalos**, as beautiful.)*

Titus 2:15 Continue to communicate content in your every conversation; [1]inspire and entreat with conviction and assertiveness; you are not at the mercy of anyone's [2]suspicious scrutiny. *(Encourage everyone to become acquainted with their redeemed identity, [1]**parakaleo**; and the word, [2]**periphroneo**, translates as to think beyond what is obvious, suspicious scrutiny.)*

James 1:21 Therefore, by embracing the [1]infused word, you discover how thoroughly freed you already are from any kind of perverted passion that spirals out of control, polluting your lives like a filthy garment; your [2]gentle abandonment to this logic, powerfully [2]realizes the full [3]extent of your salvation from the dictates of the soul ruled realm. *(Again, a word only James uses, ἔμφυτος [1]**emphutos** impregnated. The words, [2]**en prauteti** - in gentleness are used in contrast to **orgay**. Rescuing you from negative thought patterns and depressing emotional traits! The verb σωσαι [3]**soosai** is the Aorist Infinitive tense, which presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end.)*

James 1:22 Give the mirror-word your [1]undivided attention; do not underestimate yourself. [3]Make the calculation. There can only be one logical conclusion: your authentic origin is mirrored in the word. You are God's poem; [2]let his voice make poetry of your life! *(The word, [1]**akroate**, means intent listening. James is not promoting the doing of the law of works; he is defining the law of perfect liberty.*

Doing the word begins with your undivided attention to the face of your birth. [2]A doer of the Word, ***poetes****, means poet. Make the calculation, [3]****paralogizomai****, from* ***para****, a Preposition indicating close proximity, union, and* ***logizomai****, to reckon the logic in any calculation.)*

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing himself]* **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.**

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life** *[of their original design.]* **They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]****parakupto,*** *with mesmerized from* ***para****, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and* ***kupto****, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]****parameno****, to remain captivated under the influence of;* ***meno****, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]****eleutheria****, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

Col. 3:9 That old life was a lie, foreign to our design! Those garments of disguise are now thoroughly stripped off us in our understanding of our union with Christ in his death and resurrection. We are no longer obliged to live under the identity and rule of the robes we wore before, neither are we cheating anyone through false pretensions. *(The garments an actor would wear define his part in the play but cannot define him.)*

Col. 3:10 We stand fully identified in the new creation renewed in knowledge according to the pattern of the exact image of our Creator.

Col. 3:11 The revelation of Christ in us gives identity to the individual beyond anything anyone could ever be as a Greek or a Jew, American or African, foreigner or famous, male or female, king or pawn. From now on everyone is defined by Christ; everyone is represented in Christ. *(In seeing him not just recorded in history but revealed in us, we discover the face of our birth as in a mirror! Jas 1:18.)*

2 Cor. 5:14 The love of Christ constrains us and [1]resonates within us; leaving us with only one [2]conclusion: when Jesus died; every individual simultaneously died. In God's logic, one has died for all, [2]thus all died. *(The word, [1]**sunecho**, to press together; to squeeze; from **sun**, meaning together with and **echo**, meaning to echo; to embrace; to hold; also, to resonate. The word αρα [2]**ara**, means conclusion. Jesus didn't die 99% or for 99%. He one hundred percent died humanity's death! If Paul had to compromise the last part of verse 14 to read: "one died for all therefore only those who follow the prescriptions to qualify, have also died," then he would have had to change the first half of the verse as well! Only the **agape** of Christ can make a calculation of such enormous proportion! The religious mind would question the extremity of God's love and perhaps prefer to add a condition or two to a statement like that!)*

2 Cor. 5:15 Now if all were included in his death they were equally included in his resurrection. This unveiling of his love redefines human life! Whatever reference we could have of ourselves outside of our association with Christ is no longer relevant.

2 Cor. 5:16 Therefore, from now on, I no longer know anyone according to the flesh! I no longer see people from a human point of view! This is a radical and most defining moment! No label that could possibly previously identify someone carries any further significance! Even our pet doctrines of Christ are redefined. Whatever we knew about him historically or sentimentally is challenged by this conclusion. *(By discovering Christ from God's point of view we discover ourselves and every other human life from God's point of view! Paul sees by revelation that, what Jesus redeemed in every person, brings final closure and death to any other reasoning and judgment we may have had of ourselves or anyone else for that matter! This is Paul's **'metanoia' moment!** Note, the Greek word, **metanoia**, from **meta**, together with and νοιέω **noieō**, to perceive with the mind. It describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing.*

Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery. It has nothing in common with the Latin word ***paenitentia*** *- where the idea of penance and repentance stems from!)*

2 Cor 5:17 Now, in the light of your co-inclusion in his death and resurrection, whoever you thought you were before, in Christ you are a brand new person! The old ways of seeing yourself and everyone else are over. Acquaint yourself with the new! *(Just imagine this! Whoever a person was as a Jew, Greek, slave or freeman, Boer, Zulu, Xhosa, British, Indian, Muslim or American, Chinese, Japanese or Congolese; is now dead and gone! They all died when Jesus died! Remember we are not talking law language here! The 'If' in, "If anyone is in Christ" is not a condition, it is the conclusion of the revelation of the gospel! Mankind is in Christ by God's doing [1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4]. The verses of 2 Corinthians 5:14-16 give context to verse 17! For so long we studied verse 17 on its own and interpreted the 'if' as a condition! Paul did not say, "If anyone is in Christ," he said "THEREFORE if anyone is in Christ ..." The "therefore" immediately includes verses 14 to 16! If God's faith sees everyone in Christ in his death, then they were certainly also in Christ in his resurrection. Jesus did not reveal a "potential" you, he revealed the truth about you so that you may know the truth about yourself and be free indeed! In the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, God did not redeem a compromised replica of you; he rescued the original, blueprint you, created in his radiant mirror likeness! Any other 'self' you're trying to find or esteem will disappoint! Reckon your 'DIY-law of works-self' dead, and your redeemed self co-raised and co-seated together with Christ! This is freedom indeed! Galatians 2:19,20; Rom 6:11. See 1 Pet 1::3 We are reconnected with our original genesis through the resurrection of Jesus from the dead! This new birth endorses and celebrates the hope of the ages; God's eternal love dream concludes in life!)*

2 Cor 5:18 The idea of mankind's co-inclusion in the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ is entirely God's doing! To now realize that God has indeed brought final closure to the old and for us to see everything and everyone in this new light is to simply see what God has always known to be true about us in Christ; we are not debating human experience, opinion, or their contribution; this is exactly what God believes. In Jesus Christ, God [1]exchanged equivalent value to redeem us to himself. He went to the highest extreme in this act of reconciliation to persuade us of our original worth! This God has given us as the mandate of our ministry. *(The word,* [1]**katalasso**, *translates as reconciliation; it is a mutual exchange of equal value. This transaction was not to buy us back from "the Devil"; a thief never becomes an*

owner; it was God redeeming our minds from the lies that we believed about ourselves - reconciliation is the bold unveiling of the value of the hidden treasure in everyone! See 2 Cor 4:7 and Math 13:44.)

2 Cor 5:19 Our ministry declares that Jesus did not act independently of his Father. God was present in Christ when he reconciled the total [1]cosmos to himself. Deity and mankind embraced in him; the fallen state of mankind was deleted; their trespasses would no longer count against them! He now announces his friendship with every individual from within us! *(The incarnation did not separate the Father from the Son and the Spirit. In him dwells the fullness of God in a human body. Col 2:9. As a human person, Jesus felt the agony of fallen mankind on the cross when he echoed Psalm 22, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me! Why are you so far from helping me, from the words of my groaning?" But then in verse 24, David declares triumphantly: "He has not despised or abhorred the affliction of the afflicted; and he has not hid his face from him, but has heard, when he cried to him." The word, [1]kosmos in the NT refers to the entire human family.)*

2 Cor. 5:20 The voice God has in Christ he now has in us; we are God's ambassadors. Our lives exhibit the urgency of God to [1]persuade everyone to realize the reconciliation of their redeemed identity. *(The word, [1]**parakaleo**, comes from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname. In Luke 15:28, 31, His father pleaded with him, "My child, you are always with me, and all that I have is yours." "Be reconciled" could not be translated, "Become reconciled!" "Do in order to become" is the language of the Old Testament; the language of the New Testament is, "Be, because of what was done!")*

2 Cor 5:21 This is the divine exchange: he who knew no [1]sin embraced our distortion; he appeared to be without form; this was the mystery of God's prophetic [2]poetry. He was disguised in our distorted image and marred with our iniquities; he took our sorrows, our pain and our shame to his grave and [3]birthed his righteousness in us. He took our sins and we [3]became his innocence. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians*

*3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. The word, [2]**poema**, often translated "made" like in, "he was made to be sin." However, because of its context here I have translated **poema** to read prophetic poetry. As the scapegoat of the human race, he took on the distorted image of fallen mankind, he did not become a sinner, but the official representative of mankind's sin. Then Paul uses the word [3]**ginomai**, he birthed his righteousness in us since we were born anew in his resurrection from the dead. Hosea 6:2, Eph 2:5, 1 Pet 1:3.*

Isaiah 52:10 "The Lord has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations, and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God." Isaiah 52:14-15 "Just as many were astonished at you—so was he marred in his appearance, more than any human and his form beyond that of human semblance—so will he startle many nations. Kings will shut their mouths because of him; for what had not been told them, they will see and what they had not heard, they will understand." Isaiah 53:4-5 "Surely he has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows; yet we esteemed him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted. But surely he was wounded by our transgressions; he was bruised by our iniquities; the chastisement of our peace was on him and by his stripes we ourselves are healed."

*Note: He was not bruised by God but by the very mankind he was about to redeem! You may ask, "But what about Isaiah 53:10!?" [It pleased the Lord to "crush" him!] Translators of the New Revised Standard Version say in their footnotes to this verse: "Meaning of Hebrew uncertain." The Septuagint - Greek version of this verse - written between 300BC and 250BC, by 72 Hebrew scholars, with access to older manuscripts than what we have today, have rendered the Hebrew text as follows: "and the Lord desires to purify him of the plague!" Also translated, "The Lord desires to cleanse his wounds!" The word, **plege** means a wound.*

Deut. 32:5, 6 "They have corrupted themselves; they did not behave as his children, they have become a distorted generation of people, twisted out of their true pattern; they are a crooked and perverse generation."[Paul quotes this verse in Phil. 2:15.]

*Deuteronomy 32:18 "You were unmindful of the Rock that begot you and have forgotten the God who danced with you." [Hebrew, חוּל **khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21.]*

Romans 8:29 "He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned

in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the idea and invention of God." (We were born anew when he was raised from the dead! [1 Peter 1:3] His resurrection co-reveals our common genesis as well as our redeemed innocence. [Romans 4:25 and Acts 17:31, 2 Timothy 1:9] No wonder then that he is not ashamed to call us his family! We indeed share the same origin [Hebrew 2:11], and, "In him we live and move and have our being; we are indeed his offspring!" [Acts 17:28].)

Romans 8:30 Jesus reveals that mankind pre-existed in God; he defined us. He justified us and also glorified us. He redeemed our innocence and restored the glory we lost in Adam. [Romans 3:23, 24: the word, ***prohoritso****, means pre defined, like when an architect draws up a detailed plan; and the word,* kaleo*, to surname, identify by name.]*

Titus 2:11 "The grace of God shines as bright as day making the salvation of mankind undeniably visible.")

2 Tim. 1:9 He rescued the [1]integrity of our original [2]design and revealed that we have always been his own from the beginning, even [3]before time was. This has nothing to do with anything we did to qualify or disqualify ourselves. We are not talking religious good works or karma here. Jesus unveils grace to be the [4]eternal intent of God! Grace celebrates our pre-creation innocence and now declares our redeemed union with God in Christ Jesus. *(The word [1]**hagios**, means holiness, purity, integrity;* ***hagios + kaleo*** *is often translated, holy calling; [2]**kaleo** means to identify by name, to surname; [3]**pro xronos aionios**;* ***pro****, before;* ***xronos****, means a measured duration or length of time;* ***aionios****, speaks of ages. Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer; this was before calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. [**kairos** is a due, or specific moment of time.] So* ***aionios*** *spans time in dimensions that includes specific seasons or eras, but expands it all from the immediate now as the focus and zooms it out beyond boundaries without losing the "now" relevance! Jesus defines it as, "Before Abraham was, I am!" What happened to us in Christ is according to God's eternal purpose [Bread of the Presence, or Show-bread, in Greek, πρόθεσις [4]**prothesis**, pre-designed/prophetic purpose], which he has shown in every prophetic pointer and shadow; in the Hebrew tradition the showbread [**prothesis**] pointed to the true bread from heaven, the authentic word that proceeded from the mouth of God - Jesus, the*

*incarnate word - sustaining the life of our design. See Heb 9:2 The first tented area was called the Holy Place; the only light here came from the lampstand illuminating the table upon which the showbread - **prothesis** - was presented. The Hebrew word is* לחם הפנים ***lechem paniym,*** *face bread, or bread of the presence. The lampstand was a beautifully crafted golden chandelier portraying budding and blossoming almond branches. Remember that this is also what Jeremiah saw in Jer 1:12, when God said, "I am awake over my word to perform it." The same Hebrew word is used here,* שׁקד ***shaqad****, the almond was called the 'awake tree', because it blossomed first, while the other trees were still in their winter sleep. The showbread pointed towards the daily sustenance of life in the flesh as the ultimate tabernacle of God, realized in the account of Jesus with the two from Emmaus. Their hearts were burning with resonance and faith while he opened the Scriptures to them, and then around the table their eyes were opened to recognize him as the fulfillment of Scripture, their true meal incarnated: Luke 24:27-31; Mankind shall not live by bread alone, but by the authentic thought of God, the Word proceeding from his mouth, the original intent, his image and likeness incarnated, revealed and redeemed in human life.*

Titus 1:2 This is the life of the ages that was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before time or space existed. [Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity!] This life was made certain before eternal time. [BBE 1949, Bible in Basic English])

2 Tim. 1:10 Everything that grace pointed to is now realized in Jesus Christ and brought into clear view through the gospel: Jesus is what grace reveals. He took death out of the equation and re-defines life; this is good news indeed!

2 Tim. 1:11 Grace is my commission; it is my job and joy to proclaim this message and guide the nations into a full understanding of the love initiative of God.

2 Tim. 1:12 What I suffer because of this does not frighten me at all; faith has made him so [1]apparent. I am absolutely persuaded that I am safe in him. We are no longer looking for a future event, or another day, the day has come! Death is not Doomsday; nothing can interrupt what he has done! *(Greek, [1]**eido**, Latin, **video**, to see, to know.)*

Heb. 9:24 In Christ we have so much more than a type, reflected in the tabernacle

of holy places which was set up by human hands. He entered into the heavenly sphere itself, where he personally mirror-exhibits us face to face with God. *(νῦν now, ἐμφανισθῆναι to exhibit τῷ προσώπῳ τοῦ Θεοῦ in the face; immediate presence; the words, ὑπὲρ [with the Genitive case] across ἡμῶν, us; thus, he mirror-exhibits us.)*

Heb. 9:25 Neither was it necessary for him to ever repeat his sacrifice. The High Priests under the old shadow system stood proxy with substitute, animal sacrifices that had to be offered every year.

Heb. 9:26 But Jesus did not have to suffer again and again since the [1]fall of the world; the single sacrifice of himself, in the fulfillment of history, now [2]reveals how he has brought sin to nought. He was made manifest once and for all, at the [3]conclusion of the age, in order to do away with sin. *(The word, [1]**kataballo**, meaning "to fall away, to put in a lower place," instead of **themelios**, meaning "foundation" [see Eph 2:20]; thus, translated "the fall of the world," instead of "the foundation of the world." The entire "Fall" was a falling away in our minds from our true identity as image and likeness bearers of Elohim. Just like Eve, we were all deceived to believe a lie about ourselves, which is the fruit of the "I-am-not-tree". We all, like sheep, have gone astray. [Isa 53:6]) [2]God's Lamb took away the sins of the world! The word, [2]**phaneroo**, means to render apparent, to openly declare, to manifest. Here in the Perfect Passive Indicative tense, πεφανερωται which means that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. The words συντέλεια τῶν αἰώνων [3]**sunteleia toon ainoon,** at the conclusion of the age - only used here and 5 times in Matthew. Jesus is the end of the age; he is the end of the law; what he has done, now defines human life and not their performance measured under the law of works!)*

Heb. 9:27 So, every person's [1]once-off appointment with death is mirrored in the full consequence of [2]this very judgment, which Jesus now disengaged! *([1]**hapax** as in once-off; μετὰ with δὲ [1]τουτο **this** κρίσις judgment. See John 12:31 Now is the judgment of this world; this is the moment where the ruler of the world-system is [1]conclusively cast out! [John uses a double-barrel word here, ekballo ekso - completely thrown out! Thus, taken out of the equation! Luke 10:18.]The serpent's head is about to be crushed! Genesis 3:15; Colossians 2:14,15. Also, John 16:11 Then the world will be convinced that the judgment that was their due was accomplished when the ruler of this world system was judged.)*

Heb. 9:28 Thus, in this context *[of everyone's appointment with death]*, **Jesus is**

the ultimate sacrifice. What the first, shadow-dispensation merely prophetically pointed to, he fulfilled [1]once and for all, when he was [2]presented as an offering, to [3]take upon himself the sins of the [4]entire human race! Now, with sin no longer on the agenda, he appears a [6]second time, [5]out of this death, to be clearly seen in everyone's [7]whole-hearted embrace of him as Savior! *(The word, απαξ [1]**hapax** here, mirrors the same 'once-off appointment with death' in the previous verse, now concluded in Christ. The Aorist Passive Participle προσενεχθεις of [2]**prospherō**, having been presented as an offering; ἀναφέρω [3]**anapherō**, [Aorist Infinitive describes the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end] to take upon one's self as a load to be carried. The preposition εἰς **eis**, points to a final conclusion; then, τὸ πολλῶν [4]**to polloon**, the many, the mass of humanity. Now, out of this death, he appears a second time; the Preposition [5]**ek** always denotes source, **out of**. The resurrection is thus his [6]**second appearance** in this conversation! The word, δεύτερος [6]**deuteros**, the other of two.*

*[7]**In** their whole-hearted embrace of him; the Dative case also points to location "in", thus, τοις αὐτὸν ἀπεκδεχομένοις. [7]**apekdechomai**, from **apo**, away from, [that which defined one before] and **ek**, out of, source; and **dechomai**, to take into one's hands to accept whole-heartedly, to fully embrace. In his resurrection he re-appeared as the victorious Savior of the world! Sin is no longer on the agenda; the Lamb of God has taken away the sins of the world! Jesus Christ fulfilled mankind's destiny with death! [1 Cor 15:3-5, Rom 4:25, Acts 17:30, 31.]*

Many Scriptures have been translated and interpreted with only a futuristic value and have consequently neutralized many, like the Jews, to diligently wait for the Messiah still to come. The Messiah has come once and for all as Messiah. Jesus appeared again after his resurrection, and now his resurrection life in us as his body is the extension of his second appearance; God making his appeal to an already reconciled world to "be reconciled!" [Acts 3:26, 2 Cor 5:19, 20] The church continued to postpone the reality what God introduced in Christ. We are now already fully represented in his blamelessness! The traditional, "second coming doctrine" is not the context of these chapters at all! [See 1 Pet 1:10-13] The Aramaic word, ***maranatha***, מרן אתא ***maran ata***, *means, "Our Lord has come"!)*

John 12:23 Jesus, immediately understanding the prophetic significance of the moment, knew that he, the Messiah, was who all the nations were longing for and answered, "The hour is here for the Son of man to be glorified! *(Jesus studied*

Scripture as in a mirror - he knew that "in the book, it is written about me!" Haggai 2:7 and the desire of the nations shall come…See Col 1:27.)

John 12:24 Most certainly shall the single grain of wheat fall into the earth and die - if it doesn't die it remains alone - but in its death it produces much fruit.

John 12:28 "Father! Glorify your name!" And immediately there came a voice out of the heavenly realm saying, "I have glorified it, and I will glorify it again!"

John 12:31 Now is the judgment of this world, now shall the ruler of this world be cast out;

John 12:31 Now is the judgment of this world; this is the moment where the ruler of the world-system is [1]conclusively cast out! *(The serpent's head is about to be crushed! Genesis 3:15; Colossians 2:14,15. This is what the Holy Spirit will convince the world of! John 16:11. John uses a double-barrel word here,* ***ekballo ekso*** *- completely thrown out! Thus, taken out of the equation! Luke 10:18.)*

John 12:32 When I am lifted up from the earth, I will draw all judgment unto me! *(He would be lifted up on a cross, descend into the depths of our hell, then, according to the prophetic word in Hosea 6:2, after two days, the entire human race he represents, will be co-quickened and on the third day, be co-raised, out of the lowest parts of the earth and elevated to the highest heavens! Ephesians 4:8,9; see also Ephesians 2:5,6 and Colossians 3:1-3. 'All' includes all of mankind and their judgment. The subject of the sentence, as from the previous verse, is the judgment of the world - thus the primary thought here is that in his death, Jesus would draw all judgment upon himself! John 3:14; John 8:28; Act 2:33. 1 John 3:5 We have witnessed with our own eyes how, in the unveiling of the prophetic word, when he was lifted up upon the cross as the Lamb of God, he lifted up our sin and broke its dominion and rule over us! John 1:29 "Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away* ***[airo]*** *the sin of the world! The word* ***airo*** *means to lift up.")*

John 12:33 This he said to point to the way in which he would die. *(See John 19:15 - Lift him up! Lift him up! Crucify him!")*

Isa. 53:4, 5; 1 Pet. 1:10-12; Acts 17:3. The most amazing thing about God's beautiful mind is that he is mindful of us! Jesus is God's mind made up about us! The heavens declare his glory, night to night exhibits the giant solar testimony that is mathematically precise…revealing that God knew before time the exact moment he would enter our history as a man, and the exact moment the Messiah would expire on the cross!

Within the vast context of this amazing setting, we find ourselves participate in choices beyond any definition of 'karma' where we are free to partake, delay or resist the love initiative of our Maker, beckoning us. "I was ready to be found by those who did not seek me. I said, "Here am I, here am I," Isa. 65:1

Our response is not a willpower driven decision to believe! We are wired by our Lover and Maker to spontaneously awaken to love's appeal! Love awakens faith! Gal. 5:6

The attraction of the truth of the Gospel is such, that to resist or reject it, or even to remain indifferent towards it demands a deliberate effort of the will.

To respond to the wooing of his love is as instinctive as falling head-over-heels in love! We don't need to go to kissing-school do we?

The mystery that was hidden for ages and generations is now revealed, it is Christ in us. To reject or suppress this truth causes one to deceive oneself just like so many millions of humans have done and still do; unredeemed time is a wasted life in terms of living the life of your design on planet earth.

Thank God for mercy and eternity and to know that sin was judged and dealt with once and for all. What remains is for the ambassadors of the kingdom to continue to be the voice of the spirit pleading with an already reconciled world to grab the advantage now!

Every contradiction becomes an opportunity for the reinforcement and confirmation of the truth, rather than a distraction from it.

Truth realized makes of faith a fortress!

If all God wanted was Jesus then why did he redeem you? We are not merely Christ-cloned; we are individually uniquely and awesomely designed to give display to the image and likeness of our Maker within our own person, our fingerprint, our touch, our smile, our voice, our countenance. God loves you as an individual; you matter to him! He is not looking for gigabyte or terabyte space in your mind; he has redeemed your original life, body soul and spirit in seamless harmony. Now you are free to be the you that God always knew!

1 Cor. 13:12 There was a time of [1]suspense, when everything we saw was merely mirrored in the prophetic word, like in an enigma; but then *[when I became an adult in the revelation of Christ]* **I gaze face-to-face that I may know me, even as I have always been known!** *(The word, [1]**arti**, comes from **airo**, meaning to keep in suspense. "I knew you before I formed you in your mother's womb!" Jeremiah 1:5.)*

"Can a leopard change its spots? Then may you also do good who are accustomed to do evil." Jer. 13:23

The most distinct feature which defines the leopard is compared to man's inability to free himself from a foreign force that stained his identity. "How long will it be before you will be made clean?" Jer.13:27.

The very core of that which identified man as a sinner and a fallen creature is challenged in the gospel. If the gospel does not have what it takes to free mankind's authentic identity, then the gospel will remain a weak philosophy.

The question comes to Job in 4:17 "Can a man be righteous before God? Can a man be pure before his Maker?" Come on, can a leopard change its spots? *"I tell you what we do, we just hypnotise the leopard into believing that it has no spots. Let's hypnotise people into believing a fantasy about their true identity."* God's faith is not faking it!

Rom. 7:22 The real person that I am on the inside delights in the law of God. *(The law proves to be consistent with my inner make-up.)*

Rom. 7:23 There is another law though, *(foreign to my design)* **the law of sin, activating and enrolling the members of my body as weapons of war against the law of my mind. I am held captive like a prisoner of war in my own body.**

Rom. 7:24 It doesn't matter how I [1]weigh myself I just do not measure up to expectations! The situation is absolutely desperate for mankind; is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap? *(The word [1]**talaipōros** occurs only twice in the New Testament - Rom 7:24, Rev 3:17 - and both times it is translated wretched!? It has two components, **talanton**, which is the word for a scale of balance; that which is weighed, a talent [of gold]; and **poros** from **peira**, to examine closely, from peira, to pierce; a test to determine the hidden value of something.)*

Rom. 7:25 Thank God, this is exactly what he has done through Jesus Christ our Leader; he has come to our rescue! I am finally freed from this conflict between the law of my mind and the law of sin in my body. *(In the Incarnation, in a human body exactly like ours, Jesus balanced the scales! He is the true measure of the life of our design - he revealed and redeemed the image and likeness of God in us as in a mirror! See Rom 1:16,17 and 3:24 and 27.)*

Rom. 8:1 Now the decisive conclusion is this: in Christ, every bit of condemning evidence against us is cancelled. *("Who walk not after the flesh but after the spirit." This sentence was not in the original text, but later copied from verse 4. The person who*

added this most probably felt that the fact of Paul's declaration of mankind's innocence had to be made subject again to a person's conduct. Religion under the law felt more comfortable with the condition of personal contribution rather than the conclusion of what faith reveals. The "in Christ" revelation is key to God's dealing with mankind. It is the PIN-code of the Bible. [See 1 Cor 1:30 and Eph 1:4].)

Rom. 8:2 The law of the Spirit is the liberating force of life in Christ. This leaves me with no further obligation to the law of sin and death. Spirit has superseded the sin enslaved senses as the principle law of our lives. *(The law of the spirit is righteousness by faith vs the law of personal effort and self righteousness which produces condemnation and spiritual death which is the fruit of the DIY tree.)*

Rom. 8:3 The law failed to be anything more than an instruction manual; it had no power to deliver us from the strong influence of sin holding us hostage in our own bodies. God disguised himself in his Son in this very domain where sin ruled us, in flesh. The body he lived and conquered in was no different to ours. Thus sin's authority in the human body was condemned. *(Hebrews 4:15, As High Priest he fully identifies with us in the context of our frail human life. Having subjected it to close scrutiny, he proved that the human frame was master over sin. His sympathy with us is not to be seen as excusing weaknesses that are the result of a faulty design, but rather as a trophy to mankind. He is not an example for us but of us.)*

Rom. 8:4 The very righteousness promoted by the law is now realized in us. Our practical day-to-day life bears witness to spirit inspiration and not flesh domination.

Sin is singular - its symptoms are plural - its been a sonship thing from the beginning - no wonder Jesus says freedom indeed is found in the truth of our authentic and redeemed sonship - even the "other brother" in Luke 15 has the Father pleading with him, "My son you have always been with me and all that I have is yours!!" Sin is not about things you do or don't do - sin is missing out on sonship!

Confession - Chapter 20

English translations do little to help us understand what repentance truly is. Until Jerome's Latin Vulgate translation, the word ***metanoia*** was commonly used. For instance, Tertullian wrote in ١٩٨ A.D. "In Greek, *metanoia* is not a confession of sins but a change of mind." But despite this the Latin fathers begin to translate the word as "do penance" following the Roman Catholic teaching on doing penance in order to win God's favor.

In 1430, Lorenzo Valla, a Catholic theologian, began a critical study of Jerome's Latin Vulgate and Valla pointed out many mistakes that Jerome had made. Sadly, the "Vulgate-Only" crowd of Valla's day forced him to renounce many of the changes that he noted needed changing in the Vulgate including the poor translation of *metanoia*.

Confession is not telling God about the detail of your sin! It is reminding yourself of the detail of your redemption. God doesn't need the information, you do! See the context of 1 John 1:9 here...

1 John 1:1 The [1]Logos is the source; everything commences in him. The initial reports concerning him that have reached our ears, and which we indeed bore witness to with our own eyes - to the point that we became irresistibly attracted - now captivates our gaze. In him we witnessed [2]tangible life in its most articulate form. *(The Logos - the [1]Word. To touch, [2]**psallo**, to touch the string of a musical instrument, thus resonance.)*

1 John 1:2 The same life that [1]was [2]face to face with the Father from the beginning, has now dawned on us! The infinite life of the Father became visible before our eyes in a human person! *(In the beginning "was" the Word; [1]**eimi**, timeless existence, "I am". The Preposition [2]**pros** says so much more than 'with,' it suggests towards; face to face. See John 1:1&2. Also John 1:14 "Suddenly the invisible eternal Word takes on visible form! The Incarnation! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible display of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the authentic begotten Son. The glory (that Adam lost) returns in fullness! Only grace can communicate truth in such complete context!" Also John 1:18 "Until this moment God remained invisible; now the authentic begotten Son, the blueprint of mankind's design who represents the innermost being of God, the Son who is in the bosom of the Father, brings him into*

full view! He is the official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us.")

1 John 1:3 We include you in this conversation; you are the immediate audience of the logic of God! This is the Word that always was; we saw him incarnate and witnessed his language as defining our lives. In the incarnation Jesus includes mankind in the eternal friendship of the Father and the Son! This life now finds expression in an unreserved union. *(We do not invent fellowship; we are invited into the fellowship of the Father and the Son!)*

1 John 1:4 What we enjoy equally belongs to you! I am writing this for your reference, so that joy may be yours in its most complete measure. *(In all these years since the ascension of Jesus, John, now ninety years old, continues to enjoy unhindered friendship with God and desires to extend this same fellowship to everyone through this writing.)*

1 John 1:5 My conversation with you flows from the same source which illuminates this fellowship of union with the Father and the Son. This then, is the essence of the message: God is radiant light, and in him there exists not even a trace of obscurity or darkness at all. *(See James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above (where we originate from); proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda. (The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word, [1]**anouthen**, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

1 John 1:6 This is the real deal! To live a life of pretense is such a waste of time! The truth has no competition. Truth inspires the poetry of friendship in total contrast to a fake, performance-based relationship! Light is not threatened by darkness! Why say something with darkness as your reference?

1 John 1:7 We are invited to explore the dimensions of the same light that engulfs God; when we see the light in his light, fellowship ignites! In this light, we understand how the blood of Jesus Christ is the removal of every distortion and stain of sin! *(Sin **[hamartia]** is a distorted identity. From the words, **ha**, without and **meros**, form. To walk in the light as he is in the light means to see your life and*

everything that concerns you, exclusively from your Father's point of view. Ps 36:9. 1 Pet 1:18,19.)

1 John 1:8 To claim innocence by our own efforts under the law of personal performance, is to deceive ourselves and to deliberately ignore the truth. The truth about you does not mean that you now have to go into denial if you have done something wrong! *(If you've hurt or wronged someone, go to them and be reconciled! To apologize restores harmony; but the essence of confession is a conversation inspired by the revelation of the love of God demonstrated in Christ. The focus of this conversation shifts from what you did wrong, to what Jesus did right!)*

1 John 1:9 Our [1]conversation takes on a brand new dynamic when we take sides with what God believes about us! So, instead of telling God about the detail of your sin, you remind yourself about the detail of your redemption. God doesn't need the information, you do! God's faithfulness and righteousness is the basis of our [2]forgiveness and [3]cleansing from every distortion. Jesus removed every bit of condemning evidence against us! *(The word traditionally translated "confession" is the word [1]**homologeo** from **homo**, the same, and **logeo** to speak. The context of verse 7 suggests that we say what God says about us. The word translated forgiveness, or remission is the word [2]**aphiemi**, from **apo**, away from, and **hieimi** an intensive form of **eimi**, I am; thus forgiveness is in essence a restoring to your true 'I-am-ness.' The injury, insult, shame, hostility or guilt would no longer define the individual. The words, αφη **aphe**, from aphiemi [to forgive] and καθαριση [3]**katharitse**, from katharitzo, [to cleanse from every stain] are in the Aorist Subjunctive, which indicates a definite outcome that happens as a result of another stated action.)*

1 John 1:10 If we judge ourselves innocent by the law of our own works, then we make Jesus Christ, and what his word and blood communicate within us, irrelevant.*(See John 1:3-5 The Logos is the source; everything commences in him. He remains the exclusive parent reference to their genesis. There is nothing original - except the Word! His life is the light that defines our lives. [In his life, we discover the light of life.] The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. [Darkness represents mankind's ignorance of their redeemed identity and innocence [Isaiah 9:2-4, Isaiah 60:1-3, Ephesians 3:18, Colossians 1:13-15]". See also Isaiah 9:2 "The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light; those who dwelt in a land of deep darkness, on them light has dawned." A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world!)*

Heb. 10:23 Our conversation echoes God's persuasion; his faithfulness backs his promises. *(His integrity inspires our confession. "Let us hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering, for he who promised is faithful.)*

Heb. 10:24 Let us also think of creative ways by which we can influence one another to find inspired expression in doing things that benefit others. Good actions give voice and volume to the love of God. *(Let us consider how to stir up one another to love and good works." RSV.)*

Heb. 13:5 Don't give money a prominent place in your thoughts; realize that what you already have is priceless! He has said that he will never quit on you or abandon you! *[Josh 1:5.]* **This is reason enough for total and continual contentment!**

Heb. 13:6 What he said concerning us gives our confession the edge; we boldly echo Scripture, "The Lord is for me, I cannot be afraid of anything that anyone could possibly do to harm me." *(Ps 118:6.)*

In Genesis 17:4-5 God announces Abraham as the father of the masses of nations אב המון גוים, ***ab hamon goyim****; The word* המון, ***hamon****, does not express simply a large number, but the rain-like noise that emerges from a unified, seething throng of people! Abraham's identity, his name, was the echo of God's faith and his bold confession in the absence of Isaac. The name change, similar to that of Simon to Rock, reminds mankind to realize their original identity as sons of God, hewn out of the Rock [Deut 32:18, Isa 51:1,2].*

Rom. 4:20 While he had every reason to doubt the promise, he did not hesitate for a moment but instead empowered by faith confidence, he continued to communicate God's opinion. *(His name was his confession: in the Hebrew language, "Abraham"* אברהם *was not a mere familiar sounding name, but a meaningful sentence, a confession of faith-authority, against the odds. He did not become embarrassed about his name. He did not change his name to "Abe" for short, when there seemed to be no change in his circumstances. Every time he introduced himself or someone called him by his name, it was a bold declaration and repetition of God's promise, calling things that were not as though they were. I would imagine that Sarah spoke his name the most! In fact, every time they addressed one another they spoke the promise, "Mother of nations, kings of peoples shall come from you!" [Gen 17:5, 16]. Abraham, "the father of the multitudes.")*

Don't gossip the past! It's over! Gossip the gospel! Acquaint yourself with the new! 2

Cor 5:17 Behold, all things are new!

I am addicted to the Philemon 1:6 kind of koinonia: The acknowledging *[communication]* of every good thing that is in us in Christ, ignites the energy of faith in our fellowship with one another.

So simple!

Agree with God about you!

Here's what fires up faith and fellowship - simply acknowledge and appreciate that every divine attribute on display in Jesus Christ - is equally present in one another!

How do you know for certain that it is in you?

1 John 2:7,8 "everything that is true of him is equally true of you!"

Jesus isn't an example for you but of you!

The alternative is this: - here's what neutralizes faith and kills fellowship - communicate all the lack and the wrongs in you and others...

James, the brother of Jesus says that when we go back to the old way of seeing ourselves, we immediately forget what manner of person we are! James ch 1

Well, if we can immediately forget, we might as well stop wasting time and immediately remember!

Joy and indescribable adventure awaits you!

Such a great salvation - Chapter 21

A meaningful relationship with the Creator and our fellow humans, of tangible content and feedback was substituted for an airy-fairy philosophy of religious ritual, sentiment and dreams. Trapped in a spiritual vacuum of ignorance, we've latched on to worn-out and fading traditions of the past and vague future hopes.

A new day has dawned! Glad tidings of great joy that belongs to all people are proclaimed. This message includes all of mankind everywhere!

The Gospel reveals what God believes to be true about you.

Isa. 55:10, 11, For as the rain comes down, and the snow from heaven, and do not return there, but water the earth, and make it bring forth and bud, that it may give seed to the sower and bread to the eater, so shall my word be that goes forth from my mouth; it shall not return to me void, but it shall accomplish what I please, and it shall prosper in the thing for which I sent it. RSV

Jesus did not come to the planet to begin the Christian religion, he came to reveal and redeem the image and likeness of God in human form! He did not fail in his mandate! He returned with the full harvest of mankind's salvation!

Eph. 4:18 Mankind was darkened in their understanding, alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them, due to their hardness of heart. RSV

Acts 17:30 The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he urgently implores all people everywhere to awaken *[metanoia]* in their understanding. Entreating people to engage their thoughts with God's thoughts.

Jesus is God's thoughts packaged in human life; not as an example for us but of us! The life of our design is on exhibition in him as in a mirror!

Good News!

What makes the Gospel good tidings of great joy for all of mankind?

If what you hear does not fill you with great joy it's not good news. The best news is irrelevant if you feel excluded.

If what you hear doesn't make you feel good about life, God, yourself and others, you're not hearing good enough news!

This is the mystery of grace, God reveals us in Christ!

Titus 1:2 This is the life of the ages that was anticipated for generations; the life of our original design announced by the infallible resolve of God before time or space existed. *[Mankind's union with God is the original thought that inspired creation. There exists a greater dimension to eternity than what we are capable of defining within the confines of space and time! God's faith anticipated the exact moment of our redeemed union with him for all eternity!] This life was made certain before eternal time. [BBE 1949, Bible in Basic English])*

In the gift of Christ God fulfilled his dream and promise to redeem and restore fallen humanity to glory. Jesus reveals that God is for you; his intention is only to greatly benefit you.

Through the law of association or the law of faith as Paul calls it in Rom. 3:27, God associated mankind in Christ before the foundation of the world! Eph.1:4. Of God's doing are you in Christ...1 Cor.1:30.

"This is the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations which none of the rulers of this world understood otherwise they would never have crucified Lord of glory!" 1 Cor. 2:6, 7. They thought that Jesus died as an individual, but in the mind of God mankind died when Jesus died! Jesus did not die as the second Adam but the last Adam; He brought an end to the Adamic race!

Adam's fall is not our default setting!

2 Cor. 3:13 What we say is so unlike Moses who had to keep Israel in suspense with a veiled face; they did not realize that this arrangement would never suffice to secure their standing before God. In essence the letters on stone confirmed their death. All that they could see was the futility of the law of works; how entirely useless their best attempts would be to match the life of their design. *(In Adam all people alike stood condemned; they did not realize it until the law revealed it. In Christ all are declared innocent; yet they do not know it until the Gospel reveals it. Rom 10:17 and Rom 7:4-25.)*

2 Tim 1:9 He rescued the [1]integrity of our original [2]design and revealed that we have always been his own from the beginning, even [3]before time was. This has nothing to do with anything we did to qualify or disqualify ourselves. We are not talking religious good works or karma here. Jesus unveils grace to be the [4]eternal intent of God! Grace celebrates our pre-creation innocence and now declares our redeemed union with God in Christ Jesus. *(The word [1]**hagios**, means holiness, purity,*

*integrity; **hagios + kaleo** is often translated, holy calling; [2]**kaleo** means to identify by name, to surname; [3]**pro xronos aionios**; **pro**, before; **xronos**, means a measured duration or length of time; **aionios**, speaks of ages. Paul speaks of God's mind made up about us, before the ages, which is a concept in which eternity is divided up into various periods, the shorter of which are comprehended in the longer; this was before calendar time existed, before the creation of the galaxies and constellations. [**kairos** is a due, or specific moment of time.] So **aionios** spans time in dimensions that includes specific seasons or eras, but expands it all from the immediate now as the focus and zooms it out beyond boundaries without losing the "now" relevance! Jesus defines it as, "Before Abraham was, I am!" What happened to us in Christ is according to God's eternal purpose [Bread of the Presence, or Show-bread, in Greek, πρόθεσις [4]**prothesis**, pre-designed/prophetic purpose], which he has shown in every prophetic pointer and shadow; in the Hebrew tradition the showbread [**prothesis**] pointed to the true bread from heaven, the authentic word that proceeded from the mouth of God - Jesus, the incarnate word - sustaining the life of our design. See Heb 9:2 The first tented area was called the Holy Place; the only light here came from the lampstand illuminating the table upon which the showbread - **prothesis** - was presented. The Hebrew word is* לחם הפנים ***lechem paniym,** face bread, or bread of the presence. The lampstand was a beautifully crafted golden chandelier portraying budding and blossoming almond branches. Remember that this is also what Jeremiah saw in Jer 1:12, when God said, "I am awake over my word to perform it." The same Hebrew word is used here,* שׁקד ***shaqad**, the almond was called the 'awake tree', because it blossomed first, while the other trees were still in their winter sleep. The showbread pointed towards the daily sustenance of life in the flesh as the ultimate tabernacle of God, realized in the account of Jesus with the two from Emmaus. Their hearts were burning with resonance and faith while he opened the Scriptures to them, and then around the table their eyes were opened to recognize him as the fulfillment of Scripture, their true meal incarnated: Luke 24:27-31; Mankind shall not live by bread alone, but by the authentic thought of God, the Word proceeding from his mouth, the original intent, his image and likeness incarnated, revealed and redeemed in human life.)*

This statement defines the Gospel!

On the basis of its integrity Paul understands the love of Christ; and then makes the most powerful calculation recorded in Scripture, "if one has died for all then all have died. Therefore from now on I no longer know anyone from a human point of view!"

What God did in Christ more than 2000 years ago rescued the human race. His image and likeness in humanity was redeemed. In the Logos becoming flesh, the incarnation, Jesus proved that God did not make a mistake when he made mankind.

Paul wrote Rom. 5:12-21 before any of us preached it; and at the risk of being misunderstood by the legalistic mind as he states in the next verse 6:1, shall we continue in sin so that grace may abound?

The mass of humanity deserves to hear this gospel, countless many are facing enormous crisis right now; let's live the living epistle to be known and read by all people now; uncluttered, unveiled and trust the design of the human spirit to grasp the true light that enlightens every individual.

What happened to humanity in Adam is by far surpassed by what happened to mankind in Christ!

All of mankind is equally represented and included in Christ, before anyone but God believed it. "God was in Christ when he reconciled the world to himself." 2 Cor. 5:18, 19.

This is the essence of the good news we preach. Something doesn't become true by popular vote or when someone believes it! It is already true. When I get the correct answer in math, it was already correct answer before I got it!

The next verse (2 Cor. 5:20) says, "now God pleads though us with an already reconciled world to be reconciled!" Note: not to "become reconciled", but "to be reconciled" because God already reconciled the world to himself in Christ!

Why would God plead with Mankind?

This gospel mobilizes us to be the mirror voice of every person's true redeemed identity and the integrity of their innocence.

Paul says in 2 Cor. 5:14, "The love of Christ constrains me!" Then he explains: "Because I am convinced that one has died for all, therefore all have died."

This simple calculation is the crux of the Gospel. In God's mind every human life is represented in Christ.

In Luke 15 Jesus tells how the Father pleaded with the older brother to persuade him: "My son you have always been with me and all that I have is yours!"

Rom. 1:1 Paul, [5]passionately engaged by Jesus Christ, [1]identified in him to [2]represent him. My [3]mandate and [4]message is to announce the goodness of

God to mankind. *(Mandate, the scope or horizon of my message, from* [3]***horitso****, meaning marked out. The word,* [2]***apostelo****, means an extension from him, a representative;* [5]***doulos****, means slave from* ***deo****, to be bound or knitted together like a husband and wife;* [1]***kletos*** *comes from* ***kaleo****, meaning called, to identify by name, to surname; and* [4]***eu + angellion****, means well done announcement, good news, the official announcement of God's goodness.)*

Rom. 1:2 This message is what the Scriptures are all about. It remains the central prophetic theme and content of inspired writing.

Rom. 1:6 In Jesus Christ you individually discover [1]who you are. *(The word,* [1]***kaleo****, means to call by name, to surname.)*

Rom. 1:14 I am so convinced of everyone's inclusion; I am [2]indebted both to the Greeks as well as those many [1]foreigners whose languages we do not even understand. I owe this message to everyone, it is not a matter of how literate and educated people are; the illiterate are equally included in the benefit of the Good News. *(The word,* [1]***barbaros****, means one who speaks a strange and foreign language;* [2]***opheiletes****, means to be indebted, obliges one to return something to someone that belongs to him or her in the first place.)*

Rom. 1:15 Because of this compelling urgency I am so keen to preach to you Romans also.

Rom. 1:16 I have no shame about sharing the Good News of Christ with anyone; the powerful rescuing act of God persuades both Jew and Gentile alike.

Rom. 1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of [1]God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness reveals the life of our design. "Righteousness by his *(God's)* **faith defines life."** *(See my commentary note on Rom. 1:17 in chapter 3 The Romance of the Ages, page 33.)*

Ignorance is humanity's biggest enemy.

Hos. 4:6 "My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge."

"We ourselves were once foolish..." Titus 3:2-4.

The law reveals how exceedingly sinful mankind became in Adam; the gospel reveals how exceedingly righteous that same mankind became in Christ.

We didn't know sin until the law revealed it; in the same way we do not know

righteousness until the gospel reveals it.

Rom. 7:8 But the commandment triggered sin into action, suddenly an array of sinful appetites were awakened in me. The law broke sin's dormancy.

Rom. 7:9 Without the law I was alive; the law was introduced, sin revived and I died.

Rom. 7:10 Instead of being my guide to life, the commandment proved to be a death sentence.

Rom. 7:11 Sin took advantage of the law and employed the commandment to seduce and murder me.

In the light of the New Testament this would translate to "I was once dead apart from the gospel, but when the good news came to me, righteousness revived and now I live!

Rom. 5:18 The conclusion is clear: if one offence condemns the entire human race; then in principle, the righteousness of one vindicates the entire human race. *(Phillips translation: "We see then, that as one act of sin exposed the whole race of humanity to condemnation, so one act of perfect righteousness presents all humanity freely acquitted in the sight of God!")*

Rom. 5:19 The disobedience of the one [1]exhibits mankind as sinners; the obedience of another exhibits mankind as righteous. *(The word, [1]**kathistemi**, means to cause to be, to set up, to exhibit. We were not made sinners by our own disobedience; neither were we made righteous by our own obedience.)*

Rom. 5:20 The presence of the law made no difference, instead it merely highlighted the offence; but where sin increased, grace superseded it.

So again, why does God plead through us with mankind? Because "he desires to show more convincingly to the heirs of the promise the unchangeable character of his purpose." Heb. 6:17 RSV

Heb. 6:16 It is common practice in human affairs to evoke a higher authority under oath in order to add weight to any agreement between parties, thereby [1]silencing any possibility of quibbling. *(The word [1]**peras**, means the end of all dispute; the point beyond which one cannot go.)*

Heb. 6:17 In the same context we are confronted with God's eagerness to go to the last extreme in his dealing with us as heirs of his promise, and to cancel out all possible grounds for doubt or dispute. In order to persuade us of the

unalterable character and finality of his resolve, he [1]confined himself to an oath. The promise which already belongs to us by heritage is now also [1]confirmed under oath. *(The word [1]**mesiteo** is used, interposed or mediated. Compare **mesites**, mediator, from **mesos**, midst. In the incarnation, God has positioned himself in the midst, of his creation. See Galatians 3:20 With Abraham there was no middleman; it was just God! [The Mosaic law spoke the language of "the fallen mind" and required mediators - the Levitical priesthood - because it was an arrangement whereby mankind had a part and God had a part. Mankind's part was to obey the commandments and God's part was to bless. God's covenant with Abraham was a grace covenant pointing to the man Jesus Christ, in whom God himself would fulfil mankind's part and therefore needed no mediator apart from himself.*

In the incarnation Jesus fulfills both the proposal and the "I do!" M. Perez]

The Word is the promise; the Incarnate, crucified and risen Christ is the proof. He desires to show more convincingly to the heirs of the promise the unchangeable character of his purpose. RSV .

Mankind was not redeemed from the Devil; a thief never becomes an owner; neither did Jesus do what he did to change his Father's mind about us! It was our minds that needed persuasion! God was not to be reconciled to his creation; God was in Christ when he reconciled the world to himself! 2 Corinthians 5:18-20.)

Effortless believing - Chapter 22

If believing isn't effortless, then it's "make-belief"!

Faith is easy!

We sometimes interpret, "to walk by faith and not by sight" as a very difficult, almost unnatural walk; yet it is the very mode of our being! We are wired to believe! We are faith creatures in our make-up; we want to believe.

If breathing had to be the reward of my diligent study of how the lungs function, and then my constant conscious application and concentration, then we would override the ability of our design to breathe naturally and freely.

The thought of you intrigues your Maker with delight!

Faith has nothing to do with your ability to concentrate on God for at least five uninterrupted minutes; faith is a glorious awakening to the fact that your Maker is mindful of you. Yes indeed! God's mind is full of you!

Jesus is what God believes about you! Jesus is God's mind made up about the human race! Awake to your innocence, awake to oneness!

His words are kisses; his kisses words. Everything about him delights me, thrills me through and through! Song of Songs 5:14,15 (The Message)

Love realized, awakens belief. It is so easy to believe, when you know that you are loved!

Gal. 5:6 Love sets faith in motion. The law presented man with choices; grace awakens belief! Willpower exhausts, love ignites! If choices could save us we would be our own Saviors! Willpower is the language of the law, love is the language of grace and it ignites faith that leads to romance; falling in love beats "making a decision to believe in love"!

So many sincere believers over the years have struggled to come to grips with the illusive victorious life and exhausted every altar call to dedicate and re-dedicate their lives at every opportunity, struggling to get "assurance".

I am convinced that it has been the result not of a lack of sincerity on either the preacher or the convert's part, but very much a case of ignorance based wrong preaching resulting in wrong believing.

Rom. 3:23 was preached, taught and printed in every tract, while we failed to

appreciate that verse 24 carries the main focus of the Gospel. The law revealed how sinful humanity was, while the Gospel proclaims how forgiven the same humanity is!

Unbelief, rooted in ignorance empowers an already defeated foe, "the god of this world blindfolds the minds of the unbelievers to keep them from seeing the light of the gospel which is the intent and blueprint opinion of God revealed in the face of a man!"

2 Cor. 4:3 If our message seems vague to anyone, it is not because we are withholding something from certain people! It is just because some are so stubborn in their efforts to uphold an outdated system that they don't see it! They are all equally found in Christ but they prefer to remain lost in the cul-de-sac language of the law!

2 Cor. 4:4 The survival and self-improvement programs of the [1]religious systems of this world veil the minds of the unbelievers; exploiting their ignorance about their true origin and their redeemed innocence. The veil of unbelief obstructs a person's view and keeps them from seeing what the light of the gospel so clearly reveals: the [2]glory of God is the image and likeness of our Maker redeemed in human form; this is what the gospel of Christ is all about. *(The god of this [1]**aion**, age, refers to the religious systems and governing structures of this world. The unbelief that neutralized Israel in the wilderness was the lie that they believed about themselves; "We are grasshoppers, and the 'enemy' is a giant beyond any proportion!" [Num 13:33, Josh 2:11, Heb 4:6.] "They failed to possess the promise due to unbelief." The blueprint [2]**doxa**, glory of God, is what Adam lost on mankind's behalf. See Eph 4:18.)*

Law encourages performance and guilt, while love energizes spontaneity and life.

"Read your Bible and pray every day" sounds like telling newlyweds to read the marriage documents and kiss every day!

So much of the typical Christian preaching and teaching reduced faith to just another set of rules and recipes demanding quality decisions, duty and discipline.

All willpower-driven energy remains trapped in a system of performance measured by success or failure, praise and guilt. It is a vicious circle.

Beginning with the sinner's prayer-formula, to the many discipleship disciplines diligently taught, we were introduced to a whirlpool of emotions that came and went with the next youth camp, seminar or visiting evangelist.

There is no record in scripture of any sinner's prayer formula used by Jesus or any

of the Apostles. Yet much of the evangelistic emphasis adopted various methods to help introduce people to Christ in the popular "repeat after me" recipe, followed by a bold, "and now you are born again!" remark, with all the forms and statistics filed for follow-up reference etc.

There is only one faith that matters, not what we believe about God, but what God believes about us!

Jesus is not another religion. Jesus is what God believes about you!

What matters most is to know how God sees us. This is what sets us free to be free indeed; we are not looking into a "make-belief, potential-me mirror", needing many make-overs and face lifts!

Our faces are unveiled to recognize ourselves in his features mirrored in us! Now we may know even as we have always been known! 1 Cor 13:12

Live your life conscious of how irreplaceably priceless you are. You host God in your skin.

Rom. 3:22 Jesus is what God believes about you! In him the righteousness of God is on display in such a way [1]that everyone may be equally persuaded about what God believes about them, regardless of who they are; there is [2]no distinction. *(The Preposition, [1]**eis**, indicates a point reached in conclusion. The Greek, **ou gar estin diastoley** means [2]there is no exception - this includes every single person, Jew and Gentile alike!)*

Rom. 3:23 Mankind is in the same boat; their [1]distorted behavior is proof of a [2]lost [3]blueprint. *(The word sin, is the word [1]**hamartia**, from **ha**, negative or without and **meros**, portion or form, thus to be without your allotted portion or without form, pointing to a disorientated, distorted, bankrupt identity; the word **meros**, is the stem of **morphe**, as in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. See Deuteronomy 32:18, "You have forgotten the Rock that begot you and have gotten out of step with the God who danced with you!" Hebrew, חול **khul**, also means to dance, as in Judges 21:21. See Romans 9:33 in the Mirror! The word [2]**hustereo**, to fall short, to be inferior, [3]**doxa**, glory, blueprint, from **dokeo**, opinion or intent.)*

Rom. 3:24 While the law proved mankind's dilemma, the grace of God announces the same mankind's redemption in Jesus Christ! Their blameless innocence is a

free gift! The gift-principle puts the idea of reward out of business! There is no exception - this belongs to every single person, Jew and Gentile alike! *(v 22)* **Mankind's righteousness is now redeemed. Jesus Christ is proof of God's grace gift; he redeemed the glory of God in human life; mankind condemned in the language of religion, is now mankind justified in the language of the gospel!** *(The man Jesus Christ proved that God did not make a mistake when they made humankind in their image and likeness! Sadly the evangelical world proclaimed verse 23 completely out of context! There is no good news in verse 23, the gospel is in verse 24! All fell short because of Adam; the same 'all' are equally declared innocent because of Christ! The law reveals what happened to mankind in Adam; grace reveals what happened to the same mankind in Christ. Their is no distinction - all have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God - now they are all justified freely as a gift through the redemption [the liberating action] of Jesus Christ!)*

Rom. 3:25 Jesus exhibits God's mercy. In his blood conciliation God's faith persuades mankind of his righteousness and the fact that he has brought closure to the historic record of their sins. *(Not by demanding a sacrifice but providing the sacrifice of himself.)* **Jesus is the unveiling of the Father's heart towards us.** *(See note to Hebrews 8:12; also 1 John 2:2.)*

Rom. 3:26 All along God [1]refused to let go of mankind. At this very moment God's act of [2]righteousness is [3]pointing them to the evidence of their innocence, with Jesus as the [4]fountainhead of faith. *(God's tolerance, [1]**anoche**, to echo upward; God continues to hear the echo of his likeness in us. See Rom 2:4. In both these verses [25+26] Paul uses the word, [3]**endeixis**, where we get the word indicate from. It is also part of the stem of the word translated, righteousness, [2]**dikaiosune**. To point out, to show, to convince with proof. Then follows, [4]**ek pisteos iesou; ek,** source or origin and **iesou** is in the Genitive case, the owner of faith is Jesus! He is both the source and substance of faith! Hebrews 11:1, 12:2 "The Incarnation means that God Himself condescended to enter into our alienated human existence, to lay hold of it, to bind it in union with Himself; and the consummation of the Incarnation in the death and resurrection means the Son of God died for all men, and so once and for all constituted men as men upon whom God had poured out His life and love, so that men are for ever laid hold of by God and affirmed in their being as His creatures. They can no more escape from His love and sink into non-being than they can constitute themselves men for whom Christ has not died. How can God go back upon the death of His dear Son? How*

can God undo the Incarnation and go back upon Himself? How can God who is Love go back upon the pouring out of His love once and for all and so cease to be Himself? That is the decisive, final thing about the whole Incarnation including the death of Christ, that it affects all men, indeed the whole of creation, for the whole of creation is now put on a new basis with God, the basis of a Love that does not withhold itself but only overflows in our unending Love. That is why creation still continues in being, and that is why man still exists, for God has not given him up, but on the contrary poured out His love upon him unreservedly once and for ever, decidedly and finally affirming man as His child, eternally confirming the creation as His own handiwork. God does not say Yes, and No, for all He has done is Yes and Amen in Christ. That applies to every man, whether he will or no. He owes his very being to Christ and belongs to Christ, and in that he belongs to Christ he has his being only from Him and in relation to Him." Thomas F. Torrance courtesy Baxter Kruger's study notes.)

Rom. 3:27 The law of faith cancels the law of works; which means there is suddenly nothing left for anyone to boast in. No one is superior to another. *(Bragging only makes sense if there is someone to compete with or impress. "While we compete with one another and compare ourselves with one another we are without understanding. [2 Corinthians 10:12]. "Through the righteousness of God we have received a faith of equal standing." [See 2 Peter 1:1 RSV] The OS (operating system) of the law of works is willpower; the OS of the law of faith is love. Galatians 5:6 Love sets faith in motion. The law presented one with choices; grace awakens belief! Willpower exhausts, love ignites! If choices could save us we would be our own Saviors! Willpower is the language of the law, love is the language of grace and it ignites faith that leads to romance; falling in love beats "making a decision to believe in love" by far! See Rom 7:19 Willpower has failed me; this is how embarrassing it is, the most diligent decision that I make to do good, disappoints.)*

Rom. 3:28 This leaves us with only one logical conclusion, mankind is justified by God's faith and not by their ability to keep the law.

Rom. 10:4 Christ is the conclusion of the law, everything the law required of mankind was fulfilled in him; he thus represents the righteousness of the human race, based upon faith *[and not personal performance].*

Rom. 10:5 Moses is the voice of the law; he says that a person's life is only justified in their doing what the law requires.

Rom. 10:6 Faith finds its voice in something much closer to a person than

their most disciplined efforts to obey the law. Faith announces that the Messiah is no longer a distant promise; neither is he reduced to a mere historic hero. He is mankind's righteousness now! The revelation of what God accomplished in Christ, births a new conversation! The old type of guess-talk has become totally irrelevant; Christ is not hiding somewhere in the realm of heaven as a future hope; so, to continue to say, "Who will ascend into heaven, to bring Christ down", makes no sense at all! *(The nearness of the Word in incarnation-language is the new conversation! The word made flesh so that all flesh may witness the glory of God reflected in the radiance of their own illuminated understanding!)*

Rom. 10:7 Faith-conversation understands the resurrection-revelation *(and mankind's co-inclusion in it! Hosea 6:2).* **The Messiah is not roaming around somewhere in the region of the dead. Someone asks, "Oh, but what about the pit? Where does the abyss fit into this? Who will descend into the abyss to bring Christ back from the dead?" This revelation takes the abyss out of the equation!** *(Those who deny the resurrection of Jesus would wish they could send someone down there and confirm their doubts, and bring back final proof that Jesus was not the Messiah. Faith announces a righteousness that reveals that mankind has indeed been co-raised together with Christ! See Eph 4:8 Scripture confirms that he arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! ["he took captivity captive"] And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he repossessed what belonged to us by design, in human form; this is his grace-gift to us! Eph 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. See Luke 9:27 You don't have to wait till you're dead to see the kingdom of God; some of you standing here with me right now, are about to dramatically witness the kingdom of God with your own eyes! [The word, ὁράω* ***horaoo****, to stare; to gaze with wonder; to encounter; to see for yourselves. Then, in the next verse, [Lk 9:28], Peter James and John join Jesus in prayer on the mountain, where his appearance is spectacularly changed by the radiance of God's glory bursting through his skin; even his clothes became dazzling white like light. Then, the voice of his Father confirms that his beloved son is the conclusion of the conversation represented in both Moses, [the law] and Elijah, [the prophets] - "Hear him!" - Jesus is the conversation of God - he is the Logos - See John 1:1,2,5,9 To go back to the very beginning, is to find the Word already present there; face to face with God. The Word is I am; God's eloquence echoes and concludes in him. The Word equals God. The beginning*

mirrors the Word face to face with God. [Nothing that is witnessed in the Word distracts from who God is. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father."] The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! At the end of his life Peter reminds us in 2 Pet 1:16 We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic appearance; with our own eyes we witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate presence of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life. 2 Pet 1:17 He was spectacularly endorsed by God the Father in the highest honor and glory. God's majestic voice announced, "This is the Son of my delight; he completely pleases me."2 Pet 1:18 For John, James, and I the prophetic word is fulfilled beyond doubt; we heard this voice loud and clear from the heavenly realm while we were with Jesus in that sacred moment on the mountain. 2 Pet 1:19 For us the appearing of the Messiah is no longer a future promise but a fulfilled reality. Now it is your turn to have more than a second-hand, hearsay testimony. Take my word as one would take a lamp at night; the day is about to dawn within you, in your own understanding. When the Morning Star appears, you no longer need the lamp; this will happen shortly on the horizon of your own hearts. 2 Pet 1:20 It is most important to understand that the prophetic word recorded in Scripture does not need our interpretation or opinion to make it valid. 2 Pet 1:21 The holy men who first spoke these words of old did not invent these thoughts, they simply voiced God's oracles as they were individually inspired by the Holy Spirit.)

Rom. 10:8 Righteousness announced by God's faith, is the authentic conversation! Here, every definition of distance in time, space, or even indifference and hostility, is cancelled. The word is no longer a distant prophetic pointer in the mouths of Moses and Elijah! They announced its destiny to be mirrored in the incarnation! "The Word is extremely close to you. It spills over from your heart and becomes dynamic conversation in your mouth!" *(Deut 30:11-14.)* We publicly announce this message, since we are convinced that it belongs to everyone. *(Lxx Greek OT - ἔστιν σου ἐγγὺς τὸ ῥῆμα σφόδρα **[extremely near]** ἐν τῷ στόματί **[in your mouth]** σου καὶ ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ σου **[in your heart]** καὶ ἐν ταῖς χερσίν σου **[in your hands!]**)*

Rom. 10:9 Now your salvation is realized! Your own [1]words echo God's voice. The unveiling of the masterful act of Jesus forms the words in your mouth, inspired by the conviction in your heart that God indeed raised him from the dead. *(In his resurrection, God co-raised us [Hosea 6:2]. His resurrection declares our innocence*

*[Rom 4:25]. Salvation is not reduced to a recipe or a "sinners prayer" formula; it is the spontaneous inevitable conversation of a persuaded heart! To confess, [1]**homologeo, homo,** the same thing + **logeo**, to say.)*

Rom. 10:10 This is where believing happens spontaneously, in the heart! The revelation of mankind's redeemed righteousness ignites a new conversation, announcing salvation. *(The word **pisteuetai** is the Impersonal construction, "it is believed"; believing takes place! [Present Passive Indicative of **pisteuō**] Faith is not something we "do" - faith is what happens to us when we realize what God has done for us! Isa. 26:12 O LORD, you have wrought for us all our works. RSV. "Of God's doing are we in Christ!" 1 Cor. 1:30. He restored us to blameless innocence! It is impossible not to boldly announce news of such global consequence [Isa 40:9])*

Rom. 10:11 Scripture declares that, whosoever believes in Christ *[to be the fulfillment of the promise of God to redeem mankind],* **will [1]not be ashamed**. *(See Isa 28:16. These two Hebrew words, חוּשׁ **chush**, to make haste, and [Isa 49:23] בּוֹשׁ bush, to be[1] ashamed, look and sound very similar and were obviously confused in some translations—the Septuagint [LXX], was the text that Paul was familiar with and there the Greek word, καταισχύνω **kataischunō** to be ashamed; thus, it was clearly translated from the word בּוֹשׁ **bush.**)*

Rom. 10:12 Nothing distinguishes the Jew from the Greek when it comes to the generosity of God. He responds with equal benevolence to everyone who sees themselves identified in him. *(They realize that God defines them and not their cultural identity.)*

Rom. 10:13 Salvation is to understand that every person's [1]true identity is revealed in Christ. *(Whosoever shall [1]call upon the Name of the Lord shall be saved; [1]**epikaleomai,** to entitle; to identify by name, to surname.)*

Rom. 10:14 How is it possible to convince people of [1]their identity in him while they do not believe that he represents them? How will they believe if they remain ignorant about who they really are? How will they understand if the Good News of their inclusion is not announced? *(The word, [1]**epikaleomai**, traditionally translates as "to call upon," from **kaleo**, which literary means to surname, or to identify by name. This is also the stem in **Ekklesia**, with **ek** being a Preposition that denotes origin, and **kaleo**. In the context of Matthew 16 where Jesus introduces this word, he reveals that the son of man is indeed the son of God, "I say to you Simon, son of Jonah, you are **Petros** [Rock] and upon this **petra** I will build my **Ekklesia**!" [See note on Rom 9:33].)*

Rom. 10:15 What gives someone the urgency to declare these things? It is recorded in prophetic Scripture, "How lovely on the mountains *(where the watchmen were stationed to witness the outcome of a war)* **are the feet of them leaping with the exciting news of victory. Because of their eyewitness encounter they are qualified to run with the Gospel of peace and announce the consequent glad tidings of good things that will benefit everyone."**

Rom. 10:16 It is hard to imagine that there can yet be a people who struggle to hear and understand the Good News. Isaiah says, "Lord, who has believed our report?"

Rom. 10:17 So, [1]this faith is [2]sourced in discerned hearing; the kind of hearing that recognizes the authentic unveiling of Christ as the [2]fountainhead of faith. *(Note, [1]**this faith**; see 2 Cor. 13:5, also, Eph 4:5. There is only one faith that matters - not what we, or a million others believe, but what God believes! Jesus is what God believes about you-manity! We are God's audience; Jesus is God's language! The Greek, [2]**ek**, is a Preposition that denotes source or origin; thus, faith emerges out of the word that reveals Christ. Hearing this dynamic message, both in the mouths of the prophets and now unveiled in the incarnate Christ - the anointed Messiah - ignites persuasion!*

*The word [rhema] of "Christ", **not**, "of God" appears in the best manuscripts. It's not the mere quoting of the Scriptures that brings faith! It is the unveiling of Christ within, that does! See Luke 24:27 And beginning with Moses and all the prophets, he interpreted to them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself. They later testified, "Did not our hearts ignite within us while he explained the Scriptures to us?")*

Rom. 10:18 Has God not given mankind a fair chance to hear? Psalm 19 says, "His words touch the entire world like the rays of the sun; nothing is hid from its heat; yes, truly their resonance resounded in all the earth, and their voice unto the ends of the earth." *(Rom 1:19 God is not a stranger to anyone; whatever can be known of God is [1]manifest in man. God has revealed it in the very core of their being which bears witness within their own conscience! [Note Rom 2:14 & 15 For even a pagan's natural instinct will confirm the law to be present in their conscience and though they have never even heard about Jewish laws. Thus they prove to be a law unto themselves. The law is so much more than a mere written code; its presence in human conscience even in the absence of the written instruction is obvious. See also 2 Corinthians 4:4 & 7 and Colossians 1:27. Blindfold-mode does not remove the treasure from where it was hidden*

*all along! Every time we love, encounter joy, or experience beauty, a hint of the nature of our Maker reflects within us; even in the experience of the unbeliever. In the incarnation Jesus unveils God's likeness, not his "otherness", in human form as in a mirror! The word [1]**phaneros** from **phaino**, means to shine like light. Colossians 2:9,10 "It is in Christ that God finds an accurate and complete expression of himself, in a human body! Jesus mirrors our completeness." While the expanse cannot measure or define God, his exact likeness is displayed in human form. Jesus proves that human life is tailor-made for God! See also Ephesians 4:8 And James 3:9 We can say beautiful things about God the Father but with the same mouth curse a fellow human made in his mirror likeness. The point is not what the person did to deserve the insult! The point is that people are image and likeness bearers of God by design!]*

Rom 1:20 God is on display in creation; the very fabric of visible cosmos appeals to reason. It clearly bears witness to the ever present sustaining power and intelligence of the invisible God, leaving mankind without any valid excuse to ignore him. [Psalm 19:1-4, "God's glory is on tour in the skies, God-craft on exhibit across the horizon. Madame Day holds classes every morning, Professor Night lectures each evening. Their words aren't heard, their voices aren't recorded, But their silence fills the earth: unspoken truth is spoken everywhere." — The Message.])

Rom. 10:19 I cannot understand how Israel could be so blind as to miss the Messiah in their midst. First it was Moses who predicted that God would provoke them to jealousy with a mass of people who are the nobodies in their estimation; a seemingly senseless bunch of people will steal the show to the disgust of Israel. *("They have stirred me to jealousy with what is no god; they have provoked me with their idols. So I will stir them to jealousy with those who are no people; I will provoke them with a foolish nation." [Deut 32:21 RSV].)*

Rom. 10:20 Then Isaiah in no uncertain terms hears God say, "I was stumbled upon by them who did not even bother to seek me, I became obvious to a people who did not pursue me."

Rom. 10:21 "Yet My hands were continually hovering over Israel in broad daylight beckoning them, while their [1]unbelief and negative and [2]contradictory conversation caused them to blatantly ignore me." *(The word, [1]**apetheo**, [apathy] means refusal to believe; and [2]**antilego** means contradictory conversation. See Isa 65:1 I was ready to be sought by those who did not ask for me; I was ready to be found by those who did not seek me. I said, "Here am I, here am I," [mirror-language] to a nation*

that did not call on my name.

Isa 65:2 I spread out my hands all the day to a rebellious people, who walk in a way that is not good, following their own devices.)

In Christ God has overlooked the times of ignorance, as Paul says to the Greek philosophers in Acts 17, "God now urges all people everywhere on the planet, to 'repent', to metanoia! Thus, to awaken in their minds to that which is true. The word, metanoia is a re-alignment of one's reasoning; it is a gathering of one's thoughts; a co-knowing. Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery. It has nothing in common with the Latin word ***paenitentia*** - where the idea of penance and repentance stems from!

Rom. 4:25 Our sins [1]resulted in his death; his resurrection is [1]proof of our righteousness. Here is the equation: He was handed over [1]because of our [2]short fallings *[our fallen mindset]*; **he was raised [1]because we were declared righteous! His resurrection is the official receipt to our acquittal.** *(This is one of the most important statements in the entire Bible. His cross = our sins, his resurrection = our innocence! His death brought closure to our short fallings; his resurrection is proof of our redeemed righteousness. Why was Jesus handed over to die? Because of, [1]**dia**, our transgressions. Why was he raised from the dead? Because of, [1]**dia**, our righteousness! His resurrection reveals our righteousness! If mankind was still guilty after Jesus died, his resurrection would be irrelevant! This explains Acts 10:28 and 2 Corinthians 5:14 and 16.*

See Young's Literal Translation, Rom. 4:25 "who was delivered up because of our offences, and was raised up because of our being declared righteous."

*The word [2]**parapiptō** has two components, **para**, closest possible proximity of union, and **piptō**, to descend from a higher place to a lower; to fall; to be thrust down; from **petomai**, to fly. Thus to stop flying! Losing altitude! This speaks of mankind's short fallings, or their fallen mindset. See Col 3:1-3.*

In Acts 17:31, Paul explains to the Greek philosophers that according to the Jewish prophetic word, "God had fixed a day on which he would judge the world in righteousness by a man whom he has appointed, and of this he has given proof to all mankind by raising him from the dead." God's declaration of your redeemed innocence is his most urgent invitation to you(manity) to encounter intimate oneness!

See also 1 Peter 1:10-12 "This salvation which you now know as your own, is the theme of the prophetic thought; this is what captured the Prophets' attention for generations

and became the object of their most diligent inquiry and scrutiny. They knew all along that mankind's salvation was a grace revelation, sustained in their prophetic utterance! (Salvation would never be by personal achievement or a reward to willpower-driven initiative! The law of works would never replace grace!)

1 Pet 1:11 In all of their conversation there was a constant quest to determine who the Messiah would be, and exactly when this will happen. They knew with certainty that it was the spirit of Christ within them pointing prophetically and giving testimony to the sufferings of the Christ and the subsequent glory. (Whatever glory was lost in Adam, would be redeemed again in Jesus Christ!)

1 Pet 1:12 It was revealed to them that this glorious grace message that they were communicating pointed to a specific day and person beyond their own horizon and generation; they saw you in their prophetic view! This heavenly announcement had you in mind all along! They proclaimed glad tidings to you in advance, in the Holy Spirit, commissioned from heaven; the celestial shepherd-messengers themselves longed to gaze deeply into its complete fulfillment.")

Living letters of radiating life cannot be silenced!

We are not waiting for anything to still happen!

God is not indebted to anyone.

How long does it take to awaken out of religious slumber?

How long does it take for truth to dawn?

The ugly duckling was never an ugly duckling to begin with,

only a confused swan!

We were darkened in our understanding,

we have forgotten who we are!

The ends of the earth shall remember!!!

and turn to the Lord effortlessly! Psalm 22:27

How does this gospel translate into a transformed life?

Chapter 23

God's work of redeeming mankind was not a desperate effort to engage them in a lifelong struggle to gradually improve or upgrade their behavior; he rescued his image and likeness in them. The "life more abundantly" that Jesus restored them to, can only be measured by the original blueprint. John 10:10, Gen.1:26, Col. 1:13, 15, 2:9, 10.

The 'ugly duckling' did not see a potential swan reflected in the mirror! The swan saw the swan!

We have a brand new point of reference! Instead of wasting time in the wilderness of survival and striving, playing snakes and ladders and memorizing Deut 28, we awaken to throne room realities! We are seated in Christ in heavenly places to begin with!

We've wasted so much time trying to get there, when there is where we are to begin with!

Dying to the unenlightened self; the fruit of the "I am not-Tree-System; the old Adamic "law-man"; or the DIY *[Do It Yourself]* - person, takes one simple conclusion; not a life long struggle! The conclusion is in agreeing with God about you!

You don't have to waste another day of "unlearning! "Deconstruction" and "Unlearning" is easy!

You don't have to extract the drought first! Let the water deal with it and watch the space transform naturally!

Light dispels darkness effortlessly!

The gospel unveils the only worthwhile perspective to embrace: The integrity of your perfect, authentic design is redeemed!

Any perspective that still carries reference to the contradiction even under the disguise of "honesty" distracts from the revelation of the finished work of Christ. Freedom comes from knowing the truth, not from how one honestly perceives oneself! Ask the "ugly duckling"!

Faith fellowship ignites when we acknowledge every good thing that is in us, in Christ! Philemon 1:6

Someone said that we often find God in our crisis and difficult times! I agree that sometimes it takes a crisis to realize that God has never been in hiding!

But I am persuaded that it is better still, to be found in him beyond any measure of good or bad, tough or easy times, we never need to waste another day trying to `get there' when we know that we are already seated in a place of permanence! In the heart of the Father!

We are not living towards, we are living from completeness! Otherwise our suffering and not his becomes our message!

God is not a slot machine who we can manipulate with our prayers, praise or pleas, or even our personal sacrifice if we just try long and hard enough to overcome his reluctance to "bless" us!

He has already blessed us with every blessing heaven has; problem is we've distanced ourselves mentally form him by believing lies about ourselves and of him! Jesus didn't come to negotiate with God to bless us if we jump through all the hoops! He is God's mind made up about us! He mirrors the Father.

Paul writes in Philippians 4:12, I am not defined by abuse or abundance! It might be a different day and a different place, but the secret remains the same; whether I am facing a feast or a fast, a fountain or famine. *(Abundance is not a sign of God's goodness; neither is lack a sign of his absence!)*

Phil 4:13 In every situation I am strong in the one who empowers me from within to be who I am!

The truth does not set people free; Jesus said, "You will KNOW the truth and the truth will set you free!" What does he mean by this, to know the truth; the truth about what? The truth about you! Jesus is the truth about you!

Eph. 4:21 [1]Truth is defined in Jesus! It is not possible to study him in any other context; he is the incarnation; hear him resonate within you! The truth about you has its ultimate reference in Jesus. *(Lit. [1]The truth, as it is in Jesus. See 1 John 2:7,8, Whatever is true of him, is equally true of you! He did not come to introduce a new compromised set of rules; he is not an example for us but of us!)*

Eph. 4:22 Now you are free to strip off that old identity like a filthy worn-out garment. Lust corrupted you and cheated you into wearing it. *(Just like an actor who wore a cloak for a specific role he had to interpret; the fake identity is no longer appropriate!)*

Eph. 4:23 Be renewed in your innermost mind. *[Ponder the truth about you, as it is displayed in Christ; begin with the fact of your co-seatedness.]* **This will cause you to be completely re-programmed in the way you think about yourself!** *(Notice that Paul does not say, "Renew your minds!" This transformation happens in the spirit of your mind, awakened by truth on a much deeper level than a mere intellectual or academic consent. We often thought that we had to get information to drop from the head to the heart; but it is the other way around! Jesus says in John 7:37, "When you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, then you will discover that you are what I am all about, and rivers of living waters will gush out of your innermost being! The spirit of mankind was never contaminated; just like the watermark in a paper note. The lost coin never lost its original inscription and image [see also James 3:9]; it was the mind that was veiled by darkness; we were darkened in our understanding! Our thoughts were reduced to the soul realm reference, knowing ourselves, and one another merely after the flesh. Isa 55:8-11 There is nothing wrong with our design or our redemption; we were thinking wrong! In order for our thoughts to be rescued from the dominion of darkness, Jesus as the incarnate image and likeness of God, has gone into our darkest hellish nightmare, and faced our cruellest judgment and fears, and died our death! This is the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations, for our glorification! We were co-crucified, to bring absolute closure to every reference we have had of ourselves as a result of Adam's fall! And while we were dead in our sins and trespasses, God co-quickened us and co-raised us, and co-seated us in Christ! Now, we all with unveiled faces may behold the glory of the Lord as in a mirror! And be radically transformed in our thinking in order to rediscover his image and likeness fully redeemed in us!)*

Eph. 4:24 Immerse yourself into this God-shaped new person from above! You are created in the image and likeness of God. This is what righteousness and true holiness are all about.

Eph. 4:25 Faking it and lying to one another was part of the old life; now truth remains the constant inspiration in your every conversation. We are related to one another like different parts in the same body. *(Which means that cheating one another would be cheating yourself! Truth only finds context in Christ [v 21].)*

Eph. 4:26 Even if you think you have a valid excuse, do not let anger dominate your day! If you don't deal with it immediately *[in the light of the likeness of Christ in you]* **the sun sets for you and your day becomes one of lost opportunity where darkness employs anger to snare you into sin.**

Eph. 4:27 Any sin that you tolerate is an open invitation to the Devil. Do not give him a platform to operate from.

Eph. 4:28 If you were a thief before, you are one no more. Find an honest job where the fruit of your labor can be a blessing to others!

Eph. 4:29 Instead of cheap talk, your mouth is now a fountain of grace, giving encouragement and inspiration to everyone within earshot.

Eph. 4:30 The Holy Spirit is your signet ring from God to confirm that you are redeemed to live your life in the light of day; any conduct that belongs to the night grieves him.

Eph. 4:31 Take up the strongest possible position against every form of distorted behavior in your own life. Do not allow yourself to be spiteful; outbursts of violent emotion and rage do not become you. You don't have to shout in order to make your point. People must feel safe in your conversation; therefore, slander and hurtful words *[blasphemy]* **are out!**

Eph. 4:32 Be inspired by kindness and compassion; your forgiving one another when you might feel irritated and frustrated demonstrates the way God graciously treated us in Christ.

The culmination of the gospel, according to John, is summed up in the following verses:

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and the Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

1 John 2:7 My beloved family, I know that the words I write to you here may not immediately remind you of the [1]precepts of Moses; this does not mean that it is a new [1]doctrine, it is the ancient [1]conversation that [2]echoes God's voice prophetically! It is indeed the very [1]conclusion of the word, which you have heard from the beginning! *(The word [1]**entole** is often translated commandment or precept;*

this word has two components: ***en****, in and* ***telos****, from* ***tello****, to set out for a definite point or goal; properly the point aimed at as a limit, that is, by implication, the conclusion of an act or state, the result; the ultimate or prophetic purpose. Strong's 5056. The word,* [2]***echo****, to hold, like sound is held in an echo; to resonate.)*

1 John 2:8 And yet it is a glorious [1]new [2]message that I am writing to you! You may ask, "How can that which is old, also be new?" Herein is the secret of its newness: whatever is true of Jesus is equally true of you! The days of the [3]dominance of darkness as a reference to human life, are over! The true light surely shines with [4]bold certainty and illuminates your life, as it is unveiled in Christ. *(The word* [1]***kainos*** *means, fresh, recent, unused, unworn, of a new kind, unprecedented, novel, uncommon. The freshness of this encounter is celebrated in a fellowship of exactly the same oneness enjoyed between the Father and the Son! Again the word* [2]***entole*** *is used, precept or teaching. The word* [3]***parago*** *from para, close proximity and* ***agoo****, to lead; thus darkness will no longer lead you into its sway. The word* [4]***ede****, even now: - already, by this time; from* ***ē*** *[pronounced ay] an adverb of confirmation; assuredly: - surely; and* ***dē*** *[pronounced day] which is a particle of emphasis or explicitness; now, then, etc.: - also, and, doubtless, now, therefore.)*

1 John 5:19 We know that we have our origin in God; yet the whole world [1]lies trapped in the blindfold-mode of a lost identity; intoxicated by the poneros system of a futile mentality of hardships labors and annoyances! *(The word* ***keimai*** *means to lie prostrate, outstretched; buried.)*

1 John 5:20 This is what has become distinctly clear to us: the [1]coming of the Son of God is God's mission accomplished! He is the incarnate Christ. The moment all of Scripture pointed to has arrived! The Son is [1]present! In him God has given us the greatest gift, [2]a mind whereby we may know him who is true; and in the same knowing, to find ourselves there in him who is true! Mankind is fully included and located in him, in his Son Jesus Christ; this means that whatever Jesus is as Son, we are. This is the true God; this is the life of the ages! *(The word* [1]***heko*** *means to have come, to have arrived, to be present. John uses the word* [2]***dianoian****; deep thought; with* ***dia*** *relating to the means by which we may know; a mind to know; compare metanoia, to know together with; an entwining of thought; the mind of Christ. Jesus said, you will know the truth as it is unveiled in me, and that will set you free!)*

1 John 5:21 This defeats every image of our imagination that could possibly compete with the authentic likeness of our design! Darling children, distance

yourselves from every substitute image, which is what idolatry is all about! *(The word* [1]***eidolon,*** *often translated idol, refers to image or likeness.*

Isa 40:18-21 To whom then will you liken God, or what likeness compare with him? The idol? A workman casts it, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold, and casts for it silver chains. He who is impoverished chooses for an offering wood that will not rot; he seeks out a skilful craftsman to set up an image that will not move. Have you not known? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you ***from the beginning****? Have you not understood from the foundations of the earth? Remember your beginning! You are God's idea - the Engineer of the Universe imagined you! Gen 1:26; Col 1:15; Col 2:9,10.*

Act 17:28-31 For 'In him we live and move and have our being'; as even some of your poets have said, 'For we are indeed his offspring.' Being then God's offspring, we ought not to think that the Deity is like gold, or silver, or stone, a representation by the art and imagination of human origin. The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he compels all of mankind everywhere to awaken to their redeemed identity and innocence!

Idolatry is a projection of an image of one's own making. Idolatry is the crux of religion - it is expensive business since your idol is like a slot machine at the casino! It remains hungry and it is wired to bite and bankrupt you!)

1 John 4:10 Love is not defined by our love for God, but by his love for us! It is not our response to God that attracts his attention; we have always had his undivided affection as declared in the prophetic promise and finally demonstrated in his Son's commission and work of atonement for our sins. *(See 1 John 2:2 Jesus is our at-one-ment, he has conciliated us to himself and has taken our sins and distortions out of the equation. What he has accomplished is not to be seen as something that belongs to us exclusively; the same at-one-ment includes the entire cosmos! [The word hilasmos, means to conciliate, to bring about atonement, from hileos, gracious, merciful. Also reminds of the word hilaros, cheerful, joyous, hilarious!])*

1 John 4:11 Loved Ones! If this is true about God's love for us, it is equally true of his love in us for others!

1 John 4:12 God was never visible to anyone until Jesus brought him into full view; now your love does the same! Our love for one another is evidence of God's seamless union with mankind as witnessed in his love perfected within us! *(See John 1:18 Until this moment God remained invisible to everyone; now the authentic begotten Son, [monogenes, begotten only of God] the blueprint of our design, who*

represents the innermost being of God, [the Son who is in the bosom of the father,] brings him into full view! He is the official authority qualified to announce God! He is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us.)

1 John 4:13 His own Spirit is the [1]source of this gift, of knowing that we are [2]continuously, seamlessly and very consciously present in him and he in us. *(The Preposition [1]**ek** always denotes source or origin. The word [2]**meno** means to continue to be present.)*

1 John 4:14 We bear witness to that which has [1]arrested our attention concerning the Father's intent in commissioning the Son as Savior of the world! *(John uses the word, [1]**theaomai**, to view attentively, to contemplate, to learn by looking. Realizing authentic, redeemed sonship is what rescues the world!)*

1 John 4:15 For anyone [1]to see and to say that Jesus is the Son of God is to awaken to the awareness that we are [2]continuously, seamlessly joined in oneness. *(The word [1]**homologeo**, from **homo**, the same and **lego**, to speak; thus to say the same. The word [2]**meno** means to continue to be present. Young's Literal Translation reads: God in him doth remain, and he in God. [Now God cannot remain somewhere if he was never there to begin with, neither can we!] See John 14:20.)*

1 John 4:16 And thus we have come to know and believe the love that God has unveiled within us. God is love. Love is who God is; to live in this place of conscious, constant love, is to live immersed in God and to feel perfectly at home in his indwelling. *(You're not alone and adrift in the universe; you are at home in the Father's good pleasure - Godfrey Birtill - The Wine is Alive!)*

1 John 4:17 So now, with us awakening to [1]our full inclusion in this love union, everything is perfect! Its completeness is not compromised in contradiction. Our [2]confident conversation [3]echoes this fellowship even in the face of [4]crisis; because, as he is, so are we in this world - our lives are mirrored in him. We are as blameless in this life as Jesus is! This perfect love union is the source of our confidence whenever we [5]face the scrutiny of contradiction. *(This place of seamless union is the perfection of Agape - **en toutoo teteleotai he agape meth'hemoon**; notice, the word [1]**meth'hemoon**, together with us; from meta, together with and hemoon, us; to be included in the same togetherness. The word [2]**parresia**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, and **rheo**, to pour forth; to flow freely, suggesting unreservedness in speech; bold utterance, confidence. The word, [3]**echo**, to hold, like sound is held in an echo; to resonate. The word [4]**krisis** is often translated, judgment. So,*

the [5]day of judgment, "in the face of crisis", can be translated, "facing the scrutiny of contradiction in our daily lives.")

1 John 4:18 Fear cannot co-exist in this love realm. The perfect love union that we are talking about expels fear. Fear holds on to an expectation of crisis and judgment *[which brings separation]* **and interprets it as due punishment** *[a form of karma!]* **It echoes torment and only registers in someone who does not yet realize the completeness of their love union.** *[With the Father, Son and Spirit and with one another.] (See Heb 2:15.)*

1 John 4:19 We love because he loved us first! *(We did not invent this fellowship; we are invited into the fellowship of the Father and the Son!)*

1 John 4:20 If anyone claims to love God but he cannot stand a fellow human, his love for God is fake; how is it possible to not love someone you can see with your eyes yet claim to love an invisible God? *(Love is not defined by our ability to like or dislike someone; love is a God-thing from start to finish. God cannot make his love for mankind more tangibly certain than what he did in his Son, Jesus Christ. James 3:9.)*

1 John 4:21 God's [1]conclusion on this is clear, loving him includes loving your fellow human - there is no distinction. *(The word often translated, commandment, [1]**entole**, from **en**, plus **telos**, in completeness; I have translated, conclusion.)*

Col. 3:1 See yourselves co-raised with Christ! Now ponder with persuasion the consequence of your co-inclusion in him. Relocate yourselves mentally! Engage your thoughts with throne room realities where you are co-seated with Christ in the executive authority of God's right hand.

Col. 3:2 Becoming affectionately acquainted with throne room thoughts will keep you from being distracted again by the earthly *[soul-ruled]* **realm.** *("Set your minds upon the things that are above and not upon the things below!" RSV. Whatever you face in your daily lives, acquaint yourselves with the greater reality! The things that are above! Do not engage the energy of the things that are below! Also note Romans 1:18, where the word **katecho** is used - to echo downwards is the opposite to **anoche**, to echo upward- Romans 2:4 and Romans 3:26. Also 2 Corinthians 4:18 "We are not keeping any score of what seems so obvious to the senses on the surface; it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us which has our full attention and captivates our gaze!" A renewed mind conquers the space previously occupied by worthless pursuits and habits. See my notes on Earthbound vs. Heavenly Dimension*

Realities at the end of Revelation Chapter 16.)

Col. 3:3 Your union with his death broke the association with that world; see yourselves located in a fortress where your life is hidden with Christ in God! *("In that day you will know that I am in my father, and you in me and I in you." [Jn 14:20] Occupy your mind with this new order of life; you died when Jesus died; whatever defined you before defines you no more. Christ, in whom the fullness of deity dwells, defines you now! The word, "hidden" can also be translated, secret; the secret of your life is your union with Christ in God! [See Col 2:9, 10] "Risen, then, with Christ you must lift your thoughts above where Christ now sits at the right hand of God, you must be heavenly minded; not earthly minded, you have undergone death, and your life is hidden away now with Christ in God. Christ is your life, when he is made manifest you are made manifest in his glory." — Knox Translation.)*

Col. 3:4 The unveiling of Christ, as defining our lives, [1]immediately implies that, what is evident in him, is equally mirrored in you! The exact life on exhibit in Christ is now repeated in us. We are included in the same bliss and joined-oneness with him; just as his life reveals you, your life reveals him. *(This verse was often translated to again delay the revelation of Christ to a future event! The word, [1]**otan**, often translated as "when" is better translated as "every time." Thus, "Every time Christ is revealed we are being co-revealed in his glory." According to Walter Bauer Lexicon, **otan** is often used of an action that is repeated. Paul declares our joint-glorification in Christ! We are co-revealed in the same bliss. [See 1 Cor 2:7-8, Rom 3:23-24, Rom 8:30, 2 Pet 1:3.] In him we live and move and have our being; in us he lives and moves and has his being! Acts 17:28.)*

Col. 3:5 Consider the members of your body as dead and buried towards everything related to the porn industry, sensual uncleanness, longing for forbidden things, lust and greed, which are just another form of idol worship. *(Idol worship is worshipping a distorted image of yourself!)*

3:6 These distorted expressions are in total contradiction to God's design and [1]desire for your life. *(The word [1]**orge**, associated with wrath or punishment is from **oregomai**, to stretch oneself out, to reach out, to long for, to desire. The sentence, "upon the sons of unbelief" or as the KJV translates it, "sons of disobedience", was added later in some manuscripts.)*

Col. 3:7 We were all once swept along into a lifestyle of lust and greed.

Col. 3:8 But now, because you realize that you co-died and were co-raised together

with Christ, you can flush your thoughts with truth! Permanently put these things behind you: things such as violent outbursts of rage, depression, all manner of wickedness, [1]slander and every form of irregular conversation. *(The lifelong association with sin is broken; the dominion of the character of God is revealed again in ordinary life. The word [1]**blasphemos** means any attempt to belittle someone else and to cause someone to receive a bad reputation.)*

Col. 3:9 That old life was a lie, foreign to our design! Those garments of disguise are now thoroughly stripped off us in our understanding of our union with Christ in his death and resurrection. We are no longer obliged to live under the identity and rule of the robes we wore before, neither are we cheating anyone through false pretensions. *(The garments an actor would wear define his part in the play but cannot define him.)*

Col. 3:10 We stand fully identified in the new creation renewed in knowledge according to the pattern of the exact image of our Creator.

Rom. 6:6 We perceive that our old lifestyle was co-crucified together with him; this concludes that the vehicle that accommodated sin in us, was scrapped and rendered entirely useless. Our slavery to sin has come to an end.

Rom. 6:7 If nothing else stops you from doing something wrong, death certainly does.

Rom. 6:8 Faith sees us joined in his death and alive with him in his resurrection.

Rom. 6:9 It is plain for all to see that death lost its dominion over Christ in his resurrection; he need not ever die again to prove a further point.

Rom. 6:10 His appointment with death was [1]once-off. As far as sin is concerned, he is dead. The reason for his death was to take away the sin of the world; his life now exhibits our union with the life of God. *(The Lamb of God took away the sin of the world; [1]**efapax**, once and for all, a final testimony, used of what is so done to be of perpetual validity and never needs repetition. This is the final testimony of the fact that sin's power over us is destroyed. In Hebrews 9:26, "But Jesus did not have to suffer again and again since the fall (or since the foundation) of the world; the single sacrifice of himself in the fulfillment of history now reveals how he has brought sin to nought." "Christ died once, and faced our judgment! His second appearance (in his resurrection) has nothing to do with sin, but to reveal salvation unto all who eagerly embrace him [Heb 9:28]."")*

Rom. 6:11 This reasoning is equally relevant to you. [1]Calculate the cross; there can only be one logical conclusion: he died your death; that means you died to sin, and are now alive to God. Sin-consciousness can never again feature in your future! You are in Christ Jesus; his Lordship is the authority of this union. *(We are not being presumptuous to reason that we are in Christ! "[1]Reckon yourselves therefore dead to sin" The word, [1]**logitsomai**, means to make a calculation to which there can only be one logical conclusion. [See Eph 1:4 and 1 Cor 1:30].*

"From now on, think of it this way: Sin speaks a dead language that means nothing to you; God speaks your mother tongue, and you hang on every word. You are dead to sin and alive to God. That's what Jesus did."— The Message.)

Rom. 6:12 You are under no obligation to sin; it has no further rights to dominate your dead declared body. Therefore let it not entice you to obey its lusts. *(Your union with his death broke the association with sin [Col 3:3].)*

Rom. 6:13 Do not let the members of your body lie around loose and unguarded in the vicinity of unrighteousness, where sin can seize it and use it as a destructive weapon against you; rather place yourself in [1]readiness to God, like someone resurrected from the dead and present your whole person as a weapon of righteousness. *(Thus you are reinforcing God's grace claim on mankind in Christ; [1]**paristemi**, to place in readiness, in the vicinity of.)*

Rom. 6:14 Sin was your master while the law was your measure; now grace rules. *(The law revealed your slavery to sin, now grace reveals your freedom from it.)*

Rom. 6:15 Being under grace and not under the law most certainly does not mean that you now have a license to sin.

Rom. 6:16 As much as you once gave permission to sin to trap you in its spiral of spiritual death and enslave you to its dictates, the obedience that faith ignites now, introduces a new rule, rightness with God; to this we willingly yield ourselves. *(Righteousness represents everything that God restored us to—in Christ.)*

Rom. 6:17 The content of teaching that your heart embraced has set a new [1]standard to become the [1]pattern of your life; the grace of God ended sin's dominance. *(The word, [1]**tupos**, means form, mold. The Doddrich translation translates it as, "the model of doctrine instructs you as in a mold.")*

Rom. 6:18 Sin once called the shots; now righteousness rules.

2 Pet. 1:1 I am Simon the Rock, bondman and ambassador of Jesus Christ. We

are in this together; it is not something we had to compete for, since we are equal [1]shareholders in a faith of exactly the [2]same, priceless value. This rests entirely upon the merits of the righteousness of God and our Savior Jesus Christ. *(He rescued us from the lies that we believed about ourselves. The word, [1]**lanchano**, means to be measured out beforehand; to be allocated something by allotment. This emphasizes the fact that nothing we did or determined to achieve had any influence upon God to qualify us. Faith is not something we do to persuade God; faith is what happens to us when we realize how persuaded God is about us. Salvation belongs to everyone based on exactly the same merit. God's righteousness persuades us. What God did right in Christ cancels out everything that Adam, or we did wrong! See Rom 1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness defines the life that he always had in mind for us. "Righteousness by his (God's) faith defines life." The word, ἰσότιμος [2]**isotimos**, from **isos**, means that which is similar; equal, and τιμή **timey** value, esteem, thus, reckoned as equally precious.)*

2 Pet. 1:2 God's [1]desire is that we may now increasingly be overwhelmed with grace as his divine influence within us and become fully acquainted with the awareness of our [2]oneness. The way he has always [3]known us, is realized in Jesus our Master. *(The verb [1]**plethunthein,** meaning to increase, to multiply, is in the Optative mood which expresses a wish. The word [2]**eirene,** means peace, from **eiro**, to join, to be set at one again, in carpentry it is the strongest joint, referred to as the dove-tail joint. The [3]knowledge of God is not our knowledge of him; it is God's knowledge of us! He knew us before he formed us in our mother's womb! Jer 1:5. In this context no one can ever feel ignored or neglected again.)*

2 Pet. 1:3 By his divine [1]engineering he gifted us with all that it takes to live life to the full, where our ordinary day to day lives mirror our [2]devotion and romance with our Maker. His [3]intimate knowledge of us [4]introduces us to ourselves again and [5]elevates us to a position where his [6]original intention is clearly perceived! *(I have translated the word, [1]**dunamis,** power or ability, as engineering, in this context. The word [2]**eusebeia** means devotion or worship. The word [3]**epignoseos** suggests an intimate knowledge; here it is in the Genitive case, which means God is the owner of this knowledge. Jer 1:5, 1 Cor 13:12. The word [4]**kaleo**, means to surname, I translated*

*it, "he introduced us to ourselves again", which reminds of Jesus declaring to Simon, son of Jonah his original identity and thus laying the rock-foundation in our understanding that the son of man is indeed the son of God, now celebrated in the Ekklesia, which literally means our original identity. Math 16:17,18. The word [5]**arete** from **aireo** means to elevate, to lift one's perspective; often translated, virtue. The word [6]**doxa**, often translated, glory, from **dokeo**, original intention, opinion.)*

2 Pet. 1:4 This is exactly what God always had in mind for us; everyone of his abundant and priceless promises pointed to our restored participation in our [1]godly origin! This is his gift to us! In this fellowship we have escaped the distorted influence of the corrupt cosmic virus of greed. *([1]His image and likeness is redeemed in us. The default settings are restored. We are re-booted to fully participate in the life of our design.)*

2 Pet. 1:5 Now *[in the light of what we are gifted with in Christ],* **the stage is set to display life's excellence. Explore the adventures of faith! Imagine the extreme dedication and focus of a [1]conductor of music; how he would [2]diligently [3]acquaint himself with every individual voice in the choir, as well as the contribution of every specific instrument, to follow the precise sound represented in every single note in order to give maximum credit to the original composition. This is exactly what it means to exhibit the divine character. You are the choir conductor of your own life. Familiarize yourselves with every ingredient that faith unfolds! See there how [4]elevated you are, and from within this position** *[of your co-seatedness in Christ],* **[5]enlightened perspective will dawn within you.** *(The word, [1]**epichoregeo**, comes from **epi**, a Preposition of position, over, in charge, indicating continuous influence upon, + **chorus**, choir, orchestra, or dance + **ago**, meaning to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep; thus, the conductor of music. [2]"Giving all diligence, extreme devotion." The word, [2]**spoude**, means to interest one's self immediately and most earnestly. The word, [3]**pareisphero,** means to introduce simultaneously. I translated it, to acquaint yourself with every detail of the whole. From **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, + **eisphero**, to reach inward. Before a performance, the first violinist will give the exact key of the piece to be played; now every instrument can be finely tuned to that note, in the same way the faith of God gives that exact pitch. The word, [4]**arete**, often translated, virtue,*

*comes from the word **airo**, to raise up, to elevate. Faith unfolds the secret of our joint-elevation with Jesus. See yourself seated together with Christ! Colossians 3:1-3. Now from this position of elevation we begin to see new horizons; in fact we begin to see everything differently! There is a level of understanding, [5]**gnosis**, a knowing, that can only be accessed by faith. As in Hebrews 11:3, "by faith we understand that the ages were framed by the Word of God.")*

2 Pet. 1:6 Here you will realize your inner strength and how fully competent you are to prevail in patient perseverance in the midst of any contradiction. It is from within this place of enlightened perspective that meaningful devotion and worship ignite! *(Spiritual strength exceeds mind-, muscle- or willpower by far!)*

2 Pet. 1:7 In worship you will find a genuine fondness for others. At the heart of everything that faith unfolds is [1]the agape-love of God. *(Worship and devotion includes esteeming people and honoring friendship [Jas 3:9]; the same voice that magnifies God cannot insult a person made in God's image. True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate. The word, [1]**agape**, is from **ago**, meaning to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep, and **pao**, to rest; as in Psalm 23, "he leads me besides still waters, he restores my soul; or, by the waters of reflection, my soul remembers who I am!"*

See The Message translation, " ... each dimension fitting into and developing the other.")

2 Pet. 1:8 While you diligently [1]rehearse the exact qualities of every divine attribute within you; the volume will rise with ever increasing gusto, guarding you from being ineffective and barren in your knowledge of the Christ-life, displayed with such authority and eloquence in Jesus. *("These things being in you." The word, [1]**uparcho**, translates rehearse, from **upo + archomai**, to commence or rehearse from the beginning. The word **arche**, suggests commencement or beginning.)*

2 Pet. 1:9 If anyone feels that these things are absent in his life, they are not; spiritual blindness and short-sightedness only veil them from you. This happens when one loses sight of one's innocence. *(The moment one forgets the tremendous consequence of the fact that we were cleansed from our past sins, one seems to become pre-occupied again with the immediate sense-ruled horizon, which is what short-sightedness is all about; this makes one blind to his blessings. Spiritual realities suddenly seem vague and distant. Become acquainted with your innocence! See 2 Cor. 13:5.)*

2 Pet. 1:10 Therefore I would encourage you my fellow family, to make every immediate effort to become cemented in the knowledge of our [1]original identity [2]revealed and confirmed in the logic of God. Fully engage these realities in your lifestyle, and so you will never [3]fail. *(Your original identity, [1]**kaleo**, often translated as calling, to surname, to identify by name; [2]**eklogen**, often translated as election; yet the two parts of this word, **ek**, a Preposition denoting origin or source, and **lego**, from **logos**, suggests the original word (the logic of God) as our source [Jn 1:1,14]. The word, [3]**ptaio**, means to fail, falter, or get out of tune again in the context of verse 5, literally to fall, lose height, to stop flying.)*

2 Pet. 1:11 Thus the great [1]Conductor of music will draw your life into the full volume of the harmony of the ages; the [2]royal song of our Savior Jesus Christ. *(In Colossians 2:19, "You are directly connected to Christ who like a choir conductor draws out the music in everyone like a tapestry of art that intertwines in harmony to reveal the full stature of divine inspiration," which is Christ in you. Again the word [2]**epichoregeo** is used, the choir conductor; this time, God is doing the conducting and is leading us into his harmony; [2]**eis + odos**, meaning access into the road. Yet, in this context I prefer the thought that we are led into a song, an **ode**; a ceremonious lyric poem. The form is usually marked by exalted feeling and style. The term **ode** derives from a Greek word alluding to a choir song, usually accompanied by a dance; also a poem to be sung composed for royal occasions.)*

2 Pet. 1:12 Having said all this I am sure that you can appreciate why I feel so urgent in my commitment to you to repeatedly bring these things to your attention; as indeed you have already taken your stand for the truth as it is now revealed.

2 Pet. 1:13 So while I am still in this body-suit, I take my lead from the revelation of righteousness and make it my business to thoroughly stir you until these truths become permanently molded in your memory.

2 Pet. 1:14 All the more since I know that my time in this tabernacle is almost done; our Lord Jesus Christ has prepared me for this.

2 Pet. 1:15 In the meantime, I will do whatever it takes to make it possible for you to always be able to easily recall these realities even in my absence.

2 Pet. 1:16 We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic appearance; with our own eyes we have witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate presence of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life.

(His face shone like the sun, even his raiment were radiant white. Mt 17.)

2 Pet. 1:17 He was spectacularly endorsed by God the Father in the highest honor and glory. God's majestic voice announced, "This is the Son of my delight; he completely pleases me."

2 Pet. 1:18 For John, James, and I the prophetic word is fulfilled beyond doubt; we heard this voice loud and clear from the heavenly realm while we were with Jesus in that sacred moment on the mountain.

2 Pet. 1:19 For us the appearing of the Messiah is no longer a future promise but a fulfilled reality. Now it is your turn to have more than a second-hand, hearsay testimony. Take my word as one would take a lamp at night; the day is about to dawn within you, in your own understanding. When the Morning Star appears, you no longer need the lamp; this will happen shortly on the horizon of your own hearts.

A renewed mind conquers the space previously occupied by worthless pursuits and habits.

The awakening to and engaging in Spirit dimension is not a gradual evolving into spirit awareness – it is not in any way time related – it's as immediate as one's next breath and as refreshing as plunging into a cool pool of mountain water on a hot summers day and as all-consuming as falling head over heels in love! It eclipses night and day; time and season.

Just like the earth is eclipsed by galaxies of planets, moons and stars of innumerable quantities and mind-boggling dimensions, so, the sphere of our visible world is eclipsed in Spirit dimension beyond all comparison! The "heavens" are far more spectacular in every definition, than a mere distant, geographical location, somewhere in outer space! It spans the horizons of Eternity; the ages of the ages are engulfed here and yet closer to us than our breath or thought!

Gal. 2:20 So here I am dead and alive at the same time! I'm dead to the old me I was trying to be and alive to the real me which is Christ in me! Co-crucified, now co-alive! What a glorious entanglement! I was in him in his death; now I discover that he is infused in me, in my life! For the first time, I'm free to be me in my skin, immersed in his faith in our joint-sonship! He loves me and believes in me! He is God's gift to me! *(The verb* [1]***συνεσταυρωμαι*** *from* ***sustauroō****, is in the Perfect Tense, indicating that not only was I crucified with Christ in the past, but I am existing now in*

that present condition. How can any human effort improve on this! See Hosea 6:2 and Eph 2:5 also Romans 7:6 But now we are fully released from any further association with a life directed by the rule of the law, we are dead to that which once held us captive, free to be slaves to the newness of spirit-spontaneity rather than age old religious rituals, imitating the mere face value of the written code. The moment one exchanges spontaneity with rules, the edge of romance is compromised!

*See 1 Thess 5:10 The fact that he died our death is equally valid to those who are awake to its effect or still fast asleep in their indifference to it; we are together destined to live entwined in the [1]closest possible association with him! [The word [1]**hama** is a particle of union denoting close association.])*

2 Cor. 10:3 The fact that we are living in a physical world in human bodies of flesh does not mean that we engage ourselves in a combat dictated to by the typical "tit-for-tat" strategies of religion and the politics of the day.

2 Cor. 10:4 The dynamic of our strategy is revealed in God's ability to disengage mindsets and perceptions that have held people captive in pseudo fortresses for centuries!

2 Cor. 10:5 Every lofty idea and argument positioned against God's knowledge of us, is cast down and exposed to be a mere invention of our own imagination. We [1]arrest every thought at spear point - anything that could possibly trigger an opposing threat to our redeemed identity and innocence is taken captive. The caliber of our weapon is empowered by the revelation of the ultimate consequence of the obedience of Christ. *(The obedience of Christ dwarfs the effect of the disobedience of Adam into insignificance! See Romans 5:12-21. The word **aichmalōtizō** from **aichme**, spear and **halosis**, to capture, thus, to arrest at spear point.)*

2 Cor. 10:6 Our ears are fine tuned to [1]echo the voice of [3]likeness that resonates within us. We are [2]acquainted with the articulate detail of the [4]authentic language of our origin. *(The word [1]**echo**, means to hold or embrace; the word [2]**hetoimos**, is from an old noun **heteos** (fitness) which means adjusted, ready, prepared. The word [3]**ekdikeō** from **ek**, denoting origin + **dike**, two parties finding likeness in each other. The word [4]**parakoē** from **para,** originating from, + **akouo**, to hear.)*

Phil. 4:4 Joy is not a luxury option; joy is your constant! Your union in the Lord is your permanent source of delight; so I might as well say it again, rejoice in the Lord always!

Phil. 4:5 This kind of joy empowers you to show perfect [1]courtesy towards all people! The Lord is not nearer to some than what he is to others! *(Courtesy, [1]**epieikes**, from **epi**, indicating continuous influence upon, and **eikos**, reasonable, courteous. This is exactly Paul's attitude towards the idol worshipping Greek philosophers in Acts 17:27,28. See also Titus 3:3. Your joy makes the gospel visible! Every definition of distance is cancelled!)*

Phil. 4:6 Let no anxiety about anything [1]distract you! Rather translate moments into prayerful worship, and soak your requests in gratitude before God! *(The word [1]**merimnao**, anxiety, through the idea of distraction, from **meritzo**, to divide. Your requests do not surprise God; he knows your thoughts from afar and is acquainted with all your ways; yet he delights in your conversation and childlike trust! Song of Songs 2:14; Mat 6:8.)*

Phil. 4:7 And in this place of worship and gratitude you will witness how the peace of God within you echoes the awareness of your oneness in Christ Jesus beyond the reach of any thought that could possibly unsettle you. *(uperecho)* **Just like the [1]sentry guard secures a city, watching out in advance for the first signs of any possible threat, your hearts deepest feelings and the tranquillity of your thoughts are fully guarded there.** *(This peace is not measured by external circumstances, it is residing deeply in the innermost parts of your being. We are not talking about a fragile sense of peace that can easily be disturbed; one that we have to fabricate ourselves; this is God's peace; the peace that God himself enjoys!)*

Phil. 4:8 Now let this be your conclusive [1]reasoning: consider that which is [2]true about everyone as evidenced in Christ. Live [3]overwhelmed by God's opinion of you! Acquaint yourselves with the revelation of [4]righteousness; realize God's likeness in you. Make it your business to declare mankind's redeemed [5]innocence. Think [6]friendship. Discover how [7]famous everyone is in the light of the gospel; mankind is in God's limelight! Ponder how [8]elevated you are in Christ. Study [9]stories that celebrate life. *(See Col 3:3, "Engage your thoughts with throne room realities where we are co-seated together with Christ!" The word [1]**logitsomai** suggests a logical reasoning by taking everything into account; [2]**alethes**, means that which was hidden, but is now uncovered; In Eph 3:21 Paul speaks about the truth as it is embodied in Jesus. The word overwhelmed is, [3]**semnos**, from **sebomai**, to revere, to adore. The word for righteousness is [4]**dikaios**, from **dikay**, two parties finding likeness in each other, where there is no sense of inferiority, suspicion, blame, regret or pressure*

to perform. The gospel is the revelation of the righteousness of God; it declares how God succeeded to put mankind right with him. It is about what God did right, not what Adam did wrong. See Rom 1:17. The word [5]***hagnos*** *speaks of blameless innocence. The word* [6]***prophileo,*** *is exactly what it says, pro-friendship. The English word for famous is derived from the Greek word* [7]***euphemos***, *from* ***eu***, *well done, good and* ***phemos***; *it means to be in the lime light, from* ***phao***, *to shine; Jesus said, "you are the light of the world." Just like a city set on a hill, your light cannot be hid. The word* [8]***arete***, *is often translated, virtue, from* ***airo***, *to raise up, to elevate;* [9]***epainos***, *commendable, praise worthy, from* ***epi***, *indicating continuous influence upon, and* ***ainos***, *story.)*

Phil. 4:9 These things are consistent with all that I teach and live; you can confidently practice what you hear and see in me. The peace that inevitably follows this lifestyle is more than a fuzzy feeling; this is God himself endorsing our seamless oneness.

"Why the other tree and why the temptation in the Garden?"

Chapter 24

I think the picture that we are presented with in the garden of Sabbath abundance, and of the 2 trees and the temptation, present us inevitably with the full scope of our design! We are not robots who are to simply respond to our Maker in remote control fashion.

To give ultimate context to the setting of paradise beauty, we were presented with the opportunity to consciously and spontaneously fellowship with our invisible Maker and to explore the dynamics of our own being there; and from that place of knowing that we are known we would reflect what we discover in fellowship union and intimacy in Elohim and in one another! We were designed to explore the limitless dimensions of our being as referenced in our Source.

The temptation was to follow the suggestion of an alternative idea that maybe we are not perfect by design; maybe, we thought, even Elohim knew that we are not really what they had in mind, and would therefore feel threatened by our knowledge of good and evil; maybe that is the reason they didn't want us to eat of the fruit of the "other" tree, we reasoned!

The alternative tree gives us the opportunity to engage an alternative system, whereby we have to now prove to ourselves, and to one another, as well as to our own ideas of deity (religion) that we can manage and possibly master our own being and destiny, independent of our Source!

The quest to prove my I-am-ness would now become my constant drive; instead of finding and celebrating me in fellowship with my Maker and my fellow human being, and also in my harmonious co-existence with paradise nature, I have to now strive for it in the fruit of my own efforts to become something I already am by design, perfect and esteemed.

And so we have exchanged Elohim's perfect approval of us, based on their perfect knowledge of us, for our imperfect knowledge of ourselves and of one another, proved by the inevitable evidence in our disappointment with ourselves and with one another.

The "I am not-tree-system" would continually be reinforced by feelings of shame,

guilt, inferiority and competing, which sadly brings with it every shade of hostility and frustration and the corruption that our history and societies have borne such horrid witness to.

The law expresses and confirms the existence of these systems and their dominance in societies and philosophies for many centuries.

The love of God, the Engineer of our being, demonstrated in the unveiling of our inclusion in the death, decent into hell, the resurrection and ascension of Jesus Christ, reveals that we are rescued from the lies that we have believed about ourselves, about our Maker and about one another! We are presented with a brand-new beginning! The old things have passed away! Behold, everything has become new! 2 Corinthians 5:14-21.

See also 1 Peter 1:18,19 It is clear to see that you were ransomed from the futile, fallen mindset that you inherited from your fathers, not by the currency of your own labor, represented by the fluctuating values of gold and silver, and the economy of your religious efforts; but you were redeemed with the priceless blood of Christ; he is the ultimate sacrifice; spotless and without blemish. He completes the prophetic picture! [In him God speaks the most radical scapegoat language of the law of judgment, and brings final closure to a dead and redundant system! In Psalm 40:6,7, it is clearly stated that God does not require sacrifices or offerings! Jesus is the Lamb of God! He collides victoriously with the futile sacrificial system whereby offerings are constantly made to the pseudo, moody, monster gods of our imagination! This is the scandal of the cross! God does not demand a sacrifice that would change the way he thinks about mankind; he provides the sacrifice of himself in Christ in order to forever eradicate sin-consciousness from our minds and radically change the way we think about our Maker, one another and ourselves! [Sin-consciousness is in essence a works-based consciousness.] God did not clothe Adam with the skin of an animal because of a divine need to be appeased, but because of their unconditional love for Adam; they spoke the language of Adam's own judgment: Adam, not God, was embarrassed about his nakedness. The clothing was not to make God look at Adam differently, but to make Adam feel better about himself! And ultimately it was to prophetically prepare Adam for the unveiling of the mystery of mankind's redemption in the incarnation. Here Deity would clothe themselves in human skin, in a Son; and the Lion of Judah would become the Lamb of God in order to free our minds to re-discover his image and likeness in our skin! See 1 Peter 1:2.)

Promptly engage your thoughts with the reality of your co-seatedness in Christ in the highest dominion of life, and discover there the bliss of your redeemed innocence and your eternal oneness! Colossians 3:1-4)

Genesis 3:22 does <u>not</u> say, "he has now become like one of us!" Instead it says, **"Behold, the man, who was already created like one of us, now also partook of the knowledge of evil;** *[the Greek word 'evil' is* ***poneros*** *- full of labors, hardships and annoyances - which describes the system which tries to manage the fruit of the "I am not-Tree" - I am not good enough, I am not this- or that-enough, etc etc.]* **and now, lest he puts forth his hand, and take also of the tree of life, and eat and live forever in this "lost identity" state..."** *[See note on Gen 3:24 below.]*

The original Hebrew and the most authentic versions use the Perfect Tense, היה ***hayah****, which is the Qal Stem, masculine, third person, Active, and in the Perfect form, and signifies was, not is. The Perfect Tense denotes an action which is completed in the past, but the effects of which are regarded as continuing into the present.*

The Samaritan text, the Syriac, and also the Septuagint, have the same Tense. The Greek verb, γέγονεν, is the Perfect Active Indicative Tense of ***ginomai****.*

The Hebrew word in **Genesis 3:24,** הפך ***hâpak*** is a primitive root; meaning to turn about; by implication to change, to return, to be converted, turn back. Also in the Septuagint the same thought is communicated in the Greek word, ***strephō,*** which is the strengthened from the base of ***tropay;*** to turn around or reverse: - convert, turn again, back again, to turn self about. The Sword would always point back to mankind's original identity. In Luke 15 the prodigal son returns to himself - Plato is quoted by Ackerman [Christian Element in Plato as thinking of redemption as coming to oneself!

For those facing tough times! Chapter 25

What helps me when I face difficult times is to know on a deeper level than what my senses are often aware of, that my difficulties do not define me, and that they cannot separate me from the affection of God, who is the very Source of my being.

Many people everywhere have similar and perhaps worse situations to face than what you are facing right now!

All of us face contradictions and are often tempted to give the contradiction a stronger voice than what it deserves!

What God spoke to mankind in the incarnate Christ is absolutely true for every single human life, whether we believe it or not.

The relevance of the full implication of God's love declared and demonstrated in Christ, often remains veiled to us, because our own circumstances seem to be more real.

God is not nearer to some than what he is to others; he is equally and inseparably Immanuel to every person on the planet!

Paul addresses the Greek Philosophers and reminds them of their own ancient writings and he quotes two of their well known philosophers: in 600BC Epimenedes wrote a song saying, "We live and move and have our being in God" then Aratus wrote in 300BC that we are indeed God's offspring! In this context, Paul announces that, the God whom they worship in ignorance is not far from each one of us! He is not more Immanuel to the Jew than what he is Immanuel to the Gentile!

We live simultaneously, in two different dimensions; the seen and the unseen. Technology helps us to understand that you don't need to see something to make it real! You don't see your radio-, internet or TV signal before it shows up on a compatible device!

When God calls things which are not as though they were, it is because they are! Rom. 4:17. They are more real and permanent than anything we perceive with the senses!

2 Cor 4:18...because we look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen; for the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal.

The Mirror reads: **2 Cor 4:18 We are not keeping any score of what seems so obvious**

to the senses in the natural realm, it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us that has our full attention and captivates our gaze!

Walking by faith and not by sight is not a luxury option for some; this is the life of our design! We are wired to believe!

1 Cor. 2:9 It is written: "What has been concealed for ages in a realm inaccessible to the senses; what no human eye could catch a glimpse of, nor their ear could even hear a whisper of; neither could the inquiring mind decipher the code of that mystery, which God has already [1]fully accomplished and prepared as a royal highway, [2]imprinted in the hearts of his lovers!" *(The exact detail of his plan, to rescue his image and likeness in man, was in place. How Jesus would represent mankind to die their death was the wisdom of God concealed. In the mind of God we were associated in Christ before the ages; this was according to God's eternal resolve. "The things that God has prepared" or [1]**hetoimatzo**, from the oriental custom of sending people ahead to level the roads and make them passable before a king's journey. What seemed a cul-de-sac for the flesh is a royal highway for faith.*

*The redemption of mankind was not to be the product of human philosophy or speculation. In the Hebrew text it is a quote from Isaiah 64:3 [In our English translations it is v 64] the Hebrew word [2] חכה **ghaka**, is used, which means to carve an image; to show by drawing or description, piercing, traditionally also translated as those who "wait upon the Lord." [In Ps 130:5 and also in Isa 40:31, a different word is used for those who "wait" upon the Lord, קוה **kawa** means to intertwine.] Paul writes in Greek and most probably from the Septuagint when he quotes Isaiah 64 (verse 3 in the Septuagint) and uses the phrase, "for those who love him." The Septuagint uses the word, **eleos**, tender compassion. Thus, faith opens the horizon of love's mystery. It is a place where thoughts [2]carve an impression; a place not accessible to the scrutiny of a suspicious, academic or a religious, guilt and a performance-based approach. [see 1 Cor 3:20].)*

1 Cor. 2:10 These profound mysteries of God's eternal resolve are now unveiled in us; nothing is hidden from Holy Spirit, who explores the innermost thoughts of God.

1 Cor. 2:11 Just as a person's spirit knows their own thoughts beyond the public eye, even so the Spirit of God is our faith decoder to access the thoughts of God. *(In modern technology it would be impossible to access information from a source that is not compatible with your device; or without a decoder.)*

1 Cor. 2:12 The Spirit proceeding from God unveils the gifts of his generosity. He has graced us with understanding so that we may know what he has always had in mind for us; this is so unlike the secular spirit of the wisdom of the world where everything has a price tag! *(Christ is the unveiling of the mystery of God's wisdom: now we know how God redeemed our righteousness and our wholeness in Christ. In God's economy, Christ represents us; what mankind could never achieve through personal discipline and willpower as taught in every religion, God's faith accomplished in Christ. Of his design are we in Christ; we are associated in oneness with him. Our wisdom is sourced in this union! Also our righteousness and holiness originate from him.*

Holiness equals wholeness and harmony of someone's spirit, soul and body. Our redemption is sanctioned in him. He redeemed our identity, our sanity, our health, our joy, our peace, our innocence and our complete well-being! [See note on 1 Corinthians 1:30] Secular religion is the product of the spirit of this world where everything is performance based; only the heroes of the moment are acclaimed; the rest are reduced to spectators and audience.)

1 Cor. 2:13 The impact of our words are not confined to the familiar wisdom of the world taught by human experience and tradition, but communicated by seamless spirit resonance, [1]combining spirit with spirit. *(The word **sugkrinō**, suggests a spirit compatibility; joint together fitly, compound, combine, to interpret, to compare: thus, a joining of spirit with spirit!)*

Heb. 11:1 Persuasion confirms confident expectation and proves the unseen world to be more real than the seen. Faith celebrates as certain what hope visualizes as future. *(The shadow no longer substitutes the substance. Jesus is the substance of things hoped for the evidence of everything the Prophets foretold. The unveiling of Christ in human life completes mankind's every expectation. Col 1:27.)*

Heb. 11:3 Faith alone explains what is not apparent to the natural eye; how the ages were perfectly framed by the Word of God. Now we understand that everything visible has its origin in the invisible.

2 Cor 5:2 Facing pressure times the way we often do, makes us sigh with longing to exchange the skin-suit with the permanent splendor of the heavenly-suit.

2 Cor 5:3 In the meantime, whatever challenges we are facing in the meat-box, we know that we shall never be found naked; since we are already fully clothed with our heavenly identity in Christ in our inner person!

2 Cor 5:4 We are not complaining about our bodies, even though we are often aware of its frailties; instead we yearn to be overwhelmed with life. We know that every evidence of death, even in our bodies, will dissolve into life!

2 Cor 5:5 God wired us this way; his Spirit already confirms within us the present evidence of eternity. We are eternal beings by design.

2 Cor 5:6 We are cheerfully courageous; knowing that our immediate address in our earthly bodies cannot distance us from the Lord, since we originate from him.

2 Cor 5:7 Faith is to our spirit what our senses are to our bodies; while the one engages with the fading and the fragile, the other celebrates perfection!

2 Cor 5:8 Our confidence stems from knowing that even though it might feel at times that we are merely reduced to flesh; our greater reality is that we are entwined in the Lord. He is our permanent abode! *(The word,* ***tharreo****, means confident courage;* ***eudokeo****, means well done opinion; mallon, means prefer or rather; and* ***ekdemeo****, from* ***ek****, is a Preposition that always denotes origin or source and* ***demeo*** *from* ***deo****, to bind, to wind, to tie, to knit; originating out of the body (we were knitted together in our mother's womb). In severe affliction one feels at times reduced to mere physical identity; but our persuasion is anchored in a greater opinion; the reality of our genesis in God and our union in him. The word,* ***endemeo****, means entwined, knitted together, tied in oneness. Yet at times it almost feels strange to be trapped in this body especially when we are exposed to such abuse and suffering; one longs to then do the exchange and relocate to our permanent address, where our hearts already are; in the immediate embrace of the Lord.)*

2 Cor 5:9 We are totally engaged in the loveliness of that which is of exceedingly great value; whether we are in a physical union with our bodies or a spiritual union with our source; it makes no difference to God's esteem of us! We are highly favored by the Lord. *(The word,* ***philotimeomai****, comes from* ***phileo****, meaning dear, fondness;* ***timay****, meaning value, esteem; and* ***einai*** *from* ***eimi****, I am. The word,* ***endemeo****, means in union with, entwined; and* ***ekdemeo*** *means tied to our source.)*

James 1:2 Temptations and contradictions come in different shapes, sizes, and intervals; their intention is always to suck you into their energy field. However, my friends, your joy in who you know you are [1]leads you out triumphantly every time. *(The word, [1]****hegeomai****, comes from a strengthened form of ago, to lead, thus, to officially appoint in a position of authority; to lead with distinguished authority. Joy is*

the official voice of faith! "Count it all joy," make a calculation to which joy can be the only logical conclusion.)

James 1:3 Here is the secret: joy is not something you have to fake, it is the fruit of what your faith knows to be true about you! You know that the proof of faith results in a persuasion that remains constant in contradiction.

James 1:4 *(Just like a mother hen patiently broods over her eggs,)* **steadfastness provides you with a consistent environment, and so patience prevails and proves your perfection; how entirely whole you are and without any shortfall.**

James 1:5 The only thing you could possibly lack is wisdom. *[One might sometimes feel challenged beyond the point of sanity.]* However, make your request in such a way that you draw directly from the [2]source. *[Not filtered through other opinions]* God is the origin and author of wisdom; he [1]intertwines your thoughts with good judgment. His gifts are available to all, without regret. *(The word, [1]**haplos**, from ha, particle of union; **hama**, together with + **pleko**, meaning to plait, braid, weave together. See Luke 11:34 "The eye is the lamp of the body; if the eye is "single" [entwined with light], the whole body is full of light!" Entwining our eyes with Papa's eyes is what enlightens our entire being! Which is exactly what the word קוה Kawa in Hebrew means in Isa 40:31, they that entwine with the Lord's thoughts mount up with wings like eagles! We are wired by design to entwine! Also, Matthew 6:22. See 2 Cor 1:12. Wisdom that comes from above remains unaffected by the contradictions of the senses. The word, [2]**didomi**, to give, to be the author or source of a thing — Wesley J. Perschbacher.)*

James 1:13 Do not say, "I am scrutinized by God" when you feel enticed. He is not in the teasing business; evil offers no attraction to God for God to be tempted by it, neither is he experimenting with your design! *(God cannot be both the source of light and darkness. Every temptation is an attempt of darkness to intercept light. [James 1:17])*

James 1:14 Temptation employs lust to [1]lure someone into a trap *(just like in hunting or fishing)*, **one is deceived by the attraction of the [2]bait. Your own private desires can snare you.** *(The word, [1]**exelko**, means to lure as in hunting or fishing, and [2]**deleatzo** comes from the word, **dolos**, to deceive by bait.)*

James 1:15 When passion conceives, it becomes the parent of sin. Sin's mission is to murder you.

James 1:16 My dear friends, do not go wandering off into deception. *(By giving*

credit to temptation, thinking that it could possibly be God's way of speaking to you! So what about the Lord's prayer? "Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil!" This sounds like God had temptation on today's agenda for you, but if you pray this prayer then maybe he'll change his mind! 'To lead' in this sentence is the Greek word ***eisphero****, to carry inward, to reach within; and temptation is the word* ***peiratzo****, to test through piercing, to examine closely, from* ***peira****, to pierce; a test to determine the hidden value of something; also from the word* ***peras****, which speaks of extremity or the furthest boundary. But as James clearly points out in verse 13, God is not in the teasing business. He is not the source of good and evil! The deliverance from evil,* ***poneros****, is the intent of this sentence; that hidden alignment to the law of works will not be found within me, giving evil a foothold as it were. The word* ***poneros****, translated, evil, means full of hardships, annoyances and labors! Sounds like the wrong tree to me! Rather pray, "Father, you know me inside-out! Free me thoroughly from any hidden alliance with the old system of performance based living! Remove any trace of the fruit of the "I am not-tree system".)*

James 1:17 Without exception God's [1]gifts are only good; it's perfection cannot be flawed. They come from [2]above *(where we originate from);* **proceeding like light rays from its source, the Father of lights, with whom there is no distortion, or even a shadow of shifting to obstruct, or intercept the light; nor any hint of a hidden agenda.** *(The principle of a [1]gift, puts "reward-language" out of business. The word, [1]**anouthen**, means, from above. John 3:3, 13. The Father's resolve stands in total contrast to the perverted passions of sin, claiming it's illegitimate parenthood of mankind. Js 1:2; Js 1:12-16.)*

James 1:18 It was according to the Father's delightful [1]resolve that he [2]birthed us; giving [3]authentic, incarnate expression to the Word. *[The face to face-ness of the Logos that was before time was. Jn 1:1]* **Just like the first-fruits mirror the harvest, so we mirror the [4]conclusion of his [4]workmanship in the core of our [5]being.** *(The word, [1]**boulomai**, means the affectionate desire and deliberate resolve of God. Only James uses the word, [2]**apokueō** from **apo** + **kuma**; from **kuo**, to swell with young; bend or curve. [same word in v 15, where sin's passion parented death, vs God's passion parented authentic life in us!] Truth, [3]**alethea**, from **a**, negative + **lanthano**, meaning hidden; that which is unveiled; the Word **[logos]** of truth is the [3]unveiled **logic** of God. The Preposition [4]**eis**, points to conclusion. The word, κτίσμα*

*[5]**ktisma** meaning creation with reference to the proprietorship of the manufacturer -*

*God owns the idea of our invention - he holds the copyright! The words, εἰς τὸ εἶναι ἡμᾶς ἀπαρχήν - **einai hemas** - [5]our beingness from **eimi**, I am. See Rom. 8:29, He pre-designed and engineered us from the start to be jointly fashioned in the same mold and image of his Son according to the exact blueprint of his thought. We see the original and intended pattern of our lives preserved in his Son. He is the firstborn from the same womb that reveals our genesis. He confirms that we are the invention of God. Also, John 1:1-18; 1 Pet. 2:9,10.)*

James 1:19 Consequently my beloved friends, [when you are faced with temptation,] give your immediate attention to the Word that reveals your true origin; do not ponder the contradiction. Rather remain silent, than to quickly give your vote and voice to the [1]emotions that arise in the heat of the moment! *(Quick to hear, slow to speak, slow to [1]anger. The word ὀργή [1]**orgay** from **oregomia**, means the excitement of the mind; to stretch one's self out in order to grasp something, to reach after or desire.)*

James 1:20 These outbursts of emotion would typically distort the picture, and bring no credit to compliment God's [1]righteousness. *([1]What God achieved in redeeming our identity and innocence.)*

James 1:21 Therefore, by embracing the [1]infused word, you discover how thoroughly freed you already are from any kind of perverted passion that spirals out of control, polluting your lives like a filthy garment; your [2]gentle abandonment to this logic, powerfully [2]realizes the full [3]extent of your salvation from the dictates of the soul ruled realm. *(Again, a word only James uses, ἔμφυτος [1]**emphutos** impregnated. The words, [2]**en prauteti** - in gentleness are used in contrast to **orgay**. Rescuing you from negative thought patterns and depressing emotional traits! The verb σωσαι [3]**soosai** is the Aorist Infinitive tense, which presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end.)*

James 1:22 Give the mirror-word your [1]undivided attention; do not underestimate yourself. [3]Make the calculation. There can only be one logical conclusion: your authentic origin is mirrored in the word. You are God's poem; [2]let his voice make poetry of your life! *(The word, [1]**akroate**, means intent listening. James is not promoting the doing of the law of works; he is defining the law of perfect liberty. Doing the word begins with your undivided attention to the face of your birth. [2]A doer of the Word, **poetes**, means poet. Make the calculation, [3]**paralogizomai**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, union, and **logizomai**, to reckon the logic in any*

calculation.)

James 1:23 Anyone who hears the word, sees the face of their birth, as in a mirror! The difference between a mere spectator and a participator is that both of them hear the same voice and perceive in its message the face of their own genesis reflected there;

James 1:24 they realize that they are looking at themselves, but for the one it seems just too good to be true; this person departs *[back to the old way of seeing themselves],* **and immediately forgets what manner of person they are; never giving another thought to the one they saw there in the mirror.**

James 1:25 The other is [1]mesmerized by what they see; [2]captivated by the effect of a law that frees a person from the obligation to the old written code that restricted one to their own efforts and willpower. No distraction or contradiction can dim the impact of what is seen in the mirror concerning the law of perfect [3]liberty *[the law of faith]* **that now frees one to get on with the act of living the life** *[of their original design.]* **They find a new [3]spontaneous lifestyle; the poetry of practical living.** *(The law of perfect liberty is the image and likeness of God revealed in Christ, now redeemed in human form, as in a mirror. Look deep enough into that law of faith that you may see there in its perfection a portrait that so resembles the original that he becomes distinctly visible in the spirit of your mind and in the face of every person you behold. I translated the word, [1]**parakupto,** with mesmerized from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, and **kupto**, to bend, stoop down to view at close scrutiny; [2]**parameno**, to remain captivated under the influence of; **meno**, to continue to be present. The word often translated as freedom, [3]**eleutheria**, means without obligation; spontaneous.)*

Paul's testimony is very relevant for dealing with every possible contradiction. Here, he powerfully communicates his own encounter with the thorn in the flesh:

2 Cor. 12:7 In sharp contrast to these spiritual revelations, the physical pain that I suffered and my severe discomfort momentarily distracted me. It was as if the old mindset of accusation *[Satan]* **persuaded me that this affliction was actually God's way of keeping me humble.** *(Note that it was not a messenger from God, but from Satan! The word,* ***satanas*** *means accuser! By these revelations of extreme proportions and consequence Paul understood that we are indeed co-seated together with Christ in heavenly places. In his resurrection he already elevated us beyond any claim of*

accusation. See Hosea 6:2 and Ephesians 2:5,6. We cannot get any more elevated into the bliss of our redeemed innocence than discovering our joint-seatedness with Christ in the throne room ! Colossians 3:1-3.)

2 Cor. 12:8 I almost believed this lie and even implored the Lord three times to remove the thorn from my flesh.

2 Cor. 12:9 Finally it dawned on me that grace is God's language; he doesn't speak "thorn-langauge"! He said to me, "My grace [1]elevates you, to be fully content." And now, instead of being overwhelmed with a sense of my own weakness, he overwhelms me with an awareness of his strength! Oh what [2]bliss to rejoice in the fact that in the midst of my frailties I encounter the dynamic of the grace of God to be my [3]habitation! *(The word [1]**arkeo,** content, stems from the word **airo** which means to elevate. The word [2]**hedista** from **hedeos**, means pleasure. The word [3]**episkenoo** has two components: **epi**, continuous influence upon and **skenoo**, to encamp, to reside in a tent; the noun, **skenos** reminds of the English word skin! Paul suggests that God's grace fits you like a skin! One feels most at home in the consciousness of his grace!)*

2 Cor. 12:10 I now enjoy a [1]delightfully different frame of mind when I encounter things that would normally make me feel frail, whether it be from insults or when I am in situations where [2]I'm forced to do things with my arms twisted behind my back; whether I am persecuted or feel squeezed into [3]claustrophobic spaces. Because of Christ, every time that I encounter weakness I escape into the strength of my [4]I am-ness! *(The word, [1]**eudokeo** is a compound word from, **eu**, well done, beautiful, and **dokeo**, to form an opinion. The word [2]**anagkē** to bend the arm like when your arm is locked behind your back, where your own efforts to clear or save yourself are completely neutralized. The word [3]**stenochōria**, means a narrowness of place. The word [4]**eimi**, is the verb, I am.)*

Winter – The womb of new beginnings.

I will endeavor to learn from the seasons;

That is to allow winter to run its course in my life with dignity,

Not regretting the loss of leaves.

Rather embracing the chance to gather secret strength from my roots:

A well of life that remains an invincible testimony to an inevitable turn in season.

Together with the early and the latter rain we will again celebrate the song of spring.

In your presence even the night is light. I welcome the wilderness. The winter finds me sheltered in your joy.

2 Cor 4:8 We often feel completely hemmed in on every side but our inner space remains unrestricted; when there seems to be no way out, we escape within!

Draw from your source! He is within you and closer to you than your next breath! True worship is simply living from the awareness of our unbroken oneness.

Isa 40:27 Why do you say, "My way is hid from the LORD, and my right is disregarded by my God"?

Isa 40:28 Have you not known? Have you not heard? The LORD is the everlasting God, the Creator of the ends of the earth. He does not faint or grow weary, his understanding is without limits. *(He knows you inside out! Your crisis cannot exhaust God!)*

Isa 40:29 He gives power to the faint, and to them who has no might he multiplies strength.

Isa 40:30 Even young athletes become faint and weary, and strong young men fall down exhausted;

Isa 40:31 but they who entwine their thoughts with the LORD renew their strength; they mount up with wings like eagles; they run and are not be weary, they walk and do not faint.

The performance driven system of hardships, labor and annoyances, is a cruel and relentless taskmaster!

Discover eagle wings in Kawa-mode; where God's thoughts entwine with your thoughts, and his strength ignites within.

Isaiah 40:30 and 31 basically reflect the two laws that Paul refers to in Rom 3:27, the law of works and the law of faith. The law of works is governed by willpower; the law of faith is inspired by love. While the one exhausts, the other ignites. Love awakens belief. Gal 5:6

Tapping into the well within you causes you to soar in a different dimension in the midst of routine life; it is adventure unlimited! The Hebrew word, קוה **kawa**, often translated, to wait, means to entwine, which takes "waiting on the Lord" to a most exhilarating level!

Waiting is boring; entwining is exciting!

Healing - Dr Luke Reports - Chapter 26

Luke 1:1 There has been several attempts to give an [1]accurate account of the [2]extent of that which has been fully accomplished [3]within us. *(The word, διηγησιν , **diegesin**, an accurate account; from διά, **dia** through, or because of, and ἡγέομαι, **hegeomai**, to lead or carry a narration through to the end; to lead with distinction; with the idea of thoroughness. A strengthened form of the word **agoo**, to lead; thus, to be officially appointed in a position of authority. Dr. Luke was familiar with this terminology. The word was particularly applied to a medical treatise. Galen applies it at least seventy-three times to **the writings of Hippocrates**. [Vincent]*

Having travelled extensively with Paul, Luke gets to the core of the good news in his opening statement! Not only are we audience to these events but indeed, in the unveiling of the mystery, we are the immediate beneficiaries of its consequence. In the incarnation revelation, the entire human race has been greatly advantaged! The ultimate significance of the Christ-event is not merely its historic relevance, but therein, that it will forever be celebrated in the unfolding of the mystery of the ages - which is [1]Christ, unveiled in human life, in the nations as well as in every individual. This unveiling is what transforms society into bridal bliss! The New Jerusalem is not a city but the redeemed society of mankind! The Bride of Christ! See my notes on the City Bride in Rev 3.

*The words, [3]**en hemin**, 'in us' say so much more than merely 'amongst us'! πεπληροφορημένων ἐν ἡμῖν πραγμάτων **peplerophoremenoon** having been fully accomplished **en hemin** in us **pragmatoon.** The Genitive Case [**-oon** endings in verb and noun], confirms that this matter belongs to us!*

*The word, [2]**plērophoreō**, to fully accomplish, is the Perfect Passive Participle in the Genitive case, **peplerophoremenoon.** In other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now present.)*

Some interesting observations about Hippocrates: He was the Father of Western Medicine - he died at the age of 90; 460 - 370 BC. Born on the island of Kos, Greece. He based his medical practice on observations and on the study of the human body. He held the belief that illness had a physical and a rational explanation. He rejected the views of his time that considered illness to be caused by superstitions and by possession of evil spirits and disfavor of the gods. Disease was not a

punishment inflicted by the gods but rather the product of environmental factors, diet, and living habits. He believed in the natural healing process of rest, a good diet, fresh air and cleanliness. In general, the Hippocratic medicine was very kind to the patient; treatment was gentle, and emphasized keeping the patient clean and sterile. For example, only clean water or wine were ever used on wounds, though "dry" treatment was preferable. Soothing balms were sometimes employed. Hippocrates was reluctant to administer drugs and engage in specialized treatment that might prove to be wrongly chosen. Generalized treatments he prescribed included fasting and the consumption of a mix of honey and vinegar. Hippocrates once said that "to eat when you are sick, is to feed your sickness." He noted that there were individual differences in the severity of disease symptoms and that some individuals were better able to cope with their disease and illness than others. He was also the first physician that held the belief that thoughts, ideas, and feelings come from the brain and not the heart as others of his time believed. Even today, the entire medical profession acknowledges this amazing man in the Hippocratic Oath, to uphold specific ethical standards.

Thank God for physicians and medicine - the ministry of Jesus however, as also emphasized by Dr Luke, far exceeds medication or medical diagnosis and explanations. See Luke 8:43.

Luke 5:15 Jesus' fame escalated even more dramatically. Great multitudes crowded together to hear him, and be healed of their infirmities.

Luke 5:16 But he would often retire secretly into a remote area in prayer.

Luke 5:17 Then, one day, while he was teaching, the following dramatic incident happened. There were Pharisees and Scholars of the law also sitting in his audience along with people coming from every village in Galilee and Judea as well as the outskirts of Jerusalem. The very atmosphere was charged with the presence of the Lord to heal. *(See Luke's account of Paul's ministry in Acts 14:1 - "he taught in such a way, that many believed!")*

Luke 5:18 Meanwhile, there were people desperately trying to get into the house where Jesus was teaching; they were carrying a man on a bed who suffered from severe convulsions that left him paralyzed. If only they could get him close to where Jesus was teaching. But, because of the crowd they were unable to. *(Dr Luke uses the technical medical term, ος ην παραλελυμενος - **hos aen paraleloumenos** in the Perfect Passive Participle Tense; describing a state that exists, as a result of something*

that happened previously. The man was left paralyzed possibly because of an accident or seizures.)

Luke 5:19 Then, having no alternative, they got onto the roof and proceeded to break the roof open by taking the tiles off and then lowering him down on his bed to exactly where Jesus was. *(Peter's house apparently, Mark 2:1. Jesus and everyone in the house obviously heard the noise and witnessed the commotion; now why didn't Jesus interrupt their efforts and spared the house from being damaged by them, with a simple "magic-wand" type of healing? He saw strategic opportunity to use this dramatic event to powerfully reinforce the essence of his mission, which was to dismantle the entire sin consciousness-currency of the religious system of the day.)*

Luke 5:20 And when Jesus saw their faith, he said to the man, "Your sins are forgiven!" *(Oh WOW! He just pulled the religious rug out from under their favorite philosophy's feet! Suddenly the Pharisees and Law Professors felt very vulnerable. Their entire leverage over people are in question. Sin-consciousness is their currency! Remember Simon's response earlier in the chapter! "Depart from me Lord, for I am a sinful man!" Jesus deliberately dismantles this idea! Innocence is our design! This is even before the cross! In order to persuade the human race, Jesus was en-route to give mankind the largest possible platform in the universe to exhibit their authentic worth and reclaim their innocence in his death as our death and in his resurrection as our resurrection!")*

Luke 5:21 This triggered immediate controversy. The Law Professors and Pharisees in the house, were perplexed and whispered under their breath, "This is blasphemy! Who does this man think he is!? Surely, only God has the power to forgive sins!"

Luke 5:22 Jesus knew exactly what they were thinking and asked them, "Why do you even reason like this in your hearts?

Luke 5:23 To say, your sins are forgiven, instead of, rise up and walk, does not make the one more relevant than the other.

Luke 5:24 Now, let me show you the connection here and help you see for yourselves that the son of man has authority on earth to forgive sins!" Jesus then again addressed the paraplegic man saying, "Arise, lift up your pallet and be on your way home!" *(The entire basis of the healing ministry of Jesus is reinforced in the fact that he came to break the association people had with sin as the cause of sickness -*

he has come to redeem mankind's innocence! Sickness is not some form of "Karma"! We have nurtured the idea for generations! When she falls in love, Maria von Trapp sings, "For somewhere in my youth or childhood, I must have done something good!" While all along engaging the same reward-based, DIY-Tree-system.)

Luke 5:25 The lame man instantly responded, got up, took his bedroll and left for home, magnifying God all the way!

Luke 5:26 Everyone were beside themselves with ecstatic joy! Overawed, they continued to praise God, mesmerized with the wonder of the paradox they have just witnessed! *(Luke here, uses the word* ***ekstasis*** *literally standing outside yourself! Then he uses* ***paradoxa****, which is the only time it's used in the NT. Its modern meaning is, a seemingly contradictory statement which, when investigated may prove to be well founded or true. As we all know, both words are accepted English words today.)*

John also addresses the issue that sickness is not some form of judgment or punishment, in the following account:

John 9:1 On his way Jesus noticed a man who was born blind.

John 9:2 And his followers asked him, "Master, whose sin is responsible for this man's condition; is he punished for his own sins, or perhaps for his parent's sins? Why was he born blind?"

John 9:3 Jesus answered emphatically, "His condition has absolutely nothing to do with any sins committed either by himself or his parents! Neither him nor his parents were guilty of sin, this is an opportunity for God's action *(in Christ)* **to be unveiled in him!** *(Jesus again disarms the Karma-principle that religion hinges on!)*

John 9:4 [1]We together, must occupy ourselves to accomplish the work of him who sent me - you must take sides with me! *(John here records a most remarkable statement of Jesus! The best texts read [1]ἡμᾶς, we, instead of ἐμὲ, me/I. Jesus does not say, "****I must do the works*** *of him ....". He says, We cannot pull in two opposite directions in the same team! Grace and Karma do not go hand in hand!)*

Jesus is seen praying in Luke more than all three other Gospels combined,

Luke 6:12 It was during that time that he again departed into the mountain to engage in prayer - he spent the night there; entwined in the face to face embrace of God. *(He continued all night -* ***ēn dianuktereuōn****, this is the Periphrastic Imperfect Active tense, which is only used here in the N.T., but common in the LXX and in late Greek writers. Medical writers used it of whole night vigils. Then Luke employs a phrase*

that again occurs nowhere else, ἐν τῇ προσευχῇ τοῦ Θεοῦ ***en tēi proseuchēi tou theou****, which is the Objective Genitive -* ***in the prayer of God!*** *The word* ***proseuche****, often translated, prayer, as in* ***proseuchomai****, from* ***pros****, face to face and* ***euche****,* ***eu****, well done* ***echo - a place of mutual resonance where desires are mirrored.*** *The word* ***euchomai*** *also translates, good wish, or good desire.)*

Luke 6:17 He then came down from the mountain with them and stood in an open plain where a crowd of his followers and a large multitude of people were gathering; they were coming from all over Judea and Jerusalem as well as the coastal regions of Tyre and Sidon.

Luke 6:18 They were there, [1]determined to hear Jesus teach and to be [2]healed of their infirmities. Also those who were harassed by unclean spirits were amongst them and they too were healed. *(Luke always connects Jesus healing ministry with his teaching. As in his account of Paul's ministry in the book of Acts, "Paul preached in such a way, that many believed… Acts 14:1; also on another occasion in Acts 14:8,9, ...while he was teaching, he saw a man's face lit up with faith…!*

This is such a different attitude to the Law Professors and Pharisees who sat in the same audience, with frowns on their foreheads!

*The people however, were there, [1]****determined*** *to hear ακουσαι from* ***akouō*** *to hear; which is an Aorist Active Infinitive; Greek Infinitives could have either a Present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms has more to do with aspect than with time. The Present Infinitive is used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as* ***a determined, completed unit*** *with a beginning and end. Thus, they had their minds made up! They were going to hear with understanding and be healed! The next verb, ιαθηναι iathenai, is also an Aorist Infinitive, this time in the Passive voice of ἰάομαι [2]****iaomai*** *to heal, from* ***ἰαίνω iaínō****, "to warm". Of the 29 times this word is used in the NT, Luke uses it 17 times - as medical man he is interested to know how someone feels who experiences the healing touch of Jesus! This is amazing! Also in my own experience, when praying with people, I have had people testify that they felt heat moving through their bodies or in the affected areas!* ***I believe, that while reading the Mirror Bible, unveiled understanding comes to you and faith and healing happens!*** *I do not imply that someone has to "feel" the heat in order to be healed! Many times healing happens without any "feeling"!)*

Luke 6:19 Everyone in the crowd was pressing in to touch him, because power was surging from him and he healed them all, one by one. *(The word, ἅπτομαι **haptomai**, means to cling to; attach oneself to; from ἅπτω **haptō**, to be kindled! Then the sentence, δύναμις παρ᾽ αὐτοῦ ἐξήρχετο - **dunamis para auto ekserchetо**, - **para**, closest possible proximity of nearness - out of his innermost being. Then, **kai iāto pantas** - with ιατο is in the Imperfect Middle voice, he kept on healing every single one; the Middle voice giving a personal touch to it all.)*

Now follows, **The Beatitudes**, like you've never seen them before! He introduces the beatitudes as a state of utmost bliss. The word, beatitude was connected to this teaching of Jesus by the Eastern church fathers in 15th century, from the Latin beātitūdō, from beātus "happy, fortunate" + ***tūdō***, indicating a state or condition.

At this pivotal point of Jesus' ministry, he continues to dismantle the entire philosophy of a religion based upon the typical Deuteronomy chapter 28 model! The idea of blessings and curses, as defining human life, is challenged to the core! One can only imagine the stories of horror proportions represented in the masses of diseased and tormented people who came to be healed by Jesus. Yet Luke makes no reference whatsoever to the degree of need or the merit of any individual case that qualifies someone to be healed. At no point does Jesus encourage anyone to first "say a sinners prayer", or perhaps first show remorse and confess or tell their sad stories of abuse etc. Neither did he make any appointments for further, extended counselling sessions. Yet, Jesus' healing ministry was not based on the "magic-wand" style; he always taught and healed! See Luke 5:5 & 17. Luke always connects Jesus healing ministry with his teaching. As in his account of Paul's ministry in the book of Acts, "Paul preached in such a way, that many believed… 14:1; also on another occasion in Acts 14:8,9, …while he was teaching, he saw a man's face lit up with faith…! This is such a different attitude to the Scribes and Pharisees who sat in the same audience!

Luke 6:20 Finally, having concluded his healing of the multitudes, Jesus lifted up his eyes and spoke to his followers, "To be [2]reduced to the most extreme state of poverty, does not define you. Disaster is not the fruit of [1]fate or karma *[performance-based religion]***! The [1]blessing of knowing, that the Kingdom of God [3]belongs to you personally, and that it is oozing from you, is the essence of your wellbeing and identity!"** *(The word translated blessed, **μακαριοι [1]makarioi**, stems from μη, **mey** not, and **keyr**, κηρ, fate! Fate has no say here! The word, πτωχός [2]**ptōchos**, poverty; bankruptcy; reduced to a crouching, beggarly state -*

*from **πτωσσω**, to tremble, or shrink with fear. Associated with judgment. The word, ὑμέτερος [3]**humeteros**, proceeding from you; belonging to you!*

Sadly, just like Simon's religious response, "Depart from me Lord, for I am a sinful man", the law professors and Pharisees were more interested in their question of, "Why was the boy born blind!?" John 9. Was it his own sin, or perhaps "a generational curse" inherited from his parents!? The concept of fate has been predominant in Greek/Roman myth and the driving force for most of their stories. In the Hebrew mind, מזל טוב mazal tov, good fortune, plays a major role, but it is always connected to their entire performance-based philosophy and religion.)

Luke 6:21 From [1]now on, the idea of fate or any sense of judgment when you are faced with famine, is no longer relevant! Since you are blessed with a brand new reference of a far greater reality, where you are abundantly sustained and [2]fully satisfied in lush green pastures! Your reason for weeping, is now transformed into blissful laughter and ecstatic joy! *(Luke adds the adverb νυν [1]**nun** "now" after "famished in famine" and again after "weep." He thus sharpens the contrast of this new reality as reference to this place of bliss. Fully satisfied, χορτασθησεσθε from χορτάζω [2]**chortazō** as in animal fodder. See Psalm 23, "He makes me lie down in green pastures!" Luke is reminded of Paul's testimony in Phil 4:12, I am not defined by abuse or abundance! It might be a different day and a different place, but the secret remains the same; whether I am facing a feast or a fast, a fountain or famine. Phil 4:13 In every situation I am strong in the one who empowers me from within to be who I am!)*

Luke 6:22 Your blissful state remains uninterrupted when, because of your association with me as the son of man, people hate, de-friend, gossip, block and exclude you, or even slander and embarrass you by dragging your name through the mud, making you out to be somebody evil! Your social standing and recognition is no longer based on how popular you are in the typical religious world.

Luke 6:23 Hey, instead of sulking about it, [1]click your heels and do a happy dance! You are [2]tapped into heaven's currency and cannot be bought! You are surrounded by a cloud of witnesses! These religious leaders, who are so stoked on their currency of condemnation and judgment are the very same fanatics who murdered your fathers, the prophets who saw my day! *(Leap for joy σκιρτήσατε [1]**skirtēsate**, an old verb used in LXX, but only in Luke in the N.T. The word, μισθός **misthos**, dues paid for work.)*

The blessings of the beatitudes are sharply contrasted here with the sigh of sadness!

Luke 6:24 [1]Sigh! How [2]sad to think that the wealth you accumulated by your own toil, is not the [3]true [4]reflection of what you're worth! *(The word [1]**plēn** denotes a vivid contrast. The word, [2]**ouai** as in **oua,** is a sigh of bewilderment -Oh! - Woe! The word, [3]**apechō** means, a receipt in full, as the papyri show. Then, παράκλησις [4]**paraklēsis** from **para**, closest possible association, and **kaleo**, to surname; to define identity. Thus, making your "wealth"to be proof of your success in keeping the law, the official receipt; the document that defines and credits your successful attempts to justify yourself according to the law of works.)*

Luke 6:25 Oh my, oh my! While you might be convinced [1]for the moment, that you are [2]most fully content with your diet of legalism, you will soon realize how famished you actually are! What a shame! Here you are, sneering with laughter while the same things you laugh about now, will make you weep with grief! *(The word, εμπεπλησμενοι from [2]**empiplēmi**, **en** + πλείστος **pleistos** the very extreme/most satisfied. Again Luke employs the adverb νυν [1]**nun** "now", twice, as in Luk 6:21, in vivid contrast between the two scenarios.)*

Luke 6:26 Oh, it is such a waste of time! While, trying your best to be in everyone's good books - you are revelling in exactly the same flattery your fathers were giving the false prophets!

Now, just to reinforce the fact that he is not attacking people in the above woes, he introduces the earth-shattering extravagance of the agape of God! This is the same agape Paul celebrates in 1 Corinthians 13; the kind, that keeps no record of wrong!

Jesus is not, as most translations of the above passage would suggest, telling the law professors and Pharisees that God's gonna get them and that they're all gonna burn in hell for this! He is exposing their evil mindsets; those mindsets will most certainly perish! See my notes on the Lake of Fire in Rev 19.)

Luke 6:27 For those of you who are really hearing me, allow me to give this conversation [1]another title! "What it means to discover the extravagant extent of Agape!" Yes, you are challenged to love the most unlikely - your enemies! Do things that will be to the best advantage of those who despise you! *(The words [1]**allos** and **heteros** are both usually translated as "another" in English. Yet **allos** means "another of the same kind" and **heteros** means "another of a different type".)*

Luke 8:40 The crowds welcomed Jesus warmly on his return to Galilee, since they

were all [1]looking out for him with eager expectancy. *(Here Luke uses the Periphrastic Imperfect Active of [1]**prosdokaō**, an old verb for eager expectancy.)*

Luke 8:41 Then, a man by the name of Jairus, the chief of the synagogue, approached him with a most urgent request; he collapsed at the feet of Jesus begging him to promptly come to his house.

Luke 8:42 His only daughter was dying, and she was only twelve years old. Jesus immediately went with him, but the dense crowd was thronging them.

Luke 8:43 Amongst them was a woman who was suffering from an issue of blood for twelve years; she had spent all she owned on physicians, but not one of them could heal her. *(Interesting in the context of my comments on Hippocrates, her physicians obviously also studied and were certainly influenced by Hippocrates; as was Dr. Luke for that matter. However, Luke records the healing ministry of Jesus which far eclipses the dimension of medical as well as natural cures.)*

Luke 8:44 She squeezed though the throng of people and touched the hem of Jesus' garment and was instantly cured!

Luke 8:45 Surprisingly, Jesus immediately wanted to know who it was that touched him. But no one stepped forward; then Peter said to him, how can you ask that? Throngs of people are crowding you and many are obviously touching you! *(The word, ἅπτομαι [1]**haptomai**, means to touch, to clasp, to cling to; it is the reflexive form of ἅπτω **haptō**, to kindle, light a fire.)*

Luke 8:46 Jesus answered, "Someone has touched me differently; I felt a surge of power emanating from me."

Luke 8:47 Then, realizing that she could not remain unnoticed, she approached Jesus, trembling and knelt before him and proceeded to tell everyone her story, and that she felt heat going though her body as she touched the hem of his garment and was [1]instantly [2]cured! *(The word, παραχρῆμα [1]**parachrēma**, immediately, is used only 19 times in the NT - twice by Matthew but 17 times by Luke. Again Luke uses the word, ἰάομαι [2]**iaomai** to heal, from **ἰαίνω iaínō**, "to warm". Of the 29 times this word is used in the NT, Luke uses it 17 times - as medical man he is interested to know how someone feels who experiences the healing touch of Jesus! This is amazing! Also in my own experience, when praying with people, I have had people testify that they felt heat moving through their bodies or in the affected areas! I believe, that even while reading the Mirror Bible, unveiled understanding comes to you and faith and healing happens! I do not imply that someone has to "feel" the heat in order to be*

healed! Many times healing happens without any "feeling"!)

Luke 8:48 And he said to her, Daughter, [3]your faith has saved you, continue on your life's journey [1]in this place of our [2]joint-oneness and peace. *(The Preposition [1]**eis**, speaks of a point reached in conclusion. The word, [2]**eirene**, means peace, from **eiro**, to join, to be set at one again, in carpentry it is referred to as the dove-tail joint, which is the strongest joint. Peace is a place of unhindered enjoyment of friendship beyond guilt, suspicion, blame or inferiority. [3]Note, "**Your faith!**" - this lady didn't approach Jesus hesitantly, saying to herself, if he heals me, then, when I see the miracle, I will believe it! She heard enough of the Good Report, confirming that Jesus is what the Jews were really waiting for - he is indeed the Messiah, the One who was to come as Savior of the world! Thus, an invincible, unstoppable faith already sprung up within her! It is vital to see that the unveiling of the gospel is, "from faith to faith" - Rom 1:17, The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. It is God's faith to begin with; it is **from faith to faith**, and not our good or bad behavior; we are not defined by our performance or circumstances. The Greek word translated "from" is the Preposition, **ek**, which always denotes source or origin. Paul refers here to Habakkuk 2:4, "The just shall live by his [God's] faith." Habakkuk sees a complete new basis to mankind's standing before God! Instead of reading the curse when disaster strikes, he realizes that the Promise out-dates performance as the basis to mankind's acquittal. The curse is taken out of the equation! Gal 3:13. Deuteronomy 28 would no longer be the motivation or measure of right or wrong behavior! Instead of righteousness as a reward to mankind's efforts to obey the law, Habakkuk celebrates God's righteousness based on God's belief, in the face of apparent disaster, represented in the evidence of all the curses mentioned in Deuteronomy 28! He sings, "Though the fig trees do not blossom, nor fruit be on the vines, the produce of the olive fails and the fields yield no food, the flock be cut off from the fold and there be no herd in the stalls, yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will joy in the God of my salvation. God, the Lord, is my strength; he makes my feet like hinds' feet, he makes me tread upon my high places." [Habakkuk 3:17-19 RSV]. It is interesting to note that Habakkuk - חבקוק **chăbaqqûq**, was possibly the son of the Shunammite woman and her husband who hosted the Prophet Elisha. They could not have children, until Elisha declared that in a year's time she would embrace - חבק **chabaq** - a child! When the child grew up to be a young man he died of sunstroke and Elisha stretched himself over the boy and mirror-embraced the dead child, face to face and the boy came back to life. חבקוק **Chabaqquq** is a double embrace - it is the*

prophetic picture of our mirror-resurrection together with Christ! If anyone knew that righteousness was not by works but by God's faith, it was Habakkuk!)

Luke 8:49 Jesus was [1]still speaking *[to the woman he healed from a 12 year long condition],* **when someone arrived to tell the ruler of the synagogue that his daughter had died, and that there would be no further need to trouble the Teacher.** *(Luke uses the Present Active Participle, [1]**lalountos**, λαλουντος , of the verb, λαλέω. I just love Luke's attention to detail! He positions Jairus in the middle of this conversation! See next verse also...)*

Luke 8:50 Jesus, overhearing the conversation said to Jairus, "You have no need to be disturbed by this news! [1]Remain in this place of seamless persuasion and she shall be completely restored." *(Hah! Luke again emphasizes Jairus' inclusion in the immediate audience! Jesus overheard..." Jairus has just heard the testimony of the lady who was instantly healed from a condition that she suffered from for 12 years! Exactly as long as his daughter was old! This must have so impacted his faith! The word, [1]**monon**, from μένω **meno**, to abide; to continue to be present; abiding in seamless union.*

I love Dr. Luke! He again and again reminds us in Jesus' conversation, that it is vitally important "how" you hear! Mere, academic hearing just doesn't do it! Debating,doubt and arguing neither. And in this case, don't let bad news interrupt your hearing!)

Luke 8:51 When they got to the house he would not let anyone in except Peter, James and John, as well as the father and mother of the girl.

Luke 8:52 Everyone outside was weeping and overcome with grief, but Jesus said, there is no need for weeping since she is only sleeping and not dead! *(He redefines death.)*

Luke 8:53 Their wailing immediately became scornful laughter since they were convinced that she was dead.

Luke 8:54 He then grabbed her hand firmly and summoned her, "Little lady, arise!"

Luke 8:55 Her spirit immediately returned and she stood up! Jesus then suggested that they bring her something to eat.

Luke 9:37 They descended the mountain the following day where a large crowd was waiting to meet him.

Luke 9:38 And a man from the crowd called out and implored Jesus to consider the condition of his one and only son. *(To look upon - **epiblepsai** - Aorist Infinitive of*

epiblepō *from* ***epi****, upon,* ***blepō****, look, common verb, but in the N.T. only here and Jas 2:3 except Luk 1:48 in quotation from lxx. This compound verb is common in medical writers for examining the patient carefully.)*

Luke 9:40 He said that he implored the disciples to help him but they were not able to.

Luke 9:41 Jesus responded with a sigh of frustration, "How long will I be here, face to face [1]with you and [1]mirror-echo your identity, before you finally get it? Why confuse who I am with your twisted ideas of yourself, conceived in your unbelief?" He then asked the father to bring his son to stand face to face with him. *(Mark relates this same event and mentions the fact that the law professors were disputing with the disciples and the crowds... Mar 9:14 As they came to rejoin the disciples, they saw an immense crowd surrounding them and a party of law professors disputing with them. Mar 9:16 "What is the subject you are discussing?" He asked them.*

This explains Jesus' frustration when he addresses them, ἕως πότε ***heos pote*** *[how long] ἔσομαι* ***esomai*** *[I am εἰμί* ***eimi****] πρὸς* ***pros*** *[face to face] ὑμᾶς [1]****humas*** *[with you Accusative] καὶ [and] ἀνέξομαι* ***anechxomai****. [from* ***ana****, upward and* ***echo****, to hold, echo. See Rom 2:4, 3:26] ὑμῶν [2]****humon****, [Genitive your - I am your mirror identity] The word, γενεά* ***genea,*** *fathered, birth, nativity; that which has been begotten. The word, διαστρέφω* ***diastrephō****, distorted, twisted, turned, or torn in two.)*

Luke 9:42 When the child [1]approached Jesus, the demon threw him on the ground and convulsed him severely. Jesus restrained the unclean spirit, healed the child and gave him back to his father. *(Again the word,* ***pros****, face to face combines, this time with* ***erchomai****, to come - προσέρχομαι* ***proserchomai****.)*

Luke 9:43 Everyone was struck with astonishment at the magnificence of God and they marvelled at all the things Jesus was doing.

Luke 18:31 Jesus then privately, looked his disciples in their eyes and said, Our journey will conclude in Jerusalem. There you will witness the fulfillment of everything the prophets pointed to in Scripture, concerning the son of man. *(The great* ***tetelestai*** *statement of Jesus on the cross, is already contained here,* ***tetelesthesetai*** *τελεσθήσεται - it is about to be fulfilled; See Isa 53:1-12; Dan 9:26-27.)*

Luke 18:32 He will be betrayed and handed over to a Gentile governor and Roman soldiers. He will be scorned, violently abused and spat upon with contempt.

Luke 18:33 And having lacerated him with a whip they will slay him; and in the

third day, he will arise.

Luke 18:34 Yet again, his disciples were unable to make the vital connection and thus failed to [1]comprehend the significance of these words! *(The word, [1]**suniemi** means, a joining together like that of two streams; a fusion of thought, a joint-seeing.)*

Luke 18:35 As they approached Jericho, a blind man was sitting beside the road; in eager expectation to receive something. *(Again a word that only Luke uses and just this one time, ἐπαιτέω **epaiteo**, to ask again and again, importunately. Remember, earlier in this chapter, 18:8 I assure you, he will speedily vindicate you; the day of the son of man is about to dawn! Will the Messiah find a people standing on tippy toe in full expectation of his coming!*

Here is a blind beggar from Jericho, "standing on tippy toe" in his eager expectation for Jesus, the son of David, to show up and heal him! He made the vital connection!)

Luke 18:36 When he heard the commotion of a crowd approaching he inquired from those passing by if this was, who he thought it was? *(πυνθάνομαι punthanomai to ascertain by inquiry.)*

Luke 18:37 They said, Yes indeed! Jesus the Nazarene is on his way!

Luke 18:38 He shouted with urgent persuasion, Jesus! Son of David! Have mercy on me! *(The rumors he heard about Jesus, already persuaded him, that Jesus is the son of David, the Messiah; he is what the Scriptures are all about!)*

Luke 18:39 The ones leading the procession tried their best to shut him up, but he hollered even louder, crying, Jesus! Son of David! Have mercy on me! *(The word, ἔκραζεν, to cry clamorously; the tone of your voice betrays **your** faith!)*

Luke 18:40 Jesus stopped and ordered the blind man to be brought to him. When they presented him to Jesus, he asked him,

Luke 18:41 What do you desire from me? He answered, Lord, that I may see!

Luke 18:42 Jesus responded, Look up! Your faith has made you well. *(Note, "Your faith!" See my commentary in Luke 8:48.)*

Luke 18:43 His eyes popped open instantly and he joined Jesus on his way, magnifying God while the people boldly announced what they have witnessed again of the amazingness of God.

Incarnate Faith - Chapter 27

So, what was different about this woman's touch?

Luke 8:44 She squeezed through the throng of people and touched the hem of his garment and was instantly cured! *(This woman knew the prophetic scripture in Malachi 4:2, "the sun of righteousness will rise, with healing in his wings"; the Hebrew word for wings is* כָּנָף ***kanaph****, which is the same word for the hem of a garment!)*

Luke 8:46 Jesus answered, "Someone has touched me differently; I felt a surge of power emanating from me."

Luke 8:48 And he said to her, Daughter, [3]<u>your faith has saved you</u>, continue on your life's journey [1]in this place of our [2]joint-oneness and peace.

*Note, "**Your faith!**" - this lady didn't approach Jesus hesitantly, saying to herself, if he heals me, then, when I see the miracle, I will believe it! She heard enough of the Good Report, confirming within her, that Jesus is what the Jews were really waiting for - he is indeed the Messiah, the One who was to come as Savior of the world! Thus, an invincible, unstoppable faith already sprung up within her!*

We do not 'invent' faith through positive thinking or, desperately trying out some alternative philosophy. We are faith-compatible by design; we are wired to believe naturally and effortlessly! If breathing had to be the reward of my diligent study of how the lungs function, and then my constant conscious application and concentration, then we would override the ability of our design to breathe naturally and freely.

So, what makes your faith invincible? "Let it be to you, according to your faith!" Whatever it is that you believe, draw from the authentic Source! Reflect God's persuasion about you! Rest your entire being in his Agape.

Rom. 10:10 This is where believing happens spontaneously, in the heart! The revelation of mankind's redeemed righteousness ignites a new conversation, announcing salvation. *(The word **pisteuetai** is the Impersonal construction, "it is believed"; believing takes place! [Present Passive Indicative of **pisteuō**] Faith is not something we "do" - faith is what happens to us when we realize what God has done for us! He restored us to blameless innocence! It is impossible not to boldly announce news of such global consequence [Isa 40:9])*

Something doesn't become true by popular vote! Or by our beliefs! If it wasn't true to begin with, we're wasting our time trying to "believe" it true! ***Faith happens to you when you encounter the good announcement!***

See also **Luke 18:8 I assure you, he will speedily vindicate you; the day of the son of man is about to dawn! Will the Messiah find a people standing on tiptoe in full expectation of his coming!** *(Jesus is not talking about some future coming of the son of man! - Not in this, or in the previous chapter of Luke!)*

Meanwhile... **Luke 18:35 As they approached Jericho, a blind man was sitting beside the road; in eager expectation to receive something.** *(Here is a blind beggar from Jericho, "standing on tiptoe" in his eager expectation for Jesus, the son of David, to show up and heal him! He made the vital connection! He didn't buy into the unbelief of the religious leaders of the day!)*

Luke 18:36 When he heard the commotion of a crowd approaching he inquired from those passing by if this was, who he thought it was? *(πυνθάνομαι punthanomai to ascertain by inquiry.)*

Luke 18:37 They said, Yes indeed! Jesus the Nazarene is on his way!

Luke 18:38 He shouted with urgent persuasion, Jesus! Son of David! Have mercy on me! *(The rumors he heard about Jesus, already persuaded him, that Jesus is the son of David, the Messiah; he is what the Scriptures are all about!)*

Luke 18:39 The ones leading the procession tried their best to shut him up, but he hollered even louder, crying, Jesus! Son of David! Have mercy on me! *(The word, ἔκραζεν, to cry clamorously; the tone of your voice betrays* ***your*** *faith!)*

Luke 18:40 Jesus stopped and ordered the blind man to be brought to him. When they presented him to Jesus, he asked him,

Luke 18:41 What do you desire from me? He answered, Lord, that I may see!

Luke 18:42 Jesus responded, Look up! Your faith has made you well. *(Note, "Your faith!")*

Luke 18:43 His eyes popped open instantly and he joined Jesus on his way, magnifying God while the people boldly announced what they have witnessed again of the amazingness of God.

Also in this incidence, **Luke 5:19 Then, having no alternative, they got onto the roof and proceeded to break the roof open by taking the tiles off and then lowering**

him down on his bed to exactly where Jesus was. *(Peter's house apparently, Mark 2:1. Jesus and everyone in the house obviously heard the noise and witnessed the commotion; now why didn't Jesus interrupt their efforts and spared the house from being damaged by them, with a simple "magic-wand" type of healing? He saw a strategic opportunity to use this dramatic event to powerfully reinforce the essence of his mission, which was to dismantle the entire sin consciousness-currency of the religious system of the day.)*

Luke 5:20 And when Jesus saw their faith, he said to the man, "Your sins are forgiven!" *(Oh WOW! He just pulled the religious rug out from under their favorite philosophy's feet! Suddenly the Pharisees and Law Professors felt very vulnerable. Their entire leverage over people is in question. Sin-consciousness is their currency! Remember Simon's response earlier in the chapter! "Depart from me Lord, for I am a sinful man!" Jesus deliberately dismantles this idea! Innocence is our design! This is even before the cross! In order to persuade the human race, Jesus was en-route to give mankind the largest possible platform in the universe to exhibit their authentic worth and reclaim their innocence in his death as our death and in his resurrection as our resurrection!")*

Jesus dismantles the entire philosophy of a religion based upon the typical Deuteronomy chapter 28 model! The idea of blessings and curses, as defining human life, is challenged to the core! One can only imagine the stories of horror proportions represented in the masses of diseased and tormented people who came to be healed by Jesus. Yet Luke makes no reference whatsoever to the degree of need or the merit of any individual case that qualifies someone to be healed. At no point does Jesus encourage anyone to first "say a sinner's prayer", or perhaps first show remorse and confess or tell their sad stories of abuse etc. Neither did he make any appointments for further, extended counselling sessions. Yet, Jesus' healing ministry was not based on the "magic-wand" style; he always taught and healed! See Luke 5:5 & 17. Luke always connects Jesus' healing ministry with his teaching. As in his account of Paul's ministry in the book of Acts 14:1, ***"Paul preached in such a way, that many believed."*** Also, on another occasion in Acts 14:8,9, ...while he was teaching, ***he saw a man's face lit up with faith***. This is such a different attitude to the Scribes and Pharisees who sat in the same audience!

Rom. 5:16 The principle of the gift speaks a different language and brings a radically different equation to the table. Whereas a single sin resulted in a judgment that concluded in condemnation; grace translates countless deviations

into acquittal and innocence.

Rom. 5:17 Death no longer has the final say. Life rules! If the effect of one man's crash-landing engaged mankind in a death-dominated lifestyle how much more advantaged is the very same mankind now that they are the recipients of the boundless reservoirs of grace, empowering them to enjoy the dominion of life through the gift of righteousness because of that one man, Jesus Christ. Grace is out of all proportion in superiority to the transgression. *(No, grace is not something you qualify for by receiving it! Grace already belongs to mankind without their permission! The words* ***οἱ λαμβάνοντες - [1]oi lambanontes*** *do not mean, to believingly accept, but simply the recipients! [the Present Active Participle Nominative] The word* ***[2]perisseia περισσεία*** *means super abundantly; that which exceeds all boundaries. Of course it doesn't take faith out of the equation!* ***It gives context to faith!*** *See verse 1&2. Faith isn't what you do in order to; it's what happens to you because of!)*

It is vital to see that the dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. It is ***from faith to faith***, and not our good or bad behavior; we are not defined by our performance or circumstances. The Greek word translated "from" is the Preposition, ***ek***, which always denotes source or origin. Paul refers here to Habakkuk 2:4, "The just shall live by his [God's] faith." ***Habakkuk sees a complete new basis to mankind's standing before God!*** Instead of reading the curse when disaster strikes, he realizes that the Promise out-dates performance as the basis to mankind's acquittal. The curse is taken out of the equation! Gal. 3:13.

Galatians 3:17 This is my reasoning: God endorsed the covenant of promise in Christ 430 years before the law was given. The law did not later replace the promise! *(God's faith, as embodied in Christ, is the only basis to mankind's acquittal and could never be replaced by their own ability to keep moral laws.)*

Gal. 3:18 The law and the promise are not compatible; the one system nullifies the other. God gifts Abraham with heir-ship by promise *(and not by reward for his behavior.)*

Gal. 3:5 Would you accredit what you have received from God to something you did or something you have heard?

We are faith-compatible by design. "Look away [from the law of works] unto Jesus; he is the Author and finisher of faith." [Hebrews 12:1]. It is God's faith to begin with; it is from faith to faith, says Paul in Rom. 1:17. The Greek word translated "from" is the

Preposition, ***ek***, which always denotes source or origin.

Faith is everyone's equal portion, says Peter,

2 Pet. 1:1 I am Simon the Rock, bondman and ambassador of Jesus Christ. We are in this together; it is not something we had to compete for, since we are equal [1]shareholders in a faith of exactly the [2]same, priceless value. This rests entirely upon the merit of the righteousness of God and our Savior Jesus Christ. *(He rescued us from the lies that we believed about ourselves. The word, [1]**lanchano**, means to be measured out beforehand; to be allocated something by allotment. This emphasizes the fact that nothing we did or determined to achieve, had any influence upon God to qualify us. **Faith is not something we do** to persuade God; **faith is what happens to us** when we realize how persuaded God is about us. Salvation belongs to everyone based on exactly the same merit. God's righteousness persuades us. What God did right in Christ cancels out everything that Adam, or we did wrong! See Rom 1:17 Herein lies the secret of the power of the Gospel; there is no good news in it until the righteousness of God is revealed! The dynamic of the gospel is the revelation of God's faith as the only valid basis for our belief. The Prophets wrote in advance about the fact that God believes that righteousness defines the life that he always had in mind for us. "Righteousness by his (God's) faith defines life." The word, ἰσότιμος [2]**isotimos**, from **isos**, means that which is similar; equal, and τιμή **timey** value, esteem, thus, reckoned as equally precious.)*

2 Pet. 1:2 God's [1]desire is that we may now increasingly be overwhelmed with grace as his divine influence within us and become fully acquainted with the awareness of our [2]oneness. The way he has always [3]known us is realized in Jesus our Master. *(The verb [1]**plethunthein,** meaning to increase, to multiply, is in the Optative mood which expresses a wish. The word [2]**eirene,** means peace, from **eiro**, to join, to be set at one again, in carpentry it is the strongest joint, referred to as the dove-tail joint. The [3]knowledge of God is not our knowledge of him; it is God's knowledge of us! He knew us before he formed us in our mother's womb! Jer 1:5. In this context no one can ever feel ignored or neglected again.)*

2 Pet. 1:3 By his divine [1]engineering he gifted us with all that it takes to live life to the full, where our ordinary day to day lives mirror our [2]devotion and romance with our Maker. His [3]intimate knowledge of us [4]introduces us to ourselves again and [5]elevates us to a position where his [6]original intention is clearly perceived! *(I have translated the word, [1]**dunamis,** power or ability, as engineering, in this context.*

*The word [2]**eusebeia** means devotion or worship. The word [3]**epignoseos** suggests an intimate knowledge; here it is in the Genitive case, which means God is the owner of this knowledge. Jer 1:5, 1 Cor 13:12. The word [4]**kaleo**, means to surname, I translated it, "he introduced us to ourselves again", which reminds of Jesus declaring to Simon, son of Jonah his original identity and thus laying the rock-foundation in our understanding that the son of man is indeed the son of God, now celebrated in the Ekklesia, which literally means our original identity. Math 16:17,18. The word [5]**arete** from **aireo** means to elevate, to lift one's perspective; often translated, virtue. The word [6]**doxa**, often translated, glory, from **dokeo**, original intention, opinion.)*

2 Pet. 1:4 This is exactly what God always had in mind for us; everyone of his abundant and priceless promises pointed to our restored participation in our [1]godly origin! This is his gift to us! In this fellowship we have escaped the distorted influence of the corrupt cosmic virus of greed. *([1]His image and likeness is redeemed in us. The default settings are restored. We are re-booted to fully participate in the life of our design. Sadly, my mother tongue language, in the old Afrikaans translation says, "Once you have escaped the corruption of the lusts of the flesh, you'll be rewarded with the divine nature!" Now that is "putting the cart before the horses"!)*

Unfortunately our Authorized Bibles all repeat the same mistake in the next verse, 2 Pet. 1:5, by saying, "***Add to your faith*** virtue, etc..." This is after Peter clearly states in verse 1 that, to begin with, we already are equal shareholders in a faith of exactly the same, priceless value. Then in verse 3, that by God's divine engineering, we are gifted with all that it takes to live life to the full!

One cannot add to something that is already complete! However, one can engage the adventure of a limitless discovery! I often use an 8-piece Babuska doll to illustrate that there is so much more than just the outer image! This is a traditional Russian doll, beautifully carved out of wood and painted with a colorful image. The outer image is repeated again and again in smaller, identical inner pieces - each one fitting perfectly into the other. Until it almost seems impossible that yet another piece could follow the little figures that emerge! Our 5 year old grand-daughter, Nicola calls this, the Reflection Doll!

Faith unfolds into these amazing attributes that each person is equally gifted with:

1/ Faith; 2/ Elevation; 3/ Spiritual insight; 4/ Inner strength; 5/ Patient perseverance; 6/ Meaningful devotion and worship; 7/ Genuine fondness for others and finally, the heart of faith is 8/ the Agape of God!

Now, acquaint yourselves with these!

The keyword here, in Peter's illustration is the word, ***epichoregeo*** which was traditionally translated, to 'add to'! The etymological values of this word clearly describe a conductor of music.

2 Pet. 1:5 Now *[in the light of what we are gifted with in Christ],* **the stage is set to display life's excellence. Explore the adventures of faith! Imagine the extreme dedication and focus of a [1]conductor of music; how he would [2]diligently [3]acquaint himself with every individual voice in the choir, as well as the contribution of every specific instrument, to follow the precise sound represented in every single note in order to give maximum credit to the original composition. This is exactly what it means to exhibit the divine character. You are the choir conductor of your own life. Familiarize yourselves with every ingredient that faith unfolds! See there how [4]elevated you are, and from within this position** *[of your co-seatedness in Christ],* **[5]enlightened perspective will dawn within you.** *(The word, [1]**epichoregeo** has three components: **epi**, a Preposition of position, over, in charge, indicating continuous influence upon, + **chorus**, choir, orchestra, or dance + **ago**, meaning to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep; thus, the conductor of music. [2]"Giving all diligence, extreme devotion." The word, [2]**spoude**, means to interest one's self immediately and most earnestly. The word, [3]**pareisphero,** means to introduce simultaneously. I translated it, to acquaint yourself with every detail of the whole. From **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, a thing proceeding from a sphere of influence, with a suggestion of union of place of residence, to have sprung from its author and giver, originating from, denoting the point from which an action originates, intimate connection, + **eisphero**, to reach inward. Before a performance, the first violinist will give the exact key of the piece to be played; now every instrument can be finely tuned to that note, in the same way the faith of God gives that exact pitch. The word, [4]**arete**, often translated, virtue, comes from the word **airo**, to raise up, to elevate. Faith unfolds the secret of our joint-elevation with Jesus. See yourself seated together with Christ! Colossians 3:1-3. Now from this position of elevation we begin to see new horizons; in fact we begin to see everything differently! There is a level of understanding, [5]**gnosis**, a knowing, that can only be accessed by faith. In Hebrews 11:3, "by faith we understand that the ages were framed by the Word of God.")*

2 Pet. 1:6 Here you will realize your inner strength and how fully competent you are to prevail in patient perseverance in the midst of any contradiction. It is

from within this place of enlightened perspective that meaningful devotion and worship ignite! *(Spiritual strength exceeds mind-, muscle- or willpower by far!)*

2 Pet. 1:7 In worship you will find a genuine fondness for others. At the heart of everything that faith unfolds is [1]the agape-love of God. *(Worship and devotion includes esteeming people and honoring friendship [Jas 3:9]; the same voice that magnifies God cannot insult a person made in God's image. True worship is to touch someone's life with the same devotion and care you would touch Jesus himself; even if the other person seems a most unlikely candidate. The word, [1]**agape**, is from **ago**, meaning to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep, and **pao**, to rest; as in Psalm 23, "he leads me besides still waters, he restores my soul; or, by the waters of reflection, my soul remembers who I am!" The Message reads, "each dimension fitting into and developing the other.")*

2 Pet. 1:8 While you diligently [1]rehearse the exact qualities of every divine attribute within you; the volume will rise with ever increasing gusto, guarding you from being ineffective and barren in your knowledge of the Christ-life, displayed with such authority and eloquence in Jesus. *("These things being in you." The word, [1]**uparcho**, translates rehearse, from **upo + archomai**, to commence or rehearse from the beginning. The word **arche**, suggests commencement or beginning.)*

2 Pet. 1:9 If anyone feels that these things are absent in his life, they are not; spiritual blindness and short-sightedness only veil them from you. This happens when one loses sight of one's innocence. *(The moment one forgets the tremendous consequence of the fact that we were cleansed from our past sins, one seems to become pre-occupied again with the immediate sense-ruled horizon, which is what short-sightedness is all about; this makes one blind to his blessings. Spiritual realities suddenly seem vague and distant. Become acquainted with your innocence!)*

2 Pet. 1:10 Therefore I would encourage you my fellow family, to make every immediate effort to become cemented in the knowledge of our [1]original identity [2]revealed and confirmed in the logic of God. Fully engage these realities in your lifestyle, and so you will never [3]fail. *(Your original identity, [1]**kaleo**, often translated as calling, to surname, to identify by name; [2]**eklogen**, often translated as election; yet the two parts of this word, **ek**, a Preposition denoting origin or source, and **lego**, from **logos**, suggests the original word (the logic of God) as our source [Jn 1:1,14]. The word, [3]**ptaio**, means to fail, falter, or get out of tune again in the context of verse 5, literally to fall, lose height, to stop flying.)*

2 Pet. 1:11 Thus the great [1]Conductor of music will draw your life into the full volume of the harmony of the ages; the [2]royal song of our Savior Jesus Christ. *(In Colossians 2:19, "You are directly connected to Christ who like a choir conductor draws out the music in everyone like a tapestry of art that intertwines in harmony to reveal the full stature of divine inspiration," which is Christ in you. Again the word [2]**epichoregeo** is used, the choir conductor; this time, God is doing the conducting and is leading us into his harmony; [2]**eis + odos**, meaning access into the road. Yet, in this context I prefer the thought that we are led into a song, an **ode**; a ceremonious lyric poem. The form is usually marked by exalted feeling and style. The term **ode** derives from a Greek word alluding to a choir song, usually accompanied by a dance; also a poem to be sung composed for royal occasions.)*

2 Pet. 1:12 Having said all this I am sure that you can appreciate why I feel so urgent in my commitment to you to repeatedly bring these things to your attention; as indeed you have already taken your stand for the truth as it is now revealed.

2 Pet. 1:13 So while I am still in this body-suit, I take my lead from the revelation of righteousness and make it my business to thoroughly stir you until these truths become permanently molded in your memory.

2 Pet. 1:14 All the more since I know that my time in this tabernacle is almost done; our Lord Jesus Christ has prepared me for this.

2 Pet. 1:15 In the meantime, I will do whatever it takes to make it possible for you to always be able to easily recall these realities even in my absence.

2 Pet. 1:16 We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic appearance; with our own eyes we have witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate presence of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life. *(His face shone like the sun, even his raiment were radiant white. Mt 17.)*

2 Pet. 1:17 He was spectacularly endorsed by God the Father in the highest honor and glory. God's majestic voice announced, "This is the Son of my delight; he completely pleases me."

2 Pet. 1:18 For John, James, and I the prophetic word is fulfilled beyond doubt; we heard this voice loud and clear from the heavenly realm while we were with Jesus in that sacred moment on the mountain.

2 Pet. 1:19 For us the appearing of the Messiah is no longer a future promise but

a fulfilled reality. Now it is your turn to have more than a second-hand, hearsay testimony. Take my word as one would take a lamp at night; the day is about to dawn within you, in your own understanding. When the Morning Star appears, you no longer need the lamp; this will happen shortly on the horizon of your own hearts.

Heb. 6:13 Since God had no one greater by whom to swear, he swore by himself. He could give Abraham no greater guarantee but the integrity of his own Being; this makes the promise as sure as God is.

Heb. 6:14 Saying, "I will continue to speak well of you. I will confirm my intention to always only bless you, and to multiply you beyond measure." *(In blessing I will bless you, and in multiplying I will multiply you.)*

Heb. 6:15 And so Abraham continued in patience and secured the promise.

Heb. 6:16 It is common practice in human affairs to evoke a higher authority under oath in order to add weight to any agreement between parties, thereby [1]silencing any possibility of quibbling. *(The word [1]**peras**, means the end of all dispute; the point beyond which one cannot go.)*

Heb. 6:17 In the same context we are confronted with God's eagerness to go to the last extreme in his dealing with us as heirs of his promise, and to cancel out all possible grounds for doubt or dispute. In order to persuade us of the unalterable character and finality of his resolve, he [1]confined himself to an oath. The promise, which already belongs to us by heritage, is now also [1]confirmed under oath. *(The word [1]**mesiteo** is used, interposed or mediated. Compare **mesites**, mediator, from **mesos**, midst. In the incarnation, God has positioned himself in the midst, of his creation. See Galatians 3:20 With Abraham there was no middleman; it was just God! [The Mosaic law spoke the language of "the fallen mind" and required mediators - the Levitical priesthood - because it was an arrangement whereby mankind had a part and God had a part. Mankind's part was to obey the commandments and God's part was to bless. God's covenant with Abraham was a grace covenant pointing to the man Jesus Christ, in whom God himself would fulfil mankind's part and therefore needed no mediator apart from himself.*

In the incarnation Jesus fulfills both the proposal and the "I do!" M. Perez]

The Word is the promise; the Incarnate, crucified and risen Christ is the proof. He desires to show more convincingly to the heirs of the promise the unchangeable character of his

purpose. RSV .

Mankind was not redeemed from the Devil; a thief never becomes an owner; neither did Jesus do what he did to change his Father's mind about us! It was our minds that needed persuasion! God was not to be reconciled to his creation; God was in Christ when he reconciled the world to himself! 2 Corinthians 5:18-20.)

Heb. 6:18 So that we are now dealing with two irreversible facts which make it impossible for anyone to prove God wrong; thus our persuasion as to our redeemed identity is powerfully reinforced. We have already escaped into that destiny; our expectation has come within our immediate grasp! *(The promise of redemption sustained throughout Scripture and the fulfillment of that promise in Jesus. See John 8:13-18* ***John 8:17*** *That should settle it for you since it is written in your law that the testimony of two, is true! [This combined witness of two is not true just because they agree, unless true in fact separately. But if they disagree, the testimony falls to the ground. Deuteronomy 17:6; and Deut 19:15. - Robertson. Also Rev 10:6 See notes on the Oath at the end of Rev 10 also the Notes on the Testimony of Jesus at the end of Rev 20.])*

Heb. 6:19 Our hearts and minds are certain; anchored securely within the innermost courts of God's immediate Presence; beyond the *(prophetic)* **veil.**

Heb. 6:20 By going there on our behalf, Jesus pioneered a place for us and removed every type of obstruction that could possibly distance us from the promise. In him we are represented for all time; he became our High Priest after the order of Melchizedek. We now enjoy the same privileged access he has. *(He said, "I go to prepare a place for you so that you may be where I am. On that day you will no longer doubt that I and the Father are one; you will know that I am in the Father and you in me and I in you!" John 10:30, 14:3, 20.)*

2 Cor. 1:18 God's certainty is our persuasion; there is no maybe in him!

2 Cor. 1:19 The Son of God, Jesus Christ, whom I, Paul, Sylvanus and Timothy boldly announced in you, is God's ultimate yes to "you-manity". Jesus is God's Yes to you! Human life is associated in all that he is. In God's mind there exists not even a hint of hesitation about this! *(Note, Paul and his team proclaimed Christ* ***in*** *them, not, "to"them! See Gal 1:16; and Col. 1:27. Also 2 Cor 3:4.)*

2 Cor. 1:20 In him the detail of every single promise of God is fulfilled; Jesus is God's yes to your entire well being! In our union with him the Amen that echoes in

us gives evidence to his glorious intent through us.

John 1:13 These are the ones who discover their genesis in God, beyond their natural conception! This is not about our blood lineage or whether we were a wanted- or unwanted-child; this is about our God-begotteness. We are his dream come true and not the invention of our parents. You are indeed the greatest idea that God has ever had! *(See Jeremiah 1:5; 29:11 & John 3:2-7)*

John 1:14 Suddenly the invisible, eternal Word takes on [1]visible form - the Incarnation, on display in a flesh and blood Person, as in a mirror! In him, and now confirmed in us! The most accurate tangible exhibit of God's eternal thought finds expression in human life! The Word became a human being; we are his address; he resides in us! He [2]captivates our gaze! The glory we see there is not a religious replica; he is the [3]authentic begotten Son. The [4]glory *(that we lost in Adam)* **returns in fullness! Only [5]grace can communicate truth in such complete context!** *(In him we discover that we are not here by chance or accident or by the desire of an earthly parent, neither are we the product of a mere physical conception; we exist by the expression of God's desire to reveal himself in the flesh. His eternal invisible Word, his Spirit-thought, [1]became flesh, [1]**ginomai**, as in be born and [2]**theaomai**, meaning to gaze upon, to perceive. We saw his glory, [4]**doxa**, the display of his opinion, the glory as of the original, authentic begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth. He is the "only begotten," [3]**monogenes**; begotten only by the Father and not of the flesh; in him we recognize our true beginning, as in the authentic original mold. He is also the "first born from the dead", declaring our new birth. [Colossians 1:18, 1 Peter 1:3]. He is the revelation of our completeness.*

*And out of **[ek]** his fullness have we all received! The Preposition, **ek** always points to source/origin. Grace mirrored in grace, [5]**garin anti garitos**. For the law was given through Moses, grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. He who is in the bosom of the Father, the only original, authentic begotten of the Father; he is our guide who accurately declares and interprets the invisible God within us. Interesting that the revelation of the Incarnation in verse 14 doesn't follow verse 2 or 3, but verse 12 and 13! Genesis 1:26 is redeemed! See 2 Corinthians 3:17,18.)*

Belief doesn't make something true;

but truth realized makes faith most relevant!

Nothing is more true

than the love of God for you

and in you for others!

God has found a face in you

that portrays him more beautifully

than the best theology!

Your features,

your touch,

the cadence of your voice,

the compassion in your gaze,

the lines of your smile,

the warmth of your person and presence

unveil him!

The Prayer Of God

Luke 6:12 It was during that time, that he again departed into the mountain to engage in prayer. He spent the night there; entwined in a face to face mirror-encounter, in the prayer of God. *(Jesus is seen praying in Luke more than all three other Gospels combined. Here, Luke employs a phrase that occurs nowhere else, ἐν τῇ προσευχῇ τοῦ Θεοῦ en tēi proseuchēi tou theou, which is the Objective Genitive - in the prayer of God! The word proseuche, often translated, prayer; from pros, face to face and euche, eu, well done echo - a place of mutual resonance where deep inner longings are mirrored. The verb euchomai also translates, to express a good wish or a beautiful desire.)*

Rev 22:4 And you will gaze upon him, face to face; recognizing every distinct detail of his divine features mirrored in you! His Name is tattooed in your innermost thoughts! *(The word [1]**metopon**, from **meta**, together with, and **ὤψ - ops**, countenance; face; the space between the eyes, the forehead; focus. Also Rev 3:12. See Psalm 17:15, As for me, I shall behold your face in righteousness; when I awake, I shall be satisfied, beholding your form. Beholding God's face in Jesus (our righteousness) as in a mirror, awakens me to my true likeness! Psalm 34:5 Look him in the face - you'll glisten with God. You'll gleam, your face'll scream, "GOD!" 2 Cor 3:18, "We've got our masks off; God's brilliance is bouncing off our faces! We're glowing from knowing!" Rob Lacey. "The whole earth is full of his glory!" Isa 6:3.)*

I am overwhelmed with the thought that even prayer has its origin in God! And reminded of Adam and Eve's very first conscious moment, when Elohim knelt over them in adoration! Which is what the Hebrew word, בָּרַךְ Barak means. As in John 1:3 Everything is sourced in the Logos; the conversation of the Father, Son and Spirit. Also, Col. 1:16 Everything that is, begins in him; both visible and invisible.

In the context of prayer, this brings an entirely fresh dynamic to the table.

Thus, we are invited to engage the Love of God; the Faith of God; the Peace of God; the Joy of the Lord; the Knowledge of God; the Wisdom of God; the Power of God; the Presence of God, and here, the Prayer of God!

John says that we love, because he first loved us. Paul writes that we source our

strength in the joy of the Lord! We also find our peace there! The peace of God that passes all the confines of our own comprehension, and floods our hearts and minds with a tranquillity that takes charge of our emotions and wellbeing in fragile times! Peter speaks about the knowledge of God which suggests that even our definitions of theology need radical adjustment! It's not our knowledge of God! It's in God's knowledge of us that we are enlightened! David says, Your gentleness made me great!

Prayer is a love affair. You have God's undivided attention! He so longs for yours!

Phil. 4:6 Let no anxiety about anything [1]distract you! Rather translate moments into prayerful worship, and soak your requests in gratitude before God! *(The word [1]**merimnao**, anxiety, through the idea of distraction, from **meritzo**, to divide. Your requests do not surprise God; he knows your thoughts from afar and is acquainted with all your ways; yet he delights in your conversation and childlike trust! Song of Songs 2:14; Mat 6:8.)*

Phil. 4:7 And in this place of worship and gratitude you will witness how the peace of God within you [1]echoes the awareness of your oneness in Christ Jesus beyond the reach of any thought that could possibly unsettle you. Just like the [2]sentry guard secures a city, watching out in advance for the first signs of any possible threat, your deepest feelings and the tranquillity of your thoughts are fully guarded there. *(The word, [1]**uperecho** translates, echoes ...beyond the reach of. And, φρουρέω [2]**phroureō** guarding the gates of the city. This peace is not measured by external circumstances, it is residing deeply in the innermost parts of your being. We are not talking about a fragile sense of peace that can easily be disturbed; one that we have to fabricate ourselves; this is God's peace; the peace that God himself enjoys! This peace surpasses all the confines of our own reasonings, and floods our hearts and minds with a tranquillity that takes charge of our emotions and wellbeing in fragile times!)*

2 Tim. 1:3 I love the [1]constant [2]thought of you; I am aware of our union in Christ 24/7. [3]Prayer is such a permanent thing when we discover God's [4]grace-echo in our [5]worship! Our [6]conscience celebrates our [7]pre-creation [8]innocence before God! *(The word [1]**adialeiptos**, means without interruption; [2]**mneia**, remembrance; [3]**deeisis**, prayer, from **deo**, to bind in agreement - see reference in Eph. 4:3 below; [3]**charin echo**, grace echo, sometimes translated as thanksgiving; [5]**latreuo**, to worship without obligation, not under compulsion; [6]**suneido**, conscience, to see together [with God]; [7]**progonos**, before birth; [8]**katharos**, innocence, clean, pure. We celebrate an innocence that pre-dates Adam's fall! We have allowed an illegitimate sin-*

consciousness to prevail in our theologies and worship! The prodigal son's father had no reference to, or remembrance of past sins; imagine how that would spoil the party!

See reference to the root word in ***Eph. 4:3 Being alert to treasure our oneness in spirit; encapsulated in peace.*** *[The word* ***sundesmos*** *from* ***sun****, a primary Preposition denoting union and* ***deo*** *to bind in agreement like in a marriage. The word* [1]***eirene****, means peace, from* ***eiro****, to join, to be set at one again; in carpentry it is referred to as the dove-tail joint, which is the strongest of joints. Peace is a place of unhindered enjoyment of friendship.])*

Eph. 6:18 Prayer is an ongoing conversation; praying in the spirit includes every form of prayer, whether it be a prayer of request or a prayer of thanksgiving, or worship or interceding for all to realize their saintly innocence. Oh, and remember, you do not have to do all the talking! Always be attentive to the voice of the Spirit. *(Prayer is so much more than a one-way conversation.)*

Prayer is not about putting pressure on God to bless you!

So many sincere believers have over the years, struggled to come to grips with the illusive victorious life and exhausted every altar call to dedicate and re-rededicate their lives at every opportunity; struggling to get "assurance"!

I am convinced that it has been the result, not of a lack of sincerity on either the preacher or the convert's part, but very much a case of ignorance-based, wrong preaching that resulted in wrong believing.

So many Christian teachings reduced faith to be just another set of rules and recipes, demanding guilt- and duty-driven decisions and discipline. Rom. 3:27.

All willpower-driven energy remains trapped in a system of performance measured by success or failure, praise and guilt. Beginning with the sinner's prayer-formula, to the many discipleship disciplines diligently taught, we were introduced into a whirlpool of emotions that came and went with the next youth camp, seminar or visiting evangelist.

By the way, there is no record in scripture, where Jesus or any of the apostles employed the typical sinners-prayer as method to convert people. Yet much of the evangelistic emphasis adopted various ideas to help introduce people to Christ in the popular "repeat after me" recipe. Followed by a bold, "and now you are born again!" remark, with all the forms and statistics filed for follow-up reference etc.

There are libraries full of Christian books on the "how to's", and "six steps to this", then "ten steps to that". This so reminds of the forty wasted years of an already redeemed Israel, led by their unbelieving leaders, through lap after lap of the same old wilderness - where, eventually an entire generation perishes on the wrong side of the promise - wasted years and wasted lives! Their leaders taught them to believe a lie about themselves! See Num 13:33 and Joshua 2:11. And mind-you, while they witnessed the supernatural on a 24/7 basis for forty years, they still died because of unbelief! Heb 4:2. Which just goes to show that the supernatural is not proof of faith!

Fasting and praying are not requirements to get God to move on our behalf! God's move in Christ is already complete. Fasting is just an extended opportunity to feast on God's goodness. It's also good for your health from time to time! We're not fasting towards spiritual breakthrough or blessing but from a consciousness of our co-seatedness with Christ in heavenly places!

The scripture "this kind does not come out but through prayer & fasting" does not

appear in the original text, it was added later!

God is not a slot machine who we can manipulate with our prayers, praise or pleas; or even our personal sacrifice, if we just try long and hard enough to overcome his reluctance to "bless" us!

Hey, and God does not have a plan B. We pray the wrong prayer by asking God to tear open the heavens and send us revival! God does not owe this world anything. He already revived us together with Christ on the 3rd day. This was the grandest revival of all time - now wake up to it; engage your thoughts with throne room realities! Col. 3:1-3

There is no pending, or postponed revival!

John 7:38 In your realizing that I am what the Scriptures are all about, you will discover uniquely for yourself, face to face with me, that you are what I am all about and rivers of living waters will gush out of your innermost being! *(Note, Holy Spirit is an outpouring, not an in-pouring!)*

We are already blessed with every blessing heaven has; problem is we have distanced ourselves mentally by believing lies about ourselves, one another and of God! Jesus didn't come to negotiate with God to bless us if we jump through all the hoops! He is God's mind made up about us! He mirrors the Father. Jesus is what God believes about you; in his incarnation he proofs the integrity of your design. He is the Engineer of your being. There is nothing wrong with our design or our redemption! Our thoughts have gone astray, but his hasn't! The Shepherd never forsook the sheep!

We have spent and wasted so much time in our Christian journey, trying to get "there", when "there" is where we are to begin with! You cannot get more co-seated than what we already are! Eph. 2:5,6. You can be a lot more aware of it though! Col. 3:1-3.

Paul writes in Philippians 4, that he has discovered the secret to be super satisfied regardless of any extreme circumstance. Abundance is not a sign of God's goodness, neither is lack a sign of God's absence. Gossip or praise make no difference when you are persuaded about God's opinion of you!

Hidden treasures are there to remind us of the wealth that is hidden within each and everyone of us! Gold does not become gold when you discover it but it certainly becomes currency!

A little girl who had just lost her front teeth, asked her teacher to take a bite into her

apple, just to help her get 'thtarted.'

Engaging in worship - how to get started?

Worship is the awareness of our oneness! Distance is an illusion. Immanuel cancelled every definition of separation. God is closer to you than your next breath. Prayer does not begin with your need but with acknowledging God's nearness. He is not more Immanuel to some than what he is to others!

Jesus is God's yes to you; every promise of God is made yes in Jesus; we echo the Amen!

Your innocence is successfully redeemed; agree with God about you.

Allow yourself to be overwhelmed with God's fondness and love for you. Immanuel means that God is inseparably one with you, and does not desire to ever be apart from you!

Thanksgiving, Prayer Requests, Supplications and Intercession

Our eldest son, Renaldo was born on the 5th February 1981, in Nelspruit Mpumalanga, South Africa. It was a very difficult and complicated birth since the baby was several weeks late and exceptionally big!

I was praying in tongues most of the time whilst watching the doctors struggling with the delivery, until, I eventually passed out! Lydia was in labour for 18 hours!

The joy of holding Renaldo in our arms soon made the agonizing hours of labor fade in memory.

A few months later, we noticed that the frontal seam of his head had closed prematurely. Two of my uncles were very well-known medical Doctors in South Africa at the time, and with their sons also being doctors, we had the best medical advice and support.

They arranged for us to go to Pretoria where a top neurologist and neurosurgeon would attend to Renaldo.

It was a massive challenge for us - Lydia was allowed to stay with our baby in hospital and I spent my time in and out of the hospital and hardly slept at all.

The doctors immediately advised an operation and my uncles all said that we had no other option.

At the time I was doing a study of all the Hebrew words used in the Psalms for praise and worship. Early the next morning, just after their report, I had an amazing encounter with Abba while studying the Hebrew word Todah in Psalm 50. It felt to me that I was trapped in a dark hole with no light or ventilation. Then, suddenly, a bold joy sparked within me and as I broke out in praise, the room lit up with light!

Psa 50:2 Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God shines forth. Then in the context of this Psalm Jaweh says - do not engage me with blood sacrifices engage me with the fruit of your lips; announcing by Todah the perfection of beauty that shines forth out of Zion - and I will show you, your salvation - Jeshua

TODAH - תודה to show gratitude in advance! A gratitude which is anchored in the promised Messiah!

And in Ancient Hebrew, edft also reading from right to left, the letter Tau is a cross [!!!], then the letter Waw, is a peg symbolizing to anchor, or secure something; then the letter Dalet is symbolizing a door on the horizon! And finally the letter, ***hey*** ה

which in Ancient Hebrew pictures a person with raised hands, as when looking at a great sight; thus, meaning, "breath" or "sigh," as one does when seeing something wonderful and pointing it out. It is the breath-sound and core letter in the Name of God, יהוה Jaweh. And also the addition to Abram's and name that God gave him to be Abra***ha***m!

Todah means, to break forth into gratitude for something that is already seen on the prophetic horizon! The cross secures the door that opens into wow!

We checked out of the hospital that same day and took our baby home! Obviously against the wishes of my precious medical family. [We are not at all against the amazing medical profession and medicine! Thank God for them and for what they do! - This brief testimony is just to bless you with our story from 40 years ago!]

Today, our darling, six foot seven inches tall Renaldo, turning 40 soon, is an absolute genius and sparkling light! [His partner is a medical Doctor by the way!]

Many years ago I met a young Jewish Rabbi whom I shared this Todah-testimony with; he then told me that in their typical Jewish praying, they would always begin with Worship and the overwhelming awareness of God's greatness; then they would move on to Todah; and in that place of joyful celebration, their requests and intercessions take on a brand new perspective!

Jer 32:17 Ah, Lord God! Behold, You have made the heavens and the earth by your great power and by your outstretched arm! There is nothing too difficult or too wonderful for you!

I would challenge you to worship beyond religious routine; then, soak your prayer requests, supplications and intercessions in Todah! And from that place, live the prayer-adventure!

Worship is where our hearts entwine with his thoughts – and his thoughts merge with our understanding - this is what the word KAWA means in Isaiah 40:31

It was always translated to 'wait' upon the Lord - waiting can be very boring! Intertwining is most exciting!

We are wired by design to entwine!

Phil. 4:7 And in this place of worship and gratitude you will witness how the peace of God within you [1]echoes the awareness of your oneness in Christ Jesus beyond the reach of any thought that could possibly unsettle you. Just like the [2]sentry guard secures a city, watching out in advance for the first signs of any

possible threat, your deepest feelings and the tranquillity of your thoughts are fully guarded there. *(The word, [1]**uperecho** translates, echoes ...beyond the reach of. And, φρουρέω [2]**phroureō** guarding the gates of the city. This peace is not measured by external circumstances, it is residing deeply in the innermost parts of your being. We are not talking about a fragile sense of peace that can easily be disturbed; one that we have to fabricate ourselves; this is God's peace; the peace that God himself enjoys! This peace surpasses all the confines of our own reasonings, and floods our hearts and minds with a tranquillity that takes charge of our emotions and wellbeing in fragile times!)*

Rom. 8:18 He has taken the sting out of our suffering; what seemed burdensome at the time, becomes insignificant in comparison to the glory he reveals in us. *(See 2 Cor 4:16-18.)*

Rom. 8:19 Our lives now represent the one event every creature anticipates with held breath, standing on tip-toe as it were to witness the unveiling of the sons of God. Can you hear the drum-roll?

Rom. 8:20 Every creature suffered abuse through Adam's fall; they were discarded like a squeezed-out orange. Creation did not volunteer to fall prey to the effect of the fall. Yet within this stark setting, hope prevails.

Rom. 8:21 All creation knows that the glorious liberty of the sons of God sets the stage for their own release from [1]decay. *(2 Cor 11:3 I am concerned for you that you might [1]pine away through the illusion of separation from Christ and that, just like Eve, you might become blurry-eyed and deceived into believing a lie about yourselves. The temptation was to exchange the truth about our completeness [I am] with the idea of incompleteness [I am not] and shame; thinking that perfection required your toil and all manner of wearisome labor! [The word, [1]**phteiro**, means to pine or waste away, to whither. Any idea of separation causes one to whither away in loneliness!])*

Rom. 8:22 We sense the global agony and pain recorded in history until this very moment.

Rom. 8:23 We ourselves feel the grief echo of their groaning within us while we are ready to embrace the original blueprint also of our physical stature to the full consequence of sonship. What we already now participate in as first fruits of the spirit, will bloom into a full gathering of the harvest. *(The glorified physical body [Mt 17]. Also the full realization of everything reconciled in Christ. In James 1:18, "It was his delightful resolve to give birth to us; we were conceived by the unveiled logic of God, the*

Word of truth." We lead the exhibition of his handiwork, like first fruits introducing the rest of the harvest he anticipates.)

Rom. 8:24 For what we already experience confirms our hope and continues to fuel our expectation for what we still cannot see. In the final visible completeness of the harvest, hope has fulfilled its function.

Rom. 8:25 In the meantime our expectation takes us beyond visual confirmation into a place of patient contentment.

Rom. 8:26 The Spirit also sighs within us with words too deep for articulation, assisting us in our prayers when we struggle to know how to pray properly. When we feel restricted in our flesh, he supersedes our clumsy efforts and hits bulls-eye every time. *(He continues to call things which seem non-existent as though they were! [Rom 4:17]. He is never distracted, he only sees and celebrates perfection.)*

Rom. 8:27 He who scrutinizes the heart understands the intention of the spirit. His [1]intercession for the saints is consistent with the blue-print purpose of God. *("I knew you even before I fashioned you in your mother's womb" [Jer 1:5]. "Then you will know, even as you have always been known." [1 Cor 13:12]. He knows us so much better than what we know ourselves. He intercedes for us, [1]**entungchano**, means to hit the target with an arrow or javelin. He is not trying to persuade God about us, he persuades us about the Father! He brings our conversation back to the point; the success of the cross.)*

Rom. 8:28 Meanwhile we know that the love of God causes everything to mutually contribute to our advantage. His Master Plan is announced in our original identity. *(Called according to his purpose, **kaleo**, meaning to surname, to identify by name.)*

Worship beyond religious routine.

John 4:21 Jesus said unto her, "Believe me lady, the moment everyone was waiting for has come! From now on worship is no longer about a geographic holy mountain - or a sacred city in Israel experience! *(It is not whether you are a Jew in Jerusalem or a Gentile in Japan! The days of prophetic pictures are over!)*

John 4:22 You have been worshiping in ignorance all along while the Jews continue to anticipate the Messiah in their devotion, knowing that the promise pointing to the Savior of the world would be emerging from within. *(The Samaritans were a mixed race and only received the five books of Moses while they rejected the Prophets. 2 Kings 17:28-34.)*

John 4:23 The end of an era has arrived - the future is here! Whatever prophetic values were expressed in external devotional forms and rituals are now eclipsed in true spirit worship from within, [1]face to face with the Father - acknowledging our genesis in him - this is his delight! The Father's desire is the [1]worshipper more than the worship! *(Whatever it was that time pointed to, is now present in me. The word often translated worship, [1]**proskuneo**, from **pros**, face to face and **kuneo**, which I would like to believe to be a derivation of **koinonia**, joint-participation; rather than **kuon** which means dog. I know, some tried to connect the idea of a dog licking its master's hand, which then became a possibility of kissing. I prefer a divine face to face koinonia encounter to define true worship! Although, I do believe that dogs, often referred to as man's best friend because of the very nature of their devotion to their master, has its Greek root connected - **koinonia** is a friendship word to begin with and in it is therefore possible to see its etymological link. This is the only reference to the noun [2]**proskunētēs**, worshipper, in the New Testament. See Extended Commentary at the end of the Mirror Bible.)*

John 4:24 God is Spirit and not a holy mountain or a sacred city with man-made shrines! Return to your Source - the Father is our true fountainhead! *(You are not defined by your physical birth, your domestic life, your history, your culture or your religion!)*

It is amazing how small your needs and requests become when you focus on God's incarnate awesomeness, unveiled in you. This is your true prayer-perspective.

God desires to be so much more in you than a 'quick-fix' spare-wheel solution.

It is not the degree or severity of our needs that inspire fervent and effective prayer,

but the certainty of our faith, in the accomplished work of Jesus.

"Behold I am the Lord, the God of all flesh; is anything too hard for me? Ah, Lord God! You have made the heavens and the earth by your great power and by your outstretched arm. Nothing is too difficult for you. Great and mighty God, you are great in counsel and mighty in deed. Jer. 32:17,27.

2 Cor. 4:13 We [1]echo the exact same spirit of faith David had when he wrote: "I [2]believe and so I speak!" We too believe and so we speak! Our persuasion is our conversation. *(The word, [1]**echo**, means to hold or to embrace. Paul quotes David here in Psalm 116; sometimes one's soul wants to gallop away into distraction like a wild horse; then, David reminds himself, "Return to your rest, oh my soul, for the Lord has dealt bountifully with you! I believe, and so I speak!" God's bountiful dealings with us in Christ is our only valid rest; Sabbath celebrates perfection! "Behold, it is very good!" Gen 1:31,2:2 And remember God does not employ circumstances to teach us something! The finished work of Christ teaches us; his work on the cross rescued us! Ps 116:7,10 I [2]believe; I am sure, אמן **aw-man**, with the root meaning, to build up, or support; to foster as a parent or nurse; figuratively to render [or be] firm or faithful, to trust or believe, to be permanent or quiet; to be true or certain; to go to the right hand: - hence assurance, [relocate yourself mentally where you are co-seated together with Christ in God's right hand!] Also, the word, amen, so be it.*

*Hebrew word to speak, דבר **dabar**, to arrange words in such a way that their effect is to persuade with clarity. [Like a lawyer's letter; using legal language.]*

*Then David uses the word, ענה **anah**, which was translated, 'afflicted', but the same word is also used to respond; by extension to begin to speak; specifically to sing, shout, testify, announce: - give account, which is a much more appropriate rendering of this word in context! The Hebrew actually says: I will sing loudly! Remember Paul sang in prison!*

Let faith speak. Let faith break out in song!)

Every blessing heaven has is lavished upon us in Christ! Eph 1:3. God owes us nothing! Imagine how this revelation would change someone's prayer life! Give gratitude your voice!

When faced with tough times, one can become so burdened down with negative stuff. Whatever it is you're going through - whether you've suffered loss or insult or abuse; somehow, you forget who you are and what you've got! I remember a time many years ago, where we have lost everything and experienced incredible challenges - I

struggled to sleep and felt angry often - I would eventually fall asleep miserable and wake up grumpy! Lydia said that I no longer spoke, I just sighed!

Then very early one morning, I felt inspired to get my thoughts into a gratitude gym! I would imagine how one goes through a gym from one piece of equipment to the next - and just do it, knowing that you will see results if you keep at it! I was desperate to snap out of a negativity that I've never known before. So, I would line up things that I can be grateful for, and began to ponder them one by one. In the process I also consciously acknowledged the Father's goodness and presence, even when I felt nothing! And, guess what! Joy wins! It is not possible to engage genuine gratitude, without it affecting your emotions and mind and conversation!

If air conditioning can do it, your conversation can change the atmosphere!

Phil. 4:4 Joy is not a luxury option; joy is your constant! Your union in the Lord is your permanent source of delight; so I might as well say it again, rejoice in the Lord always!

Phil. 4:5 This kind of joy empowers you to show perfect [1]courtesy towards all people! The Lord is not nearer to some than what he is to others! *(The word, [1]**epieikes**, from **epi**, indicating continuous influence upon, and **eikos**, reasonable, courteous. This is exactly Paul's attitude towards the idol worshipping Greek philosophers in Acts 17:27,28. See also Titus 3:3. Your joy makes the gospel visible and irresistible! Every definition of distance is cancelled, as well as every excuse to feel miserable and neglected!)*

Phil. 4:8 Now let this be your conclusive [1]reasoning: consider that which is [2]true about everyone as evidenced in Christ. Live [3]overwhelmed by God's opinion of you! Acquaint yourselves with the revelation of [4]righteousness; realize God's likeness in you. Make it your business to declare mankind's redeemed [5]innocence. Think [6]friendship. Discover how [7]famous everyone is in the light of the gospel; mankind is in God's limelight! Ponder how [8]elevated you are in Christ. Study [9]stories that celebrate life. *(See Col 3:3, "Engage your thoughts with throne room realities where we are co-seated together with Christ!" The word [1]**logitsomai** suggests a logical reasoning by taking everything into account; [2]**alethes**, means that which was hidden, but is now uncovered; In Eph 3:21 Paul speaks about the truth as it is embodied in Jesus. The word overwhelmed is, [3]**semnos**, from **sebomai**, to revere, to adore. The word for righteousness is [4]**dikaios**, from **dikay**, two parties finding likeness in each other, where there is no sense of inferiority, suspicion, blame, regret or pressure to*

*perform. The gospel is the revelation of the righteousness of God; it declares how God succeeded to put mankind right with himself. It is about what God did right, not what Adam did wrong. See Rom 1:17. The word [5]**hagnos** speaks of blameless innocence. The word [6]**prophileo,** is exactly what it says, pro-friendship. The English word for famous is derived from the Greek word [7]**euphemos**, from **eu**, well done, good and **phemos**; it means to be in the lime light, from **phao**, to shine; Jesus said, "you are the light of the world." Just like a city set on a hill, your light cannot be hid. The word [8]**arete**, is often translated, virtue, from **airo**, to raise up, to elevate; [9]**epainos**, commendable, praise worthy, from **epi**, indicating continuous influence upon, and **ainos**, story.)*

Phil. 4:12 I am not defined by abuse or abundance! It might be a different day and a different place, but the secret remains the same; whether I am facing a feast or a fast, a fountain or famine. *(Abundance is not a sign of God's goodness; neither is lack a sign of his absence! "Righteousness by his (God's) faith defines life." The good news is the fact that the Cross of Christ was a success. God rescued the life of our design; he redeemed our innocence. Mankind would never again be judged righteous or unrighteous by their own ability to obey moral laws! It is not about what someone must or must not do but about what Jesus has done! It is from faith to faith, and not a person's good or bad behavior or circumstances interpreted as a blessing or a curse [Hab 2:4]. Instead of reading the curse when disaster strikes, Habakkuk realizes that the Promise out-dates performance as the basis to mankind's acquittal. Deuteronomy 28 would no longer be the motivation or the measure of right or wrong behavior! "Though the fig trees do not blossom, nor fruit be on the vines, the produce of the olive fail and the fields yield no food, the flock be cut off from the fold and there be no herd in the stalls, yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will joy in the God of my salvation. God, the Lord, is my strength; he makes my feet like hinds' feet, he makes me tread upon my high places [Hab 3:17-19 RSV]. "Look away [from the law of works] to Jesus; he is the Author and finisher of faith." [Heb 12:1]. See Rom 1:17.)*

Phil. 4:13 In every situation I am strong in the one who empowers me from within to be who I am! *(Paul lived his life in touch with this place within himself. He discovered that the same I-am-ness that Jesus walked in, was mirrored in him! I am what I am by the grace of God! Christ in me, mirrors Christ in you! Phil 2:12, "Not only in my presence but much more in my absence! Col 1:27 In us God desires to exhibit the priceless treasure of Christ's indwelling; every nation will recognize him as in a mirror! The unveiling of Christ in human life completes mankind's every expectation. He is not hiding in history,*

or in outer space nor in the future, neither in the pages of Scripture, he is merely mirrored there to be unveiled within you. Mt 13:44, Gal 1:15, 16.)

Our prayers and worship now blend in harmony with the eternal reflection and ascension of earth's praise, the adoration not of men only but of all created things. Elizabeth Goudge.

Like bird-song or the fragrance of flowers and incense, every minute molecule and vibrating atom has a voice, saluting the Maker. Listen up! Beyond the silence their voice echoes like the sound of many waters and like mighty thunder.

The awakening to, and engaging in Spirit dimension is not a gradual evolving into spirit awareness – it is not in any way time related – it's as immediate as one's next breath and as refreshing as plunging into a cool pool of mountain water on a hot summers day and as all-consuming as falling head over heels in love! It eclipses night and day; time and season.

Just like the earth is eclipsed by galaxies of planets, moons and stars of innumerable quantities and mind-boggling dimensions, so, the sphere of our visible world is eclipsed in Spirit dimension beyond all comparison! The "heavens" are far more spectacular in every definition, than a mere distant, geographical location, somewhere in outer space! It spans the horizons of Eternity; the ages of the ages are engulfed here and yet closer to us than our breath or thought!

Heavenly places are not located in "Outer Space"! It is living from within! Use your GPS! God's Positioning is our Seamless union!

Jesus did not point to the sky when he gave the address of the kingdom of God; he said, "The kingdom of God is within you!" Luke 17:21

Also Math 13:44 The Kingdom of heaven is the treasure, buried, redeemed and now revealed in the field!

Col. 1:26 Mankind's most sought after quest, the mystery which has remained elusive and concealed for ages and generations, is now fully realized in our redeemed innocence. *(It is indeed Christ in us! This concludes our every expectation. Col. 1:27)*

Here are my notes on an open heaven at the end of Revelation 13

Notes on An Open Heaven

"Jesus has united heaven and earth, the life of God and human life in himself. Just as it was planned before the time of the ages." Dr Baxter Kruger.

Rev 3:7 And to the messenger of the Ekklesia of [1]Philadelphia write, I am the Holy and True one! I hold the key of David as prophesied in [1]Isaiah 22:22! Yes, I [2]unlock the mysteries of the heavenly dimension and no one can shut the door! And I lock the entrance and none *(of the old legalistic mindsets)* **can access it!** *([1]**Philadelphos**, from **philos**, fondness; friendship, and **adelphos**, the same womb; immediate family; kinsfolk; household. [2]Isaiah 22:22 And I will place on his shoulder the key of the house of David; he shall open, and none shall shut; and he shall shut, and none shall open. The word [2]**anoigo** from **ana** upward and **agoo**, to lead! Also Ezek 34: 23 Then I will place one shepherd over them, my servant David, and he will take care of them. He will take care of them and be their shepherd.)*

Rev 3:20 You have shut me out in your self-righteousness *[Laodicea]*, **but behold, here I stand knocking at the door! If anyone [1]recognizes my voice and lets me in, I am so ready to join you for a feast! Yes, I will dine with you and you with me!** *(Song of Songs 5:2 I was asleep, but my heart was awake.* ***It is the voice of my beloved who knocks****: "Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled; for my head is filled with dew, and my hair with the dampness of the night." Rev 3:3 Remember therefore what it felt like when you first heard and embraced the word as your own! It was like discovering a priceless treasure! Now make up your mind once and for all! Why should I surprise you like a thief and break into your space whilst you are fast asleep and not even anticipating my intimate intent, not knowing the moment of my visitation? See John 10:2, The shepherd of the sheep enters by the door. [In the context of Jesus' conversation he emphasizes the fact that the Shepherd-Messiah would surely only enter by the door; which is* ***[1]the familiar voice of the prophetic word****.]*

Rev 3:21 *[Through this door of my death as your death, and my resurrection as your resurrection]* **- we now dine together in the throne room, [1]celebrating your victory mirrored in mine! This is my gift to you; it is on exactly the same basis of [2]my victory celebration and my joint seatedness with my Father in his throne-room!** *(The word [1]**nikoon**, is the Present Active Participle, form of the verb **nikao**, to conquer; to emphasize a continual or habitual victory. Note the words, **hōs kagō enikēsa** where [2]**enikesa** is the first Aorist Active Indicative of the same verb, **nikaō**, looking back*

*on the victory as over in the past. A.T. Roberston compares this to John 16:33 where before the Cross Jesus says **egō nenikēka ton kosmon** which is in the Perfect Active tense of the same verb **nikao**, emphasizing the abiding effect of the victory!)*

Rev 3:22 Now listen up with your inner ears! Hear with understanding what the Spirit is saying to the Ekklesia! *(Paul prays in Ephesians that the eyes of our understanding will be flooded with light that we may see our co-seatedness!)*

Rev 4:1 [1]Talking about our co-seatedness, I want you to see something! Oh wow! What I see takes my breath away! A [2]wide-open door in the heavenly realm! The first thing I heard was this voice addressing me! It was distinct and clear, like the sound of a trumpet; it captured my attention, inviting me to enter. "Come up here and I will show you how everything [3]coincides with what you have already seen!" *(I saw **[eidon]** second Aorist Active Indicative of **horaō**. Behold **[idou]** exclamation of vivid emotion as John looked, "With this I saw!"Most translations would translate **meta tauta** with, "after this" The word **[1]meta** however refers to, with this; coinciding with this! [Our co-seatedness and enjoying feasting together with him! Rev 3:20 and 21. Robertson suggests that it is a change in the panorama, not chronology.*

*The word **[2]eneogmene** is the Perfect Passive Participle of **anoigō** to open, from **ana**, upward and **ago**, to lead; as in Rev 3:8 [door of opportunity] and Rev 3:20 [door of the heart] **A dimension of limitless possibilities open, right in front of my eyes!** The Passive Participle describes a state that exists at the time coincident with that of the leading verb as a result of action completed prior to the time of the main verb, behold! Thus John witnessed the opening of the door. The Perfect Tense denotes an action which is completed in the past, but the effects of which are regarded as continuing into the present. The verb **genesthai** is not the future of the verb [1]to be; it is the Aorist Infinitive where the thought is not the prophetic, but the necessity of the inevitable consequence as a result of the crucified and risen Christ! John again, as in verse 1, employs the verb, **ginomai**, to beget, in the Aorist Infinitive tense, **genesthai**, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. Greek Infinitives could have either a Present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms was not necessarily one of time, it is a difference of aspect. The Present Infinitive was used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end.)*

Rev 4:2 So here I am, immersed in this unrestricted space of spirit ecstasy. As the

vision opens I immediately notice the throne and One seated upon it. *("Having accomplished purification for sins he sat down!" His throne is proof of mankind's redeemed innocence! This unveiling is central to the throne-theme. See Heb 1:1-4 in the Mirror.)*

Rev 4:4 And coiled into a complete circle around the throne were twenty four thrones with twenty four [1]Presbyterians seated upon the thrones. They were enwrapped in white with [2]victors' wreaths of gold crowning their heads! Their minds were co-enthroned in the authority of the throne engulfing them in their co-seatedness! *(In the symbolic language of Revelation, we have a circle of people representing the entire human race. [1]Typo drawn again from the Jewish Sanhedrin,* ***suneidron*** *- a co-seatedness around the throne - the 24* ***presbuterians*** *or [1]Elders picture the twelve prophetic Patriarchs and the twelve Apostles, here, as two dispensations merged into one, now fully representing the entire Ekklesia. The word* ***kuklothen*** *is the adverb from* ***kuklo****; to form a circle, that is, all around; from* ***kulioō****, a rolling together. From the base of* ***kuma****, from* ***kuō****, to swell [with young], that is, bend, curve; a billow, as bursting or toppling: - thus, a wave; through the idea of circularity. The word [2]****stephanos****, is a victor's wreath.*

Much of what John saw, reflected in the Jewish mind as familiar prophetic pointers and symbols. See the prophetic imagery in Ezekiel 1:1-28. The symbolic pictures John sees of judgment would immediately remind his typical Jewish audience of their prophets imaginary of judgment. This time the slaughtered and risen Lamb brings brand new context! Israel's unfaithfulness is met and eclipsed by God's faithfulness. The Lamb's death and resurrection confronts every idea of judgment that was mankind's due.)

John 1:50 Jesus said, "So you believe because I say I saw you sitting under the fig tree? You haven't seen anything yet!

John 1:51 Truly I say unto you, Nathaniel *[singular]*, **because of who I am, you** *[plural - You-manity - all the families in heaven and on earth]* **will surely see this communication between the heavenly sphere and earth thrown wide [1]open and the celestial messengers of God ascending and descending upon the Incarnate son of man. Heaven and earth meet in the Incarnate one!** *(In him every definition of separation and distance is cancelled! Isaiah 55:10,11 "For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven, and return not there without saturating the earth [all flesh], so shall my word be that goes forth from my mouth; it shall not return to me empty, but it shall accomplish that which I purpose, and prosper in the thing for which I sent it.*

*The prophetic word was destined to become flesh; every nook and cranny of human life is saturated in the incarnation! The word **aneogota**, Perfect Active Participle Accusative Masculine Singular, 2nd Conjugation-form; the one who has led us upward- from **anoigō, ana**, upward and **agoo**, to lead! Jesus reminds Nathaniel of Genesis 28:12-14 And Jacob dreamt that there was a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven; and behold, the celestial messengers of God were ascending and descending on it! And Jahweh said to him, I am Elohim of Abraham, your seed shall be like the dust of the earth, and you shall spread abroad to the west and to the east and to the north and to the south; and in you and your descendants have all the families of the earth been blessed!)*

Rev. 13:3 One of its heads appeared to be [1]slain then it miraculously revived and was restored to health again. The entire human race was mesmerized by this. *(Here the "Christian-Religion" is represented by the same multi-headed Beast - mimicking the slain and resurrected Lamb - Only John uses the word, [1]**sphatzo**, which speaks of a brutal slaying. Four times in the book of Revelation he employs this word with direct reference to the slain Lamb of God, and once in 1 John 3:12 in reference to Cain's [1]killing of his brother Abel. See my commentary notes there.*

There is no saving power or relevance in a death and resurrection-belief that fails to see mankind's co-inclusion in the same event. In the mind and belief of God, an inseparable association exists, where, together with Jesus, mankind died and the same human race was co-revived and co-raised! Hosea 6:2 After two days he will revive us on the third day he will raise us up! This happened while we were still dead in our sins and trespasses. Eph 2:5,6.)

Rev. 13:4 They all worshiped both the Dragon who gave its power to the Beast as well as the Beast itself. Convinced that it had no equal and that it was invincible. *(The Dragon is the source-system of accusation empowering the Beast of the religion of performance and self-effort with its inevitable fruit of judgment and condemnation.)*

Rev. 13:5 The Beast, was given a loud, boastful and blasphemous mouth for the duration of forty two months. *(See v 2, The Dragon gave its assumed power to the Beast; also its throne and great authority. Forty and two months - **mēnas tesserakonta kai duo** - accusative of extent of time. This period is also mentioned in Dan 7:25 and Dan 12:7. It occurs in three forms in Revelation, forty-two months, here; **1260 days**, Rev 11:3; Rev 12:6; **time, times and half a time** or **3-1/2 years**, Rev 12:14 and so in Daniel. This symbolic period is is the duration of the sojourn of the woman in the wilderness, as*

well as the duration of the prophesying of the two witnesses, which is the culmination of the law and the prophets in the 3 and a half years of Jesus' ministry - from his baptism to his crucifixion. And he shall confirm the covenant with many for one week: and in the midst of the week he shall cause the sacrifice and the oblation to cease. Dan 9:27. The middle of the week - 3 and a half days, again prophetically pointing to the 3 and a half years of Jesus' ministry.)

Rev. 13:6 It hurled its accusations in God's face, while blaspheming his Name and tabernacle and those dwelling in the heavenlies. *(The words, [1]**pros ton theon** positions the Accuser to now face God's image and likeness incarnate in human form, since there was no trace of accusation present in the heavenlies, having been thoroughly expelled from any further presence or relevance in the heavenly sphere. [Rev 12:8-10] The significance of heaven endorsing the tabernacle of God on earth - in both its prophetic symbolism as well as its tangible unveiling in incarnate human life, is now the target of accusation and every blasphemous utterance of this Beast who takes its authority from Mr. Accusation himself!*

*And them that dwell in heaven; **kai tous en too ouranoo skenountas** - in contrast to those whose minds are still trapped in earthbound-mode! See verse 8.)*

Rev. 13:7 And it was given the mission to wage war against [1]those who have discovered their wholeness in Christ in order to conquer them and to dominate the entire spectrum of people-groupings; every tribe, tongue and nation. *(The word, [1]**hagios**, saints, refers to wholeness of body soul and spirit - see 1 Cor 1:30. The words remind of Dan 7:21,22,23. Where there seemed to be no escape from the Beast's rule. **However, the fact that the Beast failed in its mission is already celebrated in Rev 5:13 as well as in Rev 7:9** At this moment I saw a massive throng of people, impossible to count, standing tall and innocent; everyone of them dressed in white with palm branches in their hands; they have [1]escaped everything that could possibly define them as a non-Jewish, Gentile world! In fact, every sphere of society was there - including the entire spectrum of people-groupings; all tribal identities with their unique language-specific dialect preferences; they were all present facing the throne and the Lamb as the people of the planet! [The Preposition [1]**ek**, points to source or origin; mankind was delivered out of their national, geographical and historical identities! Seven times in the book of Revelation human society is addressed in the most all-inclusive fashion, with a similar grouping of words. Rev 5:9, Rev 7:9, Rev 10:11, Rev 11:9, here in Rev 13:7, Rev 14:6 and Rev 17:15. Also note Rev 5:13 and Rev 11:15.])*

Rev 13:8 The plan was to engage the entire [1]earthbound population of the planet to worship the Beast *[The counterfeit "slain and risen lamb"].* **This would endorse the idea** *[of the religious system],* **that there were individuals, since the fall of the [2]cosmos, whose names were not included in the slain Lamb's Book of Life.** *(The word [1]**katoikeō** from **kata**, down and **oikeo**, to dwell or set up home - ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς upon the earth - thus, the earthbound population of the planet. Paul invites us to engage our thoughts with resurrection realities and to see ourselves seated together with Christ in heavenly places! Col 3:1-3. The word, [2]**kosmos** in the NT refers to the entire human family and their social structures. See my notes on **The Lamb's Book of Life - Mankind's Redeemed Identity** at the end of Rev 17. Mirror Study Bible*

The "earthbound-dilemma" of mankind is addressed in the Incarnate Christ. *See notes on Armageddon at the end of Revelation 16. Mirror Study Bible.)*

Rev 19:11 Then, in my vision, heaven opened and I saw a white horse appear; and the name of the one seated upon the horse is Faithful and True. Righteousness spans the range of his judgment and warfare.

Eph. 3:15 Every family in heaven and on earth originates in him; his is mankind's family name and he remains the authentic identity of every nation.

Ephesians 1:3 Let's celebrate God! He lavished every blessing heaven has upon us in Christ!

Ephesians 4:8 [1]Scripture confirms that he [3]arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! ["he took captivity captive"] And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he [2]repossessed what belonged to us by design, [4]in human form; this is his grace-gift to us! *(In this verse Paul explains what he just declared in verse 7 - he wants us to know the extravagant extent and dimensions of the measure of the gift of Christ! Remember that he is writing from prison [Eph 4:1] He's not asking for prayers to get him out of jail! He is arrested in Christ - [4:1] my complete existence is defined and confined in him! He was once a prisoner of the law of performance, held hostage in his own body, crying in desperation, "Is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap?" [Rom 7] He now speaks as a prisoner of Christ! He is reminded of and obviously intrigued by the entire context of Psalm 67 which celebrates God rescuing the prisoners from their captivity and even the wayward and stubborn, who already died and are stuck in their graves! [mindsets] See Ps 67:6,7 He is the father of the orphans, and protector of the widows. God settles the lonely in a home; leading forth prisoners*

mightily, also the stubborn, even them that dwell in tombs! Paul sees by revelation the relevance of Jesus dying our death and entering into our darkness and hell on a rescue mission! Now he [1]quotes Ps 67:19 [from the LXX Septuagint - the Greek OT which is Ps 68 in the Masoretic Hebrew text], and sees captive mankind arrested in the death, descent into hell and the triumphant resurrection of the incarnate Word, in the man Jesus Christ. Ps 67:19 ἀνέβης εἰς ὕψος, ᾐχμαλώτευσας αἰχμαλωσίαν, ἔλαβες δόματα ἐν ἀνθρώπῳ - ***anebes eis hupsos, [3]echmaloteusas aichmaloosian, [2]elabes domata en*** *[in] [4]**anthropo** "You ascended on high, having taken captivity captive [[3]**arresting at spearpoint**! See 2 Cor 10:5] and [2]**repossessed mankind's gifts** in human form. The word [2]**elabes** from **lambano** means to take what is one's own. The word for the [4]human species, male or female is [4]**anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner. [The Masoretic Hebrew text, Ps 68:18,19,* לקחת מתנות באדם ***lakachat mattanoth ba adam** - "You have taken gifts in Adam." **The gifts which Jesus Christ distributes to us he has received in us, in and by virtue of his incarnation!** Adam Clarke.]*

Ps 67:19 LXX continues: καὶ γὰρ ἀπειθοῦντες τοῦ κατασκηνῶσαι - ***kai gar apeithountes tou kataskenoosai,*** *"in order that even the unbelievers, **apeithountes** - the ones resisting persuasion, the backsliding, the headstrong, the wayward, the rebellious may rest; or may now inhabit - **kataskenosai** - to encamp within - again this word emphasizes the significance of the incarnation - **kata**, down and **skenosai**, from **skenos** - skin! The eternal thoughts of God, the conversation that was before time was, is clothed in skin! John 1:1-3,14.*

See Rev 13:10, Being taken captive by the spear and killed by the sword [John 18:3] made death a doorway into the very domain in which mankind was held prisoner, [to be led out triumphantly in the resurrection as the Lamb's trophies!] After two days he will revive us! On the third day he will raise us up! Hosea 6:2 We were born anew in his resurrection. 1 Pet 1:3. Also Ephesians 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our deviations, we were co-quickened together with Christ!)

Ephesians 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. *(See John 3:13, "No one has ascended into heaven but he who descended from heaven, even the son of man." All mankind originate from above; we are **anouthen**, from above. See James 1:17, 18.)*

Ephesians 4:10 He now occupies the ultimate rank of authority, from the lowest

regions of our darkness into which he reached in order to rescue us, to the highest authority in the heavens, having executed his mission to the full. *(Fallen mankind is fully restored to the authority of the authentic life of their design. Psa 139:7 Where shall I go from Your Spirit? Or where shall I flee from Your faces? Plural* מפניך ***mippaneycha*** *Faces of Elohim. The plurality of persons in the Godhead is intended. Psa 139:8 If I go up to Heaven, You!* שמים שם אתה ***Shemayim Shem/Sham Atah.*** *The word* שמים ***shemayim****, the heavens [which is the plural of the next word],* ***Shem,*** *meaning, name or renown; the identical adverb* ***Sham*** *meaning, here, there. In Ancient Hebrew,* ms%*breath.*

Then the word, אתה *begins with* ***Aleph*** *and* ***Tav*** את *AT which are the first and last letters in the Hebrew Alphabet; the Rabbis interpret as the first matter out of which all things were formed, [see Gen 1:1]. The particle AT [pronounced,* ***et****], is untranslatable in English; but, says Rabbi Aben Ezra, "it signifies the substance of the thing!" Then follows the letter* ה ***hey****, in Ancient Hebrew, it is* e*, the man with raised hands pictures a sigh of wonder, "behold," as when looking at a great sight; thus, meaning, "breath" or "sigh," as one does when seeing something wonderful and pointing it out. The* ה ***[hey]*** *is also the number 5, which is the number for grace! The union of* ***Alpha*** *and* ***Omega*** *[which are the first and last letters in Greek], makes the verb* ***αω****, I breathe. And in Hebrew the union of the first and last letter in their alphabet,* את *[in modern Hebrew] are written,* ***Aleph*** *[bull's head] and* ***Tav*** *[the cross]* ta *in Ancient Hebrew!*

If I make my bed in Hades, your presence already fills it! LXX - πάρειμι ***pareimi*** *your immediate presence - I am! In the LXX, which is the Greek Septuagint [250 BC] it is Ps 138:8 [139 in the Hebrew text] See my notes on 1 Thess. 2:19.)*

Col 3:1 See yourselves co-raised with Christ! Now ponder with persuasion the consequence of your co-inclusion in him. Relocate yourselves mentally! Engage your thoughts with throne room realities where you are co-seated with Christ in the executive authority of God's right hand.

Col 3:2 Becoming affectionately acquainted with throne room thoughts will keep you from being distracted again by the earthly *[soul-ruled]* **realm.** *("Set your minds upon the things that are above and not upon the things below!" RSV. Whatever you face in your daily lives, acquaint yourselves with the greater reality! The things that are above! Do not engage the energy of the things that are below! Also note Romans 1:18, where the word* ***katecho*** *is used - to echo downwards is the opposite to* ***anoche****, to echo upward- Romans 2:4 and Romans 3:26. Also 2 Corinthians 4:18 "We are not*

keeping any score of what seems so obvious to the senses on the surface; it is fleeting and irrelevant; it is the unseen eternal realm within us which has our full attention and captivates our gaze!" A renewed mind conquers the space previously occupied by worthless pursuits and habits.

2 Cor 4:6 The light source is founded in the same God who said, "Light, be!" And light shone out of darkness! He lit the lamp in our understanding so that we may clearly recognize the features of his likeness in the face of Jesus Christ reflected within us. *(The same God who bade light shine out of darkness has kindled a light in our hearts, whose shining is to make known his glory as he has revealed it in the features of Jesus Christ. — Knox Translation)*

2 Cor 4:7 And now, in the glow of this glorious light and with unveiled faces we discover this treasure where it was hidden all along, in these frail skin-suits made of [1]clay. We did not invent ourselves; we are God's idea to begin with and the dynamic of his doing and amazing engineering! *(The word translated earthen vessel or clay jar is the word [1]**ostrakinos** from **ostrakon** "oyster"! It is a great visual picture of how we carry a very valuable pearl within us. The cosmetic value of the clay pot can never compete with the treasure it holds. There is so much more to you than what meets the eye! "The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in an agricultural field, which a man found and covered up; then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and buys the entire field." In order to redeem our minds from the lies that we believed about ourselves, God invested all that he has in the redeeming of our original value! See 1 Peter 1:18,19. He rescued the life of our design. Our inner life hosts this treasure. Jesus said in John 7:37,38, "If you believe that I am what the Scriptures are all about, you will know that you are what I am all about and rivers of living water will gush out of **your innermost being!**")*

2 Cor. 4:8 We often feel completely hemmed in on every side but our inner space remains unrestricted; when there seems to be no way out, we escape within!

2 Pet. 1:3 By his divine engineering he gifted us with all that it takes to live life to the full, where our ordinary day to day lives mirror our devotion and romance with our Maker. His intimate knowledge of us introduces us to ourselves again and elevates us to a position where his original intention is clearly perceived!

2 Pet. 1:5... Familiarize yourselves with every ingredient that faith unfolds! See there how elevated you are, and from within this position *[of your co-seatedness in Christ]*, **enlightened perspective will dawn within you.**

Rev. 22:17 The Spirit and the Bride beckons, "Come!" And let everyone in whom this bold bidding resonates, extend the same urgent invitation, "Oh yes, come!" This is for the thirsty to come and quench their deepest longings by freely drinking from the water of life! *(Hear the prophetic echo in Isaiah's pleading in chapter 55:1 Ho, every one! Your thirst drives you to the waters but you have no money; I urge you to buy without your currency and drink priceless wine and eat the finest wheat [ἄνευ ἀργυρίου καὶ τιμῆς [perceived value] οἴνου καὶ στέαρ - Ps. 147:3 -Septuagint: He satisfies you with the finest of the wheat.]*

Isa. 55:2 Why do you spend your money for that which is not bread, and your labor for that which does not satisfy? Hearken diligently to me, and eat what is good, and delight yourselves in fatness.

Isa. 55:3 Incline your ear, and come to me; hear, that your soul may live; and I will make with you an everlasting covenant, my steadfast, sure love for David.

Isa. 55:4 Behold, I made him a witness to the peoples, a leader and commander for the peoples.

Isa. 55:5 Behold, you shall call nations that you know not, and nations that knew you not shall run to you, because of the LORD your God, and of the Holy One of Israel, for he has glorified you.

Isa. 55:6 "Seek the LORD while he may be found, call upon him while he is near;

Isa. 55:7 let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts; let him return to the LORD, that he may have mercy on him, and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon.

Isa. 55:8 For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, says the LORD.

Isa. 55:9 For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts than your thoughts.

Isa 55:10 "For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven, and return not thither but water the earth, making it bring forth and sprout, giving seed to the sower and bread to the eater,

Isa 55:11 so shall my word be that goes forth from my mouth; it shall not return to me empty, but it shall accomplish that which I purpose, and prosper in the thing for which I sent it.

Isa 55:12 "For you shall go out in joy, and be led forth in peace; the mountains and the

hills before you shall break forth into singing, and all the trees of the field shall clap their hands.

Isa 55:13 Instead of the thorn shall come up the cypress; instead of the brier shall come up the myrtle; and it shall be to the LORD for a memorial, for an everlasting sign which shall not be cut off.")

The Lord's Prayer like you've never seen it before!

Luke 11:1 He was praying in a certain place one day and when he paused, one of his disciples asked him to teach them to pray, just like John taught his followers. *(Imagine how loaded Jesus' prayer was with the content and focus of his mission!)*

Luke 11:2 He said, [1]whenever you pray, say, Father! Your Name is to be celebrated as holy by all creation! Your kingdom is present! *(The word οταν **hotan**, translates, whenever, as in every time. According to the Walter Bauer Lexicon, it is often used of an action that is repeated. Jesus makes Father, our prayer-focus. Eph. 3:15 Every family in heaven and on earth originates in him; his is mankind's family name and he remains the authentic identity of every nation.*

Remember the commission of the disciples in Luke 10:9, Heal the sick and announce to them that God's kingdom is within everyone's immediate grasp and is here to stay!)

Luke 11:3 Sustain us daily with the [1]gift of the [2]prophetic bread that was to come! *(This bread is a [1]gift - it is not the bread we labor for. See John 4:35. The Adjective επιουσιον [2]**epiousion**, to be at hand; to-morrow's. The Adjective form of this word is only used here and again in Matthew's rendering of "the Lord's Prayer", Math 6:11, τὸν ἄρτον ἡμῶν τὸν ἐπιούσιον δὸς ἡμῖν σήμερον· **"Give us tomorrow's bread today!"** Tomorrow's bread is the prophetic bread of life - like the Manna in the wilderness! See Revelation 2:17 ... feast on the revelation of the hidden manna in the Ark. [This prophetically pointed to the Messiah - the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations is Christ in you! Jesus communicates the idea of bread that we didn't labor for! He had no other bread in mind! "He treated you gently in the wilderness of your unbelief and fed your hunger there with manna, which you did not know, nor did your fathers know; that he might make you know that man does not live by the bread of their own labor, but that the life of our design hungers to be completely sustained by that Word which proceeds out of the mouth of the LORD." Deut 8:3.] Luke then, also uses the feminine singular Participle of this same word, **he epiousa**, in Acts 7:26, Acts 16:11, Acts 20:15 and Acts 21:18; every time meaning, the next day.*

See my notes on understanding the significance of meals in NT context at the end of this chapter. [Luke 11])

Luke 11:4 Oh, that your [1]forgiveness of our sins may be fully realized! So, everyone indebted to us may also know that we have released them from their obligations to us! Father, you know us inside-out! [2]Free us thoroughly from any hidden alliance

with the old system of performance-based living! *(The word translated forgive, is the word αφες [1]**aphes**, which is the Aorist Active Imperative of **aphiemi**, from **apo**, away from, and **hiemi** an intensive form of **eimi**, I am; thus forgiveness is in essence a restoring to your true 'I-am-ness.' The injury, insult, shame, hostility or guilt would no longer define the individual. The Aorist Active Imperative tense means to get it over and done with immediately - to do so without delay - forgiveness is a non-negotiable! So, in Jesus' teaching on prayer, he emphasises the importance of praying from a place of innocence. The word 'forgiveness', occurs in Luke more frequently than in all the other New Testament writers combined. Used in medical language of the relaxation of disease. [Vincent.]*

Amazing how connected forgiveness is with one's total wellbeing!

See also Col 3:13, ...upholding one another in positive expectation. If anyone finds fault with another, restore that person to favor, remembering how the Lord's forgiveness has transformed our lives.

*[2]"Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil!" This sounds like God had temptation on today's agenda for you, but if you pray this prayer, then maybe he'll change his mind! 'To lead' in this sentence is the Greek word **eisphero**, to carry inward, to reach within; and temptation is the word **peiratzo**, to test through piercing, to examine closely, from **peira**, to pierce; a test to determine the hidden value of something; also from the word **peras**, which speaks of extremity or the furthest boundary. James 1:13 says clearly that God tempts no one. "Do not say, "I am scrutinized by God" when you feel enticed. He is not in the teasing business; evil offers no attraction to God for God to be tempted by it, neither is he experimenting with your design! [God cannot be both the source of light and darkness. Every temptation is an attempt of darkness to intercept light. James 1:17.]*

*The deliverance from evil, **poneros**, is the intent of this sentence, that hidden alignments to the law of works will not be found within me, giving evil a foothold as it were. The word **poneros**, translated, evil, means full of hardships, annoyances and labors! Sounds like the wrong tree to me!)*

Luke 11:5 *(Then Jesus follows up on the prayer-teaching by giving practical examples...)* **Can you imagine anyone who would wake up a friend in the middle of the night, desiring to urgently borrow three loaves of bread,**

Luke 11:6 since another friend arrived unexpectedly from a journey and he has

nothing to feed him. *(Lend me, **chrēson moi**, is the Aorist Imperative, lend me now; from **kichrēmi**, an old verb, to lend as a matter of friendly interest as opposed to **daneizō**, to lend on interest as a business. Only here in the N.T. [Robertson] Maybe, the three loaves suggested that, since all three of them are connected in friendship, they might as well have a midnight party! I've got enough wine but hey, we've run out of bread!)*

Luke 11:7 But alas! The friend doesn't even open his door to him; he just tells him off from within the house, "We don't want to be disturbed at this late hour! My family and I are all in bed!"

Luke 11:8 I am convinced, that even if it wasn't a friend, but a total stranger, he would still get out of bed and give him as much as he needed because of the predicament he was in and the fact that he was not ashamed to ask for help!

Luke 11:9 So what I'm saying to you is this, in prayer, it is the same, simple principle! Ask and it shall be given you; seek and you shall find; knock and it shall be opened for you.

Luke 11:10 This is not just true for you as my friends *[like in the parable]*, **it is true even for those who are still total strangers to the Father's goodness! Everyone who asks will receive, and whoever searches will find and whoever knocks, the door will be opened!**

Luke 11:11 Any father amongst you would certainly not give his child a snake if they're expecting to receive a fish;

Luke 11:12 or if he asks for an egg, would you give him a scorpion instead?

Luke 11:13 So, if you, even within the confines of an [1]earth-bound, [2]performance-based religious society, know to give your children excellent gifts that will only advantage them, how much more certainly will your Father give the Holy Spirit out of his limitless, heavenly resources to everyone who asks him! *(The word, ὑπάρχω [1]**huparchō** below rule - suggests the earth-dimension. Again, the word often translated, evil, [2]**poneros**, means full of hardships and labors and annoyances which describes the typical performance-based religious society.)*

Luke 11:14 He then cast out a demon from [1]someone and the deaf and dumb man immediately began to speak, to the astonishment of the crowd. *(Confirming his point about, [1]**whoever** asks, receives... he answers even the "silent" request of an [1]unidentified man. Its not whether you're a saint or a sinner; a Jew or a Gentile;*

known or unknown - you matter!)

Conclusion

In Colossians 3:1-3 Paul confronts us with the reality of our co-resurrection and joint-seatedness together with Christ and appeals to us, to now engage our thoughts with this dimension and then concludes in verse 16, with this context and focus in our worship...

Col 3:16 [1]Give the [2]clarity of God's [3]conversation in Christ permanent residence in you; allow it's [4]magnificence to permeate your entire being. [5]Celebrate God. From this rich reservoir of the heart, continue to [5]instruct one another with [6]inspired thoughts; making music with [7]stringed instruments and [8]spirit infused songs that articulate the nuances of grace. *(The word, [1]**enoikeitoo** is the Present Active Imerative, welcome home; give the word of Christ permanent residence in you; the Present Stem of the Greek Verb has the sense of continuous action. Then, ἐν πάσῃ σοφία referring to the full effect of the indwelling word, in all [2]**sophia**, wisdom/clarity. The [3]**logos**; the word - see John 1:1 the eternal conversation; incarnate in Christ. The Adverb, πλουσίως [4]**plousiōs**, the fulness or permiating richness or magnificance.*

*The Present Active Participle form of the verbs διδάσκω, to teach [[5]**didaskontes**] to emphasize a continual or habitual teaching; and νουθετέω to engage thought, [[6]**nouthetountes**] thus, to continually remind; as well as ᾄδω to sing [[5]**adontes**] thus, to continue singing. For the Present Participle, this implies that the action of the Participle is going on at the same time as the action of the main verb in the sentence , here, the word, [1]**enoikeitoo.***

*The word [8]**psalmos**, here refers to the prophetic Psalms celebrating the Messiah . Its verb form, ψάλλω psallo, means to touch; as in touching or plucking the strings; thus raving about the Messiah in praise and worship accompanied by musical instruments. The word [9]**humnos** suggests a celebration in song - a testimony song. In the Greek tradition, it is a song in the praise of gods, heroes and conquerors, from **hudeo** - to celebrate.*

*An [3]**ōdē en pneumatikos** is a spirit infused chant or song. According to Jewish custom, as recorded in Neh 8:8 "And they read from the book, from the law of God, clearly; and they gave the sense, so that the people understood the reading." Now, Paul connects the tradition of cantillation ["singing to speech"] with a new context: where you once chanted the Torah, now sing grace songs. "Cantillation serves to bring home to the listener the interrelation and coordination of the words used by the speaker. In order to*

appreciate the delicate shade of meaning conveyed. (Wickes)

ἐν χάριτι ᾄδοντες [from ᾄδω to sing] ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ ὑμῶν τῷ Κυρίῳ, making melody in your hearts to celebrate the grace of the Lord. Here translated, from this rich reservoir of the heart, articulate the nuances of grace.)

John 14:13 And whatever you desire in my name, that will I do that the Father may be glorified in the Son. Your sonship is endorsed in my sonship. *(The first occurrence of the phrase, In my name,* ***en tōi onomati mou.*** *See also John 14:26; 15:16; 16:23, 16:24, 16:26. "If this name, Jesus Christ is in the believer's consciousness, the element in which the prayerful activity moves; so that thus, that Name, embracing the whole revelation of redemption, is that which specifically measures and defines the disposition, feeling, object, and contents of prayer. The express use of the name of Jesus therein is no specific token; the question is of the spirit and mind of him who prays" Meyer. [Vincent])*

Paul's prayer request from prison is very specific! (Mine too!)

Eph 6:19 My most urgent request is for clarity of utterance every time I open my mouth to speak. I desire that my words will be gifted with inspiration, boldly articulating the mystery of the gospel.

Col. 4:4 My sincere desire is that my message will accurately unveil the mystery of Christ in its most complete context. You! This is the mission of my life! (Eph 3:9)

Soul realm sources its wisdom from information

gathered and interpreted through the senses

and filtered through the familiar avenues of our cultural,

historical, or personal references.

There is another Source though!

Supreme and so significant

when one's ears begin to hear the whispers

of spirit to spirit resonance -

the Logic of a thought incarnate

inside of you -

a knowing that you are known,

entirely-

even from before time was-

and that you are loved -

unconditionally and very intentionally!

This understanding cuts like a two edged sword

to the division of soul and spirit,

ending the dominance of the sense realm

and its neutralizing effect upon the human spirit.

In this way man's spirit is freed

to become the ruling influence again

in the thoughts and intentions of the heart.

See Heb 4:12 in the Mirror Study Bible

Thoughts on hell - Chapter 29

It is so sad that for many years multitudes of preachers reduced their message to a heaven or hell theme in order to persuade people to make a decision for Christ.

Any fear-based relationship has to be sustained by fear, and removes all possibilities for romance.

Imagine a marriage with even a hint of a performance based, fear-related agenda!

Agape is God's only agenda;

God is love, and Love keeps no record of sins.

Evil is not immortal, love is.

If we go blurry eyed at the dimensions of outer space, how could we possibly underestimate the height, length, breadth and depth of the love of Christ, which surpasses knowledge. In the dimensions of its breadth and length, we see its geographic, horizontal extent; the complete inclusion of the human race. The depth of his love reveals how love rescued us from the deepest pits of hellish despair and led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high.

Eph. 1:20 Do you want to measure the mind and muscle of God? Consider the force which he unleashed in Jesus Christ when he raised him from the dead and forever seated him enthroned as his executive authority in the realm of the heavens. Jesus is God's right hand of power! He was raised up from the deepest dungeons of human despair to the highest region of heavenly bliss!

Eph. 1:21 Infinitely above all the combined forces of rule, authority, dominion or governments; he is ranked superior to any name that could ever be given to anyone of this age or any age still to come in the eternal future.

Paul gives context to the single, most important motivation of ministry when he declares that "the love of Christ constrains us, because we are convinced that one has died for all, therefore all have died!" 2 Cor 5:14.

And in verse 16 he says, therefore, it is no longer possible to see any individual, in any other light!

Our message is powerful enough to stop people in their tracks with the best news ever! Sin in its every disguise doesn't have what it takes to even remotely match the

attraction and total contentment and appeal of the Christ-life!

I am often overwhelmed at the thought of the ultimate extent of the great work of redemption and act of reconciliation that God undertook to rescue us. Underestimating this great salvation has always been the biggest sin of the church.

Jesus said in Math 13:44, that the man who found the treasure in the agricultural field, sold all he had and bought the entire field! He did not buy us back from the thief - a thief never becomes owner [Ps. 24:1]; his priceless blood was shed to persuade us of our authentic worth! Heb. 6:16,17. Mankind was not redeemed from the Devil; neither did Jesus do what he did to change his Father's mind about us! It was our minds that needed persuasion! God was not to be reconciled to his creation; God was in Christ when he reconciled the world to himself! 2 Corinthians 5:18-20.

The Gospel reveals the extravagance of the love initiative of God; not as a reward for people's good behavior; nor out of pity for the human race, but because God is fully acquainted with the integrity of our design. It announces what God believes, and achieved on humanity's behalf in the death, descent into hell, and triumphant resurrection of Jesus Christ. This all happened without our permission, and while we were still dead in our trespasses. God co-quickened us and co-elevated us and co-seated us together with Christ in heavenly places! Eph 2:5,6. The gospel begins there - it doesn't end there for a few lucky ones who got to say some "sinners prayer" formula sincere enough, and then with the exertion of the most extreme willpower, proceeded to earn enough points to win the prize of possible access into heaven one day!

Multitudes have wasted so much precious time, going around in circles in "trial and error-mode", for generations!

There are countless seminars and TV shows and books with recipes on "getting there", when "there" is where you already are to begin with! Col. 3:1-3.

Life is not a snakes and ladders game where the fall of the dice dictates your day! We begin at the FINISH! ["Chutes & Ladders" in the USA]

See yourself seated together with Christ in the throne room!

Deut 28 is outdated! We are no longer chasing blessings and dodging curses. Every blessing heaven has was already lavished upon us in Christ. Eph. 1:3. And every definition of curse was cancelled on the cross! Gal. 3:13

If the Gospel has the power to get people to fall head over heels in love with God, and to love their neighbor as much as they love themselves, then this Gospel demands our

total attention.

This immediately frees a person from the dread of hell or any sense of pending or possible punishment. 1 John 4:18 "There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear. For fear has to do with punishment." 1 John 4:19 "We love because he first loved us." And, perfect love drives out all fear!

1 John 4:18 Fear cannot co-exist in this love realm. The perfect love union that we are talking about expels fear. Fear holds on to an expectation of crisis and judgment *[which brings separation]* **and interprets it as due punishment** *[a form of karma!]* **It echoes torment and only registers in someone who does not yet realize the completeness of their love union.** *(With the Father, Son and Spirit and with one another.)*

Luke 12:5 Let's imagine the most extreme context of the fear of death - the worst possible scenario would be that someone has the authority to, after death, also cast a culprit into the fires of Gehenna! Now that's scary! *(See Rev. 18:21 And a huge celestial messenger lifted what seemed like a massive millstone and cast it into the sea, saying, so shall Babylon the great Prostitute-City, be hurled into the ocean and not a single trace of her existence shall ever be found again! [See Math 18:6, But whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in me to stumble, it would be better for him to have a great millstone fastened round his neck and be drowned in the depth of the sea.] The context is clearly about the offence and judgment that the legalistic mindset brings - if your hand, foot or eye offends you [causes you to stumble], cut it off and pluck it out in order to escape* ***burning in Gehenna****! This was obviously a familiar comparison to judgment. Jesus graphically and almost sarcastically points to the inability of the law of works to save us from judgment! The hand, foot or eye are not the culprits; the mindset is! Note also that here, the depths of the sea is used on par with the fires of Gehenna - the idea was to emphasize a judgment that will ultimately, in the full comprehension of the human race, of the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ and their co-inclusion in it, as well as their awakening to their joint-seatedness in the throne of God, bring a final end to the threat and existence of evil.*

The garbage heap outside Jerusalem, commonly related to hell. ***Gehenna****, is the Latin word;* ***Geenas****, which is the Greek word used for the Hebrew "****The Valley of Hinnom****,"* גיא בן הינום *which is modern day* ***Wadi er-Rababi****. A fiery place for the disposal of waste matter from Jerusalem. The "Valley of Hinnom" lies outside ancient Jerusalem.*

Also see my notes on ***The Lake of Fire*** *at the end of Rev. 19.*

When the imagery of the Lake of Fire is introduced, it suggests a judgment, whereby every possible trace of both the source [the counterfeit Trinity system], as well as the effect in the recipients [their distorted perceptions and mindsets], are forever consumed.

Every single person who ever dies in ignorance, indifference or unbelief, is immediately confronted with and mirrored in the once and for all death and resurrection of Jesus. This is pictured here in the lake of burning sulphur, cleansing and purifying like in a furnace; separating the gold from the dross in the mindsets of the masses.

The Greek word for sulphur is ***theion****, from* ***theios****, godlike [neuter as noun, divinity]: - divine, godhead. Sulphur is a yellow inflammable mineral substance found in quantities on the shores of the Dead Sea. This was also known as divine incense, because burning brimstone was regarded as having power to purify, and to ward off disease. Its medicinal values are well known even today.*

All the symbolic pictures of fire, referenced in the book of Revelation comes from the same source, the brazen altar, the prophetic picture of the cross.)

Heb 2:15 As a fellow human, he re-defined death and delivered them from the lifelong dread of death. *(He brought final closure to the idea of judgment, which is what the system of works is all about. Heb 9:27,28. Evil is not immortal, love is.*

When we step out of this earth suit,

we do not step into redefined time,

we're stepping into eternity himself;

the Author of the ages

who dwells within us!

The Greek word ***krisis***, often translated, judgment, does not mean damnation or condemnation! Judging involves setting affairs right between different parties, deciding an issue, coming to a conclusion.

The judgment of Jesus is the acquittal of the human race! Rom. 4:25.

John 12:31 Now is the judgment of this world; this is the moment where the ruler of the world-system is [1]conclusively cast out! *(The serpent's head is about to be crushed! Genesis 3:15; Colossians 2:14,15. This is what Holy Spirit will convince the world of! John 16:11. John uses a double-barrel word here,* ***ekballo ekso*** *- completely thrown out! Thus, taken out of the equation! Luke 10:18.)*

John 12:32 When I am lifted up from the earth, I will draw all of mankind and every definition of judgment unto me! *(He would be lifted up on a cross, descend into the depths of our hell, then, according to the prophetic word in Hosea 6:2, after two days, the entire human race he represents, will be co-quickened and on the third day, be co-raised, out of the lowest parts of the earth and elevated to the highest heavens! Ephesians 4:8,9; see also Ephesians 2:5,6 and Colossians 3:1-3. 'All' includes all of mankind and every definition of judgment. The subject of the sentence, as from the previous verse, is the judgment of the world - thus the primary thought here is that in his death, Jesus would draw all judgment upon himself! John 3:14; John 8:28; Act 2:33. 1 John 3:5 We have witnessed with our own eyes how, in the unveiling of the prophetic word, when he was lifted up upon the cross as the Lamb of God, he lifted up our sin and broke its dominion and rule over us! John 1:29 "Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away* ***[airo]*** *the sin of the world! The word* ***airo*** *means to lift up.")*

John 12:33 This he said to point to the way in which he would die. *(See John 19:15 - Lift him up! Lift him up! Crucify him!")*

Just like Jesus and the Father - the Holy Spirit will not condemn the world but rather convince the world!)

John 16:11 Then the world will be convinced that the judgment that was their due was fully accomplished when the ruler of this world system was judged, once and for all. *(Just like Jesus and the Father - the Holy Spirit will not condemn the world but rather convince the world! In Jesus dying mankind's death, closure was brought to the system of the law of works and performance as dictating and defining human life. In mankind's co-crucifixion and joint-descent in Jesus into their hell and in their co-resurrection and co-elevation to be seated together with him in heavenly places! See John 5:21,22; John 12:31-33; Hosea 6:2, Ephesians 2:5,6; Colossians 3:1-3; Romans 4:25; Acts 17:29-31; 1 Peter 1:10,11; Hebrews 1:1-3.)*

Isaiah 25:7 And he will destroy on this mountain the covering that is cast over all peoples, the veil that is spread over all nations.

Isaiah 25:8 He will swallow up death for ever, and the Lord GOD will wipe away tears from all faces, and the reproach of his people he will take away from all the earth; for the LORD has spoken.

Isaiah 26;19 but your dead will live; their bodies will rise. You who dwell in the dust, wake up and shout for joy! Your dew is like the dew of the morning; the earth will give birth to her dead!

Hosea 6:2 After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will raise us up!

John 3:14 *(This is my mission: See the prophetic relevance - this is how the veil will be removed!)* **Remember how Moses lifted up the [1]serpent in the wilderness even so the son of man will be lifted up!** *(Revelation 12:9. John 3:13 and 14 are most significant since they point to the very essence of the Mission of Jesus - the co-begotteness of the human race, now redeemed in our co-crucifixion and co-resurrection on the third day into newness of life! 1 Peter 1:3. The word serpent in the Greek is [1]**ophis**. See Extended Notes on **Ophis**, the old Serpent at the end of Revelation chapter 12.)*

John 3:15 In the same prophetic pattern, I will be lifted up for all to see, and be equally persuaded in the echo of the life of the ages, now redeemed within them!

Rom. 8:34 What further ground can there possibly be to condemn mankind? In his death he faced our judgment; in his resurrection he reveals our righteousness; the implications cannot be undone! He now occupies the highest seat of authority as the executive of our redemption in the throne room of God. *(See Rom. 8: 1, also Rom. 4:25.)*

James 2:13 Judgment showed no mercy to those who do not walk in mercy, but mercy triumphs over judgment. *(Those who walk in mercy walk in the law of liberty. [Gal 5:22, 23] There is no law against love. While judgment threatens condemnation, mercy interposes and prevails over judgment.)*

1 John 3:20 So, even if our own hearts would [1]accuse us of not really being true to ourselves, God is greater than our hearts and he has the full picture! His knowledge of us is not compromised. *(This word, [1]**kataginosko** is only used three times in the NT, translated, to blame, or condemn. From **kata**, down and **ginosko**, to know; thus to know from below; from a fallen mindset perspective)*

1 John 3:21 Beloved when we know what God knows to be true about us, then instead of condemning us, our hearts will endorse our innocence and [1]free our conversation before God. *(The word [1]**parresia**, from **para**, a Preposition indicating close proximity, and **rheo**, to pour forth; to flow freely, suggesting an unreservedness in speech; bold utterance.)*

The greatest safeguard we can ever give someone against a wasted life, is in our message that reveals truth in such a way that every possible excuse we could have to experience distance from God, or to continue in any form of sin, guilt, fear or an inferior lifestyle, is done away with. In its stead there remain only the wide open arms

of Father longing to embrace every individual into the most attractive adventure of friendship.

There is enough content in the positive revelation of Christ in you, to rid you of a sin consciousness and its dreadful consequence of even a moment's sense of separation.

So, where does the abyss fit into this!

Rom. 10:5 Moses is the voice of the law; he says that a person's life is only justified in their doing what the law requires.

Rom. 10:6 Faith finds its voice in something much closer to a person than their most disciplined efforts to obey the law. Faith announces that the Messiah is no longer a distant promise; neither is he reduced to a mere historic hero. He is mankind's righteousness now! The revelation of what God accomplished in Christ, births a new conversation! The old type of guess-talk has become totally irrelevant; Christ is not hiding somewhere in the realm of heaven as a future hope; so, to continue to say, "Who will ascend into heaven, to bring Christ down", makes no sense at all! *(The nearness of the Word in incarnation-language is the new conversation! The word has become flesh, so that all flesh may witness the glory of God, reflected in the radiance of their own illuminated understanding!)*

Rom. 10:7 Faith-conversation understands the resurrection-revelation *(and mankind's co-inclusion in it! Hosea 6:2).* **The Messiah is not roaming around somewhere in the region of the dead. Someone asks, "Oh, but what about the pit? Where does the abyss fit into this? Who will descend into the abyss to bring Christ back from the dead?" This revelation takes the abyss out of the equation!** *(Those who deny the resurrection of Jesus would wish they could send someone down there and confirm their doubts, and bring back final proof that Jesus was not the Messiah. Faith announces a righteousness that reveals that mankind has indeed been co-raised together with Christ! See Eph 4:8 Scripture confirms that he arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! ["he took captivity captive"] And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ, he repossessed what belonged to us by design, in human form; this is his grace-gift to us! Eph 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. See Luke 9:27 You don't have to wait till you're dead to see the kingdom of God; some of you standing here with me right now, are about to dramatically witness the kingdom of God with your own eyes! [The word, ὁράω* ***horaoo****, to stare; to gaze with wonder; to encounter; to see for yourselves. Then, in the next verse, [Lk 9:28], Peter James and John join Jesus in prayer on the mountain, where his appearance is spectacularly changed by the radiance of God's glory bursting through his skin; even his clothes became dazzling white like light. Then, the voice of his*

Father confirms that his beloved son is the conclusion of the conversation represented in both Moses, [the law] and Elijah, [the prophets] - "Hear him!" - Jesus is the conversation of God - he is the Logos - See John 1:1,2,5,9 To go back to the very beginning, is to find the Word already present there; face to face with God. The Word is I am; God's eloquence echoes and concludes in him. The Word equals God. The beginning mirrors the Word face to face with God. [Nothing that is witnessed in the Word distracts from who God is. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father."] The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world! At the end of his life Peter reminds us that, 2 Pet 1:16 We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic appearance; with our own eyes we witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate presence of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life. 2 Pet 1:17 He was spectacularly endorsed by God the Father in the highest honor and glory. God's majestic voice announced, "This is the Son of my delight; he completely pleases me."2 Pet 1:18 For John, James, and I the prophetic word is fulfilled beyond doubt; we heard this voice loud and clear from the heavenly realm while we were with Jesus in that sacred moment on the mountain. 2 Pet 1:19 For us the appearing of the Messiah is no longer a future promise but a fulfilled reality. Now it is your turn to have more than a second-hand, hearsay testimony. Take my word as one would take a lamp at night; the day is about to dawn within you, in your own understanding. When the Morning Star appears, you no longer need the lamp; this will happen shortly on the horizon of your own hearts. 2 Pet 1:20 It is most important to understand that the prophetic word recorded in Scripture does not need our interpretation or opinion to make it valid. 2 Pet 1:21 The holy men who first spoke these words of old did not invent these thoughts, they simply voiced God's oracles as they were individually inspired by the Holy Spirit.)

Luke 9:27 The Kingdom of God is not a future event beyond your reach! You don't have to wait till you're dead to see it; some of you standing here are about to [1]dramatically witnesses what I am talking about! *[The word, ὁράω [1]**horaoo**, to stare; to gaze with wonder; to encounter; to see for yourselves.)*

To influence people to make a decision for Christ based on hell is a complete distraction from the truth. What a shame that the very romance of the ages should be compromise d with a hidden clause of dread, attached to it!

The focus and central theme of the Gospel is the revelation of the mystery of

mankind's inclusion in the death Jesus died and our co-resurrection and joint-position at the Father's right hand. The liberating truth of the forgiveness of sins awakens an understanding of the integrity of our innocence; this naturally leads to a tangible intimacy with the living God and a spontaneous love for people. God pleads through us to bring people to realize their full inclusion in the Gospel. Let his love in you reveal him to your neighbors and the nations. His love is unthreatened and needs no defence!

The biggest waste of, even a day of your life, is to miss out on meaningful and intimate encounter with your Creator and fellow humanity.

The object of New Testament ministry is not to get people to go to heaven one day! It is the unveiling of the most attractive life possible, the life of our design redeemed again. Now to be enjoyed in an immediate, intimate, daily, constant, conscious feedback encounter with the Living God in Spirit and in truth and undiluted friendship with our fellow-humans!

Lydia made this comment a few years ago: It amazes me how Christians would often rather cut the baby in half than allow the real Mother to have her baby back! *(If mankind is indeed the offspring of God, how could we allow any doctrine that gives an illegitimate parent any claim on the human race!?)*

Phil. 2:10 What his name unveils will persuade every creature of their redemption! Every knee in heaven and upon the earth and under the earth shall bow in spontaneous worship! *(See Isa 45:23 "My own life is the guarantee of my conviction, says the Lord, every knee shall freely bow to me in worship, and every tongue shall spontaneously speak from the same God-inspired source.")*

Phil. 2:11 Also every tongue will voice and resonate the same devotion to his unquestionable Lordship as the Redeemer of life! Jesus Christ has glorified God as the Father of creation! This is the ultimate conclusion of the Father's [1]intent! *(The word [1]**doxa,** intent, opinion, often translated, glory. Rev 5:13 And I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth and in the sea, and all therein, saying, "To him who sits upon the throne and to the Lamb be blessing and honor and glory and might for ever and ever!" Also my commentary note on Rom 14:11. Paul, here quotes Isaiah 45:23 See verse 22,& 23 "Face me and **be** saved all the ends of the earth! [Note, '**Be saved**!' Not 'become saved!'] I am God; your idols are figments of your invention and imagination!" Isa 45:23 "I have sworn by myself; the word of my mouth has begotten righteousness; this cannot be reversed!" The Hebrew word, [1]צא **Yatsa** can be translated,*

begotten like in Judges 8:30 "Every knee shall bow to me and every tongue shall echo my oath!" [Thus, speak with the same certainty sourced in me!] The Hebrew word, שבע ***Shaba*** *means to seven oneself, that is, swear - thus in the Hebrew mind, by repeating a declaration seven times one brings an end to all dispute! See Heb 6:13.16,17.)*

Eph. 4:5 There is only one legitimate Lordship; one faith and one [1]baptism; we are all immersed in the same oneness! *(There is only one faith! Not what we believe about God but what God believes about us! Our faith does not invent God; God's faith defines us! Jesus is what God believes! See my commentary on John 1:33; John's baptism announces the incarnation; yet it communicates a mere prophetic picture of what Jesus' spirit baptism will fully interpret of mankind's co-inclusion and joint immersion into his death, resurrection and ascension. In the incarnation we have the prophetic word on exhibit, intercepting human history by assuming human form; thus we see divinity immersed into our humanity and declaring that there would be no stopping him from entering into our hell and deepest darkness. In dying our death, God would bring closure to every destructive mindset and futile fruit we inherited from Adam's fall. Just as he was raised out of the water in his baptism, we would be co-elevated together with him in his resurrection into newness of life! Hosea 6:2; Ephesians 2:5. The word [1]****baptizo*** *from* ***bapto****, to immerse, to overwhelm.)*

Eph. 4:6 There is only one God. He remains the ultimate Father of the universe. We are because he is. He is present in all; he is above all, through all, and in all. *("He is not far from each one of us; in him we live and move and have our being. We are indeed his offspring." Acts. 17:24-28. The father of lies is not the father of the human race!)*

Eph. 4:7 The gift of Christ measures the extravagant dimensions of grace; where everyone is equally advantaged. *(Grace was given to each one of us according to the measure of the gift of Christ. RSV. One measure, one worth! Our worth is defined by his gift not by a reward for our behavior.)*

Eph. 4:8 [1]Scripture confirms that he [3]arrested every possible threat that held mankind hostage! *["he took captivity captive"]* **And in his resurrection, he led us as trophies in his triumphant procession on high. Consider the genius of God, in the incarnate Christ; he [2]repossessed what belonged to us by design, [4]in human form; this is his grace-gift to us!** *(In this verse Paul explains what he just declared in verse 7 - he wants us to know the extravagant extent and dimensions of the measure of the gift of Christ! Remember that he is writing from prison [Eph 4:1] He's not asking for prayers to get him out of jail! He is imprisoned in Christ - [4:1] my complete existence*

*is defined and confined in him! He was once a prisoner of the law of performance, held hostage in his own body, crying in desperation, "Is there anyone who can deliver them from this death trap?" [Rom 7] He now speaks as a prisoner of Christ! He is reminded of and obviously intrigued by the entire context of Psalm 67 which celebrates God rescuing the prisoners from their captivity and even the wayward and stubborn, who already died and are stuck in their graves! [mindsets] See Ps 67:6,7 He is the father of the orphans, and protector of the widows. God settles the lonely in a home; leading forth prisoners mightily, also the stubborn, even them that dwell in tombs! Paul sees by revelation the relevance of Jesus dying our death and entering into our darkness and hell on a rescue mission! Now he [1]quotes Ps 67:19 [from the LXX Septuagint - the Greek OT which is Ps 68 in the Masoretic Hebrew text], and sees captive mankind arrested in the death, descent into hell and the triumphant resurrection of the incarnate Word, in the man Jesus Christ. Ps 67:19 ἀνέβης εἰς ὕψος, ᾐχμαλώτευσας αἰχμαλωσίαν, ἔλαβες δόματα ἐν ἀνθρώπῳ - **anebes eis hupsos, [3]echmaloteusas aichmaloosian, [2]elabes domata en** [in] [4]**anthropo** "You ascended on high, having taken captivity captive [[3]**arresting at spearpoint**! See 2 Cor 10:5] and [2]**repossessed mankind's gifts** in human form. The word [2]**elabes** from **lambano** means to take what is one's own. The word for the [4]human species, male or female is [4]**anthropos**, from **ana**, upward, and **tropos**, manner of life; character; in like manner. [The Masoretic Hebrew text, Ps 68:18,19,* לקחת מתנות באדם ***lakachat mattanoth ba adam*** *- "You have taken gifts in Adam." **The gifts which Jesus Christ distributes to us he has received in us, in and by virtue of his incarnation!** Adam Clarke.]*

*Ps 67:19 LXX continues: καὶ γὰρ ἀπειθοῦντες τοῦ κατασκηνῶσαι - **kai gar apeithountes tou kataskenoosai,** "in order that even the unbelievers, **apeithountes** - the ones resisting persuasion, the backsliding, the headstrong, the wayward, the rebellious may rest; or may now inhabit - **kataskenosai** - to encamp within - again this word emphasizes the significance of the incarnation - **kata**, down and **skenosai**, from **skenos** - skin! The eternal thoughts of God, the conversation that was before time was, is clothed in skin! John 1:1-3,14.*

See Rev 13:10, Being taken captive by the spear and killed by the sword [John 18:3] made death a doorway into the very domain in which mankind was held prisoner, [to be led out triumphantly in the resurrection as the Lamb's trophies!] After two days he will revive us! On the third day he will raise us up! Hosea 6:2 We were born anew in his resurrection. 1 Pet 1:3. Also Ephesians 2:5 This is how grace rescued us: while we were

yet in that state of deadness and indifference in our deviations, we were co-quickened together with Christ!)

Eph. 4:9 The fact that he ascended confirms his victorious descent into the deepest pits of human despair. *(See John 3:13, "No one has ascended into heaven but he who [1]descended from heaven, even the son of man." All mankind originate from above; we are [1]**anouthen**, from above [see Jas 1:17, 18].)*

Eph. 4:10 He now occupies the ultimate rank of authority, from the lowest regions of our darkness into which he reached in order to rescue us, to the highest authority in the heavens, having executed his mission to the full. *(Fallen mankind is restored to the authority of the authentic life of their design. Psa 139:7,8 Whither shall I go from your Spirit? Or whither shall I flee from your presence? If I ascend to heaven, You! If I make my bed in hell [Sheol], You! Eph 1:20,21. [Fallen mankind is fully restored to the authority of the authentic life of their design. Psa 139:7 Where shall I go from Your Spirit? Or where shall I flee from Your faces? Plural* מפניך ***mippaneycha*** *Faces of Elohim. The plurality of persons in the Godhead is intended. Psa 139:8 If I go up to Heaven, You!* שמים שם אתה ***Shemayim Shem Atah*** שמים ***shemayim***, *the heavens [which is the plural of the next word],* ***Shem,*** *meaning, name or renown; in Ancient Hebrew,* ms%*breath.*

Then the word, אתה *begins with Aleph and Tau* את *AT which are the first and last letters in the Hebrew Alphabet; the Rabbis interpret as the first matter out of which all things were formed, [see Gen 1:1]. The particle AT [pronounced,* ***et]****, is untranslatable in English; but, says Rabbi Aben Ezra, "it signifies the substance of the thing!" Then follows the letter* ה *hey, in Ancient Hebrew, it is* e*, the man with raised hands pictures a sigh of wonder, "behold," as when looking at a great sight; thus, meaning, "breath" or "sigh," as one does when seeing something wonderful and pointing it out. The* ה *[hey] is also the number 5, which is the number for grace! The union of* ***Alpha*** *and* ***Omega*** *[which are the first and last letters in Greek], makes the verb* ***αω****, I breathe. And in Hebrew the union of the first and last letter in their alphabet,* את *[in modern Hebrew] are written,* ***Aleph*** *[bull's head] and* ***Tav*** *[the cross]* ta *in Ancient Hebrew!*

In the Greek Septuagint Ps 138:8 [139 in the Hebrew text] reads, If I make my bed in Sheol, behold, You are there! LXX πάρειμι ***pareimi*** *your immediate presence - I am! See my notes on 1 Thess 2:19)*

1 Peter 3:18 Christ [1]died [2]once and for all, in order to [4]conclusively [3]separate you from a [5]distorted identity. Thus, restored righteousness *[shared likeness]* **triumphed [6]beyond the reach of any identity that is not in sync with innocence and oneness,** *[righteousness bringing closure to [7]unrighteousness]*— **in order that he might [8]lead you-manity to be face to face with God; his body was [9]murdered, but he was made alive in spirit.** *(The best manuscripts have, [1]**apethanen** [Aorist form of ἀποθνήσκω, to die], later manuscripts were changed to **epathen** [suffered]. Then the word, [2]**hapax** once for all; not once upon a time **[pote]**. Oldest manuscripts have **humas** [su] **you**-manity not **hemas us** believers. The words, περὶ ἁμαρτιῶν [3]**peri hamartioon** [here, the Genitive suggests, separation from] The Preposition [4]**peri**, encircling; circuit [around], excess [beyond], completeness; all inclusive. The word often translated, sin, [5]**hamartia**, from **ha**, without and **meros**, which is the stem of the word **morphe**, form; thus a distorted form; the lie that we believed about ourselves. As in 2 Corinthians 3:18 the word **metamorphe**, with form, which is the opposite of **hamartia** - without form. Sin is to live out of context with the blueprint of one's design; to behave out of tune with God's original harmony. Then, the preposition ὑπέρ [6]**huper**, means above; beyond. The word often translated, unrighteous, [7]**adike**, from **a**, negative and **dikay**, two parties in sync with one another; shared likeness - thus, **adike** means to be out of sync. The word, [8]**prosagagey**, προσαγαγη with **pros**, face to face and **agoo**, to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep. θανατωθεις, [9]**thanatootheis**, the Perfect Passive Participle is a hebraistic equivalent for the superlative; he was murdered.)*

1 Peter 3:19 Thus, through the doorway of death, his spirit entered the very domain where those who died before were imprisoned! There, he announced his message! *[See my rendering of Eph 4:8,9 with commentary.]*

1 Peter 3:20 His audience included all who died in unbelief, in the days of Noah when he built the [1]Ark! Jesus is the extension of the patience of God, who waited for mankind at a time when only 8 survived the flood! There is a new baptism! Immersed in his death and co-quickened in his resurrection, mankind once dead and drowned are now made alive and crowned! *(See Heb 9:4 Pointing prophetically to the rebooted life of our design where the law of agape is inscribed in our inner consciousness. A golden "fire-pan" was for the purpose of carrying fire, in order to burn incense on the day of Atonement [at-one-ment] once a year in the ultimate place of*

*worship. The word, [1]**kibotos**, the wooden box, is the same word used for Noah's ark; the container of mankind's redemption. Gen 6:14 The manna prophetically pictured the true bread from heaven, not the bread that mankind's labor produces. John 4:35, 38.* ***Noah*** *נֹחַ rest. Noach נֹחַ found favor חֵן in the eyes of the Lord! See Gen 6:8, the same letters in reverse, as in a mirror reflection, חֵן **chen**, means, grace/favor.)*

Jesus emptied whatever definition we have of hell, and came back with the trophies *[humanity]* and the keys *[Isa 22:22]*! Oh, what an insult it is to the entire gospel, to continue to preach a defeated devil and an empty hell, back into business! *See Rev 1:18 I am also the Living One; I died and now, see, here I am alive unto the ages of the ages and I have the keys wherewith I have disengaged the gates of* ***Hades*** *and death!*

Rev 3:7 And to the messenger of the ekklesia of [1]Philadelphia write: I am the Holy and True One! I hold the key of David as prophesied in [1]Isaiah 22:22! Yes, I [2]unlock the mysteries of the heavenly dimension and no one can shut the door! And I lock the entrance and none (of the old mindsets) can access it! *([1]**Philadelphos**, from **philos**, fondness; friendship, and **adelphos**, the same womb; immediate family; kinsfolk; household. [2]Isaiah 22:22 And I will place on his shoulder the key of the house of David; he shall open, and none shall shut; and he shall shut, and none shall open. The word [2]**anoigo** from **ana** upward and **agoo**, to lead! Also Ezek 34:23 Then I will place one shepherd over them, my servant David, and he will take care of them and be their shepherd.)*

Rev 3:8 I am fully aware of your efforts in doing the work of the ministry! I want you to see something, I [1]have given you a doorway right in front of you that has been fully opened into the heavenly dimension! Nothing can possibly close it again! Even when you had very little strength you have treasured my word and have not contradicted my name! *(I have given you, [1]**dedoka**, Perfect Active Indicative of **didomi**, denotes an action that has been completed in the past and the results of the action are continuing on in this moment, in full effect. Rev 4:1 I want you to see something! Oh wow! What I see takes my breath away! A wide-open door in the heavenly realm! The first thing I heard was this voice addressing me! It was distinct and clear like the sound of a trumpet; it captured my attention, inviting me to enter. "Come up here and I will show you how everything coincides with what you have already seen!")*

Here's what Jesus says about Hades:

He asks the most important question in the Bible "Who do people say, that I, the son of man, am?" No, I'm not a reincarnate prophet! I am the Incarnate Word in whom all things exist - I gave you birth!

Luke 9:19 They replied, "Some think that you could possibly be John the baptist re-incarnated, or even a re-appearance of Elijah or another of the ancient prophets resurrected."

Luke 9:20 "And you; who am I to you?" Jesus asked them; Peter answered, "The Messiah of God!"

Blessed are you, Simon, son of Jonah! *[Bar Jonah, his surname identity]* **Flesh and blood did not reveal this to you, but my Father! I say, you are Rock, a chip** *[petros]* **of the old Block** *[petra]!* **And upon this revelation, that the son of man is the son of God, I will build my Ekklesia, and the gates of Hades will not prevail against it. I shall give you to the keys of the dominion of the heavens, and whatever you bind upon the earth shall be, [1]having been bound in the heavens, and whatever you loose upon the earth shall be, [1]having been loosed in the heavens.** *([Matthew 16:13-19.]* ***Ekklesia*** *from* ***ek****, origin and* ***kaleo****, to surname; original identity.* ***Hades****, from* ***ha****, negative particle, and* ***eido*** *to see. In a walled city, the gates are the most strategic point - if the gates are disengaged, the city is taken! Thus, the blindfold mode of mankind's forgotten identity, will not prevail against your advance! The Perfect Passive tense used in both , having been bound and having been loosed, clearly reveals what Jesus accomplished once and for all in his triumpant mission! The keys Jesus refers to here, are the same keys John recorded in Revelation 1:18.)*

Rev 1:17 Observing all this, I fell at his feet like a dead man. Then, [1]kneeling down, he ordained me with his right hand upon me and said, "Do not be afraid! I am the origin and the [2]conclusion of all things. *(See Isa 44:6. The word [1]****tithemi*** *from* ***theo****, to kneel down, lay down, to ordain, purpose, put, set forth. See John 15:16, I have* ***ordained*** *you - I have strategically positioned you! Also 1 Tim 2:7 I am an "ordained" preacher.*

*Again the word, [2]****eschatos;*** *Jesus, as the Alpha and Omega, defines eschatology!)*

Rev 1:18 I am also the Living One; I died and now, see, here I am alive unto the ages of the ages and I have the keys wherewith I have disengaged the gates of [1]Hades and death! *(This profound statement of Jesus in verses 17 & 18, is the platform, theme*

and focus of the entire book. To distract from these words of Jesus is to miss the point of the Revelation! [1]See commentary note in verse 20 and Rev 2:7 on the gates of Hades. Multitudes are in hell on this side of the grave; we have the keys to unlock a door that was already opened when Jesus went there as a man to free the human race from Adam to Noah, to now! Wow, what joy to introduce people to the freedom of sonship! Let's not make the other brother in Luke 15 our reference when we can know the Father's heart!)

The Hebrew word שְׁאוֹל ***Sheol***, means, a seeking for what is not known. Translated ***Hades*** *[unseen]* in LXX. [The Septuagint is the Greek translation of the Scriptures 300BC.]

In the context of the gospel - How does your present format of belief rate? What percentage of the billions of people who already lived and died on the planet are we prepared to condemn to everlasting torment? Was Adam's fall more successful than the cross? Consider the gospel you live and believe in the light of Rom 5:10-21; 2 Cor 5:14-21 (in any translation of your choice)

Would you say that the church in all its many groupings have "successfully converted" about 10 percent (or even 1% perhaps!) of the entire human population? While Jesus reveals in Luke 15 that 99 sheep in the fold is not enough! He goes after the last one, not out of a sense of duty until he finally gives up on it, but He seeks UNTIL he finds the one! The GOOD NEWS is that the lost sheep, the lost coin, the lost son, are now all found safe and sound in Jesus! In him dying humanity's death he went into the darkest and deepest dungeons of our lostness and led us as trophies on high in his resurrection! His return to the Father is humanity's return! The problem is, most people (including most Bible believers) don't know it! This is why we live our lives with persuasion, intent and passion to tell them!! Isa 40:9

Make the calculation, what would give Jesus the greater glory? An empty heaven and a full hell? Or an empty hell and a full heaven?

The Greek word, apocalypse means, revelation - a lifting of the veil, to bring into view what is already there!

The language of the Book of Revelation's rich imagery celebrates the Champion of the Ages, the slain and risen Lamb of God bringing closure to every definition of judgment in his death and resurrection.

Jesus is not a literal Lamb, nor a literal Lion! As the Son of God he is the Incarnate Word that has always been face to face with God. He is the Word in whom all things exist!

The stars are not literal stars neither is the underworld a literal fathomless pit, or the Lake ablaze with Brimstone a literal place! See my notes on the Lake of Fire at the end of Rev. 19.

Throughout the unfolding conversation in the book of Revelation, pictures come to mind that have already been part of the narrative of God's prophetic dealings with Israel for generations, symbolically pointing to a Person and a Moment recorded historically in time, where the resolve of God concludes powerfully in the glorious triumph of the Lamb over every definition of Devil. In fact, every possible idea of Sin, Judgment, Death, Hades, Satan, Devil, Demon, Dragon, Beast and False Prophet-Prostitute is addressed and dissolved and thus rendered redundant.

See Rev 17:14 These join forces in that hour to wage war against the Lamb, but the Lamb defeats them since he is the Lord of lords and the King of kings. And, sharing with him in his victory, are his kindred, recognizing their origin in this conversation; they too are now of the same persuasion. The Lamb led them into freedom from their lost identity, and their doubts.

As far as God is concerned, it is indeed, Mission accomplished! The salvation of humankind is no longer a possible outcome of events, it is the grandest announcement of the great redemption, of the Romance of the Ages!

From the religious monster in camouflage, the counterfeit "lamb" who desires to manipulate and control the business of buying and selling with a counterfeit currency of a fear and performance based alliance to its stamped image and inscription on their foreheads and hands, to the true Lamb of God who ransomed the human race with the currency of his self-giving agape and shed blood, revealing their inherent worth, based on Elohim's image and inscription entwined in their inner person!

Revelation 5:13 Then I heard every creature in Heaven and earth, in underworld and sea, join in, all voices in all places, singing: To the One on the Throne! To the Lamb! The blessing, the honor, the glory, the strength! For age after age after age.

Here it is in the Mirror Study Bible...

Rev. 5:3 And no-one in the heavenly realm or upon the earth or in the underworld was eligible to open the scroll or even see a hint of what was written therein. *(See 1 Cor 2:7-9.)*

Rev. 5:4 I felt terribly heartbroken and cried inconsolably at the thought that there seemed to be no-one entitled to open the scroll in order to interpret it!

Rev. 5:5 Then one of the elders said unto me, "You need not weep anymore! Look! The Lion has conquered! He who is of the tribe of Judah, the root of David! His victory qualifies him to open the scroll and to break its seven seals!" ***(Idou enikesen*** *Behold! He has conquered!* ***ho leon, ho ek tes phules Jodah, he ritza David****, The Lion who is out of the tribe of Judah, the root of David. Rev 3:7 I hold the key of David as prophesied in Isaiah 22:22.*

See Gen 49:9, Judah is a lion's whelp; Gen 49:10, The scepter shall not depart from Judah, nor the ruler's staff from between his feet, until he comes to whom it belongs; and to him shall be the obedience of the peoples. Gen 49:11, Binding his foal to the vine and his ass's colt to the choice vine, he washes his garments in wine and his vesture in the blood of grapes. See my comments on ***The Root of Jesse*** *Rev 22:16.)*

Rev. 5:6 So I looked to see the Lion, and there - as if fused into one with the throne and in unison with the four Living Beings - taking center stage in the midst of the elders, I saw a little Lamb, alive and standing - even though it seemed to have been violently butchered in sacrifice! It had seven horns and seven eyes which are the seven Spirits of God having been sent out to accomplish his bidding in all the earth. *(You cannot see the Lion until you see the Lamb! Mankind's redeemed innocence is the authority of the throne of the Kingdom of God. "Having made purification for sins, he sat down!" Heb. 1:3.*

*The word [1]**mesos,** in the midst; from **meta** - suggests an immediate closeness as in an inseparable union. The word [2]**arnion**, is the diminutive from **aren**; thus a lambkin. The verb [3]**esphagmenon**, indicates violence, butchery - also the sacrificial word. Ex. 12:6.*

Interesting prophetic pointer to the slain Lamb of God! The Lion of Judah! See Gen 49:6 Oh my soul, come not into their council; Oh my spirit, be not joined to their company; for

in their anger they slay a man, as if they are slaying an animal in their wantonness! And then 3 verses on, Gen 49:9 Judah is a lion's whelp; and :10 The scepter shall not depart from Judah!

Isa 52:10 The LORD has bared his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God. Isa 52:14 As many were astonished at him—his appearance was so marred, beyond human semblance, and his form beyond that of the sons of men— Isa 52:15 so shall he startle many nations; kings shall shut their mouths because of him; for that which has not been told them they shall see, and that which they have not heard they shall understand. Psalm 22:27 All the ends of the earth shall remember and return to the LORD; and all the families of the nations shall worship before him.)

Rev. 5:7 The Lamb [1]came and [2]at once took it out of the right hand of the One seated upon the throne! *(The use of the Greek tenses create a vivid dramatic picture of the actual scene; [1]**elthen** [Aorist] and [2]**eilephen** which is in the Perfect Tense of the verb, **lambano**, to take, receive, grasp. Alternating the Perfect Tense with the Aorist, is very graphic. [Vincent] Then in the next verse it is back to the narrative Aorist tense.)*

Rev. 5:8 The moment he [1]took the scroll, the four Living Beings and the twenty four elders bowed down in worship in their priestly offices before the little Lamb. Each one had a [2]stringed instrument and a typical temple [3]vessel, a broad shallow saucer of pure gold, filled with incense - in the context of this imagery their praise represented the prayers and worship of the masses of saints - and every single one realized how sanctified they were because of the Lamb. *(Here John again resumes the narrative Aorist tense, [1]**elaben**. The imagery is from the typical tabernacle and temple service. The word [2]**kitharos** [guitar] harp was a triangular shaped stringed instrument with 7 and later 10 strings traditionally associated with joy and gladness in worship [Psa 33:2; Psa 98:5] Then each one of the elders also had a [3]**phialas chrusas**, a golden fire-pan specifically designed to receive the sweet smelling frankincense which was lighted with coals from the brazen altar, where the sacrifice has just been presented in the outer court and then proceeded to offer it on the golden altar before the veil. See Luk 1:10 And the whole multitude of the people were praying outside at the hour of incense.)*

Rev. 5:9 And they sang a new [1]song saying, "We proclaim your excellent worth! You are the only one in the universe entitled to open the scroll and break its seals, since you were slaughtered in sacrifice and [2]in your blood redeemed mankind's

authentic identity [3]in God. You rescued them [4]from everything that could possibly define society before and brought them out of the confines of their dwarfed mindsets. This includes the entire spectrum of people-groupings: our [5]tribal identities, our [6]language-specific dialect preferences, our [7]political and religious associations, as well as every form of [8]racial identity! *(An [1]**ode** is poem praising or glorifying an individual, describing their nature intellectually as well as emotionally. Greek odes were originally poetic pieces performed with musical accompaniment.*

*In the sentence, "in your blood" John uses the Preposition [2]**en**, in. It is used Hebraistically of the price; the value of the thing purchased being contained in the price. [Vincent] And redeemed [2]in God; τῷ Θεῷ - the Dative case also points to location "in" [the words τῷ Θεῷ, too Theo, in or to God, are most likely added by copyist] Textual Commentary by Bruce Metzger.*

Jesus said in Math 13:44, that the man who found the treasure in the agricultural field, sold all he had and bought the entire field! He did not buy from the thief - a thief never becomes owner; his priceless blood was shed to persuade mankind of their worth! Heb 6:16,17.

*The word, **hemas**, "us", in "He redeemed **us**", is not in the original text! Thus, we are not a select group of individuals that are redeemed; this is mankind redeemed out of whatever it was that defined them before! The Preposition **ek**, is used here; thus, [4]out of everything tribal, dialect-related, political etc. - [4]**ek pases [5]phules kai [6]gloosses kai [7]laou kai [8]ethnous.** The word [5]**phule** from **phuo** to beget - tribe - immediate family-ties; blood relatives; [6]**glōssa**, mother-tongue dialect; [7]**laos**, a people group, any specific segment of society; [8]**ethnos**, race; Hebrew גוי **goy**, non-Jewish, in the racial Jewish mind it included the masses of the heathen nations.*

Seven times human society is addressed in the most all-inclusive fashion, with a like grouping of words for all mankind of all races and nations; - here in Rev 5:9, then also Rev 7:9, Rev 10:11, Rev 11:9 Rev 13:7; Rev 14:6 and Rev 17:15.)

Rev. 5:10 And you have made [1]them unto God a realm of royalty to reign upon the earth as priests! *(Again, not, ἡμᾶς, us; but αὐτοὺς, them! Also, not, we shall reign (βασιλεύσομεν basileusomen), but, βασιλεύουσιν **basileuousin**, they reign! They are the redeemed human race as a whole - redeemed to reign as kings and priests, after the order of Melchizedek! The Christ life rules! See Psalm 110:4; Hebrews 7:14-24)*

Rev. 5:11 Then I saw [1]wave upon wave of innumerable celestial shepherd-

messengers [1]engulfing the throne and the elders and the Living Beings and I heard singing! It was a mass choir of [2]multiple millions! *(The word [1]**kuklo**, encircle, from **kuma**, a swelling wave; which also connects with the etymological value of the word **muriades**, from **meu**, like in waves of the sea. Countless [2]myriads - literally ten thousands times ten thousands and thousands of thousands! The largest number named in Ancient Greek was the myriad, myriad [written MM] or hundred million. In his Sand Reckoner, Archimedes of Syracuse used this quantity as the basis for a numeration system of large powers of ten, which he used to count grains of sand!*

According to PIE, the etymology of the word myriad has been variously connected to meu- "damp" in reference to the waves of the sea and to Greek myrmex μύρμηξ, "ant", in reference to their swarms. Proto-Indo-European [PIE] is the linguistic reconstruction of the common ancestor of the Indo-European languages, the most widely spoken language family in the world.)

Rev. 5:12 In their full capacity they exploded in song, proclaiming in unison, "The Lamb's worth is now fully [1]realized! [2]Having been slain in sacrifice, the power, wealth, wisdom, strength, honor, glory, and blessing [3]belong to him!" *(The word [1]**labein**, to have taken/realized, from **lambano**, to take, to grasp, to receive; here in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. The word [3]**esphagmenon** is the Perfect Passive Participle of the verb, **sphazō**, to slay in sacrifice. It is used to describe a state that exists at the time coincident with that of the leading verb as a result of action completed prior to the time of the main verb. The basic thought of the Perfect Tense is that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. In other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now in existence.)*

Rev. 5:13 At that point the entire universe burst out in praise! I heard every created being in the heavenly realm and upon the earth and under the earth and upon the ocean and everything within all these spheres, declaring to the One seated upon the throne and to the Lamb: "The most [1]articulate language, the admiration, the supreme magnificence, the might until the ages of the ages!" *(The word [1]**eulogia**, from **eu**, good, well done, and **logos**; thus, polished language; such language which is artfully adapted to captivate the hearer: fair speaking, fine speeches.)*

In the symbolic language of the book of Revelation people's perception of the world is four dimensional: heaven, earth, the ocean and the deep underworld [including under

the ocean Eze 28:8; Rev 5:13. The idea of the earth dwellers of the time was that the planet was flat and square! So the four corners of the earth were not factual but merely to communicate a symbolic picture and principle within their perceptions - as also the idea of an under world. See these spheres already referenced in Gen 1:2, the earth being without form and empty, and darkness on the face of the deep, [abussos - LXX] and the Spirit of God moving gently on the face of the waters. Also in Ps 135:6 Whatever the LORD pleases he does, in heaven and on earth, in the seas and the Abyss. Or in the LXX it is Ps 134:6.

Rev. 7:9 At this moment I saw a massive throng of people, impossible to count, standing tall and innocent - every one of them [1]dressed in white with palm branches in their hands; they have [1]escaped everything that could possibly define them as a non-Jewish, Gentile world! In fact, every sphere of society was there - including the entire spectrum of people-groupings; all tribal identities with their unique language-specific dialect preferences, they were all present facing the throne and the Lamb as the people of the planet! *(Amazing how, in the previous verses of this chapter, the tribes of Israel are associated with a very specific "number", emphasizing the prophetic detail of the entire Jewish nation. But here, John sees a massive throng of people, impossible to count! In Israel there is a prophetic voice of God's intention to release the blessing of the single SEED of God's faith through Abraham and bless all the nations of the earth! "Count the stars, count the sand!"*

*The word [1]**stolay**, is the white outer garment worn by kings, priests, and persons of rank. The palm branches and the white robes are signs of the celebration of victory and joy. The Preposition [1]**ek**, points to source or origin; mankind was delivered out of their national, geographical and historical identities! Seven times in the book of Revelation human society is addressed in the most all-inclusive fashion, with a similar grouping of words. Rev 5:9, here in Rev 7:9, Rev 10:11, Rev 11:9, Rev 13:7, Rev 14:6 and Rev 17:15. Also note Rev 5:13 and Rev 11:15. See Extended Notes on Israel at the end of Rev 20.*

I looked again and saw a huge crowd, too huge to count. Everyone was there—all nations and tribes, all races and languages. And they were standing, dressed in white robes and waving palm branches, standing before the throne and the Lamb. The Message)

Rev. 7:10 Then I heard the masses shouting as if with one thundering voice saying, "Our salvation is secure in our God who is seated upon the throne and endorsed in the Lamb's doing!"

Hades has no future!

It's gates were disengaged when Jesus went there as a man,

representing the entire human race

and came back with the keys that unlock our authentic sonship!

The son of man is the son of God!

Hey Mr Rock, you're a chip of the old Block! Matt 16:13-19

The Greek word, Hades has two components,

ha, "not" and "eido" to see!

There is no degree of ignorance or indifference

that has what it takes

to prevail against the exhibit of God's image and likeness

revealed and redeemed in ordinary human life!

All flesh shall see his glory - as in a mirror! Isa 40:5

"Mufasa, remember who you are!"

Let's not repeat the same mistake the Jews made! They are still waiting for their Messiah and missed him in their midst!

Luke 18:8 I assure you, he will speedily vindicate you; the day of the son of man is about to dawn! Will the Messiah find a people standing on tip-toe in full expectation of his coming! *(Again, Jesus is not talking about some future coming of the son of man! - Not in this, or in the previous chapter [17] of Luke!)*

Meanwhile... **Luke 18:35 As they approached Jericho, a blind man was sitting beside the road; in eager expectation to receive something.** *(Here is a blind beggar from Jericho, "standing on tip-toe" in his eager expectation for Jesus, the son of David, to show up and heal him! He made the vital connection! See my Chapter on Incarnate Faith.])*

Luke 12:36 Be on tip-toe alert! Imagine how prepared and ready people would be for their master's [1]return from a typical wedding feast! In their mind's eye, they have already pictured the [2]loosening of the mooring of the ship, getting ready to depart, bringing him home; then, waiting at the door, they would immediately open when he knocks and [3]welcome him warmly with open arms! *(Jesus, knows that his eminent death and resurrection would be the culmination of the prophetic word, which was anticipated for generations! The great reconciliation of humanity and their Maker would be accomplished! "I go [to the cross] to prepare the way for you; then I'll return and take you with me, that you may be where I am! John 14:1-3. He is not speaking about what's been interpreted as the "Second Coming" - he is speaking about his resurrection which will be the catalyst to the ultimate flooding of the earth with the knowledge of his glory as the waters covers the sea!"And the glory of the Lord shall be revealed and all flesh shall see it together! As in a mirror! Isa 40:3-5. See 2 Cor 3:18. Also Eph 4:8,9 and, Col 3:1-3 Engage your thoughts with our co-resurrection and co-seatedness in the throne room. Acts 13:29-33*

*The words, πότε ἀναλύσῃ, [2]**analuse**, he shall return; the figure is taken from sailors making the return voyage to the port from which they had sailed. The word, [3]**prosdechomenoi**, means to receive to oneself, to welcome with open arms. From **pros**, face to face and **dechomai**, to welcome, to embrace.)*

Luke 17:20 The Pharisees demanded to know from him, So, when do you say, the

kingdom of God would finally arrive? He answered them, God's kingdom does not arrive as a reward for someone's scrupulous [1]scrutiny. *[Verses 12-21 here, so reminds of Luke 4:17-30! Also, the fact that the Jews, again, missed the moment - as they did in Elijah's and Elisha's days when the Gentiles embraced the blessing! The words, μετὰ [1]παρατηρήσεως, with meticulous observation.]*

Luke 17:21 It's neither here, nor there - *[it's not calendar- or geographical-related]* - **look, and see for yourselves - it is closer to you than what you've ever imagined! The Kingdom of God is within you!** *(People's opinions are confusing; no, it's not where they are pointing to, in their guesses and philosophies. Oh, "perhaps it's somewhere here, within the confines of our traditional beliefs, interpretations and expectations; or maybe it's out there, in outer space?"*

The kingdom of God is indeed within! As Paul would later confirm in Romans 1:19, God is not a stranger to anyone; whatever can be known of God is manifest in man. God has revealed it in the very core of their being, which bears witness within their own conscience! See also Gal 1:16 and John 14:20.)

Luke 17:22 He then turned to his disciples and said to them, There will be days when you will long to see just one of the days of the son of man and there will seem to be no visible evidence for your eyes to behold. *(Luke 10:21-24 Just then, Jesus began to leap with ecstatic joy in the Holy Spirit and burst out into praise, "Oh my Father, Lord of heaven and earth, I mirror your delight! You hid these things from the eloquent scholars of the day and unveiled it to babes! Yes Father, this joyous unveiling [in human form], is your glory! This is the radiance of your face!" (The word, ἀγαλλιάω agalliaō from* ***agan*** *[much]) and ἅλλομαι* ***hallomai*** *with much leaping. The word, ἐξομολογέω* ***exomologeō*** *from ek, out of and* ***homo****, the same and* ***logeo****, to speak - I mirror you. This is your good intention radiating from your countenance -* ***outos egeneto eudokia emprosthen sou*** *- οὕτως ἐγένετο εὐδοκία ἔμπροσθέν σου. Luke 10:22 All things were endowed on me by my Father. No one knows the son like the Father does and it is not possible to know the Father unless the son, who knows him intimately, unveils him to the one who wishes to see him. The only possible way to really know the son is through the Father's eyes - and the only possible way to really know the Father is through the eyes of sonship! [The only way to really know who you are, is to discover yourself through the Father's eyes! This unveiling doesn't happen through mere academic or philosophical scrutiny.] Luke 10:23 He then turned and faced his disciples privately saying, "I want each one of you to know how blessed your eyes are to see what*

you see. Luke 10:24 I tell you, there are generations of prophets and kings who longed to see this and never saw it and to hear what you hear and never heard it!")

Luke 17:23 And some will start pointing you to various locations of their imagination; don't go there! *(The Kingdom of God is within you! Nowhere else!)*

Luke 17:24 For, just like a flash of lightning can illuminate the sky in a moment, so is the unveiling of the son of man!

Luke 17:25 The most significant reference to the day of the son of man, is in the inevitable, terrible things he is about to suffer in his rejection by this generation. *(The day of the Lord Jesus is the theme of Scripture as in 1 Peter 1:10; this was what the Prophets were studying and desiring to know. The content of their message always pointed to the day and the person where the promise of redemption would be realized. The sufferings of the Messiah would redeem and release the glory of God's image and likeness in human life; the glory that Adam lost on behalf of the human race, returns. In Acts 17:31, "In the resurrection, God gave proof to the redeemed innocence of mankind; the "day and the person" prophesied was fulfilled in Jesus." Jesus gives context to this day in John 14:20, "In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you!"*

See Zechariah 3:9 For behold, upon the stone which I have set before Joshua, upon a single stone with seven facets, I will engrave its inscription, says the LORD of hosts, I will remove the guilt of the earth in a single day.

Isaiah 66:8 Who has heard such a thing? Who has seen such things? Shall a land be born in one day? Shall a nation be brought forth in one moment?

Hosea 6:2 After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will raise us up, that we may live before him. (Acts 17:31, Rom 4:25, 1 Pet 1:3.)

Mat 24:34 I tell you in solemn truth that the present generation will certainly not pass away without all these things having first taken place.

2 Cor 1:14, The day of the Lord Jesus Christ is no longer a distant promise but a fulfilled reality.)

Luke 17:26 *[Again, Luke quotes much of Matt 24 - See my notes in Luke 12 for context]* **As it was in Noah's days, so shall it be in the day of the son of man.**

Luke 17:27 People will just be doing life as usual, as if nothing was ever going to change, eating, drinking, and getting married till the day Noah entered the ark and then the flood came, and all were destroyed.

Luke 17:28 Also in the days of Lot; business as usual,

Luke 17:29 until Lot left Sodom and it rained fire and brimstone from heaven and destroyed all. *(See my notes on fire and brimstone at the end of Rev 19. When the imagery of the Lake of Fire is introduced, it suggests a judgment, whereby every possible trace of both the source [the counterfeit Trinity system], as well as the effect in the recipients [their distorted perceptions and mindsets], are forever consumed.*

Every single person who ever dies in ignorance, indifference or unbelief, is immediately confronted with and mirrored in the once and for all death and resurrection of Jesus. This is pictured here in the lake of burning sulphur, cleansing and purifying like in a furnace; separating the gold from the dross in the mindsets of the masses.

*The Greek word for sulphur is **theion**, from **theios**, godlike [neuter as noun, divinity]: - divine, godhead. Sulphur is a yellow inflammable mineral substance found in quantities on the shores of the Dead Sea. This was also known as divine incense, because burning brimstone was regarded as having power to purify, and to ward off disease. Its medicinal values are well known even today.*

All the symbolic pictures of fire, referenced in the book of Revelation, come from the same source, the brazen altar, the prophetic picture of the cross. See Rev 8:5.)

Luke 17:30 In the same way, the Son of man will be unveiled as the Savior of the world on the day of the Lord. *(Noah and Lot are types of Christ - but, where the masses were "lost" in their day; the entire human race is found and redeemed in Jesus. See Luke 15.)*

Luke 17:31 So, on the day when the son of man is unveiled everything changes - the man working on the roof of his house, suddenly has a new priority - leave the house and the things you accumulated under the old legalistic mindset in it! The one working in the field, does not return to the old ways of reaping the harvest of one's own labor. *(Doing home, as well as doing business, takes on a brand new meaning from now on! See John 4:35.)*

Luke 17:32 Remember Lot's wife.

Luke 17:33 Thinking that you can buy your way out to redeem the old life by turning back to your old ways of seeing and doing things, is your loss! By losing the old, you discover the new! *(The word, **peripoiesasthai**, περιποιησασθαι means to purchase; and ζωογονήσει **zōogonēsei,** to restore to life/ rescue from death.)*

Luke 17:34 Also at night, two will be in bed, and one will be taken, the other left.

*(The word, **paralēmphthēsetai**, to be received near - embraced associated - aphiemi left, Luke 18:28 we have given up our homes and followed you...*

*See **Luke 12:51** Do you think that I have come to give peace on earth? No, I tell you, but rather division. (διχοτομέω **dichotomeō** to bisect - cut asunder; to cut into two parts. While this statement of Jesus seems in total contradiction to the good news announced to the Shepherds at his birth "Joy to the world and peace upon earth; God's delight is in mankind!" Luke 2:14. The gospel of God's delight in mankind is an offence to the religious ear! God's favor and grace puts religion out of business! Gal 3:18 The law and the promise are not compatible; the one system nullifies the other. See Rom 3:27. While every single human life is equally included and valued in Christ, multitudes are still in blind-fold mode. See 2 Cor 3:15-18. In the meantime, nothing seems to have changed; the same veil continues to blindfold the hearts of people whenever Moses is read. [Moses symbolizes the futility of self righteousness as the global blindfold of the religious world. John 1:17 Against the stark backdrop of the law; with Moses representing the condemned state of mankind, Jesus Christ unveils grace and truth! He is the life of our design redeemed in human form. **Luke 12:52** From now on a family of five will be divided. Three against two and two against three. **Luke 12:53** A father will be against his son and a son against his father. A mother will be against her daughter and a daughter against her mother. A mother-in-law will be against her daughter-in-law and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law." Also, see my commentary note to Luke 13:27.*

Two systems are represented: righteousness as a reward for obeying the law; or righteousness as a gift from God based on what Jesus accomplished on the cross. See Rom 3:23, 24 and 27.)

Luke 17:35 Two will be grinding at the same mill; one will be taken the other left. *(Just like when Paul was struck off his horse, 1 Thess 5:2 You know for yourselves from experience how the day of the Lord suddenly dawns like a thief in the night! [Acts 9:3 Now as he journeyed he approached Damascus, and suddenly a light from heaven flashed about him. 2 Corinthians 4:6 For it is the God who said, "Let light shine out of darkness," who has shone in our hearts to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Christ. Isa 9:2 The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light; those who dwelt in a land of deep darkness, have been illuminated with light. John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world!)*

1 Thess 5:3 The systems of this world of darkness and unbelief, which held the masses under their pseudo-sway of make-belief peace and security shall suddenly be broken into, like travail upon a woman with child, and none of their captives shall remain under their claim! (The gates of Hades shall not prevail! Hades from ha + eido, not to see.) 1 Thess 5:4 You are no longer in darkness; there are no daunting surprises waiting for you like a thief in the night!)

Luke 17:36 *(The 36th verse is, without doubt, an addition by copyists. The whole verse is absent in the most important as well as all the older manuscripts.)*

Luke 17:37 Where shall this be? Where the vultures gather. *(Again, Matthew is copied, Mat 24:27 for as the lightning strikes from the east unto the west, so shall the unveiling of the son of man be; Mat 24:28 for wherever the carcass may be, there shall the birds of prey be gathered together. See my notes on Rev 19:17-21.)*

Rev 19:16 And a Name is written on his robe and thigh: King of kings and Lord of lords! *(Psa 45:3 Gird your sword upon your thigh, Oh, mighty one, in your glory and majesty!*

Revelation Rev 3:11 Do not let tough times make me seem distant from you! I am at hand - see my nearness, not my absence. And don't let temporal setbacks diminish your own authority either! Remember that you call the shots; you wear the crown. My crown endorses your crown. Rev 3:12, And I will engrave upon the individual the name of my God, also the name of the city [the bride!] of my God, the new Jerusalem that descends from heaven; as well as my own new Name! [2]My Father's Name, John 5:43, I have come in my Father's Name! John 12:28 Father, glorify your Name! Abba Father!

See Psalm 103:4 He redeems his life from the Pit and weaves a crown for him out of loving-kindness and tender mercies.

Rev 21:2 And I saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband;

Psa 87:3 Glorious things are spoken of you, Oh city of God - "This one and that one were born in her" Psa 87:7 Singers and dancers together say, "All my springs of joy are in you!)

Rev 19:17 Then I saw another Celestial Shepherd-Herald standing in the luminous light of the sun. With a loud voice he invited all the birds of the sky to flock together for the great supper of God. *(Another symbolic reference to the Last [Final] Supper - the Lamb's flesh and blood introduce the New Covenant where every judgment is concluded and the Incarnate Word is now our feast - his flesh is bread indeed and*

becomes our flesh his blood is drink indeed and becomes our blood - celebrated in every meal me have. His broken body pictures the broken body of the human race - one died for all, therefore, all have died! 2 Cor 5:14.)

Rev 19:18 Come feast on the flesh of all mankind! The flesh of kings and the flesh of the high ranking captains, the flesh of the mighty men, the flesh of the horses and their riders; all flesh, slave and free, both the prominent and the least. *(This reflects on Ezekiel 39:17 As for you, son of man, thus says the Lord GOD: Speak to the birds of every sort and to all beasts of the field, 'Assemble and come, gather from all sides to the sacrificial feast which I am preparing for you, a great sacrificial feast upon the mountains of Israel, and you shall eat flesh and drink blood. Eze 39:20 And you shall be filled at my table with horses and riders, with mighty men and all kinds of warriors,' says the Lord GOD. Eze 39:21 "And I will set my glory among the nations; and all the nations shall see my judgment which I have executed, and my hand which I have laid on them.*

*See extended notes on **The Winepress of the Passion of God & The Great Supper** at the end of the chapter.)*

Rev 19:19 And I saw the Beast in alliance with the kings of the earth muster their armies to engage in a [1]once-and-for-all war against the One seated on the horse and his army! *(The idea of a once-and-for-all war is implied by the Aorist Infinitive tense of the verb, **poiesai**. [Weymouth] This is the Aorist Active Infinitive which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. Greek Infinitives could have either a present or Aorist form. The contrast between the two forms was not necessarily one of time, it is a difference of aspect. The Present Infinitive was used to express progressive or imperfective aspect. It pictures the action expressed by the verb as being in progress. The Aorist Infinitive however does not express progressive aspect. It presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. This is an important fact since there are numeral references to the same "once and for all war" in the heavens! It is however the same hour; the same event! Rev 12:7; Rev 16:13,14; Rev 17:13,14; Rev 20:8.)*

Rev 19:20 And the Beast and the miracle working Puppet Partner, the False Prophet were arrested and cast into the lake ablaze with sulphur. These two were the ones who were empowered by the Dragon to amaze and deceive those who were tattooed in their heads and hands with the character of the Beast and make them pay religious homage to its image. *(The word [1]**theion**, sulphur, from **theios**,*

godlike [neuter as noun, divinity]: - divine, godhead. Sulphur is a yellow inflammable mineral substance found in quantities on the shores of the Dead Sea. This was also known as divine incense, because burning brimstone was regarded as having power to purify, and to ward off disease. Its medicinal values are well known even today.

Rev 14:8-20 In the imagery here, John sees how the triune religious counterfeit system, the Dragon, the Beast and the False Prophet are thoroughly stripped of their influence and dominion and brought to nought. The False Prophet is mentioned in Rev 16:13 (KJV) "And I saw three unclean spirits like frogs come out of the mouth of the Dragon, and out of the mouth of the Beast, and out of the mouth of the False Prophet." Here in Rev 19:20 and also in Rev 20:10 the Devil, who led them astray will be hurled into the lake of fire and brimstone where his puppet partners, the Beast and the False Prophet have already been confined to. Day and Night they will be the subject of God's touchstone for the ages of the ages - the very atmosphere of the entire universe will be thoroughly fumigated from any evidence of Satanas. [See my notes on the Touchstone in Rev 14:10] Rev 13:11 Then I saw another wild animal; this one emerged out of the earth - it had two horns and resembled a young lamb; yet it had a Dragon's voice. [The counterfeit "trinity" emerges - the one mirroring the other - 1/ the Dragon-Accuser; 2/ the seven headed sea-monster of religion with its leading role player, the head that was slain but became alive again; 3/ and now, here, the Dragon clothed in a lamb's-disguise; later called, the false Prophet.] See extended ***Notes on The Lake of Fire*** *at the end of this chapter.)*

Rev 19:21 The One seated upon the horse, with the sword that proceeded from his mouth, has slain the allies of the Beast and its puppet False Prophet, the kings and their hosts, while all the fowls of the air feasted on their flesh. *(The word,* ***rhomphaia*** *a large, long sword; used in Luk 2:35, where Simon prophesies over Mary: "and a sword will pierce through your own soul also, then the thought processes, reasonings and dialogues of many hearts will be uncovered." This word is used 6 times in Revelation, Rev 1:16, Rev 2:12, Rev 2:16, Rev 6:8, Rev 19:15, Rev 19:21 - in the LXX [Greek Septuagint] it is used for the sword of the Lord. It is an exaggerated size to emphasise its symbolic use. See also my notes on* ***the Sword of the Lord****, Rev 2:16 and Rev 1:16 The Sword would always point back to mankind's original identity. The Hebrew word in Gen 3:24, [where the cherub with the flaming sword was positioned at the Eastern Gate of Eden]* הפך ***hâpak*** *is a primitive root; meaning to turn about; by implication to change, to return, to be converted, turn back. Also in the Septuagint the*

same thought is communicated in the Greek word, ***strephō****, which is the strengthened from the base of* ***tropay****; to turn around or reverse: - convert, turn again, back again, to turn self about. In Luke 15 the prodigal son returns to himself - Plato is quoted by Ackerman [Christian Element in Plato] as thinking of redemption as coming to oneself!*

See also Hebrews 4:12 The message God spoke to us in Christ, is the most life giving and dynamic influence in us, cutting like a surgeon's scalpel, sharper than a soldier's sword, piercing to the deepest core of human conscience, to the dividing of soul and spirit; ending the dominance of the sense realm and its neutralizing effect upon the human spirit. In this way a person's spirit is freed to become the ruling influence again in the thoughts and intentions of their heart. The scrutiny of this word detects every possible disease, discerning the body's deepest secrets where joint and bone-marrow meet.)

I will not leave you as orphans

Remember what Jesus said about his Father in John 14:11, The fact that the Father seems distant or invisible to you does not mean that he is absent. In me he is very present with you! You cannot claim to know me while you ignore him - we are inseparable.

John16:7 Now listen up! Hear me, my departure is not to disadvantage you; everything that is about to happen, brings conclusion and bears together what the Prophets pointed to! This will be to your absolute benefit! If I do not go away, your [1]Companion cannot come to you, but if I go I will send to you One to be [2]face to face with you defining your very being. *([1]**Parakletos**, from **para** and **kaleo**; redefining our original being in the closest possible association and kindred companionship; closer to you than your breath! Again the word [2]**pros** is used!)*

John 16:16 For a brief while I will be absent from your view; then in another brief while you will see and know me.

John 14:10 Are you not convinced that I am in the Father and that the Father is in me? We are in seamless union. The words that I speak to you are not my independent opinion or ideas; the Father in me addresses you; this conversation then translates into the Father's action unveiled in my doing.

John 14:11 The fact that the Father seems distant or invisible to you does not mean that he is absent. In me he is very present with you! You cannot claim to know me while you ignore him - we are inseparable. I dare you *[plural]* **to believe that I am in the Father and the Father in me - if it seems far fetched, then believe me because of what I have done and what I am about to do. It is the Father in me who defines me. My works exhibit his resolve.** *(Jesus does not have to persuade the Father about us, he came to persuade us about the Father. There is nothing in the incarnate Word that is in conflict with who God is! John 1:1-3 If you underestimate me, you underestimate my Father - and you underestimate you!)*

John 14:12 I want you to be fully convinced about this, anyone whose belief concludes in who I am, will also do the works that I do. And because of my [1]relocation to continue to be [2]face to face with my Father, the works that the believer will do, will be of greater proportion and of global influence; the Father is as present in you as he is in me. *(The word, [1]**poreuomai**, to transfer, relocate, to travel. Again the word, [2]**pros**, face to face. Jesus is multiplied in us.)*

John 14:13 And whatever you desire in my name, that will I do that the Father may be glorified in the Son. Your sonship is endorsed in my sonship. *(The first occurrence of the phrase, In my name,* ***en tōi onomati mou.*** *See also John 14:26; 15:16; 16:23, 16:24, 16:26. "If this name, Jesus Christ is in the believer's consciousness, the element in which the prayerful activity moves; so thus, that Name, embracing the whole revelation of redemption, is that which specifically measures and defines the disposition, feeling, object, and contents of prayer. The express use of the name of Jesus therein is no specific token; the question is of the spirit and mind of him who prays" Meyer. [Vincent])*

John 14:14 If you ask me anything, in knowing what my name entitles you to, that will I perform. *(The use of 'me' here is supported by Aleph B 33 and the Vulgate Syriac Peshitta manuscripts. Aleph is the famous Sinaiticus, the great discovery of Constantine von Tischendorf, the only surviving complete copy of the New Testament written prior to the ninth century; [4th century].)*

John 14:15 In your loving me you will greatly value and treasure [1]the prophetic conclusion of my ministry. *(The word [1]**entole**, which is often translated commandment or precept, or assignment, has two components, en, in and telos, from tello, to set out for a definite point or goal; properly the point aimed at as a limit, that is, by implication, the conclusion of an act or state, the result; the ultimate or prophetic purpose. Strong's 5056. See 1 John 2:3.)*

John 14:16 In my prayerful engagement with the Father, he will give you [1]another [2]close companion to be with you - in such an intimate way that [3]my immediate presence will continue to be [4]inseparably one with you in [5]timeless ages to come! *(The word* ***allos*** *is used here. The words [1]**allos** and **heteros** are both usually translated as "another" in English. Yet **allos** means "another of the same kind" and **heteros** means "another of a different type". The word, [2]**parakaleo,** alongside, closest possible proximity of nearness; and **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname. Also, kinsman; intimate companion. See Rom 12:8. "...just be there alongside someone to remind them of their true identity." 1 Thessalonians 5:11 Continue, as you so eloquently do, to edify one another by cultivating the environment of your close association in your joint-genesis. [The word **parakaleo** is here translated as our joint-genesis] The words,* ***ina he meth*** *[meta]* ***umoon eis ton aiona he*** *- ινα η μεθ υμων εις τον αιωνα - the verb [3]**he** from **eimi**, I am, is in the Present Active Subjunctive form, to continue to be; [4]**meta**, with, inseparably one with you in [5]**aiona**, the timeless ages!)*

John 14:17 Your eternal companion is the Spirit of truth, whom those trapped in

the sense-ruled world, just cannot [1]get to grips with! Their visual horizon is veiled, and they are unable to understand what they cannot see. But, *[in your acquaintance with me],* **you are familiar with this [2]seamless, intimate union, and the Spirit's continued presence within you.** *(The word, [1]**lambanoo**, to grasp; to get to grips with. The following 3 verbs are all in the Present Active Indicative tense, which is the timeless present tense, and indicates continued action, something that happens continuously or repeatedly, or something that is in the process of happening: to know, **ginosko**; to abide **meno**; and to be **eimi**. Thus, [2]**ginooskete**, a knowing that is extended beyond the moment. The "absence" of Jesus will not interrupt this knowing. [See verse 20!] Then, ὅτι παρ᾽ ὑμῖν μένει **hoti** because, **para**, closest possible nearness and intimate acquaintance, and [2]**meno** - to abide in seamless oneness; and is present in you! καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἐστιν **kai en humin estin**- the Spirit already resides in you. In the Incarnate Word, spirit dimension is not a foreign place, neither is the Spirit a foreign person to you!)*

John 14:18 At no time will you be orphaned or abandoned by me; I come to abide [1]face to face with you. *(I come to be no less face to face with you, than what I've always been face to face with the Father, from the beginning and for all eternity. The Holy Spirit does not replace, but reinforces the presence of Jesus and the closeness of the Father. Again, John uses the word [1]**pros**, face to face. See John 1:1)*

John 14:19 In yet a little while the world will no longer see me, but I will be tangibly visible to you in the very life we share together.

John 14:20 In that day you will know that we are in seamless union with one another! I am in my Father, you are in me and I am in you! *(The incarnation does not divide the Trinity; the incarnation celebrates the redeemed inclusion of humanity! Picture 4 circles with the one fitting into the other - The outer circle is the Father, then Jesus in the Father, then us in Jesus and the Holy Spirit in us! This spells inseparable, intimate oneness! Note that it is not our knowing that positions Jesus in the Father or us in them or the Spirit of Christ in us! Our knowing simply awakens us to the reality of our redeemed oneness! Gold does not become gold when it is discovered but it certainly becomes currency!)*

The mystery that was hidden for ages and generations is now the unveiling of Christ in us! This is second coming-language, and ultimately the earth will be flooded with the revelation of his glory! As the waters cover the sea! And all flesh shall see it together. According to Peter in Acts 3:25,26 Pentecost celebrates the second coming of the risen Christ, in the nations!

John 12:24 Most certainly shall the single grain of wheat fall into the earth and die - if it doesn't die it remains alone - but in its death it produces much fruit.

John 4:35 Would you say that it will take another four months for the seed to ripen in the ear? This is not the food that I am talking about. The fruit of your own toil will never satisfy permanently. I want to show you the real harvest! From now on, look at people differently; see them through your Father's eyes, and you will know that they are ripe and ready to discover how perfectly mirrored they are in me! *(Jesus cancelled every definition of delay! We've been waiting for the wrong harvest for centuries - the one we've labored for all our lives. A harvest is ripe when the seed in the ear matches the seed that was sown!)*

While all of creation is waiting and longing for the unveiling of the sons of God, many Christians are waiting for the second coming of Jesus!

See Peter's powerful testimony in Acts 3:11-26. This is just after he and his partner John, healed a cripple beggar at the temple. [Only a few days after Pentecost.] Now remember, they did not say to him, sorry Sir, you've missed Jesus by 50 days! Nor did they point this man to an invisible Jesus who disappeared into the sky; they boldly said to him, "Sir, look at us! What we have, belongs to you!"

When everyone gathered in awe of this fantastic miracle, performed by two illiterate fishermen, Peter boldly addressed them:

Acts 3:12-15 Men of Israel, why would you marvel at this and stare so strangely at us! No, we do not possess magic powers due to some level of spirituality or personal piety, because of something that we have achieved! There is a very relevant reason why this man is now walking. The God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, the God of our fathers glorified his son Jesus, whom you betrayed and killed; he is the Prince of life, and God raised him from the dead - this is what we are witnesses to.

Acts 3:16 And on the basis of the faith sourced in his Name, this man, who is known to all, is now standing strong in front of your very eyes. His Name and the faith infused by him has gifted him the complete restoration of his body.

Acts 3:17,18 You and your leaders acted in ignorance; yet God fulfilled every detail of his prophetic word concerning the suffering of his Christ.

Acts 3:19 Let this be your [1]wake-up call once and for all! Face the fact that your sins were [1]completely blotted out, and return to the one you have wandered from. Now you may encounter times of total rejuvenation in the face to face, immediate presence of the Lord! *(The word, [1]**metanoesate**, μετανοησατε - be awakened in your mind - this is the Aorist Active Imperative Tense, which means, get it over and done with!] and return, **epistrepsate** same tense. Then Peter uses the Aorist Passive Infinitive tense εξαλειφθηναι, which clearly does not refer to a future event. The Aorist Infinitive presents the action expressed by the verb as a completed unit with a beginning and end. From the verb, [1]**exaleipho**, with three components, **ek**, out of, and **aleipho**, with **a,** as a particle of union, and **liparos**, to grease, to leave a stain; scars of hurtful experiences were like grease stains stored in memory. The word αναψυξεως, [2]**anapsuxis** from **ana** upwards, and ψύχω **psuchō** to breathe again; a unique word only used this once by dr*

Luke, meaning to catch your breath; heavenly breath from above; spiritual rejuvenation/ refreshing.)

Acts 3:20 Jesus is the [1]authentic Christ, the one whom the prophets spoke about all along; he is the desire of the nations, the very [2]One you longed for; the one and only Messiah, who was to be sent to you! *(The best texts read προκεχειρισμένον, [1]**prokecheirismenon**, meaning, the prophetic and authentic, "handpicked" for you. The "handpicked one", gives a powerful, personal touch to the fact that in his incarnation, Jesus is the tailor-made, anticipated Messiah. Used by Luke only, Acts 22:14; Acts 26:16. The verb originally means to take in hand. Thus, he was handpicked/tailor-made for you. [It is the Perfect Passive Participle, describing a state that exists, as a result of something that happened previously] Then the word, αποστειλη [2]**apostoley**, which is the Aorist Active Subjunctive, expressing a wish, regarding a single event. A definite outcome that will happen as a result of another stated action [the prophetic word]. See John 12:23, Jesus, immediately understanding the prophetic significance of the moment, knew that he, the Messiah, was who all the nations were longing for, and answered, "The hour is here for the Son of man to be glorified! (Jesus studied Scripture as in a mirror - he knew that "in the book, it is written about me!" Haggai 2:7 and the desire of the nations shall come...)*

Acts 3:21 Jesus is the theme of God's conversation, from the earliest ages; through the lips of the prophets who carried the Messiah in the womb of their words. He was to be held all along in the unseen heavenly realm for a time such as this. He is the restoration of all things. *(**The idea of restoration** was part and parcel of the Messianic expectation. Here, in context with the healing of a cripple man, Luke records Peter, using the noun, ἀποκαταστάσεως **apokatastaseos**. The verb, αποκαταστησει to restore to its natural and original condition; as a technical medical term, it denotes complete restoration of health; the restoring to its place of a dislocated joint. **See also it's synonym, diothosis**, used in **Heb 9:10** All these external rituals pertaining to food and drink and the various ceremonial baptisms and rules for bodily conduct were imposed upon them until **the anticipated time of restoration**; the foretold moment when [1]all that was crooked would be made straight and **restored to its natural and original condition**. (This word, [1]**diothosis**, is only used in this one place in the New Testament; what was crooked will be made thoroughly straight, restored to its natural and normal condition something which in some way protrudes or has gotten out of line, as broken or misshapen limbs. Isa 40:3-5.*

Peter clearly remembers his, James and John's encounter on the mount of transfiguration with Jesus, when Moses and Elijah also appeared. Then, a voice ***from within the cloud*** *spoke, this is my Son, the Incarnate Logos* ***[eklego]*** *- hear him! Luke 9:35. See* ***Matt 17:9*** *And as they were coming down the mountain, Jesus commanded them, "Tell no one the vision,* ***until the Son of man is raised from the dead."*** ***Matt 17:10*** *And they asked him, "****Then why do the scribes say that first Elijah must come?****"* ***Mat 17:11*** *He replied, "Elijah does come, and he is* ***to restore all things;*** ***Matt 17:12 but I tell you that Elijah has already come,*** *and they did not know him, but did to him whatever they pleased. So also the Son of man will suffer at their hands."* ***Matt 17:13*** *Then the disciples understood that he was speaking to them of John the Baptist. See Luke 3:3-6 in the Mirror]*

Acts 3:22, Has not Moses told us: The Lord your God will raise up a prophet out of your midsts who is like me. Give your undivided attention to every detail of his conversation and dealings with you. *(The Jews understood Moses to be a type of Christ.* ***John 1:21*** *"Could you possibly be the re-incarnate Elijah?" To which he answered, "No, I am certainly not!" Then you must be The Prophet who Moses said would come? "No!" He said, "I am not." [Deut 18:15; John 6:14; Acts 3:22])*

Acts 3:23 What a foolish thing it is to reject Jesus! There is no second Messiah on the prophetic menu! So, if you've already missed out on linking Jesus with Moses' word, then your entire Messainic expectation is ruined! *(Litt - ignoring who Jesus is, by not hearing Moses [who very much defines the Jewish people], completely destroys your Messainic expectation! ἐξολεθρευθήσεται ἐκ του λαου)*

Acts 3:24 All the prophets, from Samuel onwards, spoke and announced this present time. *(1Sam 3:1 Now the boy Samuel was ministering to the LORD under Eli. And the word of the LORD was rare in those days; there was no frequent vision.)*

Acts 3:25 And you are the sons of the prophets, and the covenant that God initiated with your fathers who were mirrored in Abraham's face when he declared, in your seed will I bless all the families of the earth! *(ἐνευλογέω eneulogeō Gal 3:8. Mat 26:28 for this is my blood which is to be poured out for the many for the remission of sins--the blood which ratifies the Covenant.)*

In the next verse Peter clearly announces the fact that after his resurrection, Jesus has now appeared again, mirrored in this miracle, performed by ordinary people who have realised the essence of the incarnate Christ in his first coming! The single grain of wheat that fell into the earth and died, did not abide alone! It bore much fruit!

Acts 3:26 Having raised his child, Jesus from the dead, he commissioned him first of all to you; in order to bless you in turning you away from the poneros *[evil]* system of wearisome labors and annoyances! *(Heb 9:16 For a will to take effect the person who made it must be dead. Heb 9:17 Before the testator dies the will is merely a future promise with no immediate benefit to anyone.*

See Gal 1:4 Grace and peace have their reference in the fact that Jesus gave himself as the scapegoat for our sins and plucked us out from the [1]evil of this present religious age that encroached on us. This was exactly what the Father had planned in his love for mankind. (The word, [1]poneros, means full of labors, hardships and annoyances; the fruit of the tree of the knowledge of good and labor "poneros"! This concludes in a judgment based on performance. Which is the opposite to an opinion of approval based on value!) Gal 1:5 His glorious reputation is ageless; it extends beyond all times and seasons. We salute him with our amen! (Nothing that religion communicates in any age or context can match him.) Gal 1:6 I am amazed that you can so easily be fooled into swapping the Gospel for a gimmick! The Gospel reveals the integrity of your original identity rescued in Christ; the gimmick is a conglomeration of grace and legalism. This mixture boils down to a do-it-yourself plan of salvation. (Which is a recipe for disaster.) Gal 1:7 There is no other gospel in spite of the many so-called Christian products branded "gospel." If any hint of the law remains, it is not good news but merely religious people's ideas, detracting from the gospel of Christ. (Some seek to unsettle your minds by perverting the Gospel to accommodate their own opinion.)

The same Cloud which "took him from view" now unveils him!

Acts 1:9 And saying these things, while they were gazing at him, he was taken up, and a [1]cloud veiled him from their sight. *(The Jews were familiar with the cloud! See Ex 13:21 in LXX the cloud of his presence, which led the Israelites in the wilderness - νεφέλη **nephele**, from nephos. In Hebrew,* ענה *annah, and Ancient Hebrew,* Enno *Reading from right to left, an eye,* o *seeing the multiplied seed,* nn *then, a picture of a man with his arms raised in wonder, looking at a great sight,* e.*)*

In his message recorded in Acts chapter 3, Peter clearly remembers his, James and John's encounter on the mount of transfiguration with Jesus, when Moses and Elijah also appeared.

2 Pet 1:16 We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic [1]appearance; with our own eyes we have witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate [2]presence *[[2]parousian]* of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life. *("His [1]appearance" here, is obviously referring to this specific moment of seeing Jesus like they have never seen him before! His face shone like the sun, even his raiment were radiant white. Mt 17.)*

2 Pet 1:17 He was spectacularly endorsed by God the Father in the highest honor and glory. Then, a voice from within the cloud spoke, this is the Son of my delight; he completely pleases me. *(Matt 17:5 a radiant cloud enveloped them.)*

2 Pet 1:18 For John, James, and I the prophetic word is fulfilled beyond doubt; we heard this voice loud and clear from the heavenly realm while we were with Jesus in that sacred moment on the mountain.

2 Pet 1:19 For us the appearing of the Messiah is no longer a future promise but a fulfilled reality. Now it is your turn to have more than a second-hand, hearsay testimony. Take my word as one would take a lamp at night; the day is about to dawn within you, in your own understanding. When the Morning Star appears, you no longer need the lamp; this will happen shortly on the horizon of your own hearts.

Luke 9:34 While Peter was still chatting away, they were suddenly struck with awe, being overshadowed by a cloud and enveloped in it.

Luke 9:35 Then, a voice from within the cloud spoke, this is my Son, the Incarnate Logos *[eklego]* **- hear him!** *(The voice of his Father confirms that **his beloved son** is*

the conclusion of the conversation represented in both Moses, [the law] and Elijah, [the prophets] Mark, Matthew and Peter quotes, the Son of my delight instead of "chosen" eklego; Mar 9:7; Mat 17:5. 2 Peter 1:16-19.

Peter, however, knows exactly what he's saying in 1 Pet 2:9, You are proof of the authentic ***[eklego]*** *generation; you give testimony to the original idea of the royalty of true priesthood [the order of Melchizedek;] you are a perfect prototype of the mass of the human race. You are the generation of people who exhibit the conclusion* ***[eis]*** *of the prophetic, poetic thought of God that has come full circle. [See 1 Pet 1:3] You publish the excellence of his elevation and display that your authentic identity has been rescued out of obscurity and brought into his spectacular light! [The word* ***eklego*** *has traditionally been translated to mean election - I would prefer to emphasize the fact that* ***ek*** *is a preposition always pointing to origin or source and the verb* ***lego****, is associated with its noun* ***logos*** *as in the context of John 1:1,14. The original conversation!] See Hebrews 1:1-3 - Jesus is the conversation of God - he is the Logos - Also, John 1:1,2,5,9,14, To go back to the very beginning, is to find the Word already present there; face to face with God. The Word is I am; God's eloquence echoes and concludes in him. The Word equals God. The beginning mirrors the Word face to face with God. [Nothing that is witnessed in the Word distracts from who God is. "If you have seen me, you have seen the Father."] The darkness was pierced and could not comprehend or diminish this light. A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world!)*

Luke 9:36 In the silence following the voice, Moses and Elijah were gone; it was just Jesus. The disciples were speechless and for the time being, kept their encounter secret. *(See Matthew 17:9 As they were descending the mountain, Jesus emphatically instructed them not to tell anyone about their encounter until they see the son of man risen from the dead.")*

Rev 1:7 Behold he comes with a [1]large dense multitude; an innumerable throng of people, united as one, like the particles of water in a cloud. Every eye will see him, not merely as observers, but they will perceive him for who he really is - even those who participated in his murder, when they pierced his hands and his side. Every single tribe of the earth will see him and weep greatly at the thought of their foolish rejection of him! This will surely be! *(The word* ***nephos*** *is a cloud, a large dense multitude, a throng. See Phil 2:8-12.)*

Rev 1:8 The God who is Lord over all things says: I am the Alpha and the Omega -

my I-am-ness defines time - I am present, past and future. *(The union of **Alpha** and **Omega**, in Greek, makes the verb **αω**, I breathe. And in Hebrew the union of the first and last letter in their alphabet, **Aleph** [bull's head] and **Tav** [the cross] makes* ta *in Ancient Hebrew or* את *in modern Hebrew - **et**, which the Rabbis interpret as the first matter out of which all things were formed, [see Gen 1:1]. The particle **et**, is untranslatable in English but, says Rabbi Aben Ezra, "it signifies the substance of the thing!" Jesus is the* [1]***Alpha*** *and **Omega** in whom we live, and move, and have our being! He is indeed closer to us than the air we breathe! Don't waste a day waiting for another day!)*

1 Thess 4:17 In the wake of their arising, we will all be gathered into a large dense multitude of an innumerable throng of people, united as one, like the particles of water in a cloud, and we will encounter the Lord in the very air we breathe and so shall we continually celebrate our I-am-ness in our union with him. *(All flesh shall see his glory together - ultimately every single one will realize that Deity and humanity are married - the Bride and her Groom are united!)*

Heb 12:1 So now the stage is set for us: all these faith-heroes cheer us on; they are the [1]cloud of witnesses; as it were, like a great multitude of spectators in the amphitheater. This is our moment. As with an athlete who is determined to win, it would be silly to carry any baggage of the old law-system that would weigh one down. Make sure you do not get your feet clogged up with sin-consciousness. Become absolutely streamlined in faith. Run the race of your spiritual life with total persuasion. *(νέφος [1]**nephos**, a cloud, a large dense multitude, a throng.)*

See 1 Kings 18:43-44 And Elijah said to his servant, "Go up now, look toward the sea." So he went up and looked, and said, "There is nothing." And seven times he said, "Go again." Then it came to pass the seventh time, that he said, "There is a cloud, as small as a man's hand, ***rising out of the sea!***" *[the sea represents the entire human race - co-raised in the man Jesus!]* So he said, "Go up, say to Ahab, 'Prepare your chariot, and go down before the rain stops you.'" *(Note, the size of a man's hand! The word, **xristos**, the Anointed one, from χρίω **chriō**, to smear or rub with oil, to anoint; to draw the hand over, to measure; from χείρ **cheir**, hand. [We still measure the height of horses by hand - ie. "A seventeen hand horse!"])*

The Hour has come!

John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world!

Rev 1:10 I was in a spiritual trance where I witnessed the [1]Day of the Lord. I heard a loud voice [2]behind me, clear and distinct, like the sound of a trumpet! *(The [1]Day of the Lord is the very day to which the prophetic voice of the Spirit of Christ pointed - Jesus the Messiah, is the fulfillment of this day! The word [2]**opiso** points to that which is behind in place and time. The fact that John hears a word **behind him** is so significant! It means that what he hears already happened within its prophetic context! This reminds of the incident recorded in Genesis 22:7 & 8 where Abraham was asked by Isaac, "We have the fire and the wood; but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?" Abraham answered, "God will provide a lamb for the burnt offering, Son." Then, in Gen 22:13, we read that Abraham lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold, **behind him** was a ram, caught in a thicket by its horns! Jesus refers to this in John 8:56-58 when he says, "Abraham saw my day!" And, "Before Abraham was, I am!" [See Extended notes on the Day of the Lord in the Introduction to Revelation as well as at the end of Rev 17.]*

The day of the Lord is the very day to which the prophetic voice of the Spirit of Christ pointed - Jesus the Messiah, is the fulfillment of the day! See 1 Peter 1:10 and 11 where Peter specifically makes mention of the fact that throughout Scripture the Prophets mentioned the day of the Lord as pointing to the sufferings of the Christ and the consequent glory. Their urgent quest was to search out when this would happen and who the Messiah would be. Also in Acts 17:31 Paul addresses the Greek Philosophers and reminds them of their own ancient writings and he quotes two of their well-known philosophers: in 600BC Epimenedes wrote a song saying, "We live and move and have our being in God" then Aratus wrote in 300BC that we are indeed God's offspring! Paul then announces to them that the God whom they worship in ignorance is not far from each one of us! He is not more Immanuel to the Jew than what he is to the Gentile! Then, in the context of his Jewish background and personal encounter of the revelation of Jesus Christ, Paul declares to them the Good News of mankind's redeemed innocence. "God has overlooked the times of ignorance and now is calling all of mankind, whoever and wherever they are, to a radical mind-shift, since he has prophetically fixed a day on which he would judge the world in righteousness by a man whom he has appointed, and of this [righteous judgment] he has given proof to all by raising him from the dead."

Acts 17:30,31. See also Rom 4:25 where, in Paul's understanding, the resurrection of Jesus from the dead includes mankind's co-resurrection and seals their acquittal and redeemed innocence. See extended commentary at the end of Revelation chapter 1 on this theme. Also my notes on End Times at the end of Rev 17.)

John 5:25 Oh how I desire for you to get this! The [1]prophetic hour has come! This is the moment for the dead to hear the voice of the Son of God - C'mon! Hear and live! *(The same sentence is used in John 4:23; the [1]eternal hour, is now!* ***Whatever it was that time pointed to, is now present in me.*** *The verb* ***erchetai****, is the Present Middle Active tense, which is the timeless present tense, [1]the prophetic, hovering hour, is now;* ***kai nun estin****)*

Luke 4:19 I announce that the Jubilee year of the Lord has come! This is the liberation celebration of the Lord, embracing humanity home! *(Isa 61. The Jubilee year is connected with the 50th day of* שָׁבוּעוֹת *Shavuot - Sabbaths; Πεντηκοστή Pentecost - 50 days. Shavuot is called the "Festival of Weeks" [originally tied to an ancient grain festival. See Lk 4:4] because it is held fifty days [seven Sabbaths plus one day] from the first Shabbat after Passover. Lev. 25,10 "You will declare this fiftieth year sacred and proclaim the liberation [Greek* ***aphesis****] of all the inhabitants of the land. This is to be a jubilee for you". In the Greek translation of the Old Testament the relation between jubilee and liberation is even closer because the Hebrew term* יובל ***jubel*** *is not translated into Greek as it was in the Latin of the Vulgate [jubilaeus] and in other languages, it has been translated as "liberation [****aphesis****; see my commentary of this word in the previous verse]" [Lev 25,13], or "year of liberation" [Lev 25,10)] or again "sign of liberation" [Lev 25,11-12]In Hebrew,* יובל *or in Ancient Hebrew* lbfi *to shepherd someone safely and securely home. See Lev 25:10 in the LXX "...and each of you shall return to his home!" Luke 15! The prodigal son came to himself when he returned home! Back to his true I-am-ness!)*

Luke 4:20 Jesus then rolled up the scroll and gave it back to the attendant and sat down, while everyone's eyes were fixed on him. *(They knew that the Messianic expectation hinges on this Scripture; the big question was, when?!)*

Luke 4:21 He announced emphatically, Today this scripture is fulfilled in your hearing! *(This, "one-liner message", contains the weight of the entire prophetic, messianic and jubilee significance! Now, it is no longer a waiting game; it's all about your hearing! See Rom 10:8, "The Word is extremely close to you. It spills over from your heart and becomes dynamic conversation in your mouth!" [Deut 30:11-14.] Pentecost*

is the outpouring of Holy Spirit - "from your innermost being flow rivers of living water! John 7:37-39.)

The Greek word Parousia does not mean 2nd coming!

1 Thessalonians 2:19 We expect nothing less in the context of the gospel than you enjoying a face to face encounter in the [1]immediate presence of our Lord Jesus Christ! This is our delight and wreath of honor! *(The word [1]**parousia** speaks of the immediate presence of the Lord! From **para**, a Preposition indicating closest possible proximity; intimate connection, and **eimi,** I am! There is not even a hint of judgment or punishment in this word! While there are great and accurate definitions in Strongs, please do not believe everything you read there! "G3952 parousia from the Present Participle of G3918 **pareimi**; a being near, that is, advent; often, return; specifically of Christ to punish Jerusalem, or finally the wicked."!!?? [This is blatant nonsense!!]*

The Greek word parousia, occurs 24 times in the NT, and 22 times it wrongly implies a 2nd coming or coming judgment! Only twice it is translated as presence! 2 Cor 10:10, Phil 2:12. Of all the English translations that I have checked, only the Young's Literal has it correct! What a shame that this word has been so dramatically twisted over the years!

*In the Greek Septuagint Ps 138:8 [in the Hebrew it is Ps 139] reads, If I make my bed in Hades, your presence already fills it! LXX - πάρειμι **pareimi** your immediate presence - I am!)*

1 Thess 3:13 The [1]dominion of the Christ life establishes you in blameless innocence, face to face before our God and Father, in the constant awareness of his [2]presence in our mutual togetherness with all the saints! *(The subject of the sentence is the Lord Jesus Christ from the previous verse. His lordship endorses the reign of the Christ life in us. Again the word **parousia** is translated in all other translations [Except YLT] as second coming!)*

2 Pet 1:16, We are not con-artists, fabricating fictions and fables to add weight to our account of his majestic [1]appearance; with our own eyes we have witnessed the powerful display of the illuminate presence *[[2]parousian]* of Jesus the Master of the Christ-life. *(Peter was certainly not referring to a possible future event. "His [1]appearance" here, is obviously referring to this specific moment of seeing Jesus like they have never seen him before! His face shone like the sun, even his raiment were radiant white. Mt 17.)*

1 Thess 4:13 I do not want you to be ignorant concerning those who seem to be fast asleep in their indifference and unbelief. There is no need for you to grieve

as if they are beyond hope! *(See 1 Cor 15:51 [1]Ponder this mystery, I want to show you something that you have never seen before: [2]everyone will awaken out of sleep; we will [3]all experience exactly the same change. Look! A Mystery - [1]**idou musterion**; [2]**pantes ou koimethesometha**, means no one will sleep; [3]**pantes de allangesometha**; everyone will be changed.)*

1 Thess 4:14 We believe that Jesus died and rose again, and that he fully represents and includes even those who have not awoken unto him yet. God will [1]lead them to realize that they are indeed in Jesus. *(The word [1]**ago** means to lead as a shepherd leads his sheep. See 1 Corinthians 1:30, Ephesians 1:4.)*

1 Thess 4:15 We give voice to the word of the Lord; we are God's wake-up call to them that are asleep! We are exhibiting the [1]immediate tangible presence of the Lord and shall not [2]exclude them! *(The word [1]**parousia** means immediate presence. See my comment in 1 Thessalonians 2:19. See the use of the word [2]**phthanō**, to prevent, to hinder or exclude, also in 2 Corinthians 10:14, Our ministry to you is proof that there are no geographic limitations which could possibly exclude you from the gospel of Jesus Christ! See also 1 Thessalonians 3:12, "We can already see how the Lord causes the love we have for you to dynamically impact each of you and burst its banks to flood the entire world!" The people who dwelt in darkness have seen a great light! The true light that enlightens everyone has come! And the glory of the Lord shall be revealed and all flesh shall see it together!)*

1 Thess 4:16 *(There remains no disconnect between those who are dead and those who are alive; everyone will encounter the great awakening, where the invisible meets the visible!)* **In their awakening, the dead will all, first-hand witness the Lord stepping out of the invisible heavenly realm into their immediate visible horizon with an inciting shout, announcing his triumphant reign in the trumpet-like billowing voice of God.**

1 Thess 4:17 In the wake of their arising we will all be gathered into a large dense multitude of an innumerable throng of people, united as one, like the particles of water in a cloud, and we will encounter the Lord in the very air we breathe and so shall we continually celebrate our I-am-ness in our union with him. *(All flesh shall see his glory together - ultimately every single one will realize that Deity and humanity are married - the Bride and her Groom are united!*

1 Thess 4:18 The fact that we are all deeply connected in the same source of our 'beingness' causes us to be constantly engaged in this conversation with one

another.

Like a "Thief in the Night"

Rev 3:3 Remember therefore what it felt like when you first heard and [1]embraced the word as your own! It was like discovering a priceless [2]treasure! Now [3]make up your mind once and for all! [4]Why should I surprise you like a thief and break into your space whilst you are fast asleep and not even anticipating my [5]intimate intent; not knowing the moment of my [5]visitation? *(The word [1]**eilephas** from **lambano** is in the Perfect Tense, meaning, what you received as a permanent deposit. The word [2]**tereo** means to treasure. The word **metanoia** means to realize God's thoughts. Like most Greek words, μετάνοια [3]**metanoia** is a compound word, from **meta**, together with and νοιέω **noieō**, to perceive with the mind. It describes the awakening of the mind to that which is true; it is a gathering of one's thoughts, a co-knowing. Faith is not a decision; it is a discovery! It has nothing in common with the Latin word **paenitentia** - where the idea of penance and repentance stems from! Sadly the word repentance became the popular English translation of **metanoia.** Here [3]**metanoesan,** is in the Aorist Imperative - meaning, "Engage your thoughts with my thoughts once and for all - get it over and done with!" The word [4]**ean** suggests, if perhaps, in case you were not alert, you would not anticipate the intimacy of my presence. The word [5]**heko** means to be present - to approach one with intimate intent. The Hebrew idiom, like a thief in the night, refers to the surprise element; this is in reference to one of the traditions of the Jewish marriage practices as celebrated in the 1st century, where the Groom comes to "retrieve" his Bride at an unexpected moment. This is to be looked for with joyful expectation.)*

Rev 3:19 It is with [1]affection that I address every one of you, whoever you are. I would [2]earnestly persuade you as a parent would [3]instruct and nurture their children: [4]eagerly [5]acquaint yourselves with all that I have in mind for you. *(The word [1]**phileo**, is a friendship word and suggests fondness and affection; [2]**enlencho** means to encourage, convince, to persuade. This is a quote from Proverbs 3:12 for the LORD reasons convincingly with him whom he loves, as a father communicates with the son in whom he delights. Here the Hebrew word, יכח **yâkach** is used, which in this context suggests to reason together; see Isaiah 1:18. The word [3]**paideuo** means to nurture and train a child; [4]**tzeleuo** from **zelos** - means to be fervently eager; to have strong feelings of excitement. The word often translated 'repentance' is actually [5]**metanoeo** which has nothing to do with penance! It means to join thoughts*

about something; to co-know.)

Rev 3:20 You have shut me out in your self-righteousness *[Laodicea]*, **but behold, here I stand knocking at the door! If anyone [1]recognizes my voice and lets me in, I am so ready to join you for a feast! Yes, I will dine with you and you with me!** *(Song of Songs 5:2 I was asleep, but my heart was awake.* ***It is the voice of my beloved who knocks****: "Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled; for my head is filled with dew, and my hair with the dampness of the night." Rev 3:3. See John 10:2, The shepherd of the sheep enters by the door. [In the context of Jesus' conversation he emphasizes the fact that the Shepherd-Messiah would surely only enter by the door; which is* [1]***the familiar voice of the prophetic word****. Heb 1:1-3; Heb 4:12]*

See John 6:58 and Rev 2:20 on the significance of meals as well as the extended commentary at the end of Luke 11 and Rev 2.

It is characteristic of John to note the sayings of Christ which express the reciprocal relations of himself and his followers. See John 6:56; John 10:38; John 14:20; John 15:4, John 15:5; John 17:21, John 17:26. Compare John 14:23. Vincent's Word Studies.)

Rev 3:21 *[Through this door of my death as your death, and my resurrection as your resurrection]* **– we now dine together in the throne room, [1]celebrating your victory mirrored in mine! This is my gift to you; it is on exactly the same basis of [2]my victory celebration and my joint seatedness with my Father in his throne-room!** *(The word* [1]***nikoon****, is the Present Active Participle, form of the verb* ***nikao****, to conquer; to emphasize a continual or habitual victory. Note the words,* ***hōs kagō enikēsa*** *where* [2]***enikesa*** *is the first Aorist Active Indicative of the same verb,* ***nikaō****, looking back on the victory as over in the past. A.T. Roberston compares this to John 16:33 where before the Cross Jesus says* ***egō nenikēka ton kosmon*** *which is in the Perfect Active tense of the same verb* ***nikao****, emphasizing the abiding effect of the victory!)*

1 Thess 5:1 I do not need to speculate about [1]specific prophetic moments or even mention [2]significant dates. *(The word* [1]***xronos****, speaks of a specific space or portion of time, an individual opportunity, or season;* [2]***kairos****, a fixed and definite time, the decisive epoch waited for.)*

1 Thess 5:2 You know for yourselves from experience how the day of the Lord suddenly dawns like a thief in the night! *(Acts 9:3 Now as he journeyed he approached Damascus, and suddenly a light from heaven flashed about him. 2 Corinthians 4:6 For it is the God who said, "Let light shine out of darkness," who has shone in our hearts*

to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Christ. Isa 9:2 The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light; those who dwelt in a land of deep darkness, have been illuminated with light. John 1:9 A new day for mankind has come. The authentic light of life that illuminates everyone was about to dawn in the world!)

1 Thess 5:3 The systems of this world of darkness and unbelief, which held the masses under their pseudo-sway of make-belief peace and security shall suddenly be broken into, like travail upon a woman with child, and none of their captives shall remain under their claim! *(The gates of Hades shall not prevail! Hades from* ***ha + eido****, not to see. In a walled city, the gates are the most strategic point - if the gates are disengaged, the city is taken! Thus, the blindfold mode of mankind's forgotten identity, will not prevail against you!)*

1 Thess 5:4 You are no longer in darkness; there are no daunting surprises waiting for you like a thief in the night!

1 Thess 5:5 All of you are begotten of light, the Day of the Lord is your true parent! Neither night nor darkness have any claim on you!

1 Thess 5:6 Live alert and you will not become intoxicated by the indifference of others.

1 Thess 5:7 Sleeping and drunkenness are typical things people do at night, but now the day of the Lord has dawned within us and has put an end to the slumbering effect and intoxication of the practices of darkness.

1 Thess 5:8 So let us clothe ourselves with day-garments, protecting our sober seeing by having our hearts fully guarded by the breastplate of love-inspired faith, and having our minds encircled, like a helmet, with an expectation which is consistent with what salvation declares!

1 Thess 5:9 For God did not set us up for disappointment; he is not teasing us with [1]desires that we desperately reach for but cannot attain! He has brought us to a place where we are surrounded by the poetry of what salvation communicates in the lordship of Jesus Christ. *(The word often translated, wrath, is the word* [1]***orge****, from* ***oregomai*** *which means to stretch oneself out with strong and passionate desire.)*

1 Thess 5:10 The fact that he died our death is equally valid to those who are awake to its effect or still fast asleep in their indifference to it; we are together destined to live entwined in the [1]closest possible association with him! *(The*

*word [1]**hama** is a particle of union denoting close association. See Gal 2:20.)*

The New Heaven and New Earth

Rev 20:10 The Devil, who led them astray will be hurled into the lake of fire and brimstone where his puppet partners the Beast and the False Prophet have already been confined to. Day and Night they will be the subject of God's [1]touchstone for the ages of the ages - the very atmosphere of the entire universe will be thoroughly fumigated from any evidence of Satanas. *(See my notes on the [1]Touchstone in Rev 14:10)*

Rev 20:11 And I saw a huge white throne and it was as if heaven and earth fled away from the presence of the one seated upon the throne and its place was never found again. *(This means that there is no accusation in the heavens or upon the earth that could possibly stand in the presence of the Lamb, the One seated upon the throne of the judgment of righteousness – his throne gives testimony to mankind's redeemed acquittal. See Hebrews 1:3 "Having made purification for sins he sat down." There exists no evidence that could be brought from any sphere or dimension that could possibly testify against the human race - Acts 17 The God of creation has overlooked the times of ignorance and now urgently persuades all of mankind everywhere to awaken in their understanding to the fact of their innocence - he appointed a day and a person and on that day and in that person God would judge he world in righteousness and of this he has given proof by raising Jesus from the dead! The resurrected Jesus is the official receipt and verdict confirming mankind's redeemed innocence! Romans 4:25.* ***The entire universe now bears witness to mankind's redeemed innocence.****)*

Rev 20:4 And I saw thrones and those seated upon the thrones have been given judgment. They are the souls who didn't worship the Beast or its image, and did not take his mark in their foreheads or on their hands. The system of the Beast [1]axed them because of the Testimony of Jesus and because of the Word of God, since they didn't fit into their religious mold! They are the living beings, joined together in the Christ life, reigning from their joint-seatedness in the throne of the Lamb for a thousand years. *(See* ***notes on the thousand years*** *at the end of Chapter 20. Rev 1:2 John gave accurate evidence to* ***the Word of God and the Testimony of Jesus Christ****, exactly as he saw it. [The Testimony of Jesus Christ is the context of the prophetic word.] The word, [1]****pelekizō****, axe, to cut off, from* ***plassō****, to form, mold something from clay, wax, etc. - used of a potter - they would not be molded into a distorted image-mindset. Rev 21:1, also Mat 19:28 Jesus said to them, "Truly, I*

say to you, in the rebooting of mankind, when the Son of man shall sit on his glorious throne, you who have followed me will also sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel. See the word, ***paliggenesia****, [Mt 19:28 & Titus 3:5] suggests a complete restoration to the original, in modern terms,* ***rebooted****. From* ***palin****, again by repetition and* ***genesis****, source.)*

Heb 12:22 By contrast, we have been welcomed to an invisible mount Zion; the city of peace *[Jerusalem]*, **the residence of the living God, the festive assembly of an innumerable celestial host!**

Heb 12:23 We are participating in a mass joint-celebration of heavenly and earthly beings; the [1]Ekklesia-church of the firstborn mirror-inscribed in the heavenlies. *(Our original identity, [1]****Ekklesia****, from* ***ek****, a Preposition that always denotes origin, and* ***kaleo****, meaning to identify by name, to surname], is endorsed by Jesus, patterned in him, the first born from the dead.)*

Heb 12:24 Jesus is the spokesman and arbitrator of the New Testament order. His blood signature sanctions mankind's innocence. This is a complete new language that communicates better things, in that it is the very substance of what was spoken in the shadow-type message of the blood sacrifice that Abel brought. *(Abel's faith was a prophetic introduction to the sacrificial shadow system of the Old Covenant. Jesus is the substance of things hoped for! Heb 11:4 It was faith that made the difference between the sacrifices of Abel and Cain, and confirmed Abel's righteousness. God bore witness to righteousness as a gift rather than a reward! Even though he was murdered, his faith still has a most relevant, prophetic voice.)*

Heb 12:25 If Jesus is the crescendo of God's final message to mankind, you cannot afford to politely excuse yourself from this conversation. Consider the prominent place that Moses plays in the history of Israel: if you think that Moses or any of the Prophets who spoke with authority on earth deserve honor, how much more should this word that God declared from heaven concerning our sonship, and our redeemed innocence revealed in the Messiah himself, deserve our undivided attention!

Heb 12:26 When he introduced the prophetic shadow of what was to come *[the law-system]*, **his voice visibly shook the earth. (Ex 19:18.) But now the Messiah has come** *(he is the desire of the nations; he is what heaven and earth were waiting for [Hag 2:6,7])* **The voice of God** *(articulated in Christ's birth, life, ministry, death, and*

resurrection) **has rocked not only the systems on the earth, but also every unseen principality in the heavens, to their very foundations!**

Heb 12:27 In the words of the Prophet, "Yet once more will I shake every unstable system of man's effort to rule himself." God clearly indicates his plan to remove the old and replace it with the new. The second shaking supersedes any significance in the first shaking. Then it was a physical quaking of the earth; now the very foundations of every man-made system was shaken to the core while the heavens were impacted by the announcement of his permanent rule on earth as it is mirrored in heaven.

Heb 12:28 We are fully associated in this immovable Kingdom; an authority that cannot be challenged or contradicted. Our participation echoes grace *(and not law-inspired obedience)* **as we [1]accommodate ourselves to God's delight, yielding in awe to his firm embrace.** *(The word, [1]**euaresto**, means well pleasing, to accommodate yourself to God's delight.)*

Heb 12:29 His zeal for us burns like fire. *[Deut 4:24.]*

Isa 9:6 For unto us a child is born; unto us a son is given; and the government will be upon his shoulder, and his name will be called "Wonderful Counsellor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace."

Isa 9:7 Of the increase of his government and of peace there will be no end, upon the throne of David, and over his kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from this time forth and for evermore. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will do this.

2 Cor 5:17 The old things have passed away, behold, everything has become new!

Rev 21:3 And a glorious announcement was heralded from the throne, "Behold, God's tabernacle is with the human race!" He has taken up permanent residence in human skin, to be with them in the closest possible association of oneness. They are his own possession; his tribe and he is their God inseparably entwined with them. *(Rev 7:15 Standing free and forgiven in their redeemed innocence and union, face to face before the throne of God, they are fully engaged, day and night in their priestly service of worship in the inner sanctuary.* ***The one seated upon the throne is their tabernacle - he shelters them with his presence.)***

Rev 21:4 He wipes every tear from their eyes and [1]blots out every hurtful memory! And death shall be no more. Nor any association with it; no more mourning and

bitter weeping nor any reference to pain! For the former things have passed away! *(The word, [1]**exaleipho**, comes from **ek**, out of, and **aleipho**, with **a**, as a particle of union, and **liparos**, to grease, to leave a stain; scars of hurtful experiences were like grease stains stored in memory. Rev 7:16 & 17.*

Isaiah 25:6 The LORD of hosts will prepare a lavish banquet for all peoples on this mountain; a banquet of aged wine, choice pieces with marrow, and refined, aged wine. Isa 25:7 and on this mountain He will swallow up the covering which is over all peoples, even the veil which is stretched over all nations. Isa 25:8 He will swallow up death for all time, And the Lord GOD will wipe tears away from all faces, And he will remove the reproach of his people from all the earth; For the LORD has spoken....Holman Christian Standard Bible

And on this mountain, he will swallow up the burial shroud that enfolds all peoples, the veil that is spread over all nations—

Isa 51:11 And the redeemed of the LORD shall return, and come to Zion with singing; everlasting joy shall be upon their heads; they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.

Socrates observes, "How thrice happy those of mortals, who, having had these ends in view, depart to Hades; for to them alone is it given there to live; but to others, all things there are evil" ["Fragment"]. And Euripides: "The dead, tearless, forgets his pains.")

Rev 7:16 Here there is no memory of hunger or thirst or a scorching sun to plague them! (Isa 49 is fulfilled! See Isa 49:6 "I will give you as a light to the nations, that my salvation may reach to the end of the earth." The tribes of Judah as a prophetic pointer to the entire population of the planet are gathered as one in worship!" Isa 49:10 "They shall not hunger or thirst, neither scorching wind nor sun shall smite them, for he who has pity on them will lead them, and by springs of water will guide them.")

Rev 7:17 For the little Lamb who occupies the center stage of the throne will shepherd them and lead them beside living springs of water and God shall blot out every hurtful memory of the tears they have cried!

A similar scene is set here to mirror the historic deliverance of Israel out of slavery in the build-up to the first prophetic Passover - this time the dramatic symbolic pictures reflect on the final Passover and the slain Lamb on the throne addressing and bringing closure and conclusion to the many ideas of judgment so deeply entrenched in Jewish consciousness. Pasach, פסח protecting and rescuing. From an Arabic root which means

to expand; to save. See John 11:56. ***Their stories and symbolic prophetic pictures are repeated again and again, waging war against their perceived reasonings and philosophies portrayed in their own historic priesthood and altar services.***

The number seven brings out the varied forms as well as their essential oneness; whether the "seven Spirits of God"; the "seven churches," the "seven horns" and "seven eyes" of the Lamb, the "seven seals," the "seven trumpets", and the "seven bowls.")

Rev 21:5 And the one seated upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new! And he instructed me to write, because these words are true and to be relied on! *(See Isa 43 :18 Do not remember former things, nor consider the things of old.)*

Rev 21:6 And he said to me, everything is now [1]fully accomplished. I am the Alpha and the Omega, the sum total of the entire prophetic conversation concerning mankind's redemption. I am both the origin and the conclusion of all things. Anyone thirsty can come and drink freely from the gift of the waters of life direct from its source! *(The word [1]**gegonan** from **ginomai**, to make or give birth is in the Perfect Active Indicative Tense denoting an action which is completed in the past, but the effects of which are regarded as continuing into the present. Isa 55:1 "Ho, every one who thirsts, come to the waters; and he who has no money, come, buy and eat! Come, buy wine and the finest wheat without money and without price. Isa 55:2 Why do you spend your money for that which is not bread, and your labor for that which does not satisfy? Hearken diligently to me, and eat what is good, and delight yourselves in fatness. Isa 55:3 Incline your ear, and come to me; hear, that your soul may live; and I will make with you an everlasting covenant, my steadfast, sure love for David.)*

The Wedding

Just like Babylon is not a city in the symbolic language of Revelation, it is a fallen-mindset society; so the New Jerusalem is not a city but the redeemed society of mankind! The Bride of Christ! In John 7:37,38 when Jesus speaks of waters gushing forth out of your innermost being, he says that you are the city! You are the bride! God's redeemed society! The pool of Siloam as the source in the city of Jerusalem, mirrors your innermost being. See Luke 13:34,35.

Rev 21:2 And I saw her, in spotless magnificence, the Holy City, the New Jerusalem, descending out of the heavens; having been fully prepared as a bride and beautifully adorned for her husband.

Psa 87:3 Glorious things are spoken of you, Oh city of God - "This one and that one were born in her"

Psa 87:7 Singers and dancers together say, "All my springs of joy are in you!"

This is the conclusion of the ages and the theme wherein the entire book of Revelation unfolds!

Rev 5:11 Then I saw [1]wave upon wave of innumerable celestial shepherd-messengers [1]engulfing the throne and the elders and the Living Beings and I heard singing! It was a mass choir of [2]multiple millions! *(The word [1]**kuklo**, encircle, from **kuma**, a swelling wave; which also connects with the etymological value of the word **muriades**, from **meu**, like in waves of the sea. Countless [2]myriads - literally ten thousands times ten thousands and thousands of thousands! The largest number named in Ancient Greek was the myriad, myriad [written MM] or hundred million. In his Sand Reckoner, Archimedes of Syracuse used this quantity as the basis for a numeration system of large powers of ten, which he used to count grains of sand!*

According to PIE, the etymology of the word myriad has been variously connected to meu- "damp" in reference to the waves of the sea and to Greek myrmex μύρμηξ, "ant", in reference to their swarms. Proto-Indo-European [PIE] is the linguistic reconstruction of the common ancestor of the Indo-European languages, the most widely spoken language family in the world.)

Rev 5:12 In their full capacity they exploded in song, proclaiming in unison, "The Lamb's worth is now fully [1]realized! [2]Having been slain in sacrifice, the power, wealth, wisdom, strength, honor, glory, and blessing [3]belong to him!" *(The*

*word [1]**labein**, to have taken/realized, from **lambano**, to take, to grasp, to receive; here in the Aorist Infinitive tense, which indicates prior completion of an action in relationship to a point in time. The word [3]**esphagmenon** is the Perfect Passive Participle of the verb, **sphazō**, to slay in sacrifice. It is used to describe a state that exists at the time coincident with that of the leading verb as a result of action completed prior to the time of the main verb. The basic thought of the Perfect Tense is that the progress of an action has been completed and the results of the action are continuing on, in full effect. In other words, the progress of the action has reached its culmination and the finished results are now in existence.)*

Rev 5:13 At that point the entire universe burst out in praise! I heard every created being in the heavenly realm and upon the earth and under the earth and upon the ocean and everything within all these spheres, declaring to the One seated upon the throne and to the Lamb: "The most [1]articulate language, the admiration, the supreme magnificence, the might until the ages of the ages!" *(The word [1]**eulogia**, from **eu**, good, well done, and **logos**; thus, polished language; such language which is artfully adapted to captivate the hearer: fair speaking, fine speeches.)*

Rev 5:14 To which the four Living Beings added their endorsement and the elders prostrated themselves before the throne in silent worship!

Rev 7:9 At this moment I saw a massive throng of people, impossible to count, standing tall and innocent - every one of them [1]dressed in white with palm branches in their hands; they have [1]escaped everything that could possibly define them as a non-Jewish, Gentile world! In fact, every sphere of society was there - including the entire spectrum of people-groupings; all tribal identities with their unique language-specific dialect preferences, they were all present facing the throne and the Lamb as the people of the planet! *(Amazing how, in the previous verses of this chapter, the tribes of Israel are associated with a very specific "number", emphasizing the prophetic detail of the entire Jewish nation. But here, John sees a massive throng of people, impossible to count! In Israel there is a prophetic voice of God's intention to release the blessing of the single SEED of God's faith through Abraham and bless all the nations of the earth! "Count the stars, count the sand!"*

*The word [1]**stolay**, is the white outer garment worn by kings, priests, and persons of rank. The palm branches and the white robes are signs of the celebration of victory and joy. The Preposition [1]**ek**, points to source or origin; mankind was delivered out of their national, geographical and historical identities! Seven times in the book of Revelation*

human society is addressed in the most all-inclusive fashion, with a similar grouping of words. Rev 5:9, here in Rev 7:9, Rev 10:11, Rev 11:9, Rev 13:7, Rev 14:6 and Rev 17:15. Also note Rev 5:13 and Rev 11:15. See Extended Notes on Israel at the end of Rev 20.

I looked again and saw a huge crowd, too huge to count. Everyone was there—all nations and tribes, all races and languages. And they were standing, dressed in white robes and waving palm branches, standing before the throne and the Lamb. The Message)

Rev 7:10 Then I heard the masses shouting as if with one thundering voice saying, "Our salvation is secure in our God who is seated upon the throne and endorsed in the Lamb's doing!"

Rev 19:6 Then I heard the voice of an innumerable mass of people exploding like a thunderous torrent of mighty cascading waterfalls, bellowing, Hallelujah! The Lord our God has claimed his kingdom and established his sovereign rule over everything!

Rev 19:7 This is the climax of the ages! Celebrate his glory with ecstatic joy and extreme delight, for the wedding feast of the Lamb has come! The day didn't catch her by surprise! His bride has prepared herself appropriately! She is ready and fully [1]fit for the occasion! *(The word, [1]**hetoimasen**, is in the Aorist Active Indicative tense pointing to what has already happened. This word derives from an old word, **heteos**, fitness. She has gotten herself ready! Verse 8 tells us how she did it! See also, my **notes on the City-Bride** at the end of Revelation 3.)*

Rev 19:8 She [1]was given the finest linen to clothe herself; there she stands, wrapped in radiant white - dressed in [2]spotless, saintly innocence. *(The verb, **edothe** from **didomi**, was given, Aorist Passive Indicative. The word innocence, [2]**dikaiōma** stems from the word **dike**, two parties finding likeness in each other. The word, **dikey** is also the root for the word **dikaiosune**, righteousness. Sadly, many translations have it completely wrong here! This is not the righteous "deeds" of the saints! This innocence gives testimony to the merits of the Redeemer. Paul says in Php 3:9, "And be found in him, not having my own righteousness, which is of the law, but what is through the faith of Christ, the righteousness which is of God by faith." Zech 3:4 And the celestial shepherd-messenger said to those who were standing before him, "Remove the filthy garments from him." And to him he said, "Behold, I have taken your iniquity away from you, and I will clothe you with righteousness." Aramaic Targum.)*

Rev 19:9 And he instructed me to record this in writing: Oh the [1]blessedness

of this bliss which is the supreme celebration of the union of the ages! You have individually been [2]identified by name and invited to the Lamb's supper, concluding in the ultimate wedding feast! This is the Grand Finale in the [3]unveiling of God's word. *(This is not a wedding where you are invited simply because you're a friend of a friend of the Groom or the Bride - or a distant second cousin to a relative of a relative on someone's mother's side! No! You're the Bride!*

*The word, [1]**makarios**, usually translated, blessed, suggests a special intensity of delight. It is another beatitude [**makarioi**] like that in Rev 14:13 [fourth of the seven in the book]*

*The verb, κεκλημενοι [2]**kekelemenoi** is a Perfect Passive Participle of **kaleo**, to identify by name, to surname. The Passive Participle describes a state that exists at the time coincident with that of the leading verb as a result of action completed prior to the time of the main verb, [in previous verse] **edothe** from didomi, was given [v8] which is in the Aorist Passive Indicative. The Perfect Participle endorses the fact that this is a standing invitation! See the extended notes on **ekklesia** at the end of chapter 1. The word, [3]**alethinos**, from **alethes**; from the negative particle, **a** and **lanthanō**, to lie hidden; thus, that which is unveiled truth.)*

Rev 19:10 I was so overwhelmed that I fell down at his feet to worship him; he immediately asked me to see him as a fellow bond-servant and a fellow brother, jointly echoing the testimony of Jesus! Worship God, he said, the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy! This wedding is the entire culmination of the prophetic word!

Rev 19:11 Then, in my vision, heaven opened and I saw a white horse appear; the Name of the one seated upon the horse is Faithful and True. Righteousness spans the range of his judgment and warfare. *(See notes on the **Open heaven** at the end of Rev 13.)*

Rev 19:12 And his eyes were like flashing flames of fire. His head was adorned with many royal diadems. He has a Name written upon him which he alone understands; no one recognizes him by that name. *(The Jews knew God as the "unpronounceable Name, and therefore called him, **HaShem** - השם The Name! See my commentary on Rev 1:4*

They could not connect this most sacred Name to the Messiah-Christ, JESUS, born in Bethlehem, condemned and crucified by them!"

John 1:11 It was not as though he arrived on a foreign planet; he came to his own, yet his own did not recognize him. (The Jews should have been the first to recognize him!)

Isaiah 7:14 Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign. Behold, a virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel. See Luke 1:28,31.

*"...and you shall call his Name Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins." See Jeremiah 23:6 "In his days Judah will be saved, [**yâsha'**, a primitive root; properly to be open, wide or free, that is, [by implication] to be safe; causatively to free or succor, defend, deliver [-er], help, preserve, rescue, be safe, bring [having] **salvation**, get victory.] And Israel will dwell securely. And **this is his Name** by which he will be called:* יהוה צדקנו *- Jaweh Tzadeknu - **Jaweh our righteousness.**"*

The One with eyes ablaze as in Rev 1:14 and Rev 2:17,18, also Rev 3:12...And I will engrave upon them the name of my God, also the name of the city [the bride!] of my God, the new Jerusalem that descends from heaven; as well as my own new Name!)

Rev 19:13 The robes he wore were dipped in blood and his [1]Name has always been the Word of God! *(He is the Logos that was before time was; the completeness of prophecy, the Incarnate One! See John 1:1-3,14. See **Notes on the Hidden Name** at the end of Rev 19.)*

The Prostitute becomes the Bride!

Luke 16:18 ***[****Now, speaking about the prophetic detail of the law, you know what the law says about divorce.****]*** **[1]If a man divorces his wife to marry another woman, he commits adultery; also the man who marries a divorced woman, commits adultery.**

(Although this verse seems to be completely misplaced here, and possibly added by a copyist, I would attempt to clarify its meaning in my commentary:

[1]The first man mentioned here, symbolically represents Israel, married to the Law of Life - in its prophetic relevance and significance. This mirrors Adam & Eve, married to Elohim in likeness, innocence and oneness, until the fruit of a forgotten identity drives them out of fellowship. [See my notes on Why the other tree, in 1 John 3:12.]

In the meantime, Israel's leadership, historically represented in their kings and priests, committed adultery with their idol worship and apostasy, provoking Jaweh to jealousy. And now, here in Jesus' time, they are represented in the Scribes and Pharisees, who miss the Messiah in their midst by abandoning the prophetic theme of Scripture and its entire culmination in the unveiling of the incarnate Christ. They divorce the law of life to marry another woman, the ***poneros****-prostitute, the letter of the law of hardship, labor and annoyances. Which is the same fruit of the poneros tree in the garden of Genesis.*

The abandoned wife, Lady-law of life, represents the entire human race, and she is pregnant with the incorruptible prophetic Seed; then, in the fullness of time, she gives birth to [2]Messiah Jesus. Now, because the Pharisees and the Law-lovers have already divorced themselves from the prophetic relevance and significance of the law of life, they would continue to hold their followers hostage in their hypocrisy, since the followers would be committing adultery if they attach themselves to the new husband, Jesus!

This would appear to be a stale-mate situation, as the English idiom goes, "Caught between a rock and a hard place"! There seems to be no escape for someone "departing" from the law of hardships-, labors- and annoyances-system, without committing "religious-adultery"? [The word often translated, "evil" is the Greek word ***poneros*** *which means to be full of hardships labors and annoyances. Rom 3:27.]*

Paul's teaching brings clarity, see Romans 7:1, I write to you in the context of your acquaintance with the law; you would agree with me that laws are only relevant in this life. Romans 7:2 A wife is only bound by law to her husband while he lives; any further legal claim he has on her ends with his death. Romans 7:3 The law would call

her an adulteress should she give herself to another man while the first husband is still alive. Yet, once he's dead, she is free to be another's wife. Romans 7:4 The very same finality in principle is applicable to you, my brothers and sisters. In the incarnate Christ you died to the system of the law; your inclusion in his resurrection brought about a new union. Out of this marriage, [faith] now bears children unto God. [Where the first marriage produced sin [a forgotten identity]; righteousness [rediscovered sonship] is the child of the new union. In the previous chapter [Romans 6] Paul deals with the fact that our inclusion in Christ in his death broke the association with sin; now he reveals that it also broke the association with the system of the law of works as a reference to righteousness.]

The book of Hosea is one of the oldest books of the Hebrew Bible, predating most of the Torah. *[800BC]* In powerful prophetic language, God speaks to Hosea. *[Hebrew for Jesus - Savior - הושע Hosea, meaning "he rescued"]*

Hosea 1:2 The LORD said to Hosea, 'Go, take to yourself a wife of whoredom and have children of whoredom.'

His wife's name is Gomer, גמר which means completeness/finality. The verb גמר ***gamar***, is to complete, to finish. This is the prophetic announcement of the end of the law of performance-system. See Heb 8:7, Jesus was made apparent as the conclusion of the dispensation of condemnation; he fulfilled every single prophetic pointer to the mission of the Messiah-Christ! The verb ***gamar*** occurs only five times in Scripture *[the number 5 means grace]* all in the Psalms; Psalm 12:1; Ps 77:8 *[Has his steadfast love for ever **ceased**? Are his promises at an **end** for all time?];* Ps 138:8 *[Jahweh will **perfect** his work in me; O Jahweh, your mercy endures forever; you will not forsake the works of your hands];* Ps 7:9 and Ps 57:2 *God **fulfils** his purpose for me.*

Then God tells Hosea to name Gomer's firstborn son יזרעאל ***yizreel*** meaning, God has sown. And then her daughter, לא רחמה ***lo rachamah*** meaning, no compassion; not pitied. Hos 1:8 When she had weaned ***lo rachamah*** Unloved, she conceived and bore a son. Hos 1:9 And the LORD said, Call his name לא עמי ***lo ammiy*** Not my people!

*[**Yizrieel** is a type of Christ - he is sown into the earth, and in his resurrection, he announces that the new has come! The old things have passed away!]*

Then in the next chapter, God says to Yizrieel,

Hos 2:1 Say to your brother, "My people," and to your sister, "She has obtained mercy." *(The word, Racham רחם means to fondle; to show fondness and compassion.)*

Hos 2:2 "Plead with your mother, plead..."

Hos 2:14 Therefore, behold, I will allure her, and bring her into the wilderness, and speak tenderly to her.

Hos 2:15 And there I will give her vineyards, and make the Valley of Achor a door of hope. And there she shall answer as in the days of her youth, as at the time when she came out of the land of Egypt.

Hos 2:16 "And in that day, says the LORD, you will call me, 'My [1]husband,' and no longer will you call me, 'My Boss.' *[Baal* בעל *- also husband but more in an owner/ manager context, rather than [1]my man,* אישי *- ishi, my man! My intimate spouse/ companion! From "slave-driver" to soul mate!)*

Hos 2:17 For I will remove the names of the Baals from her mouth, and they shall be mentioned by name no more.

Hos 2:18 And I will make for you a covenant on that day with the beasts of the field, the birds of the air, and the creeping things of the ground; and I will abolish the bow, the sword, and war from the land; and I will make you lie down in safety.

Hos 2:19 And I will betroth you to me for ever; I will betroth you to me in righteousness and in justice, in steadfast love, and in mercy.

Hos 2:20 I will betroth you to me in faithfulness; and you shall know the LORD.

Hos 2:21 And in that day, says the LORD, I will answer the heavens and they shall answer the earth; *(Hebrew* ענה *'ânâh, to hear; respond; to sing. In Ancient Hebrew* en *reading from right to left, the pictograph of the seed and a person with raised hands seeing an amazing sight! Gen 3:15 The seed of the woman shall bruise the serpent's head!)*

Hos 2:22 and the earth shall answer the grain, the wine, and the oil, and they shall answer Jezreel; *(The single grain of wheat shall not abide alone! John 12:24. See* **Hosea 6:2** *"After two days he will revive us, on the third day he will raise us up!")*

Hos 2:23 and I will sow him for myself in the land [יזרעאל *yizreel*]. ***And I will have compassion on*** [לא רחמה *lo ruchamah*] ***Unloved, and I will say to*** [לא עמי *lo ammiy*] ***Not my people, 'You are my people'; and he shall say, 'You are my God.'"***

Then in Hosea 3:1, after Gomer had left him to continue her promiscuous lifestyle, the Lord commanded Hosea to find her and buy her back! *(1 Peter 1:18,19.)*

Hosea 6:2 After two days he will revive us, on the third day he will raise us up! *(See Eph 2:5,6; Col 3:1-3)*

A hundred years later, another prophet with the almost the same name, sees the new Jerusalem-Bride, in the context of powerful prophetic salvation poetry, recorded in Isaiah 52,53 and 54. His name is Isaiah ישעיה meaning, Jaweh has saved.

Isaiah 52:1 Awake, awake; put on your strength, O Zion; put on your beautiful garments, O Jerusalem, the holy city. *(Addressing the city of Jerusalem in the feminine singular in Hebrew. Through the feminine form of the command 'awake!'* ***uri! uri!*** עורי עורי *and* ***livshi!*** לבשי *'put on', as well as the feminine singular possessive and objective pronoun endings on the words,* ***izek***, עזך *'your strength',* ***tifartek***, תפארתך *'your beauty' and* בך ***bak***, *'in you'.)*

Isaiah 54:5 For your Maker is your husband, the LORD of hosts is his name; and the Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer, the God of the whole earth he is called. [See my notes on ***The City-Bride*** at the end of Rev 3.]

Epilogue

I'm often intrigued with the thought of how brief time is.

How do we make fleeting moments last beyond their momentary presence in our smell, sight, sound, taste or touch-world?

How do we enlarge memory?

We certainly are the generation who captures and documents more moments in megapixel clarity than any other.

Paging through thousands of these, one very briefly "relives" some of the more "stand-out" and dramatic ones.

In the meantime we invent what we call "currency" to at least "measure in order to justify", a form of "reward" to the exchange of precious life for the time we exhausted in the pursuit of our dreams and the idea of relevant value.

Considering our authentic origin, revives the thought of a dimension that might be more familiar to us than any known, temporal value within our typical, physical horizon.

Jesus, the great Rescuer of the human race has given us the key that unlocks the prison doors to free us from every futile effort to define our lives and translates us seamlessly into the romance of the ages. Our redeemed union, the blueprint life of our design, is celebrated once more in the adventure of uncompromising oneness.

The gates of Hades (not to see) are disengaged.

I encourage you to live the adventure of life from this wonderful space of permanence on a day to day basis, where you know that you are known, and loved and have nothing to fear.

We've wasted so much time trying and striving to get "there", when "there" is where we are to begin with!

Nothing we can ever do can get us more elevated than what we already are!

Perfection is not the eventual reward for many years of striving in trial and error-mode!

It's not what you do to persuade God, it's what God did in Jesus to persuade you!

Living 'towards' will keep you busy

Living 'from' will keep you blessed!

Who we are by design and redemption does not shrink into something inferior when we experience crisis or even death!

We simply expand into the boundless dimensions and blissful awareness of our oneness!

2 Cor 4:8 We often feel completely hemmed in on every side but our inner space remains unrestricted; when there seems to be no way out, we escape within!

Biography



Lydia and Francois met on the 25th of August 1974, while he was working with Youth For Christ. She was sixteen and he, nineteen. The following year he studied Greek and Hebrew at the University of Pretoria for three years while Lydia completed her nursing training.

In 1978 Francois also spent a year with YWAM.

They married in January 1979 and are blessed with four amazing children, Renaldo, Tehilla, Christo and Stefan; also, two darling grandchildren Nicola and Christiaan.

They pioneered and worked in full-time mission for fourteen years, during which time they also pastored a church and led a training facility for more than 700 students over a five-year period. During this time he translated several of the Pauline Epistles [The Ruach Translation], which were never published; although printed along with other booklets he wrote and distributed amongst their students.

They then left the ministry and for ten years did business mainly in the tourism industry.

They built and managed a Safari Lodge in the Sabi Sand Game Reserve and eventually relocated to Hermanus where they started Southern Right Charters boat-based whale watching.

In December 2000 Francois began to write the book, "God believes in You" which led to him being invited to speak at various Christian camps and churches. Since February 2004, they travelled regularly abroad and into Africa as well as South Africa.

Francois has written several books in both English and Afrikaans, including God Believes in You, Divine Embrace, The Logic of His Love; these are also available on Kindle. Also, The Mystery Revealed and Done, which are no longer in print - although still available in Afrikaans.

In order to focus their time on writing and translation, they relocated from Hermanus in 2015, to a remote farm in the Swartberg Mountains. They have since, also stopped most of their travelling.

Lydia has written 6 amazing children's stories of which Stella's Secret, The Little Bear And The Mirror, Kaa of the Great Kalahari as well as The Eagle Story, are already published in print and on Kindle. Her most recent story "King Solitaire's Banquet" will be released soon.

Francois passionately continues his translation of the Mirror Bible, which will eventually include the entire NT as well as select portions of the Old. The 1st 250 page, A5 edition, was published in 2012. The

current 9th edition Mirror Study Bible is a 7 x 10 inch book, now almost 1000 pages.

Lydia's books are already available in English Afrikaans, German and Spanish.

The Mirror Bible is currently available in Spanish, Shona, Xhosa and large portions in German.

More than 50000 people subscribe to their daily posts on Social Media; Lydia has her own fb page and Francois has 5 English pages and an Afrikaans, Spanish, Hungarian, French and Dutch page on Facebook.

Their email address is info@mirrorword.net

You can get more detail about them on www.mirrorword.net

The Mirror Bible is also on Kindle as well as an App, app.mirrorword.net

Their Mirror Word YouTube channel link is, https://m.youtube.com/channel/UC63YHkpabON9nHgQqWeIPkA/videos

Referred to by the author's name or by some abridgement of the title.

THE MIRROR STUDY BIBLE

BBE (1949, Bible in Basic English)

Dr. C Baxter Kruger (The Mediation Of Jesus Christ.)

J.B. Phillips Translation (Geoffrey Bles London 1960)

KJV (King James Version - In 1604, King James I of England authorized that a new translation of the Bible into English. It was finished in 1611)

Knox Translation (Translated from the Vulgate Latin by Ronald Knox Published in London by Burns Oates and Washbourne Ltd. 1945)

NEB (New English Bible New Testament - Oxford & Cambridge University Press 1961)

RSV (The Revised Standard Version is an authorized revision of the American Standard Version, published in 1901, which was a revision of the King James Version, published in 1611.)

The Message (Eugene H. Peterson Nav Press Publishing Group)

Weymouth New Testament *(M.A., D.Lit. 1822-1902)*